The Way You Bend, The Way I Break

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The Way You Bend, The Way I Break

by itsmarilena

Summary

Phainon found himself plagued with both disgust and curiosity after finding out about his best friend's secret, a BDSM-forward lifestyle. And as any good friend would, Mydei offered to give him a glimpse into what it was like to be not just a submissive, but his submissive.

If Phainon could just be open-minded to new experiences, then Mydei swore he would find it in him to be patient with his ignorant feelings towards it all. But at what point did a test run between friends become the real thing between lovers?

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[tags will be added as i update.]

Notes

we are gathered here today because i love bdsm, i love mydei, and i love phainon. so. what better to do than combine all three?

this will be a story with HEAVY bdsm elements that explores 24/7 dynamics and learning the ropes of it all. i am in no way a bdsm mastermind, but ive dabbled in it for a LONG time. if it isnt your thing, sorry. might wanna move on.

this is also fixed dom/top mydei and sub/bot phainon. they will not switch. i have no preferences for either, but i just felt like writing it this way.

will do my best to update as often as i can! and again, tags will be updated as i write more and more c:

Chapter 1: Chapter One

Phainon was… curious. That was all.

His best friend since high-school had a secret, one he had let him in on once but seemed to keep to himself otherwise. It wasn't an accident when he had confessed, nor was it coerced out of him in any way. Mydei simply said it over the phone as if it were a casual fact about him, like he didn't care if he knew even if he didn't ever talk about it.

"Well, I haven't had a boyfriend, but I did have a submissive. He wasn't difficult to talk to."

He hadn't understood what that meant or why he felt the need to differentiate between the two.

Was it similar to the *'square is a rectangle'* kind of logic? A boyfriend could be a submissive kind of partner, but a submissive wasn't always a boyfriend?

How did that even work? With nothing but casual sex between them? Were there no romantic feelings involved?

From what he knew, his best friend wasn't a playboy. Mydei didn't casually flirt with guys in an attempt to take them home, and he didn't seem to like other people most of the time too. That stoic expression of his didn't exactly give off the impression he enjoyed company, and his way of speaking came off more callous than anything.

If he thought long enough, he wasn't even sure if Mydei ever mentioned the guys he found attractive or wanted to potentially ask out. The only reason he knew he was interested in guys to begin with was because of a singular enamel pin that once lived in the strap of his high-school book bag.

They had never really spoken about the topic either, just accepted the other wordlessly as they shared details about themselves over time. Coincidentally, that was how most of their friendship went—silent acceptance of uncomfortable topics and full-blown, back-and-forth banter over others.

Phainon had wanted to ask about this particular thing when it happened, however, but over the phone after a failed attempt at picking someone up felt like a terrible setting to have the conversation. He didn't have it in him.

Now, he wished he did.

Mydei's slip of the tongue had quietly bothered him since the moment he heard it, and he talked himself into believing it was because his own sex life was bone dry. It has been years of just him and his steadily growing collection of toys. Part of him assumed it was that way for his best friend too since he never brought up partners, dates, or feelings. As ambitious as he was, he thought the other man was just too focused on climbing the corporate ladder of his father's company.

Yet that one sentence proved Mydei wasn't going through the same thing as him. That one line told him that while he was single, bored, and feeling a little left out of the romance scene, Mydei was secretly seeing God-knows-who and having the time of his life.

On one hand, good for him. On the other hand, it was just a little bit annoying.

Though he knew he could try to find someone at a bar or club too, strangers never seemed to hit the mark he needed them to. Pretty girls approaching him didn't excite him as much as they should've when all they wanted to do was dance on top of him. Handsome men offering to buy him a drink only made him think too much about going to a place he's never been to with someone he's never met to do things while he was too drunk to remember his own name. There were hardly any moments to just… talk, to get to know each other better before moving on to physical things, and there were too many potential risks in sleeping around. His brain never let him enjoy it.

On top of that, his heart couldn't take just being someone's sexual object for a night when he wanted a connection closer than that. It didn't make sense how someone could open themselves up without trusting them first.

That was why he confronted Mydei.

With two shots of liquid courage in his system before the man showed up, as they sat around his apartment casually chatting about the newest thriller movie they were watching, Phainon just had to know. It ate away at his psyche, begging to be acknowledged.

"Hey, De? H… How did you even find a submissive?"

Mydei hummed, the sound low and rumbling as he contemplated his answer for a moment. "I met my last one on a dating app," he answered simply, cleanly.

Dating apps somehow felt worse than bars or clubs. They felt emptier than talking face to face, and he heard stories of catfishing and uncomfortable sexting from his other friends who have them.

Mydei never seemed like he would take part in the online-dating group of people, but he guessed these were the intimate details that wouldn't typically be shared in a conversation. Those habits weren't just casual day-talking conversations. Especially since his style of dating wasn't, well, *dating*. It was darker. Dirtier.

"Why do you want to know?" Mydei wondered after.

"You sound a little defensive. Is there a reason why?" Phainon shot back as amber eyes bore right into his cerulean ones.

Mydei's lips pursed. The rim of a sleek glass touched his bottom one, then tilted back for a drink of the rich, caramel-tinted liquor.

"No." Alcohol burned his vocals into a rasp. "But why ask such a question so suddenly?"

“How’d you even get into it?” He asked him instead, too tangled within his curiosity and confusion to entertain him with a response. “It’s some pretty violent stuff.”

“Pardon?”

Thick, golden eyebrows furrowed together into a pinch as his gaze hardened. More than a purse, his lips then tilted downwards into the makings of a frown.

Phainon swallowed over the brooding expression. “What?”

BDSM was violent. Dominance of his kind was aggressive in nature, and submission was the fear in response to it. Rules and punishments, permissions and denial, those kinds of things weren’t common in a relationship. They weren’t something someone should adhere to in a place where comfort, trust, and acceptance were meant to be. It was arbitrary.

In addition to not being a playboy, his best friend wasn’t necessarily a violent person either. He had his moments of anger, but so did everyone else when pushed far enough. Which was what made this even more surprising.

When did he grow to crave such all-consuming power over someone?

“It’s *not* something violent if you don’t want it to be,” Mydei argued, pulling him from his thoughts.

His glass clinked to the coffee table, and the movie they were watching was paused with a singular button. Everything they had been doing was put on halt, stopped so they could have this conversation.

“I am *not* violent with my partner.”

“You’re not, but isn’t that what *BDSM* is, Mydei? Sexual violence?” He reasoned, unable to accept that it was different from what he read about online. “Someone pushes something on to someone else, and they’re too afraid of punishment to deny that demand. Sadism is right in the title, and sadism is, by definition, getting off on hurting people. It’s… *violent*.”

Mydei’s voice cut like a knife as he retorted, “Why are you suddenly so interested in things you clearly don’t like?”

Phainon paused, aware that he was upset with his viewpoint and poking at a lion poised to strike. But he also knew that he wouldn’t try to interject more than necessary because he valued his privacy greatly. Trying to prove him wrong would mean having to admit the gritty details of his affairs, and he wasn’t the kind of guy to just spill his guts for anything.

“It doesn't make sense,” he told him. “Why are they considered your *submissives* and not your *boyfriends*?”

“Why are you so fixated on my personal affairs, Phainon?”

This time, it was him who turned to face the other man better. With his knee bent on top of the couch cushion and his hands on his calf, he gave Mydei his complete attention back.

“Why won’t you answer my questions? Is it because you know I’m right?” He bit, trying to imagine his best friend in the shoes of some of the videos he saw while searching for answers.

The man throwing someone’s smaller body around as he pleased despite their cries for mercy; the man tying someone up with rope, hitting their delicate skin while in such a defenseless state, and finding enjoyment in their pain; the man resting his heavy, dirty boots on top of someone's bruised, naked body while casually watching television—that was Mydei. That was his best friend.

The same guy who bent down to pet stray cats on the street and gifted his friends meticulously wrapped, homemade desserts was a person who got off on dehumanizing his partner.

Phainon wasn’t sure how that sat inside of his stomach as he looked at him, at the face he almost didn’t know if he recognized.

A shadow had been cast over him, replacing the golden light that once cascaded over him. How was he meant to see him as that same person knowing what he enjoyed doing to someone else?

“You’re prying into a place you don’t belong,” Mydei warned him carefully. “My relationships or lack thereof, my kinks and fetishes, and my preferred lifestyle are not any of your business, Phainon. Stop.”

“You’re my best friend. Of course it’s my business too,” Phainon insisted as a weight pulled at the depths of his gut. Desperation laced his words. “I don’t want to be friends with—”

“—with *what?*”

Silence followed.

The tension between both men was chokingly thick and heating with each passing moment. All of the oxygen in the room dissipated, replaced with something that could be sliced with a knife, something not so easily taken into the lungs.

Mydei’s glare over him was hot. Piercing, even, like it shot right through his body in an attempt to find an explanation himself since he refused to answer his questions too.

“You’ll look me in my eyes and accuse me of being an abusive person?” He asked incredulously.

Hearing that unspoken accusation materializing out loud in his own voice, Phainon supposed that it sounded a little bit… outrageous. Maybe he was being unfair by assuming so baselessly. After all, simply having and liking a submissive partner didn’t mean he wanted to hurt people.

This was his best friend. They had grown up with each other for over ten years now, visiting each other’s houses as often as their parents would allow them to and begging to spend the

night after. When he had football games in high school, Mydei was there in the stands to support him, win or lose. During the days Mydei was too drained with his family problems to make it to his college courses, he took extra time to help him study the notes he had written down for him in their shared classes.

Mydei wasn't a bad person. He knew that. His heart knew that.

Phainon's shoulders sunk in on themselves, and he looked away as the accusation hung heavy in the air.

"That's not what I…" He tried to defend himself, just to sigh heavily. "Forget I said anything, De. It's not like I think you're a bad person."

His best friend scoffed bitterly. "Clearly you do, Phainon."

Guilt weighed over him as he winced from the sound, not used to hearing so much venom within his voice. Especially when it was directed at him.

"No, it's not like that," he protested weakly. "I'm just… I-I guess I'm confused on how it works."

"The internet is in your pocket."

"The internet is why I think the way I do!" Phainon raised his voice.

As their eyes met again, Mydei's glare softened.

"Don't you think I already looked online, De? And guess what I found there? I found people w-with bruises over their bodies, and people being treated like sexual objects, and people talking about how their '*masters'* control every aspect of their life from when they wake up to what they eat! Isn't that just a little bit crazy?" He begged him to understand, voice pitched louder with disbelief. "Is that… your life? Do you do that?"

Deep down, he was begging to hear him say '*no*'.

No matter his interests and no matter his past, even if it was just a little white lie, all he needed to tell him was that he got it all wrong. None of that was his thing. He didn't enjoy a single aspect of anything he just listed. It was crazy. Who could live like that?

But another beat passed them, and that hope plummeted faster and faster with each second of silence.

Then Mydei answered, his voice much more gentle than it had been previously.

"*Yes*."

Phainon's breathing hitched over the response he knew was coming, and he leaned away from him as he gave the man a once over.

“Does that upset you, Phainon?” He asked honestly, still holding on to that same gentle tone. “Knowing what I do in my own time, does that make you feel uncomfortable around me?”

“You get off on controlling a person’s life,” he whispered back, amazed that Mydei didn't see it the way he did, the way most people did.

“No, Phainon, I get off on having sex with my partner in a way we’ll both enjoy. That’s all,” he corrected him, speaking as if he were talking to a confused child. “Instructing someone who wants to be guided shouldn’t scare you. That’s just a couple with good communication.”

Was it? Could it really be *that* simple, innocent, and clean?

“So… *what?* You look for helpless people willing to submit blindly to you?” He accused him, unable to find the best way to word his thoughts. “You find people who want to be bossed around, and you just… boss them around? Like that? Like a *dog?*”

“I look for people whose interests align with mine.”

Phainon wanted to scream. He wanted to grab Mydei by his shoulders, shake them until reason came to him, and then yell that he wasn’t explaining anything. His responses didn’t shake his lingering concern away in its entirety.

It chewed at his insides that Mydei liked hurting his partner and making them submit. Because in that same breath, it meant he liked a man who wanted to be hurt and forced to submit.

That someone would probably be smaller than Mydei was, though that wasn’t particularly difficult. They would have to be more timid than him too in order to let him take the wheel in their own life, and maybe even more insecure in order to fully objectify themself for sexual gratification. Like someone’s ‘*pet*’.

Or, worse. Maybe this mystery man would prefer to be called Mydei’s ‘*slave*’.

Shivers wracked Phainon’s body over the demeaning title, forcing him to look away from his best friend in hopes of wiping that sickening thought from his head.

A heavy hand then settled over his shoulder, holding him gently.

“I don’t want to argue with you about how I choose to live my life,” Mydei said, but it felt a little late for that. “Will you tell me why you’re so curious now?”

“Because!” His voice raised for a moment, then dragged on into a quieter sound as he gripped the leg of his sweatpants helplessly. “Because it’s… different… from anything I know, okay? It’s weird, and it makes me feel so differently about… things.”

Mydei sucked in a sharp breath, and a few seconds later, he exhaled as if those words had physically hurt him.

“I see…”

“Well, it’s not weird, it’s just… confusing to me. It’s—”

“Phainon.” He was cut off, and his lips sealed as he stared down at his white knuckles. “You wouldn’t happen to be… curious about these things, would you?”

“*Huh?!*”

Cerulean eyes snapped upwards, widened from the sudden question thrusted at him.

That was only meant to grab a reaction rather than be answered truthfully, right? Which then meant he didn’t need to dignify it with a proper response, *right?*

Secretly, he pleaded for that to be the case even if it wasn’t likely. Everything in his body told him that was wishful thinking. Because while staring at one another, Mydei gave his shoulder a tight, reassuring squeeze. The pad of his thumb dug in deep, rubbing gently by the collar of his t-shirt.

Of course he meant that.

“If you’re genuinely curious about how this works for your own agenda, I’ll do my best to explain. If you just want to stay ignorant, I can take my leave right now,” he offered him, and Phainon laughed nervously.

“W-What kind of person do you think I am?” He smacked his hand away before balling his fist tightly. “I don’t want to hit anyone, Mydei! That doesn’t arouse me!”

“Forget the *sadism* and the *masochism* aspect of it for just a second, okay? Forget people hitting each other or making each other cry,” he suggested. “Consider the other parts of the acronym. Consider *bondage*, *dominance*, and *submission* in a not-so aggressive kind of way.”

“I don’t want to tie someone up either!”

Mydei’s head tilted. “Then… maybe you want to be the one getting tied up, Phainon,” he hinted at him. “Have you ever considered being in that position?”

At that, he laughed again. Though his best friend’s expression didn’t change, he couldn’t help but find it funny.

Him being into bondage? Not a chance.

There was never a point in time where he wanted one of his ex-girlfriends or boyfriends to tie him down to the bed and have their way with him. It was already so nerve wracking to get that far, to open up and let them see the parts of him that no one else ever has. That trust, his feelings, and mutual pleasure were all of what he had to give. Adding restraints into the mix of that mess, and the lack of control to stop them from doing anything they may have wanted with his body, would be too much. He just didn’t have it in him.

“You’re insane,” he accused Mydei. “Too much could go wrong with that, and what if they’re secretly a terrible person trying to just… hurt me? I wouldn’t be able to stop them.”

“I wouldn’t.”

A pound cracked against his ribs over the response.

“I don’t find pleasure or comfort in going against someone’s desire. That would make it rape, Phainon, and I’m *not* a rapist,” Mydei tried to reassure him. “There are others who are just like that too, and they aren’t rapists either.”

“Mydei…” He trailed off quietly, unsure what to say back.

“There are all kinds of people in the world. *Someone* is bound to enjoy what I do, and *that’s* who I want to be with. No one else.”

“What is it then?” Phainon mustered up the courage to ask outloud, watching closely to study every micro-movement he made.

Just what exactly was it that he liked? Not anyone else—*him.*

A deep breath then filled his chest, inflating it to a momentary puff. “I am always in charge,” he said to him, getting straight to the point and leaving no room to misunderstand him. “Ideally, my submissive would look to me for whatever they needed, and I would hold most of the power in this relationship.”

To Phainon, that sounded arbitrary. It sounded completely one-sided.

Were they not allowed a say in anything that happened to them? Was Mydei meant to rule their life completely as if they were his devout follower and he were their god? His—*dare he think the word again*—slave?

“Your last submissive… What happened to him?”

Mydei sighed, teeth pulling on to his bottom for a moment as he paused to think. “He was a good man, and we had a nice time together, but we weren’t compatible. I told him he should go find what he wanted, so he left.”

Oh.

Phainon wasn’t sure what he expected the story to be, but it definitely wasn’t that. It wasn’t Mydei just letting him go because he couldn’t provide for him, and the other man—*who he had never even met*—to just agree.

“Things like…?” He tried his luck by asking, hoping to find out what Mydei didn’t like as well.

“That’s not my business to discuss.”

That sounded a lot like the man he grew up with—good at keeping his affairs his own and never one to talk behind someone’s back. He had been that way all their life, straying away from idle gossip and spreading information he wasn’t yet certain of. Reliability and honesty were some of his most defining traits, and Phainon knew this. He knew.

And yet a strange discomfort still sat within the depths of his belly, tugging him in a direction separate from his head.

“Right… Sorry,” Phainon apologized, bringing his hands to his face to rub it. Fingers pressed to either side of his nose, slipping up and down shortly before covering over his eyes in an attempt to hide his face.

Why was he so upset by Mydei’s sex life?

Because he didn't have one of his own and felt left out? Because it was so out of the ordinary that he needed to know every detail about it?

Were those even good enough reasons to pry so deeply into his privacy?

“Look…”

He hummed in acknowledgment.

“I don’t know why you care so much, but if it upsets you this much, just… ask,” he encouraged him again. “I’ll tell you about myself, but leave my exes out of it.”

Mydei’s voice felt warmer than ever, like a blanket wrapping around him to pull him back together when he was in pieces. It always did with that nurturing tone.

“Why?” He found the courage to ask, speaking just as softly. “Why do you even like controlling someone?”

“Why do I like taking responsibility for someone?” He reworded, but that didn’t make it sound any better to him. “I have always been good at taking care of people. It’s natural to me.”

Phainon peeked through his fingers, finding that Mydei was still looking at him with his lightened expression. Not angrily. Not defensively. Not even agitatedly. Lightly, like he understood him and his concerns, like he wanted to make him feel better even if it meant exposing his own secrets.

That only made him feel worse for second guessing his supportive character.

“I want someone that wants to please me the way I want to provide for them.” Phainon gulped, listening intently. “That would make it a mutual exchange of power, not a one-sided relationship.”

“And if they don’t listen to you…?”

His heart was pounding. Anxiety simmered underneath his skin for the answer he knew was coming.

“A warning comes first, of course. If they continue past my warnings, I’d have to punish them,” Mydei said as if it were a simple series of events. Just how normal was it for him to

punish his partner? “How would they feel if I stopped taking care of them because I simply didn’t want to? This is an agreement, so certain requirements need to be met.”

Phainon nodded slowly, attempting to see it from his point of view. “If you make a promise to someone but don’t keep it, that’s… upsetting,” he reasoned.

“Yes, exactly," Mydei agreed with that comparison. “If someone promises me obedience, I expect obedience. If I promise to take the lead, they expect me to lead them. We both have a role to fulfill.”

That cold, creeping feeling in his stomach still didn’t disappear, but maybe this was making a little bit more sense now than it did half an hour ago.

“What’s a ‘*punishment*’ to you?” He found himself asking, only realizing a second after that he might not want to know all the details.

“Anything we agree upon. Time away from watching their favorite show, not being able to go out shopping for things they want, not having an extra dessert…” Mydei listed whatever came to mind, and he was silent as he listened. “It could be time alone by themselves away from me, wearing something they don’t like but I do, or something more sexual in nature.”

“Like?”

He hadn’t meant to ask so quickly, but if his best friend noticed, he didn't say anything. Thankfully.

“I could possibly spank them,” he brought up, which was something tamer than he expected him to say. “I could gag them so they can’t talk back or cuff them so they can’t touch me. It’s hard to say because it depends on the person, the offense, and if it was an accident or not. Everyone is different.”

“So, the bruises…”

Mydei shrugged lightly.

“Maybe. It’s a possibility. But I won’t leave them like that. I keep creams and other aid on hand to treat my punishments.” It was said like a promise, like he was swearing that it wasn't as bad as it sounded.

“And that’s… normal… for your relationship?”

“Yes. It’s important to take care of the other person’s wounds and feelings after,” he explained. “Some people do like it though, Phainon. They like being hurt, and that means some people like hurting them. You have to accept that it’s their business, not yours.”

“I don’t care about what other people do,” he brushed off.

Mydei’s lip tilted upwards after hearing that. “You only care about what I do then,” he pointed out.

“You’re my best friend, so of course I want to make sure you're not hurting anyone,” he retorted, circling back around to his first argument. “Don’t look at me so smugly.”

“Have I eased some of your concerns?”

Phainon wasn't entirely sure this conversation did.

He didn’t feel as put off from the idea of him enjoying it anymore, but there was still this whisper that haunted the back of his head. It told him Mydei liked submission, and he liked people who would let him do whatever he wanted with them. That was his fetish. That was something he couldn’t live without as it seemed each secret relationship of his was the same way, with him leading someone else like a pet.

Even if he was a good guy, if he pet stray cats on the streets and rubbed ointment into bruised skin, he craved to reward, punish, and have that authoritarian-type of control.

It hurt in his stomach the longer he thought about it.

“How do you find people to sleep with but not me? I’m not nearly as picky as you are,” he huffed, and Mydei snickered while turning away from him.

“Perhaps I just know how to look in the right places,” was all he said before standing up. “Besides, you only sleep with people after you’ve bought them a wedding ring. I believe that’s a bigger requirement than wanting a naturally submissive person.”

“Not true… I just want to like the person I’m sleeping with.”

Mydei picked the empty takeout boxes left on the coffee table up, and as he walked away, Phainon felt his stomach grumble. The plates of barbecue they had ordered previously were not enough, it seemed.

“Are you still hungry?” He called back to him.

Instead of answering, Phainon chose to grab his forgotten glass and throw back the last of his forgotten drink. It burned lightly going down, warming his throat and chest in the process.

“Phainon, are you deaf?” Mydei grumbled loudly, not hearing as he coughed from the alcohol. “If you’re still hungry, I’ll make you something real quick. What’s in your fridge?”

“I have to go shopping this weekend, so nothing much right now,” he admitted. “I guess I am still a bit hungry though. All I’ve eaten was this today.”

“*Tsk*. Maybe you need someone to take care of you if you have whiskey in the pantry but not proper food,” he scolded him.

“It just lasts me longer than you! In case you forgot, I’m not a daily drinker like *someone* is!” Phainon defended himself. “Don’t lump me in with all of your little boy toys, De!”

He came back to the living room soon after, phone in hand as he tapped on the screen repeatedly, dutifully. Each click of his keyboard made him more confused. Every tap made

him crane his neck further to peek at the screen.

“What are you doing?”

“Ordering you some groceries for the next few days,” he said casually, and Phainon’s eyes rolled over his protectiveness. “It’s bad for your body to skip meals. You shouldn’t make a habit of doing that, Phainon.”

“I don’t. I just had to get a new tire, so I took it out of my grocery bill,” he told him. “Thanks though, De. I appreciate it. I can pay you back when—”

“Don’t be stupid,” Mydei brushed him off, then placed his phone on the couch beside him. “No more alcohol without food tonight, lightweight. You’ll get sick.”

He never noticed it, but Mydei was always in charge of the things around them. They butted heads because of it, fiery personalities colliding to start a blaze sometimes, but he always tried hard to take care of what, or who, was closest to him. From buying him things without any warning to scolding him when he wasn’t careful with himself, it was as if his best friend was taking responsibility for him.

Was this how he treated his partner—*his submissive*—in the past?

Did Mydei buy that man things if he couldn’t afford it, ensure he ate enough throughout the day, and take care of his wellbeing if he didn’t care to? Would he reward him with the freshly baked desserts he handed servings out to his friends?

That soft, spongy fruitcake he gave to him, Cyrene, Cassie, and Cifera a few weeks ago on a whim, was that a piece of his ex’s *reward?*

The thought was amusing *and* uncomfortable.

“Free trial run,” he snickered to himself as Mydei sat down on the couch beside him again.

“Hm?”

“I was thinkin’—”

“Oh no,” Mydei cringed, and he gasped in offense as the other hung his head. “Now what?”

“—if you act like this to your sub’, then I’m technically the first you ever had,” he teased him, and Mydei was silent as his face scrunched up momentarily in confusion. “All the things you did for me as your friend, was that how you got into these kinds of things? Was I the free trial before you decided you wanted a premium plan?”

“Stop thinking. It doesn’t suit you,” he deadpanned, not bothering to look at him. “Every time you open your mouth something senseless comes out.”

“C’mon.” Phainon pushed his shoulder lightly, smiling at the way he allowed himself to sway from his touch. “You know I’m right."

“‘*Trial run*’,” he repeated under his breath, then scoffed. “At this point, my commitment as your best friend will be the longest one I’ll ever have. These so-called ‘*premium plans*’ don’t last me even a fraction of how long I’ve known you.”

“Don’t jinx our friendship! Knock on wood!” He cried.

“Okay, and where is the wood?” Mydei asked, splaying his hands in front of him as if to tell him to look around them. “Your carpeted floors, your glass coffee table, or your leather couch? Do you have a brain?”

Well, he had a point.

“Smart ass,” he huffed, pushing him again.

“You would give me such a migraine as a submissive,” Mydei sighed, then grabbed the television remote from between them. “‘*Trial run*’…”

“If you can’t handle me, maybe you should get better at being a dominant. I’m not even doing anything,” he told him, earning a snort.

Mydei’s arm hugged the back of the couch as he raised an eyebrow at him.

“Are you serious? Phainon, you didn’t even know what it meant to be one about ten minutes ago,” he reminded him, sounding both offended and amused by the jab. “You have as much knowledge about *BDSM* as a house-dog does of the outside world.”

“I am *not* a dog!”

“You sure bark like one,” he shot back.

“What? Are you gonna muzzle me if I’m barking too much for your taste? Will you punish me for using my free will?” Phainon scoffed, unsure where in his chest it was coming from but feeling as each word climbed his vocal cords and fell from his mouth.

Mydei’s eyes rolled. “With how much you keep bringing this topic up, I’m starting to believe you might *want* me to.”

“As if I’d want that!” He protested, but the thought brought a sickening tingle throughout his body. It chilled around his chest and inched into the pit of his stomach.

There was no immediate response, but Mydei watched him for a moment as he squirmed within his spot. Amber eyes darted from the way he held on to his own arms, hoping to subtly soothe the prickle of his skin, and then back up to his face where heat had pooled inside of both cheeks. Whether it was the alcohol in his system or not, he didn’t really know, but they were warm. Maybe rosy.

And of course Mydei noticed.

“Are you sure?” He egged him on. “You might enjoy it.”

“Of course I’m sure,” Phainon hissed sharply, looking away from the eyes that always saw right through someone. “I’m not some… some pathetic, subservient *mutt*. I don’t want someone to dictate my life for me.”

“Don’t lie,” Mydei warned him. “Look at me, and think about it, Phainon. Why are you so interested in it? Why do you keep bringing it up? Why is my style more important than anything online when I told you it’s almost the same?”

“Be—”

“You and I both know it’s not because we’re friends,” he cut him off before he could even get the word out. “Are you interested in this? Do you want a proper trial run of this?”

He was quiet, too busy biting the inside of his lip and trying to push that bubble of confusion, curiosity, and disbelief aside. They mingled together into a tangled knot, one that made his stomach cramp uncomfortably the longer he mulled the question over.

Did he want that?

No… There was no way. He didn’t want to be told what to do with this time or how to behave by someone with a power trip. It didn’t excite him to imagine someone sticking their nose up at him and expecting him to obey.

But this was Mydei. His best friend, Mydei. Would sooner run his bank account dry than let someone struggle in front of him, Mydei.

Mydei wasn’t just someone, and he wasn’t some faceless, nameless ‘*dominant*’ who didn’t give a damn about how people felt.

“Phainon.”

He looked back at him.

“It’s alright.” Mydei came in closer to steal the space between them. He could feel his presence coming nearer and the warmth radiating off his body. “If you’re curious, it’s best to be honest with me. Don’t joke around with it, and don’t run away from me.”

A shaky breath fell from his lips.

He could feel his heartbeat picking up. Each pound slammed against his ribcage, threatening to break through the bone with each passing moment.

“You can trust me.”

He knew that. He did.

There was only one other person he trusted as much as he did Mydei, but she was currently taking a trip back to her parents’ house. She wasn’t here to ask what to do, and she wouldn’t be for awhile. Texts weren’t the same, and the service was always so bad out there in the countryside that calls felt like pulling teeth with a pair of pliars.

He couldn't rely on her advice for this, just his own judgement.

"I'm not someone who can let my guard down easily," he reminded him. "I mean… I haven't had a relationship since I was a teenager, and no matter how hard I try, I can't even want someone enough to participate in things like that freely."

"You're thinking too much about it."

"You—!"

When looking back at him, his breathing hitched. The tension in his brows that he didn't even realize was there smoothed out, and his lips sealed shut before he could even finish his sentence. All the words he wanted to say had been stolen within seconds.

Mydei was there. *Right there.*

Leaned closer to his height, one hand on his knee and the other on the back of the couch, he was only inches away. Liquor fell from his breath. Crackled leather from his coat and warm amber stained his burgundy collar where a few buttons had been undone. Sunset bangs were swept over the crooked bridge of his nose, kissing his golden cheeks but splitting to reveal his expectant gaze.

"Don't say '*someone*' if you mean me," Mydei instructed him, speaking quieter since he was so close. "You don't care about them. You said you only cared about me."

"M-Mydei…"

"You need to be honest with me, Phainon. What do you want out of tonight?" He asked him seriously. "Did you really only call me over to have a few drinks and watch movies?"

Phainon gulped, and as his lips parted for a response, a knock sounded at the door.

Before Mydei could speak, before he could force him to ignore the presence and respond, he bounced on to his feet and rushed over. Stumbling, he used the doorknob and wall to keep himself upright.

The door was pulled open, and he looked at the paper bags left on the floor before glancing to the driver already walking down the steps. Four bags were in front of him, each packed full with things Mydei had picked out for him. From what he could see, there were fresh vegetables and produce, even a few peeking labels of pasta boxes and packed bread.

"I bet the bread and eggs are at the bottom," Mydei commented from behind him, and he jumped from the proximity. "Here, let me help you put these away."

Without waiting for a response, he lightly batted him aside to carefully pick up three of the four bags. By chance, or maybe by his design, the last happened to be the least full of them all.

"Thank you again for this, Mydei."

“What are friends for?”

Phainon locked the door behind him, and as he cradled the brown bag in arms, he watched as Mydei began unpacking them.

“This is a lot for a few days…” He trailed off.

“Three nutritious meals a day, snacks in between, and a little bit of sweets to keep you happy. Doesn’t seem like a lot to me,” he reasoned with him. “You need to eat properly. You’ll lose muscle and weight if you don’t.”

“It wouldn't be that noticeable.”

Mydei stood his ground. “It never is until it is,” he insisted.

The bag in his hands was set beside the others, and as Mydei tucked a bottle of juice away, his shaking fingers grasped the sleeve folded up by his elbow. They curled into the soft fabric, grabbing his attention almost immediately.

“Mydei, look. I’m not really… good at being open about my feelings,” he confessed, staring at his heavy forearm as he was unable to meet his eyes. “To be honest, I-I don’t know why it bothered me so much to know you’re so much more successful in dating than I am…”

A soft hum of encouragement followed, coaxing him to continue speaking his mind.

“Usually we’re so neck-and-neck, but it’s like you’ve got this whole thing figured out while I… don’t.” The awkward, forced laugh that bubbled past his own lips made Phainon cringe on himself lightly. “On top of that, the things you want are so… out there. I needed to understand how you could manage it but I just… can’t.”

“*Heh*…”

Mydei’s opposite hand planted itself on top of his head, and he grunted quietly over the weight of it.

“Stupid,” he mocked him playfully. “We aren’t competing on who has a better love life. I may have had more partners, but yours have lasted much longer than mine.”

Phainon’s eyes followed a folded sleeve up to the bulge of Mydei’s bicep, then brought his attention towards his face. To his surprise, the other man was ready for it. He met his eyes swiftly, holding on to his gaze.

“And for the record, if it was you, I-I think I could trust you.”

“Could you?” He asked as if he was interested in that statement. “So, if I were to tell you to bring me our dishes from the living room, sit at the bar to keep me company, and let me fix you a small meal, would you listen to me?”

His heart skipped. His stomach knotted.

Exhaling shakily, he gave a singular nod of his head.

“I mean, it’s the same as just straight up asking me as a friend, right?” He laughed nervously, trying not to see it as a test but a simple request. “I wouldn’t… say no… That’s my mess out there too…”

Mydei nodded in the direction of the living room. “Then go,” he said simply, casually, like it wasn’t a thinly veiled command.

“S… Seriously?" He double-checked, and Mydei nodded curtly. “That’s an actual… demand? You want me to—”

“Phainon, please just go,” he repeated himself, softer this time. “Bring me our dishes and that bottle, then come sit down for me.”

His hand let go of him, and he turned to the living room slowly.

“I’m only doing this because I have to clean up my own mess anyway,” he tried to convince him before walking back to the living room. As he did, paper bags crinkled with movement once again.

It felt so odd to hear his best friend talk like that to him. His tone of voice and clear-cut instructions made his stomach tight, but he still wasn’t sure if it was out of disgust or interest. Both feelings grew around one another like roots mingling too close together, using the soil of his insides as a place to mature as one singular flower. A horribly confusing flower that blossomed suddenly, violently, when he thought of *BDSM* and its complicated nature.

All at once, this was embarrassing and thrilling.

He was upset at himself for rolling over to listen, yet his body was alive in ways he never was before from doing a simple, meaningless task.

Phainon’s fingers shook as they stretched to pick up their twin glasses. The cups rattled from his unsteady hold, glass clinking and echoing a pitched chime. His other hand grasped the neck of their almost-empty bottle of whiskey, eyeing the caramel liquor that was giving him all his strength.

Without it, he probably would have caved in on himself and never called Mydei over in the first place. But three small drinks and he was obeying the other man like some kind of butler…

He almost wanted to throw the last of the bottle back in hopes he could forget tonight entirely come tomorrow morning. It whispered his name, beckoning his lips to meet the opened rim, to reignite that phantom burn down his throat. Maybe it could kill that flower inside of him, burn it from the roots before it could bud.

“Phainon, what’s taking you so long?”

He snapped his attention in the direction of his kitchen, breathless, and carried all three glasses back to Mydei.

What was wrong with him?

“Here,” he offered him, thrusting them all across the counter roughly. “Finish it before I do.”

“I said no more for you tonight.” Mydei took the bottle before removing it from his arm’s reach. “Here. You can have water.”

The words echoed within his head.

‘*You can have water*.’

This was *his* apartment. He paid the rent every month for it. This was *his* kitchen. He bought the bottle Mydei had grabbed from the refrigerator on his last run to the grocery store.

But he could have it. It was his water, but Mydei was giving him permission to drink it instead of the alcohol eyeballing him from across the room. The alcohol he wasn’t allowed to have even if he bought that too.

Phainon stared at the cold bottle, then at his best friend’s back when he turned to chop some lettuce that he definitely didn’t have in his fridge ten minutes ago.

“I can have water,” he repeated to himself quietly, bringing the drink closer. “What else can I have inside of my own place, De?”

“For now, just sit.”

“Yes, *master*,” he mouthed back.

His knife drove harder into the cutting board, thumping sharply through the otherwise silent room and rattling the couple of spoons left in a dish rack.

“What?” He continued, amused by his still figure and silence. “Gonna keep bossing me around in my own place? Is it getting you off to tell me where I can sit, what I can drink, and decide what I get to eat, De?”

“Phainon…”

“Tell me where to put my bottle when I’m done with it, or when I can head to bed for the night,” he tagged on, warmed by the heat within his cramping stomach.

Mydei’s voice lowered as he set the knife down. “Phainon, stop,” he warned.

“Should I sleep on the left side or the right side of my mattress, *master?*” He bit back, not caring to listen. “Can I wear a shirt as I sleep, or do I have to be shirtless for your viewing pleasure, *master?*”

“Phainon, I said that’s enough!”

He flinched back from the strength of his voice, and Mydei looked over his shoulder to stare back at him with a fierce glare.

“Stop acting like a petulant little brat by throwing this tantrum, and stop calling me by that title,” he demanded of him. “I’m no one’s *master* because I don’t have a *partner*.”

Gulping, Phainon cracked the seal on his bottle with trembling hands. He threw it back quickly, hoping it could wash away the full-body chill Mydei’s outburst gave him and keep his mouth busy for long enough.

“If you hate this so much, you can say it. You can ask me to stop, and I will.”

He kept drinking, swallowing loudly and slowly.

“Or, we can keep playing this cat-and-mouse game until you make up your mind on how you feel about it,” he allowed. “Either way, if you’re going to be mouthy and disrespectful, I’ll find a way to make you quiet.”

A moment of quiet passed, allowing his threat to hang heavily in the air. Then the chopping sounds continued, proving that he was done speaking and ready to move on.

As Phainon’s bottle lowered, he watched him grab a plump, ripe tomato from the sink before slicing it in half.

“How?” He whispered between the rhythmic clicks of his chopping, and Mydei was still for another second. Nothing but the consistent hum of the refrigerator and crinkle of plastic filled between them.

“How what?”

He felt it, the bud in his stomach peeking in sick, twisted interest to see what comes next.

“How will you make me?”

Mydei brought the knife down and turned around to face him. With a quarter of the produce in one hand, he walked up to him and raised the opposite to grip his chin. His index finger brushed his bottom lip, and his thumbprint pressed firmly to the bone. They held him there steadily, not pulling him closer, pushing him away, or prying to make him drop his jaw.

“Open,” he said firmly.

Sparks popped through his body once more. They tingled in his chest and beneath his belly, buzzing through every nerve like a live current.

When he didn’t part his lips, Mydei stood taller in front of his seated figure. Those deep, honey-gold eyes stared down at him, gluing him into his spot within their syrupy gaze even as his leg bounced rapidly and fists tightened.

Another crinkle filled between them.

“Open your mouth,” he repeated himself, and Phainon slowly lowered his jaw for him. “If you eat it, that tells me you don’t want this.”

The tomato was placed on his tongue, and he made a move to sink his teeth into its flesh just to show Mydei the flex of his jaw, to show him he *could* just chew it up and swallow it down.

He could end this now. *Right now*. That was his free will, and it was something Mydei had no control over.

“I’m going to finish this sandwich, and you’re going to sit here quietly until you can eat it,” Mydei said slowly, ignoring his glare and the push back against his authority.

Part of him wanted to spit the thing back at him. How dare he think he could talk to him like that? So what if he did buy him this meal and decide to make it for him? They were friends, not partners. He didn’t owe him submission, and this game was starting to feel less like a game the longer it went on.

But a bigger part of him simply wanted to swallow its sweet juice on his tongue and leave it to fill his mouth. Where would this take them if he committed to this bit they set up? What would it mean for them both if he actually listened and kept it between his teeth?

Did he even want to know?

Phainon sat there silently as Mydei went back to fixing his food, both ashamed by his curiosity and intrigued by the possibilities.

It couldn’t have been that long, maybe even just a few minutes, but the wait felt like forever.

The stretch of his jaw wasn’t uncomfortable. Neither was the weight sitting on his tongue. But what it symbolized made him squirm, itching inside of his seat for this to end. Even without Mydei so much as glancing at him and his fully clothed body, he felt stripped bare for the other man.

A plate was set in front of him soon enough, and he looked down at the cold sandwich before flicking his attention upwards. Silent.

“Did you eat it yet?”

The right side of his lip curled upwards, revealing the bright red tomato still clutched between his teeth. Mydei watched him bite right through it this time, but Phainon decided to close his mouth while chewing.

Then, he swallowed loudly.

“Now I did,” he mouthed off, unsure what that meant for them both moving forward.

Had he completed that punishment? Was he meant to wait for an instruction to swallow?

“You’re going to give me one hell of a headache, Phainon, but if you can be open-minded, then I can be patient,” he told him, hinting at what he was both afraid of and curious about. “Do you want to start a trial run of this dynamic? If you don’t like it, you can cancel at any point in time.”

“Do you offer all your friends a chance to be your submissive, or is it just me?” Phainon found it within himself to joke, laughter being the best cure for confusion and awkwardness.

“You can sleep on it,” he brushed off. “Take the rest of the week to think about it.”

He was… serious about that? If they did this, then what did that mean for them as friends?

“Friends don’t just do things like that together,” he reminded him, wondering how he could be so casual about this all.

“Everyone deserves a safe and comfortable place to explore,” Mydei reasoned. “If I can be that for you, I will. The last thing I want is for you to look elsewhere and get hurt in the process.”

Phainon nodded, taking the dish from him and admiring its clean cut halves and impressive height. Packed full of vegetables and meat, it seemed Mydei was determined to make sure he ate enough before he went to bed for the night.

“You know, you’d make a good boyfriend if you actually dated instead of playing king or something.”

He huffed, acting annoyed for the sake of his joke. “You could make for a good submissive, if you aren’t scared of a spanking every now and then."

Everything inside of him lit up at the thought of possibly being spanked by his best friend’s heavy hand. Red flashed violently inside of his head from the sirens that screamed, ‘*do you really want to be hit*’. Sparks the size of fireworks bursted within his veins, each booming loudly as if to drown out those cries of reason.

“I don’t really…” Phainon cut himself off, trying to wrack his hazy mind of what he wanted to say rather than whatever was instinctual. “No. I never actually thought about having sex with you before.”

His best friend was an attractive man—that was an undeniable fact. Anyone with eyes could see how he meticulously upkept his appearance and his health, always making sure to fit a workout into even the busiest of schedules and dressing himself luxuriously. Being friends since childhood meant he had seen him in various states of undress, and his body was that of the gods chiseled from old, marble slabs.

But just because Mydei was attractive, that didn’t mean he ever considered having sex with him until his brain was infected by things like sadism and bondage.

Mydei shrugged in response. “We don’t have to have sex,” he reassured him.

Was *BDSM* not inherently sexual? Was pulling someone’s pants down and smacking their bare ass repeatedly not considered a sexual act?

Phainon lowered his eyes to the hands in front of him, to the thick fingers drumming over the counter, their trimmed nails, and the golden ring glistening on his pinky. He tried imagining them on his body. He tried to envision the heat of his palm when he cocked his hand back to

swing it against his bottom, the strength of his grip as he grabbed on to his body in pleasure, and the stretch of them possibly buried inside of him like the toy tucked into his bedside dresser. The hands that pushed him when he got annoying and held him when falling apart, how would they feel trying to please him?

A blank card was drawn.

He had never gotten that far with a man, and he couldn't quite picture what it'd be like to have his hands on him.

Mydei's arm lifted, and his focus followed until it reached to tuck a strand of sunset gold hair behind his ear. There, he looked back at his eyes.

"That is a subject we can talk about if you agree to continue. I have nothing else to say on that as of now," he brushed off. "Please eat."

"If I agree, will that ruin our friendship?" He asked quietly. "How could we go back to being the way we were if we…"

Phainon didn't need to finish his sentence. The sincere expression on Mydei's face said all he needed to know.

A twitch pulled on his lip, and he sighed before picking at the corner of his sandwich.

"Do you promise?"

Losing him would be the worst outcome of all. Forget the bruises that may happen. Forget giving up his autonomy. Forget being seen as a perverted freak for agreeing to try. If he lost his best friend because of this, what would be the point of anything after?

"Our friendship will not change, Phainon."

Nervous laughter bubbled from his lips as he realized he was seriously contemplating agreeing, and his clean hand pushed the other man away when he took a few steps closer. It was instinctual. His body just moved to do the first thing he could think of, and it just felt right to do.

Though Mydei swayed, he didn't move from his spot beside him at the bar. And though he only meant to push, his hand didn't move away from the plush muscle of his bicep.

It was comforting to feel him there, especially since this was uncharted territory he was blindly waltzing into. His only guide through the maze, and his only support in this secret endeavor, was him. He had to hold him.

Who knew where he'd end up if he didn't.

"Let's talk about it some other time," Phainon suggested, overwhelmed by everything they had talked about. "I would love to eat, then get ready for bed. If I'm lucky, I'll forget this in the morning."

“You didn’t drink nearly enough for that. Don’t delude yourself,” he chuckled back at him, allowing himself to be held.

He almost wished he drank more. Things would be so much easier if he woke up with nothing but a headache and magic groceries in his refrigerator.

Chapter 2: Chapter Two

Chapter Notes

> tysm for the support and comments. trying to to write as much as possible and as soon as possible.
>
> i have little brainworms for this that need to be fleshed out. theyre itching to come to life

As many times as Phainon had woken up in the middle of the night to change sleeping positions, the dreams of being his best friend's submissive partner didn't leave. And unfortunately for him, they weren't even one long, cohesive dream that he could slip right back into. That would have been too easy. It would have been too kind.

Instead, his imagination ran wild with whatever scenario it could think up, but he remembered only one when he woke up.

He recalled the scene where he was on his knees and looking up at Mydei's dimly lit figure with unwavering clarity. He could remember every detail in the outfit his best friend wore, a black-colored button down shirt with his tie loosened beneath its undone buttons and dark, fitted jeans that hugged his thighs nicely. A gold and navy pin attached to his tie glittered despite the poor lighting, and it matched the heavy, dangling earring beneath his ear.

There weren't any words telling him what to do, just the weight of silent yet deafening authority gazing down on him. But he wasn't able to speak either. His mouth had been free, and his lips could move to formulate the shape of words, but the sound of his voice was stolen. It didn't want to come out.

All he could do was sit there and rely on the other man to just… *know*. He had to trust him to make sense of, and follow through with, the things he couldn't communicate.

It left Phainon on edge the whole day, and he mentally blamed Mydei for it completely.

Had he never mentioned his ex-submissive so casually, he never would have gone searching online for all things *BDSM*-related that night. And had he never gone online to see the violent depictions of sex and domination, then he never would have felt the need to ensure his best friend wasn't secretly a terrible person. And had they never had that conversation last night, then he never would have had a dream so chilling and intrusive.

That image of Mydei mixed with his authoritative voice last night was all Phainon could think about at work.

His hands shook while tapping on the screen of his tablet to take orders, sometimes clicking the wrong option and having to make his tables wait longer than they should so he could fix

it. The painted smile on his lips when serving their dishes was just a ploy to mask the sinking, dirty feeling in his stomach for being so distracted. Each pitched word that came from his mouth was rushed and overly excited, leading to a few weird looks and awkward smiles, but he just didn't want them to hear what it sounded like shaking.

Then, as he listened to the chefs shouting at one another and chopping things at record speed in the kitchen, all it reminded him of was Mydei gripping him by the face and telling him not to speak. Those fingerprints stained the skin of his chin and jaw, phantoms pressing into them when he found himself still for too long.

He had looked so… in control, so in his element as he stood above him and told him what to do. It was as if he somehow knew how far to push and when to give him his space.

But was he seriously going to agree to that proposition? Was he going to just hand over everything to Mydei and follow behind him like a dog on a leash?

How long would this thing between them last? Did Mydei have an end in mind for it, or was it just until he decided he either liked it or hated it?

"Damn," a huff pulled himself out of his thoughts, and he looked over to his co-worker as she peeked down at her phone. "My stupid month trial is up…"

His lips wobbled into a shaky grin. Then, he laughed quietly to himself and hoped that was just a freak coincidence.

Logic told him that people couldn't read minds. They couldn't hear thoughts either. No matter how rampant and loud the words became or how long strangers looked at him and stood by him, these thoughts and feelings were his alone. The only other person who knew of them was Mydei, and he was on the other side of the city in his office at this point in time. He doubted the man was thinking about him as he took phone calls, sent out reports, and read his emails.

But even if he knew that, it felt as if his shame was printed across his skin for all to see. To him, he might as well have the word '*pervert*' tattooed over his forehead in big, bold letters.

—

After work, he decided to just swallow down what was left of his pride and text Mydei. He wanted to see if he could swing by his condo to hang out for a little bit, as it would make him feel a little bit better to have company around. Though, the most important part of this was having company he could confide in. Otherwise, he had other friends who he knew weren't doing anything tonight.

And as he always did, his best friend gave him a time to show up.

While at his kitchen bar, he almost wanted to ask for a drink stronger than his simple ice water, but he wasn't necessarily a drinker. Not like Mydei, who was fixing himself a glass of something strong just to take the edge off after a long day. Or maybe to give himself the confidence to have another emotionally charged conversation too.

Should he ask?

"Have you eaten?" Mydei spoke before he could.

"More than I should've probably," he joked, watching as his best friend leaned back into his refrigerator comfortably. "I visited my mom to pass the time before I came over, and she cooked up this whole feast."

"Did she really?" He encouraged him to keep speaking. "How has she and your father been?"

"Mm… She spent most of the time telling me how much she misses our hometown. One of these days, I need to get her out of the city and bring her back to that old, rickety house," he signed wistfully, thinking of his childhood home. "The smell of the ocean and the fields would be *so* much better than all this pollution."

"You should," Mydei rasped out, powering through the burn of his liquor. "Your father works hard too… All of you should take a trip back and recharge."

"It's just hard with all of our busy schedules," he brushed off. "When I save up enough and have some days off, I'll mention it to them… Hey, maybe I can kidnap you and show you where I used to live before we met."

Amber eyes rolled in response. "You don't need to kidnap me. You just need to ask me like a normal person."

"It's more fun if you're kicking and screaming."

His best friend snorted quietly, raising his glass for another sip as he looked into his eyes.

"There's only two rooms though, so you'll probably have to sleep in the wheat fields since the bed is mine," Phainon teased him. "I'll lay a blanket down for you, but try not to be eaten alive by the bugs overnight, okay, city boy?"

"'*City boy*'," he scoffed, not liking the sound of that. "A few bugs won't scare me, Phainon."

"We'll see about that. The mosquitoes there really sucked," he insisted, noticing when Mydei came closer so he could set his glass down. "Cyrene and I used to wear these repellent bracelets all day because they were everywhere. We never left the house without them."

"All mosquitoes suck, stupid. That's how they eat."

"*Tch*…"

Phainon stretched across the bar to punch his chest over that ridiculously annoying response, and Mydei laughed while simply accepting his blow. In fact, he had even leaned forward into

his fist and took the time to tuck their glasses aside, cautious of knocking them over.

“Careful,” he chided.

It was at that moment Phainon realized he was wearing a black button up shirt, similar to the one inside of his dream last night. Though he had yet to undo the tie around his neck completely, there was still a light gap between his undone collar and its knot. A peek of golden skin revealed itself, showcasing the dip near the base of his throat.

He gulped, fist loosening from his fist before snapping his attention away.

Damn. Just when he thought he had forgotten about it, the image of his best friend standing over him came back full force.

“H-How was your day?” He asked quickly, hoping to quickly distract himself from the memory again.

“Father continues to overload my schedule and nitpick my ideas simply because I’m his son,” he answered calmly. “Uneventful otherwise.”

“That sounds frustrating. I’m sorry.”

“Yes, well… He has no other children. It’s been my responsibility since birth to bear,” he brushed off, clearly not wanting to go in depth about it. Not that he blamed him. “I’m home now, so I’ll be okay until tomorrow morning. Do you plan on staying the night?”

“Nah, I mean… it’s probably better that I go back home later, right?” A deep breath filled his chest as he paused. “I’m just here to talk about… things.”

Mydei hum thoughtfully. “What do you want to talk about then? Your hometown and its ecosystem? My exhausting nine-to-five?”

Phainon shrugged, unsure how to bring up the topic he desperately wanted to get off his chest. Without a drop of alcohol in his system, it was proving to be impossible. He felt like a fish out of water.

“Um… have you eaten?” He asked instead, trying to buy himself just a little bit more time to prepare.

“*That* is your topic of choice? Learn your own lines,” he mocked him, amused by him copying his earlier conversation starter. “No, I haven’t. I planned to make something once you’ve run out of things to say… but this was sooner than I expected.”

He was quiet in return, and a golden eyebrow raised as if to silently ask if that meant *now*. Could he make himself dinner *now*, or did he have something more to share with him?

Which, yes, he did. He had so much going on his head that his skull felt as if it’d crack from the pressure. His ribs were no better since the weight on his chest was nearly suffocating.

If only he could speak as easily as Mydei could on topics like this…

“You know this is really difficult for me, yet you don’t seem too keen to step in and help me…” Phainon murmured, warmth pooling within his cheeks over the spotlight placed on him. “This isn’t something I do, De. You know that, right?”

It would probably be easier to pull teeth with a pair of pliers than it was to spit this mess out.

“You should learn how to communicate your thoughts and feelings better on your own whim. Depending on alcohol for some confidence will never teach you to trust in yourself,” Mydei advised him while a glass of whiskey sat right beside him on the counter.

“Hypocrite.”

“I don’t *need* this to be okay. I just like the taste,” he defended himself. “You need it to talk, but that has got to change, Phainon.”

“*Whatever*…”

He hated that it made sense and that he wasn’t at his own place to make a big deal about it.

Had this been his apartment, he would have griped until Mydei handed him the bottle or found a different way to shut him up. But this wasn’t his place, that wasn’t his liquor, and Mydei was not just the owner of both but the man expecting submission from him too. The second he walked into this home, his hands were tied.

His best friend then turned away from him to pull his refrigerator open, and Phainon’s eyes raked over the neatly organized shelves. Containers upon containers were stacked on each other, separated by their different colored lids as if he had some kind of system to upkeep. Some looked like meal prep with the food tucked inside, others looked like ones he just restocked when low. As if the store boxes and wrappers were an eyesore for him to look at.

Sighing to himself, he rested his cheek over one hand.

Mydei had it all figured out, didn’t he? His life was nearly perfect to a fault, if he ignored the strained relationship between him and his father.

Everything in his home had its place, and everything was in its place all the time. There was never a book left off its shelf, or a fork placed beside the spoons inside a dishrack. There was no mess to clean up because he knew better than to make one for himself, and he was so comfortable with himself that he could discuss embarrassing topics like *sex* with the utmost maturity and a calm composure.

It was intimidating.

Mydei was so incredibly intimidating without meaning to be.

“Is that a cake?” He asked suddenly, noticing a glass tray tucked on top of a higher shelf. Plastic wrap protected its top layer from the chilly, open air. “You baked one recently?”

“Yes.”

His hands pulled the baking dish out next, showing off a small, square cake with swirls of yellow and white frosting over the top. Considering the zest sprinkled into it and the soft, pale yellow bottom, he assumed it was lemon flavored.

“I made this last night,” he told him simply. “It’s a lemon cake with lemon curd and cream cheese frosting.”

Without explicitly saying it, Mydei had basically just confessed that he didn’t get much sleep after he left his apartment. If he had left his apartment late, then came back home just to make a cake from scratch, that meant he must not have gone to bed until the early A.M hours… when he wakes up at six-in-the-morning to work out before work. At most, he probably would have gotten about four hours of rest.

He probably shouldn’t stay so late and keep him up longer than necessary then, which meant he had to hurry up and *spit it out*.

“It looks good,” Phainon praised his work, making the other man smile. “Everything you make looks good though. What made you want to bake it?”

“If you can say what you came here to say without a drop of alcohol, I’ll let you have some,” he said instead, striking a deal rather than answering his question.

Phainon paused, unsure if he heard him right.

“I’ll leave it here. Take your time contemplating.”

Mydei continued with his business after that, grabbing things from his refrigerator and pantry to cook himself for dinner in silence. Pots clanked lightly to the stove after being filled with water, and the gas range clicked with life when dials were spun. Plastic bags crinkled from movement. Knives thumped to the cutting board quickly.

A gentle quiet settled over them both as he stared at the delicious looking dessert, unable to make his lips say the words he wanted to.

There was a time and a place to talk about things, but when and where were they? Over a slice of lemon cake and a bowl of stir-fried noodles inside of his kitchen after a long day at work?

If he didn’t do it now, who was to say he could even do it tomorrow? Or the day after? Or even the day after *that?*

But it was difficult to find the words to say. They could pop up inside of his head with ease, but somewhere between his brain, his tongue, and his vocal cords, they always seemed to lose their way.

Forget even trying the cake at this point, his chest had been heavy all day with the weight of his anxiety. He wanted that mess gone. He wanted that heaviness off of his chest.

Phainon groaned quietly. “Mydei, do you just Pavlov people with cakes like pet owners do dogs with treats?” He asked, not yet looking at him. “Do you bake things and put it in front

of your submissive so they know to obey for a piece?"

"I reward good behavior and habits."

"Manipulation tatics…" He murmured to himself, glaring lightly at the baking dish meant to coerce him into opening up. "I'm being trained like a dog to obey my '*owner's* will."

The worst part of it was he couldn't call it stupid when it actually *did* work to train animals.

"It isn't a '*manipulation tactic*'. It's an *incentive*, like how you get a promotion for performing well at work," he protested, choosing to ignore the second half of his snarky remark. "You don't have to do it, you know. I'm not forcing you."

Part of him wondered if that would work in helping him spit it out. If he could *make* him be quiet when all he wanted to do was talk, then surely he could *make* him speak when all he could manage was silence.

"It… might be too hard to get it out if you don't try," he hinted at him, hoping for a little push.

"I've given you an incentive. Is it not good enough?"

"I'm not motivated by *food*, Mydei," he hissed at him, silently cursing his sweet tooth for aching at the sight. But even if he did want the treat, a craving wasn't enough to make him spill his guts.

"Would you prefer it if I praised you then?" He suggested, his voice just as casual as it has been all night.

Phainon felt his heart jump inside of his chest over the question, but he scoffed quietly as a tingle tickled through his body.

"L-Like a dog, right?"

"I'm starting to believe that's your kink," he bit back, annoyed by the repetition. "Dog this. Dog that. Are you going to become a dog for me then, Phainon? Will you sit on the floor by my side and do tricks for my attention? Should I beckon you to me with a whistle or a snap of the fingers?"

"*Tch*…"

His shoulders stiffened, and there came that fabricated picture of Mydei standing over him with that all-powerful look in his eye again. This time, the sound of snapping fingers came with it, reminiscent of the way he would call his family's pets to him when he lived at home.

Sick.

That was *sick*.

His thoughts all day have been just as invasive, catered towards the darker, dirtier things he had seen and heard about. Mydei's prodding sarcasm didn't help. It wasn't coming off like the mockery he *meant* it to be, the joke it was *supposed* to be.

His words were a paintbrush over the blank canvas of his mind, and the images painted with them were too much.

"Don't say things that are so… so *weird!*" Phainon's words were rushed and breathless, sounding less his usual self and more like the wreck this whole thing was making him into.

"Then no, I won't praise you like a '*dog*', but like a man who did something worthwhile," Mydei corrected his previous comparison, sounding slightly annoyed that he even had to explain it to him. "Stop calling yourself a dog if you're not. Men are capable of being good too, so if you give me a reason to praise you, then I will."

Phainon sunk back into his barstool over his firm words, eyes shifting across the counter as he bit into his bottom lip roughly.

It wasn't as if he *wanted* to be praised by him, but the words did need to come out while he was sober. He knew that.

Without talking about the mess inside of him, how would Mydei know where he stood on this whole thing? This half-joking and half-serious situation would only make them both frustrated from having to constantly walk on eggshells.

Another quiet, frustrated groan left his lips, and he looked over to Mydei as he still just continued to do his thing like this was nothing to him. Like it was just another Friday night or a normal conversation between friends.

"I keep thinking about what we talked about, but it's… weird inside of my head and stomach when I think that I want to try," he forced himself to say, hoping for some kind of reaction. Maybe empathy. Maybe sympathy. Maybe an explanation of some kind since the other man was more knowledgeable than him in all of this. "I-It feels… gross… like I'm dirty and everyone else can see it. Does that mean I should stop?"

Was it a sign that he didn't really want it even if he had listened to him last night willingly?

He didn't *have* to obey. He didn't *have* to sit there, mouth full and unable to talk back, and wait for Mydei's attention to finally swallow. That was all on his own accord, no coercion required.

He… wanted to experience more of what they did, but if he wanted it, then why did he feel so *badly* about it?

"You still think of this as something to be ashamed of," Mydei reasoned, already having an answer. "That's not a perspective that changes overnight with just a couple moments of comfort or enjoyment."

Phainon swallowed. "What am I meant to do about it?"

“*I* can’t make you feel any kind of way, Phainon. That’s not how it works,” he explained to him. “*You* have to stop thinking this is wrong to want or that it makes you a terrible person.”

His teeth bit harder into his lip, and he watched as Mydei came back towards him with a steel spatula and silver fork in hand.

“How’d you do it?”

“I don’t typically feel repulsed by the things I enjoy," he told him, which only made him feel worse. Was he weaker than him somehow for being this full of doubt? “Certain kinds of people and play may be repulsive to me, but I just choose to stay away from them.”

A square slice of cake was cut out of its dish carefully, and though he could have just stretched his arm out to pass the plate to him, Mydei walked around the counter. It clicked beside him carefully, and the accompanying fork did the same when set down on top.

Once free, that same hand slowly reached to cup his cheek. There was a pause of hesitation, a silent second asking for permission, but when Phainon didn’t stop him, the warmth of his palm connected to his skin.

“It’s unfortunate that you saw the extreme side of things before anything else. I wish you would have just asked me instead of looking on pornsites or reading diary entries online,” he said to him, keeping his gaze locked into his own. “But you’re smart, Phainon. I know you're aware that whatever we start with each other won’t be anything like those heavier dynamics.”

He nodded weakly.

“You and I are not dirty for indulging in this, and even if we are to someone else, whose business is it?” Mydei asked him carefully. “What you and I may do, who needs to know about it?”

“N-No one.”

“No one,” he repeated much more firmly. “This is between you and I. The only opinions that matter are yours and mine, and I don’t find you to be dirty.”

“Do I even want it i-if I’m this messed up over it?” He whispered, stumbling over the words that felt like hell to spit out. “I’m confused…”

“New things can be confusing and scary,” he agreed with him. “You’re doing your best to be understanding, Phainon, and that’s as much as you should ask of yourself.”

Tingles sparked underneath his skin as his words echoed inside of his head.

‘*You’re doing your best’*.

“This right here is a very good example of what I meant by communicating your feelings, and I’m very proud of you for being able to do it,” Mydei praised him, gently rubbing his thumb across his cheek.

“I-I uh…” Phainon’s eyes tried to dart away, but with the hold on his cheek and his bottom still glued to the barstool, there weren’t many places he could go. “I’m…—”

“Keep this up,” he encouraged him. “If you’re feeling nervous or insecure, confide in me. If you want something or need something, ask me. My job is to take care of you and your feelings, to take these worries away from you so they don’t hurt you. For me to do that, you have to share them as they come, okay?”

Phainon exhaled heavily, feeling as his heartbeat picked up over the mix of his gentle praise and supportive words.

Mydei hummed, tilting his gaze slightly upwards to better gaze into his eyes. “Can you do that for me, Phainon? Can you be a good boy for me?”

The next pound against his ribcage was violent and sudden, striking swift and rough. It tested the strength of his ribcage, threatening to pop through the bones.

“Can I… H-Huh? *What?*” He choked out, stunned.

“Can you be a good boy for me?” Mydei repeated again in that same low, husky voice of his.

Something awakened inside of Phainon at that moment.

Though people have called him that before, it was always a mocking joke from their friends or simple praise from the adults around him as a kid. They often laughed at the way he committed to helping others even if it inconvenienced him in some kind of way. Those older people mentioned it in passing when talking about him and reminiscing his childhood to his parents. Being an objectively good person made him a good boy. That was it.

Or, that *was* it because never had someone said it like that—*like Mydei did*. With a tilt of faith laced in between each word, that singular question ripped the need to comply right from the deepest parts of him into the light.

Phainon always wanted to be good—a good friend, a good partner, a good son, just… *good*. That desire was innate, tucked inside of him for all his life, and he thought it was something every guy strived for. Simply being a good man would make for a good life, and having a good life meant he did a good job at living.

But as that desire laid open and bare between them both to see, it became sickeningly clear just how big a piece it was of him.

And Mydei knew that about him. He had to. His mouth was lifting higher and higher in either direction to form a confident yet kind smile, and the thumb pressed to his cheek began moving away from his face as the warmth under his skin as it burned hotter.

Why? Because he wanted to see it on his face and in his eyes as he touched that part of him. He wanted to watch his expressions and his emotions as they shifted and took over like the *sadist* he secretly was.

A short bubble of laughter left Phainon's lips shakily, the sound broken up by his flustered and pulled apart state. They started softly as a little shake in his buzzing chest, then grew louder as his belly tensed repeatedly to both let them go and stop them from coming.

"*Phainon*…" Mydei called to him, dragging his name out as if he was trying to guide him closer. Not that there was any more space to be taken between them. "Please answer me. Are you going to be my good boy?"

Another burst of laughter followed, but he willed his gut to tighten in an attempt to keep them inside. With it, his lungs decided to still, holding whatever oxygen was left inside of them and rejecting the rest.

Beneath Mydei's semi-amused and semi-impressed expression, Phainon suddenly felt naked. His clothes were on, and really only his arms and above his collar could be seen, but he felt completely bare.

His best friend just called him a '*good boy*'. More specifically, '*his*' good boy. Not just anyone's, but '*his*' as if to stake claim over his future decisions. As if to make him his without telling him.

And his entire body felt warm from it, like a current was buzzing through each vein and sending volts of electricity to every inch of him. His skin didn't quite feel real from all the sensations underneath it, and his chest ached from disappointment since he hadn't said it again. That pit living in his stomach was still there, all-consuming and dragging him down, but somehow even *that* tingled.

Was that… normal? Was *he* normal?

"Hm… Come here," Mydei hushed him, pulling him into a warm embrace by cradling the back of his head within his large hand. "Talk to me."

"Why d-did I like that so much?" He confessed, pressing his forehead to the crook of his neck as heavy breaths fell from his lips. "I'm… fuck. Mydei, what's… wrong with me?"

"It's a common kink. Nothing is wrong with you because you enjoy being praised," he reassured him. "You're okay."

"I'm okay?" He begged softly, needing to hear it again.

"Yes, you're okay."

He leaned in closer, allowing his cheek to settle against Mydei's collarbone and his deep breaths to drink in the scent of his cologne. Sweet, spicy, tinged with his own sweat from working all day, it was both so painfully familiar and yet so breathtakingly new. This was what he usually smelled like, but suddenly it felt so much… *more*.

The man holding him was his best friend for years, but all at once, now he felt like more than he did. His words held more weight and power to them, and his presence felt more comforting than ever.

“You don’t know much about kinks at all, do you…” Mydei said, but it sounded less like a question and more as if he were speaking to himself. Like a thought accidentally shared outloud.

“I do,” he defended himself weakly. “I know about kinks. I’m not *stupid* o-or anything, just… not particularly experimental, okay?”

“Besides being praised, tell me one you know you have, Phainon,” Mydei instructed him despite keeping his voice soft.

“I like being kissed on my neck,” he answered, but as he said it outloud, the confidence in his voice wavered. “And I like… being touched on my chest…”

He nodded, accepting those answers and not asking for more.

Phainon wasn’t entirely sure if he even had another to share with him past those two—*if they even counted as kinks*. He didn’t know what qualified something he casually enjoyed to upgrade into a ‘*kink*’ or a ‘*fetish*’, but he did really, *really* like those things. It had been so long since someone last did it, but every time he thought of someone touching him that way, it made his body tremble just a little bit.

“How do you feel?”

“Fine,” he mumbled even if his insides still felt a little bit shaken from being opened up so suddenly. “I’m fine. I think I want that piece of cake now…”

“Do you?” He pressed, using the fingers tangled within his hair to lightly rub his head.

“Mm… yeah. Sweets will help.”

Mydei, still holding him and still trying to soothe his uneven breaths, inhaled deeply. He could feel as the air inflated his chest and forced it closer against him, then as it fell and eased back into a more relaxed state.

Tucking deeper into him, closer towards his chest rather than his shoulder, Phainon pressed his ear up against the plush muscle. With his arms holding his own stomach, he fisted his own shirt tightly over the sound of a racing heart, of Mydei’s racing heart.

“… De?” He murmured, shifting in his cushioned seat. “Are *you* alright?”

“I feel fine,” he brushed his concern off, then cleared his throat. “You’ve earned that reward, so take it as you please. Enjoy your cake. I made it for you.”

Slowly, Mydei unraveled himself from his body. The hand in his head left, instead reaching to push the hair from his own face back, and the other one began to loosen his tie further.

“Your heart’s racing like crazy right now,” Phainon brought up, eyeing his face and the peachy tint painting his golden cheeks. “Why’s that?”

His head tilted, tempting gravity to pull a lock of hair down over his nose. “Do you want an honest answer, or would you prefer to ignore it?” He offered him a choice.

There was really only one choice.

“Truth. Only tell me the truth.”

“Heh…” Those amber eyes shifted, looking away from him as a breath left his parted lips. From this angle looking up, he could see the way his tongue lined the bottom of his teeth. “I… liked that expression on your face when I called you my good boy. It makes me want to say it again, and again, and again.”

To be honest, Phainon wasn't quite sure what he expected, but it definitely should have been that.

“Y-Yeah?”

“Yes,” he confirmed. “I don’t want to overwhelm you though, so I won’t do it again tonight. But I can’t promise it won’t come back up in the future.”

“You have a kink for praising people then,” he assumed, feeling as if it were fair to know after Mydei asked about his own.

“I have a lot of kinks.” Phainon gulped as his amber eyes looked right back to him, narrowed slightly as if to warn him of prying too deeply. “You won’t be able to handle a lot of them if you get *that* flustered over a singular phrase. I can keep them to myself.”

He knew that was true. It didn’t take a rocket scientist to figure out that he wasn't ready to sit and play at whatever level Mydei was on. Who knew how deep he was in this? Who knew how long he had been interested in these things?

Phainon knew this, but it still felt like he had blown a shotgun-shot sized hole right in the middle of his ego.

“I’m not some delicate little virgin boy,” he reminded him, and Mydei’s lips pursed over his defensive tone. “I’ve had sex, and I have my own kinks. Don’t look down on me because I’ve never used chains, or whips, or things like that.”

“Whips break skin easily and are said to be hard to handle. I’m *not* proficient in one, nor do I want to be,” Mydei denounced.

Immediately, he leaned in the opposite direction of him, poisoned by the mental image of a *whip* in his best friend’s hand. It would be just like the things they used on big animals to make them listen, right? The ones in movies that whistled when they sliced through the air and cracked like thunder when the blow landed?

And Mydei was strong. His arms and shoulders were padded with dense muscle, and he could probably crack a whip harder than anyone he knew because of that.

“You… *don't* want to use one?”

“I don’t,” he said again, easing some of his discomfort from that thought. “And chains are only attractive to me if they’re attached to a pretty collar or a man’s chest. I don’t care for the impracticality of chunky steel bondage gear, nor the smell of metal it leaves. It can be nauseating.”

Phainon leaned back further, scooting to the edge of his stool as his hands slowly cupped either wrist. He had a watch on one and a singular braided friendship bracelet woven out of purple and gold string on the other. The thought of heavy, metal cuffs over either one made him cringe.

Mydei, seeming to notice his discomfort, took a deep breath before closing his eyes. His own hand held his tie limply, and the other finished its travel through the lengthy strands of his messy hair.

“You told me two of your kinks, and I’ve told you two of mine. We are even now,” he decided, making his way back into his kitchen. “Damn. I got so distracted that I bet my food is cold…”

“One.”

“Pardon?” He asked, looking at him from across the bar and kitchen counter again. That forgotten glass was in hand, liquid swished with whatever was left of the ice cube it had.

“You told me one of your kinks, and I guessed the other one. That doesn’t count as you telling me two,” Phainon reasoned with him. “What’s another one?”

He hoped it was… simple. Normal, even. Maybe a kiss in a special place or a touch somewhere else. If not, he wanted it to be just as kind as enjoying to praise someone.

Time and time again, Mydei insisted that he didn’t like hurting people just for the sake of it. In fact, he liked to compliment people, reward them, and look after them. That meant he didn’t have to worry too much about him dropping some terrible and dark interest on him. It would be palatable. Maybe it could be out there, but it wouldn’t be anything crazy.

At least, that was what he hoped.

A golden eyebrow curled upwards in both amusement and disbelief, and an amused puff of breath left him. “Really? Are we splitting the hairs that finely? Must we go kink for kink?”

He nodded, not trusting his voice to convey how much he needed this exchange.

“Well… I like seeing pretty boys cry,” he disclosed, and Phainon grew still. His eyes left to stare at the dark countertops. “There. Are you happy with that answer?”

To hear that come out of his mouth, it meant only one thing to him at that moment.

“*You* would make *me* cry…” Because *he* would become *his* ‘*pretty boy*’ soon.

“You have always had very pretty eyes.” Mydei didn't even try to deny the accusation or sugar coat the truth. “If you would allow me to, I would want to.”

“How would you even…” Phainon trailed off unsurely, then widened his eyes as the answer became glaringly obvious. “I said I-I wasn’t ready to have sex with you. De, I’m not sure if I can do that.”

“Then I ask—does that mean I can’t touch you at all?” He kept his voice steady and firm. Genuine concern oozed from each word as if he needed to be sure. “You don’t need to take me, Phainon, but does that mean I won’t be allowed to spank you if you’re bad? Can I not get you off with my hands or a toy if you’re deserving of a reward?”

His lips sealed, and he looked down at his lap as he considered if he might want that with him or not.

Never had he thought of it, but did Mydei? Bringing up handjobs and sex toys so easily, did he already wonder about what it’d be like?

“What is ‘*sex*’ to you, Phainon?”

“I don’t know. I can’t think of stuff like that. Sex is just… *sex*,” he tried to explain.

“It’s okay. Calm down. When you’re a little bit more comfortable and relaxed, let’s… try something,” he suggested. “Let me touch you over your clothes. If you hate it, we never have to do it again.”

And if he *liked* it, what then? Mydei could just touch his body as he pleased because it would then be his own? Taint it with things only he would ever be able to give him since there was no one in this world he would trust this deeply?

Or, what if he *hated* every second of it? Would he get upset at him if it made his skin crawl to be touched that way by his hands?

Would it be better to just get it over with instead of sitting in a perpetual loop of worrying? Was the risk worth it?

“Phainon, talk to me.”

“If I hate it, would you get upset at me?” He found the strength to voice his thoughts.

“If you hate it, I’ll understand. You’ve never been the type to be with just anyone,” Mydei said back. “If you like it, there’s no harm in mutual pleasure. I’ll take care of you, and it’ll be okay. Do you trust me?”

Phainon took a deep breath, then nodded slowly as he tried to will his worries away.

“Yeah, I do. I trust you.” He swallowed down the rest of his nerves. “I’m off this weekend. Is Sunday do-able?”

“Mm… I’ll be with my mother in the morning, but I can be at your place in the afternoon. I’ll text you when I’m on my way,” he agreed. “Which reminds me…”

Phainon nodded again in silent acknowledgment, encouraging him to keep speaking and keep filling the air with words to bury the ones inside his head.

“If I ask you to text me every morning and every night, could you do that for me?”

“What for?” He wondered since they already texted one another every day. “What would I even send? An emoji?”

“‘*Good morning*’ and ‘*good night*’.”

His attention lifted, finding Mydei was already looking at him with his arms crossed over his chest. The food he had worried about was still sitting in a bowl beside him, cold and untouched, since he found himself busy with him instead.

“You want me to tell you that every day and night?” He clarified, just a little bit confused. “You’ll make fun of me when you see how late I go to bed… especially on nights I don’t work the next day. I can already hear you scolding my sleeping schedule.”

“I enjoy having a present submissive. One that updates me on their lives and includes me even if I’m not around,” he explained. “I won’t make you. But if you’re seriously considering this, then that’s one thing I’ll expect out of you.”

If he was being honest, two text messages didn’t seem like a lot to ask out of someone. Wanting the person he’s seeing to think of him so often and keep him informed of their day seemed like the most normal thing of all this.

He hasn’t dated in awhile, but he would do that without being told if he was in a relationship.

“I can. I’ll text you more.”

“I keep my phone silenced at work, but I check it periodically. You may text me as much as you’d like for whatever you’d like,” he allowed like that wasn’t *already* a channel open for him.

“If I see really fat cats when I’m out running, do you want me to send them to you?” He joked, trying to push their previous topic out completely.

Mydei stifled a chuckle, his eyes pinching from the lift of his amused grin. “Yes, Phainon. Please send me videos of the fat stray cats around your apartment complex. Update me as much as you can.”

“I can do that since you’re going out of your way to make this as comfortable as possible for me. Is there anything else you might want, *master*?” He teased, the word a little less daunting to say the more he used it.

His eyes rolled over the title. “You can also compile a list of the things you like for me. I know some off the top of my head, but a document would help.”

Phainon’s head tilted in confusion. “That’s weird. Why would I do that?”

“I want you to,” was his response. “If you want a specific pair of boots or a certain bottle of cologne, link it in that document and send the file to me. With it, I want to know the sizing too if necessary.”

A quiet laugh left his lips, now aware of why he wanted to know so much about him. It wasn’t rocket science to put two and two together.

“I’m not letting you—”

“Good behavior should be rewarded. If homemade desserts and meals won’t motivate you, allow me to spice up the reward pool,” Mydei cut him off, standing firm on his request. “You don’t need to ‘*let me*’.”

Phainon covered his face as heat began to burn underneath his skin from his stern tone and the nature of his request.

He thought about his best friend essentially spoiling him in gifts, and it brought a bittersweet knot to his stomach. It was one thing to force groceries at his doorstep, or maybe cover a meal every now and then when they shared one, but things like colognes and shoes would be too much. As kind of a gesture as it was, he couldn’t possibly let him pour money into him. This was meant to be a temporary arrangement, after all.

This wasn’t real. It was an experiment between someone who was experienced and someone playing with the idea of kinks and fetishes. A trial run to see if he liked it or not.

He couldn’t accept gifts like that. It’d be like taking advantage of him, and Phainon did *not* want to do that.

“Mydei, that’s not necessary,” he promised him. “I won’t be doing that one.”

“Does it upset you? Why?”

He shrugged. “I just don’t need that.”

“Yes, that’s why I said ‘*want*’, Phainon,” he mused. “You don’t need these things, but everyone has wants. For instance, I *want* to give them to you. It’s the same as if—”

“I just can’t accept gifts for nothing, okay?” He rushed to say. “Cologne, shoes, and things like that get expensive. I can’t let you spend that much money on me for whatever this is. You should use it on yourself or tuck it away for a rainy day.”

“*I want to*,” he repeated himself with a little bit more force. “Phainon, you are trying very hard for me. The things I’ve been asking of you are far from your comfort zone, but you’re pushing past it anyways to learn and understand. That is not ‘*nothing*’. Your efforts deserve to be rewarded.”

Phainon’s lip wobbled, and he shook his head while planting both elbows on the counter. He hid himself further, unable to let the other man see a single bit of his face.

“You just… Why’d you have to go and say that?” He asked him, already feeling the crack in his resolve. “Why’d you have to be so… supportive? You’re talking me up as if I’m doing something ground breaking when I’m just… trying out some sex stuff.”

“It’s not ‘*sex stuff*’. We haven’t had sex, but here we are still exercising this loose dynamic of you entrusting in me and me guiding you. That’s *dominance*. That’s *submission*,” Mydei explained, and Phainon’s shoulders shook with a silent chuckle.

He hated him.

Oh, Phainon hated that Mydei was so passionate about wanting to reward him because he knew he meant it. That was just the kind of guy he was, supportive until the grave. Even then, he would probably tag along as a ghost and continue egging him on to keep being better, to keep pushing himself to overcome his worries and fears.

“Fine,” he caved, glaring at the other man through his spread fingers. “Fine, I’ll do it! I’ll make that dumb list, and you can just play sugar daddy!”

“Thank you,” he said in return, earnest. “And I’m not a ‘*sugar daddy*’. I provide more than just sex and money to someone, so watch it.”

“I know. I know. I’m just talking shit. God, I feel like such a mess…” He grumbled, rolling his head to the side before sighing. “Mydei, I’m exhausted.”

“You’re welcome to stay the night, but I have a meeting to attend early in the morning. I then promised Cassie I would help her bake a cake for someone,” he informed him, tone slightly solemn as if apologetic.

Speaking of cake…

One arm dropped, and he picked up the fork beside him before bringing a bite of his forgotten treat to his mouth. Sugar and the light tang of lemon filled his tastebuds, and he sighed dreamily to himself over it.

It was making him feel a little bit better after the emotional rollercoaster he just went on, like the lollipops doctors gave him after getting shots as a kid.

“What will you do with the rest of that?” He asked curiously, pointing to the baking dish still on the counter. “That’s a lot for one person.”

“Perhaps one of our friends would enjoy it.”

He nodded, swallowed, and then pointed his fork to where Mydei was standing instead.

“Now, I need to ask this so be honest, De. Have you ever fed us things you baked for your other submissives?” He narrowed his eyes on him. “Did you feed us leftovers of their reward treats?”

“Hm…” His lips were pulled between his teeth, and he drummed his fingers over his arms before nodding his head slowly. “A few times I made something for them, but because they

misbehaved, I packaged it up and gave it to you guys."

"We ate someone's punishment dessert…" He mumbled to himself, taking another bite while wondering what gifts were of the heart and what were simply disposed on to him.

"The cinnamon rolls Cyrene gobbled up with her coffee—"

"Oh! Those were good too. Thank whoever that guy was for whatever he did to upset you. I promise that tray did not go to waste," Phainon grinned happily at the memory. "You *have* to make those for us again."

"Say please."

Their eyes met, and a light flutter filled his stomach over the stern tilt to his voice and expression.

Fork to his lip, he flashed a smile back at the man. "*Please* make those again for us," he obeyed.

"I'll keep in mind that you liked them. If you continue to behave well, I will continue to give you things you want," he promised him, nodding with approval. "If you become a spoiled brat, I'll have to refrain from giving you anything at all."

"Yes, *master*," he joked.

"You like that title a lot, don't you?" Mydei taunted him. "If you keep that up, I'm going to slap a collar around your neck."

The hand not holding his fork reached for the leather band he wore daily in his neck, and he pulled it a few times before letting go.

"Can't. I already have my choker, and I don't take it off. There's no space for a collar here," he mouthed off, not taking him seriously.

"You want to bet?"

Now he was taking him seriously.

"H-Huh?"

"No, not yet. I have rules, you have limits, and we need to agree on them." Mydei looked away, rubbing his jaw as he exhaled. "That's… a conversation for another time. Forgive me, I got carried away."

"Bring them over this weekend," he allowed. "Your rules… you have them written somewhere, right? Surely it's not just in your head. Knowing you, there's definitely some kind of folder."

"Yes. Of course." He nodded. "I'll bring my list, and we'll discuss them at your place. If we move forward with this, *then* I will be able to collar you. You won't take that one off either."

He gulped, holding the base of his throat gingerly as he imagined some kind of thick, leather collar squeezing it. Maybe it would be the ones with a heavy metal ring in the middle, the kinds people wore casually for an edgy fashion sense. Though he doubted Mydei wanted him in a collar for fashion's sake when he mentioned chains looked best when attached to them.

Was he seriously meant to wear two leather chokers on top of each other every single day? That would look ridiculous to other people and feel uncomfortable for everyone.

But maybe he'd get a say in it.

Knowing Mydei and how he's been with him, maybe they'll be able to talk about it then too. They could make it as comfortable as possible, and they could decide together about when and where he was meant to wear it. His best friend wouldn't jeopardize his life by making him walk around in some kind of dog collar at work or at home. He believed in that. He trusted him with that.

His fingers lowered, leaving his neck to lay against the counter.

Yeah, it would be okay.

Chapter 3: Chapter Three

Chapter Notes

> i have chapters drafted that i just need to edit/flesh out, so updates have been faster than usual haha. perks of hyperfixating on things.
>
> i wanted to make this detailed but not obnoxiously long (this is 11-12k words i think) so im sorry it some parts feel a little rushed. i hope they dont though.
>
> some bratty little touch-starved phainon getting, well, touched in this too. and mydei being his soft-ish dom self

Sunday morning, Phainon started his day off with his face smashed into his pillow, one eye cracked open, and his nearly-dead phone balanced beneath his hand. The edge was pinned to his bed, holding it in place as his thumb lazily dragged against his blurry keyboard. Every so often it slipped and clicked the wrong key, and while trying to delete it, he nearly dozed back off into a longer sleep.

> *[Phainon: Goof Morbingg Myfei]*

> *[Phainon: Good Morning Mydei*]*

Within seconds—*maybe, he had nodded off again while staring at his text messages*—his phone buzzed in his hand. The sudden vibration jerked him awake, causing his eyes to snap open and his phone to fall screen down into his bed.

Groaning, he lifted it back up and then looked at the screen, eyes squinted to read the response.

> *[Mydei: What morning? It is 11:36am…]*

> *[Mydei: This is to be expected when you go to bed at 3am. You should have slept earlier.]*

> *[Mydei: Did you at least sleep well?]*

> *[Mydei: This idiot fell asleep on his keyboard. No way it takes that long to type something out…]*

His eyes rolled. Had he not called it—Mydei bullying him for his sleeping schedule on his days off? It was as if he knew the future.

Phainon quickly tapped against the keyboard again, more awake than he had been when he sent his first few text messages.

> [Phainon: Okay DAD]

> [Phainon: And yeah, I slept great. Out like a light.]

Phainon couldn't remember what his dream was, but he hasn't had another night where Mydei had an almost ominous aura from above him. His imagination has been nice to him and his rest. If he *was* in one, it was simply as his best friend—smiling, laughing, and calling him stupid.

He wondered, at the moment, if it was because Mydei was making all of this *BDSM* stuff out to be less… dark… than he had originally believed.

> [Mydei: Don't call me that. I'm not on your birth certificate. If I was, you wouldn't be asleep at 12pm.]

> [Mydei: At least you slept well. Tell me about your dreams if you remember them.]

Phainon hated him. What was he going to do about him sleeping in when they really get this ball rolling? Punish him because he was tired?

> [Phainon: It's my day off and I'm a grown man. Mind your business.]

> [Phainon: And I didn't remember this one. Next one, I'll tell you.]

This time, instead of Mydei sending another text to him, he got an audio message about twelve seconds long. The play button stared back at him until he clicked it, and he cranked the volume up to better hear.

"*So long as you're doing this dance with me, your business will always be my business,*" Mydei said to him, leaving no room for doubt or discussion. "*And mind your tone when you're texting me, Phainon. Don't be a brat.*"

Underneath his voice was the chime of a store's door opening, then the muffled greeting of the receptionist to a woman. It wasn't his mom's though, as Phainon knew her voice well and it wasn't that high.

He was saying that in public. Maybe outside of whatever place he was at with his mom, waiting for her and biding his time by texting him. Or, well, *talking* to him for that instance.

Phainon shivered as he listened to it again, taking note of how his voice lowered in both volume and depth when telling him to behave. Like he was being not only firm to drive his point across but cautious of his surroundings.

Then he listened to it again, specifically that second half, and he hummed to himself as a warmth pooled into his stomach.

Once it finished, he tapped the microphone on his own keyboard and then raised it to his mouth.

“Heh, you never said anything about when I speak to you.” His own words were lowered from their usual pitch from just waking up, and they dripped with attitude. “You should mind what you say in public, *master*. You could get caught saying something you shouldn’t.”

He sent it, then turned the screen off before dropping the device on to his bed and sighing.

“Do not check that phone until he comes over,” he said to himself as it buzzed, and buzzed, and buzzed.

Mydei might just kill him, but why did that thought make his stomach feel so giddy?

—

Later, he had scrubbed his skin until he swore it was cleaner than ever, brushed his teeth twice just in case something happened there, and tidied up his bedroom since that was where he figured they’d be most of the time. Clothes were put in the wash to get rid of the pile on his chair. His bed was made up to make sure it didn’t look like he slept in until noon. The window was cracked open, curtains pulled open to let a nice breeze in.

It was perfect if Mydei decided he wanted to mess around a little bit. Well, hopefully it was perfect. He hasn’t done *that* in a while, and it was nerve-wracking to think about.

Phainon was busy agonizing over his hair in his mirror when his phone buzzed again from his back pocket. Seconds later, the doorbell rang.

Oh, was Mydei going to kill him for teasing him in public and then ignoring him for the last few hours?

A mix of nerves, excitement, and shame twisted inside of him, and he pulled just beneath his t-shirt’s collar to gently fan his heated skin off. Each step only made it worse, until he was standing at the door with his hand on the knob. It felt as if he would throw up, but he was trying desperately not to.

His phone buzzed again, causing him to suck in a deep breath before twisting the lock and opening the door.

“Where is your phone?” Was the first thing Mydei asked as he walked into his apartment, though it was clearly him *demanding* to know why he wasn’t responding to him. “Dead? Charging? Half way across the damn city?”

Phainon shook his head. “In my back pocket,” he answered honestly, unsure why his belly felt so… tingly.

“Then why weren’t you texting me back all afternoon? Did your fingers break while trying to make yourself pretty for me?” He pressed.

His best friend walked around him, making his presence known inside of his apartment before he pushed the front door closed on his own. The force reverberated through the walls and trembled them for a moment, then a steady quiet filled the space between them.

Not even his refrigerator kicked on to hum, as if holding its own breath in the face of his best friend's wrath.

Mydei leaned over him. The arm that had shoved his door closed bent at the elbow, pushing him in closer.

"W-Woah," he mumbled, chuckling awkwardly to himself as his eyes raked over his best friend's face and neck. "Mydei, y-you're um… close…"

He was in his personal space at this point, but when wasn't he? Since talking about this, it felt as if the man was always touching him or closing in on him to back him into a corner—metaphorically *and* physically. There was nowhere to go trapped between his body and the door, then nowhere to hide inside of his small apartment. In his head, there was still only him in all of his thoughts and senses.

It made his heart beat pick up just a little bit.

"Hands," Mydei demanded, and Phainon lifted both of his hands for him to see the second it left his mouth. "Not a single bandage in sight. Is your phone charged? Let's find out. Make these useful and hold this for me."

A deep, wine red folder was handed to him, and he marveled for a moment at how heavy it was inside of his grasp.

This wasn't what he was expecting at all. Just how many rules did he have for this to feel like some kind of magazine? How many pages lived inside of this plastic sleeve?

"Look at me."

His eyes lifted, meeting Mydei's as he raised his phone to his pierced ear. The screen darkened when close enough, but he had seen the contact photo before it did. He knew it was his own since it had been the same for years now—a picture of them at their college graduation.

As the dial tone rang, Phainon's ring tone began to chime. Each vibration in his back pocket made him sink deeper within himself.

"So, f-funny story," he smiled sheepishly, clutching the plastic folder tighter as the eyes looking down at him narrowed. Clearly, he wasn't in the mood for 'funny stories'. "You see, I was so focused on cleaning up that I forgot to check my phone. I completely zoned out! You know me, I can be a bit of a ditz."

"Mm…"

Mydei very obviously didn't believe him, but he also didn't seem too keen on calling him out on his lie.

“Let’s not ‘*forget*’ to text me back next time, okay?” Mydei hinted at, eyes travelling down his face and neck before picking back up to his own. “You want to be good, don’t you? You want me to praise you, speak highly of you, and reward you with nice things and delicious treats, right?”

A shaky breath fell from his lips, and though he couldn’t bring himself to nod, he knew it was obvious.

“Then the next time you decide to act like a mouthy little brat while I’m out with my mother, you’re going to take the consequences like a man instead of running off like a child,” he instructed him, speaking slowly to emphasize his seriousness. “Got it?”

He nodded weakly.

“I need to hear you, Phainon.”

“Yeah. Y-Yeah, I got it,” he forced himself to say.

Mydei gave one last look over his flustered expression before pulling away. With it, Phainon bit down on the inside of his lip and pulled the folder to his chest as if the plastic would cool his skin through his shirt.

“How was your morning?” He asked, following behind him as he made his way to the living room. “What’d you guys do?”

“She wanted to get her car detailed, so I took her to the hair salon for an appointment while we waited,” he answered. “I need stationary. Where are your…”

“Pens?”

“You don’t own markers anymore, do you?” He deadpanned, and Phainon shrugged. “When was the last time you saw a highlighter that wasn’t in college?”

“On my paystub when they highlight my cut after taxes.”

“Oh…” Mydei smacked a hand to his forehead. Breathing deep, he then nodded. “I know Cyrene has some kind of pink, purple, blue, or *whatever* kind of markers in her room. Please grab them.”

“She would kill me if I went into her room while she was gone…” He trailed off, more scared of her than he was of testing Mydei’s authority.

“Don’t get caught.”

His blood would be on Mydei's hands.

Phainon, still holding that folder to his chest, walked towards his roommate’s bedroom and flinched as he opened the door even if he knew she wasn’t there.

There would be no possible way that she knew he was in here unless there was a camera hidden inside of a teddy bear, but that bunny on her bed felt like it was watching him. If it was sending live footage to her phone right now, he wouldn't be surprised. Since his phone wasn't ringing and she wasn't scolding him in fragmented words because of poor cell service, maybe he was just being paranoid.

His fingers pulled her desk drawer open, and he sighed as he picked up a set of adorably packaged highlighters.

"Don't kill me, 'rene," he mumbled.

Once in hand, Phainon rushed out the door, a weight in his chest like she just knew what he was going to do with him. Like she was a fly on the wall and ready to make fun of him.

He set them on his coffee table, and Mydei stifled a chuckle over the cartoon characters printed on each one.

"Those are very cute."

"Don't mock them!" He hissed, hitting his best friend in the chest with his own folder. "Why do we need markers anyways? Are we studying this thing?"

"I'm not mocking them. They're cute," he repeated, then opened the sleeve up. "And yes, you and I will be discussing and creating our rules."

"What? You don't just smack me with the Ten Commandments and I have to oblige like a devout follower?" He grumbled, sitting down on the carpet between his table and couch. "Yes, *master*, my *master*. Whatever you wish from me, your darling *slave-in-training.*"

"That tongue in your mouth will get you in trouble. I advise you to bite it. *Now*," he warned him but sat beside him anyway. "Here's the key for how we'll revise these pages. Understand this before we do anything else…"

He picked three markers out, then placed a pad of white sticky notes in front of them.

"This… red-ish, pink-ish… color means '*no*'." As he spoke, he scribbled a box shape down and the word beside it. "This means absolutely not. You will not do that under any circumstances. Reserve this for your *hard*-limits."

Phainon pulled his knees to his chest as he nodded, watching him pick up another one from the pack.

"This orange-ish, yellow-ish color means '*maybe*'." Again, he scribbled in the shape of a box and wrote the word beside it. "This means you're not happy with this or you're unsure of it, but you're willing to do it with a push from me. Your *softer* and pushable limits will fall here. Understand?"

"Yeah, it makes sense so far."

“This green-ish, blue-ish color is ‘*yes*’.” For a third time, he created a final box at the bottom of the notes. “It means yes. You like it, and you want it.”

“I would have never guessed,” he joked, and Mydei shook his head as he peeled the note off. It was placed on top of his folder’s cover, then flattened out for easy access and reading.

Color-coded, like the tupperware in his fridge and the books on his shelves. He knew his best friend liked things neat and organized, but he never imagined him to be this meticulous with order.

“Now, we should have a safeword. Do you know what that is?” He asked, and Phainon hummed as he thought about it.

Safe… word. Safe meaning ‘*to protect*’, and word being, well, a *word*.

A word that protects.

“Is it something you say when you're scared?” He answered unsurely, hearing of it when he did his short venture online but never quite getting an explanation of it. “Or maybe a word to use when you don’t feel safe doing something anymore?”

“You’re close. This is a word that stops our play,” he explained to him, tapping the capped tip of a purple pen to the pad of sticky notes. “This word tells me you need a time out, and it tells you that I need a time out. It should be easy to remember and quick to say, and we both need to adhere to it.”

“What does someone say if they can’t speak?” He asked him curiously. “You put that tomato in my mouth to keep me quiet. Had it been something… different, what do I do with something I can’t swallow or remove?”

“See these?” Mydei pointed to the color code, and he nodded. “One finger. Two fingers. Three. I’ll ask you how you’re doing, and you’ll give me one of these signals. You’re at your limit. You’re nearing your limit. You’re good.”

He drew tally marks in each corresponding color, and Phainon looked at his own hand before lifting his fingers accordingly.

“Okay…”

This was both easy to remember yet a lot to swallow down.

“As for a safeword, think of something. What would you not say while doing something… sexual?” He brought the purple marker back, this time with its cap open.

“Can I just say a color if you ask me for one?” He wondered, figuring that would be the easiest solution. Otherwise, he’d be here for a while wondering what word was good enough to be considered a safeword, and that didn’t sound fun at all.

“Final answer?”

He nodded, and Mydei wrote that down before placing it beside his other note.

As he sat there watching him organize his things, Phainon leaned down to his shoulder and rested his cheek against it. The hand with a marker woven between his fingers raised, settling over the top of his head to bring him in closer. For comfort, he leaned back further, slouching just a bit and turning his knees closer to Mydei's body. If he bumped the coffee table, he only mentioned it with a short, amused breath.

"This isn't so bad, right?" Mydei smiled softly, and Phainon looked at the crisp pages he was pulling out with his free hand. "Are you okay?"

"Fine," he brushed off, catching a glimpse of some words printed amongst the bulletpoint list. "Just… really surprised. I've known you almost all my life, but this is the first time I've ever seen… this. It's the most shocking part."

"This was my business," he said simply, matter-of-factly. "But since you want to do this dance with me, it's now *our* business. There's nothing for me to hide from you."

"You say that to all your submissives to make them feel special?" Phainon teased him, wondering how many people have sat here in his spot and gone over these things with him.

Did they all use the same color systems? Did they all have the same exact rules to follow and lines to learn?

How many times has he done this… '*dance*'?

Mydei chuckled, his shoulder shaking and bouncing his cheek in tandem. "No, they typically know what to expect, which makes a lot of this redundant. A few of them have bossed me around during this phase too, bringing their own rules to me."

"Mm… But you do this with them all?"

"Yes. My sub will always have a say in what we practice. I'm *not* God, and they're *not* devout followers. But, I've never used a… black cat… pen while doing this before," he commented, looking at the cartoon character before showing it to him. "What is that exactly?"

"Kuromi," he answered.

"Kur—*huh?*"

"You don't know Sanrio characters? What kind of a big, bad dominant are you?" He mocked him, and Mydei blinked a few times as if processing his insult. "The one you used for '*red*' is My Melody, and '*yellow*' is Pompompurin."

"Pompompu—*what?*" He repeated, and Phainon laughed over his confusion. "What kind of a ridiculous name is that?"

"What kind of a name is Mydei?" He shot back, and the other man rolled his eyes before bringing his arm back down. "I like that one, you know. The yellow one."

“Do you?”

He nodded, and Mydei picked the highlighter up before rubbing his thumb over the character.

“I suppose it’s cute. This one reminds me of you though,” he said, handing him a pale blue pen from inside the case.

Phainon looked down at it, at the ivory puppy with bright blue eyes. “I look like that?” He asked.

“Yes.”

His fist gripped it tightly, and he hummed to himself as Mydei began preparing his trio-colored pens to mark up some more pages.

“Do you just keep a stack of your rules handy to rinse and repeat this step?”

“A few at least. Feelings always tend to change over time. You may think you hate something, then turn around and feel up for it a month later when things get more comfortable,” he answered. “I’m going to tell you what I expect from you, and you’re going to tell me how you feel about it—red, yellow, or green.”

Phainon nodded, fiddling with the pen in hand as he awaited the list. His thumb pushed and pulled the cap off, adding a click to the ambiance of their comfortable silence. While Mydei stacked the papers neatly on the table and readied them in front of him, he was already reading the text printed on the page.

“If I don’t like it?”

“Then we discuss it and come up with one we both do, or I can just cross it out,” he told him. “This is a mutual agreement we should both benefit from. When we finish, you will tell me your expectations of me too.”

That sounded fair to him, but he wasn’t quite sure what he expected out of him besides to just… *lead*. Wasn’t that the whole point?

He didn’t know anything about this. It was so uncomfortable, yet for some reason his body kept reacting positively to it—to the praise, silent ownership, and being dragged along. Those tingles deep inside of his gut and the boil of his blood when things felt right were so foreign to him, and he needed help navigating them.

He needed Mydei to show him, teach him what to want and ask for, and cushion the negativity that clawed in his gut.

Why did he need to have any other expectations than just… ‘*take control*’? What else was there?

The capped butt of a red marker was used to motion to each bullet point statement, and Phainon listened as he read it, explained it, and gave an example.

He expected him to text him '*good morning*' and '*good night*' every day. If he didn't have service for any reason and physically could not, that was fine. Things happened and they couldn't control that. But, if he simply chose not to do it, then it would be taken as he didn't care to speak with him. There would be two warnings, and the last would be a punishment. His punishment would be having to physically drive over and apologize in person—tedious to do if he was tired after a busy day and embarrassing to think about.

It would be easier to just text him throughout the day, he agreed.

Mydei also expected him to take care of himself. He wanted him to eat three meals a day, limit his caffeine intake, do his best to continue his daily runs around the neighborhood, and maintain proper hygiene. That sounded like a given—*he did those things anyways on his own*—but it also meant he needed to cook or exercise even if he was too exhausted to think about it, then put down the energy drink if his chest started to feel a little bit funny than power through it.

But Mydei would help him. He promised. He would prepare the meals for him and keep his fridge full, and he would come over to tackle a pile of clothes or a mountain of dishes. It just needed to be done. No excuses.

If he continued to neglect himself and his space, Mydei would have to be more strict. He'd want pictures of folded clothes, empty sinks, and the toothbrush hanging out of his mouth. If he still denied that, even after offering to help all he could, then there'd be no point in continuing this.

Which… he guessed was fair. Everyone wanted a partner who took care of themselves, or at least let them help if they couldn't do it. Rejecting both would be… unfair. Phainon, himself, wouldn't want to be with someone who lived in filth and refused to change that.

Most of his expectations and rules after were mundane things alike, things he already did in his daily life and didn't really see a point in being told to do it.

Be polite to other people and remember his manners when addressing him—the first was always true, but the second was fun to press against. Remain loyal to him as a partner—not that Phainon would ever cheat on someone, real relationship or not. Keep things honest and transparent—there was zero room for lying or hiding things away in Mydei's eyes, and Phainon was already practicing that as much as possible.

A few were a little bit… *more* than what he was used to, but they still made a relative amount of sense.

Mydei also wanted to know who he would be with if he was going somewhere without him, the places they would go, and what they would do there. He wanted his location shared with him in real time if there was a possibility of getting drunk or high, then he wanted him to limit his intake of either substance as well. All of it was under the guise of safety, of staying transparent with one another and keeping a healthy life, and he understood that even if it was… *a lot*.

Being micromanaged in that way made him squirm. To think he wanted everything out of him and on the table was a little bit intense. There was so little privacy at that point, so little autonomy in day-to-day life if he was being that open with him. But… he could do it. He could manage it.

The only few that made him truly uncomfortable was the print that said Mydei wanted to be able to touch him as he pleased, but he had crossed that out before even getting to it. Those words never left his mouth even if it was printed on a page, and he was grateful for the silent trashing of such a thing.

Maybe his other submissives didn't mind that, but he wasn't quite ready for his best friend to just force him on his knees and drop his pants. He couldn't even imagine being demanded to bend over and take him any time he pleased like some kind of walking, talking sex toy.

Another was his offer for financial help. He did *not* want to ask Mydei every time he fell short on some cash, and he did not want to accept any of his money like some kind of '*allowance*'.

He expected him to be honest, to come to him if things got bad so he could step in, but Phainon would sooner work himself to the bone than accept a wad of cash for simply batting his eyes and saying '*please*'.

"It's my role, Phainon," he insisted.

"You're not a bank," he argued with him, speaking out for the first time against anything in his page. Though he could be understanding enough, compliant too, this one was too much. "I'm not coming to you for money. Under no circumstances will that happen."

"Always so stubborn on this topic…" Mydei muttered, having anticipated his push-back. "This comes from the heart, and you know I don't mean to make you feel inadequate. My family has always had money to spare, and if you need it more than I do, then I can give it to you without a worry. I want to take care of you and provide for you, and this is an extension of that."

And Phainon understood that. He did. Maybe *someone else* would love that kind of financial net to fall back on. Maybe his old submissives were crying tears of joy that a handsome man with cash to blow would throw it in their direction if they sucked him off or begged prettily enough with teary eyes. They probably saw it exactly as Mydei did, an extension of his care or another way he could provide for them, but *not* him. *Never him*.

Mydei has always had money, but never did he want to exploit that.

His head shook adamantly. "You should know the only time I take your money is when you do it *without* telling me."

"How about this… Allow me to pay for your little things then," he offered, attempting to compromise with him on a topic he knew he wouldn't win. "You don't need to tell me what it's for. Let me give you something to buy your necessities so you can put your money to more important things."

“No, Mydei.”

This was a hill he was going to *die* on.

“Hm…”

They looked at each other, and he watched as Mydei’s hand gripped the marker tighter. For a moment, he worried the delicate pen would snap. Then he would *really* be dying on this hill.

Mydei tried to convince him once more. “It isn’t a problem, Phainon. Financial burdens tend to be the most stressful, and they’re not so quickly solved without help. People get loans, but that’s not… You don’t have to. You’re my best friend, so this has always been the case for us. I can—”

“It’s a problem for me,” he argued back, not wanting to hear it. “I don’t like the idea of you coughing up cash just because I bat my eyes at you. I won’t do it. *I won’t*. I’ll say any safeword that you can think of, but cross that off the list and let me keep my financial *burdens* and my financial *freedoms*. They’re mine, *not* yours.”

“The whole point of this is—”

“I thought you said you’re not anyone’s ‘*sugar daddy*’? So why do you want to throw money at me so badly?” He demanded, throwing the phrase that had annoyed him before back into his face.

Mydei stilled beside him for a moment, and he picked the red pen up before silently drawing an ‘*x*’ by that specific bullet point.

“Thank you.”

“This is for you, so… As long as you're comfortable, it’s okay,” he reassured him. “We can forget it’s even here.”

They went through the rest of the list, marking up the sleeve with mostly green and yellow strokes. Very few were painted in red.

To see the end result of a singular page felt… surreal. Was that how this worked? Couples agreed upon roles and rules together, and they lived by their conjoined wills? It wasn’t just a ‘*dominant*’ person forcing their wants on to someone who was then made to take it?

Or—*and he could definitely believe this more than anything*—maybe Mydei was just better than anyone else.

“What do you want from me, Phainon?”

He looked up at him, at his side profile as Mydei pulled out another page from behind the one they just went over. His eyes traced over the slope of his curved nose and his smooth, golden cheek. Sunset hair swept over his face, bangs framing his jaw from where they weren’t quite long enough to join the rest in his ponytail.

“What do you mean?” He asked, watching as Mydei turned to look at him as well.

“Do you expect me to help push you to better convey your feelings? Like how I got you to speak without alcohol?” Their eyes met, and he shifted a little bit under his intense gaze. “Do you expect me to take care of myself for you so you can have a partner that’s healthy and attractive to you?”

Phainon shrugged unsurely.

Mydei already did those things. It was wired into him. Wasn’t it a little bit redundant to try and force him to do something he made himself do every day?

Sure, he was doing the same thing to him, but Mydei liked that kind of control. He needed that control. Phainon… didn’t see the point in it as much.

“You wanted to learn,” Mydei reminded him. “You wanted to see the way I do things and understand why people might enjoy this, so do you want me to help you experiment with things you’ve never done? With experimenting comes trials and errors, do you expect me to push you to try? Will you allow me to?”

“Mydei, what does that mean?” He asked him.

He sighed quietly, then shook his head. “Tell me your ideal partner, Phainon.”

His head turned, and he stared down at the pen still clutched within his fist as its cap clicked to close. The happy little puppy on it made his chest warm, especially upon remembering Mydei saw him like that even if he had no clue what character it was.

That was cute.

His ideal partner would probably be like that too—honest, constantly thinking of other people, and willing to do cute things freely.

Phainon didn’t really get attracted to people right off the bat. People could be handsome, or beautiful, and it might encourage him to approach them, but he wasn’t the kind of person who found himself sexually drawn to them because of that. That came after he got to know someone better.

Simply being good looking wasn’t enough for him. He wanted someone who could make him laugh too, not just politely, but the type that made his belly ache and cheeks hurt. He tried to look for people who were good at talking and holding conversations, especially if the topic wasn’t centered around them and their own interests. Bonus points came if they spoke kindly or respectfully of other people rather than outright slandering someone just to build themselves up. It was always attractive to be a good person.

He wanted someone who wanted to be his, who enjoyed his company and his touch. They’d want to be around him often, want to keep him as close as possible in person or on the phone. His friends would love them. His family would adore them.

That was his ideal partner.

“Phainon?” Mydei waved a hand in front of his face, and he hummed softly. “The lights are on, but is anyone home? Hello?”

“Hm? Yeah,” he mused, batting his hand away. “My ideal partner would be kind and respectful. That’s about all I got.”

“Is that so?”

“Yeah, but you’re already that way. I’m not… exactly sure what to ask for now,” he admitted. “I just want to learn the way you do things. What we did before was a glimpse, but I bet it gets heavier after this, right? You have rules, expectations, and punishments for me to follow now. Things will get more strict, and I’ll be tested even more. I want to see that part.”

Mydei nodded in confirmation. “I’ll be much more strict with you after today. No more brushing things off and letting you get away with whatever you want.”

“Just… don’t forget that I’m your best friend first, sub-in-training second, okay? That’s my expectation.” He joked, but deep down, he really meant that. “Don’t become someone I don’t recognize anymore.”

“Okay,” he agreed gently before pretending to write on the page. “Continue… to… bully… Phainon…—”

“Hey!”

They laughed together over his mocking words, and Phainon pressed his forehead to his shoulder as his eyes closed.

For all that they were talking about, somehow this was the least nerve-wracking thing they’ve done together. Talking about feelings had never felt so easy, and to do it with such minimal arguing between them both was impressive in his eyes.

“You’re doing very good so far,” Mydei praised him gently while reaching around to pull him into his body. “Come here. Sit a little closer to me.”

Phainon’s breaths hitched as he was pressed into Mydei’s side, head hitting his chest. The weight of his arm rested along his shoulders, spanning across them and hanging off the edge. Their hips touched side by side, bodies flush against one another when he tightened his hold.

“M-Mydei…”

His heart skipped. Rich, warm cologne clouded his senses, grounding him.

“Are you holding up okay?”

“Yeah,” he promised, then took a deep breath. “I’m okay. This is… a lot, but if it’s you explaining them and working with me, they make a little more sense. Most of these things aren’t as cutthroat as I thought they’d be. They’re fairly… simple.”

“Did you seriously expect me to say some ridiculous thing like you must be naked and collared all the time?” He brought up, and the thought made him cringe deeper into his side. “You thought I’d force you to please me as some kind of ‘*sex slave*’ to fit that ‘*master*’ joke of yours.”

He didn’t want to admit that a part of him really did expect something a little bit darker than ‘*you must drink this much water a day*’. Maybe not quite sex, but maybe he’d want him to go out of his way more to behave more passively. Maybe he wanted him to be more soft spoken and less of his usual self to fit that ‘*submissive*’ stereotype.

Even if he knew Mydei would never change him, that lingering voice told him that he wasn’t the submissive person he probably wanted. He wasn’t easy to agree with, and he didn’t take kindly to being told what to do without reason. On top of that, his body was just as big as Mydei’s, so he didn't even look like the submissive-type he was probably into.

It was reassuring to know that he could still just be himself in this arrangement.

“Oh, *master*, I’d never think of you like that,” Phainon teased him back. The sarcasm earned a quiet snort of amusement.

“What was it you told me that night you hounded me? ‘*Shirtless for my viewing pleasure’?*” Mydei recalled the words he had thrown at him before. “If you’d genuinely like to be, I won’t stop you.”

“Keep it in your pants, pervert!” He gasped, elbowing him sharply as his face grew hot. “I’d never flaunt my naked body just because you asked me to.”

“No?”

“No!”

“What a pity.”

Phainon rolled his eyes, taking it as a joke even if he knew Mydei probably meant that.

“Pervert…” He repeated, quieter this time. “It’s like you want me that way.”

“Truthfully, Phainon, I won’t lie to you and say I’m not interested in sexual submission too. This dominance goes both ways, in bed and out,” he shared with him. “It’s not *all* of what makes this work, but it makes up a nice chunk for me.”

Phainon’s playful mood sank just a little bit, and his eyes peeked open to look down at the marker he was still clicking.

“I can’t—*with a good conscience, anyway*—ask you about your feelings regarding certain… punishments, rewards, and talk… because I don’t know how far you want to go with me,” he continued. “You don’t want sex, but I still don’t know what you consider to be ‘*sex*’. Is it gagging you? Spanking you? Asking you to ask me for permission to touch yourself?”

“You want me to ask permission to…?”

How would that conversation even go? Was he meant to just text him and pray that he responds fast enough for him to do something?

‘*Can I please get rid of this boner I woke up with, master?*’

“I do,” Mydei answered. “I want you to ask me for permission to touch and get off without me, and I want the authority to say ‘*yes*’ or ‘*no*’ with the knowledge that you’ll obey whatever comes out.”

“That’s…” A breath fell from his lips. “A lot. Like… that’s really a lot, Mydei.”

“Yes. I know it’s a lot to ask of you,” he agreed, turning to face him more. In doing so, it pushed him deeper into his body.

Mydei set the papers in his hand down on his coffee table, and he capped the markers not being used to keep them from drying out. Though he didn’t package them away, he made sure they didn’t roll off of the table.

“Do you trust me?”

His heart pounded harder, mouth drying as he wondered what could come next after a conversation like this and a question like that.

“Yeah…”

Mydei then used that freed hand to reach for one of his bent knees, coaxing him to curl closer and closer to his lap. He didn’t stop until his leg was hovering over his body, where he looked down at him.

“Will you tell me your color?” He checked in.

“I… I don’t know,” Phainon breathed out, but that wasn’t a response he seemed to accept judging by his firmly pressed lips. “I think… green?”

“You ‘*think*’ is not acceptable.” His grip tightened, still holding him steady and not yet moving again. “Try again.”

“Yellow?” He tested, wondering if that could convey just how fast his heart was racing or how sweaty his palms felt. “I’m not sure.”

“I can stop. Do you want me to stop?” He offered him. “Or do you want me to push you a little?”

He nodded weakly.

“Use your words when answering me.”

“Don’t stop,” Phainon whispered, twisting his body to follow as Mydei continued to pull his knee over his lap.

Cautious of hitting the table, he rested his weight on the opposite leg to shift. Either were spread around Mydei's hips, bracketing his thighs to keep him still. But he didn't sit. He stayed on his knees with his hands to his sides, unsure where they should be.

Should he put them on the couch behind Mydei and block him like he did at the door? Should he place them on his chest or shoulders and touch his body?

Deep breaths flooded into his lungs faster, but Mydei's own were still gentle and calm in nature. As were his hands as they curled around the back of his lower thighs, not daring to venture too high. Fingers pressed firmly but not roughly, as if rooting him in place but not forcing him to move otherwise.

He was looking down at him this time, at his best friend's tilted back gaze.

"You look good up there," Mydei praised him, speaking quietly like it was a secret just for the two of them. "You can sit down, Phainon."

"My knees are fine," he defended his stiffened state.

If he sat down, he would be sitting directly on his lap, body to body in a way they've never been. Could he do that? Was that okay?

"I wasn't asking about your knees," he pressed. Still, he made no effort to force his body lower. "Put your hands on the table if you won't put them on me."

Phainon reached behind him, stretching his arms out to either end before gripping the metal frame carefully. Like this, he left his body open for Mydei to touch if he felt like it. His legs, his waist, his chest, with his arms pulled out of the way, nothing was stopping him.

"I've got you. Relax a little bit," Mydei reassured him, slowly curling his hands to the outer parts of his legs rather than the back. "I'm going to move my hands around to see what's comfortable for you. When I stop, you'll give me a color. Can you do that?"

"Yeah, I-I can… I can do that," he choked out, not used to having someone touch him even if it was through his clothes.

"Good boy."

The stuttered breath falling from his lips made Mydei hum quietly, as if pleased by the sound.

His hands raised, slowly and gently gliding higher up his thighs. Denim muted the direct feel of his fingertips, but it didn't mute their weight when he paused by his pockets. They held firmly, lingering just below his hips.

"G… Green…"

Mydei didn't respond, but he did move, planting his fingers just above his belt. Both thumbs managed to slip beneath the hem of his t-shirt, touching his lower stomach skin to skin.

Phainon's hips bucked, pulling back from the touch that made his stomach burn deeper than it should have.

"I've got you," he repeated, placing his thumbs to leather instead. "Your shirt rode up from your squirming. I didn't mean to touch you there."

"Green," he whispered.

Shivers wracked through his spine when his stomach and waist were subjected to the same sensual treatment. His own fingers gripped the frame of his coffee table harder, the glass lightly rattling from him pulling it closer.

Cotton was significantly thinner than his jeans, and Mydei's hot palms were so much easier to feel as he dragged them down his body rather than up. It kept his shirt from rising, from accidentally revealing his skin, and he noticed that. Despite his flustered state, he noticed the change in direction almost instantly.

They stopped on his waist, holding him steady, and Phainon nodded quickly as if to silently tell him '*that's fine*'.

"Words, Phainon," Mydei instructed him, tracing his thumbs back and forth over his ribs.

"Green."

There was a pause when he pushed a little higher, stopping momentarily just before the muscle of his chest.

"You like being touched here, but is it okay if my hands do it?" He wondered to himself, inching them closer before he could answer his favorite phrase—'*I don't know*'.

One of his own ripped away from the coffee table to grasp his wrist tightly, and Mydei stared at his fist for a moment. Cool glass from his watch pressed to his palm, filthying its clean display with his sweaty skin.

"I didn't say you could move that. Put it back, Phainon," he instructed him. "Use your words. Communicate with me."

The grasp loosened as he stared into his eyes of warm amber, taking in the stern tilt of his brows. Slowly, he brought his hand back to the table, and Mydei held his hands steady where they were right beneath the muscle.

This felt obscene. His chest was spilling over the juncture of his thumb and index finger like something straight out of an adult video, and as much as he liked being touched there, his stomach was in knots.

"Do you need a moment?" Mydei asked him, voice low but gentle.

"I… I'm…"

Nervous laughter bubbled from his lips, and he curled in on himself as he felt his chest tremble. Each shake only emphasized the push of their bodies together.

“If you touch me there, I-I might… I don’t know. Make a weird noise… or something…”

He tried not to say it directly to him, but somehow what came out sounded even more embarrassing.

“You’ll enjoy it? I see no issue with that,” Mydei chuckled, slowly squeezing beneath his pecs and lifting ever so slightly. “Look, these are already poking through your shirt. Isn’t it too late to be so modest?”

Phainon choked over his own moan when the pad of his thumbs brushed against his pebbled nipples. Even through his shirt they were sensitive to the touch, tingling and hardening further from the sudden stimulation. Pleasure swirled deep inside his gut, combating the embarrassment and shame of liking Mydei’s hands on him or that push against his comfort zone. The cocktail of emotions made him dizzy, eyes half lidded and vision just a little fuzzy.

Rather than move, Mydei kept his hands there. Fingers curled into his chest from either side and his thumbs stayed steady in their place. Every breath pushed him closer, sinking them deeper.

“Green. M-Mydei, move already,” he begged, wanting to drag his hands away himself. “Stop touching there.”

Mydei gave one final squeeze and pull, massaging his chest once more before sliding his palms towards his collarbones.

“Sit down now, Phainon. That’s a demand,” he instructed him. With it, a light pressure was put over his shoulders. “Look me in my eyes while you do.”

Phainon’s body lowered to ease over his lap. With his bottom hovering just inches off of his thighs, he tried to keep himself from touching him, but Mydei refused.

More pressure was put on his shoulders, and he bit down on his tongue when he was forced on to him completely. The force made his breaths hitch. Likewise, Mydei groaned softly, sliding his body lower as to pull him higher.

“There you go, that’s my good boy… Be still. Tell me how this makes you feel.”

His eyes trailed down Mydei’s face and neck, taking in the peachy tint in his cheeks and the bob of his Adam’s apple. They lingered around his collar and shoulders, around the sapphire glint hanging beneath the buttons of his white, linen shirt. It matched his earring, gold with a sparkling gem propped in the middle.

Lower and lower, he watched his chest rise with a breath. He noticed his shirt stretching by his stomach from where the hem was caught underneath his body.

Breathless, he noticed just how close other parts of them were. Sitting on his lap, ass to thighs, Phainon couldn’t help but stare at the front of his own jeans from where they were

close to his own. Just a tilt would make them touch.

“Ah ah, look me in the eyes,” Mydei repeated to him, using his thumbs to push underneath his chin and raise it. “How does this make you feel?”

Nervous and hot, like the room had grown a hundred more degrees in between letting him in and sitting over his lap. Breathless and shaky, as if his heart would pound right out of his chest and his lungs couldn’t find enough oxygen to suffice. Tingly and buzzing, like an uncapped wire full of life.

“Fine,” he whispered, unable to say more than that. “I’m fine. This is… *fine*.”

Two thumbs trailed down the base of his throat, tickling his skin and passing over the leather band around his neck. They stopped when they met the collar of his shirt, not daring to slip underneath.

“Just fine?”

“You can keep going,” he allowed, feeling him move his thumbs higher again. This time, they stopped at his choker.

“You’re very handsome, Phainon,” he said to him, easing his accessory higher to reveal more of his skin. “You always have been, but you know that, right?”

“I’ve been told,” he answered quietly, not wanting to sound arrogant. “Am I to you?”

“Yes. You have beautiful eyes, and you’ve worked hard for your body. It shows.” The compliments continued, making him shift over his lap as heat pooled within his belly. “If you weren’t so nervous of letting people in, I know you would be someone else's right now. You’d have a beautiful girlfriend, or a handsome boyfriend, and I bet they’d say the same things I do. It’s not an opinion. It’s a fact. Phainon, you are handsome.”

Amber eyes raked over his skin with reverence, as if admiring and memorizing every divot, shadow, and rosy inch along his neck and face. They met his own, lowered down the bridge of his nose and curve of either lip, then fell back where his neck piece had been.

“But you’re going to be mine for a little while, okay? You’re going to be *my* handsome man, *my* submissive,” Mydei said softly, rubbing the front of his throat and closing his fists around the sides.

“I’ll be yours for a bit, Mr. Possessive,” he caved, nervous underneath his gaze. “You’re my… dominant, so whatever you ask, I have to do anyway.”

Mydei nodded, lowering his hands from his throat. “Yes, I am. And I don’t share. If you don’t want this anymore, or if you decide someone else is more befitting your needs, be sure to tell me immediately. Don’t wait.”

“I will.”

“Good.” He swallowed, bringing his hands to his waist before leaving them there. “But until then, it’ll be *my* hands on your body and *my* name in your mouth. Call me ‘*master*’ if you want, or ‘*sir*’ if it tickles your fancy, but whatever it is it better be *mine* and *mine alone*.”

Phainon felt him pull his body closer, forcing him to let go of the table behind him.

“*My* claim will be around your neck soon,” he whispered, but even while quiet, his voice dripped with authority. “You will wear it all day, every day. Only *I* will be able to take it off, understand?”

“How does that… work?” He asked him honestly. “What kind of collar can I even wear to shower?”

“A kind that won’t tarnish.”

‘*Metal*,’ reason supplied immediately. ‘*Not leather.’*

This accessory would be actual jewelry instead of a glorified dog collar. Mydei said he didn’t like clunky, steel bondage gear, and it wasn’t as if he could wear leather in every kind of scenario possible.

It would be a necklace, one designed to stake his ownership over him rather than look pretty for fashion.

“I want leather to play with too, so I’ll buy you one of each.” Just as his mouth opened to object, Mydei spoke again. “I *don’t* care if you don’t like it. I *don’t* care if you even hate it. I *will* be buying you both, and you're *not* going to stop me. That’s an order, understand?”

His lips sealed.

“Do you understand?”

“Yeah…” He mumbled, shifting around as his stomach tightened from the firmness of his tone. “I understand.”

Mydei leaned even closer, pressing their chests together and holding him tighter. It felt as if his fingerprints would burn through his shirt and into his skin.

“You and I will look for a style you like, one that’s conspicuous enough outside and another for inside our homes,” he explained. “I don’t want anyone to know this side of me, and I don’t want you to break yourself down worrying about what people think. This is between us.”

Phainon nodded, aware that his best friend valued his privacy. “I won’t tell anyone,” he swore.

“This is my life, and it's not common, but it’s mine. I’m letting you into it just as much as you’re letting me into… well, you,” he stressed.

“Hey,” he hushed him, bringing his hands to his warmed cheeks before cupping them. “It’s okay. I'm not going to tell anyone.”

“I trust you.”

He smiled softly, and Mydei took a deep breath before looking down between them.

Mydei hummed thoughtfully. “While we’re discussing rules, expectations, and comfort… Tell me, would you let me touch you here? I can feel that you’re hard through your pants.”

Phainon bit down on the inside of his bottom lip when his hands lowered, head tilting back to hide his expression. They held his hips, slowly curling to the inside of his thighs.

“Be a good boy and tell me your color here, Phainon.”

“Mydei, wait,” he gasped, pulling his hips back before rolling them forward. “I’m…—”

“Yes?”

“Just… Just over my clothes, okay? That’s all. Don’t take them off,” he told him, and one of Mydei’s hands eased closer. “And don’t look at me. It’s embarrassing to know you’re watching me. I might get too nervous a-and—”

The hand not inching towards the front of his jeans reached for his arm, fingertips slowly tracking down the muscle towards his hand. He grabbed it from where they hadn’t yet left his cheeks, and he slid it upwards towards his eyes.

For more security, Phainon used his opposite one as well. Both pushed over his eyes, cupped by the knuckles so as to not push directly on to them. He looked at him, at the lower half of his face still revealed to him, watching his pink lips move.

“Do I make you that nervous?” Mydei teased him, and he pushed just a little harder over his head. “For being such a good boy and taking this all so well, I’ll let you do this to me then. Just this once though, Phainon. Savor it while you can.”

His best friend’s palm pressed to the front of his jeans, lingering there for a moment.

“Give me a color.”

He exhaled, hips bucking closer. “Green,” he answered quietly.

Suddenly, his hand lowered, digging between his thighs until his fingers curved beneath the crotch of his jeans. Heel to his zipper, he squeezed down around him, working his hand tightly but slowly.

“M-Mydei,” he could barely get out, too shocked by the sudden hold over his lower body. “Mydei, *wait*. I haven’t… Fuck, that’s… *h-hah*—”

Phainon wanted to reel himself back, nervous of potentially taking this somewhere they couldn’t return from even if that line had already been breached before. He let him keep his

hand there, and he agreed to do this under his own rules, but this burning spark inside his veins was new. It made him scared and excited all at once, and he wasn't sure if it was arousal tingling over his skin or anxiety.

"What about this?"

This was so… *bad*.

It was so, so bad to do this with his best friend, with someone he had never considered in this way until starting this mess of an agreement.

But it did feel *good*.

Mydei's hand felt so nice palming him through the thick material of his jeans. He knew when to squeeze around him, and he knew when to push down, moving in tandem with his clumsy hips.

It felt so much better than his own hands ever could be.

"Mydei… *Damn*, that's… green. *So, so green*."

"I bet you look just as good as you sound right now," Mydei purred, his voice low with a pleased tilt in it as if he were imagining it. "What gets you off, Phainon? Tell me. Is it just praise? Do you want me to talk you through it?"

"Talk me through *what?*"

The hand holding his moved without warning, blindly reaching in front of him to brush against his ribs. But that wasn't what he was aiming for, it seemed. Not when his heavy and hot palm engulfed one side of his chest like he had earlier swiftly, groping the muscle firmly.

A loud moan followed, the sound torn from his throat without permission.

"That's it," Mydei encouraged him like he was proud of the mess he was becoming. "Keep moving your hips for me. Show me how much you're enjoying this."

"Mydei, y-you're doing too much now," he tried to tell him, overwhelmed by all of the attention. "You can't touch both of these places a-at once. I'm… *nngh*… n-not… I can't—"

"You say that, but your body continues to betray your mouth," he lightly scolded him. "If you truly cannot take it, use your safewords."

Phanon's hips buckled forward, and his chest pushed closer, but neither '*red*' nor '*yellow*' escaped his parted lips because Mydei was right. He craved the heat of his hands on his body even if he felt so *dirty* for wanting it. Everything was so much, but it was too good for him to want to end it all.

For a moment, this overwhelming pleasure swamped his deep rooted guilt, and he tucked it aside where it couldn't be seen.

“Tell me if it feels good for you, Phainon. I want your honesty.” As Mydei spoke again, he massaged his pec tighter, milking more moans from his dry mouth.

“That’s embarrassing. I can’t just—”

“You can and you will. Come on,” he cut him off, speaking firmly. “Be honest with me. Do you like my hands on your body like this?”

“Yeah, I-I like it,” he couldn’t help but whine. “Mydei, your hands feel so good. It’s… It’s all so *good*.”

Two fingers moved towards his clothed nipple, and he wrenched his hand from the other’s eyes to grip his wrist instead. Though he didn’t try to yank him off, he did squeeze tightly, shaking as they closed around the bud.

“Have you ever pinched these before?” Mydei asked, just as curious as he was teasing. “Do you enjoy it? How hard may I go?”

“I have,” he answered, voice raising when they tightened just enough to feel the bite. “Just be gentle with them, De. Don’t hurt me…”

Phainon’s stomach knotted deeper as he grinded into his dutiful palm, the action making his cock throb inside of his briefs. Pre-cum was smeared all over the fabric, something he felt stickily sliding against his own skin.

“You’re doing such a good job for me,” he reassured him. “Just a little longer, okay? I’ve got you.”

“Yeah,” he sighed softly, slipping his touch higher to cup over his best friend's knuckles.

He pulled the hand from his eyes immediately after. Instead of enforcing his ‘*do not look*’ request, Phainon used it to grip the knuckles between his thighs as well. His head lolled forward as he lightly trembled within his hands, thighs tensed and belly tighter.

“Mydei, I-I’m… close. I’m really, *really* close.” The pitch of his raised voice made Mydei chuckle softly.

“Do you want to finish for me like this?” He asked him, and his heart skipped as he looked down at their combined hands. “Ask me, Phainon. Be a good boy and ask me if I’ll allow you to cum like this.”

“Please don’t,” he panted, watching his own hips rock into their hands. “Please don’t make me—”

“*Ask*.”

It wasn’t a request this time. Before, Mydei made it sound like a best friend simply requesting his friend to do something for him. No, this was a demand, one given from a dominant to his submissive, and it was meant to be followed. There wasn’t any other answer besides ‘*yes*’.

Phainon throbbed behind his jeans, and he felt tears lightly burn in the corners of his eyes as that medley of filth, embarrassment, and pleasure forced his abdomen to flex.

“Mydei, please,” he begged him. His hips were moving jerkily, thighs tensing as he tried his best to wait. “I wanna cum.”

“That’s not *asking*. That’s *telling*,” he chastised. “Don’t tell me you want to cum. Ask me for permission.”

“Fuck, Mydei! C-C’mon,” he cried out, nails curling into his best friend’s hands. “*Please*. I can’t keep h-holding it. I *can’t*.”

Mydei didn’t respond to his begging either, and he grit his teeth before scratching deeper into his hands.

“P-Please, *master*,” he forced himself to say, and that earned a sharp intake of breath from the other man. “*Can I please just cum?*”

A moment passed, and that was when the hands on his body tightened. His cock was squeezed tighter, and his nipple was pinched harder as his other fingers curled deeper beneath the plush muscle. The sudden increase made his voice sob out loudly, pathetically, and his body shook even further as he tried curling in on himself.

Hunched over, shoulders closing on themselves and stomach bent, he tried to both fight his cruel hands and fuck into them.

“Go on then. Cum for me, my bratty little prince,” Mydei allowed, giving him all the permission he needed.

His misty eyes screwed shut, and he pressed his forehead to Mydei’s collar as heavy breaths and pitched moans tumbled from his lips.

“Mydei… Mydei, I’m g-go-onna… Mydei, *h-hah*,” he chanted, repeating his name because it was all he could think of at that moment. “*M-My—Master!*”

Phainon’s hips gave one last pump, humping forward weakly before simply grinding into Mydei’s massaging fist. Those skilled fingers wiggled, toying beneath his tightened balls even through the denim, coaxing him to keep it up. His cock throbbed almost painfully as he spilled an even bigger mess into his already sticky briefs, trapped behind the zipper of too-tight jeans. There was just nowhere for anything to go inside of them.

“Mm… you’re going to be the death of me,” Mydei murmured, but his voice was drowned out by his post-orgasm haze.

Sharp ringing sounds filled his ears as ragged breaths dried his mouth out even further, and there was an achy, sore strain around his vocal chords from how loud he had been. Both knees ached from sitting on them for so long, and there was surely no way he could hope to walk with how gelatinous his legs felt.

High off his bliss, Phainon nuzzled himself closer into Mydei's collar. The point of his nose traced over golden skin after tucking his braid aside, and he let himself fall into his body limply for a moment. That was all he needed.

The hands between them moved, releasing his sensitive body and instead holding him closer. One planted behind his head, and his other rubbed up and down his spine gently. Beneath him, Mydei even lowered himself further, allowing him to lay more comfortably on top of his slouched figure.

"Did you feel good?" He asked gently, earning a nod in return. "Good… My hands can please you without being intimidating or violent, see?"

He nodded weakly, eyes heavy as his familiar cologne flooded his senses.

"How about we take a little break from all these rules and *Pompomp-y* things?" An exhausted chuckle left his lips. "Let's get you some water, a change of pants, maybe a snack, and we can look over the rest a bit later. I want you to talk to me about how that made you feel, and how you want to go forward with things that are *sexual* but not quite '*sex*'."

"In a bit. I just… need to sit here for a second…"

"Alright, lazy. I guess we can stay here for five minutes," he teased him playfully. "And tell me the name of the white cat-thing on the blue pen. It might have rolled under my leg from where you dropped it. I might have heard a crack."

"Mm… Cinnamoroll."

Mydei chuckled quietly. "… Cinnamon roll? Is that why you like them so much?"

Phainon shook his head, then used one arm to wrap around his neck and pull himself a little higher. With his mouth by his braid, since that chunk of hair typically covered his ear, he repeated himself slowly.

"*Cinna-mo-roll*."

"Got it," Mydei said as his head rolled to the side. "Cinnamoroll, the blue eyed cat that looks like my bratty prince."

He looked down at him to find that his eyes were still closed, a request he had just remembered that he made. Thick, dark blond lashes kissed over his cheeks, not bothering to lift even when he stared directly at him.

"He's a puppy," Phainon corrected him, and Mydei turned to face the direction of his stare better.

"Is he? Well, he still looks like you."

"*I'm* a puppy?" He joked, but Mydei hummed as if he were seriously contemplating his question.

“You have these big, round eyes, get easily excited, like to be involved in things you definitely don't need to be, whine really cutely, and fit nicely on my lap—you’re the cutest puppy I’ve ever met.”

“Shut up, ‘m not a dog,” he huffed, feeling as a blush warmed over his already heated skin. “I’m a… What did you call me? ‘*Prince*’?”

“My *spoiled* prince.”

“Will you open your eyes already?” Phainon grumbled, then watched as amber eyes looked right back at him. “I’m not spoiled.”

“Not yet,” he murmured, then reached to lightly brush his thumb beneath his eye. “Mm… Next time, I’d like to watch them fall.”

‘*Next time*’.

‘*Next time*’ he wanted to *watch* him tear up from being overwhelmed by his hands.

“What about you?” He asked him, and Mydei shrugged. “Are you… hard right now?”

“You’re sitting on my lap. Just say it’s small next time,” he huffed.

“No! No, I-I didn’t mean…” Phainon rushed out, panicked that he had upset him by accident. “*Fuck*. Mydei, look, that’s not what I meant. I’m sure it’s not *small*. It’s just… with your hand there, I wasn’t grinding into you but into our hands. I didn’t feel it because my body was scooted back a little bit.”

“I was kidding,” he snickered, holding his head down to his neck as his other hand pushed on his lower back. “Of course I’m hard. I’ve got my handsome submissive in my arms, and I just made him cry my name with just a hand. *Feel*.”

His hips were brought closer. The softening bulge was pushed flush to the front of his jeans, and cerulean eyes widened from the stiffness pressing into him.

“But you won’t touch me. Not because you don’t want it, but because *I* don’t. We can do that some other time,” Mydei decided for them. “For now, let’s make sure you’re comfortable first.”

“Won’t it hurt if you leave it like that?”

“Keep my mind distracted and it won’t,” he smiled at him. “Let me get you water and a snack. Go change into something more comfortable for me, okay? You made a mess, and it’s not very hygienic to just… sit in it.”

He cringed at the thought, then nodded since he was right. It was a little bit gross to sit in a mess of his own cum for long periods of time.

“A few more minutes of this though,” Mydei murmured, holding him tight enough to keep them pinned together. “Let me hold you a little bit longer.”

Phainon sunk into him, liking the sound of that idea too.

Chapter 4: Chapter Four

Chapter Notes

i love soft intimacy between doms and subs.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei's rules weren't particularly difficult to follow, but he did make some mistakes in the days following. It wasn't because Phainon wanted to disobey them either, he just wasn't used to them being there.

Sometimes he forgot he had any at all, which left him with an ink-covered page taped to his bedroom vanity. Mydei had given him a copy, repeated the exact same color code as his own, and he was expected to memorize it. Every morning when he woke up and every night before he went to bed, he was told to read them.

Part of him felt a little bit silly reviewing a set of '*rules*' like he was some kind of child. He'd look over the page while getting dressed, wondering if Mydei would ever find out if he didn't read it, just to give it a single once over before moving on with his day.

Ultimately, he *did* read them every time he came across it. For some odd reason, disobeying a request from him left an uneasy feeling inside of his stomach. He worried that one look at him would reveal he was a liar or a fraud if he tried. After all, it was him who wanted this, so he had to listen. If Mydei was meant to guide him, then he was meant to follow. That was *his* part to play.

Texting him was easy. Phainon had made a habit out of waking up, groggily swiping out a text with too many typos, then starting his day. Whenever he had a break at work or went out on his run, he also sent him a message asking how his day was going. Other times, he gave him short videos of the cats that liked hiding by his mailbox. Then, the last thing he did before heading to sleep was plugging his phone in and sending off a bedtime wish for a good night's rest.

Telling him where he was going was a bit trickier, and so was reminding him of what he was doing. Sometimes he just went to the store and didn't mention it until they were sitting on the phone together later that night. Apologies worked, but Mydei was quick to remind him that he agreed to it. There would only be so many warnings before he started asking for his location even if the destination was as simple as the store for a roll of toilet paper.

For him, the worst rules were the ones meant for inside of their homes. Speaking to Mydei with *manners* felt a little awkward, especially when he was so used to talking back, challenging him, and making fun of him. Was there a time to be his best friend over his

submissive? How was he meant to combine the two while still respecting his rules and dominance? Did he overthink it too much?

They talked about so much already regarding their likes, dislikes, and expectations, but there was *always* more to discuss. Mydei made it clear that they were *always* going to be learning. In that same sentiment, his questions felt never ending too, like the more he knew about *BDSM* then the more he over thought and questioned the things around him.

Phainon's inexperience was loud. He could hear it in the silence when watching him, wondering if he could mock him for making a mistake like a friend or if it would be smarter to stay in his place beneath him as a submissive. He could feel it in the air when Mydei took the control of the room regardless of whose it was, his hesitation to do anything made seconds akin to hours.

He could see it when Mydei let him sit in his bedroom, and there was a tall mirror pointing right at him from a corner. Like all things he owned, it sat spotless in its place, not so much as a speck of dust sitting over its reflective face. Because of that, he could see every inch of his rigid state.

Since Mydei had gotten him off inside of his living room, his body has been… strange.

The tingles have always existed. The warmth was always there. Deep in his stomach, Phainon has felt it since that first night of him gripping his face and looking down at him, but he shoved it down. He tried to snuff it out by telling himself it was wrong to want, that it was worthy of guilt.

But then Mydei said it was okay. He said *he* was okay. And he got him off like it was nothing to be ashamed of.

Mydei, *his best friend*, made him cum.

With one hand on his chest and the other pressed between his thighs, he made him beg, plead, and cry for permission to orgasm. He made him call him '*master*', and while it wasn't something he asked for, the title slipped anyways with all of his self-control.

It was supposed to be a joke. He wasn't supposed to call him that as he came, and he wasn't supposed to enjoy it so much that he willingly finished inside his pants.

They never even used his bedroom, the one he had taken his time to clean and make pretty for him. All of it happened in his living room, and not even on the couch but the carpet. The fucking *carpet*.

How much dirtier could he be?

One hand covered his mouth over the memory as he looked back at himself, seeing his own eyes, arms, and body but not recognizing them. When he was waiting for Mydei to come back to snap a collar around his neck, it was hard to see the same guy from just a few weeks ago when he was none-the-wiser. Back then, he wouldn't have even known what half of *BDSM* meant, having never been interested in talk like that.

The sound of a door closing made him jerk, and he whipped his head around to find Mydei picking at a thick, rust-red and gold leather collar.

“Your day collar will take longer to come. Custom made jewelry always does,” he told him, and Phainon gulped. “This, however, is for our eyes only. It does not leave my house. Do you want to try it on?”

“I-It looks heavy…”

“Do you want to hold it?” He asked, offering him the buckled neck piece. “Touch it. Feel it. Get familiar with it. This is yours, so if you don’t like it, there’s no point in having it.”

Mydei sat beside him, and he shakily picked the collar up before thumbing across the black stitches and edges. Unlike his choker, the insides were soft and cushioned, as if anticipating a lot of pulling, tugging, and pressure. Its edges were thick and tall, clearly made to protect someone’s delicate throat.

One finger hooked into the round, golden ring hanging off of it, clinking it softly to the D-ring embedded within a second layer of fine, textured leather. Golden studs shined on either side of them, clean enough to show his own reflection when he tilted it.

“It came with a leash, but you’re not a dog, so no need for it for you’re not interested,” Mydei said to him, and he clinked the rings together again.

“Reminds me of Reaver and Khas back at home,” Phainon said, referring to the large Samoyeds his parents took care of. “This is what they sound like running to you. Listen.”

Click. Click. Click.

Mydei chuckled, and he couldn’t help but laugh with him as that all-too familiar concoction of emotions bled through his stomach.

“You don’t like it then?”

Phainon continued to examine it. His hands pulled the buckle open, allowing the edges to stretch apart into one flat strip of leather. Cerulean eyes raked over it, taking in its length and all the notches carved into it to make it as tight or loose as possible.

“This would not fit around Khas’ neck. He’s such a big dog,” he said to him while running his thumb along the back. “Reaver either. He’s big too.”

“Good thing it’s for my Phainon, *not* a dog,” he repeated, and Phainon looked up at him. “Try it on before you reject it.”

“Did you want the leash when you bought this?” He asked him quietly, shifting in his spot awkwardly. “You said chains are prettiest when attached to a collar… *What?* Did you want to lead me around with it? Put me on all fours and make me paw at your leg?”

The thought made him uneasy. How humiliating would that be?

“Phainon, you’re doing it again,” Mydei warned him. “If you have something to say, you can do it without the attitude.”

“What am I doing? I’m just saying it how it is, right? You want me to crawl on my hands and knees for you so you can yank me around with this?” He continued to press. With each word, he shook the collar for emphasis as the metal clicked together.

Mydei raised one hand to his mouth, then used the other to grip his wrist tightly and stop its clicking.

“*Who* are you talking to like that?” He demanded, keeping his voice low, not loud. Never was he loud even when upset. “I am your *dominant*, and you need to talk to me with respect, not passive aggression. Do you understand me?”

He glared up at him for a moment longer, then dropped his shoulders before turning his head as much as possible.

Mydei’s hand pressed down further on his mouth, and Phainon tilted his head back to ease the pressure on his neck. Underneath his heated gaze and the warmth of his palm, the room suddenly felt much hotter than it had been. His clothes felt too heavy on his body. His stomach was tight with an ache.

“You do this thing where you fixate on something and try to convince us both that you hate it, but you don’t. Do you?” He asked him, his tone sharp and lined with dominance. “When I handed you that water bottle in your kitchen, you went off on a tangent about what *I* might have wanted when *I* never said any of that to you. Then, you saw a simple cake, and you berated yourself into a dog because you’re scared to enjoy being rewarded and praised for your submission. You twist what we have into a darker kind of ‘*master*’ and ‘*pet*’ dynamic when I only ever *once* called you a puppy—a white and blue *cartoon puppy*.”

The hand on his wrist tightened, and he gulped nervously as Mydei leaned closer.

Phainon could feel the heat of his breath as it fanned against them both, and he could smell his worn cologne that’s tinged with his own skin. Both only pulled the knot inside of his stomach, mangling up the shame, arousal, and fear inside of him. This familiar combination was making him feel sick.

Mydei had never spoken to him like this before. No matter how much he pushed on his authority and snapped back at him, this had never happened before. But he couldn’t tell if he regretted what he said yet or not as he held his eye contact and watched him flick his attention over what was shown of his face.

“A *dog* would not be sitting on my bed but kneeling at my feet awaiting my order. A *dog* would not get a choice in whether they get a leash or not because that’s their *owner’s* decision,” he said to him. Phainon whimpered behind his hand, trying to back away from him. “You are not a pet. You *are* mine, Phainon, but that *doesn’t* make you a dog.”

Phainon nodded quickly, and his heart hammered wildly within his chest from the picture painted in his head.

He regretted it. It was twisted so deep in his guts that all he wanted to do was take back the words and go back to being good.

“I’m going to take my hand off, and you’re going to repeat that to me. *One*.” His hand cupped off of his mouth. “*Two*.” Slowly, all five fingers lifted from his skin as well.

He nodded once again, pulling on the wrist still trapped within his grasp.

“*Three*.”

“I-I’m not your pet,” he rushed out. “I’m not a dog.”

Mydei nodded in acknowledgment. “Who am I? Who are you?” He asked after, still holding on to that firm tone of voice.

“Mydei,” he breathed out, but that wasn’t the answer he seemed to want. “Mydei’s my… d-dominant. He’s my master, and I’m his sub, but I’m *not* his dog.”

That was what he wanted.

Mydei then narrowed his eyes, taking in his pathetic attempt to be good again, to fish out praise where it wasn’t yet deserved.

“Every time you call yourself that in the future, I’m going to put you on your hands and knees with a leash and let you see how it feels to be one,” he told him, keeping his voice low but steady. It wasn’t a threat, but a promise. “If you *want* to keep calling yourself a dog, I’m going to start treating you like one. If you *don’t* want to be one, then *stop calling yourself one*.”

“I’ll stop. I… I’m sorry,” he apologized quickly, and Mydei loosened his grip on his hands over the urgency within his voice. “Don’t do that, Mydei. Please. I’ll be good, okay? You don’t have to make me do that.”

That sounded like torture. It sounded like hell.

He would rather sit in a corner of the room with a gag in his mouth than do that, and he’s never even *seen* one of those red, plastic balls in real life. Just in videos he’d rather forget.

“I don’t like when you speak badly about yourself, Phainon.” Mydei’s voice was softer now, a complete one-eighty from his previous tone. Its gentle nature made his chest ache, as if it were reaching deep between the bones of his ribs to grasp his heart himself.

It hurt.

Phainon couldn’t explain what it was exactly, or why he even felt this strongly, but it hurt so bad to look at Mydei and see his disappointment and frustration. Even listening to him now, to his attempt at soothing this bubbling mess over, it still felt difficult to breathe.

He didn’t want to be bad. He didn’t want Mydei to look at him or talk to him like that again.

He wanted to be *good*.

“Nothing is wrong with someone being a ‘*pet*’, okay? Some people enjoy the freedom of letting go of the things that make us human,” his best friend said. “But if it upsets you so much, stop riling yourself up with it. You’re triggering your own insecurities by making yourself out to be something you’re not, and I won’t just stand here and watch you do it.”

Phainon’s lip wobbled as his hands curled into fists, and he felt Mydei’s hand cup his cheek gently.

“I’m not trying to scare you. I’m only trying to curb this bad habit so you can enjoy this more, okay?” He hushed him, swiping his thumbs across the top of his cheek slowly. “I can see that you like being someone’s prized possession, and you like being pushed forward when you’re too nervous to keep going. Stop talking yourself out of enjoying it by dehumanizing yourself—*unless* you have a degradation kink I don’t know about.”

“I’ll be good,” he promised him, his voice slightly raspy from the emotions pawing at his vocal chords. Mydei’s eyes flicked down to his lips for a moment, drawn by the sound. “I-I wanna be good again, Mydei. I’m sorry. I don’t know why I do that. It’s…—“

“—safe. I get it. It’s safer to think of it with disgust than admit you might like it,” he finished his words for him. “But you don’t need to be afraid of it. I’m right here with you, Phainon.”

Leaning into him, Phainon felt as his hand lowered, tracing down his jaw and towards his throat.

He liked touching there, it seemed. Whenever he could, Mydei’s hands enjoyed rubbing over his choker or following the dip towards his collarbones. They liked lining either artery, feeling his heartbeat pound inside of his chest, and then brushing over his Adam’s apple after moving his accessory away. Maybe he liked how it bobbed when he swallowed. Maybe he wished he could have his own collar around it, not the leather he has worn religiously for years.

Maybe he didn’t even need to guess that last one, not as Mydei’s thumb glided over the button and his nail curled into its edges. He pulled gently, spinning his choker so its enclosure was easier to access.

But then he stopped.

With the button just beside the bulb of his throat, two thin, leather cords situated themselves above and below. It was just a little uncomfortable to have the accessory twisted around this way, and his hands itched to spin it back, but they refrained. His fingers stayed curled into his palms, fists balled over his thighs to keep his touch to himself.

Mydei spun it again, revealing more of his skin and coaxing the thicker part towards the back of his neck.

“I know you like this old thing,” he whispered, touching the space between either half with his warm thumb. “I do too. It’s always suited you well… But right now, I want to take it off.”

Before he could protest or agree, the button snapping both halves together popped open. That was when he realized Mydei wasn't *asking*, he was he was *telling*.

He wanted it off. He was taking it off.

The choker fell down his shoulder and back, its heavier side falling victim to gravity's pull. Laid out behind him on the bed, its absence left the expanse of his throat completely bare and open to any kind of advance.

Phainon's shoulder twitched in an attempt to shy away from his touch, the reaction involuntary.

"Is this place sensitive because you always cover it up?" Mydei asked him, eyeing his neck.

"I don't know. It just is," he answered quietly, hyperware of the fingers ghosting down his skin and towards the collar of his shirt. "What are you doing, Mydei?"

"Nothing. I won't do anything."

Mydei pulled away, allowing his hand to linger for just one moment more before he reeled that back as well.

"Keep it off for a little bit, and come here. Closer," he instructed him.

They sat together, with him practically on his lap from how little space there was between them. His arms wrapped around his best friend's waist, and he placed his head over his shoulder to be enveloped in him.

"I won't return that collar," he told him, changing his tune from earlier. "If it clicks like the dogs back home, we're going to learn not to associate it with them. If I keep giving in to everything that bothers you, how will you hope to overcome this?"

He nodded, murmuring a soft agreement, and Mydei tightened his hold over him.

"Are you okay?"

"I'm trying," Phainon promised him, reaching for one of his hands and bringing it to his lap. "This is intense, okay? A-And I can't help it. It's got a reputation for a reason. Sometimes it feels nice though, l-like it's not so bad. But then I feel like the world's biggest pervert, and it's just so… so fucking *embarrassing*. I feel *sick*."

"Why don't you go take a bath?" He suggested. "I'll run you one."

"I don't—"

"Come on," he ignored his protesting, then brought their conjoined hands to his mouth. "It'll help you relax, and you can borrow some clothes. If you don't work tomorrow, or you're scheduled later in the day, stay the night."

Mydei's lips pressed to his own golden knuckles, completely dodging the fingers wrapped around his own. But Phainon realized the gesture was there even if he couldn't feel the kiss himself.

Did he even deserve that after his outburst?

"That doesn't sound like punishment for being rude to you…" He trailed off, and Mydei hummed.

"Spend that time alone to think about what was said, then prepare to show me how well you can follow an order," he decided. "*I* will be picking out the clothes you'll wear when you get out. *I* am picking out what you get to have for dinner, then if you get sweets. *I* am deciding whether you get to stay up late on your phone, or if it's coming with me to bed."

Phainon winced, repeating the words to himself inside of his head. That was a lot of having to sit back and just… take it.

"Mydei, please… Can't I keep my phone? I—"

"You're going to refer to me as '*master*' or as '*sir*', so refrain from using my name for the rest of tonight. You may call me that again tomorrow," he silenced him, not leaving any room for discussion.

There it was—*punishment*.

No more being nice. No more being lenient. Mydei was done letting him do as he pleased and getting off with nothing but a slap on the wrist.

"What will I do while you're asleep?" He asked quietly, fidgeting with his hand to quell the tickle of intimidation in his gut.

"You can sleep."

Phainon sighed at that, sulking to himself as he stared at the hands still close to his mouth.

"If you behave correctly, I'll allow you to watch a movie with me before I go to bed," he allowed, and his stomach jumped at the thought of a reward in the middle of all that punishment. "If not, you can simply go to bed in the guest bedroom."

"I'll be good, s…—no, *master*," he promised.

That mocking name he used for him tasted the best in his mouth, and it settled the best inside of his stomach. '*Sir*' was allowed, and he was sure it was more common, but it still felt wrong to say.

Maybe it was because of '*master's* teasing origin that it rolled off the tongue easier than something as unfamiliar and professional as '*sir*', but it just felt a little bit reminiscent of their playful friendship amidst these strict rules and regulations.

Objectively, it was probably worse. Like Mydei said earlier, the name probably had implications that he didn't quite understand. Masters with their slaves. Masters with their pets. Both of those submissive titles felt wrong for him, but for Mydei? He saw it.

In every part of his body, it just made sense. It felt right.

"Come on." Mydei's voice cut through his thoughts. "Hold on to me."

He picked his body up off of the bed with just a soft grunt of exertion, and Phainon couldn't help but look up at him in shock. The action was so swift, so sudden, and he barely had the reaction time to grapple an arm around his neck.

"Watch your head. I'll try not to smack it into the doorframe, but you need to be careful not to do it yourself," he mused. "*Tsk*. Even a prince when you're being punished. I've gone soft."

'*Prince*'.

Phainon vaguely remembered being called that when they were in his living room, but to hear it again made his legs squirm. His insides warmed as if he drank a shot of whiskey.

He's called a girl '*princess*' before. Years ago when the only things that mattered were sports, grades, and being popular, that was his favorite thing to call his ex-girlfriends. No one ever complained, and he liked the way their faces would heat up into a blush. It was cute.

Never would he have thought being in their shoes felt even better than that, especially if the person calling him that was *Mydei*.

—

After his bath and their dinner together, as Phainon awkwardly stood in the kitchen wearing a borrowed tank-top and sweatpants, Mydei turned to him.

His best friend had just come back from a shower, having entrusted the clean-up to him as part of his punishment, and was preparing for bed. Once he double-checked his work, gave him a nod of silent approval for keeping things properly separated and nicely tucked away, he held his hand out expectantly. When a moment passed without reaction, his middle fingers curled as if urging him to comply.

"Phone."

"Mm…"

Phainon's shoulders sank, and he looked down at the device in his hand longingly, not wanting to part with his silly videos, music, and puzzle games. But there wasn't a choice.

“Yes, master…”

Mydei took it from him, slipped it into the pocket of his shorts, then grabbed his arm firmly. A gentle pull eased them closer together, closing the space between their bodies.

“Thank you. Now, come watch a movie with me in my room,” he offered him, and Phainon perked up at the mention. “We can watch one of the hero ones you like. I’ve never finished them all.”

That made him lift his head higher.

“They’re all so old now,” he teased him, making the other man roll his eyes. “They were putting those out when we were in school.”

“I was always too busy studying to watch them, but now I have no drive to do so on my own,” he said simply, leaving no room to question him. “Watch one with me, then we’ll head to bed. Or, you can go lay down—”

“—*no!* Let’s watch one!” Phainon rushed to say. “You have to see the one where the friends reunite! In fact, we can watch them in chronological order in which the universe takes place! I know you’ll understand it better that way!”

Mydei nodded, chuckling softly to himself as he looked away. “Come on. No need to be so excited. One movie, Phainon, because I have to wake up early.”

“Let’s watch them all over time!”

“If you continue to be good, we will watch them all eventually.”

They made their way to his bedroom, flipping off the lights as they passed them and pulling the door shut behind them. Mydei placed his phone on the dresser beside his own, and Phainon instinctively reached for his neck to take his choker off. But all he felt was his own skin when his nails scratched lightly.

Oh. Right. It was taken off already.

He curled into himself, silently looking around the room for his choker while touching his throat. Though he really, really wanted it just for comfort’s sake, it was no longer on the bed where he remembered it being. Both dressers didn’t have it either. Only one held their phones and Mydei’s reading glasses—which made him assume he liked sleeping on the left side of his bed by the window. The other was completely empty on top except for a singular lamp.

His eyes glanced towards the bottom of the bed, to where his blush colored blankets nearly kissed the wooden floor. There was no choker there either.

Mydei didn’t seem none the wiser to his searching as he peeled his bedding apart and laid out a few pillows. A few matched his sheets, and a few looked just like the ones from his guest bedroom.

If they were already in his bed, Phainon realized he must have assumed he'd agree before even asking.

"You don't have to sleep here, but come lay down," Mydei said gently.

"Hey, um… Myd… master," he corrected himself before he could get reprimanded, and Mydei turned around. "Where's my choker?"

"I put it in the dresser." His finger pointed to the one on his side, and he rushed to open it up. "Your clothes, choker, and collar are in there."

Sure enough, a breath of relief left his lips when he saw it, but his attention soon shifted to the collar perched right beside it. Even now, it looked just as intimidating to him. Sat on top of his white t-shirt, the deep red and shiny gold colors made his stomach flutter.

It was so… *Mydei*.

His best friend loved his reds, blacks, and golds, and he supposedly loved collars with leashes attached to them.

If he wore it, that was probably what Mydei was banking on, to take one look at him and see him as his. Dressed in his colors, in his blatant claim, it probably made this whole ordeal better for him. If not, what did Mydei really gain from helping him with this?

That made him freeze in place.

His best friend was a busy man, but he was taking time away from his usual schedule to do this with him. He was patient, empathetic, and supportive of his exploration, teaching him all that he knows and always looking out for his best interest. This place he created for him was safe while being the right amount of uncomfortable, gentle while being firm, and pleasurable. *Everything* he did was for him to enjoy and understand this.

But what did he do for him? What did this arrangement give him if he wasn't taking any kind of personal pleasure or knowledge from this?

If it was just about a collar, any standard black one would do. They could have ran to the nearest adult store and grabbed one off the shelf in all its flimsy, faux leather and fake metal glory. That would have sufficed. It didn't need to be this elaborate or thought out, and it didn't need to perfectly match his best friend's aesthetics.

A collar was a collar, but this was *Mydei's* collar, and a submissive was a submissive, but he was *Mydei's* submissive.

'*You're going to be mine for a little while, okay?*'

Phainon didn't realize he had grabbed the neck piece until a clink of metal meeting metal stole his attention. As he looked down at his shaking hand, he noticed that curled within his fist was thick, padded leather. Beneath, dangling uselessly in the air, was the ring meant for a leash attachment.

“Why are you holding that?” Mydei asked him, and he glanced over to him. “Put it down. The more time you waste, the less—”

“Can I try it on?” He cut him off, raising it towards the other man. “You bought this for me, and you’re also doing a lot for me. Don’t you want me to be yours for a little while, master?”

Mydei’s lips sealed shut, unable to rebuke the statement he had explicitly said to him in the past.

“You wanted your claim on my neck, and I… have to get used to it, right?” Phainon reasoned, using his own words against him to press his resolve. “Would I even look good in red?”

“Come here.”

He could have crawled over the bed. He could have taken that shorter route, rolled over to his side, and then stood in front of him. But that’d look clumsy, right? It’d lack finesse.

Instead, he carefully shut the drawer until wood gently thumped to wood, and he walked around the mattress slowly. With every step, he felt Mydei’s watchful gaze.

“Turn around.”

While facing the large window, Phainon looked down at the nighttime bustle beneath them. Even now, he felt Mydei’s presence grow behind him. He had been sitting down, but he knew he was standing even if his bed made no noise. The heat of a body so close was unmistakable.

The glass in front of him was crystal clear except for tall, ceiling to floor beams. They separated the rectangular planes, serving as the only indicator that there was a window there.

It was nauseating. It was dangerous.

He never realized just how high up Mydei’s condo was. As he leaned just a little close, a whisper of anxiety told him that he’d walk right off of the floor into the still-bustling city.

Small twinkles of cherry breaks lay stagnant in the streets below, caught by the matching traffic lights. On the lit up sidewalks, ant-sized people still walked along freely in their evening adventures, minding their own businesses.

That whisper of fear came back slowly, telling him that one look up would expose him for all that he was. This room was dimly lit and higher than all the little shops around them stacked on top of each other, yet they’d see him. They’d see the outline of his body, of Mydei’s body behind him, and they’d know what they did in here. Everyone would.

“Not so close,” Mydei scolded him gently, pulling him back to his chest.

“I won’t touch them,” he promised.

“I don’t care about the fingerprints,” he scoffed quietly. “It’s a gorgeous view, and I’m sure they’re secure, but don’t go testing the weight capacity of these windows.”

Phainon laughed, then jerked his shoulder when he felt Mydei’s hands bring the collar around his neck. “I bet it’s prettier in the morning,” he agreed.

“It is. You should wake up early with me and enjoy it.”

He *should*.

Was that a kind suggestion as his friend, or was that a thinly veiled demand from his dominant? He had no clue. Was he supposed to?

The first thing Phainon noticed was the kiss of cold metal against his hot skin. Its dangling ring touched between his collarbones lightly, deliberately, settling there for a moment and making itself acquainted with his body. What was just a kiss turned into more as the entirety of the ring flattened out, angled to rest comfortably on top of him.

“Keep going,” he whispered back to him.

Both hands raised as the ring slid higher, leaving his collarbones for a moment to dip into the base of his neck. Now, the soft padding of its inner lining tickled his Adam’s apple, ghosting across his delicate skin before gently pressing down.

Swallowing nervously, Phainon already felt that it was slightly taller and definitely more rigid than his choker. It would take up more space, allow him less movement, and sit heavier on his throat, serving as a constant reminder of his position.

“Don’t stop…” Phainon said, even as his hands raised as if to pull on the accessory. “Master.”

Mydei pulled it tighter, looping one end into its buckle before curling the band completely around his neck.

A gasp ripped itself from his lips, and one finger curled into the ring before weakly pulling. Though it wasn’t enough to choke, it felt different. It felt new.

It was a little bit… scary to know how close he was to choking him, but it was Mydei. Because his best friend was doing it, the experience was also thrilling.

He would never try to choke him… right?

Back to chest, the body behind him stood firm and tall when he backed into him, and Mydei’s nose brushed behind his ear as he exhaled softly. Mint clouded from his lips, crisp and refreshing through the bedroom that reeked of his daily colognes and shampoos.

“Pull harder,” Mydei demanded quietly.

Immediately, his index finger flexed before pulling down on the ring, but it didn’t budge.

Phainon's other hand reached around him, gripping his best friend's t-shirt tightly and pulling him stomach to spine next. Nails scratched into the fabric, ripping into the quiet bedroom.

"*Harder*."

He pulled again, putting more strength into it. This time it lifted slightly, separating from his skin for a moment to give him more space to breathe. But when he let go, it slithered right back into place.

"You don't touch this buckle." The words made him shiver, and his lips trembled as he pulled again without being told to. "If I put this on you, I'll decide when it comes off."

"Yes, master."

A pleased hum followed. "That's my good boy."

Pride flooded through his chest and every vein within his body, tingling with life and excitement.

Mydei loosened his collar, allowing it to sag against the base of his neck before the buckle was fully fastened. Two fingers circled around, pushing and pulling to make note of how much space separated the leather from his skin. When satisfied, those two fingers dipped down and jostled against the ring.

Click.

Phainon winced, breaths heavy from all the different feelings welling up inside of him. He pulled on Mydei's shirt harder, looking up because the thick wall of his collar made it difficult to look that steeply down.

"Who are you, Phainon?" Mydei whispered into his ear, and he screwed his eyes shut.

Click.

"I'm master's sub…" He answered just as quietly, speaking as if someone else could possibly hear them.

Click.

"Do you like your collar?" He asked, and Phainon nodded quickly. In doing so, the collar shifted on its own, forcing the metal to meet again. "Because I think you look better in red than I do."

"Yeah, I… I like it. I like being yours."

His fingers left the ring to push up against the leather, lifting it higher and pressing it closer to the left artery on his neck.

"You're going to wake up early with me," he instructed him, and Phainon felt his own heart beating violently against the cushioned leather. "We're going to the roof to work out and

watch the sunrise together, then you're going to have coffee and breakfast with me. That's your schedule, remember it."

"Yes, master," he agreed.

Mydei let the collar go before settling his palm right over his collarbones. Beneath the leather, he slid the juncture between his thumb and index finger to the base of his neck, holding him firmly and lifting the ring off of his skin.

"But for right now, you're going to sit handsomely in my bed, and I'm going to search for the lore-accurate beginning of this movie franchise."

Phainon laughed, unable to hold it back from both the nerves eating away at him and the humor of Mydei's genuine lack of pop culture knowledge. In the heat of this intense night, it was a refreshing reminder.

"No way Eurypon works you that hard," he said through his chuckles, and Mydei shrugged, still holding on to him. "First, you don't know Sanrio. Second, you don't know superheroes? What's next? You don't play video games anymore?"

Mydei had his console hiding somewhere in his home, but he hasn't seen the handheld device since… *when*, again? He wasn't sure.

"I told you, I don't have the drive to watch movies or television shows on my own. If I wanted to waste hours of my life sitting in the same spot all alone, I'd just sit in my office and work," he scoffed, though Phainon knew the displeased sound wasn't directed at him. "Father would love that."

As Phainon heard one of their phones slip against his wooden nightstand, a thought came to mind. It was fleeting, coming quick and leaving quicker, but it echoed in the back of his head anyway.

Maybe Mydei liked having control in his relationships because he never had any of his own growing up… But he could only laugh at that idea. It was much too sad to give another second of his time.

"What's so funny?" Mydei huffed suddenly, and he tilted his head back into his shoulder to meet his eyes. "And I thought I told you to sit down? Must you always test my hand?"

"Master's holding me too tightly, so I can't go anywhere. Is he scared I'll run from him?" He joked, and that made him pull his hand away slowly while humming. For a moment, he missed the heat and comforting weight.

"I'm not scared," he said confidently. "If you run from me, it must be for a good reason. But if I end up catching you, that must mean you're mine to keep."

"Creepy…" Phainon teased, then reached to sit down on his bed. "I won't need to sleep in this, right? It's so stiff."

Mydei scoffed again, the sound soft and distant as he scrolled through his phone. “Of course not. I’ll take it off of you when the movie ends.”

“Yes, master.”

He settled into his bed, taking over the rosy pillows and finding a comfortable spot within his bed to lay down. They smelled of Mydei’s shampoo, and it made him hum softly to himself.

“Are you comfortable with my stuff, brat?”

“Mm… yeah.” Phainon grinned. “Try not to fall asleep before I can say ‘*good night*’. I’ll say it when the movie ends.”

“I’ll be up longer than you will,” Mydei promised him.

“No, I’ll be up longer,” he protested, looking up at him as amber eyes glanced away from his dimmed phone screen. “You’ll sleep first. You always do, you know.”

“I don’t like that know-it-all attitude,” he told him, then pinched the cheek not pressed into his pillow. “Be good.”

Phainon nodded. “I am good,” he insisted, then nuzzled into his pillows as he awaited him to lay down and start their movie.

If he ended up falling asleep over his shoulder to Mydei’s quiet breaths before the movie even reached the halfway mark, then neither of them needed to talk about it in the morning.

Chapter End Notes

just imagine mydei waking himself up a lil bit after, seeing him sleeping in his collar, then gently unbuckling it so he could be more comfortable.

then him tucking phainon in and falling asleep beside him, ready to wake up in 6hrs to watch the sunrise with his sleepy, whiny prince

Chapter 5: Chapter Five

Chapter Notes

subspace and subdrop are one hell of a thing to write. i think its my favorite about bdsm

The collar became easier to wear since Mydei '*forced*' him to wear it whenever he visited, even if the clinking noise still tickled him in an uncomfortable way. Each time he moved, the ring jostled. Every time he turned, it swung side to side. That sound was inescapable, but he had to learn how to accept it.

He learned to simply… let it go. If he didn't think too much about it, or if he just immersed himself in other things, he could appreciate the comforting mark of Mydei's ownership without the spiral of shame. After all, the collar was comfortable to wear and was meant to help him get in touch with the submissive side of him. Maybe serve as eye candy for Mydei, too.

Phainon caught him looking at it when he thought he was being sneaky, but his gaze was hard to ignore. Those amber eyes were always so intense even if he didn't mean them to be, like they could pull someone apart within seconds if caught too long.

And waking up to those eyes blinking down at him wasn't… *new*. Sharing a bed together wasn't either.

Being friends since high school, they've had their fair share of laying back to back and squeezing into one bed over the years. Every couple of friends did. As adults who both had their own places, however, they didn't do it nearly as often. Mydei typically went back home at night, and Phainon would borrow his guest bedroom if it was offered to him. There wasn't really a reason to sleep together anymore.

But then he fell asleep watching that movie, and he was too tired to drive home the night after, so he borrowed Mydei's expensive bed again while the man washed dishes. Then, again, he slipped into his room to watch another movie a day later, and they had fallen asleep together.

It was comfortable. It was safe. Being next to him made his chest feel fuzzy and his stomach tingle, both in the best ways possible.

One night, while getting his bed ready for them to lay down in, he noticed something that he never did before.

Typically, this was Mydei's job. His best friend was particular about how his pillows sat and where things went, but he was tasked with it since he was busy. Wrongfully so, as it was only

a minute in when he chucked his phone against the headboard by pulling on a pillow.

The device had slipped after clacking loudly. Luckily, it didn't fall completely down the floor, but what he felt when blindly reaching for it was… *interesting*.

As he sat by the head of his mattress, pillows pushed back in disarray behind him, Phainon had his eyes set on two black hooks embedded into the bottom of Mydei's headboard. The gap between the bed and wood revealed them, but they blended in well thanks to the dark decor surrounding them.

He wasn't stupid. He knew it was for bondage, something Mydei was interested in, but it was surprising nonetheless. Did he do those sorts of things often enough to need hooks inside of his bed?

Phainon, unable to stop himself, slotted a finger into one curiously before pulling to test its strength. When it didn't budge, his fingertip circled the large opening a few times to gauge its circumference.

There was a lot of space to feed something through it, like a knotted rope or set of chains, and both felt the same when he checked the one across from it. Mydei must have drilled one for each hand.

"Here's a glass of water. I also…—What are you doing?" The man in question demanded, confusion laced within his voice.

He turned to look over his shoulder, pulling on the hook once more as he looked into his best friend's eyes.

"I-I uh… dropped my phone down here, and when I picked it up, I found your um… hooks," he answered honestly. There was no reason to lie to him, not when he made a promise to never do that to him. "Why are there…?"

"Bondage."

In retrospect, that *was* a stupid question for him to ask when he already knew that. But maybe he just… hoped for more of an elaborate response, something more than stating the obvious.

Sensing his disappointed reaction, the glass in hand was set on top of a coaster on his dresser, and he took a deep breath before leaning over the bed.

"I feed my ropes through them when tying my partner up," he explained a little bit more, satiating the curiosity within him. "Or the chain to my handcuffs since they detach."

Phainon gulped quietly to himself, looking down at the hooks while imagining his own wrists being bound. Would it be so tight that they dig into his skin until his fingers tingled? Or would Mydei treat it like his collar and leave them loose enough for some wiggle room?

Ropes were scratchy with itchy, frayed fibers poking every which way. Wouldn't it feel uncomfortable curled around such delicate skin? How could someone stomach rubbing up against them for long?

“Why are you asking?” Mydei wondered, watching him while he watched his finger circle the hook again.

Interest flared within him, but like most things they did, as did fear.

Being so vulnerable sounded terrifying. Being bound by anything—*rope, leather, or metal*—meant he was susceptible to any kind of treatment. He wouldn’t be able to stop someone if he wanted to, and it would be impossible to move if things became too much. All he would be able to do is sit there and be forced to accept whatever someone—no, whatever *Mydei* wanted to do to him.

There was no ‘*someone*’ anymore. There was no mysterious dominant and a figurative submissive. It was only him and Mydei.

How could *he* stomach rubbing his skin against uncomfortable ropes like in the hardware stores? What would *Mydei* do to him if he had him tied down to his bed and free to touch?

“Phainon, if you want something, you know how you need to ask.” Mydei’s voice was both condescending and encouraging, pushing him to speak rather than stand there and think. “Make a choice. We can watch a movie together, or we can do a little exploration. Regardless, I have about two hours before I need to be in bed.”

The words sat on the tip of his tongue, but his vocal chords were too weak to carry the weight of his request. No sound escaped him besides for his breaths even as he imagined just… *asking.* Free. Uninhibited. *Confident*.

“Phainon.”

He looked over to him, embarrassed by the nature of his innate curiosity, and Mydei’s expression hardened slightly. Amber eyes dropped to his trembling mouth and collared neck, then lifted back towards his own cerulean gaze.

“Closed mouths don’t get fed. Speak or starve,” he instructed him, causing his heart to jump inside of his chest.

That tone was absolute. Mydei’s words might as well have been law with the way his jaw dropped as if to speak.

Still, no words left his lips.

“Okay. Lay down,” he said simply. “We’re not doing it.”

Mydei stood upright, then grabbed a few pillows before laying them out against the headboard in the way he liked them. His patient hands peeled the blankets back, grabbed the abandoned remote so it didn’t get launched like his phone did, and turned the television on.

“No, I-I want…” His voice was a weak, pathetic sound that didn’t feel like his at all, and he immediately took one hand to touch his own throat in shock.

“What do you want?” Mydei asked him. “Surely you can elaborate a little more.”

“Master, I want… *this*,” he said finally.

“Am I supposed to know what ‘*this*’ means?”

“I wanna try… y-you know…” When Mydei didn’t react, his attention still on the screen in front of him as he typed a movie name in, Phainon’s jaw tightened slightly. “Stop looking at the TV and pay attention to me! I-I’m trying my best to say it!”

Mydei turned, lifting an eyebrow upwards at his sudden outburst.

“I wanna try *this*,” he stressed, tapping the metal hooks roughly. The impact of his fingers hitting it hurt less than him looking uninterested in what was troubling him so much. “I wanna try bondage, Mydei!”

“Try again.”

Phainon’s stomach fell. His eyes widened in surprise over the immediate shut down.

Mydei’s lip curled, an unimpressed sneer stretching over his face. “Speak to me the way a submissive is meant to speak to their dominant. You don’t have any grounds to demand from me right now, Phainon.”

He shrunk back, glancing between his hands and that heated glare as he tried to quell the nerves bubbling inside of him.

Forcing it out just once was a lot, and having to say such an embarrassing thing again felt a little bit humiliating. Especially when he was being watched so intently.

But he wanted it. He really, *really* wanted to try it.

“Can I… um… please try bondage with you, master?” He asked him instead, shifting in his place as embarrassment thrummed beneath his skin.

“Better. Do you want me to cuff your wrists to the hooks or tie them up with ropes?” He asked specifically.

“Anything. I-I just want to try it.”

“Don’t say that. Be specific. You don’t mean ‘*anything*’, so tell me what you want done to you,” he repeated himself. “If you truly mean ‘*anything*’, you’ll find more than just your hands restrained.”

“Cuffs. I want you to cuff my hands to them,” he forced himself to say, afraid of what he could do with his inexperienced body if given the chance to be creative. “Please, Mydei.”

“Who are you talking to?”

“*Master*. I meant to say ‘*master*’.”

A pleased hum followed, accepting his correction. “Fine. Wait here for me.”

He set the remote down, then walked off towards the direction of his closet. When he came back, he held a pair of thick handcuffs and a chain in his hands.

They were laid out before him, placed neatly on the bed in how they were meant to look. Either leather cuff sat on the edges of the lobster-clawed chain, all three spread out for his viewing pleasure.

“Touch them,” Mydei offered, crossing his arms over his chest while nodding towards them. “Feel them.”

It reminded him of when he was given his collar. He was meant to familiarize himself with it, to become less intimidated by their presence.

Shaking fingers grasped one of the cuffs, and he eyed its padded insides before thumbing across the neat stitching. It smelled like clean leather when he brought it closer, reminding him that Mydei disliked the scent of metal on skin. That was probably why he didn’t have the classic pair of metal handcuffs he saw online, the ones police officers carried on their hip.

Truthfully, *those* were what he expected, not *these*.

Like his collar, it was thick and heavy. Lined with a nice cushion and decorated with an extra strap to hold a D-ring in place, had this been any bigger, he would have assumed it was a collar too.

Metal kissed his fingertips when he reached, and he picked the connecting chain up before taking in its shiny surface. Upon looking at it, an intrusive thought shot right through his body when the pad of his thumb pulled the claw open, violent and devastating, like a bullet in the chest.

He raised it higher, past the metal ring of the cuff in his opposite hand and towards the one around his neck. But he stopped just before it got too close. Before he could clip it on like some kind of leash, an invisible force pushed him to deny finishing the act.

“Give it to me now,” Mydei decided, and he handed them off wordlessly. “Do you want to be on your back or kneeling for me?”

Phainon looked at him, and he looked down at his hands before humming. “Back, please. I want to see you.”

“Lay down.”

He moved carefully, not wanting to humiliate himself by seeming too eager or too nervous. A pillow was placed behind his head, and he looked up at Mydei as the other man looked down at him.

A nervous laugh bubbled from his lips while he squirmed, sliding himself lower down the bed when his hands knocked the wood. Its sound made his stomach churn.

“Do I look good like this?” He asked, teasing him to ignore the flutters inside of himself. “Have you thought of doing this to me since we started this? You’d enjoy having me at your

mercy like some kind of object, wouldn't you?"

Mydei's jaw clenched, then eased as he looked towards his awaiting wrists.

"You're doing it again," he told him. "Silence, Phainon. If it isn't a color in your mouth, and if I don't ask you to, do not speak."

His lips sealed, and he looked up at his hands as Mydei enclosed the handcuffs around either one.

He let him feel them first, sliding the leather around his delicate wrists without buckling it. They were cool, not yet warmed from the heat of his body, and taller than they had felt in his fingers.

Mydei didn't leave them like that, however. He eased some space between his skin and the equipment, then buckled it carefully. With a tug, he tested their strength. With a finger slotting between, he gauged how tight they were.

One wrist and then the other, he dressed them both in leather, and Phainon bit down on his bottom lip as he looked up at his handiwork. His hands rolled, and his fingers twitched when they were forced lower to the bed. Now that they were on, that meant the chain was next, and Mydei paused before lowering it into his palms.

"Color?"

His back arched off of the bed. His bare feet pressed into the mattress and slid over the soft sheets.

"Green so far," he answered, and the chain was pulled from his hands. As it was fed through the crack between the bed and headboard, he heard its slender links clank against wood and metal.

A claw bit around the left D-ring, but it was the second one that made his chest pound.

Phainon pulled once they were connected, rattling the metal. All of the air in his lungs left when he found there was nowhere for him to go. His elbows bent and his hands wiggled, but they didn't move. His wrists were pinned down to the bed, unable to separate or obey his own commands.

"M-Mydei…"

"Lay like that," he told him, watching his attempts to fight what he knew was impossible. "Squirm, but don't forget to breathe."

Whimpering, he gave one final look to his bound hands, then looked around the bedroom that suddenly felt a lot bigger than it had been. Being restrained to the bed made him feel smaller, less like he stood at Mydei's height and more like he was *less* in general. Like he was just another part of his bedding to admire. Like all the muscle in his body meant nothing because he was more powerless than ever.

Both legs kicked again weakly, and he looked up at Mydei when his hand gently brushed the hair from his face.

“I could do anything to you,” he told him, pointing out the obvious as if to remind him of how vulnerable he was. “This poor little prince is all tied up, what could stop me?”

“Mydei,” he choked out, pulling again as a jolt of something sickening bled through his stomach. “I can’t… I don’t…—”

“Talk to me.”

Gentle fingertips trailed down his cheekbone and jaw, caressing his skin lightly.

“Do you like this?” He asked, swooping underneath his chin to pick it up off the edge of his collar. “Look straight. Look at me. Tell me how being powerless feels.”

Phainon hated it. He hated that lick of heat that burned underneath his cheeks, and the invisible grasp wrapped around his lungs that made it difficult to breathe. It was a terrible feeling for his skin to not feel real underneath that soothing touch, but like a thin veil hiding something vile beneath.

If Mydei touched him too hard, he worried it’d tear and reveal the mess beneath—the writhing, electrified mess of deep rooted shame and guiltied pleasure.

He hated that fear. The one that told him he was a pathetic man for letting himself be tied down and spoken to that way, the one being poked and prodded at by his embarrassing position. Mydei was toying with it both physically and emotionally by keeping him restrained and reminding him of his statement.

Like this, it felt like every part of him was Mydei’s to touch, to create and destroy as he saw fit—inside *and* out. More than just being *his* submissive-in-training and *his* best friend, he was *his toy*.

“Ah ah, stay with me,” Mydei scolded him lightly, pinching his cheeks and bringing him back from the depths of his head. “You have no other place to be but right here. I didn’t say you could leave.”

Phainon rolled closer to him instinctively, to his grounding and familiar presence in this maze of the unknown, and Mydei eased his hand.

“Tell me what you feel.”

“W-Weak,” he answered, flicking his attention up to his eyes. “Gross. P-Powerless. Ah… h-hot…”

Mydei didn’t respond, so he continued, rambling to appease the invisible but unmoving pressure pushing on his insides.

“Scared. I’m scared, De,” he confessed, rattling the cuffs again and shifting his shoulders off the bed before falling back, limp. “I’m… I’m also tingling. Am I even real? Am I…

someone? Or am I just… *feelings?* There's so many so deep inside of me, a-and they're growing deeper, *bigger*, but I can't stop them. I can't do anything."

A hand pressed flat to his stomach after, and he tilted his head back as a gasp ripped itself from his lungs.

"This right here is trying to combat *stigma* from *truth*, so be kind to it. Don't rush it," he told him. "I've got you, and you trust me, right?"

"Yeah. I trust you," he promised. "You're the only person I trust with this."

"Is it exciting?" Mydei asked, rubbing his belly as it flexed involuntarily. "Being handcuffed like that, does it excite you to know you're at the mercy of someone you trust? Is it comforting to know it's me?"

Phainon nodded quickly. "You wouldn't… take advantage of me. I know that."

"Only if you liked it," he teased him, and his fists balled at the implication. "You're doing so well with this. I can only imagine how you'd handle other kinds of play and kinks. With this strong body and your resolve, I'm sure you'll find things will get easier as you do them more often."

"I'm doing good?"

"Yes, Phainon. You're being so good for me," he praised him softly. As a deep breath filled his lungs, Mydei continued. "I'm very proud of you."

"Proud because I-I think I like it?" He wondered, earning a shake of the head.

"Even if you hated this, I'd still be proud of you. Our experiments aren't about you *liking* them. Not everyone will like this kind of play or lifestyle. This is about you trying to *learn* and opening yourself up to *understanding*," he corrected him. "For that, I am proud of you."

Heat filled his body, and his legs kicked weakly as an electrifying bolt shot right between his hips.

"Mydei, I'm… I um…" He stammered, unsure how to tell him that all of this was arousing him in some sick, twisted way.

"That expression on your face tells me you're liking this more than you're letting on," Mydei accused him, inching the hand on his belly higher.

He nodded quickly, jerking his arm as the urge to grab his hand struck him. "Yeah… I like it."

"And this?"

His hand paused by his ribs, holding him as he sucked in deep breaths and let them out just as heavily.

“Like that day?” He asked him. “In my living room, when you… touched me. Are you gonna…?”

“I should reward you, right? For accepting those handcuffs so bravely,” he told him, slowly lifting his hand higher.

Phainon’s chest pushed forward, back arching higher off of the bed. His silent encouragement made Mydei to continue, coaxing him to cup the plush muscle and squeeze.

“Master,” he moaned softly. The title slipped from his mouth before he could catch it. “Can you… Can… *nngh… pinch?*”

“What do we say?”

“Please?”

Two fingers clamped down through his shirt, and he hissed quietly while turning his head away. With his eyes screwed shut, he tried his best to ignore the fact Mydei could see him this time.

Before, his best friend had his eyes covered and closed. Now, he could watch as he trembled from the growing heat licking at his skin, and he could see the bulge poorly hiding behind his borrowed sweats. Every twitch. Each flush. They were his to witness, to revel in the fact he’s the only person to ever see him like this.

“I think you would like nipple clamps,” he told him thoughtfully, rolling the sensitive bud between his index finger and thumb. The tank-top agitated his skin, rubbing it into an ache. “Have you seen them?”

“Yeah,” he panted. “Yeah, i-in those videos… Mydei, they’re scary.”

“Cuffs were too until I put you in them,” he reminded him. “I have some. The one you’d like is probably the lightweight set with silicone tips. Do you want to try them?”

He’d have to be naked for that, right?

Well, not naked. He had his pants and his boxers on, but Mydei would have to look at his bare chest, at his rosy and stiffened nipples. He’d get to see every breath he took, every flex of his body, and though his torso was not a new sight, this was new.

It was one thing to see him casually at the beach or around the house, but it was another to see him sexually as he was getting off.

But this was Mydei. This was his eyes on him, and his hands on his body, and he was safe. He was cautious. He was here to help, even if he was scared, shy, or snappy of what they did.

“I wanna try,” he said quietly, and Mydei’s hands left his body slowly. While retreating, he smoothed his top out.

“I’ll be right back,” he promised him as the weight beside him left.

Immediately, his stomach dropped. It was as if he hadn’t just asked him to grab another sex toy from his closet of kinky things, as if he had chosen to just leave him here on his bed, bound and helpless.

Phainon bit down on his bottom lip, then wiggled higher up the bed before glancing down at the state of his body.

His sweats were low. The constant moving pushed the waistband down, exposing the elastic of his boxer briefs. Beneath, his stiffened cock peeked through the fabric, tenting it so obviously that shame burned red hot inside of his veins. It only worsened when he noticed the light poking of his nipples through his shirt, even the one that wasn’t being touched.

“Mydei,” he called out, looking around the empty room. “M-Mydei, hey—”

Metal rattled. His heart hammered faster.

“Mydei? I-I change my mind. Come back,” he rushed, unable to shake the feeling that he was left here. “Mydei!”

From a corner of the room near the door to his bathroom, he watched as a head of sunset blond hair popped out. His eyes fixated on the bed, and he rushed over without another to spare.

“Relax, I’m right here,” he promised him, and Phainon’s arm reached for him, just for it to meet the cuff. “What, can’t take being without me?”

“Don’t leave me like this,” he begged. “Don’t go where I can’t see you if I’m like this. Please.”

“Shh… breathe for me. I’d never leave you alone like this.” A warm hand cupped his cheek, and he nuzzled closer into it as tears burned inside his eyes. “Tilt your head up. Drink.”

The palm on his face slid to the back of his head, helping him lift his head as much as possible to accept the glass he held his mouth.

Phainon looked up at him, tears blurring his vision into nothing but that familiar and comforting combination of gold and cherry red. He couldn’t make him out in every handsome detail, but he felt his hands. He heard his voice. He smelled his bodywash and shampoo. All of it promised security.

“There you go,” Mydei whispered, gripping the glass tightly and controlling how much he could drink at a time. “Keep looking at me.”

His eyes never left. They watched as he carefully tipped his drink back and forth, cautious of feeding him too much too soon. Then he wiped away a few droplets of water from beneath his lip with his thumb.

“Give me a color.”

“You won’t leave again?” He exhaled shakily, and his head shook. “Can you undo these cuffs, master?”

“Do you not want them?”

“I want it like… like last time,” he admitted to him. “Please.”

Mydei eased his head back, then reached for the clasps that enclosed his wrists to the metal hook. He unraveled the chain quickly, pulling it free so he could bring his arms down freely.

“On top of me,” he ordered, and Phainon followed him as he moved to lay down beside him. “That’s it… Mm, you do look good up there.”

His knees settled on either side of his lap, lowering him onto his lap until he comfortably sat over his thighs. The cuffs were still on his wrists, but the chain between them had been discarded elsewhere for now.

Being able to move freely felt good, it let him come down faster, but part of him already missed that edge of being at his mercy. It wasn’t that he wanted to be uncuffed, he just didn’t want to be *alone*.

“My lap is your throne. Take it as you please,” Mydei told him, and he felt his stomach tighten from his words. Each nail in his thick arms dug in deep, holding him for dear life.

“As I please…?” He repeated softly, and Mydei reached beside him to grasp that chain again.

“As you please,” he confirmed, bringing his hands down to place them between their bodies. “Put these behind my head. Don’t move them. If you move them, I’ll stop.”

As soon as he missed the restraints, they were back, and his lower half twitched from the excitement of being at his mercy again.

The chain was brought behind him, and Mydei carefully tied his hair up to avoid it getting caught within the metal links. Some strands spilled over his shoulders. Some stuck out in a loose bump. As messy as it was, he still looked so good in front of him.

“You’re staring.”

“I’m not,” he protested weakly, admiring the cherry tint to his cheeks and the depth of his heated gaze. “I… I can’t move. Master’s pinning my hands behind him, so I’m stuck..”

His shoulders pushed the chain to the headboard, leaving his hand flat to the wood and unable to move. It kept him on his lap, both of them sitting upright with the front of their pants brushing together.

Through the haze over his heavy head, Phainon noticed that Mydei was just as hard as he was, but not once has he told him to touch him, give him attention, or even try to touch himself. His hands stayed on him. His focus and his words were all for him, like Mydei just did not care about his own pleasure.

Two hands soon cupped over his chest without warning, playing with his body the way he liked. They squeezed, pulling the plush skin and lifting it higher just to hear him choke on a moan.

“What a handsome expression for you to wear,” he murmured, inching his fingers down. They trailed lined his ribs before twisting to touch the hem of his tank-top and curl, but he stopped there. For a moment, they stayed like that, breathing heavily and waiting.

When he didn’t object, inch by inch, it began to rise.

His bare stomach was exposed little by little, and Phainon rolled his head to the side while watching him.

“Open.”

He obeyed instantly. Jaw dropped, he accepted the bundled up tank-top over his tongue and into his mouth.

“Give me a color.”

“Green.”

Mydei hummed, pleased by the muffled noise, then looked down at his newly revealed skin. The room was colder than he anticipated, shocking his pebbled nipples to stiffen more, and a shiver trickled down his spine. But it didn’t last for long, as two hands engulfed his waist and straightened up his spine.

“Don’t slouch, it’s bad for you,” he nitpicked his slumped figure, coaxing him into the position he wanted. “A proud submissive keeps a respectable posture, and my submissive should always look me in the eye when he can.”

Phainon held it, keeping his attention on him even as he continued to touch his naked skin with one hand.

“These clamps will pinch.”

Cold metal touched his body seconds after, making him jerk away out of reflex. Not that there was anywhere to go.

Another metal change dangled between them, catching his attention. Like a hypnosis trick, he followed the back and forth sway, intimidated by the thick ends tipped in black. They were wide mouthed with a pin to the side, one he could only assume tightened them down. Its chain was dainty—*much, much more dainty than his cuffs*—and almost pretty in nature.

Almost.

Mydei let it kiss his skin, sweeping over his chest and catching on the puffy, pink nipples standing proudly. Each brush made him wince, body folding in on itself.

The swaying soon stopped. He guided one of the silicone edges to his chest, lightly flicking over it just to tease.

“Please,” he begged through his mouthful. “Master, please.”

“You make that title grow on me every time you say it,” Mydei sighed almost happily. His attention then dropped to his chest. “Shoulders back. Let me see this handsome body.”

Phainon pushed himself out more, looking up since his collar prevented him from looking down.

“One. Two. *Three*.”

A sharp cry left his lips when the clamp bit down over his left nipple, already feeling tighter and more unforgiving than a pair of fingers were. Even tipped with rubber, the metal behind was rigid, and they only tightened as that pin was twisted.

“S-Stop,” he begged through his gag, shoulders sinking as the teeth closed deeper. “Stop, stop, stop. Master, please. That’s… That’s enough. No more.”

Instead of tightening it further, he eased it down a bit before leaving it there, then the opposite side was teased the same way. Once. Twice. Three times he nudged the sensitive bud.

“Look at me.”

Phainon dropped his gaze, tilting his head down to look Mydei in the eyes as the second pair clamped down on his body. Eyebrows raised, eyes wide from the lick of pain, he stared at him while his shoulders and chest trembled. They threatened to cave in on themselves, to lean forward and curl closer in an attempt to appease the sting.

The second one tightened until it matched the first, and fresh tears welled up within his eyes.

Mydei swallowed thickly, loudly, as he watched him squirm. “Does it hurt?” He asked, voice thick in a way it only got when he pushed him just shy of too far.

That night in his kitchen, when he admitted that he liked praising him. That day in his living room, when he said he wanted to watch him cry and collar his neck. That night in his bedroom, when he buckled a collar around his neck and demanded he pull it. Right now, as he looked up at him from his crumpled state, the chain of his clamps swinging and jerking with every twitch.

He liked it. Mydei liked him when he gave himself to him like this, and it wasn’t a secret.

Pain or pleasure, comfort or unease, wide smiles or crying eyes, Mydei wanted it all. Every piece of him and each part of this experience was his to control and own.

That was what he got out of it. *That* was his half of this arrangement.

He took care of him, yes. But he did so as his best friend too. As a dominant, this tug of war in his body was his to sway, and that was what he wanted. He wanted the struggle, the obedience, and the resolve, and he wanted all of it catered to *him*.

He wanted *everything* in return for his *all*.

Phainon couldn't explain it, but he wanted to give it to him too. He wanted to be pushed, to be forced past that nasty feeling in his stomach, and to be what his dominant wanted. He wanted to be what Mydei was to him, but what was the submissive equivalent of the security a dominant brought?

"I asked you if it hurt," Mydei repeated himself, and he nodded weakly.

His lips wobbled from around the cotton between his teeth, something he couldn't quite control no matter how hard he tried. Heat licked over his delicate nipples, rooted where the clamps held them tightly and spreading as they bounced with each muffled cry. His heart felt like it was going to beat out of his chest, and his lungs were working overtime to match the speed of his breaths.

It hurt, but it was meant to, right? They were meant to pinch.

Mydei even warned him they would pinch, but he still wanted it. He *asked* for this.

"Sit up." Mydei guided him, then cradled the chain attached to his clamps to keep the weight off. "You're doing so well. If you need to, say your safewords. I can understand you."

Tears rolled down his cheeks as he arched his back deeper, and Mydei used his free hand to cup between their bodies.

"Just like last time, you're going to cum for me," he instructed him gently, palming him slowly. "Roll your hips. Rock them into me, pretty boy."

His body felt… strange. It felt like it wasn't his own at all. Neither were his jumbled thoughts.

Mydei spoke, and it was as if every nerve and bone in his body wished to bend to his will. There wasn't a single itch to disobey, to talk back, or to deny him.

Eye to eye, unable to run because of his physical and mental restraints, all he could do was look at his best friend and follow. He was the experienced one. He was the secure one. He knew what he was doing.

Phainon's hips moved, and Mydei groaned softly. "You're so hard… Your jeans did not give me all this information last time…"

He squeezed harder, closing around the flimsy fabric. Fingertips dug beneath where his balls sat tucked into his briefs, and the heel of his palm moved against his cock. With every buck, he pushed down, massaging him tightly.

"I want…" Mydei started to speak, then he cut himself off. "Hm… Look at you. Come on, keep going. Don't stop until your master says so."

Phainon moaned loudly, jaw dropping and teeth releasing his tank-top in the process.

“What a messy little boy. Come on, give it to me. I’ve got it,” he mocked him gently, using the hand holding the chain to capture the fallen fabric.

Two fingers curled into the ring of his collar, using it to support the weight of his hand. With his thumb, he kept the other two from falling.

“Touch me,” Phainon begged, pulling his hands back just to be stopped by Mydei’s body. With it, he sat up higher on his knees to push closer to his hand. “Touch me, master.”

“I am.”

“No, *i-inside*, please.”

“Fuck…” He whispered back, watching his face before pulling his hand away from his aching bulge. “Be specific. Ask me for what you need.”

“Can you p-please touch my cock, master?” He obeyed.

Mydei’s hand slipped under the waistband of both his sweats and briefs, following the trail of ivory hairs that tickled beneath his navel. He lowered both further. The two articles of clothing soon bunched underneath his heavy balls, exposing the flushed and sticky skin of his twitching length.

He didn't look, but he did grasp him tightly. His thumb dragged over the head, spreading the mess of pre-cum lower.

Phainon’s eyes screwed shut, mouth agape as pathetic cries of pleasure fell from them. Every nerve was on fire, brought to life from the mix of burning pain and numbing pleasure. It was a concoction he had never felt before, but one that his hazy brain said was better than anything he had ever felt.

“Messy even down here,” Mydei teased him, slowly pumping his hand over the tip. “Listen. You can hear just how sticky you are.”

Sure enough, the soft, slick sounds of his speeding jerks fell underneath his voice, quiet but not silent.

“Master, I-I’m… *h-hah*…” He was speaking before he even knew what he wanted to say, lost in the sensations he had never felt before. Head lolled to the side, he looked back at Mydei, staring with distant recognition and misty eyes. “Don’t stop. Don’t s-stop. Don’t…—”

“That’s my good boy,” came his dominant’s voice, encouraging him. “Your hands are cuffed. Your nipples are clamped. Your neck is collared. You have the most debauched look on your pretty face, and I bet you don’t even understand what’s happening. I bet that head is all empty right now…”

“Yeah,” he agreed absentmindedly. “Yeah yeah yeah. Master, I wanna cum. I wanna cum s-so bad.”

“Do you remember what you need to do?”

“Yeah!” He gasped, buckling his hips forwards when Mydei’s thumb pressed to the head of his cock and his wrist twisted. “Ask! I-I have to ask my master for permission. Always have to ask.”

Mydei chuckled, eyes raking down his face before glancing away.

“What do you need to ask permission for?” He tested him.

“Cum,” he answered. “I have to ask f-for permission to cum, and I… I have to ask permission to touch myself. This is my master’s body. I have to be good for him.”

Mydei’s lips parted for a breath, and he nodded while readjusting his position beneath him.

“Are you master’s good boy?” He egged him on, slightly breathless. “You’d let me do anything to you like this, wouldn’t you?”

He nodded quickly, unable to speak when the finger holding his clamps lifted the chain high enough to jostle them. Instead, all he could do was sob from the jolt of pain.

“Let go, Phainon. Give it all to me,” he coo’ed, bouncing them lightly. “Break for me just this one time, and I’ll put my sweet prince right back together. *I promise*.”

Eyes shut, he fucked himself into Mydei’s fist, blindly chasing the pleasure that kept the burn of his chest at bay. Everything was on autopilot, guided by nothing but knee-jerk instinct and the low voice giving him order after order. Nothing else mattered. Nothing else needed to.

It was him and his master, and whatever his master wanted, he got.

“I can feel you twitching. You’re so close, aren’t you? Come on,” Mydei instructed him. “Ask your master for permission.”

Phainon hiccuped, flexing his stomach and focusing on the pleasure of having someone else touch his cock. Heat burned inside of him, engulfing every inch of his body.

“Master, c-can I cum?” He pleaded with him, voice rushed and pitched as his balls tightened. “Can I please cum for my master? I’m so close. I-I’m so, so close. Please. I’ll do anything. I’ll do a-anything.”

“That’s it. Mm… Keep going.” Mydei sounded so proud, and that positive tone made his head even more hazy. “What will you do for it?”

“*Anything*, please,” he begged, humping his hand faster and scratching his nails into the headboard.

The fist pumping his cock twisted again, squeezing even further as if trying to rip the orgasm from his body.

“Look at me.” Immediately, his eyes snapped open, but they were only able to hold a half-lidded gaze. “Good boy. Look at your master as you cum. Let him see every inch of your pretty face.”

Phainon kept his eyes on him as he felt his hips jerk and thighs shake, unable to tear his eyes away from him. An order was an order, and he was good. He listened to them, and he obeyed them, and that earned him this—an orgasm so powerful that hot ropes of seed pumped over his own chest.

Whatever coherency was left within him dissipated then and there. Between such intense feelings and the full-body release, it left him panting and gelatinous on Mydei’s lap. Ringing filled his ears. Sweat filled his nose. There was a dryness in his mouth from it being open so long, one a singular drink of water wouldn’t fix right away.

Shoulders lax and head heavy, he sat there and stared at the man in front of him. His body was filthied and exhausted, barely hanging on to reality by the thinnest thread.

And that thread was the deep, comforting voice that had been guiding him all night.

“Stay with me,” he said, and Phainon whimpered when one of his clamps eased off of his aching nipple. “Can you hear me?”

“Mm…”

The second followed, and he felt a few more tears fall while looking at Mydei, unable to recognize the expression on his face. All he could sense was that he was gentler, he was touching him softly, and his voice felt like a warm blanket on a cold night. As hot as it felt, cold shivers were wracking his undressed body, the result of the cool air meeting his sweat-slick skin.

“I’ve got you.”

“A-Ah…” He gasped, feeling something cold press to the heated flesh of his nipple. “Hurts. M-Master… *hurts*—”

“I know,” he hushed him, speaking quietly while looking at his rosy chest. “I’ll make it better.”

His eyes lowered, finding a sleek glass that still had a drink of water left at the bottom. It swished, silently beckoning him to drink and fix the dryness on his tongue.

“Open,” Mydei instructed, and his lips parted to accept the rim. “Don’t swallow. Hold it until I say.”

Phainon watched him, blindly trusting him to guide his head back and feed him the drink. He let that little bit of water coat his tongue and cheeks, then let it sit while watching Mydei’s mouth intently.

“Swallow.”

He gulped.

“I need to clean you up, rub balm on your chest, and get you new clothes.” The instructions of what he was supposed to do were unclear, and he blinked at him.

Mydei slowly lifted his arms, guiding both over his head so he could unlock his wrists. Fingers gently massaged the irritated skin from his pulling, and when he gently tickled his palm, he seemed pleased by the twitch of his fingers.

“I’m going to take your collar off,” he warned him, and Phainon furrowed his eyebrows.

“M… Master wants it off?” The sound of his voice was small and afraid, as if he was in trouble but didn’t know why.

“To clean,” he reassured him. “I’m going to take it off so I can clean both it and you.”

Phainon didn’t understand, but he sounded genuine. He sounded gentle. Because of that, his chain was raised and his neck stretched.

Fingers reached behind him to unfasten the golden buckle, and he frowned over the naked feeling of losing everything that had been stimulating him. The cuffs, the collar, the clamps, all of it was gone. They all disappeared somewhere he couldn't find the strength to look, and all that lingered was the soreness of his body and the filth of being touched.

His neck felt stiff. His chest burned. His wrists ached. His throat was scratchy. His eyes were puffy.

The longer he sat there, the worse his body felt without the rush of pleasure and adrenaline of pain to combat it. What was a storm of gut churning emotions and heart racing sensations left behind the ruins of whatever he was now, and it felt… gross. *He* felt gross, dirty, and used, and he was too wrecked to do anything about it.

Mydei eased his tank top off of his body, pulling it overhead and using it to wipe up the milky release painting them both. He tucked his sensitive cock back into his boxers and beneath the sweats, but his briefs were sticky from pre-cums seeping into them. That, too, felt disgusting against him.

“Sit aside for a second.”

His body was set aside, and he looked at the darkened screen of the television as Mydei moved quickly, dutifully. One second he was in bed. The next, he was standing beside him to pluck his body off the mattress with a soft grunt.

“Either I feed you too many desserts, or I need to increase my max,” Mydei chuckled to himself. “I’ll definitely get stronger for this, so try to keep up.”

Phainon squirmed, and as he was set down on top of a cushioned seat inside of the bathroom, his eyes shifted to a tall mirror. Upon seeing himself, his eyes widened.

He looked like a mess.

The cuffs left a rosy ring around his wrists, and his nipples were a shade of red they've never been before. All of the crying left his eyes and face pink, and there was a swell to his bottom lip from biting it so much.

And Mydei… *liked* that. He *wanted* that.

'*Pretty boy'*.

'Handsome'.

'Pretty face'.

He looked… beaten up. Kind of. Especially when he rolled his neck and found the back was red from the pressure of his collar being tugged forward.

Mydei—*his best friend who wanted him like this*—opened a cabinet nearby, and his eyes raked over all of the bottles, tubes, cans, and jars. They were too far away to make out the small prints, but he picked a few before coming back to him. Each was set on the nearby counter, and he washed his hands quickly.

"These will be sore for a little while, so I want you to sleep without a shirt tonight," he told him, spinning the lid off of a small jar before dipping a finger into it. "Let me see."

The substance on the tip of his finger came close, and he flinched away.

"Relax, Phainon," he advised him, then gently pressed his finger to his left nipple. "This should help with how tender they are, and it'll keep the skin from cracking. When you wear clamps, they can damage the skin. You have to—"

"You suggested it," he whispered, breathing heavily through having his sensitive body touched.

Phainon had never considered nipple clamps before tonight, but here he was with an aching chest. Had he never brought it up, he never would have wanted to try it.

"Yes, I thought you'd like them since you enjoy having yours pinched," Mydei defended himself. "All play comes with side effects. As long as you're careful and treat it properly, most things are safe."

"Did you like it?" He asked softly, staring at his wrists and rubbing his thumb over the hot skin. "Did seeing me in pain like that give you the power kick you crave? Will you touch yourself to my crying face later? I know you're hard—not that you even mention yourself… Do you think you're too good to join me in this?"

Mydei paused, resting his thumb just shy of his nipple so as to not overstimulate them.

"Phainon, what are you saying?"

"I-I don't know. I feel… weird," he choked out through his already scratchy throat. "My head doesn't feel like i-it's attached to my body."

“It’s okay,” he reassured him. “I’m going to make it all better. All you have to do is sit down and tell me everything you feel.”

“I feel like fucking shit,” he answered, overwhelmed by the mess inside of his body, and Mydei nodded. “I-I look like a mess. Do you… like that? Do you like looking at me when I feel this way?”

The jar was set aside, and he picked another tube up before ripping its sticker off. Upon closer inspection, he recognized it was a small stick of chapstick.

“I like knowing you felt good. Did it feel good for you?” He asked him, cupping his chin before raising the stick to his lips. “Don’t lick your lips. That’s bad for them.”

Phainon turned his head before he could touch his mouth with it, and Mydei stood there in silence for a moment while staring at him.

“Am I ‘*handsome*’ when I’m all bruised up?”

“It’s light. Your neck won’t mark, and your wrists might be a little bit tender tomorrow from all your pulling, but you won’t see anything tomorrow,” he said instead. “Your chest will hurt for a few days. I want you to take the balm—”

“That’s not what I asked,” he cut him off. “Am I ‘*handsome*’ when I look like a mess?”

Mydei turned his head, gripping his chin firmly before bringing the chapstick close again. “You are, objectively, a very handsome man,” he brushed off.

That wasn’t what he wanted to hear. Not even close.

“Just answer me, Mydei!” He begged, grabbing him by the shirt before pulling him closer. “Tell me you like it when I feel like garbage! Tell me you think I’m good looking when my face is puffy from sobbing! Tell me these bruises make you happy!”

“Phainon, that’s enough!”

He flinched over the sharp cut of his voice, then sat there as still as stone when he grappled a hand over his bare shoulder to squeeze.

“Calm down and breathe,” he said firmly. “Just relax and take a deep breath. You’re okay.”

“I don’t *feel* okay!” He cried. “You say that, but I’m so *ashamed* of myself all the time!”

Everything was disconnected. His head, his heart, his stomach, all of them said different things but they all said it at once. One wanted to come back to *reality*. One wanted to be a *good boy*. One wanted to feel *ashamed*. They fought, tangling into one another and dissecting him into pieces that made no sense separated or put together.

It was like all the leather and chains kept him together in that bed, but without them, he had no clue what to do, how to act, or what to say.

Mydei's eyes fell for a second, and he nodded slowly before giving his shoulder another squeeze.

"You are my best friend, so I'll do whatever it takes to make you feel better," he promised him softly. "Once I finish cleaning you up, I will dress you, we will get you some water and a snack, maybe cool your chest for a little bit, and I'll let you fall asleep to a movie."

"What about you?" Phainon asked, hoping he would lay beside him to watch it even if he knew he probably blew that with his attitude. "What will you do when I'm in bed?"

"A lot of things need to be cleaned before I go to bed," he said simply, clearly not wanting him to worry about it. "I'll sleep with you when I finish, unless you want some privacy. Maybe you'll feel better with some time to just… come down on your own."

Would he?

Phainon hated being alone, but Mydei knew these things better than he did. Maybe he had a point.

"I just… want this sick feeling in my stomach to go away," he muttered, and Mydei nodded while pulling him into a careful hug, promising that he'll do his best for him.

Chapter 6: Chapter Six

Chapter Notes

> i dont know how sub drop is for anyone else, but i get SUPER emotional and my insecurities really pop. its probably mostly my anxiety, but sub drop makes it so bad.
>
> if phainon is out of character, its because i use my own experiences as much as possible while trying to stay true to them. sometimes it doesnt coincide, but i try

See the end of the chapter for more notes

‘*… Maybe you’ll feel better… on your own.*’

Phainon didn’t know what that was supposed to mean. He couldn’t fathom unraveling this mess inside of him without Mydei’s skilled hands and gentle tongue.

Maybe he knew better. Maybe he should just trust him. But it felt… wrong. A voice inside nagged at him, insisting that wasn’t what *he* wanted even if it might be better.

He never liked to be alone, especially while vulnerable.

That same night, he had fallen asleep while Mydei was in the bathroom cleaning his things, staring outside at the dimly lit skyscrapers. Though the television was on, he wasn’t paying much attention. All it did was cast a bright glow into the bedroom and add a soft chatter to fill the tense quiet.

Most of his bedtime comfort came from the opened bathroom door, from listening to Mydei as he meticulously cleaned the leather cuffs and collar. It was the soft scratches of bristles that made his eyes feel heavy. The occasional flow of the faucet helped him forget about the numb sensation of his chest too. Both being mixed with the exhaustion in his bones made for a drug so strong he didn’t even remember sleeping.

One minute he was wondering why Mydei would ever think he could do this on his own, and the next he was waking up to a warm hand engulfing his shoulder.

Humming, he looked up to find Mydei leaning over him, and two things crossed his mind as his sleepy eyes adjusted to being conscious.

The first was that his nipples *hurt*.

When his heavy blanket slid over the sensitive buds, he winced, face scrunching up in discomfort. They were more tender than he thought was possible, and it made him shift to lay down his back rather than his side.

The second was that Mydei was dressed as if he had already done his morning work out, and the gleaming sun proved he must have. Its bright, golden rays streamed through the ivory curtains, illuminating the room and the sweat that lightly darkened through his compression shirt.

“G’morning…” He mumbled up at him.

“Good morning, sleeping beauty,” Mydei teased him gently, but it didn’t make him smile or laugh. “Was it nice sleeping in like you used to? It’s almost nine.”

“Mm… Bu’ what ‘bout me?” He asked groggily. “I wanted t-to join you. Mas…—*Mydei*, we’re supposed to do it together.”

His chest pulled uncomfortably to think the routine they started was broken. The worst part was he didn’t have a say in it either. Mydei decided that all on his own.

That was *their* thing.

Since that night he first woke up with him as his submissive, they took to the roof and did their daily workouts in the cool morning air together. They talked about their plans for the day while stretching, griped about their coworkers and bosses during simple weight lifting, and pressed each other to keep going when they began to slow down. It was the perfect way to start the day off feeling energized and relaxed, and it doubled as a way to spend more time with Mydei.

His best friend has always been health conscious, so sharing in his work outs meant he could do something he enjoyed the same way Mydei offered to watch movies with him. That made it into a win-win scenario.

Why would Mydei do it without him this time? Did he not want him around anymore?

“I want you to rest today,” his best friend instructed him. “I have lunch to attend with my father for work later, so I won’t be back until the afternoon.”

Phainon looked over his sweaty face and the strands of hair glued to his skin, noticing the rose flush over his slender cheeks and the tip of his nose.

“H… Huh?”

Mydei was leaving him…?

He blinked, staring up at him as Mydei’s hand slid from shoulder to bicep. His touch was hot and comforting, but his head still felt like it wasn't screwed on tight enough to function.

Things weren’t making sense. The dots just weren’t connecting, and everything felt cranked up to a level of overstimulation that he wasn’t familiar with. For someone just waking up, everything already felt like too much—the rejection, the abandonment, the physical aches in his body, the brightness of the morning sun. All of it was too much.

“How is your chest feeling?” Mydei asked, eyes glancing down briefly to assess their physical state before picking back up.

Phainon propped himself up on his elbows, and he met Mydei’s softened gaze.

“You did our thing without me, then… you’re just gonna leave me when I feel like this?” His voice was quiet, but the hurt within his words was loud. It was deafening inside the silent bedroom.

Forget his sore nipples. Forget his stiff neck. Forget whatever physically ailed him at that moment. Those could be fixed with a special little pill called a *pain killer* and a whole lot of just toughing it out.

What hurt most right now was his heart from the thought—Mydei didn’t want him there to do the things they usually did. Mydei purposefully ignored waking him up so he could have time away from him.

It felt like a punch to his uneasy stomach, and the bruise forming was in the shape of his best friend’s fist.

“I pushed you too far last night. I let our experimenting get too rough, and you ended up dropping pretty hard,” he said, tone solemn and resigned as if *that* meant anything to him right now. “I didn’t want you up. I wanted you to sleep in.”

Everything in his life had a place. Everything stayed in its place. If it was dirty, it was cleaned right away with no exceptions. If it was broken, it was thrown out to be replaced that same day or fixed as soon as physically possible. That was how he lived.

What about him?

They had one rough night, and suddenly he’s not allowed to spend time with him? Suddenly he’s not allowed to *want* to spend time with him?

Where was his place? What was he meant to do?

If he was dirty, how could he be cleaned? If he was broken, how could he be fixed? Or… was he the kind of broken that *couldn’t* be fixed?

The spiral was sickening. It was all consuming in the worst ways, gripping at the edges of his being and pulling him apart.

“De, I-I wanted to join you. That’s not fair,” he told him, but his concern seemed to fall on deaf ears. “I was supposed to be there with you.”

“I only woke you up this early because I finished your breakfast. Eat with me,” he told him gently. “I have a duty to take care of your body, so let me give it a hot meal and some more ointment.”

Phainon’s lips pursed. He glared up at him as Mydei tried to pull his arm gently, and while it was meant to be guiding, to be *silently followed* like he always allowed it to be, he stood his

ground this time.

“You’ll take care of me by leaving me, huh?” He mouthed off, bitter that he also missed the opportunity to talk to him and sneak nibbles as he cooked. “I’m meant to do it all by myself, but you were the one who wanted me like this.”

“Phainon, my lunch is for *work*,” Mydei stressed. “These are people my father is friends with. I have to show up as both his son and his future successor.”

“You didn’t even wake me up to do *our* thing together!” He hissed at him, ripping his arm from his grasp. “I wanted to do that with you! I-I like to be close with you outside of just your bedroom, like when we work out and when you cook for me!”

That was his comfort. That was his warmth.

Phainon had found it in him to enjoy being taken care of and told what to do, but only if it meant he still had some semblance of a presence. He didn’t just want some predetermined meal handed to him, he wanted to be there watching Mydei cook it if possible. He didn’t just want to do as he was told, he wanted to be beside him so Mydei could watch him and be proud of him.

Things felt more personal that way.

But Mydei took that away from him. He took that closeness away, and the distance made it feel less like a *mutual exchange* and more like a *dictatorship*.

“You needed to rest,” Mydei protested, holding his ground in this disagreement. “I wanted you to try and sleep off your sub-drop. If that didn’t work, I planned to spend all morning trying to make you feel better.”

“You don’t get it,” he spat back. “You don’t get h-how it feels that you touched me, you *hurt* me for your own sadistic pleasure, and then you just… told me to go fuck off.”

Mydei’s jaw dropped. “I would never say that to my best friend, let alone my *submissive* during such a vulnerable state, Phainon.”

“‘*Come down by myself*’,” he reminded him, throwing his previous words from last night into his face. “You wanted to see me cry, then you wanted me to just… deal with the aftermath by myself. You left me here, went about your day without me, a-and now you tell me there’s this lunch you have to attend? So I have to be alone all by myself later, too? When I feel like *shit?*”

His chest felt tight. There was oxygen in abundance all around them, yet it didn't feel like enough as he sucked in a deep breath and expelled it just as heavily.

“I thought looking out for me was *your* job?”

“It wasn’t… I mean, I didn’t… do what I did for my own pleasure’s sake,” he tried to reassure him, but even *he* didn’t seem convinced by his own words. “Everything I did last night, I did with the knowledge you were enjoying it or curious about it. And I’m not

neglecting my responsibilities by asking if you need space—some people want space after something heavy. I was only offering it to you."

'*I didn't do what I did for my own pleasure's sake*'.

What was that supposed to mean? Did Mydei *only* put his hands on him because he admitted that he was turned on? Was it not something personal to him too?

The thought that his body meant nothing to him made his chest hurt even more, and his sickened belly shook with a cold, dry laugh.

"You didn't *want* to see me like that?" Phainon asked him incredulously, almost amused by his attempt to sound so much more composed than him. "You didn't *like* looking at me on your lap like a dog, collared and cuffed, to do as you pleased with?"

A terrible feeling clawed at his chest, one he couldn't put a name to even if he tried. It tore into his bleeding heart, too big to slip between the spaces of his ribs and free itself. So it stayed.

"Phainon, that's not—"

"You didn't *enjoy* listening to me cry '*master*' over and over again?"

One hand raised, and he smacked it over the other man's chest before scraping his nails into his shirt. The fabric bunched and folded underneath his hold, giving him enough to fist within a white knuckled grasp. With a sharp tug, Mydei was thrown downwards into his bed beside him, too stunned by his sudden display of strength to respond.

That lack of a reaction made him even more upset.

"Did you forget that *I'm* strong too? Did you forget *I'm* a man too? Did you fool yourself into thinking I'm just some subservient little *dog* that paws at your chest for treats, rewards, and attention like the others before me?" He pressed him, desperate for something as vicious as his own creeping insecurity. "It isn't easy to do, you know! But I'm learning how to open up to you, and I tried to stand up to my shame for this pleasure, but suddenly you don't like it anymore, Mydei? *Are you fucking kidding me?*"

He was quiet in response, watching his every movement as if analyzing him, and Phainon planted his opposite hand on his own chest.

It hurt. Badly.

Smacking his palm against his nipple stung so much, but he braved through it to make a point. Especially when he tightened his hold enough to make the muscle pudge between his fingers.

"Phainon, don't—!"

"Didn't you want full control over me, De?" He lowered his voice, cutting Mydei's worried gasp off. "That rule you crossed out, the one that said you wanted the freedom to touch me as

you pleased, what if I said you could enforce it?"

"Stop talking nonsense," he snapped at him sharply. "You're not thinking clearly right now. You're hurt, and you're confused, so let me—"

"What if I said you could grab me whenever you wanted while I'm here? You already control when I can cum, so just go the full nine-yards. Touch me like I'm one of your past subs, *master*," he encouraged him, squeezing himself tight enough to make the porcelain skin red. "You can grope me when my back is turned, use my body to quench your thirst for sadism, then go *fuck off* like I'm just some sex toy! It can't be too different from right now!"

Mydei grabbed his wrist tightly, ripped it from where his palm was rubbing up against his nipple, and looked up at him with a glare.

Before Phainon could even register what was happening, Mydei pulled himself out from under him and rolled over. That hold he had over his stunned figure was stolen, then thrown right back at him as his back hit the bed with a bounce.

A strong hand gripped his wrists tightly, pinning them to the pillows while his other smacked right across his mouth to silence him. It stung beneath his hefty palm, and his fingers twitched from the semi-familiar position of powerlessness.

Mydei's bare knees were spread around his hips, so he couldn't even hope to try and kick him off his body. All he could do was squirm, feet sliding to the mattress wildly.

His best friend didn't speak, but he looked angry. The expression was terrible on his usually neutral face, much like when he had first accused him of being '*abusive*' to his partners. Eyes narrowed and lips pursed, there was a heat behind his eyes that burned to look into, but there was nowhere else to go. There was nothing else to see.

After working out, he pulled his hair down from his ponytail and prepared to rinse off before truly starting his day. He did it every time. Today was no exception.

With this position, those two-toned locks were draped around him, hanging like a veil to keep his attention locked to his face. The splits within their fiery wall allowed for morning light to spill past, and it chose to highlight his tightened jaw. This time, it wasn't so easily soothed or released.

Phainon laid there, completely pinned down and silent, staring up at him as the turmoil in his chest worsened.

He wanted to kick. He wanted to fight. He wanted to yell that Mydei was a liar for never being as vulnerable as he was, and he needed to get off of him before he elbowed him right in the teeth.

But he also wanted to relax underneath his warm, comforting scent and let himself be forced to calm down. After all, he didn't *like* to be angry or anxious. He didn't like to say things that could hurt someone else or himself. He just… did. It was his bad habit. No matter how many scoldings he got or punishments were administered, he couldn't stop.

The hand on his wrist reminded him of those cuffs, and he tried to pull, but it was less forgiving than the leather and chains were. There was no give. There was no space between his skin and Mydei's fingerprints.

Upon realizing that, Phainon whimpered into his hand, pulling harder as if it'd make a difference.

"I'm not letting you go until you calm down," he stated firmly.

Tears brimmed his eyes, and he glared up at Mydei while shaking his head quickly in an attempt to push his hand off.

Why wouldn't he just yell at him? Why wouldn't he shout back and match just how upset he felt? Why did he have to try so hard to hold his composure all the time?

When it came to schedules and to-do lists, Mydei could be as articulate as ever. He could explain rules, regulations, and expectations all day long with the closest attention to every detail and potential risk. Telling him to wear a collar as long as he was in his home was *easy*. Telling him to dress a specific way when he visited simply because it pleased him was *easy*. Telling him he liked the flustered expressions on his face, or the way he looked sitting on top of his lap, was *so fucking easy* for him.

Why couldn't he just admit it to his face that he *wanted* to see him in pain last night? Why was it so difficult for him to admit that he pushed him into this aching, sore state of being because he *liked* it?

He *gave* it to him. He didn't safeword, and he didn't stop him except when he tightened those clamps too much. Why did he not want that anymore?

He let himself be vulnerable for him, giving him complete power over his tied up body and a peek into the mess hidden behind his skin. Didn't Mydei want that?

Didn't he want *him?*

Tears trickled down the corners of his eyes, and the hand on his mouth slowly lifted for him to gasp brokenly.

"You're *not* a sex toy for me, okay? I don't want that," Mydei said simply. "That rule was never meant for you."

"What if… What if we did it?" He asked him in between his shaky breaths, speaking words he never thought he'd say. "What if I said you could have sex with me? Would you change it? Would you treat me like that?"

"No. I don't want your body if it's like *that*," he repeated.

Phainon should have been relieved. He should have been so happy that his best friend would never force him into something all for the sake of exploration and experimentation. Mydei saw him as *him*, as someone he loved and cared about, not someone he could just exploit for his own pleasure.

But all he heard was *Mydei didn't want him*.

"*You* don't want that, Phainon."

His head shook. His chest trembled.

"I… I don't want that," he agreed, and Mydei's glare eased as he watched him cry. "I don't want t-to be an object to you, Mydei…"

"You're not," he promised him. "You're not anything close. I'd never treat you that way unless you asked for it—*properly*."

The grasp on his wrists loosened, and he gently trailed his fingers down either outstretched arm before cupping his cheek. It was warm and heavy, comforting in the way being touched by him always was too. His thumb brushed by the tear stains, swiping them away.

"I feel like that," Phainon sniffled, and Mydei's eyes dropped to his bitten lip. "I feel like y-you don't want me after I let you touch m-me…"

"Oh, Phainon…"

Mydei rolled over onto his back. His hand reached out for him, and as much as he wanted to keep being mad at him, Phainon followed him obediently.

He leaned into him, resting his head over his heavy arm before allowing himself to be pulled closer. The movement forced him to end up on his chest, cheek pressed to his pec so deeply that he could hear his heart beat. One leg lifted over Mydei's hip, ankle slipping between his knees. One arm curled around his waist, pulling him as close as physically possible.

Even sweaty, he buried himself into him, holding him as if he'd disappear if he let go.

"Tell me how you think I can help," Mydei said softly, holding his forearm with the hand not keeping them pressed together. "What can I do to make sure you never feel that way again? Because I'd never just walk out on you like that. You mean too much to me."

"Don't go," he mumbled. "Don't… leave me out of our things. Don't p-push me away like I'm not giving you so much of me. Don't dodge me."

"I can't miss that lunch," he sighed, making him sulk for a moment. "But until I have to get dressed, I'll spend every moment by your side. What can I do to make this pretty little prince smile again, hm? What do you want to do?"

"Nothing."

Mydei's grip tightened on his arm. A deep breath then filled his chest.

"… Nothing?"

His head shook, eyes closing to better listen to his racing heart.

“You don’t want to eat breakfast, then help me tidy the kitchen after? Or we can bake something nice for you to take home later.” He listed all the things they could do, but none struck a desire within him. “We can read. *I’ll* even read to you. I can pick out an outfit for you to wear for the day, and we can clean ourselves up for the day.”

“*Nothing*,” he repeated, and Mydei went silent.

“You have to eat. We can do nothing for another… fifteen minutes,” he caved, rubbing his arm softly.

They shifted, repositioning into something just a little more comfortable. As soon as they settled, Mydei gently stroked his arm once again.

“And… just so we’re clear, I need to punish you for what you said about yourself. You understand that, right?” He brought up carefully, and Phainon winced weakly at the mention. “Not right now though. You *will* kneel while leashed for me, just not now.”

“Yes, m-master…”

“Mm… what a good boy I have,” he said after, sliding his hand higher to gently massage his arm. “Phainon, you try so hard, accept your punishments well, and speak so freely to me. I’m so proud of you.”

His chest ached. “E-Even when I keep messing up? Even when I say things I don’t mean a-and I make you angry?”

“Mistakes are inevitable. Anger is a normal, human emotion,” he brushed off. “We’ll make each other upset, and we’ll both make mistakes. It’s what we do after that matters most, okay?”

Phanon knew that. Somewhere behind this mess inside of him, he knew Mydei was right about this.

It was silly to worry so much about being cast aside or looked down on by him. It was silly to think he would ever be anything less than supportive of him, failures included. That wasn’t *him*. That wasn’t *his Mydei*.

Yet his body still considered the possibility of him turning away, and it hurt like hell all over again to imagine it all over again.

“You should stop thinking poorly of yourself,” Mydei told him, forcing him to listen rather than disappear inside of his head. “Being a sub does not mean you’re weak in comparison to me, and it doesn’t make you any less of a man than me.”

His eyes widened, stunned by the sudden words that struck something deep inside of his chest.

“Submission isn’t something born from the absence of strength. To be a ‘*submissive*’ and to be a ‘*weak person*’ does not mean the same thing.” Mydei squeezed his arm as if trying to reassure him physically too. “I’ve never viewed you as weaker than me because you decided

to give yourself to me. I've never seen you as lesser than me because you enjoy being guided and taken care of."

Shaking fingers curled into his t-shirt again, holding the fabric tightly as he repeated those words inside of his head.

Did he make them out to be the same thing? Was that why he felt so… *shameful* all the time? So *inferior* when beside him?

"In fact, I find the idea of submission to be harder than the dominance I practice," Mydei admitted to him. "It's… infinitely easier for me to take my sub's life in my hands and mold it to what I think will benefit them best than it is for them to hand it all over. The strength to let go of your control is not something to be taken lightly. People are not objects. They hurt. They bleed. They break. And when a person breaks, it's not as easy as ordering a part to fix them or gluing the pieces back together. Yet submissives trust that their dominants will never step out of what's been discussed to hurt them. Isn't that strength, Phainon? Don't you have to be a truly strong person to be able to lay yourself down in front of someone and risk being *broken?*"

Phainon pulled on his shirt as his next breath fell in a heavy, stuttered pattern, unable to answer him.

"I know it's hard, and I know it feels a little scary, but is it at least comforting to you, Phainon?" He asked quietly. "When I cook you a meal, does it take away the stress of worrying about what and when to eat? When I dress you up, does it make your day a little bit faster to not spend an hour searching your closet? When I press you to overcome your nerves, does it help you feel more comfortable to voice the things you want or the way you feel? Do you *enjoy* your submission to me even if it's still intimidating for you?"

He hesitated before answering, not wanting to get caught up in the pieces of him that were playing tug-of-war with his conscience.

On one half, submission was scary. Being vulnerable was hard, and it made him feel so guilty to get butterflies over collars and tingles over praise of his obedience. This wasn't '*normal*'. This wasn't '*right*'. If people found out, they'd see him as a completely different person. They'd see him the way he saw Mydei that night he confronted him—afraid, just a little bit disgusted, and like he was someone else completely.

On the other half, submission felt… good. Mydei was right in all the things he said. It was safe, comforting, and swiped away some of his old stressors. Those things were taken care of for him, and all he had to do was trust they were in his best interest. On top of that, giving up his control and being praised for following an order was what gave him all the butterflies and tingles in the first place.

How could he be ashamed of something he *didn't* somewhat enjoy?

Phainon swallowed thickly, coating his dried mouth and vocal chords. "Yeah," he answered just as softly. "I-It's comforting since it's you, Mydei."

“Good,” he hummed, pleased by the answer. “I want to be someone safe, not someone who comes off as… well, the opposite.”

The word was there, the one he called him when he first pressed him about his lifestyle and choices ignorantly. It started with an ‘*A*’. It ended with an ‘E’.

‘Abusive’.

Mydei didn’t want to be seen as someone abusive. And because he admitted that he didn’t typically feel disgusted by the things he liked, that meant he had sown that seed of doubt into him by being so thoughtlessly cruel that night.

“You’re not like that,” he promised him, meeting his eyes as they glanced over to him. “You’re a good person, Mydei.”

“Yes, I try to be,” was all he said in response. With it, he pushed the ivory hair from his forehead and admired his face for a moment. “How do you feel?”

“Not… a hundred percent, but not as upset as I was. Thank you.”

“Don’t thank me for taking care of you. I was the one to push you too far,” he hushed him. “I’ll do better for you.”

“Me too,” he promised him, and Mydei nodded in agreement before pushing his head down to his chest again. “Mm…?”

“Lay down and let us hold each other a little bit longer,” he instructed him. “I believe we both need this.”

Who was Phainon to deny his dominant after such an emotional morning? Especially when he was offering him even more time to be close with him?

“Yes, master.”

Mydei sighed softly, wistful in nature. “Good boy.”

—

Even if Phainon insisted on going back home, Mydei told him that he was free to stay and wait for him to come back if he wished. His lunch wouldn’t take long, and if he didn’t have work, then he could spend the day relaxing in his spa tub or watching television in his bed. If he got hungry, he could make himself something so long as it wasn’t a bunch of junk.

Ultimately, because he still felt a little bit uneasy and craved Mydei’s presence, he decided to accept his offer to stay. Though he wasn't physically here, at least his things were around to hold on to.

After his relaxing bath, he opted not to wear a shirt because his nipples were still too sore for one. More ointment was gently rubbed over them, and as much as it helped, it didn't erase the fact they hurt to brush against.

And while in Mydei's walk-in closet to grab a pair of sweats, he discovered three things:

The first was that his best friend was even more obsessed with organizing his things than he thought, as his closet was divided not only by colors, but by the lengths of each clothing, different fabrics, and their style. Professional things came first, and his leisurely items followed after. Inside of a glass case, each watch, necklace, ring, and earring he owned was kept in its velvet box like a jewelry store. There were no fingerprints on the glass, and he was too nervous to touch and leave any.

The second thing he discovered was the case of his gaming console was tucked inside of a black storage box. He only had a few games, and the device was completely dead when he clicked the power button. But it was perfect. Finding it meant he could charge it, challenge Mydei to a duel like when they were younger, and it'd give them more things to do besides watch TV and talk in the kitchen.

The third and final thing he found was a lock bolted on the right side of a cabinet door. It looked like any other cabinet in here. Sleek, black wood matched his shelves and drawers, even the frame of his full body mirror. But this one was bolted shut. This one held something important enough to need a passcode to get into.

Documents, maybe?

No, he had an office for that. Mydei kept his things together, so important papers would be kept in a locked box inside of his office desk or cabinet.

Expensive jewelry, possibly?

That wasn't likely either, as he would have put all of his accessories inside of there. Watches and rings that looked like that weren't cheap, and Mydei didn't buy cheap things. He chose to splurge on the real deal and upkeep it for years instead of buying multiple lesser quality things that would turn his skin green, fall apart within months, and look gaudy.

Phainon held the burgundy case to his gaming console to his chest, then looked away from the cabinet as heat burned into his cheeks.

He recalled Mydei walking into his closet and coming out with handcuffs and nipple clamps, and that meant this locked cabinet was probably home to his own collection of sex toys. Two were familiar enough after last night, but whatever else he kept was a mystery.

What would a dominant man into *BDSM* hold on to?

Ropes, for sure, as he mentioned them before. A leash was tucked away in there too, as his collar had come with one but he has yet to see it.

Gags, right? Like the red ones he saw in those videos? Someone like him would probably keep one or two around. Were there different kinds? Different sizes?

Did Mydei like to gag his partners so they didn't get a chance to talk back to him? He said he liked bondage when they discussed their rules, but were gags a part of that?

Upon that thought, he shook his head and turned away from the closed cabinet.

That wasn't fair, was it? To snoop around and imagine what it was he was hiding away in *his own* place was so incredibly disrespectful of him. Especially after his best friend had spent a good chunk of his morning trying so hard to make sure he felt okay before taking off.

Mydei deserved his privacy. He deserved to have his secrets.

But… if he was his submissive, then he kind of… *possibly*… deserved to know, right? Since they were slowly incorporating more sexual things into their dynamic, shouldn't he know what could potentially be in store for him? It'd be unfair if he came out with some kind of fist-sized gag to shove in his mouth, wouldn't it?

No.

No, he *wouldn't* do that. Mydei *wasn't* like that.

He was doing it again, wasn't he? He was making assumptions of him based on his own feelings and running with the idea like it was true.

Mydei always told him to stop, to not say or think things he never mentioned wanting. It was his bad habit, and he needed to curb that. Not because it made him look bad, but because it made Mydei out to be someone he wasn't. That wasn't fair to him.

Phainon shut the light off and pulled the door closed, hoping to forget about the cabinet and its contents completely. He plugged the console in by the living room couch, letting it rest on the arm before taking a deep breath.

Well, he had to wait now. What was he meant to do on his own?

Phone in hand, he checked the time real quick, staring at the digits before looking around. Mydei wouldn't be home for another hour or two. What would he want to do if he were home instead of out with his father?

Laundry, maybe.

There was a full basket in the bathroom from last night. His work out clothes, towels from both of them bathing, his own outfit from when he came over, then whatever they wore last night, all of them needed to be washed. Mydei hated messes, and it would make him happy to see an empty hamper.

He smiled to himself.

Maybe he should also fix his bed too. It was still in disarray from him being in it all morning, and coming home to a clean room would make him happy too.

On that note, could he put his collar on himself? Was he allowed to do that, or was that Mydei's job only?

Wouldn't Mydei like to come back to that?

His eyes darted to the phone still in his hand, and he opened their messages. Before he could talk himself out of the idea or come to his senses, he began typing out a text.

> [Phainon: Do you think it'd be okay if I put my collar on myself, De? Feels weird not wearing it while I'm here…]

It wasn't read right away, but he kept his phone in his back pocket while he got started on making the bed. Soft hums filled the bedroom to the tune of a pop song stuck in his head as shoved the curtains open. With the added light, he smiled, warmed by its rays.

That was when he began picking up the scattered pillows and blankets. Whatever belonged to the guest bedroom, he walked back over to place them down neatly. The ones meant to stay were set on the bench at the foot of his bed to be fluffed and arranged later.

While straightening out the rust-colored sheets, his phone buzzed.

At the same moment he looked down to his notifications, Phainon chuckled to himself. What was that thing Mydei told him before?

Something… Something… '*Don't forget to text me back*', right?

> [Mydei: Do you want to wear it?]

It was surprising to him too, but he craved the leather like it'd somehow give him the strength to do more. Like it held all the answers of what to do while waiting for him.

> [Phainon: Yeah… Is that bad?]

Was that embarrassing to admit to him? Was that something he should want without Mydei prompting it?

> [Mydei: No. You should never be ashamed of your submission. But I want you to show me. Right now.]

Phainon made his way to the dresser, and he pulled open the top drawer slowly. Leather brushed his fingertips when he reached for it. Metal chilled his touch when he grabbed it.

The buckle was worked open, and a shaky breath fell from his lips as he fit the collar around his neck. Its ring softly clicked as he jostled it, and he might have closed it one hole tighter than Mydei did, but the weight felt good. The tightness felt good. Just having it on and feeling it hug his throat made his stomach tingle and palms sweat.

Forget using *cakes* to Pavlov him into obedience. Did Mydei train him to get excited when he put a *collar* on?

His hand shook just a little while holding his camera up, and he held down the button on it before showing him his handiwork. One finger pulled on the ring, letting him see how tight and secure it was, then dropped it so he could see his bare collarbones and collared neck.

When the video was sent, it was read immediately. Clearly, Mydei was waiting for it.

> *[Mydei: That's my good boy. Is your chest okay? I can see you're not wearing a shirt.]*

A smile tugged on his lips as he read the text over again, warm from his concern over his health. Even when faced with a video like that, he was still worried about his body.

> *[Phainon: It's sore, but I'll be okay.]*

> *[Mydei: I can't hide out in the bathroom forever, so I'll see you soon. Don't take your collar off, understand? I want to come home to my handsome, collared prince.]*

Phainon dropped his phone onto the bed, and he covered his mouth with one hand while staring down at the message. His breaths were slightly labored. Warmth burned inside of his cheeks over being told Mydei wanted to '*come home*' to him.

Did he even realize what that sounded like or what that implied? How common was it for him to tell his submissives that?

Another buzz vibrated through the room, and he noticed another text pop up.

> *[Mydei: Re-apply the balm for me while you're up. Take care of yourself until I can.]*

He picked his phone up, mumbling softly to himself as he swiped out the only response he could think of.

> *[Phainon: Yes, master.]*

It was read upon delivery, but without a response, he assumed Mydei had gone back to his table to talk about whatever business his father needed him so desperately for. Which was fine. He didn't want to keep him away from his job.

A deep breath followed as he fell back onto the bed beside him. Butterflies filled his stomach and chest, taking up the space in his lungs.

"Stupid Mydei," he muttered to himself, eyes glued to the ceiling. "Why does he have to say such weird things so casually?"

And why did he *like* the idea of playing house much?

—

When Mydei came back, Phainon had just finished sorting the clothes into piles on his bed. His body was sprawled out on the couch as the front door opened, back flat to the cushions of his couch and arms raised overhead. One leg was bent at the knee, foot pressed to the edge of the cushion while his opposite leg bent off of the end. The epitome of comfort. The embodiment of relaxation.

He was practicing his character combos for when he asked to duel Mydei, eyes zeroed in on the screen and fingers smashing the buttons. They clicked loudly, overtaking the lowered volume of the game itself.

Crinkled bags and the heat of a watchful gaze made him shift, his attention stolen by the man with a couple shopping bags in his hand. His shoes were off, not wanting to track dirt throughout his clean home. His sunglasses sat where his bangs separated from the rest of his hair, unneeded now that he was indoors.

They looked at each other in silence for another moment, and as interested as he had been in his video game, Phainon shut the device off and sat up. His collar clinked as the ring moved, and he shifted to accommodate its stiff length.

“Hey. Welcome back,” he greeted him kindly, sitting up but not quite moving from his spot on the couch. “What’s all that?”

“H-Hey,” Mydei stammered out, still staring at him. He then glanced away from him briefly, fist to his mouth while clearing his throat. “Hey. I stopped by some of the shops near the restaurant we went to, so… Come here and look.”

His snowy eyebrow lifted, but he picked himself up as he was told to. Quiet but swift steps carried him over, arms tucked behind his back so they didn’t sway by his sides.

Amber eyes dropped from his face to the bare skin of his upper body. They moved much more blatantly than he probably meant them to be, dragging left to right over his chest and shoulders before travelling back up the column of his throat. His Adam’s apple bobbed, an audible swallow filling between them.

“De, you’re shameless,” he teased him, hot under his skin from being checked out. “I’m not shirtless just because I felt like it, you know.”

“Thinking about this wasn’t the same as seeing it with my own eyes,” Mydei defended himself, and Phainon’s cocky grin twitched downwards.

There he went again saying and implying things that he wasn’t used to hearing…

“You… uh… were thinking about it?” He asked, not feeling as confident as he had been in the face of his confession. “You were thinking of me being here, half naked and collared, as I waited for you?”

“I promised not to lie.”

That was true. They promised to be honest with one another, to be open with their thoughts and feelings, even if it was difficult or something slightly humiliating. It would keep them safe. It would keep their arrangement from twisting into something that could be non-consensual.

They were meant to practice honesty. He was meant to find comfort within his vulnerability, and Mydei was meant to be the security that kept it going.

“On that note, I guess I… was also thinking about you coming back to me like this…” Phainon confessed as well, awkwardness swimming through his words.

They looked at each other, and as he laughed nervously, Mydei’s lips curled into a kind smile. Soft chuckles slowly shook his chest, joining him in his attempt to dispel the weight of their confessions.

“What did you do while I was gone?” He asked him, keeping his eyes above his neck now that he got it out of his system. “Have you been playing games this whole time?”

“Actually, I cleaned up,” he corrected him. “I made the bed, and I washed our clothes inside the hamper. They’re folded in your room right now, so will you show me how to put them away? I didn’t wanna mess up the whole… *thing* you have going on in there. It looks a little too complicated.”

Mydei cocked his head to the side slightly, and he silently made his way to his bedroom as if he wanted to see the work for himself. As if he didn’t believe what he was hearing.

Nerves and fear bubbled within Phainon’s stomach at the thought of being scolded for possibly overstepping a boundary. His fingers twiddled themselves, tapping nail to nail before spinning around one another aimlessly. With his gaze pointed towards them, he tried to save himself from humiliation if Mydei were to be upset at him.

A soft grunt left his lips when he bumped into him, having followed without being told to. He didn’t notice the stillness of the other man until after they collided weakly.

“You… *wanted* to do that?” Mydei confirmed.

He shrugged. “I mean… you let me stay here while you were gone, and I can’t just run your bills up for free. I ate your food and took a pretty long bath, so I cleaned up a little bit.”

“You don’t have to worry about my bills,” Mydei mused, turning to face him. “You don’t have to worry about keeping yourself busy with me. I keep myself busy so you can relax comfortably. All I ask is that you look after yourself when I cannot.”

Warmth soon engulfed his cheeks, forcing him to look up as two hands lifted his attention higher. His mouth was slightly squished from their firm press.

“Thank you, Phainon.”

Immediately, he grinned, then shrugged to brush off the spark of pride inside of him. “It’s no big deal. I mean, I had the time…”

Appreciation for his efforts felt good. It felt so good that he wanted to do it all over again just to see that look on his face again.

“You really are such a sweet boy for me,” he praised him, and Phainon bit down on his tongue to keep from making any kind of embarrassing noise. “Thank you for waiting for me to put them away too. That’s much more helpful than forcing things into a spot they don’t belong in.”

“Everything has a place, and everything should be in its place,” he recited, earning a raised eyebrow in return. “I… know you. I know what you’re like, and as nice as doing laundry is, I know it would have stressed you out to see your things not organized to your liking. Plus… we could do it together, and you could then show me for the future. Win-win, right?"

Mydei’s eyes widened slightly. Rose tinted his cheeks the same color of his hair.

“You’re the first person to think like that,” he admitted quietly. “Usually people just put things wherever and pray it works out. The gesture is there, but it ends up just being more work on me.”

“Well, I’ve only known you all our lives…”

He let go of him, then looked down to the bags still hanging on his wrists.

“Before we put them away, I want you to open this,” he told him. “I got a few things for you.”

Guilt pooled within his stomach at the thought of him spending money on stuff he didn’t need, but he reached his hands out anyway to take the bag offered. It was rude to refuse gifts, so now that it was bought, it would be disrespectful to turn it down.

He really knew how to get around that, didn’t he?

“I know I said you needed to be punished, and that will come. I haven’t forgotten,” he started his explanation off. “But, I believe you deserve a… reward. A confirmation that I see your effort. Though you struggle with holding your tongue and depreciating yourself, I can’t help but want to reward your ability to be *completely* honest with me. Negative or not, honesty is honesty, and it helps me understand you better.”

“Mydei, you didn’t… This is my part to play, isn’t it?” He reasoned. “You shouldn’t reward me for doing as I promised. This is my half of our arrangement, so… I don’t deserve this.”

“You deserve to have your efforts acknowledged. Verbally is fine, but physical proof is always nice,” he insisted softly.

Phainon took the bag being offered to him, then reached inside to pull out a few pairs of jeans. The top one was dyed a deep black, much like the ones Mydei liked. Beneath was a blue color much more reminiscent of his own closet, proving he didn’t just grab things. He thought of him and what he liked to wear, not just what he wore for him.

One pair for Mydei to further submit himself to him, and another pair for him to enjoy himself and his own fashion sense.

“Are you calling my fashion taste bad with this?” He joked, earning a roll of the eyes.

“I’m saying you look good in black,” he corrected him. “Wear it more often for me, so even when you’re turning heads, you’re submitting to me.”

“Is that an order from my master, or a request from my oh-so fashionable best friend?” He asked, taking in his button-down, tie, and dark gray trousers.

Mydei’s lip curled, and his tongue traced over his top teeth slowly. “That’s an order from your *master*, pretty boy.”

Phainon’s breaths hitched over the name, and he gripped the clothes tighter while his best friend took a step closer into his personal space.

“You should always want to dress for my interest,” he chided, lifting the black pair up to his chest carefully. “Your own closet is charming, but I like you dressed in black and blushing down your chest.”

“I… I um…” He stammered, then looked away as his finger slowly dragged along the crisp denim to keep from touching his skin. “M-Mydei, what are you…?”

He couldn’t feel it completely, but the phantom drag of his soft fingertips gripping and groping his body made his heartbeat pick up even more. It was as if he could make out the divots of his fingerprints or the scratch of his trimmed nails through such thick clothes.

The closer his finger got to the top of the jeans, the more his chin lifted, anticipating him to then touch his neck like he usually enjoyed doing.

“Mm… I’m sorry. I was just reminded of last night and how handsome you looked,” he apologized. When he pulled his hand back, he watched as his lack of presence caused the pants to fall back into his arms. “Let's put these clothes away. I want to hear about your day.”

Exhaling, Phainon watched as his eyes glinted with something both playful and dark.

“I won’t touch you anymore today,” he promised him. “You are *not* an object, and I’m *not* trying to push you anymore than I did.”

Was *that* what people meant when calling someone a tease?

“Master…”

“Awh,” he mused. “Don’t look at me with such a needy look in your eyes, or I’ll get the wrong idea. You look good begging.”

Phainon shook his head to wipe every thought clean, and Mydei picked the discarded bag up before walking towards his bed.

“You can take your clothes back in this bag,” he allowed, setting them neatly inside. “I will give you a t-shirt to go home in, one loose enough to not agitate your chest.”

Beside them, he placed the newest addition to his closet down and then looked over to Mydei.

“Can I… ask you something?” He asked nervously, picking up his cleaned gym clothes. “There’s a cabinet in your closet… What’s the lock for?”

“Did this naughty boy go snooping through his master’s things?” He huffed. “You sure do have a way of burying yourself into my business, don’t you?”

“Well…—”

“I keep my gear in there.” Phainon guessed as much. “Do you want to see my collection? You have a look that says you’re dying to know what’s in it.”

“I don’t want to do anything sexual,” he admitted to him. Despite craving his touch just moments ago, he wasn’t sure if he had it in him to be touched all over again like last night. “My chest still hurts, a-and I still don’t feel the best *inside*, you know?”

He followed Mydei to his closet silently, then watched as he pulled open a drawer full of other sweatpants and lounging shirts.

“I didn’t ask if you wanted to *play*, I asked if you wanted to *see* them,” he repeated himself. “Behind. Dark clothes go in front of the brighter ones, because things in the front are easier to see.”

Phainon nodded, squatting down to tuck the black top with the rest of them neatly.

“Those sweats have a cuff at the bottom. They cannot go with the ones that don’t. They’re different kinds of pants. But they’re gray, so they go in front of white but behind black.”

They were placed with the others when pointed out, and he looked up at him for guidance once he finished.

“It’s a complicated system. This is why you don’t need to worry about it,” Mydei told him. “I appreciate it though.”

“I’ll learn,” he reassured him, not thinking much of it. “I’ll learn how you do things, De. You can have all the responsibility you want, but it’s nice to have a little bit of help, right? Come on. I can put clothes away.”

His expression and tone didn’t change. “It’s a lot to ask of you.”

“It can’t be more difficult than anything else you’re asking of me,” he mused, standing upright to take the clothes in his hands. “I mean, you said no one’s done this. Do you not bother with teaching them this part, or do they just not ask to learn?”

“Hm…”

The answer was silent, and Phainon nodded, accepting the answer as is.

“If I call you ‘*master*’ again, will you show me how you organize your work pants?” He asked him hopefully.

“Alright. Listen and listen well,” Mydei caved, pointing to a segment of his closet full of hung up pants. “It makes me upset if things aren’t kept where I need them to be, and I don’t like looking for them. It’s all a waste of time.”

He knew that, and he made sure to pay close attention to how he liked to separate them. Same with his shirts.

Truthfully, it was a lot. Mydei wasn't lying.

To *him*, a shirt was a shirt and pants were pants. Unless they had special instructions for care, or very clearly didn’t belong in the same drawer, they all ended up in the same place. Jeans were stacked on sweats. His undershirts were next to his going out shirts. It didn’t matter.

But *Mydei* cared. He cared a lot, so he wanted to at least try to understand his particular taste before agreeing whether or not it was too much to take. And even if it did prove to be too much, he just needed time to learn how to get it right.

“If I mess this up, will my master punish me?” He wondered casually, and Mydei took a deep breath.

“Do you want me to? We agreed to experiment, not… *this*.”

What was ‘*this*’? Was it not just a submissive helping his dominant? A friend helping his friend?

“Well, you have so many office supplies and copies of your rules. Put a sticky note on it or write it on a spare copy,” he told him simply. “Write, ‘*Phainon will learn how to be a better sub for his master*’, or something. That’s what this is, isn't it? Serving you?”

“Technically, it is…” He agreed, sounding deep in thought. “Do you really want to do this kind of thing with me too? This… *domestic* service?”

Phainon looked over to him, and Mydei looked back with an expression he didn’t quite recognize.

“I mean… it’s part of your whole gig, right?” He asked. “Even if it’s not, as your friend who’s staying over a lot more, isn’t it good for me to know?”

It didn’t seem like he needed much convincing past that.

“Okay. We can add it in.”

A tingle tickled through his body, inching from the depths of his stomach and towards his fingers, toes, and chest. It was warm, slightly sinking as if he signed even more of his

freedom away, but also a little bit thrilling. Like a rollercoaster ride that made him want to throw up but laugh in joy.

“Do you still want to look at my gear?” Mydei took a step closer to the keypad. “I can’t promise you’ll like what you see, but I’ll explain it all for you.”

He wanted to.

All of him wanted to quell that curiosity inside of him, the one that wondered what Mydei was like when he wasn’t coddling his sensitive feelings.

He liked boys who cried. He liked watching them get flustered, squirm, and crack underneath the pleasure and pain. As kind as he was outside of bed, it seemed he liked things just a little rougher than he let on.

What *exactly* did he hide in there?

But his stomach churned slightly when he was reminded of that terrible feeling of inadequacy and anxiety after. It made him feel as if he was being pulled apart from the inside, and it caused him to lash out.

Maybe he wasn’t ready to look at that yet. Maybe he needed a little bit longer to gather his feelings and keep ‘*coming down*’ from his ‘*sub-drop*’, as his best friend called it.

“Can we play video games?” He asked instead, and Mydei eased his hand away from the keypad. “I’ve been practicing, and I want to see who’s better.”

His best friend nodded, turning away from his trove of *BDSM* equipment to instead guide him towards the door. Not that he needed to when he was already walking out.

“I haven't played in awhile, so let me practice a little bit before we do,” Mydei agreed, following him out as he rushed to the living room. “Slow down! The console won’t run away from you, Phainon!”

“Awh, but master, I can’t wait to finally be the one to teach you something,” he taunted him.

He turned around to face him as he walked slowly from his bedroom and through the hallway towards him, grinning widely.

“So slow!”

“You shouldn’t run in other people’s homes. Were you raised in a barn?”

“A farm,” he answered casually as he stood still. “Mom grew vegetables, and dad was a fisherman. No barns in sight.”

“Close enough,” Mydei mused, ignoring the gaming device on his couch to keep walking towards him. “Let me see what you’ve got first, Phainon. The winner gets to pick dinner.”

His heart skipped, and he nodded quickly as he took a step backwards. “I want fish,” he decided.

“I want lamb.” His best friend shrugged. “If you win, *we* will cook fish. If I win, *I* will cook lamb chops.”

“*Deal*.”

Phainon was not going to lose this time, not when cooking beside him was on the table as a reward.

Chapter End Notes

mydeis bdsm cabinet of wonders. i wonder whats in there…

Chapter 7: Chapter Seven

Chapter Notes

> writing this made me so incredibly soft. i wanna write more of mydeis admiration and fixation for bdsm and phainons need to feel close and connected to him more than just verbally.
>
> when will mydei kiss phai?? he needs it so badly

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon had a lot to think about the next few days.

Between focusing on work, his roommate coming back from her trip, and the new things he was experiencing in secret at Mydei's home, there was almost *too much* on his mind.

Sometimes he stayed the night when he shouldn't just so they could work out in the morning and fall asleep together at night. They didn't even watch movies sometimes, just slipped right into the mattress once the clock struck bedtime. Both he *and* Mydei shared one now, and there was no more staying up watching funny online videos until the early A.M hours. That wasn't a sustainable habit when he was up at sunrise every morning.

It could be exhausting, and today was exhausting.

He had been talked down to by customers for things he wasn't even at fault for—like prices on the menu and the chefs mistaking an order he wrote down clearly. A man whistled at him like a dog to get his attention when he was busy with another table. An older woman kept calling him '*pretty boy*' and talking about how he was practically born for customer service with a face like his. All of it made him sick.

His muscles were sore from pushing himself a little too hard when working out, and his feet ached from being on them all day.

But he went to Mydei anyway.

Phainon took the parking spot he always did, and he walked the path he did every evening. The receptionist knew him by now, smiling as he walked by and waving flirtatiously when he smiled back.

It felt like a lot of people were suddenly looking at him, but he wasn't as interested in dating as he used to be. Not when his days and nights were already so full of other things.

How was he meant to have a relationship when he was knee deep in this mutual arrangement with Mydei? There was still so much he didn't know and wanted to try, and there was no

point if it wasn't him.

As he knocked on his door, body leaned to the doorframe for support, he listened intently for the twisting lock. He watched his best friend look at him soon enough, a glass of liquor in hand and his work clothes undone. Even his usual braid had been unraveled, leaving behind only the lightly patterned locks.

"Mm… Would my sweet boy like a drink?"

"I'd like the entire bottle please, master," he joked, walking to the foyer and allowing him to shut the door behind him. "I could use the de-stressing."

Phainon bent over, unlaced his shoes routinely, and then slipped them onto a rack carefully. Afterwards, he followed behind his best friend.

"Cyrene comes home tomorrow," he brought up casually. "She blew my phone up to remind me to kick my girlfriends out."

"Tell her to text when she leaves and gets here, then that you don't have a girlfriend," he said back as they made their way to his bedroom. "Will she be arriving in the morning or evening?"

"Evening, so I won't be able to come over. Maybe you can drop by our place?" He suggested hopefully. "She won't mind seeing you. To be honest, I bet she's going to come back and demand we throw this 'welcome home' thing for her. That girl loves a big social gathering, especially if all of our friends show up."

"Sounds like someone I know."

"Ha. Ha. She's definitely more sociable than me."

Mydei leaned against the door of his bathroom while looking at him, glass raised to his lips but not yet tilted back for a drink. Those rich, golden eyes looked him down like they always did, taking in the sight of his less-than-impressive uniform before lifting to his face. He studied him for a moment, searching his eyes for something.

"How do you feel?" He asked suddenly, then took a slight sip of the caramel-colored drink in his hand.

Phainon walked up to him, and he gently cupped the hand stretched around his glass.

"Can I please have a drink of yours, master?" He whispered, holding his eye contact. "I had a long day, but it'll get better with you here."

"Open."

His lips parted, and he felt his best friend bring his glass closer until the opposite edge of the rim touched his lip. Ice made it cool, but the smooth whiskey sliding down his tongue and throat burned. Nose scrunched and eyebrows furrowed, he felt his entire body warm soon after, as if Mydei were trying to relax him from the inside out.

“Good boy,” he purred, voice low and silky while watching. “Finish it. Come on…”

A ball of ice soon touched the tip of his nose, causing him to pull back and Mydei to chuckle over the reaction.

“Bring me your collar,” he told him, taking his glass back. “Take off your shirt.”

Phainon shivered, and he worked the buttons of his uniform down while walking to pull a drawer open. One hand picked the leather accessory up, fingers curling with ease and familiarity. His opposite continued with his top, revealing the tight, white t-shirt he wore beneath.

Mydei traded him. In exchange for taking his collar and button-down, he handed off his empty glass.

Standing straight with his shoulders lowered, he watched as his best friend buckled the leather piece around his neck. It hugged his skin firmly, tighter now than it ever used to be, forcing him to feel every swallow and nudge of his Adam’s apple.

A soft gasp left his lips. He stumbled when pulled closer, head ducked to Mydei’s mouth.

“You’re going to be a good boy for me. I don’t want to hear any complaints or back talk.”

“Yes, master.”

His belly tingled from the strict command. Tendrils of excitement inched inside of him, lighting his body up in a way that combated the creeping exhaustion from work and overthinking. Warmth pooled, making the room hotter than it was when he walked in.

“Dinner is in the oven. I was reading my emails when you came, so you can join me. I know that’s what you want,” he decided. “Come.”

He followed silently, obediently.

Mydei guided him to his office, where a blanket was already folded up into a small square by his desk chair.

“Kneel.”

His eyes widened, and as his best friend took a seat on his chair, he took a step closer.

“I haven’t forgotten your attitude or your foul mouth. I’m going to finish my work, and you will kneel while leashed to my chair,” he explained to him. “*Now*.”

Phainon knew it was coming. Mydei had been waiting for him to feel better, to be able to handle the humiliation and shame from a punishment, and it seemed tonight was that night. Being tired didn’t equate to not being ready.

He was pouring himself another glass from the small liquor cart next to him, cautious of placing his drink anywhere near his actual computer. On that same cart was a gold colored

chain curled neatly into a ring. Its leather handle sat in the middle, colored rust-red to match his collar.

Slowly, one knee folded lower, and Mydei watched as his body carefully settled on top of his plush blanket. The hardwood beneath was still prominent and uncomfortable on his knees, but he assumed that was the point. This wasn't meant to be comfortable or fun—it was *punishment*.

"Consider the fact you are here with me and not alone during this exercise," he brought up casually, and Phainon felt his chest throb at the thought of kneeling like this without his presence. "I could have left you in the room in front of my mirror to look at only yourself."

He cringed. "Thank you for not doing that, master."

Metal against metal followed. Chain links slid slowly but steadily off of the tray on the cart, and his eyes followed as they were taken into his best friend's hands. Steel caught the light, shining bright and reflectively underneath the computer screen and lamplight.

"Poise yourself," Mydei told him. "If I ever ask you to kneel, I want your back straight, eyes on me, and hands on your thighs."

Phainon picked himself up from his slightly slumped position, heat burning in his cheeks as he moved. Shoulders back and chin lifted, he watched closely and attentively as Mydei tied one end of the leash to his desk chair's arm. The motion ate most of its length, leaving behind just another couple of feet to clip into his collar.

"Good boy," he praised him, raising the clawed end towards the ring hanging neatly off his skin. "Do you understand why I'm doing this?"

His fingers curled into his work pants, and he glanced at the leash in front of him briefly before looking back at Mydei. As their eyes met, he nodded.

"I keep… calling myself a dog when I'm not," he answered shakily, wincing slightly when the metal clicked against his collar. "I talk badly about myself a lot…"

"Yes, you do. Do you want to know what you say?" He asked him while forward. "You degrade yourself with hurtful names that trigger your insecurities. '*Dog*'. '*Sex toy*'. '*Pet*'."

Click.

"You lash out on me constantly by ignoring the man I am for a stranger you've conjured up to fit this twisted idea of *BDSM*."

Click.

"This isn't the first time you've done either, and it violates my rule to lead a healthy life. A healthy life is more than diets, working out, and sleeping early. It's keeping a positive mindset too."

Click.

Each tap made him reel himself back bit by bit, and Mydei leaned even further forward in his chair. Legs spread wide like they usually were when he was sitting, his elbows reached to rest on top of his knees. One hand rested between, hanging off into the empty space, but his other one tapped the leash to his collar once final time. There, he held it.

His voice lowered as he stared into his eyes. “If you want to be treated as a lesser human, allow me to show you what that’s like. Maybe then you’ll realize that I don’t see you this way, and you aren’t this kind of person,” he offered him.

The leash connected, and he pulled him forward.

“Sit like a dog by my side and speak only when spoken to. Pretty *doggy* toys are to be seen but never heard,” he instructed him coldly.

His gut twisted over the cruel words. A shiver trickled down his spine, icing over his once heated veins.

“I should have stripped you down and allowed you to take your punishment naked like a real animal,” he whispered, eyes dropping down to his clothed body. “Would you like that, Phainon?”

“N-No, master,” he answered. “I would hate that. I would really, really hate that.”

“But you’re a pet, aren’t you?” He asked him, then jiggled the leash to hear the metal collide. “*Pets* don’t get to tell their owners to let them wear clothes, and they don’t get a say in how they’re punished.”

Phainon shifted, uneasy underneath the heat of his mockery.

“Sex toys don’t get a choice in how they’re used either. They’re there for pleasure, and what if seeing your naked body gave me pleasure, hm?”

“M-Master,—”

“Time to be quiet,” he decided, leaning back in his chair and looking down at him. “Reflect on what’s different between this treatment and the one I give you.”

And just like that, Mydei turned away from him. He focused his eyes on his computer, rolled his chair into his desk, and took a drink of his whiskey before clicking an unopened email. All of the attention he had given him was gone, almost like it was never there in the first place.

The room was deathly quiet, save for the occasional clicks of his mouse and the clacks of his keyboard. Occasionally, the thump of his glass to the cart followed, or the glug of his bottle as another glass was poured.

Knots tied inside of his stomach, and he looked down at the mess of chain links around his chair. Staring reminded him of his parent’s home, of tying his old pets to trees and poles when they didn’t want them running off. Those two loved adventure and trouble, and his parents weren’t as energetic or as fast as he was. It was always his job until he left.

Phainon pulled lightly by leaning back on his legs, but there wasn't much space to steal.

"Sit straight."

He froze, then looked back at Mydei, whose eyes were still on his computer screen.

"Ma—"

"Don't speak unless spoken to."

His lips sealed. The words on his tongue died out, and he swallowed them down while continuing to look at him.

Somehow, being ignored by him felt almost as bad as being alone. Though he spoke to him, probably seeing him in his peripheral vision, he didn't look at him or touch him. It was like he wasn't even there, just serving the same purpose like the paperweights on his desk—to look aesthetically pleasing.

Phainon was reminded of that woman from work. She looked at him like meat ready to be carved into. She spoke to him like he didn't have feelings or boundaries. Flirting so shamelessly with him and taking his polite responses as approval to continue, she had single handedly made him feel like nothing but a sexual object.

Then, he thought about Mydei. He remembered the way his hands touched his body the first time they ever got to—slowly, carefully, as if he were a new toy to him. The second time was rougher, greedier, and it left him feeling like that was all he was curious about. His tears, his pain, his pleasure, all of it were ripped from his body like it wasn't his to keep.

Ah… but it felt good.

Being touched by him was nerve-wracking. It was like all of his reason and sense slipped away when things became more heated between them. He could be twisting and churning inside, but the moment Mydei touched him, he soothed him just enough to let the pleasure in.

Sitting here, untouched and unacknowledged except for his mistakes, made him shift knee to knee. It was uncomfortable mentally, emotionally, and physically. Being invisible felt terrible, feeling like only his wrongdoings were worth a response felt like a punch to the chest, and his legs were tired from being on them.

Phainon whimpered quietly, the sound involuntary as he pulled back on his leash again. Same as before, there was no give in length or space.

"Master, I-I'm sorry," he apologized, but that didn't even earn him a glance. "I didn't mean to say it. I promise I won't do it again."

"One more time—do not speak unless spoken to."

His lips wobbled, and he looked down to the leash while nodding solemnly.

This was, by far, the most embarrassing thing he has been through. Nothing else came close.

Maybe it was because he saw it as something that made him less of a man, a thought that had plagued him since he heard it. Maybe it was because this felt like something that made him appear weak in comparison to someone else.

Or maybe it was because, despite all that they've done and all that he learned so far, it still didn't feel like he knew enough about BDSM and all it encompassed.

Phainon didn't know. He wasn't a psychologist, and he didn't know much about why people felt the way did—he just felt the way that he did. That was it.

He felt humiliated and stripped apart, and he hated this black hole of a void that was sucking him into himself.

He didn't want to be '*bad*'. He wanted to be '*good*'.

Phainon was his good boy. Maybe he made mistakes, but he wasn't '*bad*'. Nothing he ever said or did was meant to be '*bad*'.

More time passed. More buttons were clicked, glasses were set down, and tired sighs filled the room. It couldn't have been any more than twenty minutes altogether, but each one felt like it stretched on for hours.

Regret and shame hung heavy in his heart and his head, both weighed him down like twin anchors in this uneasy sea of punishment.

The last one he faced was mostly verbal, made to help him call Mydei 'master' easier and accept his submissive role better. Allowing Mydei to simply take care of him was simple. He did that when he came over anyways, as this was his home therefore his rules.

But this was… different. This burned like coals in his belly, and the fumes were choking.

After Mydei released another quiet sigh, Phainon's head bowed slightly from its uplifted state. Both shoulders curled inwards. His fingernails scratched into the fabric of his work pants.

"Hm?"

Slowly, Phainon leaned forward, tucking his temple to Mydei's knee carefully. It was an awkward angle to squeeze into, having to lean past the heavy arm rest and fight his leash's short chain, but he needed it. He needed the touch, the attention, the grounding of remembering he was right there. Being unable to speak, this was as much as he could do without getting reprimanded… hopefully.

The chair rolled back as if instinctively, tugging his leash and collar with it, and he winced before forcing his head higher up.

Fingers threaded through his hair slowly, starting at his hairline beside his temple before tucking the ivory strands away from his face. They dragged gently, stopping to rub light circles over his scalp when he ventured deep enough. Sometimes he gently swiped the hair on top of his ear behind, brushing over the shell and following its curve before going back.

Mydei didn't speak. He didn't acknowledge that his back was slouched or his head wasn't held high or forward. All he did was gently touch him, holding still as possible for him while still clicking with his mouse.

Phainon's eyes shut, and his heavy breaths filled into the silence. He let himself relax into him, into his soft movements and the feeling of his slacks against his cheek.

Even underneath his touch, this feeling didn't go completely away. It lingered heavily, lodged where the sparks of praise usually popped like fireworks.

As he sniffled, Mydei paused again.

This time, those same fingers trailed down his ear and along his earlobe. They rubbed lightly, pinching and swiping in a back and forth motion where they connected to his jaw. The gesture made his shoulder twitch, but quiet shush'ing allowed him to ease it down from its tensed state.

"You're okay," Mydei told him, and he pressed closer into his knee.

His wandering fingers lowered, tracing along the point of his jaw and the bone connecting it to his chin. Up and down. Up and down. The feather light touch was comforting, and the slowness of its movement was a nice pace to take his deep breath and then release it.

Phainon's eyebrows pinched when his fingers cupped beneath his chin, tilting him back and lifting him upwards. His thumb pressed in the space between his bottom lip, following its plump jut and gentle curve.

A soft and whiny hum vibrated up his vocal chords involuntarily, causing it to stop and lift higher. Rather than touching beneath his bottom lip, Mydei's thumb touched it straight on, planting itself across his mouth where his cupid's bow dipped. There was no push. He didn't trace either. It was left there for him to feel the heat and weight.

With a haze over his head and warmth slowly burning through the darkened pit in his belly, Phainon rubbed against his thumb. His lips pressed forward, and his head inched slightly to move it across his mouth.

Above him, a low and slightly amused chuckle permeated the air, and his lips parted for a shaky breath.

"I have you," Mydei promised, lowering his thumb and letting it catch on his bottom lip. "Take what it is you want."

Slowly, ever so slowly and shyly, his tongue peeked from inside of his mouth, lightly meeting his touch but finding only the flavor of his skin. There was no taste on his thumb, not even salt from sweat. Just skin and the texture of his fingerprint as he explored the pad.

But… it was *Mydei's* skin. It was *his* thumb easing into his mouth for him to better feel, and that made his stomach flutter.

Phainon's haze didn't feel like it was going away anytime soon, and his skin was beginning to feel unreal from the tingles inching underneath it. There was no voice in his head telling him '*no*'. There was no knee-jerk reaction to recoil away and wonder what he was doing.

There was only submission. All he knew was that Mydei was safe, he was here, and he wanted him to be good.

And Phainon was good. He *wanted* to be good.

Mydei's thumb didn't move. It was left inside of his mouth to fill it, to give his tongue something to swirl around and flick against. His fingers stayed curled beneath his chin, holding him gently.

"Oh, Phainon." He heard a wistful sigh follow. "You make it so hard to hold myself back…"

The tension on his neck loosened, and had he been any more present in that moment, he would have realized it was his leash coming undone. But it wasn't until the chain was gently tugged that he pressed his forehead to his leg and pulled the thumb from his mouth. Saliva strung them together, and it glistened over his bottom lip as he panted softly.

"Sit up for me," Mydei told him, and he lifted himself up before looking up at him with blurred vision. "Oh…"

His body felt heavy. His hair felt like a mess from the fingers that carded it in a direction opposite from his usual styling. His face felt hot.

Blinking slowly, Phainon swallowed the spit inside of his mouth and then curled deeper into himself. Lips parted and eyebrows raised high, he tilted his head back watching his face.

"Did I do good, master?" He asked in a voice so quiet and sincere that it made the other man cover his mouth with his fingers.

Mydei rubbed the lower half of his face while watching him, eyes darkened from their usual golden amber and leather tucked between his knuckles. That same elbow rested on his armrest to follow the lean of his body, and his legs were parted wide now that he had backed his chair up enough. With his button-up half undone and tented from his slouched position, he could see each deep breath he took and every exhale he made.

Ah… his dominant was handsome too.

"You took your punishment so well," he told him, and a shiver trembled through his body. "You lasted longer than I thought you would. Isn't my prince so strong?"

He nodded, eyes traveling down his relaxed body to take in the plush of his chest, strength of his arms, and thickness of his thighs. The bottom of his shirt was still tucked into his pants, and it revealed just how wide his torso was from rigorous working out.

Phainon wanted to sit on those thighs again, and he wanted to touch his waist to feel just how much different his body was from his own. His hands longed to explore him the way he had been, to taste the fruits of his every day labor.

He wanted it.

He wanted to be good, and he wanted to make Mydei feel as good as he made him feel.

“Did you hear me?”

Behind his slacks, where his far away gaze was directed at, he saw the tent of his arousal. Pressing up to the zipper, something from what had just happened turned him on.

“Listen, Phainon.”

He hummed, meeting Mydei’s eyes as he tugged him forward with his leash.

“Stand up for me,” he instructed him, and he shifted on top of his blanket.

Pins and needles attacked his numb legs, but he willed himself to stand up anyways and look down at him. The sensation made him wince, weight shifting from foot to foot.

It also brought him closer to reality to be moving again. To have his knees ache lightly from his punishment and his peaceful silence disturbed made that heavy cloud begin to fade.

“There he is,” Mydei teased him, standing up with him. “Someone slips easily, doesn’t he? I need to be more careful. That’s a dangerous thing.”

“Huh?”

Dangerous?

“Can you tell me my name, Phainon?” He asked while unclipping his leash. “What do you want to call me right this second?”

“M-Mydei,” he answered, and his best friend nodded. “Mydei, I… I’m sorry. I didn’t mean to stop kneeling the way you asked. I just…”

He waited as he paused, listening intently while wrapping his leash around his knuckles slowly. It was clear he didn’t plan on using it again tonight.

“I felt small,” he told him honestly, a tickle of discomfort in his chest. “And I felt really… uncomfortable and just, overall, bad. It was a lot.”

“Was it?”

He nodded slowly, batting what was left of that sweet haze away to focus on him and their moment at hand.

“Yeah, I um… I wanted to know you were there with me,” Phainon explained quietly, shy about his own dependency. “I could see you, but I wanted to touch you. Is that okay?”

A smile stretched across Mydei’s lips. “Phainon, the reason I was here was so you could find comfort in me during this. I only wanted to see how far this pushes you,” he said to him.

“I think you touching me like that made me weird again though.”

Phainon wasn’t quite sure what the name for that sensation was, but apparently to Mydei, it was dangerous. It didn’t feel that way though. Not while he was in it.

That felt like… floating, almost. Like the world was gone, the inhibitions were gone, and it was only him and Mydei left. It came silently, sweetly, trickling in like a light fog from the sea. It hovered like a tickle, kissing over his skin and engulfing him within its haze. But it left almost violently, leaving quickly and revealing the mess surrounding him that he had no clue even took place.

The shock between its rose colored bliss and the darkness that gnawed at him was extreme.

“Look at me,” Mydei told him, cupping his cheeks as he tried to make sense of the mess inside of him. “What did we learn from this?”

“I shouldn’t say things I don’t mean,” he answered breathlessly. “I’m not a dog, and I’m not a toy. You treat me like a person, and… and I should see myself as one too.”

“And?”

“And I want to be good,” he added after, speaking slower than before. “I want to be a good sub, Mydei. For you and for me.”

“Do you?” He asked softly, and he nodded earnestly. “It’s that comfortable in your subspace then?”

Was that what it was called? That floaty, disconnected from reality, state of being was called ‘*subspace*’?

“What’s that supposed to be like?” He whispered. “Why is it dangerous?”

Mydei shrugged lightly. “I hear it’s… cozy and comfortable. It’s a really vulnerable place, but it’s dangerous because you lose your sense of reality. That only means I need to be much, much more careful. I can’t push you as much as I did before because you can’t say a safeword as easily.”

Phainon nodded, then looked down between them when Mydei took a step back. From up here, he could see the bulge from behind his pants. When they were closer, he felt it brush his thigh.

“Where are you looking?” Mydei scolded him, and he bit down on his bottom lip. “My eyes are up here.”

“Why don’t you ever let me…?”

The ending was silent and obvious as he continued looking at his body.

“This is about you exploring,” he responded casually, like his own body didn’t matter much to him. “I have my likes. You abide by my rules. But as far as having to touch me? That’s not

necessary."

"But…"

A moment passed, and he heard the other man swallow as his hands shakily lifted from his sides to hold his hips. Fingers curled into his belt loops, keeping him from backing further away.

"But *what*, Phainon?"

He pulled lightly, the soft fabric moving with his tentative and guiding touch. There was hardly force, and he wasn't even sure if it qualified as a pull, but Mydel took a step forward anyway.

Both hands pressed to the heavy, wooden desk behind him, caging him between Mydei's body and the edge. Chest to chest, it cut off his sight of his lower body, and he dragged his attention back upwards. The divot in his throat where it dipped to meet his collarbones, the bulb of his Adam's apple bobbing lightly, the clench and unclench of his jaw, and the expectant look in his bronze eyes made his heart pound erratically. Bit by bit, every inch of smooth, golden skin and the hunger radiating off his body heated the space between them.

His attention dropped to his lips, to where they sat still in front of him. No arrogant smirk. No amused grin. No gentle tilt. *Nothing*.

All of his emotions were drawn into his intense gaze and pinched eyebrows.

"But," he whispered, tracing over the curve of his cupid's bow and then the tall bridge of his nose. Sunset locks were swept over the highest point and split around his gaze, fallen into his face like that was their place to be, like they knew just where to go to make him appear more alluring. "What if I want to, master?"

Mydei pushed his hips closer, pressing himself against his body.

A gasp fell from Phainon's lips, soft and surprised when he felt just how hard his best friend was.

"Have you ever seen another man?" Mydei asked him. "Don't say anything dumb like you walked in on someone changing. Have you ever seen another man's body?"

"Not… like *that*. Not in person."

Mydei's head tilted forward, and a shaky breath left him as the sound of nails scratching into wood followed. The scent of whiskey was strong on his breath, making his nose crinkle slightly.

"I should have known the answer to that. Forgive me," he apologized quietly. "I know you…"

Phainon tilted his head back when he came closer, mouth only inches away from his collar. A cloud of breath washed over both the leather and skin above it.

One of the hands behind him brushed his forearm, then followed his skin down to where his fingers were still holding his belt loops. It cupped around his knuckles, holding him for a movement and coaxing him to let go.

“Myd…—”

Their combined hands inched closer left, closer to where their belt buckles were knocked together and zippiers touched. Mydei’s grip was loose, serving as a silent reminder that he could pull away whenever he wanted to. He didn’t need to do this. He wasn’t expected to do this.

Soon, the tent in his pants filled his empty palm, and he gulped as his fingers curled beneath.

Mydei held him there, and he was too stunned by the experience to do anything but hold him gingerly. But when he came to the conclusion that he wasn’t moving, that guiding touch went back to the desk behind him.

“You don’t have to,” he reassured him. “This is *your* experiment, and I’m only here to serve as your guide. I’m much more concerned about *your* pleasure, pain, and comfort than my own.”

“Why do you have to say that?” He murmured, squeezing experimentally and pushing the heel of his palm closer, deeper. “Why do you have to make it sound like you get nothing out of this? I’m wearing *your* collar, learning *your* rules, and letting *you* touch me.”

“You wanted to learn *my* way.”

“Yeah, but…” Phainon trailed off unsurely. “But, I can tell you enjoy this. Is it so bad to indulge—”

“I’ll get ahead of myself,” he cut him off, holding himself steady even as Phainon tried garnering a reaction from him. “I don’t want to overwhelm you.”

“You should be more honest with me too, master.”

“Hm…” Mydei’s hands suddenly brushed against the back of his pants. Both grabbed his bottom loosely, engulfing it within his touch before tightening. “And if I said I want your mouth on me?”

He stilled for a second.

His *mouth*? As in, he wanted him to suck him off inside of his office, knowing full well he’s never done something like that before?

What if his teeth touched him and hurt him? Or he went too deep and gagged too hard on him?

What if he was so bad at it that—

“Kneel,” Mydei demanded quietly, effectively cutting his train of thought off. The hands on his ass raised, sliding up the curve of his stiffened spine and towards his tensed shoulders before pulling on them.

“Wait—”

Phainon’s knees buckled, not from the pressure on his body but from the crack of his resolve as he looked at him.

“Don’t talk back. You asked for me to indulge myself, and I want you on your knees for me. I want you to look up at me with those eyes again,” he told him.

“What eyes?” He asked, dragging that blanket from earlier so his knees could rest over it.

“Those big, watery eyes that only I have ever seen.”

While kneeling again, Mydei’s hand cupped the back of his head, allowing for him to lean back without bumping it against the desk. It was silent. It was quick. He didn’t even realize until he backed his head and then felt the unmovable force behind him.

“One hand comes up here.” Mydei’s opposite hand was held out, and he shakily filled it with his own. “Hold three fingers up, and drop them one by one if anything becomes uncomfortable. Do I make myself clear?”

“Yes, master.”

He didn’t lock their fingers together. Instead, his palm wrapped around the back of his hand and brought towards his body. Three fingers were pressed to his chest, all of them standing tall and visible for him.

One of each of their hands then went to his belt, and he watched as the metal buckle was worked open. Leather parted, hanging freely in front of him and giving them both the space to unbutton his slacks.

“Do it yourself,” Mydei told him after that, opting to instead pull his button-up and tank-top higher. “Show me you want it.”

Phainon’s eyes followed the rising hems of his clothes, paying particular attention to the rosy tattoos he hid away from sight every single day and the smooth, golden skin of his lower stomach. They lined either half of his hipbones in jagged, crimson bolts, pointing towards the fallen waistband of his pants and the dark hair peaking beneath it. The golden tufts trailed upwards towards his belly button, spreading and thinning out lower the closer to his waistband they got.

“Do you prefer a man that’s smooth down there?” Mydei wondered curiously, noticing his hesitation. “I’ll start shaving if that’s your preference.”

“No. It’s not that, it’s just…”

He has seen him without clothes. He has seen when his lounging pants fall a little too low or when he takes his shirt off while working out. Never did he think much past his stomach looking more toned or the odd reminder that Mydei did have tattoos too. Though, because of his corporate job, they were placed somewhere completely hidden.

Never did he think he wanted to put his mouth to his hips and taste the couple of veins poking through his skin.

“Can I…?” His fingers grabbed the zipper, pinching it but not pulling.

“Take them off.”

The command made him tug it down quickly, and the loosened fabric fell from his hips without any help to keep them up.

Teeth sunk down into his tongue at the sight, muffling the noise that crawled up his throat from seeing the way his best friend’s stiffened cock filled out his gray boxer briefs. Thick and heavy, it sat right in front of his face, pressing tight enough to make out every detail. He could see the ring of its mushroomed tip. He could see where it ended and where his balls hung beneath it.

Phainon could see so much of him from right here on his knees, only inches away.

He could also smell him, and it wasn’t… bad. It was warm, tinted his usually peppery body wash but mostly heavy with his own natural musk.

Gulping, he realized that he might like that. Mydei’s scent was deep and inviting, almost beckoning him to come closer, peel his briefs down, and then touch him skin to skin.

“Don’t be intimidated now,” Mydei murmured, and he looked up at him to meet his eyes. “I’m not *that* big.”

“Don’t lie to me,” he quipped back sharply, earning a raised eyebrow in return. “I-I’m sorry, master. I’m just… nervous, okay?”

“Relax. It’s just me.”

Right. It was just Mydei. His best friend, Mydei.

He had already seen him, touched him, and watched him fall apart because of him, but not once did he try to ridicule him for his glaringly obvious inexperience. All he ever did was guide him through and encourage him to enjoy himself.

It was fine. He’d be fine.

Phainon brought his fingers closer, finding it within himself to dip beneath his elastic and pull his boxers down. More of his was revealed to him inch by inch, this part being slightly paler than the rest of his sun-kissed body and riddled with short, coarse hairs. They were longest and thickest at the base of his cock, colored a darker blond than what was on his head.

He tried so hard not to look at it right away, especially as he tucked his boxers just beneath his balls, but it was impossible. Mydei's cock was thick, heavy, and hanging loosely in front of him with a pink, rosy tip that was leaking a pearl of pre-cum. It was so close that he could see the veins forking along the shaft.

Mydei was a liar.

"That's not gonna fit," he blurted out, and Mydei chuckled as if his brewing insecurities were funny. "I-I'm not… How deep am I supposed to take this?"

"You can learn," he said simply, making him roll his eyes before gulping. "You can also stop staring and start touching me. I don't bite… not down there."

Slowly, he brought his hand closer, butterflies deep in his stomach as his fingers wrapped around the base gingerly. The first thing he felt was heat. His skin was so hot, especially when he slowly tightened his grasp. The second thing he felt was his cock throb, flooded full of life and ready for more.

It wasn't like his toy back home. It wasn't slender or purple, and it didn't bend back and forth lifelessly like the silicone that it was. If that was meant to be five inches, just how many was this?

Phainon tilted his head slightly, then looked down at his pelvis as he stuck his tongue out shyly. Hot skin soon brushed against his tastebuds, tasting of salt when it dragged slowly around the tip.

A soft, drawn out and closed lipped groan filled into the room in response, and his heart skipped. Heat flooded into his cheeks, forcing him to reel himself back and swallow thickly. The lingering flavor made him shift, curious of what his pre-cum would be like if his skin tasted like that.

"Phainon, stop thinking so much. Stick your tongue out already," Mydei breathed out, and he rolled it over his bottom lip. "Lick around the head while you're at it."

He nodded, leaning in closer to follow his instructions.

"Mm… There you go," he encouraged him. "Just like that. Look up at me while you do that."

Phainon flicked his gaze upwards, looking through his lashes and meeting the eyes already staring down at him. His tongue continued to move. It circled around the head slowly, pre-cum smearing over his tastebuds and painting them sticky and salty—something he didn't mind at all.

"I want to mess you up so badly…"

Tingles inched through his body, branching past his gut and straight to his groin. They made his pants feel a little bit tighter because of the pressure against his zipper. When the arousal started to build, he wasn't so sure, but his own cock was stiff now. With each passing minute, it only grew harder.

“I want that glazed over, far away look on my pretty boy’s face as I fuck his mouth.”

He paused for a second, readjusting his grasp before curling his lips around the blunt tip.

“Suck on it while you do that,” Mydei guided him, and he tried his best to do both at the same time. “Oh fuck…”

It was nice to hear him feel good for once.

Every time something happened, it felt as if Mydei did it all for him. He got him off with his hands. He praised him endlessly. He rewarded him with nice things and activities he liked. But the man hardly asked for anything in return. Things were always so one-sided.

Listening to him and watching him enjoy himself for once was a nice change of pace.

“That’s my good boy. You look handsome like this,” he said, voice lightly breathy from him toying with his cock. “Take more of it, Phainon. I know you can.”

His concern must have shown through because a corner of Mydei’s lips tilted upwards, and he chuckled softly.

“Not all of it. I want to know how far you can go before it’s too much,” he pressed, easing his hips closer. “Show me where your limit is.”

Phainon slowly lowered himself. His eyebrows pinched as the girth of his cock forced his jaw open even wider. The fear of scraping him with his teeth came back, and he tried so hard not to accidentally touch.

“Come on…” He groaned softly, throbbing against his tongue. “You look so good with your lips stretched around me.”

He stopped when the very tip brushed the back of his mouth, unable to continue. If he pushed past that he’d choke, or worse, he’d gag. And he didn't want to gag because gagging meant the possibility of throwing up. That was something Phainon absolutely did not want to do.

So, he held himself there, eyes wide and begging for instructions on what to do now that they’ve established can barely take half of him in his mouth. His jaw already felt a tinge of discomfort in the hinge, and breathing through his nose was difficult from how heavy each was. There was no way anymore was going to comfortably fit.

“I’m so proud of you,” Mydei praised him sweetly. “You’re doing so well. I just need you to take a little bit more, okay?”

Before he could protest, his hips pushed forward, testing how much further he could force his cock.

The moment a choked noise bubbled from his throat, Mydei stopped. He pulled back, easing inch after inch out until just the tip was kissing his lips. Spit spilled between them both, rolling down his own chin and glistening over the length previously tucked into his mouth.

“That’s it. That’s the line,” he grinned wider, and Phainon gulped down what didn’t drip down his face. “Now that we both know where it is, let’s see how close we can get to making you tear up again.”

He whined quietly, tongue hanging from his mouth so Mydei could continue to nudge against it with shallow thrusts.

“Do you like the taste?” Mydei asked him, and he nodded. “Say it. With my cock on your tongue, tell me you like the taste of it.”

“I… I like the taste of your cock, master,” he tried to say, but the heavy length made it sound downright humiliating.

“Fuck…” Mydei’s head tilted to the side lazily as he watched him. “Close your mouth and lift your chin. Suck, and let me do all of the moving for you.”

Phainon sealed his lips around him, then leaned his head comfortably into the hand still protecting him from the desk. Fingertips slipped into his hair, rubbing his scalp softly and soothingly.

“Would you like some honesty, Phainon?”

More of his cock slipped deeper into his mouth, and he hummed around it positively. After all, they were supposed to be nothing but honest.

“What I get out of this whole thing is the peace of knowing you’re safe in your exploration. That was my biggest concern, and it’s now my greatest benefit,” he shared with him, rocking himself slowly into his mouth.

Phainon’s heart skipped.

“I do find you attractive, and you do turn me on. Getting to exercise my dominance with a willing sub is another bonus point for me too,” he listed easily. “But my greatest pleasure is seeing how *safe* you feel with me, and how you’ll *allow* yourself to try new things like this.”

Flutters filled his chest and stomach. They made him squirm lightly in his place, both heart-warmed and a little embarrassed at the thought of him getting off on his new experiences.

“Look at you, Phainon. You’re letting me fuck your face.”

Mydei moved smoothly in and out of his mouth, pressing himself as deep as he could before reeling back. More pre-cum oozed over his tongue. The vein on the underside throbbed, pleased by the friction. With every pump, the taste of him became stronger, and his spit became more viscous because of it.

“You’d never let someone else do this, would you?” He asked, and his head shook as much as it could. “Just me?”

He nodded, and more force was put into thrusting forward. It pushed his head back into his hand, and the hand still holding him let go in favor of grabbing his hip. Thumb to his tattoo,

he held him tightly, pinching his body for stability.

“You’re master’s good boy, hm?”

Phainon nodded again, eyes fluttering shut as he let himself melt into his overwhelming presence. Everything was Mydei—the salted taste on his tongue, the gentle feel on his skin, the pleased sounds in his ears, the warm smell in his nose, the tensed figure in front of him. This room was his. This home was his. *He* was his.

It was difficult to talk himself into fighting his nerves and sucking his cock, but it was easy to sit on his knees and let him please himself now that he did it. Spit mingled with pre glided every push, coating his lips and slowly rolling down the corner of his mouth face.

“Don’t do that,” Mydei said to him, and he snapped his eyes open. “Look at me. I want to see those pretty eyes. I want to see that h-handsome expression.”

His focus zeroed in on his face, and a low groan followed as he stilled his hips. Every inch he could take filled his mouth, poking at the start of his throat and sitting there for him to strain against.

“Stay with me.”

Phainon choked lightly, struggling to breathe in response to him being just a hair past his comfort into that too much area. His eyes watered, face growing hot and hotter as the seconds ticked by.

“Good boy. That’s my good little boy,” he coo’ed, twitching over his tongue. “Hold out just a little bit longer for me, Phainon. Come on, you can do it.”

Tears burned in the corners of his eyes as he choked again, and just as his limping fingers were ready to drop one, he felt Mydei pull back. The drag out was slow, but once the tip hung in front of his face, he gasped loudly. Breaths were swallowed down deeply and erratically, each too big to be taken in by his nose.

Mydei moaned at the sight, taking in his glittering tears and messy lips.

“Hold my shirt for me.”

Phainon’s hand raised, pushing the fabric out of the way so he could instead wrap it around his spit-soaked cock. Fingers brushed his lips every time he squeezed the head, and his eyes darted down to watch.

“I want to cum in your mouth.” He tapped his tip to the middle of his bottom lip. “Whether you swallow or not is up to you, but I want to.”

“Will you be mad if I don’t?” He found it in him to ask shakily. “The… texture of my own makes me think I won’t like it in my mouth.”

“I could never be mad at you for something so trivial,” he promised him. “Open up. Wrap those pretty lips around the tip, and let me finish on your tongue.”

Phainon's mouth wrapped around him, sucking firmly as he jerked himself off.

"A-Ah fuck," came his low, strained voice. "Not… Not that I can't cum from your mouth, but your jaw won't be able to take the wait, will it?"

More heat burned underneath his cheeks, and he took a little more into his mouth. The tip of his tongue wiggled against him as much as he could manage, hoping to please him to make him finish faster.

"I'm close," he panted, bumping his fist to his mouth much, much faster than he had been using his mouth. "Mm… Phainon… Just like that. Keep it up."

His pants were uncomfortably tight already, but hearing him moan his name made for an even tighter fit. Its sound in his best friend's pleasured voice sent a jolt right through his body, lighting it up with nothing but arousal.

He wanted to hear it again. He wanted Mydei to keep saying his name just like that.

"If you want to, I'll show you how to take it deeper, take it longer," he offered. A grin pulled on his mouth. "I'll train you in how to suck cock like a good boy. I-I can give you an exercise to do… A goal to reach…"

Phainon tightened his grasp on his shirt, scrunching the smooth fabric within his fist as he thought of Mydei training him in how to take him.

"I'll reward you for doing well. I'll punish you for slacking off." He was speaking, but it sounded less like it was to him and more like it was for himself. "And you'll be such a good boy for me and take it, won't you?"

He hummed, not positively or negatively, and another breathy moan tumbled from his lips.

"Sh-Shit… Phainon," he called his name again, and his own cock twitched in interest. "Phainon, I'm close."

The hand holding his fingers up shifted, and Mydei's immediate reaction was to jerk as if ready to rip himself away. Only for him to exhale heavily when he cupped his chest through his shirt, fingertips digging into the plush muscle and squeezing. But his jaw clenched, and his eyes narrowed.

"Don't do that," he scolded him sharply. "If I tell you to hold your fingers up, never drop them unless I allow you to. The only exception is to signal your comfort."

Phainon's eyes dropped.

"Don't let it happen again."

He didn't realize it was that big of a deal, but he nodded the best he could anyways.

"Keep touching me," he allowed after. "I'm… I'm gonna cum. Grab me tightly if you want to so badly. H-Hah… Hold me."

His grasp tightened upon being told to, and he inched himself closer to his body. More of his thick cock filled his mouth, forcing his jaw to open wider.

Loud, unabashed groans and heavy breaths echoed throughout the room. Beneath, the slick sound of him pumping his fist quickly followed. Both mingled into something obscene inside of his ears, something straight out of an adult video.

Only… Mydei was more handsome than the men in those videos, and he sounded better than them too, like he was genuinely enjoying himself. It was comforting to know the hands jerking himself off so roughly were gentle outside of this, and the voice that had been so rough in reprimanding him was usually kind. Knowing it was him made watching him better.

“I’m gonna… g-gonna cum,” he warned him breathlessly, words rushed in a way they never were. “Gonna fill this m-mouth full of my load. Fuck, Phainon, be a good boy a-and take it… a-ah… all. Take it all. Mm… C’mon…”

The sensation of feeling him pulse against his sealed lips was new, and his tongue stilled to feel each vein throb. It was one thing to feel himself inside his hand. Finishing into his own fist was nothing new, but to suck on someone’s cock as they orgasmed made his skin tingle in ways that made him feel dirty.

He liked that. He liked the way he could feel as he got ready to fill his mouth.

But as strange and exciting as it was to feel him gearing up to cum, actually having him shoot against his tongue and towards the back of his throat made him tremble. It was much thicker than the pre-cum he had gotten used to, heavier too as the mess flooded into his mouth rope by rope. That should have been expected. He knew what it felt like when touching himself, but it was such a surprise to experience someone else’s in real time.

Mydei’s fingers on the back of his head tightened, gripping his scalp firmly as if to hold him steady. His other hand bumped slower to his mouth the longer he moved, milking his release as long as possible and feeding him every drop.

He didn’t know how to swallow, not while his lips were stretched so wide around him, so it sat. That salty, sticky seed coated his tongue and filled his mouth.

“Mm…” Mydei’s head was tilted back in pleasure. His chest rose and fell with each erratic breath, filling the palm cupping his chest. “Phainon…”

The pressure eased up, and he gripped his shirt tighter in his fist before pulling. With it, his best friend slowly pulled out. A mix of spit and cum strung them both together.

Cheeks puffed, he looked up when his head was forced back to meet his best friend’s eyes. Even as he tried to force his throat to swallow, only a little bit of his cum managed to go down before he curled into himself and shook his head. It started off a gentle motion, then grew faster as he realized he couldn’t do it.

Laughter followed. Breathy, amused, and sweet.

“Here. Spit it out.”

A glass that smelled of ice water and whiskey was placed beside his mouth, and he spit what had been pooled on his tongue. Still, it coated every inch of his mouth, thick in a way he wasn’t sure he enjoyed.

“You’ll get used to it,” Mydei teased, setting the glass down on his cart after. “It’s the texture thing, isn’t it?”

He nodded, wiping his mouth with his hands to capture what spilled.

“Not everyone likes to. They do it to be sexy,” he reassured him. “The more you do it, the more used to it you become. Who knows? Maybe you’ll end up one of the people who like it one day.”

“You… want me to be?” He asked quietly. “You got pretty… into it… when you were talking about training me to suck dick better. Does that mean you want it?”

“Talk is talk,” he said simply, shrugging his shoulders. “There’s a distinct difference between fantasy and reality. Things like that are sexy to think about, but a bit impractical to practice regularly.”

“Is it?”

“You ask as if you want me to do it," he mused. “Should I? Should I buy you a toy to practice on when I’m not around?”

Immediately, Phainon looked away from him. The words were on the tip of his tongue, accusatory and bitter.

Mydei sounded like he wanted it.

What? Did he want him to swallow it all down so bad that he’d train him how to do it? Did he expect pictures and videos of him with his toy to prove that he was fucking his own mouth on his own time?

Would he get punished if he couldn’t teach himself to take enough or enjoy swallowing down his load?

But, he bit it back. His teeth met his tongue, and he paused for a moment before relaxing lightly underneath his gaze.

“You don’t need to buy me anything,” he told him. “I have my own things. It’s not a matter of having that stuff, it’s a matter of comfort.”

“Heh, does silicone or the real thing taste better?” He joked, and Phainon licked over his own teeth before looking back at him.

“Master tastes better,” he answered honestly.

Mydei planted a hand on top of his head, and he lightly ducked underneath its weight.

“Take off your pants. Allow me to—”

A loud and sudden alarm filled the room, slicing through their moment and causing them both to jump from surprise.

His head whipped behind him, finding that Mydei’s phone screen was illuminated with a finished timer. While wracking his head for a reason why he would need one, his nose was lightly tickled with the warm scent of a roast dinner.

For so long, he had been smelling nothing but Mydei’s skin. As comforting as it was, his food smelled nice and delicious too.

At least that would be swallowed.

“We should eat,” Phainon told him, and Mydei’s eyes dropped down to the front of his jeans. “That’s uh… fine. It’s fine.”

“After dinner, I will take care of you,” he offered. “Are you staying the night?”

“Do you want me to?” He returned, feeling as his body was eyed inch by inch from the front of his pants until their eyes met. “I don’t work early. I go in around noon.”

“You’ll stay,” he decided, answering him with a firm command. “And tomorrow, I’ll come over after work and make dinner for you both.”

“Then… my master should stay over too…” He trailed off, pressing his luck just a little bit.

Mydei’s eyes rolled, clearly noticing the tilt of hope in his voice. “Only if we go on an early run, and you show me that bush full of stray cats. I’ll bring a tin of food for them.”

He laughed over the thought, then nodded quickly in agreement. “Yes, I’d like that. Those chubby kitties would like that too.”

“It’s a date, Phainon,” he said, leaving no room for disagreement or backing out. “Let me go check on that chicken now. Hopefully it isn’t dry.”

“Go.” He waved him off. “Pull your pants up first, Mydei!”

“I have never had a submissive tell me that before.”

He watched him pull his pants up from around his ankles, then as he walked away while bucking his belt. That nice shirt was wrinkled up from his fists.

“Oh, and Phainon?”

Humming, he nodded as his best friend looked over his shoulder.

“Please put that blanket in the wash immediately, change into the clothes I left in the bathroom for you, and bring that tray so I can wash the cum out of my glass.”

It was worded like a series of simple requests, but he knew better than to skip out on completing tasks given to him.

“Yes, master,” he obeyed.

—

After their dinner settled, as they decided to go back to his bedroom, Mydei took the leash he had left on the mattress towards his closet. Two fingers beckoned him to join, and Phainon bounced off of his spot on the bed to follow. A pep made each step light and springy, like he couldn’t believe he was being called over.

“Yeah?”

One hand held the wall as he stood in the doorframe, and he watched as Mydei began to tap the keypad to his locked cabinet. Its passcode was already on its last digit by the time he showed up, and he hummed as it lit up green.

“Come here.”

He walked closer, standing beside Mydei in a mix of curiosity and nerves. They fought for control inside of his stomach, wrestling to see what would come up first—curiousity, nervousness, or his dinner.

His money was on the last one.

The black door was pulled open, and Phainon flinched like something would pop out to jump scare him. It made Mydei chuckle, and his hand curled around his arm before nudging him closer.

“Breathe,” he told him. “I’m not hiding anything too heavy in here. You won’t find needles, or electro-stimulants, or even spiked paddles.”

“Electro… *huh?*” He asked dumbly, looking at him instead of the hidden shelves, hooks, and hangers. “What does that mean?”

“Have you ever been zapped by a static shock?” He wondered, and he nodded. “It’s similar to that, but on other parts of your body. I don’t own any of those toys to take part again.”

“Like…—”

“Nipples and other intimate areas? Yes,” he finished. “It’s pleasurable. I’m not here or there for it, but if my submissive comes to me with their own toys and asks for it, I will study and

learn.”

“Has one?”

“No comment.”

Phainon wasn’t surprised about that, but he was a bit surprised by how… bare this top-secret closet was when he glanced over. Part of him expected walls of various sized sex toys, a plethora of gear, and things alike. For someone so insistent on living a fetish-based life, he thought there would be to his name.

Bundles of soft-looking, crimson ropes were laid out beside one another on a shelf, and next to them were four identical handcuffs like the ones he had used before. Hung up on a hook were four different kinds of chains, leaving him to assume they belonged to either set of cuffs. There must be different lengths, some looser and some tighter.

The next shelf had two sets of clamps, ones he knew and another pair much thinner without the silicone tips. What looked like fishing weights sat beside them, but he had to be mistaken. Surely they weren’t. Those also had hooks on the back, and leather straps lined them. One had a black ball suspended between either half, and the other had a cushioned, mask-like shape to it.

The second off the bottom held a couple of bottles he recognized as lube, a box of condoms that was already opened, and a container of latex gloves. Behind them was a metal bar. A long, steel bar with hooks on either end of it that must have been pretty heavy.

On the last were books, and his head tilted as he read over the spines. One of the books was on the safety of bondage, probably where to be more delicate and how to properly tie a knot with rope. Another looked to be about how to be smart and secure when practicing kinks, as the word '*psychology*’ was printed beside it.

“You actually read up on um… *BDSM*?” Phainon was pleasantly surprised by the revelation. “Is that all… informational guides?”

“Some are physical guides on how to be safe, and some are psychological guides to understand the emotional and mental aspects of it,” Mydei told him, then placed the leash near his clamps. “What I don’t know, I study. What I do know, I revise. The body is very delicate, so you need to remember all the key points of keeping yourself healthy. This isn’t just about sex. I’m in this all the time.”

Phainon hummed, slightly overwhelmed by the knowledge that Mydei was that deep into this whole thing.

“How long?”

“I was interested for a long time,” he answered, speaking gently. “I only started practicing it with other people a few years ago.”

“After you left home,” he assumed, and Mydei nodded. “When did you first get into all of this? Like… how did that happen?”

Mydei looked over to him, and he sighed. “I stumbled across it one day, and this couple I read about did this. They talked about being in their dynamic all the time, whether it's strictly enforced or just lightly insinuated. It was a girl and her mistress.”

Phanon nodded, listening intently.

“The way this girl explained it sounded exactly like what I wanted in a relationship, so I did more research. I joined online communities under secret aliases, and I learned what it meant to be dominant. Not… powerful, or authoritative, but dominant,” he explained quietly. “I ran with it.”

“Your first submissive was…?”

“I don’t disclose that information.” Mydei looked away from him at that. “My first submissive and I weren’t romantically involved. He offered to be my test submissive, to see if I had what it takes and could handle what I wanted. When he found someone he liked romantically, he left, and I moved on.”

“Oh.”

That sounded… *sad*.

Phainon wasn’t sure how he could open himself up so much to someone then just… have them walk away like that. It was his worst nightmare.

“You’ve had a lot of submissives then,” he guessed, chuckling softly in an attempt to lighten the mood. “I won’t ask anymore. That’s not my place.”

“Well, as my sub, you’re free to ask about my history. I just won’t tell you personal information regarding them,” he offered. “I’ll answer honestly. There’s no use in lying.”

“What did they call you?”

“‘Daddy,’ he answered. “‘*Sir*’.”

His eyebrow lifted. “No one’s called you ‘*master*’ yet?”

That was surprising. He had assumed that was a popular name and most of his older partners would have thought of it.

“That’s… not something I believe I embody,” Mydei admitted to him. “To other people, a ‘*master*’ is much more cutthroat and strict. They’re absolute.”

“I think you are…” Phainon told him. “Sometimes, anyway. Do you not like it? Should I learn something new?”

“If it’s comfortable for you to say, call me that. It grows on me the more you say it,” he allowed. “However, I don’t respond to ‘*daddy*’ anymore. That time is gone.”

“Mm…”

In the back of his head, he remembered the annoyed expression every time he referred to him as a ‘*sugar daddy*’. It irked him. Maybe it wasn’t just the aspect of handing money out, but the second half itself.

“Did… someone…?”

“Let’s just say, had it not been ruined, I would have asked you to say it,” he told him, and Phainon nodded. “Does anything in here interest you for another time, or can I close it?”

“What’s on the hangers?” He pointed out at the mess of black and rust-red leather straps. “Why are they separated from everything else?”

“Clothes I wear.”

He saw straps. Mydei saw clothes. Were they looking at the same thing? The leather belts and harnesses there were ‘*clothes*’ to him?

“I thought only submissives get tied up?” He wondered while head leaning into his shoulder. “Isn’t that for bondage?”

“I don’t get tied up.”

Beneath the hangers were a stack of shoe boxes, and from the opened pair on top, they weren’t ones meant for the son of a CEO to be seen in. If Eurypon, or any of Mydei’s higher-ups for that matter, somehow caught a glimpse of him in boots that heavy and intimidating looking, they would probably faint on the spot.

“I like to dress up,” Mydei told him as if it were truly as simple as that. “If I’m in a particular mood, I enjoy dressing up to fit the occasion.”

Phainon looked at him, and Mydei tilted his head while glancing back.

He tried to imagine him dressed in raunchy, leather straps that strained around his chest and thick-soled combat boots that tall. His best friend, bare chested with that red and gold harness on, and black pants with those clean looking shoes on, standing even taller than he already was and looking down at him. Maybe he’d lean over him, make him feel small even if they were the same size, and he’d bark a demand even harsher than he did. There wouldn’t be a ‘*best friend’* Mydei in there. It would be ‘*dominant*’ Mydei through and through, and he wouldn’t be as nice.

“Do you step on people?” He blurted out, and immediately, a look of amusement shifted out of Mydei’s previously calm expression. “I-I mean… No, I meant that. Do you like… put your feet on them?”

“I could.” That wasn’t the answer he wanted to hear. "Do you want to experience that?”

“No! I just… I saw people putting their feet up on other people,” he explained quietly, looking into his eyes. “Like furniture. Or they’d step on… you know… a guy’s balls…”

“Some people like it.”

Phainon didn’t care about what other people liked. He wanted to know if he liked it.

Yeah, he knew some of his bigger kinks and fetishes. They went over the bondage, the praising, the light touches of sadism, and the control when they looked over rules and safewords, but was that something he liked doing too? Did stepping on people fall underneath that broad spectrum of ‘*sadism*’? Was dehumanizing them some sick way to exert a sense of ‘*control*’ over someone?

“You have a look in your eye,” he told him, then turned to face him fully. “Say it.”

“Do you like it?” He asked, and Mydei hummed thoughtfully. “What is the dressing up for? Display of power?”

“I like leather,” he said simply. “I think it looks good on me, and it helps me get into certain headspaces. Just because I live in a dynamic, doesn’t mean I have the ability to uphold a sex life so… demanding.”

“‘*Headspace*’?” He repeated.

Mydei nodded. “Some days I want more control, and other times, I have to gear myself up to behave that way. Mostly, I’m exactly as you see me now.”

“Will I ever get to see you in that red and gold set? The one that matches my collar?”

He must have already known which one he was talking about because he didn’t even bother to turn around. His eyes stayed on him, watching his expressions and gauging his reactions.

“If you behave exceptionally well for me, I will dress up for you,” he promised him. “In fact, I will let you pick what we do while I’m wearing it.”

Phainon’s eyes narrowed skeptically. “What’s… ‘*exceptionally*’ to you?”

“If I gave you the answers, I might as well put it on now,” he reasoned. “Be on your best behavior. Show me that you deserve to see your master like that, that you can be comfortable enough in your submission to accept that.”

“Mm… But, master…” Phainon pouted. “I’m always good. I’m your good boy, right? So, please wear it?”

“Begging gets you nowhere, boy,” he tsk’ed, and his breathing hitched over the casually condescending statement. “Only good or progressive behavior gets you rewards. Save your breath.”

He sulked, but there was nothing he could do about it. If Mydei made up his mind, then that was that.

“Does anything else in this cabinet interest you before I close it?”

His head shook, and he watched as Mydei sealed it shut upon receiving his answer. When he was sure it locked properly, he looked over at him.

“And before we head to bed, would you like me to return the favor from earlier?” He asked him while reaching to tie his hair up into a messy ponytail. “Go sit on the—”

“No thank you, master. It went down, and I’d like to go to bed since we have a lot to do tomorrow. It’s nearly bedtime,” he denied, and Mydei lowered his arms.

“Are you sure?”

“Next time, you can put me to bed with a blowjob. As of now, I’m really tired,” he confessed. “Sleep with me?”

“I’d like that,” he told him, smiling softly. “I’ll go down on you some other time.”

Phainon nodded, then grinned to himself as Mydei walked towards the bathroom rather than the bed with him. When the door shut, he covered his mouth and then looked up at the ceiling.

He had to be good. He had to abide by every rule, take the utmost care of himself, and say all the right things to make him happy if he wanted to see him in that matching harness. It would be difficult, but he had to.

Every part of him craved to see him in the outfits he liked and felt good in, even if it was bondage gear and made up of leather and metal. Just knowing it was something that made him happy to do made Phainon want to be a part of it too. It could be theirs to share, no one else’s.

It matched his collar, and he wanted it even if he had to bite his tongue and bow his head.

Chapter End Notes

daddy mydei and prince phainon would be so cute. especially since mydeis a bit of a softer dom and gives off more caregiver vibes imo

and sorry if there was mistakes. i will edit over again when i wake up as i was up 24+hrs LOL.

excited to bring cyrene and more of their friends into this, to see how they handle groups and such.

and im excited as well to write and explore mydeis more dominant side thats a little more selfish than he lets himself be. i think he would look so good in a red and gold

harness, and phainon would love his matching collar even more hehe

Chapter 8: Chapter Eight

Chapter Notes

> im beginning to run out of pre written chapters. i have 2 left HAHAHA.
>
> writing this chapter felt very soft. very… dom/sub without it being super heavy on kinks or sexuality. and i really like this non-sexual and more comforting/safe space kind of vibe.
>
> like even if i DO want to write a future fic or one-shot with some nasty, gritty, dirty, myphai/phaidei bdsm, this soft dom mydei and his sweet sub phainon makes me want to just keep writing them in this non-nsfw way. it feels comforting and safe to me.
>
> they will fuck in this tho, just… in the future. foreplay and other kinds of non cock-in-ass sex will have to do for now. (id SAY non penetrating but… with some ideas i have, i dont think thatd be right)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The only things Phainon expected to do after he got home from work the next day was to organize his apartment a little bit and prepare an excuse as to *why* Cyrene's Cinnamoroll marker had a cracked lid. His apartment was already clean because he pretty much only used it to get dressed for work. The fridge was full because he hadn't been eating at home except for making lunch. Even his bedroom was spotless besides for a half-full basket of clothes that needed to be washed soon.

But two things happened after he started some last minute preparations—the first being Cyrene calling to say she got stuck in traffic since she left too late this morning, and the second being Mydei coming over earlier than he expected with a few bags inside of his arms.

It was as if he rushed over as soon as he got off the clock, not bothering to stay a second longer inside of his second home—*his office*. Which, he couldn't *blame* him, but it also wasn't really like him to do. Most days he stayed an extra thirty minutes or hour to work late.

"Pour me a glass of whatever you have. I don't want to open the wine before I start cooking, but if I have to, I will." That was the first thing Mydei said to him as he walked into his apartment. His eyebrows were pinched in frustration, and a tightness flexed in his jaw briefly. "Then swap her old pack of highlighters out with these."

"Huh? You found the same pack?"

"Yes. I rushed to pick them up from the store when I got off," he sighed, and the sound of its plastic pouch touching his countertop followed. "And for the trouble of even messing with her things, I also bought you both one of these. It would appear odd to randomly give her

something when we aren't close, so congratulations on being my scapegoat, Phainon. You get a toy too."

His back was already turned while Mydei continued to speak, but he heard some of his bags crinkle after. They rustled and crackled as they were dug through and folded away, then his garbage can lid flipped up with more force than anticipated.

"Thank you, but you really didn't need to buy me anything," he said back to him, grabbing a full bottle from his pantry as he was told to do. "Cyrene wouldn't think it's weird, and neither would I. It's just a kind gesture from a friend to a friend."

"Wait. Time out. Why do you have a full bottle of *that?*" Mydei asked suddenly when he twisted the lid off. "Did you start drinking more on your own without telling me?"

Phainon laughed as he carefully began to pour him the drink *he* asked for. It was amusing to hear his offended tone at the assumption of being left out of his loop, but what was even funnier was the idea of him drinking at all by himself. That was never really his thing.

"I bought this for you." He turned around to approach him, glass in hand to offer the other man happily. "On the off chance he decides to visit, my master likes a drink to relax. If I wanted a drink for myself, I would ask you. I promised that I would."

"Huh… Aren't you cute?" Mydei accepted it from him with the tilt of a smile. "Thank you."

"Aren't I *good?*" He corrected him, an edge of hope to his voice. "You take such good care of me that I wanna be someone comfortable for you to come back to, too."

"Both," he said. "You're very thoughtful, and I find that both cute and admirable. You're my good boy."

Phainon perked up, skin tingling and stomach warming over the thought of being good for him, of doing something he could be proud of him for. He liked the way praise felt more and more each time it came.

"How was work?" He asked after, watching him take a drink. "You're here pretty early. Plus, you made a few stops, so just how much were you rushing to get here?"

Suddenly, their mood shifted. Mydei's soft expression soured ever-so-slightly. The crease between his eyebrows made its way back to his face.

"Terrible," he rasped out, voice rough from the burn of liquor and tinged with annoyance. "I left as soon as I could because my father kept ringing my company line carelessly. He doesn't think. Maybe the reason I *don't* pick up my personal cell is because I *don't* want to answer his fucking…—"

Mydei paused. The gaze that had been on him shifted to the floor beside them, and he took a deep breath before covering his mouth. Fingers curled over his cheek, dragging slowly down his jaw and chin before closing into a fist.

“Forgive me. That was uncalled for,” he apologized swiftly, taking a moment to compose himself. “I only answer his calls if it’s related to work. He doesn’t like that, and he’ll call my office or work phone to get my attention. It frustrates me.”

Phainon watched him finish his glass, then he held his hand out to take it from him.

“You can talk about that,” he coaxed gently, noticing the red tainting his cheeks from trying to hold it in. “He works you hard, and he always has. Don’t you remember all the times I had to let you copy my notes because you were too burnt out to get out of bed?”

“I remember, but it’s not so simple,” he denied the offer while handing him the glass. “There’s nothing immediate that can be done about this, so complaining only breeds more negativity. Being angry around someone who has no part in it is ridiculous of me.”

Was that how he saw his feelings then? A burden for only him to bear? A bed to lie in with his teeth clenched tight?

That didn’t sound right. It didn’t sound fair to him.

“Complaining about things helps you feel better, *master*,” he hinted, dragging the title out suggestively and playfully in an attempt to lighten the mood. “Bottling things up only makes it worse. We both know I’m prone to my own outbursts and spirals, so… take it from me. It’s a… ‘*do as I say, not as I do*’ kinda thing.”

Mydei had been there when he crashed, burned, and exploded from his own emotions. The disgust and anxiety wasn’t something that disappeared overnight, and he was learning not to expect it to. Things took time, and things needed to be let out. Breathing easily was difficult with a chest under so much pressure.

And the same could be said about anger, right? If he was angry at his father, that wasn’t something that just fixed itself. It was a problem that needed to be talked about, the smoke aired out of its container so they could assess the damage properly.

For once, *he* needed to be the open and vulnerable one between them.

“You’ve been doing a very good job at not letting your emotions get to that point,” Mydei praised him casually, and he frowned slightly. “I’m very proud of you, Phainon.”

“Thank you, but this isn't about me,” he tried to explain. “*You* need to be more open with me about your feelings and thoughts, no matter how violent or heavy handed they are. I don’t need to be protected from you.”

A moment of silence passed between them both. Within it, only the soft trickle of whiskey filling his glass and Mydei’s deep breaths could be heard.

“Fine. It’s wrong of me to expect this kind of transparency from you but not give it back,” he caved, and that sounded much more reasonable to him.

“I’m all ears.”

“I guess I get a little… upset… when my father forces himself into my life like he owns it,” he admitted to him, then sighed agitatedly. “After all, he pushed this life on me. I never asked to be groomed into this corporate trap of his. I know I have to since there’s no one else to accept it, and that I can deal with. I’ve made peace with that. But even the semblance of a care for what *I want* would have been nice from him. For instance, *I want* him to leave me alone.”

His chest both hurt and warmed from the confession, saddened that Mydei never felt as if he could talk about this yet glad it was him he was opening up to. Conversations between them alluded to these feelings. Over the years, he learned they weren’t particularly close over the context clues and from behind the closed doors of his family home, but it must have been nice for him to finally say it all out loud for once. Even if it was a slightly coerced confession, the relief of letting it out must have felt nice.

“No, you didn’t ask for this,” Phainon agreed softly, handing him his second glass.

Absent-mindedly, Mydei took it, clutching the drink tightly while glaring at a wall. Then he scoffed in dry amusement and cold frustration. “And yet he tries to talk to me as if we’re friends. He attempts to steal my alone time as if I haven’t given him enough of my life as is. He invites me out on trips with other old, rich *bastards* as if I want to be there to fuel his ever-burning ego. But we *aren’t* friends. I’m his trophy son, but he isn’t proud of *who I am*, just *what he made*.”

“That’s not fair at all,” he added when his words paused for a break, supporting him in hopes he’d continue.

Mydei always strived to be as perfect as he could be. He knew this. His best friend worked hard back in school and at his job, strived to be as independent as fast and as effectively as possible, and continued to maintain a clean image so as to not embarrass the people around him.

Phainon couldn’t help but feel terrible. He wished he could do something, *anything*, to help him, but all he could do was listen and hope it was good enough.

“Why would I waste what little free time I have with him when I can use it on things that are actually important to *me*?” Mydei demanded. “Nearly every day I have to stay late, or take my work home, because he hires the sons and their friends of *his* friends. But they’re all so damn bottle-fed that they can't even send a proper email! I have to proofread their work like a school teacher before it goes out or it makes us all look stupid! But he doesn’t care because denying these guys ruins his oh-so perfect image. So I have to do my job, *then* I have to babysit, *then* I have to give him my free time off the clock, *then* I can finally think about myself? *Fuck that!*”

Phainon set a hand on his arm, squeezing his bicep tightly. “Hey, it’s alright,” he hushed him.

“No, it’s *not* fucking alright, Phainon! I—”

Mydei’s trembling hand suddenly covered his mouth again. This time his fingers dug into his face, silencing himself completely so he could take a couple of deep breaths. As he did so, he

shook his head slowly.

It seemed he was done spilling his guts. The horrified expression on his face read that he had come to realize the bloody mess before him, and Mydei *hated* a mess.

“Just breathe for me,” he said softly, and their eyes met as he exhaled shakily into his hand. “It’s not fair, you're right. You work very hard, try to make yourself available for everyone else with what little time you have to yourself, and it’s not fair for him to exploit you to make himself look better to his friends. You’re more than just a shiny trophy to reflect off of.”

“Phainon, I-I shouldn’t dump this on you. I shouldn’t have yelled at you like that,” he apologized again, voice rough but trying to be compassionate. “You have your own troubles to work through with everything we have going on. I’m complaining and whining like a selfish child, and I’m sorry.”

“Hey, we made an agreement, remember? Signed our names in those Sanrio markers and everything," he reminded him, chuckling softly at the memory. “You told me if I ever felt too ill to take care of myself, you would step in to help me. Well, it goes the same way, right? If you feel too mentally exhausted to do anything, then I have to do more to help you relax. This isn’t some one-sided thing where I get pampered like a prince and you deal with the world on your own. It’s *mutual*.”

Mydei would have to be stupid to think he’d just stand there and let him suffer on his own. Submissive or not, he was still his best friend, and every word he spoke was coming from the depths of his chest as someone who loved him dearly. Because he did. He loved Mydei, and that meant he wanted to make sure he was okay.

“If you’re exhausted, go rest in my bed while I cook for us all. If you’re overwhelmed, tell me what I can do to lighten the mental load,” he said earnestly. “If this trouble with work and your dad makes you feel powerless, then take what I have. It’s yours."

“Phainon…”

He smiled sweetly up at him. Soft eyes the color of summer’s sky searching the golden ones burning across from him.

“That’s me,” he returned playfully, hoping to ease some of that heat. “*C’mon*, don’t be like that. All of the things we’ve done together, yet *this* has you speechless?”

Phainon brushed his fingertips down his sleeved arm, admiring the way his biceps and forearms filled out the fabric before spinning his wrist around. He grabbed his elbow carefully, raising it without a warning, and then popped open the button on his left cuff.

“Let’s start with getting you comfortable,” he suggested. “You look so dressed up that it’s making *me* feel overwhelmed. These tight cuffs, that belt, and your buttoned collar must be suffocating right now.”

Smooth, dark fabric was folded up to his forearm as he usually saw it after work, revealing sweat-damp skin and still-flexed muscle. Afterwards, he took Mydei’s other arm to do the

same thing. He lifted its weight, raised his wrist, and gently folded his sleeve as close as possible to the opposite side.

They hung limp by his best friend's sides, and he took that moment to hold either in his forearms. Fingers pinched to try and massage them, lining up and down in an attempt to ease their tensed state. As he did so, Phainon's eyes found the tie still pressed snug to his stiff collar.

Trailing his hands higher, he stretched them open wider to accommodate his upper arms and rubbed gently between his muscles. The pads of his thumbs moved in careful, circular motions, travelling until he found his shoulders. Fingers squeezed around them, pinching around his stiffened body.

"You don't need to do all of this," Mydei whispered, taken back by the gentle handling of his body.

Phainon only grinned back at him.

"I *don't* need to," he agreed, speaking much more firmly. "Just as I don't wanna be an object for you, I don't want you to sacrifice your well-being to protect me. So, let me."

His touch lowered, dragging along his collarbones before finding the fabric of his tie. Without being asked and without any warning, Phainon began to unravel its knot slowly.

"You shouldn't push yourself too much. You'll burn out," he was told. "I already made you do more than I should have, and we saw how that went. You freaked out. You felt terrible for days. A mistake made in repetition stops being a mistake and becomes a choice, and I won't let us *choose* to put you through that again."

Phainon bit down on the inside of his lip, chewing it deeply as he remembered the drop he experienced.

He was terrified that all his worries would actualize, that after the kindness and comfort given to him became unexciting, Mydei would be like those cruel men he saw online. The redness in his skin and the tenderness of his chest was so foreign, and the fact Mydei *wanted* him to feel that way because he *enjoyed* seeing him like that scared him a little bit. It was too new and too much at once, something he didn't realize until *after* all the pleasure subsided and left him sore, dirty, and cold. Never had he felt his head so detached from both his body and reality.

Leaving him to rest by himself and offering to leave him alone made him afraid that he opened himself up to be discarded by the person he cared about most. To brush him off so quickly made him insecure of his place. It made him want to lash out to gather some kind of reaction that proved Mydei cared, that he wasn't just another person in his bed.

But he didn't know what it would be like, and Mydei didn't think he'd drop so hard. Between not knowing each other's bodies well and pushing the boundaries too far, they had an *accident*. They made a *mistake*.

“You couldn’t have known how badly I’d react after all the hormones wore off,” he defended them both. “What we did then was more intense than anything I’ve ever done, but *this* doesn’t feel scary. This feels like helping my best friend, so don’t deny me this. Don’t deny me a chance to help the person closest to me.”

“Phainon, listen to me,” he slowed his words down and hardened his gaze. “You don’t need to do this.”

“I *want* to,” he stressed, trying to keep his voice steady and calm despite their disagreement. “You want me to take care of myself, and I understand that. You’re worried about pushing me too far, and I appreciate that. But *this* feels more natural than anything we’ve done so far.”

Mydei’s jaw tightened as he finished unraveling his tie and balancing out the tails.

“Phainon, I’m serious. Don’t say things like that to me.”

“Mydei, I am too,” he said back. “What kind of a man would I be to stand here watching you hurt but do nothing about it? What kind of a best friend would I be?”

For a moment, it looked as if his best friend wanted to say something back, but he didn’t. There was no witty retort. He had no argument to fight back with.

“Please just… tilt your chin up and allow me to be there for you. I can’t stand seeing you upset,” he requested when the silence stretched on, touching his buttoned collar next.

But Mydei didn’t budge, too busy searching his face for something to use against him.

He hummed, growing just a little bit annoyed by his continued resistance. “Please, *master?*” He tried again.

That seemed to work.

His head tilted back slightly, giving him enough room to unbutton the shirt he had on. Every night, he had four buttons opened up while in the comfort of his own home, so he counted each one silently while undressing him.

On the first button, he felt Mydei’s eyes continuing to stare down at him, taking in his every movement. They watched his face. They raked over his hair and lips, moving in the outer edges of his focused vision.

On the second button, he heard him breathe in deep and slow like he had earlier. His hands felt the fill and deflate of his chest, and he smelled the bitter alcohol off of his lips.

As he worked the third one open, two hands reached to settle over the smallest part of his waist, holding him tightly beneath the halves of his zip-up hoodie. Not thinking much of it, he pinched the fourth button and eased it from the slit in his shirt. This one had a slight fray in its stitching, and it peeked from the design in its button.

The moment his hands pulled away, a push sent him stumbling back.

Stiff metal smacked into his shoulders and upper back, and a quiet grunt fell from his lips. Discomfort pinched his eyebrows together, and worry immediately bloomed inside of his chest from the rattling behind him. The last thing he wanted was something to spill or break inside of his refrigerator, especially when he was so proud of his entire apartment being spotless.

“What the hell—”

“Silence,” he cut him off sharply. “You can’t say all of that and expect me *not* to react. Do you have any idea what words and actions like that will do to a guy like me? Do you get what you just said?”

Pawing hands pulled him to his body, jerking it from the surface he just collided with. They circled around his torso, scratching into his black t-shirt and fisting the cotton just before his shoulders blades.

“Mydei, I was just being honest.”

An echoed pounding filled his ears, but he wasn’t quite sure if it was from knocking his head back or the rush of his racing heart. Rhythmic and quick, all signs pointed to the latter.

Phainon let himself be grappled at and wrapped around, accepting the desperate touch silently. Head to the refrigerator, he let Mydei duck into his neck and wrap his arms around his body like he owned every inch of it. One of his own hands pulled him in by the belt loops of his slacks, easing their hips together so their thighs touched as well.

“Don’t call me that. Not right now,” he demanded quietly. “Don’t undress me on your own and offer up all of your control just to call me ‘*Mydei*’ as if you’re anyone else in the world. You know what you should call me when we’re together, so say it. Call me by the name only *I* get to have, and show me you meant what you said. Show me that serving me comes naturally to you. After all, that’s *exactly* what came out of your mouth.”

Nose to choker, his best friend buried himself into his body as if he didn’t want to be seen at all, as if he were ashamed of somehow being looked at. The anger. The frustration. The desperation. He let it show, but he didn’t want to be *seen* wearing it.

And Phainon understood. It was nerve wracking to feel vulnerable. It felt like being naked even when fully clothed, stripped apart even when standing in one piece, and sitting on your knees even when on your feet.

For that, he pulled his hood up with his opposite hand, tilted his head back, and let the deep purple fabric hang over his eyes. Those fingers then held the back of his head, threading upwards through the long strands to cradle him close.

“Yes, master,” he obeyed. “Take what you need from me. I’m here for you.”

He was held tighter, so tight it felt like his ribs could crack and lungs could pop, but it didn’t hurt. Neither did his back or head after that initial throb of surprise. None of it was scary, and not a single part of him wanted to change a thing in that moment.

Phainon closed his eyes as he let Mydei ground himself within his body, thinking silently to himself.

Was this what it was like when he pulled him in before? The roles were usually reversed. It was *his* nose buried into Mydei's collar to breathe in his scent, and it was *his* emotions laid out between them to be read like a book. *He* was the emotional one. *He* was the one struggling to keep up.

It didn't necessarily feel good to stand here. There wasn't much peace in knowing his best friend bottled his things up and struggled with accepting care in return. Phainon didn't get any rush of power for being the one *comforting* rather than being the one *comforted*.

But he felt a little bit understood, like Mydei got a glimpse into the mess it felt like to be so transparent with things he never thought about sharing. After all, it was hard. It was scary.

"I want you to call me by that name until Cyrene shows up," he mumbled into his collar. "I don't want to hear my name, I want to hear '*master*'."

"Can you look at me while you say that please?"

Slowly, one of the hands on his body lifted and moved. It planted flat to the refrigerator behind him, forearm angled by his head to lean into his personal space. The rose on his cheeks was prevalent, just like the tear and swell in his lip from chewing on it.

"I need to hear you call me '*master*'," he said instead, looking directly into his eyes. "I need you to do it until your roommate gets back."

Before, he said he '*wanted*' it. Now, he was saying he '*needed*' it. That made him wonder what the difference was.

"Can you do that? Can you be my good boy?"

But now was probably not the time to ask, was it? That could be a conversation for a later time. Right now, all he wanted to do was help Mydei feel better.

His hand slid from his hair to his cheek as he hummed lightly, cupping his haw. "Yes, master. I'll be good," he promised him.

"Good."

They stayed like that for a moment longer, looking at one another as if the silence would make it easier to gauge what the other person was thinking.

Maybe Mydei could see that he'd do anything if it would cheer him up, from following any order to calling him whatever he preferred. If he asked him to sit and talk, he would take a seat and try to strike an unending conversation. If he wanted him to help him cook, he would wash his hands and start prepping whatever he brought. If he wanted music, a podcast, or some television show for background noise, he'd grab his tablet and prop it up on its stand.

Maybe he could see that Mydei really, *really* needed this from him to feel better about something. Be it his rough day at work, his sudden outburst, or their minor disagreement, it was clear this was how he wanted to calm down. And that was fine. He could do it.

They pulled apart, and his eyes shifted to look behind Mydei and at the counter.

“What are we doing first, master?” Phainon asked gently, following him a few steps forwards. “What’s the schedule for tonight?”

Mydei pushed his sleeves higher, then surveyed his surroundings. After watching him for so long, he knew his best friend was assessing the space and mapping out what he planned to do. He looked along the cleared out counters, over the stove where a metal pan sat, and then around to him since he was still in front of the refrigerator.

“I’m going to cook pasta for dinner and make a peach cake for dessert. I remember her saying something about peaches, so I brought a couple,” he said clearly, firmly, and Phainon nodded. “You’re going to bring me what I need and help keep this space clean and organized. I don’t want music. I don’t want unnecessary talking. I just want to cook, bake, and focus. *If* you want to talk, we can do it *after*.”

“Are we starting the cake first?”

“Yes. I need to prepare the peaches, then it needs time to bake. Dinner won’t take as long as that,” he explained. “Phainon, empty the bags.”

He nodded, slipping between his body and the counter. “Yes, master,” he returned.

“And open the balcony window. It’s going to get hot, and heat makes people easily irritable,” he advised. “Let’s nip that in the bud.”

“Yes, master.”

Mydei breathed in deeply, loudly, then exhaled before nodding. Without a word, he began to grab what he needed to start the dessert. As he did his thing, Phainon looked down at the food in front of him. Though they were taken out of the paper grocery bags, they were still in their plastic wraps and produce bags.

While helping him through the prepwork and cleaning up the messes made, Phainon made sure to ask permission for anything as well. Even if he typically didn’t need to, he asked. If he wanted to check his phone to see if Cyrene texted him, he made sure to ask when the counters were clean and he didn’t need assistance. If he had to use the bathroom, he asked if he could slip away for a minute or two.

Whatever the answer was, he obeyed. No back talk. No teasing. No questions. It wasn’t the time for any of that and he knew it—not that Mydei would deny him the chance to relieve himself. He just felt the urge to give him that ‘*choice*’.

And if Mydei told him to move out of his way, he stepped aside to a place where he wasn’t headed. When he asked for a clean knife or specific seasoning left out of reach, it was in his

hands within seconds.

If Mydei decided to grasp the strings of his hood and pull him into his body for a silent hug every so often, Phainon welcomed him with open arms. He let him stay, cheek to his shoulder, and decompress for a second before he went back to silently cooking.

The scent of chili, garlic, and shrimp soon flooded his kitchen, and while he wasn't the one to put most of his effort into the dish, he was proud. Watching Mydei smile down at the deep-walled pan and glass cake platter made his heart feel so full that it threatened to spill from the gaps in his ribs.

"Do you want to try the pasta?"

Phainon was so good that he didn't even try to sneak any bits and pieces, nor did he bother to ask. To be offered a bite made him giddy.

"Yes, master," he beamed happily, closing the space between them.

Mydei spun a clean fork into a spoon, gathering a bite of pasta for him before forking through one of the shrimp. With it, he carefully raised both utensils towards his mouth.

"It's hot. Blow on it," he instructed him, and he lightly blew a few times before dropping his jaw. "Tell me if it's under-seasoned or too salty."

Phainon shook his head quickly, humming positively. "Mm… Mm-mm!"

"Swallow then speak. I can't understand you," he mused, watching him chew with a fond tilt of the lip. "You've got a little bit of—"

Before he could try to wipe his mouth with the sleeve of his hoodie, Mydei set the utensils down. He pinched his chin between his thumb and index finger after, holding him firmly in place. His gaze was raised and tilted to the bright lights above them for a better look.

The pad of his thumb stretched to swipe where the end of a noodle had touched his bottom lip, cleaning the rosy sauce from his skin. It dragged slowly, gently. Their eyes never left one another's, not even for a moment.

As of now, he couldn't tell if it was the chili oil he made or the brush of contact that left his mouth tingling and numb.

Mydei raised his thumb to his own mouth, then licked the mess instead of washing it away. With a satisfied hum, he chuckled. "That's delicious. We make a good team."

Phainon nodded in agreement, stunned into silence.

'*Team*'.

Cooking with Mydei tonight was essentially him doing clean up and fumbling around to find pots, pans, strainers, and lost ingredients, but he let him have that. After all, he'd rather see

that pleased look on his face rather than the hurt from earlier. Confidence and comfort looked best on him.

Soon, the sound of keys jingling filled the apartment, and they both turned around as the lock on his front door twisted. Vaguely, he could hear a muffled chant through the wood, the voice nearly begging for something. And when it opened up fully, the words became more coherent.

“Please be my apartment. Please be my—oh! It is!” A happy, pitched voice practically squealed.

Phainon perked up, and he wiped his mouth with his sleeve anyway before rushing to the front door.

“It smelled so good outside, and I’m starving!” His other best friend’s voice cried. “Phainon! I missed your cooking so much!”

A blur of pink and white ran towards him faster than he could even comprehend, closing the gap between them in a blink. As their bodies collided, he groaned softly and grappled on to the wall beside him for stability. His other hand then held between her shoulders, lowered just enough that he touched the back of her tank-top rather than rosy skin.

Cyrene’s arms slipped beneath his hoodie, holding him tightly while rocking back and forth. With her face pushed into his chest, he couldn't help but rest his chin on her head.

“You missed my cooking but not me?” He pouted, and she nodded quickly while laughing. “Because I missed you, ‘rene. If the feeling’s not mutual, then—”

“I was just kidding! Don’t be like that!”

He grinned, eyes closing as their swaying stilled to a stop.

“My parents wanted you to come with me,” she said into his chest, half of the words muffled. “We all missed you, Phainon. That place hasn't changed much since we last visited, and our initials are still carved into that old tree—the one with the swing, remember?”

“I remember,” he sighed softly, thinking about that old rickety swing his mom swore would never break on them. Would it still be able to hold his weight now that he had put on more?

Suddenly, their third party’s voice jumped in, and he snapped his eyes open to look back at the other man. He peeked awkwardly at them both, one hand on the wall and the other settled over his hip.

“Everything is ready if you’d like to come sit down and eat,” Mydei informed her, his voice much more stoic than it had been twenty minutes ago. “Phainon and I prepared a meal for you.”

“You didn’t have to do all that,” Cyrene waved her hand at him. “But thank you very much, Mydei. It smells delicious, and I can’t wait to try it all. Come here. How have you been?”

Her body pulled away from him, and he chuckled as she went to give his other friend a hug as well. Though it wasn't one nearly as close and intimate, she still gave him a small shake side to side before pulling away.

"Welcome back," Mydei said to her. "I'm doing alright, and you?"

"I'm good! I might be a little bit tired and my hair feels weird from the salt water, but it's nothing yummy food and a shower can't fix," she mused. "Sorry I look like a mess. I wasn't expecting people here, just Phainon."

Phainon rolled his eyes. "Do you know what a '*surprise*' means…?"

"The girls aren't hiding around here either, are they? Oh, I missed Cassie and Cipher so much, but I'm not ready for an apartment full of people," she told them both honestly. "We should go out some Friday night when I am ready for everyone though. All of us."

"Maybe," he said just to tease her and watch her pout. "I might have plans *without* you next. Who knows?"

"Don't be rude," Mydei chided, a playful air to voice that masked the demand beneath. "Besides being tiresome, how was your drive otherwise? Tell us all about it."

"Oh, I *never* want to drive there again! Everyone was right when they said the plane is cheaper and faster," she huffed, ignoring the dining table to head straight to the kitchen bar. "But road trips are just so much fun! You don't get to stop and smell the roses on a plane… just stuffy, stale air and body odor. *Ugh*. No thank you."

"Here." Phainon grasped the head of a pink plushie off of the dining table, then set it in front of her on the counter. "This is for you. Say '*thank you*' to m… Mydei for being so considerate—a gift *and* a meal? He really rolled out the red carpet for you."

Mydei's eyes shifted to him, and he felt the stare for a moment as the nature of his potential slip up settled between them.

He had to be so, *so* careful of not exposing them both now. The last thing they needed was Cyrene knowing they were messing around with each other, especially to *this* degree.

"Oh, Mydei, she's so cute. How did you know I liked My Melody and plushies?"

"I pay attention," he said simply, and Phainon stifled his laugh over the real reason he learned about the characters. "I hope you like it."

"I love it. You have to remind me again why you're single," Cyrene sighed dreamily while taking the toy into her hands. "You can cook well, you have a good-paying job, you're super kind, and you're handsome. What girl isn't trying to scoop you up?"

"Keep it in your pants. He's not a girl, so you'll be disappointed when his clothes come off," Phainon joked, but she just harped on about how lucky his future girlfriend would be.

Phainon knew she was right too.

If Mydei dated casually, or if he simply wanted to try a relationship without his series of rules and regulations, he'd be so popular. On top of what Cyrene had said about him, Mydei was also very patient and articulate when he wanted to be. Things were hard to slip past him, and if they did, it was only because he allowed it to. It'd be easy to see that he was someone comforting and safe after his cool exterior melted away.

But the thought of another man genuinely fawning over him and catching his attention made his stomach feel… strange. Thinking about his stagnant love life while they were tangled up in this arrangement made him uneasy, as he must have also been popular in his own respective community. After all, he wasn't the only submissive he has ever had. There were others—*guys he never even met*—who had been all over him before.

He could be with any guy he wanted if they weren't doing this, couldn't he? Yet he chose to be loyal to him, to this temporary thing they had.

That made him both proud *and* guilty.

"I don't have the time for relationships," Mydei said simply, vaguely, leaving no room for her to suspect anything. He also didn't bother to correct her '*girlfriend*' comment—something he let everyone just assume unless they asked him personally for his preference. "I'm very busy."

"Well, thank you for finding the time to get this for me then," she gushed, holding the Sanrio toy to her chest while looking at him. "I love her. I'm going to sit her in my bed next to all of the others, and I'll treasure it forever."

He nodded curtly. "It reminds me of you—pink."

"Two pink girls against the world, huh?" She asked the plush toy cutely, then wiggled its arms wildly. "'*Yeah, Cyrene! We'll be the cutest duo!*'"

Mydei rolled his eyes over the childish gesture, and Phainon glanced at the matching white plush meant for him. He had hardly acknowledged it, and Mydei didn't push him to. All he did was set it down, let him know it was there, then leave it alone.

"De says I look like this guy too," he brought up, and Cyrene looked over at him as he held the toy by his head.

"Yeah," she agreed almost immediately, looking between them both. "You're kinda like a dog, Phainon—in the cutest way possible! I mean, you even walk around collared all the time!"

He laughed, examining the Cinnamoroll plush before petting its soft, fluffy head. "Collared is a bit much. It's a choker, Cyrene," he protested.

His collar was much, *much* heavier than this old thing, not that he could say that. Not that she could know that.

“It could be a dog collar,” she teased. “You look as if Reaver was a human. Are you sure you’re not a big Samoyed disguised as a man? I can even imagine the furry little ears on top of your head—*how cute!*”

From behind her turned body, he could see where Mydei’s lip was tilted downwards into a frown from the conversation at hand. His eyes were on her, like he wanted to speak out on it but was holding himself back from doing so.

“I’m not a dog,” he denounced, still keeping his voice light. “Sorry, Cyrene. And if I was, you’d have to pay the safety deposit, you know.”

“To keep you? I would,” she played along. “I’d buy you the cutest little blue collar with hearts all over it.”

Mydei’s frown lifted. His lips pursed together before flicking his heavy gaze over to him silently.

If he had to physically *hide* his distaste, that must have meant this was beginning to *stop* sounding like a joke, right?

He cringed lightly, chuckling awkwardly over her poking and teasing. “Let’s not do that… I don’t want that, ‘rene.”

After carrying the weight of Mydei’s collar, the idea of anyone else trying to do that to him made his stomach churn and skin crawl. Joke or not, fetish or not, there was no one he could ever imagine showing that side of him.

“What a senseless conversation. Let’s just eat,” Mydei brought up suddenly, and Cyrene nodded in agreement before tucking her plush into her lap. “Would you like a glass of wine to unwind?”

“We have wine?” She gasped, then looked over to the other man. “When did we keep so much alcohol in the house? I’d love a glass, thank you!”

“This was an old gift I kept,” he answered. “I figured it’d serve as a nice surprise for you both, and it pairs well with this meal. Phainon, where are—”

“I got—”

“Sit,” Phainon hushed Cyrene, holding his arm out to keep her in her seat and rushing to help. “You spent all day driving, and I bet you just want to rest. Relax, we’ve got it.”

She eased back into her barstool, watching them both as he grabbed one glass for her from his cabinet.

“Grab two,” Mydei said just loud enough for the two of them to hear.

The intention was so well hidden between the words he spoke, that it took him a moment to realize what he meant by it. At first, he was confused, wondering why Mydei would want

both a glass of wine *and* his whiskey. But that wasn't the case, right? If it was, he wouldn't have been so quiet.

Upon realization, his cheeks warmed, and two glasses then filled his hand.

In other words, not only was he *allowed* to drink with them tonight, but Mydei was *telling* him to at least try it.

"Okay," he whispered back. "You're the culinary genius, so you know best, *chef*."

Mydei hummed, swaying when he was gently nudged by his shoulder. "I just enjoy cooking," he brushed off, then nudged him back with a little more force.

"Anything else you need, *chef?*"

"Is this how you behave at work?" He shot back, looking over to him knowingly while holding a deep bowl. "Bring the bottle to your *table*."

Phainon's jaw dropped over the reference to his job, and he bumped him with his hip even harder when walking past him.

"Whoops, behind you," he mouthed off, feeling the lingering glare when he gently placed two glasses at the kitchen bar Cyrene was sitting at. "Your wine, *ma'am*."

A singular pink eyebrow raised as he twisted the cap off, and he grinned before flicking his gaze towards Mydei's stern expression briefly. It was clearly telling him to watch himself, and he was. Because someone else was here, he was trying to be good and playful at the same time.

"If you need anything, be sure to let me know," he told her. Once he looked away from him, his right eye dropped into a playful wink for the woman in front of him. "This bottle is on the house tonight, courtesy of *Chef Mydei*."

Her eyes rolled, and she waved her hand at him before accepting the full glass. "You two are so weird. Do you always need to be so petty?"

"'*Petty*'?" He gasped, feigning offence. "I am not '*petty*'! I'm simply doing what I do best—*serving*."

"Go '*serve*' Mydei," she hushed. "Don't make our guest do everything all by himself! Where are your manners? Auntie raised you better."

"I'm fine," Mydei promised, and Phainon grabbed his best friend's half-empty glass of whiskey before setting it by the seat.

Three plates were handed out, and their glasses were filled with their respective drinks. As he and Mydei stood side by side, they looked to the empty spot beside Cyrene.

The actual dinner table itself was free, but it was simply not being used except to sit their matching plushies. She was already sitting at the bar, and that was where the two of them

usually ate together anyway. It would be a hassle to move everything over when she was already comfortable in her seat, and one single person eating alone would look sad. He didn't want to be him, and he couldn't stand to see either of his friends feel like a third wheel.

"Go sit." He nudged Mydei with his elbow, then nodded to the stool beside his drink. "I have a lot of energy, so I'd like to stand."

"You stood all day," he argued.

"I'll be okay," he brushed his concern off. "Besides, I need a little longer to tell if Cyrene's red from the wine or from being sunburned… I want to see her face to face. Can you look this way?"

Two hands covered her face immediately, hiding away the rosy flush that warmed her skin ear to ear and across the nose. "The sunscreen wore off on my drive, and I forgot to reapply it, okay? Leave me alone!"

"I guess you don't need to wear blush when you go out for the next few days. It's almost natural looking," he joked, making her cry quietly about how silly she must look. "Go sit down, *Chef Mydei*. You're still a guest here, so relax a bit and enjoy the fruits of our labor. I won't accept any other answer, you know."

He walked silently, taking the stool for himself without another protest.

"Mydei, I can feel your leg shaking the floor," Cyrene commented, still hiding her face but turning to his direction. "Are you okay?"

"I'm fine." The response was short, sweet, and just like him. She didn't seem to notice.

Maybe it was the hands on her face that hid the glint inside of his eyes from her, or the fact she wasn't as close to him as he was, but Phainon heard it. He saw it. He *felt* it.

"We should eat," Phainon told them both sweetly, and Mydei straightened his posture before grabbing his glass. "Before the alcohol hits an empty stomach."

"Uh-oh… You're right," Cyrene mumbled. "All I've eaten is candy and chips…"

"You should take better care of yourself and your body," Mydei brought up casually. "No one else is going to do it for you."

"Yeah yeah…" She sighed. "I'm just really forgetful sometimes. And my mom tried feeding me lunch, but I hate driving long distances on a full stomach."

He shrugged lightly. "That's no excuse."

"I know."

Phainon felt heat creep over his neck as he looked away from them.

That was an interesting thing to hear come from his mouth after coming to terms with the fact Mydei wanted to take care of him. Healthy meals, planned outfits, and glasses of water for him to drink regularly, Mydei *personally* made sure he had all the things he needed while around. When he was too sleepy to stand, he pushed him to work out. After long showers and hot baths, he reminded him to moisturize and put lotion on to take care of his skin.

Even as friends, he bought him groceries and fixed him a meal if he was hungry. It wasn't just out of courtesy either. Those gestures were of his own concern for his well-being.

Yet to anyone else around him, it was, '*no one else is going to do it for you*' and '*that's no excuse*'.

"Are you feeling alright? You're red," Mydei pointed out, looking at him attentively. "Are you suddenly sunburned as well?"

"Shut up," he mumbled. "It's really hot in the kitchen."

Mydei wasn't convinced, but he had no reason to be. Phainon was a liar, and it was obvious to everyone in the room. Even Cyrene, who glanced at him and giggled over the sight of his rosy face.

"Red's a nice color on you," she noticed. "But seriously, why are you red? Do you like watching me get bullied *that* much?"

"You're fun to tease." Her eyes rolled at that. "Now, say '*thank you*' to—"

"*Oh my*—zip up his slacks when you're done with it!" She gasped, cutting him off and making his cheeks even redder as he reminded of that. "Thank you for the food, Mydei, but Phainon's being obnoxious with it."

"Ignore him." Mydei rolled his eyes as well over the comments being thrown around. "Tell us about your trip. How is the ocean and the wheat fields this time of year?"

"So nice! I spent so much time just enjoying the docks and feeling like a little girl again. We used to skip so many stones and throw so many bottles into it," she sighed dreamily. "This vacation gave me all the creative energy to work on some new stories."

Mydei smiled lightly. "That's good to hear. What are some ideas you came up with while out? I'd like to hear if you're willing to share."

Phainon, unable to stop himself, smiled as he listened to Cyrene begin to ramble on about all the ideas she had. Beside her, his best friend listened intently, completely engaged in the conversation.

It made his chest so unbelievably warm to know Mydei would go out of his way to be there for not just him, but for the people closest to him. Even after a busy day at work, even when he was having a terrible evening, he *still* made an effort to be kind and give her his full attention.

Him and Cyrene weren't close. They met only when he was there to bridge them both together, and it was like that all their lives. Yet he came, he brought her gifts, and he treated her like she was one of his own close friends.

But, that was just like him, wasn't it? He didn't show up anywhere without an invitation, but if asked to be there, he was never late, always supportive, and ready to give his all. Whether he needed to or not, it didn't matter. He was always willing to go out of his way if he cared enough.

It was so sweet. *Mydei* was so sweet.

His heart gave a throb, and he hummed quietly to himself as he took a sip of his wine, waiting for the right moment to jump into their conversation.

—

The first to turn in that night was Cyrene. Between her long day, a belly full of food, and a few too many glasses of wine, she left all her bags and suitcases in the living room before crashing into her bed.

He wasn't even sure if she took her outside clothes and shoes off, but that would be a problem for *morning* Cyrene. And maybe him too, as she would probably complain that he should have reminded her—not that she would have listened if he did. When she was tired, there was no way to make her do anything but sleep.

That left him and Mydei alone, and he nervously shut the door to his bedroom after they cleaned up and changed into their pajama clothes. The space suddenly felt smaller, hotter, and much, *much* more intimate than it ever did while sharing it with him. After all, he wasn't here often, and his room was much smaller than Mydei's was. He couldn't just walk off to a walk-in closet or bathroom, just to one end of the room or out the door.

"It's cold," Mydei commented, looking around while crossing his arms over his chest. "Sleeping with the window open at night will make you sick."

"It gets a little warm in here," he defended himself, trying not to notice the way his arms looked in that borrowed long sleeve. "Do you want me to close it?"

"No, it'll get hotter sleeping in the same bed," he said casually. "That *is* your plan, isn't it? Bringing me in here, shutting all the lights off out there, and locking your door means you never planned on letting me take the couch. You decided I'd sleep in here with you."

A sheepish smile tugged on his lips over the accusatory statement, and Phainon took a step back when Mydei took a step forward. With those deep, amber eyes on him like a predator staring down its prey, he felt his palms begin to sweat.

"*Maybe*…" He dragged out, then gasped when his bed hit the back of his legs. "Mydei, wait. Wait, I'm gonna—!"

They both tumbled on to his bed, and he laughed quietly while looking up at him. Both arms were raised above his head, the lower half of his body was bent off of the bed, and Mydei was hovering over him with one knee between his legs.

"Shh, you're gonna wake her up," Mydei grinned back at him, forcing him to nod quickly in return and seal his lips shut. "And call me by the *right* name since it's just us two."

"*Master*."

"There you go." Shivers tickled up his spine from the smooth, encouraging tone. "That's what I want to hear from you."

Phainon's belly tingled while watching him, warmth pooling within it the longer they stayed like this. Their eyes were locked together, personal bubbles merged into one protective shield around them. Two toned hair fell over his face, blocking everything around him out with its sunset veil. It left only Mydei there.

"You smell like whiskey," he murmured, and Mydei shrugged.

His eyes were the same color too, tinted a warm caramel-color that beckoned him to fall in and drown within them. Half-lidded from exhaustion and a night of catching up, they stared down at him like it gave him energy to stay up.

"I had more than I should have while we all enjoyed ourselves," he agreed quietly. "Do you have an alarm set for the morning?"

"Six, like always," he promised, feeling as the hand beside his head raised slowly. Its indent into his mattress proved as much. "Are you excited to see the kitties? I don't have a view like yours, but it's a nice neighborhood to lap around and admire. The park nearby has a nice little creek that runs through it, and a pretty pond with a fountain full of ducks."

"I haven't seen those cats in awhile. I bet they miss you when you stay the night at my place," Mydei teased. "Who else takes care of them?"

"I don't know. Maybe the people in the apartment they stay next to."

Soon, hot fingertips tickled over the bare flesh of his right arm. They lightly trailed above the elbow and teased the muscle of his forearm, curling around slowly to grasp beneath it. Goosebumps bubbled underneath the touch.

"Master, what a-are you doing?" Phainon's voice was breathy but quiet, nervous yet excited, all at once.

Mydei's fingers cupped his wrist firmly. His thumb stretched to nab the second, bringing them side by side before he closed his fist. They were pinned to the mattress as he leaned closer over him, leaving him unable to touch him or push him away.

Phainon exhaled shakily, shifting beneath him as his heartbeat picked up. Even if he could break free, if he knew it was possible to leave his grasp, it still left him with an air of vulnerability.

“I want to thank you for earlier,” he brought up, contradicting the dominating hold he had on his body. “You did something that made me feel better, and you did it all on your own. There was no way for you to know what I needed, but you took a shot in the dark and hit right where you needed to. Whether that was blind luck or an educated guess, I’m not sure, but it doesn’t matter to me.”

Oh. *That* was what this was about.

Their moment in his kitchen, when he willingly offered for Mydei to take whatever he needed and gave him all the time he wanted to hold him close, had slipped his mind completely over the night. Not that it wasn’t important, just that he wasn’t sure if there was a reason to bring it up again or dwell on it. That topic was sensitive, *clearly*, and he would rather not upset him.

“Thank you, Phainon,” Mydei said gently. “Thank you for letting me complain for a little while, and thank you for letting me come down with you. I appreciate it.”

“You’re welcome, master,” he returned in that same tone. “I’m here for you too, so come to me if you feel upset. You do so much, and you deserve to have your needs and wants met.”

Phainon wiggled his arms beneath his grasp out of pure instinct rather than to fight it, and he shifted his hips to a more comfortable position.

“Can I… hug you tonight?” He asked suddenly, tightening his grasp on his wrists. “Can I hold you instead of sleeping back to back like we usually do?”

His heart skipped for a second as the words echoed inside of his head. They bounced around for a moment, bringing heat to his face and a flutter inside of his stomach.

Like… *cuddle?* Mydei wanted to *cuddle* with him in bed as they slept together?

“Can you?” He teased him in an attempt to combat the rush underneath his skin. “Are you *asking* for permission?”

There was a sick sense of amusement within him when Mydei’s eyes widened slightly over his mocking tone. They then dropped down to his mouth slowly, watching them grin and move to form his next words.

He didn’t… mind the idea. Besides, his bed was probably too small to comfortably sleep the way they did anyways. They’d risk falling off if they tried to keep any space between their turned backs.

Well, no. *Mydei* would risk falling off, considering his bed was tucked into a corner in his bedroom. Without a partner, he never needed both ends of his bed for two people to move in

and out of freely. That meant Mydei would be the one to fall off, as he preferred sleeping by the wall where he could charge his phone.

“Can you *please* hold me tonight, master?” Phainon asked him instead, rewording the simple statement. “And can I *please* sleep by the wall?”

“Yes, I can,” he answered. “And yes, you may.”

He pulled away from him almost immediately. The hold on his hands was raised, and his knee eased away from the mattress. With a flick of a switch, the lights shut off, and Phainon stared at where his best friend had just been standing. Though his eyes hadn’t adjusted yet, it was as if he could feel him staring back.

“Bedtime,” Mydei told him, and he shifted away from his position to meet his pillows. “Come here.”

Springs creaked underneath the added weight, and his bed dipped in when Mydei sat on the edge. The sound of a phone touching his nightstand followed, then the bright light of an illuminated screen flashed. Right beside his own phone, Mydei had plugged his in, and he stared at them both sharing the wooden surface before glancing at him.

The light soon flickered off, and he turned around as the bed creaked again. With an arm under his pillow, he faced the wall, nose ticked by the ivory plush Mydei had gotten him. It smelled like a kid’s store, like most synthetic stuffed toys usually did, but a hint of Mydei’s cologne lingered.

He could imagine Mydei holding it in line, pressing it to his chest and unknowingly rubbing off on it as he waited to pay. Maybe because this character reminded him of him. Maybe because he had his hands busy with other things.

Phainon pulled it closer, draped his arm around its middle, then grinned.

“Grown man with a toy,” he teased himself, then felt a presence behind him as the sheets and blankets were pulled higher.

It wasn’t new. The feeling of Mydei sliding into bed and covering them both wasn’t something ground breaking or abnormal. Neither was the rocking or the bouncing. But the proximity was. His body lined so closely that his breathing hitched sharply and suddenly, caught in his lungs.

Mydei’s arm stretched underneath his own pillow, but it curved towards his own to brush. A faint tickle of breath batted against the back of his neck, telling him his face was close but not that close. Not enough to feel the heat directly or the point of his nose close in on him.

“How does this make you feel?” He asked him, laying his arm down over his waist slowly, lightly, like he was nervous of crushing him.

Phainon was pulled closer. His tailbone pressed firmly to the hips behind him. Eyes still, lips parted for a breath that never came, he laid there inside of Mydei’s hold for a moment. Then,

for two.

In the quiet, he wondered if the sound of his pounding heart could somehow echo through the room.

“I’m okay,” he whispered back.

“What about this?”

His arm shifted, easing around his waist loosely while slowly inching higher, and higher, and higher. Fingers dipped between him and his plush, along the divot between the mounds of his pecs, then flattened out against his collarbones. With a push, it forced his back to the other man’s chest next. Like this, their entire torsos were touching, bodies separating only when his legs curled at the knees while Mydei’s stayed relatively relaxed.

“Green,” he murmured, and Mydei hummed softly.

“Lift your chin. Pull your shoulders down and relax,” he was instructed, and Phainon obeyed.

The second be opened himself up, Mydei brought his hand higher, and he gasped over the feeling.

“I got you,” he promised, not squeezing, not gripping, and not pushing. His palm simply laid hot to the bottom of his throat, fingers curled loose around the column. "I want a color.”

They laid like that for a moment, Mydei’s hand gingerly holding his neck and his arm pressed firmly to his chest. He was engulfed fully within him, warmed by his body and the layers of sheets and blankets. Despite being in his own room and using his own bedding, he could smell the familiar comfort of Mydei’s skin.

He willed his body to relax, to sink into his touch and grow accustomed not just to cuddling but to having his neck held.

“Yes, master,” he said back to him. “Green.”

“Very well. Goodnight, my prince. Have sweet dreams,” he mumbled from behind him, and Phainon gulped before pulling his plush closer.

“Goodnight, master,” he returned, eyes focusing on the textured wall across from him. “I’ll see you in the morning.”

There was an intimidating tingle where his best friend’s fingerprints sat on the sides of his throat, one that was both scary and exciting all at once. Both emotions tangled inside of his stomach tightly, twisting and knotting into something too daunting to try and decipher at the hour. His body has learned to get tired at this time, and he could feel it dull the confusion within him.

Did he *like* Mydei’s hand around his neck? Did he *like* being held on to so completely?

He didn’t know, but that could be a problem for *morning* Phainon, not this one.

—

When waking up, they carefully dressed up and slipped out of the apartment, trying not to disturb the girl snoring away next door.

Phainon rubbed his eye sleepily, half of a bagel in his mouth while Mydei had already finished the other half. His feet dragged across the entrance to his apartment, but the other man practically took two steps at once to warm up at the base of the staircase.

It was always like this. He was the tired one from being up at the chilling crack of dawn, and Mydei was always ready as if this was the absolute highlight of his day. Never had he known someone who loved working out and exercising as much as he did. But today he seemed even more energized.

A deep breath filled his lungs, one so crisp and cool that it burned a little bit going down. The sun was still rising, tangerine shades of orange bleeding into the pale blue morning sky. Clouds dusted in sparse, faint puffs. A singular plane flew in the distance, a darkened speck leaving behind the faintest trail behind.

Underneath it all, Mydei's arms stretched high and tall above his head. Fingers interlocked, he sucked a shaky breath in through his nose, allowing it to fill his body for a few moments before he exhaled. His borrowed shirt had ridden up, exposing the crimson bolts around his hips that stretched to his back and the dimpled base of his spine. Gold and crimson stared back at him hauntingly, the sliver enough to make his heart race despite only climbing down the stairs.

Dragging his gaze higher, he watched his ponytail swing side to side, back and forth. Its lowest lock kissed his shirt's collar, and on one side, it was braided tightly. Both whipped when he turned around, throwing a look over his shoulder.

"Wake up, sleeping beauty," he goaded him, a glint sparkling within his amber eyes. "We don't have all morning. Pick up your feet."

"Mm…"

Phainon joined him in warming up, half-ass'ing his stretches in favor of finishing his early-morning snack. Only after he wiped his mouth with the navy band around his left wrist did he start to put his all into it.

"What's your usual route?" Mydei asked, and he looked towards the gate before raising his hand.

"Take a right, cross the street to the neighborhood, then I go around to the park behind," he explained, pointing as if he could understand. "I'll do it a few times, then circle around the complex a few times."

“Before we leave, I want to see *them*.”

Phainon laughed, and he followed Mydei towards the visitor’s spot he parked at. The lights on his charcoal-colored two-seater flickered, its locks opening up with an echo.

He watched him tear a piece of a cardboard box, then grabbed two metal tins before ripping the lids off.

“You came prepared,” he noticed.

“I always do.”

The makeshift tray was handed to him, and he took it without question to support it. Mydei dumped the food on top carefully. Both cans were cleared out as much as possible, then he grabbed a small paper bowl from a fresh pack sitting inside the same bag. It was filled with water soon after, then carefully set on the floor so it didn't spill.

“I don’t want my car to smell like cat food, so I’m going to tie these up and throw them out at the dumpster before we go,” he said. “Hold this. Don’t go without me.”

“I won’t,” he promised.

Phainon watched him rush towards the dumpster not too far away, each step faster than he would have normally. As he did so, his attention looked down to the bowl. Steady fingers picked it up, holding both the tray and water while waiting patiently.

When Mydei came back, he shot him a wobbled grin. Dark, blond eyebrows furrowed over the look.

“What?” He asked. “Why do you have that look on your face right now?”

“Have I ever told you that you’re a really good person?” He asked out of nowhere, and Mydei went quiet for a moment. “You treating Cyrene like she’s one of your good friends and going out of your way for a bunch of strays around here is… so incredibly kind of you.”

It was cute too, but he didn’t want to say that out loud.

“It’s courtesy,” he defended himself. “She’s someone closest to you, so of course I should be courteous towards her, and you always take care of the people who need it. In this case, homeless cats who are probably starving.”

“It’s all very sweet.”

“Just show me where they are,” he huffed.

Phainon carried the cardboard tray while nodding at him to follow, aware of his rosy face but choosing not to tease him for it.

They walked quietly along the paved sidewalk, then across the street towards a large mailbox. Behind the wall was a long bush, and parked off to the side of it sat an old car with

holes in its bumper and sun-faded stickers.

Squatting down, he tapped his fingers against the uplift in the curb while watching, already noticing the leaves rustle. Mydei bent down beside him too, setting the paper bowl down as two peeked from the bush. When another poked its head from beneath the car, he jumped, staring wide eyed at the orange animal looking up at him.

“Oh, hello, little one…” He greeted it, one hand carefully reaching out for the curious animal. “You’re so fat… How did you hide inside of that car? Does Phainon feed you too much when he’s home?”

“Hey,” he pouted, then chuckled as content purring and soft meows filled the morning air. “I’m not responsible for his weight. I’m not the only one here that takes care of them.”

The smallest one clawed at his bar knee, using it to stand up right on its hind legs, and the third went face first towards the food.

“Hi there, did you miss me?” He asked, voice pitched higher as he lightly petted its head. “Oh, you’re so pretty, girl. Look at those eyes… I missed you too.”

“You’re dirty,” Mydei protested, letting his fingers trail from head to back against the chubby animal beside him. Then, he picked it up casually. “Eat.”

He placed it by the other, and Phainon laughed quietly before guiding the kitten beside them both.

“Yeah? You wanna join them too, little girl? C’mon. My master bought all of this for you guys because he’s so sweet and thoughtful,” he coo’ed when it meow’ed loudly, eating happily through the pitched sound. “*Nom nom nom*, you’re gonna be a chubby little thing just like daddy, huh? Look at you…”

“Phainon.”

“Yes, master?” He hummed, turned to look at his best friend as he stopped petting the cat. “Should we go now? Are we already behind on our schedule?”

Another silent moment passed, and he shook his head before tilting his lip up higher.

“You’re an idiot," he teased him, a gentle glint in his eye from the sunlight catching them. “That baby voice is so stupid sounding. Do you talk like that often?”

He frowned, feigning offense. “Don’t be so mean! *What?* Do I talk to it the way I talk to you?”

Phainon lightly pushed him while straightening himself out, causing Mydei to stumble in his bent over state as he hadn’t expected the sudden shove. His shoes scraped against the street as he fell, and his hand slammed on to the floor to keep himself from falling.

Watching him made him laugh, especially since his cheeks were even darker from the embarrassment of slipping. “I am so sorry. Th-That was an accident, I swear. I didn’t think

you'd be so easy to knock over," he apologized through the giggles.

"You should run," Mydei warned him, and that was when Phainon noticed the gate that was squeaking open for a car to pass by. "If I catch you, I'm going to punish you for pushing me into this person's rust bucket."

"Oh?" He pressed, leaning forward while offering a hand out for him. "And what will my master do to me?"

"*When*, not *if*, I get my hands on you, I'll cuff your hands behind your back the next time you come over," he warned him with a hushed voice, and a rush filled his stomach when his hand was pushed away. "You have five seconds to run. *One*."

Not wanting to waste a single one, he took a step around his still-crouching figure before dodging the incoming car.

"*Two*."

"I'm running left," he called behind him, finding Mydei was watching him walk away with a grin on his lips.

Clearly, his best friend wasn't upset, just feeling more playful in nature. Otherwise, he probably would have gotten scolded for being so careless of his surroundings.

"*Three!*"

Mydei was already standing up, and his eyes widened before he turned back around and began jogging away from him.

"*Four!*"

The countdown hadn't hit the last number, but he swore he was already hearing his shoes hit the pavement as he chased after him. Even if it was to catch the closing gate before it sealed him off, how was that fair? The extra seconds of putting in his code wouldn't have been *that* big of an advantage.

Phainon laughed, picking up his pace since he saw the sidewalk was completely empty. He didn't have to worry about running into anyone, and that gave him even more confidence.

The street separated three ways, one with a free crosswalk counting down for pedestrians, the other still orange for cars to pass, and then a simple left turn around his apartment complex to loop around it. His end was coming up fast, and he had maybe five seconds to make a choice.

The first one straight ahead guaranteed his safety, as Mydei would have to wait to cross the street once the timer was up. It also led straight towards a gas station and a few small fast food places, which meant more people could see them. He didn't want to think about what strangers would think of two grown men running after each other on the sidewalk—even *if* they were in workout clothes.

The second one towards the right gave Mydei an obvious advantage, leaving him to wait for the light to turn his way and risk getting grabbed in turn. It technically was the *right* way to go, too, as it led towards another housing community and the accompanying park. *That* was where they were supposed to go.

The last one left them both in a comfortable spot to chase one another a little while longer because they could follow it around the complex. It would deviate them from the plan, but a run was *still* a run, wasn't it? Their hearts were *still* pumping. Their legs were *still* moving. This was *still* a workout.

Phainon stopped, looked in all three directions, then behind him where his best friend was chasing him. Mydei was already gaining on him from his short stop at the light, ponytail swinging and bangs bouncing with every step.

With a smile over his shoulder, he turned left, wanting to continue their little game for a little while longer.

No matter who won in the end, at least this was *fun*.

Chapter End Notes

i want to write more kinky moments between them, but phai's so tender and not used to things that i feel bad including them sometimes. like im perving on my own doll that i created. like i think of it, then im like "oh he would drop so bad" LOL

i want to write mydei getting to choke him because hes always touching his neck and holding his throat. i think it could be so sweet and scary and comforting to phainon to explore that with him as its equal parts "pain" and "pleasure". maybe i will.

i have a few kinks in mind for them to explore already and im excited for it

Chapter 9: Chapter Nine

Chapter Notes

> phainon is such a good boy. i wanna hold his cheeks and kiss his nose and tell him that hes doing amazing. not that mydei doesnt already do it.
>
> and mydei cares so much about him. he just wants to see him prosper and be a good person and feel comfortable and confident in his own skin. he should be told hes doing good too.
>
> please enjoy this soft chapter!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

With Cyrene home, it was a little bit harder to find excuses to stay over at Mydei's place and do what they usually did.

Visiting was one thing. He could go when given a time, see him for a little bit after work like they used to, but now someone was at home wondering where he was, what he was doing, and who he was with. Though he wasn't obligated to tell her, and he knew it was just for curiosity's sake rather than to be over-protective, having to think up excuses was difficult. Lying was hard for him to do on its own, adding in the fact she was always honest around him only made it more difficult.

But he couldn't just tell her their secret. Not only did he promise Mydei to keep his preferred lifestyle quiet, but this was something no one could know about him too. If people were to find out about this part of him, this side that enjoyed being Mydei's '*good boy*' and liked being owned like his *property*, it would be the end of the world. He could never show his face again.

He wanted to see Mydei though. He really, *really* wanted to keep doing what they were doing.

While on break with one of his co-workers, that was all he could think about. It plagued his thoughts while taking orders, when in the bathroom on his phone to escape the rush, and even now.

How could he hold on to their secret without letting Cyrene grow suspicious?

His back was pressed to the wall of the restaurant as he contemplated, and beside him, a woman he vaguely recognized was squatting down having a cigarette. The scent was chokingly strong, and if he could be bothered to look for somewhere else to stand, he would. But he couldn't be. He was too deep in thought.

Could he really keep pretending he and Mydei didn't have something going on? That the only reason he visited so much was because they were just *such* good friends?

Should he try to pretend that Mydei needed him for personal business? Lying on a man known for his blatant and blunt honesty didn't seem right though. Not only would he make himself out to look bad, but his best friend would be dragged down by it too. Tarnishing *his* look wouldn't be right.

In the midst of his thinking, a monotonous yet quiet voice spoke up, disrupting their silence.

"Your name is Phainon, right?"

His gaze dropped to the only other person out here, surprised that he was being acknowledged right now. "Yeah, that's me," he returned, and she looked up at him. "What's up?"

He never noticed her much. She blended into the background well, simply doing her job and then leaving right away—not that he blamed her for that. From what he knew, she worked at the bar. And while he would grab a drink or two from her for a table, it wasn't nearly often enough to remember her name, how long she was there, or anything past her general appearance.

But now that he got a chance to really look at her, she was pretty. The kind of pretty that could probably bring someone to their knees.

Her eyes looked like the ocean back at home, comforting and gentle in the way they beckoned someone to take a dive. Dark hair framed her face and hung over her thin eyebrows, but a chunk was tucked back thanks to a few ivory clips. A pearl earring sat beneath her ear on that same side, heavy and bright underneath the setting sun. It swung loosely when she shifted.

"Don't look at me like that," she said, holding her cigarette by her face to block it from sight. "Your puppy dog face is making it hard to talk to you."

"Huh?"

"How old are you, kid?" She asked him suddenly, and his eyebrows furrowed. "You look… young, but you can't be that young if you're working here, right?"

'*Kid*'? How old was *she?*

"You're awfully straightforward," he chuckled awkwardly, not wanting to tell this stranger his business so quickly. "Isn't it rude to shamelessly ask someone their age like that?"

"I'm twenty-eight," she said casually instead as if she didn't hear him. After, her fingers twitched to flick the ash off of the tip of her cigarette. "Everyone else here is graying or a bit stuck up from the reputation of this place, so… I thought I'd take a chance and ask you."

Phainon's head tilted slightly in confusion.

This whole time she had been talking about confronting him for something, but she wasn't explaining anything to him. The vagueness and suddenness of it all was becoming a little bit unsettling, even if she didn't look particularly suspicious. What kind of person just approached someone like this?

"For *what*, exactly? What do you need to ask me?"

They weren't friends, and they weren't even coworkers who pretended to be friends while on the clock. What did *he* have that *she* needed?

"Tell me you're not fresh out of high school first."

"I'm not that much younger," he mused, but she shivered as if the thought of him being a teenager disgusted her. "Would you like to see my ID for proof?"

"I don't need to know when you turn twenty-one or what height you rounded up to." Her hand waved him off. "I'm being pushed to do something I don't usually do. I thought you could help me, but I'd rather not get tangled up with some eighteen year old out of desperation."

Phainon could scream, laugh, and groan in frustration, but the one thing he couldn't imagine doing was straight up *walking away*. Even if he probably should.

"Well, I've been twenty-one for a while now, and I *am* over six-foot," he promised, just a little bit offended by her accusation. Did he look like someone who lied about something as stupid as his height?

But that seemed to be good enough for her.

The next thing she did was sigh as if resigned, as if *she* were being forced to have this conversation with *him*, but *he* was the one who didn't even know *her* name. Not a syllable came to mind.

"My wife thinks I need friends," she disclosed, not sounding the littlest bit joking. "I'm wondering if you could help me make her happy."

Phainon had to physically bite his tongue to keep from laughing at her confession. Thankfully, she had her eyes fixated to the ground because one look was all it would take to see how close he was to just letting it out. Had he been any less surprised by the nature of her request, maybe he would have been in stitches by now.

"Wait." She hesitated for a moment, a rush to her still-monotonous words. "You're not one of those people who hate like… *you know*… right? I can talk about my wife?"

"Oh, of course not."

"Wait. I *can't* talk about my…?"

He really, *really* wanted to laugh at her.

“No, I meant that I’m not one of those people. You can. You can talk about her,” he allowed, and a breath of relief left her lips. “What were you saying about your wife? She uh… She thinks you need friends, and *I’m* the person you chose to ask?”

A large part of this was amusing because no one had ever admitted that to him before. No one just took a space right next to him out of nowhere, sat in silence for a moment just existing together, and straight up asked to be friends because they had none. Usually people talked about something they had in common, waited until they enjoyed the conversation, then decided from there if they could be friends. It wasn’t just a ‘*yes*’ or ‘*no*’ question right off the bat.

But another part of him felt a little bit bad as he watched her shoulders slightly curl inwards from his words. Two fingers played with her pierced ear, rolling the lobe around slowly, and her other hand kept that burnt down cigarette to her lips.

Clearly, this was an uncomfortable conversation for her to have.

Now, he felt bad for wanting to laugh at her at all.

“I’m… kind of new in town…?” She admitted to him. “All I’ve done since we moved here is work, stay in the house, or go out with her. She’s demanding I try to make friends, but it’s… hard as an adult. The only people I see regularly are here at work, otherwise, they’re all just strangers I’ll never meet again. It’s all so confusing. It makes me anxious.”

Phainon’s lip twitched downwards.

Well, now he felt even *worse* for wanting to laugh at her.

“She says it’s not healthy to only talk to one person, but I can’t find anyone to approach. You seemed like someone nice though,” she complimented him. “Sorry. I’m really not good at this. Is that weird to say to someone you don’t know?”

“It’s okay. I’m glad you think I’m nice! That’s what I’d like for people who don’t know me to think.” She looked back up at him, eyes still gentle but unsure, and he offered her a soft smile while holding out his hand. “Let’s start a friendship the right way. I’m Phainon, and I like just about everything you can think of—sports, superheroes, sleeping, and everything else.”

The fingers playing with her earring paused, and she reached for his hand tentatively before shaking it.

“Hysilens,” she told him. "I like… my wife, and music.”

“Yeah? What’s your favorite genre?” He asked, shaking her hand firmly. “I like all kinds. I’m not the biggest fan of like… death metal and things like that, but I can appreciate a good song if one comes up.”

“I like all kinds of music.” Her lip tilted upwards into a soft smile, becoming more confident in their conversation. “If it has a nice sound, I’ll listen to it or learn it. I rarely find a song I don’t like.”

“Ah, does that mean you can play an instrument?”

Hysilens nodded, and he pulled his hand back to check his watch. “I play the violin the most, but I own much more. I also sing.”

A smoker that sang didn’t sound like a good combination to him, but he wasn’t going to judge her anymore than he already had. She seemed too nice for such cruelty.

“Our break ended a few minutes ago… We should go before we get yelled at,” he chuckled, watching as she then stood up to stomp out her cigarette. “Let’s continue this talk over the phone later. Here, give me your number, and you can go home and tell your wife that you now have a friend from work.”

She nodded excitedly, eyes lighting up at the mention of pleasing her.

“Thank you.”

He shrugged, slipping his phone out of his pocket to hurriedly create a contact for her. She watched from beside him, hands tucked behind her back with her feet rocking back and forth.

“Don’t mention it. I’m happy to help where I can,” he reassured her kindly. “I love making new friends too.”

—

When visiting Mydei that night, the first thing he did was hand the other man his phone because of how often it was lighting up. Texts from Cyrene and Hysilens took up a majority of his notification bar, and it was distracting him. One was rambling that it was good he and Mydei were working on their ‘*competitive pettiness*’, and the other was filling his messages with music recommendations for him to listen to when he had the time.

Both were kind, and he liked talking to them. Neither of the girls were the person he wanted to focus on right now, though.

The second thing he did was undress as he was told to, then hop into the shower to clean up. Mydei left him with clothes to wear, as he always did to make his evening just a little bit smoother. A pair of black lounging shorts and a white t-shirt were folded on top of the bathroom counter, and beside them both were his collar and a pair of familiar cuffs. But they didn’t have that same lengthy chain connecting them. Instead, his gear was hooked together with one much shorter, leaving very little space in between.

The set was nerve wracking to look at.

Standing in the bathroom, he stared at the bondage equipment laid out before him for a moment. Memories of his own rosy wrists flashed inside of his mind, then the clinking of chains when he had struggled against them futilely. Being locked down to the bed was both

thrilling and terrifying, and feeling Mydei's hands on his vulnerable body was more pleasurable than he anticipated.

Phainon wanted them on. He wanted to try it again to see what it'd feel like now that he was a little bit more comfortable in this all.

But thinking of the handcuffs made him think of the nipple clamps too. Those hurt in a way he had never felt before, and they pinched so much tighter than a pair of fingers ever could. He was right in saying Mydei's suggestion made him want to try something scary, but Mydei had been well within his rights to assume he would like them too. He did it to himself, and he allowed him to do it too. Why *wouldn't* he come to that conclusion?

Maybe they would have been okay if they weren't tightened down or paired with any kind of pulling. Maybe if he wore them for a shorter amount of time, he wouldn't have felt so sore after. Maybe there would be a time when they could try them again too… just not tonight.

Phainon turned to the bathroom door, a deep breath filling his lungs as he was pulled open.

"Mydei?"

Without a response, he hummed, then gathered the leather equipment into his arms. Each step came with a light bounce while walking down the hall, and a mix of excitement and nerves tangled within his stomach as he got closer.

"Mydei!" He called, just to find the man sitting on the couch with his phone in hand. Upon meeting his eyes, he grinned. "I mean… Hi, master."

Mydei lifted an eyebrow, then beckoned him closer with a nod.

"Why do you look so happy to be punished?" He mused, setting his phone aside immediately upon seeing him. "You're not supposed to want it, you know. That takes away the '*punishment*' part."

While with him, Phainon learned that there were two different kinds of '*punishment*' to be dealt.

One was, in fact, a '*punishment*' for misbehaving and breaking his rules. Those weren't meant to be comfortable or enjoyable. Being forced to kneel with a leash tying him down was the prime example of that. It was meant to hammer in what he did wrong, to make him realize he wasn't the things he called himself to help him stop feeling that way. And so far, it's helped.

The second kind was more akin to something mildly inconveniencing or reprimanding, like not getting to call Mydei by his name or getting his phone taken away. It got the message across that he did something wrong, but it was a little bit lighter of a sentence since the wrong-doing wasn't nearly as bad. They could even be *fun*.

For getting caught by him in their game of chase, Mydei decided he wanted to put him through the second version of punishment. It was meant to be fun, playful, and just a little bit

of a push towards his boundaries.

Mydei knew that. He knew that. The air in the room knew as it carried a gentle comfort and amusement within it.

"*Oh no*... Please, master. Please don't do it," he feigned terror, earning a low chuckle in return for his dramatic performance. "Please don't handcuff me and touch my helpless body."

"I never said I would *touch* you," he tsk'ed, taking the trio of leather bands from him. "Sit on my lap. Back to me."

Phainon bit down on his bottom lip, and he turned around before allowing himself to sit backwards on Mydei's knees. Both hands held the bones beneath him, drumming over his skin gently.

"You won't?"

For whatever reason, he expected to be touched in some way, and he had come to want it. Knowing it wouldn't happen made him just a little bit disappointed.

"If you want me to, you'll have to ask me," he said simply, making him squirm from having a *choice* being thrusted upon him.

It was easier when Mydei just went in and did it because he wanted to. Saying '*yes*' or '*green*' was easier than admitting that he wanted more from him, and thinking about having to ask to be touched made him antsy. Both guilt and anxiety made it a difficult task, even if they had dwindled down to a fraction of their size since they started this.

"Phainon…" He hummed, head shaking as he turned to look over his shoulder at Mydei. "Bring your arms behind your back. How can I cuff what isn't here?"

Oh. Right. They were in the middle of something.

Phainon brought his wrists behind him comfortably, and he straightened his back out while Mydei touched his body gingerly.

"You are going to be handcuffed while we talk about your day, do you understand?" He checked in. "I won't touch you in any suggestive way unless you ask, *properly*."

"We're just… talking like we usually do?" He repeated quietly, feeling as smooth leather wrapped around one.

"Talking *while* you're handcuffed, since you feel the need to put them on me so carelessly," he hinted at the other morning, and Phainon felt a grin stretch across his face.

"I didn't mean to," he swore, even if his humored tone betrayed him. "But it *was* funny."

Mydei scoffed, the sound quiet and playful. "My brat is going to sit still and take this like a good boy. Don't fight your restraints and make sure to stay calm during this. The moment you begin to think yourself into a bad spot, tell me. Got it?"

He nodded in understanding. “Yes, master.”

“We’re going to share a bowl of fresh fruit, and you’re going to tell me all about your day. When we finish talking, *then* I will uncuff them,” he promised. “If your shoulders get stiff, tell me.”

“I will.”

That sounded a little less intimidating than he anticipated this being.

One by one, Mydei secured the leather handcuffs around his wrists. Fingers slid around his wrists, tucking between the cushion and his skin to make sure it wasn’t too tight. When he pulled experimentally, a light and gentle tap smacked against his arm.

“*Ah ah*. I said not to pull,” came his scolding.

Phainon took a deep breath. “I’m sorry, master.”

“I don’t want you to say sorry,” he shot down, not accepting it. “Why did you pull after I said not to, Phainon? What’s wrong?”

“I wanted to test them,” he admitted sheepishly. “I wanted to see if I was really stuck again, and I am. There’s nowhere to go.”

“Yes. There’s nowhere for you to run, so stay with me.” Mydei’s voice lowered, his tone rich and silky like the night they spent in his office. “Don’t let yourself slip, and don’t let yourself overthink. Stay here, listen to me, and don’t fight.”

Phainon relaxed his arms, his hands fitting into one another despite the chunky cuffs pressing around his wrists. In doing so, two palms then gently reached for the base of his neck, lightly massaging just beneath with firm pinches.

“Give me a color.”

“Green, master,” he answered softly as his head rolled to the side. “Will you put my collar on?”

“You’ve grown to like it, haven’t you?” He noticed. “Is it comforting to know that when you come to my home, I own you entirely?”

His stomach tingled, and the hands on his neck lifted to gently cup his throat within it. Both thumbs stacked over each other top to bottom, and his fingers gently laced over his Adam’s apple. He didn’t threaten to squeeze, and he didn’t dare attempt to tighten. All he did was hold him, gentle and reassuring, like a collar with life in it, a choker with warmth to give, a necklace no one else in the world could have.

“Yeah,” he breathed out, eyes shutting softly to listen to his voice better. “I-I like my collar a lot, master.”

"Do you wish to have a different style?”

“No. I like the colors, the fit, and the… the ring you can pull on for my attention,” he confessed. “I like that it’s *yours*.”

“Good boy,” he praised him, then removed his hands slowly by inching them back down to his shoulders. There, he tightened his grasp. “Shoulders back. Eyes straight. Chin up.”

Phainon fixed his posture, straightening his back and opening his eyes to be more alert. From touching his shoulders to feeling nothing, he waited for those hands to come back with a gift. He waited for the kiss of leather around the middle of his throat, the tightened buckle to squeeze lightly, and that gentle click of metal.

He felt the edge rest over the base of his neck, enclosing around him loosely as Mydei chuckled.

“I used to close it right here,” he reminded him as he looped the end into its buckle. “That’s not what you want now, is it?”

“No, master.”

“What about this?” It tightened a little more, raised a little higher, and he gulped. “Is this enough for you?”

“Please…”

Mydei finally brought it to his Adam’s apple, pulled it enough to sit snugly over him, and he twitched from the pressure. A soft, shaky breath filled the room.

“That’s it,” the man behind him purred, feeding the prong through. “You like it right here, don’t you? Nice and tight, it keeps you from dropping your head too low, doesn’t it? That gives you more of a reason to look up… at… me.”

Phainon’s bound fists rolled, squirming underneath the heat of his husky tone and fixed gaze. Even without looking at him, he felt it.

“Stand for me, handsome.”

His knee swung carefully off of his body the moment those words left his lips, and he stabilized himself on one foot. With the help of Mydei’s warm hands, his other leg followed slowly until he didn’t need the assistance. While standing in front of him, he turned, focusing on his best friend completely.

There it was—that hot look of interest in his burning gaze as he looked him up and down. Despite being clothed, despite wearing just a t-shirt and some shorts, Mydei was lining his figure like he could see *all* of him. Like he wanted to see *all* of him, bound and collared, obeying his every word.

Phainon watched Mydei then grab a half-full bowl of mixed fruit. There was one fork inside of it for two people.

“Come sit down.”

Phainon carefully planted his knee beside his hip and into the couch cushion, lowering himself over his lap as he wanted. When he swayed too far, one hand pressed to the small of his back. It pulled him closer and steadied his body on top of him.

“I could do whatever I wanted with you right now,” He teased him, and a shiver inched up his spine over the familiar words. “You look handsome like this.”

“Master, keep it in your pants,” he teased him. “I’m not doing anything special.”

“All dressed up in leather cuffs and a collar…” He trailed off. “How would you feel about wearing a harness? A strappy chest piece that… Mm… I’m getting ahead of myself, aren’t I?”

Phainon’s eyes glanced down to Mydei’s chest, then as close to his own as the tall trim of his collar allowed. He tried to imagine himself shirtless, to see black leather straps working around his body in any way that could make sense. Tight, warm, hugging him like his collars and cuffs.

“You’re about the same size as I am. You have so many, surely one might look good on me,” he suggested, and Mydei nodded in agreement. “If… you ask me to in the future, I will. But not tonight.”

“Will you?”

“Yes, master.

“What if I bought you one for yourself?” He asked, and his eyes lifted. “No. Don’t take that as an offer or a suggestion. Will you wear it, yes or no?”

Phainon gulped. “I’ll wear it, but—”

“No,” he cut him off. “There are no ‘*but*’s. You listen to me, to your *master*. Don’t worry about money, and don’t think about being spoiled. It’s not your job or responsibility to tell me what to do with *my* paycheck. Now, open your mouth. Let’s change this subject before you get a chance to overthink.”

A slice of apple sat at the end of his raised fork, the crisp fruit positioned directly across from his mouth. When it got there, he wasn’t sure, but it made his belly tingle. He shifted his gaze between the bite and Mydei’s hungry eyes, hot underneath his skin.

“You’re gonna feed me…?”

“Well, I don’t suppose you have the means to do it yourself,” his best friend mocked him, and heat stretched across his face from the jab. “I don’t like to repeat myself. I said, *open*.”

Slowly, Phainon’s wobbled lips parted, allowing himself to be fed the neatly cubed fruit.

“Where shall we start…” Mydei brought up thoughtfully. “Oh. Let’s start with why you let me have control over your phone unprompted. I’m all for limiting your screen usage and staying offline, but tell me, what made you feel as if I needed to take it?”

He chewed slowly, then swallowed. “I wanted to be present for my master,” he answered honestly, hoping that didn’t sound ridiculous of him. “I was in the parking lot on my phone for twenty minutes before I came up. If I kept it on me, then I know I wouldn’t have given you enough attention.”

“What were you doing on your phone that took so much time, Phainon?” He pressed after, curious. “Were you calling someone? Or were you too busy watching videos online to put it down?”

“I made a new friend,” he told him. As he spoke, he shifted his loosened shoulders before gently rotating his wrists. “I was texting her and Cyrene, and I got caught up in doing it.”

A grape crunched under his fork, and his lips parted without being told to. The silent acceptance of the offering made Mydei smile.

“Tell me about her.”

“Her name—”

Suddenly, the fork pressed to his lips, poking at the bottom one enough to indent. “Chew, swallow, then speak. It’s extremely rude to talk with a full mouth,” he was instructed.

“Mm… I’m sorry, master,” he apologized softly, earning another grape. This time, he made sure to finish it before he spoke. “Her name is Hysilens. She’s a bartender at the restaurant I work at.”

Nodding silently, Mydei motioned with his fork for him to continue before he took a bite himself.

“She asked me during my break how old I was, then said her wife was making her make friends since she didn’t have any. I almost laughed right in her face.”

His eyes dropped as a lick of guilt burned inside of him at the memory.

“You should have more shame in admitting something like that to me,” he reprimanded him sharply. “Look at me, Phainon.”

Phainon lifted his attention immediately, meeting his firm gaze and the hint of disappointment within it even if he really didn’t want to. Regret chilled his previously heated veins because he knew he was right to call him out on acting that way, because making him upset made his chest hurt deep. He didn’t do it nearly as often as he used to, and it made him proud.

He was good. He was Mydei’s good boy.

But now, he felt *bad*.

His best friend looked right into his eyes as he spoke. “I can’t believe I have to tell you this, but no submissive of mine, *or* my best friend for that matter, should ever act that way to someone reaching out to them. Where is your compassion for someone in need?”

That guilt built deeper as he curled inwards to try and make himself smaller.

“I know. I shouldn’t have thought that way, and I’m sorry I did, master,” Phainon agreed, accepting his scolding. “But I didn’t let it out, I promise.”

“Some people struggle with talking to new people. Is that something to laugh at them for?”

“No, master. I’m sorry. It’s not funny. I wouldn’t want someone laughing at me if I was being open with my feelings, so I shouldn’t have thought like that,” he apologized again. “That was insensitive of me.”

Mydei brought his free hand to his chin, and he pinched his cheeks.

“You’re a good person, Phainon. I know awkward situations make you want to laugh, but there’s a time and place, okay?” He said gently, careful of his tone. “I don’t want you to keep apologizing to me. Just do better for the friend you nearly ridiculed. She deserves a friend who won’t think badly of her.”

“I’m doing my best,” he swore, words rushed to get out and hopefully appease his disappointment. “That’s why I was texting her so much. I-I wanted to make up for it because she’s actually very sweet. In fact, I’d like her to meet Cyrene sometime! Maybe they can be friends too.”

“Tell me about this woman,” Mydei instructed him. After he spoke, he let go of his face.

“She seems very shy, and she has a wife who works at a law firm around here,” he answered, recalling the things they texted about. “They just moved here a few months ago, but all she does is work, listen to music, and stay home.”

“Good on her partner for realizing that’s unhealthy and pushing her to do something about it,” he commented. “Everyone wants their partner to be the best version of themselves.”

“Her wife reminds me a little of you,” he chuckled, and a dark blond eyebrow raised upwards. “She tells her to make friends if she wants her to keep paying for her online subscriptions, to spend more time outside, and to wear certain things. I know that last one because I saw one of her social media pages, and she’s always wearing some kind of skirt or dress. She said her wife liked her in them.”

Mydei did that for him all the time, pushing him to dress nicer, rewarding him with nice things when he did something well, and wanting to spend time together at his home. Texts were nice when they couldn’t meet up, and calls were okay too, but nothing beat being right beside him. A ‘*goodnight*’ text was not nearly as satisfying as saying it to him from the same bed.

His best friend hummed curiously. “Does she?”

“She speaks highly of her. It’s cute,” Phainon gushed, thinking back to the couple photos he remembered of them playing around the ocean or posing at the top of mountains. “They’re cute. Do you want to see them?”

“If you feel up to showing me, then yes. But knowing so much about someone without ever meeting them feels… strange. Is it really okay to share so much about her behind her back?” He wondered. “Aren’t you sharing too much without consideration for her feelings?”

Phainon’s eyes rolled over his comment. “You and Cyrene don’t count with rules like that. I tell you both everything since you two are my best friends. Please open my phone, master.”

Besides, Hysilens surely wouldn’t mind. It wasn’t as if he were slandering her. All he’s done is praise her.

“Cyrene and I *are* your closest friends…” Mydei repeated as he reached to grab his phone from the couch cushion beside them. Upon seeing his passcode, his head tilted. “Is this password Cyrene’s birthday? What is it?”

“What? No. It’s my mom’s birthday,” he grinned proudly. “Because hers is mine, it felt fair.”

Mydei then typed the numbers in swiftly, and Phainon’s eyes widened over just how easily he seemed to remember it. Not that he didn’t know Gorgo’s birthday, but the year and month were easy for him. The exact day always escaped him.

“You really remember that?”

Maybe he should remember Gorgo’s entire birthday if Mydei remembered his mom’s…

“I remember when your family invited me to a barbecue for her birthday, and I bit into dirt because *someone* didn’t clean a radish well,” he told him simply, making him cringe at the memory. “I didn’t trust raw food from you for months.”

Embarrassment burned inside of his cheeks as he thought back to the day as well. “Garden to table… literally,” Phainon murmured, earning a chuckle in return.

His messages were opened without any delay, and Mydei placed the bowl away from them to make some room. Phainon took that as a chance to lean into his body. Arms still tucked behind his back, he awkwardly inched himself closer and moved either knee to a more comfortable position. This allowed for his chest to press to the bottom of his, and his cheek to rest against his collarbones.

One arm wrapped around him, coaxing his back to arch in by pressing a few fingers to his spine. The collar he was resting on rocked for a second as Mydei found a comfortable spot, and he guided his head beneath his chin to wrap around him completely. With fingers lightly tickling up and down his bound arms and a chin on his head, Phainon took a deep breath and looked back at the screen.

“I’ve got you,” his best friend said gently. “Are you comfortable like this?”

“Yes, master.”

Though his neck felt a little stiff, he could smell his warm scent of body-wash and the detergent he used. He could feel every breath that pushed against his body, and the comfort of being taken care of while deprived of his ability to move his hands.

“Good… It looks like you guys talked a lot for just meeting officially today,” Mydei commented, scrolling upwards slowly as he read through the texts. “Are you two best friends already too?”

“I um… felt bad for being so mean, so I wanted to make it up to her by helping her make her wife happy,” he explained to him. “I’ll have to respond now that she saw me opening these, though. Can I—”

“No. Your hands stay tied,” he cut him off, making him nod quietly. “I will send whatever you want to say. Just tell me.”

That sounded reasonable enough to him. He *was* still being punished.

“Yes, master,” he agreed, resting comfortably into his body. “You can text her for me. Whatever I have to say isn’t something that needs to be hidden.”

“Good boy.”

The link to her page was soon found in their venture through the ever-changing conversation, and when Mydei clicked on it, his breathing seemed to hitch quietly. While staring at the photos displayed for him, his thumb hovered over the screen, frozen. The reaction was so quiet that he might have missed it had his body not been so close.

“A-And you said… she’s your coworker?”

“Yeah,” he answered casually, watching as Mydei scrolled slowly through her privated account. “She and her wife are pretty, right? They have a little matching jewelry thing going on too. Hysilens wears this one pearl earring, and her wife has a pearl necklace.”

They had their wedding rings too, and the rock on Hysilens’ was extravagant, but even *that* was sometimes missing.

“Mm…”

“Do you know them? What’s with your reaction?” He wondered, watching as he clicked a close up of Hysilens’ pearl earring and how it lit up underneath the golden sun.

‘*to new dawns. to new horizons. to new experiences with you in front of me.*’

It was cute.

“She must be talking about her wife,” Phainon hummed, and when Mydei swiped, sure enough, it was the shorter woman cradling her face beneath that same setting sun. “She loves her so much. It’s all she talks about besides music.”

“That is very sweet,” Mydei said quietly, swiping back to the earring before staring at it. “I thought I recognized them, but I must be mistaken.”

“Please tell her I’m headed to bed, and I’ll listen to those songs in the morning,” he requested, pushing closer to him as his eyes shut.

He listened to the keys being tapped, then the sound of a message sending.

“How was your day, master?” He asked after, curious. “How was work? What did you eat for lunch? I ate a chicken club.”

“I took one of my meal preps,” he answered, planting his opposite hand over the back of his head. In gentle and slow traces, his fingers raked through his hair. “Sweet potatoes and chicken.”

“Mm… sounds good.”

“Work was okay. Father was less annoying than usual,” Mydei shared with him. “He was too busy actually working to bother with pestering me. Thankfully.”

Phainon smiled. “So it was a good day?”

“It’s a better night,” he settled on. “Something interesting did come in though…”

“Hm?”

“Someone’s day collar showed up. It’s with my jewelry as we speak,” he said, and Phainon wiggled in his hold to sit up. “Stay still. Let me talk.”

His body stopped, and he opened his eyes while looking down at his clothed chest.

“I have it, and I will give it to you in the morning before you leave,” Mydei promised. “But you won’t be able to take it off, okay? I’m going to lock it, so once it goes on, only I can take it off.”

It sounded intimidating, like it could become overwhelming if he was already overstimulated.

A necklace he couldn’t take off himself without destroying it sounded downright suffocating, but it also made his stomach airy and giddy. After all, they made it together. The length, the design, the material, they picked it to withstand his usual day-to-day activities. It was *theirs*, and there wasn’t another one like it around.

“The point of it being locked is that you remember you’re mine even when I’m not around,” he reminded him softly, still playing with his hair. “Do you think you can handle that?”

“If I can’t…?”

His shoulders lightly shrugged. “Well, there’s no harm in *not* wearing it. Not every submissive has to do this, and it’s not usually done so early. But you wanted *me*, and you wanted what *I* liked. I *like* submission all the time. I *like* my submissives collared all the time.”

Phainon’s hands twitched when he grabbed the chain between them, holding it to keep his wrists by his tailbone.

“I won’t make you, but I’d like for you to allow me the pleasure of collaring you semi-permanently.”

“I want to make you happy,” he said honestly. “I want to hear you praise me, reward me, and keep teaching me all these scary, exciting things. Without your push, I’d never do any of this.”

“What do you want for yourself?” Mydei took the chance to ask him. “Is this something you want for yourself? Do you want to be collared all day, every day?”

Did he? Did he want to wear that necklace every second of the day?

Phainon knew what it symbolized. He knew what it was for. Maybe he didn’t understand it as well as someone who practiced this for years, but he knew enough about it.

More than just reminding him that he belonged to Mydei, didn’t it also serve as a reminder that he was *committed* to being his? That no matter what he did, where he went, or who he was with, he would do his best to serve him as his submissive? Wasn’t it a promise that he would behave accordingly, adhere to all the rules laid upon him, and submit himself until the end?

Like his conversation with Hysilens. He would need to consider what Mydei would want of him—which was to be compassionate and kind. When he got dressed, too, if it wasn’t picked out for him, he would need to think about what Mydei liked to see him in—darker colors and more fitted clothing.

That was his role. *That* was his part to play.

Play…

Phainon turned his head, hiding deeper into Mydei’s collar.

No, it wouldn’t be ‘*playing*’. It wouldn't *come off*. Not like his collar now that he slipped in and out of, which helped him differentiate his *outside* personality from his *inside* one. Outside, he could be independent. He could do his thing then come back to Mydei and change into something a little more subservient inside of their homes. Inside, he was honest to a fault and devoted to serving him in any way. Sometimes he mouthed off, but it wasn’t nearly as much, or as badly, as being out in the open.

Mydei wanted *that* commitment, submission, and devotion *all of the time*.

“Do you like this, Phainon?” He asked suddenly, his voice calm yet firm. “Do I make this enjoyable for you?”

“Yes, master,” he answered immediately.

“How?” He pressed. “Look at me. Poise yourself. I want a proper answer.”

His body was guided back, and he took a deep breath before looking into his eyes.

“What is it that you enjoy about this arrangement, Phainon? I won’t let you wear that collar unless you convince me that you can take it,” he insisted.

Phainon felt his hands touch his arms, holding him gently as his back straightened out and his head raised.

“I enjoy seeing you happy,” he started off with. “ I look at you, and I wanna help you, follow you, and explore with you. Those terrible things I felt haven’t gone away completely, but you make it better with how hard you try for me. You make me wanna try harder, be open-minded, and be *good*.”

Mydei’s hands trailed up and down his arms slowly, soothingly. Fingers tickled over his skin as if to calm him before any bad feelings started.

“I wanna keep coming back here to you, master. Even if it might end badly when we try things, I know you’ll be there. Even if I drop, or lash out, or get consumed by self-guilt, you’re there, and you make it better,” Phainon confessed, feeling his touch lift to his shoulders.

They squeezed around his biceps, then curled around his shoulders to pinch gently.

“Is it safe here with me?”

“Yes, master,” he exhaled shakily. “I’ve never been anywhere so out of my comfort zone, but I’ve also never felt safer than I do when I’m with you.”

Mydei touched his collarbones next, rubbing along the bones with his thumbs slowly.

“I enjoy watching you grow more comfortable in this,” he shared with him, giving him back that same transparency and honesty. “I like seeing you open up to submission as something *safe* rather than something *degrading*, Phainon. Sharing this part of me with you, and watching you indulge so happily and eagerly makes me… happy.”

From his collarbones to his jaw, his hands cupped his face gently while sitting up straighter.

“I want to help you explore more, Phainon. Tell me anything you want, and as your dominant, I will give it to you,” he promised him.

He was pulled closer, close enough for their noses to brush the hair over their foreheads to press into one another’s.

“If you give me *everything*, I will give you *anything*.”

That sounded like a promise, a vow, like his best friend would sooner die than ever try to go back on it. He could ask for the moon, and somehow, someway, it was going to be in the palm of his hand.

Phainon gulped, eyes dropping down to the mouth inches away from his as breaths fanned over his bottom lip.

“Take it from me,” he allowed, speaking quietly but just as wholeheartedly. “I will tell you when it’s too much, and if I can’t, then I trust you to know when to stop.”

“Then kiss me,” he blurted out, and his heart skipped over the bluntness and the nature of his request.

A moment passed, and Mydei’s eyes slowly widened before he turned away from him. Rose painted his cheeks something violent, something they’ve never been before as long as he’s known him.

“No, I… I didn’t… Fuck. I didn’t mean to… say that,” he apologized quickly, stumbling over his words in the process. “Phainon, forget I said that.”

If he could move his arms, Phainon would grab him by the red-hot face and force him to look at him. Just as he knew if Mydei could walk away from this, he would simply brush the happenstance off and insist it wasn’t a big deal.

But he *couldn’t* touch him with his hands still bound, and he *couldn’t* run away with his helpless body still on his lap.

Phainon leaned towards the direction in which he was looking, tilting his body and head for a glimpse of his attention. When their eyes met, and he parted his lips as if to speak, only to close them upon seeing the way his lip was clenched tight between his teeth. Any harder, maybe he’d tear open the skin and let that honeyed-lemon dressing glistening on his mouth over it.

“I’m sorry.”

“Why?” He asked quietly as Mydei’s head turned to give him an easier angle to look at him. “Why do you feel bad for wanting something so gentle from me?”

A kiss between them would be… okay, right? They’ve cuddled before and seen each other in various states of undress. Mydei’s seen his cock, and he’s had his inside of his mouth before. He’s *swallowed* some of his *cum* before, and his best friend has washed *his cum* off of his hands and clothes before.

To kiss him would be so much easier than any of that when his lips were so close to his own. One tilt and they’d be touching. One inch of space to steal and he’d know what they felt like against his own. And that would be okay, wouldn’t it? Like everything they’ve done, they were *allowed* to do that, weren't they? Because it was *their* business, and no one ever had to know what they did.

“It’s not about it being gentle,” he denounced. “It’s… a purely selfish request.”

“You’re the least greedy person in the world,” he chuckled, not sure of what else to say. “Just one kiss? Is that all you want?”

“Y-Yes. Just one,” he agreed quietly. “We don't need to make it a habit. That’s fine.”

Phainon rolled his eyes playfully, combatting the airy rush beneath his skin. “My master’s shy over a kiss but had been so eager to suck me off before…”

But despite his facade, he was feeling shy too. Mydei’s eyes being so fixated on him made his palms sweat as if he planted the world’s largest spotlight over him. Bathed underneath its light, there was nowhere to hide and nothing left to hide.

“Why don’t you make me kiss you?” He said back, wanting a push forward or a pull towards him. That endless support Mydei offered him best, he wanted it at this moment of uncertainty.

One of the hands on his cheeks lowered, and he gasped when they pulled downwards on his collar.

“Kiss me,” he demanded, and the strict words shot through his body like a jolt of electricity. They awoke every nerve, now sizzling with life and energy.

Phainon leaned forward, eyes slowly inching down the face in front of him before shutting completely. Clear, golden skin was kissed with a deep cherry-hue, and the color had never looked so pretty before.

Mydei’s lips were warm and soft, and he smelled like the fruit they were just sharing—sweet and inviting. Had his lips parted and their tongues met in the middle, he was sure he’d taste exactly the same too. He was positive Mydei would be just as good for him as the healthy snack too.

The hand on his cheek slid higher, brushing beneath his ear before embedding itself within his hair. Thick fingers tangled within the ivory locks, curling to follow the shape of his head before curling deeper to grip loosely. There was no pull or push, just that steady pressure of being held.

Metal jingled when his wrists rolled and fingers twitched, and his body shifted before breaking their kiss.

“Am I still being punished, master?” He asked, keeping his eyes closed so he could continue seeing all the golden and rose-tinted colors behind his eyelids.

“No.”

The hand on his collar reached behind him, but instead of unbuckling the leather, he only unclipped the attached chain. It dropped to the floor loudly, rattling against the wood.

With his newfound freedom, Phainon reached to grab where he felt his hands had been. The loose D-rings of his cuffs lightly clicked when he moved, and the warm leather went from being restraining to feeling like a thick, weighty wristband instead. The intimidation was shredded, and only a light comfort remained.

“One more,” he begged him, cracking his eyes open while gliding his fingers down Mydei’s wrist and forearms. “One more while I can touch you. Please, master.”

Mydei exhaled shakily. His body sat still beneath him, allowing his touch to drag up either bicep slowly and grip his shirt.

“One more,” he agreed, grabbing between his shoulders before pulling him into his body.

Their mouths met again, rougher this time, and Phainon couldn’t help the moan he released. The pressure was dizzying, and the arms around him were so strong in the way they pulled him as close as physically possible. His shirt was pulled, dragging the collar to the right. His hair was gripped, holding him steady in his place.

Even without the chain, he was bound, forced to accept the bruising force of their kiss.

Heavy breaths clouded around them, exhaled and inhaled from the nose because neither wanted to pull away just yet. Not when it felt this nice to be enveloped completely within him.

Mydei’s body hit the back of the couch, forcing him into a slouched position. With it, he pulled him chest to chest.

“Wait… Wait, don’t go yet. Not yet,” he panted out, stealing another kiss from his mouth. This time, he bit down on his bottom lip, peeling it back in an attempt to get him to open his mouth.

Another full body tingle wracked through him, skin bubbling with goosebumps from both the sound of his desperation and the pinch of his teeth.

Phainon’s lips parted. He allowed for the open mouthed kiss, unable to entertain the nerves of being inadequate with the way Mydei was taking it from him. The force came in waves, pushing his head back gently and coaxing him to mimic the movements. As a tongue brushed his, he shivered, not used to the heat, slick, or the notion.

One of his hands dragged down his shoulder, and Mydei groaned quietly when he groped his chest tightly. Fingers dug into the plush muscle, massaging it tightly.

“Did I say you could do that?” He demanded, and Phainon gulped while looking down at him through a half-lidded gaze.

“My master once told me to take as I please with his body,” he recalled, squeezing again. “I wanna touch you.”

“Sneaky brat,” he accused, lips curling into a confident grin. “Fine. You can put your hands on me. In fact, you can have my body whenever you want it, but I won’t be touching you back without you asking me to.”

He squirmed weakly underneath his gaze. “What if I say you can?”

“No.” Mydei stood his ground. “I won’t, and I also won’t let you touch yourself without my permission.”

A shaky and surprised breath left his lips.

That was a rule Mydei wanted to give him from the start but he never quite felt comfortable enough to agree to it. The expectation was a lot of weight to bear. The embarrassment of needing to ask to touch his own body was too much to think about back then, yet the thought now made his skin warm.

Maybe *once* he agreed, but they both knew he hadn't meant it. While doped up on pleasure, pain, and adrenaline, he was just saying things for more attention and praise.

But he wasn't in that same floaty, ditzy headspace. He was coherent. Breathless and a little bit aroused, but coherent nonetheless. And he *offered* it.

Mydei told him not to say things he didn't mean. He told him to be explicit, to say exactly what he meant and never anything else.

When he wanted to try bondage, he needed to specify having his wrists tied down to the bed. When he said that serving him felt natural, he accepted that statement exactly the way it came out. Those times he called himself a dog, he was punished accordingly and leashed to his chair like a pet.

Phainon just told him to take everything from him, and here he was with his eye on a prize that wasn't up for grabs before.

"I'll ask my master for permission to get off," he reassured him, and Mydei's grin widened. "You can have that from me. Put it in the folder."

"Are you sure?" His tone had a warning tilt to it. "That's *a lot* of communication, humility, and obedience. If I find out you lied, I'll punish you."

How could he ask him that while wearing a grin that wide?

"Yes, master," he decided, stomach twisting in nerves and excitement. "I want to try, but if I don't like it, can I take it back…?"

Mydei nodded. "If this becomes a problem we can't come to an agreement on, we will rewrite it as a hard limit. If you find it too much but are willing to keep doing it, we can consider it a soft limit."

There it was, his safety net in all this mess, his comfort amidst this chaos.

"But me touching you is okay?"

"My body is for my submissive and my submissive alone. If I'm in the mood to be touched, it's always open," he purred. "But if you get me riled up, you can't blame me when I sit you on your knees and make you swallow my cock. This is your warning, Phainon."

He thought back to the weight of it on the back of his tongue, the salty taste when he licked around the head, and the stretch of his jaw from taking it in deep. The thick scent of his skin and body wash was so warm. The pulse and throbs of each vein when he was close. The shots of cum right down his throat.

Phainon remembered what he looked like standing above him, abs flexed tight and face washed over with pleasure. The flush of his skin was so handsome, and the hands holding him were so warm.

His hands squeezed his chest again, and Mydei laughed before pulling him closer.

With a lowered voice, he said, “I’m going to teach you how to please me better, and you’re going to show me just how secure you are in taking this step with me.”

“Yes, master,” he agreed. “l’ll say something if I’m not in the mood or don’t like it.

“I expect nothing less from you,” he told him, then leaned to kiss his cheek.

Part of him was disappointed it wasn’t on the lips like before, but a kiss was a kiss, and the cheek was better than none at all.

—

That next morning, as Phainon sat at the kitchen bar with one elbow pressed to the surface, he forked a bite of his scrambled eggs into his mouth. Packed full of vegetables and some cheese, it was definitely not what he would cook himself at almost eight in the morning, but it was what Mydei fed him. With a tall glass of water and a shorter one full of a deep-red pressed juice, he wasn't wanting for anything except company.

“Elbows off when you eat.”

Phainon shifted, sliding his arm back while turning around at the sound of his voice.

“You’re meant to be eating with me," he huffed, feeling as his hot hand slid around his throat.

He took his collar off to go work out every time they went, and while Mydei didn’t inconvenience him with putting it on for the short duration of their shared breakfast, he always slotted his usual choker in place after. It was comforting to him for something to be there. Having his neck bare and exposed felt naked, and he assumed that was how Mydei felt without his everyday jewelry—as he could *feel* his ring against his skin.

“It’s not proper to put your elbows on the table,” he chided, and Phainon hummed.

“This is a counter.”

“Mouthy,” Mydei huffed, tapping the first inch of his fingertips to his cheek before setting an opened velvet box beside him. “I went to grab this. Isn’t it pretty?”

His eyes shifted to it, and when the box tilted towards the sunlight streaming in from his living room windows, a bright sparkle reflected off of the center gem. It was nearly blinding,

yet it was hard to look away from it.

“A pretty day collar for a pretty little prince,” he praised both him and the neck piece. The sunlight danced against it for a little bit longer, then he left it there. “Keep eating. I’m going to put it on while you do.”

“You should be eating with me,” he repeated to him. “You work in a little over an hour, yet you need to eat, finish getting dressed, then get over there.”

“That’s not for you to worry about. I’ll be on time like I always am,” he promised him.

Phainon took another bite of his food while admiring the necklace, unable to redirect his attention.

Tucked into its ivory padding stretched a golden chain thick enough to withstand constant wear but thin enough to not get lost on his body. It wasn’t bulky and eye-catching, but it wasn't something delicate and easy to hide. He wanted *discretion*, and Mydei wanted *ownership*. Their compromise was a four-millimeter wide chain sure to be comfortable but still giving them what they both wanted.

In the middle, attached with an intricately woven bail, hung a small, hollow circle in that same rich gold. It wasn’t any bigger than his thumbprint, and in the middle hung a deep, dark blue, diamond shaped gem. The ring was reminiscent of his home collar, of the submission he promised to give him, and the blue stone simply called out to them.

“Look at me.”

Phainon turned, and he looked at his best friend.

Mydei had already done his hair. The side braid he kept was neatly plaited over one ear, the ends capped in a clean, golden cuff. He smelled of his usual hairspray and deodorant, not having spritzed his cologne on yet since he still needed to finish dressing. His button down was missing. His tie was missing. All he wore was a fitted white tank-top, his usual slacks, and the jewelry he frequented.

While meeting his eyes, he caught the dangle by his ear through the edges of his vision. Gold, like all the things he wore, with a deep-rooted sapphire embedded into the top.

“Can I put it on you?” He asked, and Phainon nodded. “Use your words.”

“Yes, master.”

“Turn around. Don’t move too much.” He instructed him, grabbing the necklace from the box. “There are two keys. One stays in my bedroom and locked in my cabinet at all times. One will sit in my wallet at all times.”

His fingers reached for his glass of juice, and as much as Phainon didn’t see the point in these juices, he raised it to his lips for a drink.

“If it needs to come off, I will unlock it prematurely. Tell me. If an emergency persists and you can’t get a hold of me or make it to my place, well, that isn’t a problem either. You can just cut the lock. I’ll buy a new one,” he explained to him.

“How can I get into your *locked* house to get a key in your *locked* cabinet?” He mused, licking his lips of the bitter juice.

“Easy. I’ve written the code in our folder, and I will be giving you a spare key.”

The glass clicked a little harder than he meant for it to, and he stared down at his plate as cold metal kissed the base of his neck. Due to its shorter chain, there was very little space between his collar and the necklace, allowing it to sit directly above his shirt’s collar. It dangled tightly, enough to not be suffocating but enough to remind him it wasn't *just* for fashion.

“A-A key to your place?”

“If you lose it, you will *not* get another one.”

Fingers fumbled behind him, and he felt the firm press of metal on the back of his neck.

“But I’ll get one?” He asked for confirmation. “I can just… come over whenever I want? Do I need to ask permission to walk in?”

Did he give one of those to all of his submissives when they put on a day collar?

Mydei chuckled, the sound light and amused. “You should warn me first because that’s common courtesy, Phainon. If you text me before you come over, you are free to stay. Whether I see it or not is *my* fault for how often I check my personal phone, not yours.”

“I don’t… know what to say,” he admitted to him, a little bit surprised he would be given access to all of his things.

“Then don’t say a thing. Simply accept it.”

The pressure on his neck soon left, and he looked down at his neck to try and see the necklace on himself.

“Here,” Mydei offered. Within seconds, he picked his phone out of his pocket and swiped to access the camera. “Look at it.”

It sat cleanly and prettily on his shirt, the royal blue stone contrasting brightly against the crisp white fabric. The golden chain matched his neck tattoo too, making it not look out of place on his body.

“Is it too obvious?” He asked quietly, lightly tracing a shaking finger over the ring. “What if someone asks about it? What am I meant to say, De?”

“People have much, much busier lives than to scrutinize the necklace of a man they’ll never see again,” he promised him. “If they somehow don’t, you don’t owe them any explanation. It’s your body, and the only person who can tell you what to wear is *me*.”

His eyes rolled over his possessive words. “Seriously. What do I tell our friends and my family?”

Mydei tilted the camera up, this time to look at him without having him turn around.

“You can tell them it’s just a necklace, that you saw it online and you liked it. If they ask to see it, or if they ask for you to take it off, you can tell them to mind their business,” he said firmly. “If someone gets too pushy, you only need to remind them that you’re entitled to your interests without an explanation.”

That worked for *him*. Mydei liked his peace and his privacy. Everyone knew that and accepted that.

Between how close he was with Cyrene and his parents, things like that didn’t really *fly* so easily. They loved questions, and he loved sharing everything with them. How was he meant to blatantly lie to their faces?

“It’ll be okay,” Mydei hushed as if he could hear his thoughts. “You’re okay.”

He nodded, tilting his head back to look up at him instead of the phone screen. In doing so, his neck stretched, making room for Mydei’s hand to lightly cup beneath his chin to hold him there.

“All you need to do is tell them you liked it. No one is going to jump right to you being my submissive from a singular necklace,” he repeated gently. “If it persists, call me, and we can handle it together, okay? I will talk you down, and I will guide you on what to say.”

“What if you’re busy working?”

“Then I will call you as soon as I physically can, and we’ll talk about what you said and where to go from there,” Mydei told him. “For now, just tell them it’s fashion.”

“Yes, master,” he murmured.

One hand reached upwards, and his fingertips lightly brushed his singular earring.

“We’re matching again,” he pointed out. “First, your gear and my play collar are red and gold. Now, your earring and my day collar are blue and gold. What’s next?”

“Do you hate it?”

Phainon smiled, brushing the back of his ear to toy with his earring's butterfly back.

“I love my collars,” he reassured him. “You could have grabbed anything simple, anything in the standard black that you can find in stores, but you didn’t. You could have been so clinical about this whole thing, but you aren’t. These are *yours*, and seeing *you* in them makes wearing them less daunting.”

“How could I ever treat *you* like someone impersonal?” Mydei traced his thumb over his chin as he spoke. “You’re not just some random man I’ve let into my life or an object to push my

desires on to. If I'm going to do this for you, of course it needs to be catered to *us*. If it's not *me* you see when you close your eyes, then what else would you think of?"

"I… don't know. I don't have any feelings for anyone to imagine them touching me," he chuckled. "Maybe I would see those guys from the videos again…"

"Sex still scares you then, huh?"

"A little bit," he admitted. "Some of the things we've done weren't scary at all, but… I guess the sexual aspect of being dominated is a bit harder to grasp. I… I've never been the kind of person to think much of it with someone, so to have it so suddenly is a bit much. This though?"

The hand not touching Mydei's ear held the wrist beneath his chin, and he smiled when it pressed deeper.

"I like this part," he told him honestly. "I like this… structure, and I've been feeling better as of recently, probably from all the extra sleep, exercising, and healthy meals. My nerves have gotten better too, but that's because you're a very comforting person, Mydei."

"I've always been good at supporting someone else," he agreed. "Maybe after me, you'll like this so much that you'll feel confident enough to join online communities and meet new people. You never know, maybe the reason you couldn't find a partner is because you were looking in the wrong areas."

Phainon shrugged, not caring to think about some nameless, faceless dominant. He couldn't find it in him to conjure someone else up when all he saw was Mydei there with his red and gold collar in hand.

"Maybe."

"Maybe I'll go back and see you getting hounded by all the men and women who want such a handsome and eager to learn sub," he joked, but the thought of other people wanting him like this made his stomach churn. "Have you ever thought of being dominated by a woman?"

"No."

Phainon gripped his wrist tighter as he listened to him continue.

"Maybe you'll like it," his best friend pressed, still holding on to his joke. "What's so bad about a dominant woman? You can call her '*mistress*', or '*mommy*', or—"

"I like my *master*," he cut him off, and Mydei quieted down. "I don't want a '*mistress*'. I don't want a '*sir*' either. I want *my master*."

The sound of a camera's shutter went off, and he grinned softly at the thought of him getting so distracted his finger slipped.

"What a possessive little submissive," Mydei teased him, pulling back his phone to tuck it into his pocket. "You're the one in a collar, but I'm yours, huh?"

Phainon's fingers pinched his ear gently, careful of his jewelry, then smiled. "Please eat with me, master. As you get dressed for work, I'll clean up the kitchen for us so you don't have to do it."

"What a good boy," he said, rubbing his cheek gently. "You've got a stubble growing, by the way. It's scratchy here."

"What? Do you prefer a man with a clean shave?" He mused, and Mydei's eyes darted from his face to his lap. "Hey! My eyes are up here!"

"I think your face is cuter when it's smooth," he said casually, and Phainon made a mental note to shave when he got home. "Don't be nearly as heavy handed with a razor anywhere else though."

"H… Huh?" He choked, and Mydei tapped his cheek again before letting go of him. "What does *that* mean? Like *down there?*"

"Continue eating now, Phainon," he instructed him, ending that conversation. "I'll eat with you."

Mydei sat down beside him. Without him standing behind, he eased his neck lower before looking at his own plate. One hand picked his fork up, and just as he was about to rest his arm on the counter, he paused. Then he set it on his lap.

"Good job," Mydei praised him.

Heat warmed his cheeks, and he took a small bite before glancing at him, noticing that he was already looking.

How was he meant to think of anyone else in his place?

Chapter End Notes

phainon may or may not be dense as a brick to not realize he and mydei are matching like hysilens and cerydra. or why he cant imagine anyone but mydei in that place.

and mydei may be even denser by thinking phainon would consider anyone else other than him. or getting jealous over little things.

also. im now thinking of phainon sending mydei selfies where his collar is super visible and not at all hidden behind his shirt. and mydei saving his selfies while calling him his cute prince, using them to energize him throughout his tiring day because the harder he works, the more rewarding coming back to him is.

(and mydei has both his ears pierced btw. he just only wears one dangling earring. the other is a simple stud that gets hidden behind his braid.)

Chapter 10: Chapter Ten

Chapter Notes

> nasty nasty nasty. i have here about 12k words of mydei being both soft and rough with phainon, phainon being bratty and obedient for mydei, blow jobs, face fucking, and a kiss of character development i hope you guys can spot. hopefully. if not, i failed as an author LOL.
>
> thank you guys so much for all the support. i see your posts online on bird app and i read all your comments, and it makes me wanna spend every second of my free time writing this. nothing else. like phainon, i just wanna please you guys and make you happy. so please enjoy :3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon's day collar wasn't as show stopping as he had anticipated. It didn't draw nearly as much attention as he assumed it would, and no one dug in too deep when they saw it. Like Mydei said, no one really paid *that* much attention to him.

Cyrene asked the most questions, but she wasn't particularly pushy on the subject. All she said was jewelry looked odd on him since he never wore it before, and he could accept that. After all, he didn't wear it often. Not rings. Not earrings. Not necklaces. He had his choker, his friendship bracelet with her, and his watch. That was all he ever needed.

At work, Hysilens complimented it, saying it was as pretty as the depths of the ocean. When visiting his parents, his mother warned him that he needed to be very careful not to lose something so beautiful. His father just told him that it looked good on him while patting his back.

It felt so… *freeing*. Even if his head told him they knew, no one confronted him like it was some dark, twisted secret to be ashamed of. No one did more than a glance and send a bit of praise his way, too busy or uncaring to do much else.

He could be Mydei's openly in front of them all, in front of everyone who passed him by, and no one knew any better. He loved it. He loved that freedom of expression and the security of knowing this secret was safe.

Days rolled by in a comfortable routine. Every few nights, he went to Mydei's place to talk, hang out, and keep up with their dynamics. They watched movies, played games, and tossed their back and forth banter around like they always did. Mydei cooked for them. He cleaned for them. At the end of the day, they'd cuddle in his bed with his hand on his throat to hold him close. At the start, they'd work out as the sun came up over the horizon to discuss their schedules.

Otherwise, he stayed home and did his best to abide by his usual rules by texting him for ideas of what to eat and what to wear. He sent him videos of his meals as he cooked them, snapped pictures of his freshly shaven face when he cleaned up, and took photos of him with the plush toy that sat cutely on his bed. In return, he got Mydei's audio messages praising him for being so good and pictures of him doing the same mundane things.

Though being there in person was infinitely better, he didn't mind *this* if it meant they could hold on to their secret a little while longer. Especially because he could save the photos and videos sent to him, and the messages could be replayed whenever he felt like it.

While he was stressed at work, he could hide in the bathroom with his phone to his ear, and he could listen to his best friend's voice as he called him a '*good boy*'. It gave him just enough strength to leave the stall, wash his hands and face, then get back out there with a smile on his face. Because if Mydei saw him hiding out instead of working, he'd tell him that he could do it. He'd tell him that there were just a few hours left on the clock, and he was strong enough to get through his shift no matter how rude people could be.

He could be a good boy, right? He could get through just a little bit more, couldn't he?

Yeah, he could. He would.

He *did*.

By the end of his shift, he was both exhausted and proud of himself for managing to get through the night. He was ready to go home, to make the easiest dinner he could think of, then head to bed to call Mydei and talk until they fell asleep. Like kids did in those childish romance movies when they had a crush on someone.

Not that Phainon had a crush. He just liked spending time with Mydei, and it was routine to talk about their days at the end of it. Without these personal touches, casual conversations, and sincere interest in one another's personal lives, their arrangement would feel far too strict and detached.

But as he was leaving, he felt someone lightly grab his sleeve. Upon turning to look, he saw Hysilens there with one hand pinching her rosy ear and the other gripping his shirt.

"Are you… uh… busy tonight?" She asked, and he almost wanted to say yes. He almost wanted to tell her that he just wanted to go home and end his day already.

Mydei's voice popped into his head a second after that thought, telling him she deserved a friend who would be kind to her. Lying wasn't a '*kind*' thing to do, and since he had agreed to be friends, neither was dodging her when she asked to hang out.

Would he want someone to do that to him? No, he wouldn't.

"I'm not busy. Why? What's up?" He caved to the weight of the memory, torn between cursing his best friend for making sense and himself for feeling selfish.

“I was wondering if you would like to see this local band perform. They’re playing at a bar nearby, a-and my wife got me two tickets in. She told me to ask my new friend to join," Hysilens explained sheepishly. “You don’t have to, but—”

No, he had to. There was no way he could turn her down if the tickets were already purchased. It’d be a waste of money if both weren’t used.

“When?”

“In a few hours, I think. So… that makes it about eight? I can send you the address and we can meet up a bit before it starts,” she said hopefully, and he bit down on the inside of his bottom lip.

It wasn’t necessarily his *bedtime*. There was nothing in their rules that said he had to be in bed by eight or he’d risk being punished. The reason he found it a routine at all was because Mydei typically was. He was in his bedroom by eight and asleep no later than ten every weekday. And when he visited him, that was something he had to abide by if he wanted to keep waking up at six to work out with him.

While apart, Mydei allowed him to stay up a bit later since he didn’t necessarily *need* to be up so early, but he still wanted to be in bed. He wanted to talk to him on the phone as they relaxed and prepared to fall asleep.

“I’ll need to check in with someone, but I should be able to make it. I don’t see why not.”

“Is it your girlfriend?” She asked suddenly, making his cheeks warm at the assumption he even had one to report back to. “I don’t want to intrude on your relationship. If you need to be home with her, then—”

His head immediately shook. “No. I don’t have a girlfriend,” he chuckled awkwardly to shoot her down. “I’m single, and flattered you’d think otherwise, though.”

Her eyebrows furrowed as if confused by the revelation, eyes darting down his neck before shooting towards the left. Her lips parted, but not a word left them when she decided to simply nod and meet his eyes again. The hand on his arm let him go, tucking behind her back with the other.

What was she just staring at? His every day choker? His day collar?

Nerves immediately thrummed underneath his skin, aware that she looked *at one* before trying to make it appear as if she didn’t.

It wasn’t as if they’ve ever talked about anything close to BDSM, just chores they do around the house, the things they enjoy, and her wife. He didn’t make it obvious that his chores were expectations from Mydei when at his house. He didn’t even talk much about him besides occasionally mentioning a ‘*protective friend*’ of his, one that made sure he was in bed by a specific time. That wasn’t enough to figure him out, right?

Did he make it too obvious by also mentioning that he needed to check in with someone first? Was his '*necklace*' really about as secret as a room made of glass like he feared?

No. No, it couldn't be. She couldn't know that he was tangled up with someone, or that his '*necklace*' was anything more than simple jewelry.

With the newfound freedom of having his arm back, he pulled his phone out of his back pocket to check the time and break their uncomfortable eye contact. As warm as her gaze was, it felt a lot like she was burning a hole right through his security. But the worst part was he couldn't even blame her, it was his shame cranking up the heat.

Once he held the device in hand, his thumb rushed to input his passcode, desperate to find a way out.

"I… should get going… I'd like to change out of these clothes and into something more appropriate for a night out," she brought up, and he agreed with a distracted hum. "I'll see you in a bit. Hopefully you can make it."

Did he even *want* to go anymore and risk being found out by her?

Phainon flicked his gaze back towards the woman, gave her a happy grin with a slight nod, then let her walk away first before he went to tap Mydei's contact. As the dial tone rang, his hurried feet carried him out of the building and towards his car. While unlocking the vehicle, the ringing ended.

It wasn't wrong to seek comfort in him right now, was it? After all, Mydei insisted that was what he was there for—*support*.

"Hello? Phainon?" He heard. Beneath his best friend's voice was the clacking of a keyboard. "Is everything alright?"

"Hey, De. You're not still at work are you? I thought you got off already. Don't… tell me you're staying late again." He frowned, worried that he might have disrupted him during something important.

Maybe he should have texted first.

"No, I'm in bed. I'm just browsing online at the moment." A click sounded as Phainon got into his car. "You're not disrupting anything, handsome."

When the door shut, he felt his lip twitch upwards from the privacy, the reassurance, and the gentle pet name. Even if he hadn't said it out loud, he just *knew* that was one of his worries. It felt like Mydei *knew* what to look out for now.

"Oh? And what's a man in bed alone browsing for?" He joked instead. "Did I call you at a bad time?"

"You're shameless," Mydei *tsk*'ed, but the lightheartedness was easy to discern.

“What? I can’t tease you anymore?” He pouted. “Surely even the oh-so composed *Master Mydei* has his urges when alone.”

It was meant as a joke, but sometimes he wondered if Mydei actually *did* look at stuff like that. Since they weren’t particularly deep in the sexual aspect of everything because of his own nerves, where did he get his fix? What did he like to watch in his free time? Who did he think about when he did it?

Porn never did anything for him really. Sometimes a good one popped up, but most of the time he found himself cringing at the acting or the concept.

But what did Mydei use for himself? Was he the kind of person to imagine being with whatever attractive man was on the screen, or did he imagine himself with someone else in that position?

A thought suddenly struck him after that.

Did Mydei imagine *him* when he touched himself? Or did he imagine *someone else* he was with before?

“Ha. Ha.” The sarcastic reply brought him back to their conversation. “Don’t get too curious about things like that, Phainon. You know where that nose leads you and where that head can take you.”

He could warn him of that all day and all night, but Phainon wanted to know. He *needed* to know.

Did Mydei think of *him?* Did he see *his* eyes looking up at him as he had *his* lips wrapped around him? Did he remember the way *he* looked on his lap, dressed in things *he's* never worn, as *he* shook from the pain and pleasure?

Was *he* the only person he could touch himself to right now? Or did he turn around and think of one of his *exes* when he left?

“Are you really complaining about my curious nature right now?” He mouthed back, and silence followed the bratty response. “Why are you warning me of it when it’s given you a sub that's as dedicated as I am? Do you not like me anymore?”

Mydei then sighed. “We’ve been through this lesson before, Phainon. I don’t like when you talk poorly of yourself or portray me as someone I’m not.”

“I haven’t said anything depreciating about myself though,” Phainon defended himself. “I’m just asking you a question. Is my curiosity a *bad* thing now? Should I stop being adventurous and start staying within my comfort zone more?”

“Phainon, this is your third and final warning. Talk to me as you should,” he reprimanded him. “What you're doing is not communication. It’s a one-sided argument that you’re somehow *losing*.”

“Third warning until *what?*” He dared.

“The more you run that mouth of yours, the more ways I’m going to imagine shutting it up,” he threatened. “I can get pretty creative. You may or may not like what I come up with.”

Phainon then looked down at his steering wheel.

“And how would you do that?” He retorted one last time, using it as a chance to see if Mydei would talk about what he would do with *him*. “You’re too busy rubbing one out to some guy online to do anything to me, right?”

Silence took over for a moment, then a deep intake of a breath from the other end disrupted it. Slowly, that breath bled into a chilling chuckle. It taunted him as if asking if he were sure he wanted to have this conversation, as if warning him that he might not like the things he was going to say. He could hear the humor and the interest in each shake of his chest, like it was going to come out whether he liked it or not too.

But Mydei *did* say he was going to teach him how to please him, and that included pushing his limits again and seeing how much he could bend. In return, he *did* promise to give him that control over him *all the time*.

All he had to worry about was asking for what he wanted and telling him when he felt uncomfortable with something. That was it. Otherwise, Mydei was free to act.

What would he do with that power?

“What’s so funny?”

“Do you think I’m stupid, Phainon?” He was still laughing lightly. “If you need reassurances, or if you have something you want from me, you don’t need to be a disrespectful brat to achieve it.”

Phainon didn’t want to admit this though. He didn’t want to bring up the sour feeling that reared its ugly head whenever he thought about Mydei doing these things with him just to imagine another person when he was away. It was embarrassing. There was no real reason to feel that way, but he just… *did*.

The thought of Mydei thinking about *someone else* as they went through this *together* made him uneasy.

“What if… I don’t wanna talk right now?” He hinted, hoping he could just *act* instead of forcing him to *talk*. “What if I want you to push me a little bit and get my mind off of something? We can talk about it later.”

“Where are you right now, Phainon?”

His eyes darted over the darkened dashboard and stereo. “In my car. I haven’t turned it on to go home yet,” he answered, curious about where this would go.

“Turn it on and drive yourself over here instead,” Mydei instructed, his voice firm and sending a tingle through his heavy stomach. “You have twenty minutes to be inside my

bedroom and ready to accept a punishment for your attitude. Don't expect me to be as nice as I was."

He shivered at the thought. What exactly did a '*not so nice*' version of Mydei entail?

"Oh, but wait. I can't," he back tracked, reminded of why he called in the first place when he noticed the building in front of him. "I have somewhere to be later. I was supposed to ask you if I could go, but I got… distracted."

He had to go home, get dressed, and shake himself of this nasty feeling. Then, he needed to think of a way to throw Hysilens off of his case and convince Cyrene he wasn't seeing her when she asked what he's doing later—as he *knew* she'd tease him. There was so much to think about, so much to do, and—

"You can come earn your permission like a good boy does. Stop talking, and start driving," he said to him, cutting off his thoughts. "*Now*."

The knee-jerk reaction to shakily shove his key into the ignition was almost laughable. With all the time they spent together, his reflexes knew just when to obey, and that tone of voice triggered it every time. Low, husky, and effortlessly dominant, he was weak to it every single time.

"I'll see you in twenty minutes, brat."

"Y-Yeah, I'll be there."

Their call ended, and he slumped back into his seat before rubbing his hands over his face from a mix of frustration and flustered heat.

The drive from his job to his place was about twenty minutes already, even longer at this hour with all of the traffic. People were still getting off. Everyone was trying to get across town and get back home to relax. He worked in the busiest part of the city, and finding parking around Mydei's place was a time-consuming task most days. There was no way he'd make it.

Mydei knew that too. He knew this was an impossible task to ask of him, but maybe that was the point. His best friend was too smart not to know how hard he would try to fulfill it, meaning he must have also known how miserably he would end up failing it.

Phainon squirmed, completely untouched yet bothered in a way that made him hot underneath his work clothes. His heart was pounding, beating harder and harder as he thought about the sadistic kick to Mydei's words.

'*I can get pretty creative.*'

'*Don't expect me to be nice*.'

'*Come earn your permission*.'

It was scary all over again, but it was Mydei at the end of the day. He could do it if it was him. He could *take it* if it was him.

He was quick to start his car after taking a moment to just breathe, to drive the route he knew best and beat the clock. It brought a sense of comfort within him to see the familiar shops and lights, even if there were a lot of tail lights around him. Music helped to calm the bubbling nerves that grew stronger as the space between them got smaller.

Between hitting every red light the city had to offer and fighting to find a parking spot, he knew he wasn't within his time frame. If anything, the trip probably took him nearly twice as long.

Hurried feet carried him quickly through the building, past the receptionist who always gave him a flirty wave and right towards the elevator. His eyes didn't stray. His lips didn't twitch for any kind of polite smile back. Not this time. He was a man on a mission, and every second mattered now that he had absolutely blown past his allotted time frame.

Knowing Mydei, he was counting. He was waiting with a timer, ready to tell him just how much time he wasted.

There was a key hanging off his key ring that slotted perfectly into Mydei's doorknob. The metal was cleaner than the rest of them, making it easy to spot and prove just how new it was in his possession. He could have easily opened the door himself and walked in like he owned the place. Maybe it would have been faster too.

But this time, he didn't rush. He knocked.

With his keys in one fist and the other balled to meet the wood, he stood there, waiting for Mydei to let him in on his own time. Because this was *his* space, and how could he ever try to treat it like it was his when *Mydei* was the one in charge?

Had he not been home or not demanded he visit, yes. Maybe Phainon would have let himself in. Something deep inside told him, however, this was not the time to do it.

Soon, the lock flipped, and its sound immediately made a rush flood through his nerves and upwards to his chest. It was cool and just a little anxious, as he had no idea what to expect when it opened.

Well, Mydei *was* there. And he expected that. But he didn't expect to see him *like that.*

As the front door pulled open, he saw his best friend's raised eyebrow and knowing smirk looking down at him. One arm was bent at the elbow and pressing against the doorframe beside his head, and in his hand was his phone with a ticking timer on it. The pad of his thumb hovered over the stop button, but even while looking at him, he didn't stop him. It stayed, waiting for the right moment to press.

"I'm here," he said shakily, watching the numbers run but not knowing what it meant. "M… Master, I'm here."

"Hello," he greeted him casually. "You're here, yes, but what did I say? Where do you need to be?"

Phainon looked at his face, following the bare expanse of his neck and shoulders while trying to wrack his brain for an answer. Words were leaving his lips. Thoughts were escaping his head. All he could focus on was his bare chest sitting inches from him, nothing but golden skin filling his vision. In the middle, a darling blue gem sparkled.

Was he like this when he called? Or did he take his shirt off just for him?

“The longer you make us stand out here, the longer of a show we *potentially* put on for security,” Mydei lowered his voice, and his eyes widened. “Do you want to get caught, Phainon? Is that what you want?”

His head shook, and he took a step forward to squeeze in between his body and the wooden paneling. But even as he stood in the foyer, that timer ticked down.

“Master, what is that for?” He gulped, kneeling down on one knee to take his shoes off quickly. “How do I get it to stop? You’re making me n-nervous.”

It was then he noticed the shiny, sleek leather toe of a boot right in front of him, and he sucked in a sharp breath at the sight. Tall walls of leather climbed up his ankles and up his calves, laced tightly all the way up. A buckle was fastened around the top by the knot, and another sat at the base where the eyelets began. Not an inch was hidden, his leather pants being tucked under them so he could see every bit of their mean appearance.

No wonder why Mydei looked *taller* when he first saw him. Those soles beneath had to be at least a couple inches thick.

Phainon’s jaw dropped, and a singular breath panted from his lips as he lost his balance and fell to the floor. Silently, he looked up at him from his place on the floor, unable to tear his eyes away.

“Don’t walk those dirty shoes over my clean floors. Continue taking them off,” he commanded, knocking his leg aside gently rather than kicking at his sneaker. “The longer you run my timer, the longer you’re going to sit on your knees for me. If you feel like keeping this somewhat *comfortable*, I’d advise you to *hurry up*.”

Both hands pushed behind him to support his weight, and he pulled himself back as Mydei took a step closer.

He stood over him, one boot between his legs and the other planted next to his left thigh. As he bent over, the chunky braid and heavy earring he wore every day dangled over him, capturing his attention. As did his lengthy necklace.

It was almost hypnotizing to watch them swing before meeting Mydei’s heated gaze.

“Or do you *want* to be late for your plans later tonight?”

The memory of bringing it up shocked him out of his daze, and he looked down at himself before rushing to finish taking his shoes off.

That was right. He was going to ask Mydei if he could stay up tonight and hang out with Hysilens at some bar he's probably never been to for some band he doesn't know. He was meant to be in his bedroom to earn that permission, not staring at him and the leather dressing his lower—

Bedroom.

The timer would stop when he got to *his bedroom*.

One hand practically slammed his shoes on to the rack behind him, and he flipped on to his hands and knees before pushing himself up. Without a word, he rushed through his home.

Mydei only laughed over the urgency.

Phainon ripped his work shirt off, only somewhat cautious of tearing his buttons clean from the fabric. He popped his choker off before snatching his collar from his designated nightstand, ready to stop that timer.

"Good boy," Mydei praised him, walking slowly towards him with large, confident steps. "You finally remembered. It took you long enough."

Heavy breaths wracked his lungs as he looked up at him, a strange concoction of confusion, arousal, and fear heavy in his gut. His left fingers gripped his collar tight, and the right grabbed into the bed beside him. Soft blankets were clutched inside his sweaty fist, pulling towards him.

"Hm. Why don't you try breathing?" Mydei suggested, tossing his phone on the bed.

Thirty-three minutes, fifty-five seconds.

He would have to sit on his knees for thirty-three minutes and fifty-five seconds.

A hand grasped his jaw, turning his attention back towards the look of concern rather than the screen of doom. Soft, pink lips were tilted into a smile, and the tilt of his head mixed with the raise of his shoulders made him appear *closer* to his height rather than further.

"I can tell you're aroused by just looking at you, but you need to calm down," he coaxed, tilting his head back so he could look *down* at him instead. "I can't play with you if you're not calm."

Mydei took a deep breath, motioning him to do the same with a raising hand between them, and he copied the gesture to hold it with him. When it was released, he followed that slow descend too.

"There you go. Try talking to me. What time is this '*plan*' of yours later, Phainon?"

"E-Eight. It's at eight," he answered shakily, unsure exactly what to think at this moment. "I have time. I-I can do this, and then get ready, a—"

Mydei placed a finger on his lips.

"*I* will take care of the specifics. Don't think about that. Don't think of anything but what I'm asking you. What time is your plan?" He asked again, firmer this time.

"Eight, master."

"Who is going to be there?" He continued his questioning, speaking calmly and clearly. "Where are you going? What are you doing?"

"Hysilens." Phainon took another breath. "We're going to a bar to watch a band perform and hang out."

Mydei nodded in encouragement. "Good. You're doing good so far. If you'll be with her *later*, who are you with *right now?*"

"Master," he said while tilting his head back further to push closer to his finger. "I'm with my master."

"And where do you need to be at this exact moment?" His finger pulled away, and he pointed it towards his door. "Is it out there? Are you needed out there by someone other than your master?"

"No."

Cerulean eyes continued following his hand, and Mydei pointed it towards the ceiling.

"Is it up there? Do you need your head to be somewhere else where you cannot hear your master?"

Phainon shook his head. "No, master, I don't."

Slowly, he brought his touch to his head, and he lightly tapped his temple with the side of his finger. As he did so, he lowered his shoulders to their usual size and picked his head upright.

With his guiding trace, Phainon leaned forward and flicked his gaze *upwards* at his straightened figure.

"Is it in here?" He asked him again. "Do you need to trap yourself here where your master cannot comfort you?"

"No, I don't."

Suddenly, he was curling that same finger in front of his face, beckoning him to follow.

He followed him towards the foot of his bed, and that was when he noticed the curtains had been closed and a mirror was placed in front of one. It pointed directly at them, showing off their bodies completely from head to toe.

"Ah ah," he tutted. "Don't look at that yet. I didn't allow you to. Keep your eyes on me."

Phainon obeyed immediately and attempted to ignore the reflection in his peripheral vision.

“Show me where you need to be. If I’m standing right here in front of you, speaking to you and comforting you, show me where you need to be at this very second. Where is your body telling you to go?” He crossed his arms over his bare chest after, no longer pointing or guiding him.

His knees gave a buckle before he could even think, and he kept his eyes on him as he gently lowered himself onto the hardwood floor. One knee pressed down to tap against the stiff surface, and the other followed just as carefully.

“Does the floor hurt?”

“It’s hard.” He winced when he shifted and rolled his knees against the wood to try and get comfortable. “It hurts on the bottom of my knees, master.”

“Take your shirt off slowly while I fold the blanket for you.”

He placed his collar on the bench in front of him, then lined his fingers around the collar of his shirt so his necklace could slip against skin and not get caught. With a pull to the back, as he watched Mydei slowly turn to walk towards the opposite side of the bed where a familiar throw blanket sat. In the time it took him to pull the black t-shirt off, Mydei was shaking his blanket off.

“Here.”

Phainon’s attention followed him as he approached him again. Each heavy step was suddenly in his ears now that he was no longer listening to his own breathing, but they were slower than the pounds of his racing heart.

“Back up a little bit.”

He made some space for him to set the blanket down, then pressed his knees into it before looking back up at him. The second he got comfortable, Mydei grabbed his phone, tapped the screen, and placed it beside him on the bench.

“This is how it’s going to go,” Mydei started. As he spoke, he pinched his cheeks and held him there so he couldn’t look anywhere else. “You were being extremely disrespectful to me, and you clearly wanted to push my hand to see where it’d strike. You then took a ridiculous amount of time to remember what little I asked of you. Now, you’ve put me in the mood to punish your disobedience—willful *or* not.”

A gulp filled the room when he paused.

“Understand?”

“Yes, master.”

“I’m going to teach you what happens when you test me. The only things you need to remember is giving me your safe signal and obeying me. There should be nothing else of importance to you right now,” he said firmly, leaving no room to argue. “Repeat that.”

Phainon's lips parted. "I… I only need to remember my safewords and to obey you. Nothing else matters."

"The mirror is there because I want you to watch us." The hand holding his face turned him to the mirror, forcing him to look at the way his body was kneeling around his left boot. "No more thinking about what you saw before. You're going to look at me above you, at you by my feet, and we're going to try and rewrite what left you afraid of this. I am not the person you saw online. You are not the person you saw online. This is *our* experience together, and *no one* else should be here."

Mydei looked so much bigger than him in this position.

Standing not just taller but much more composed, with his back straight and head held up high, to Phainon, he was the epitome of dominance and confidence. He carried that air daily. He made his presence as a leader known in little ways every day. But it was unmistakable now. Even without his kneeling body beside him, had he just been standing there on his own, he would have still looked exactly the same—completely in control.

Mydei said he didn't feel he embodied what it meant to be someone's '*master*', yet Phainon couldn't help but bend to each of his whims like they were *law* anyway.

Fingers lifted his chin higher, and a gentle knee pressed to his chest to straighten his posture.

"Do not hang your head unless I tell you. Always carry yourself in a confident and respectful manner. Own your submission."

Phainon sat up straighter while looking higher, hoping to look exactly how he wanted even if he didn't completely *feel* that way.

"Look at how handsome you are when you show yourself off. Look at how good you look beside me. Aren't you a sight for sore eyes?" Mydei pointed out, admiring him through the mirror.

Phainon raked his eyes over his own body, over the muscles in his arms and back when he shifted his shoulders. He took in the red in his cheeks, the flush almost violent against his pale skin and darkening as Mydei let go of his face. His collar sparkled right at the base of his neck, sitting at the dip just above his collarbones. His chest filled with steady breaths, pushing the muscles out before sinking them with each exhale.

While still watching, he saw Mydei unbuckle his leather collar beside him.

"Is it scary down there, Phainon?"

"No," he whispered, craning his neck for him to fasten the leather around his neck. His eyes never left their reflection.

He watched the rust-colored leather enclose around his throat, then the fingers swiftly fastening it like second nature.

“Open your mouth.” His eyes shifted to the other man, and upon seeing his hesitation, Mydei pulled the ring of his play collar. “You told me you’d give me everything. So unless you give me a safeword, you’re going to do exactly as I say. *Open. Your. Mouth*.”

His jaw dropped, and he twitched when two of his middle fingers held themselves out for him. They lined his lips and pulled them back, giving him a moment to get used to the feeling. When he didn’t deny them, they pushed forward, easing over his tongue.

“Mm… just as hot as I remember,” Mydei sighed in pleasure, and Phainon closed his mouth around them. “What was it you said over the phone? ‘*Do you not like me anymore*’?”

They pushed deeper, inching closer to the start of his throat.

“I wouldn’t have you wearing *my* collars if I *didn’t* like you. Why would I claim ownership for a man who doesn’t meet my standards?” His voice was harsh, almost cutthroat as if he were upset to have to remind him of it. “I wouldn’t show you *this* side of me if I *didn’t* like you. What makes you think just anybody gets to be guided and punished by my hand? The hand *in your mouth* as I speak?”

Shaky hands grasped the leg in front of him, touching the cool leather surface even if they slipped from the sweat on his hands. Tentative fingers curled on to his body, one by his thigh and one by the pull tab of his boot. Phainon gripped him tightly as amber eyes watched, bathed underneath the warmth of his gaze that made him want nothing more than to apologize for ever saying such a thing.

He ran his tongue along his fingers, swiping between the knuckles before sucking lightly.

“Close your legs around my boot,” he demanded. “Feel it. Touch it. Get acquainted with it. You’ll be seeing me like this more often.”

Both legs twitched, closing his knees around the heel and thighs over the toe cap. It was firm against his pants and pressed into his body when he squeezed tightly. One set of fingertips moved too, touching the top buckle and cuff lightly before tracing over the stitching blindly. The stiffness and texture made him shiver.

“Sit on it.” A small shake of the head made him scoff. “Oh, did that sound like a *request* to you? I thought I said, *sit on it*.”

Phainon shivered.

Lowering his body from his stiffened state, he eased himself over the shoe as he was told. Upon feeling the unrelenting fabric beneath his body, caught between the bulge pressing into his laces and the tip firm against his ass, he turned his head and ripped the fingers from his mouth. Saliva spilled from his lips, stringing them both together.

It was hard when he allowed all of his weight down, but simple leather didn’t typically support weight like this.

Were they steel capped? Did Mydei buy *steel-toed boots* for random men to *sit on?*

“You mentioned this before,” Mydei reminded him, using his opposite hand to thread his bangs back and expose his face. “You looked at my boots with interest, and you might not want to be stepped on, but that doesn't mean you won’t kneel before them and serve me.”

Shame burned inside of his veins as he shifted, rubbing himself against the shoe to test the way it felt. It was still stiff, and his pants muted a lot of the feeling, but the sheer *filth* of it all made him squirm more. Each movement pressed the toe against his bottom too, tickling his senses in a way he wasn’t used to with Mydei.

“How do you feel?”

“Dirty,” he whispered once his fingers left, clutching on to him tighter. “I feel dirty a-and hot inside. But you look so good in that, master. I’ve never seen you *like this*… I’ve never heard you t-talk to me *like this*.”

“I promised to wear the red harness for you as a reward, but this outfit is merely for fun. A little bit of spice to kick up your punishment,” he shared with him.

“I like it… I think,” Phainon confessed, still processing the whole thing. “It’s confusing inside because you’re usually so… *cool*. But now you look so…”

Hot.

Mydei looked so unbelievably *hot* in this leather get up, and he looked so *hot* standing above him.

“I don’t want to hear that answer. There is no ‘I *think*’ when we do this,” Mydei scolded him as he continued to tuck the hair away from his face. “I saw the way you looked at me by the door, and I can see the way you’re looking at me now. What do you like about this outfit? Be specific.”

He looked so much more *confident*, like he could round up all of his fears and insecurities and squash them underneath his shoe like a bug. Like he could hold his body so tightly that it’d fit together the pieces that came undone. Everything that he already embodied felt enhanced while carrying himself in such a way, like the change in outfit really brought out the difference between his *best friend* and his *dominant*.

If he stood next to him long enough, maybe some of that confidence could rub off on him too.

“I like how much more powerful you look in it, master,” Phainon answered quietly, feeling small in comparison to him. “You look like the world bends to your will. It’s… *fuck*. It’s *h-hot*.”

“Then bend,” he demanded, and a jolt shot through his stomach over the simple but powerful response. “If you didn’t want to use your mouth to talk to me back then, then show me with your body right now. And don’t lie. You won’t fool me.”

What did he want to say? That Mydei better not be thinking of some random guy when he had all of him at his beck and call? That he was better than any one of his old submissives who never even got to learn about the less sexy, more meticulous parts of his personality?

Did he just want to be here beneath him?

Phainon raised the hand on his thigh towards the front of his pants, and he cupped the bulge tightly without being told to. His fingers slotted underneath. His palm pressed in deep. He squeezed around it, massaging him slowly but firmly to coax a low, rumbled hum from his lips.

Mydei guided his head closer with the fingers in his hair, bringing his mouth towards the zipper.

"Look at how much I '*like*' you, Phainon," he challenged. "Show me you deserve to keep all of me to yourself."

There it was.

Phainon wanted *that*. *He* wanted to be the *only* person Mydei thought about throughout all of this because *Mydei* was the only person *he* thought about in return.

Mydei said his body was for him and him alone at all times, but he wanted *more*. He wanted to know he *earned* it, that he was *better* than anyone else and *deserved* it.

His hands rushed to the buckle of his belt, unfastening it so he could place it on the bench behind Mydei's body. They then grabbed the gleaming button, and he popped it open swiftly. The zipper dragged down even faster.

Mydei brought the hand not in his hair below his chin, cupping it gingerly to tilt his head higher up. He forced him to watch him, to keep his eyes on him as his fingers pulled his pants down.

"Now ask me to fuck your bratty mouth."

Phainon gripped his pants tighter as he repeated the phrase in his head. His stomach twisted tightly at the thought of having to say that outloud.

"Please," he managed to say, then paused to muster up the courage to continue. "Master, can I suck… I mean, can you fuck my… mm… my mouth?"

It sounded so bad to say out loud. Not in the sense it was *wrong*, but the words just sounded strange in his own voice. They felt weird being formed by his lips. They tasted odd on his tongue when he finished speaking.

Mydei's lips pursed, displeased by the attempt. "That's not what I said. Ask me to fuck your *bratty* mouth," he corrected.

A pound smashed against his ribs.

“Can you fuck my bratty mouth, master?” He repeated quickly and quietly. The whole sentence was no more than a murmur, and it sounded like one long word.

But Mydei shook his head again. His attempt to obey *still* didn’t meet his expectations.

“*C’mon!* I said it!” He stressed, not wanting to talk and just wanting to feel. “I did what you wanted me to do. Didn’t you hear it?”

“I heard you, but that’s not how you ask,” Mydei criticized. “You don’t half-ass the things I tell you to do. You speak up proudly, and you ask with your full chest. Are you ashamed to *want* to please me? Don’t you want to *prove* yourself to me?”

“No, I—”

“Then one final time for the man not listening to me—*ask me to fuck your bratty mouth*.”

His jaw tightened out of frustration from not being good enough, but he eased the tension within it before taking a deep breath. Leaning forward, he pressed his forehead to his leg and took a moment to calm himself down.

He didn’t need to *think* about how embarrassing it was. That wasn’t his job. If he wasn’t going to safeword out and call it quits, then he only needed to *listen*. Nothing else mattered as much as being good for Mydei and pleasing Mydei.

He wanted to be good. He wanted to be the best. He *needed* to be.

Mydei, with his fingers still in his hair, rubbed at his scalp gently. Small, circular rotations helped to ease some of his nerves.

A breath escaped his lips, and his head was tilted back so he could look back up at him the way he was meant to. Both hands held him still like that, not allowing him to hide again.

“Please… Can you please fuck my bratty mouth, master?” He said louder this time, and Mydei gave his head another gentle trace through his hair as his skin tingled from the humiliating words.

He nodded. “That’s exactly what I wanted to hear. Good job for getting it right.”

Pride swelled in his chest while he held him tightly.

“You want to be master’s good boy, Phainon, don’t you? You want to do your best to pleasure him, right?” He proposed, rubbing his head again as he nodded. “You have just under eighteen minutes left until my timer is up. Will you prove to me that you can be more than a disobedient brat in eighteen minutes?”

“Yes,” he promised. “I can be a good boy, master. I-I can please you. I can do it better than anyone else too.”

“Mm… I like that attitude. I like it a lot. Pull my cock out and give it a lick it for me then,” he ordered him, and his hands were quick to pull him free from his tight boxer briefs.

He hadn't shrunk since the last time they were here. It was still thick, still heavy, and it hung in front of his face waiting for him to do something to please him. Flushed at the tip with a smear of pre-cum by the slit, his cock practically begged to be licked, sucked, and warmed within his mouth.

Phainon leaned in closer as the warm scent of his skin beckoned him to, wanting to taste him again.

"You're looking at me like you need it," Mydei noticed. "Do you like my body, Phainon?"

A nod was all he could muster as his tongue came in close and licked at the base tentatively. Tufts of dark hair tickled his lips from the proximity.

"Do you like the taste of it? The smell of it? The feeling of it against yours?"

He nodded again, eyes drooping as the familiar salt of his skin coated his tastebuds.

Phainon dragged one hand up his body, touching the right side of his tattooed hip to trace his thumb upwards on the divot of his v-line. He followed the bump of his abs as they flexed and relaxed from the pleasure of his kitten licking, then lined his ribs until he blindly found the plush muscle of his hot chest. Fingers gripped the soft skin, massaging it.

Mydei groaned softly in response. A throb filled his stiff cock, allowing it to pulse gently over his tongue.

"I want you to wet your tongue and then continue," he was instructed, and Phainon pulled his tongue back before pooling saliva over it. Once gathered, he licked again, lathering the base with his spit. "That's it. Look up at me."

Opening his eyes, he looked up at Mydei.

"Show me your color," he said. "Your left hand, hold my hip and lift whatever it is up. Do *not* move them like last time."

Two fingers curled around his body. His pinky and thumb held him tightly, and he held the last three fingers up for him. Whether from above looking down or a quick glance at the mirror, he could see them clear as day.

"If you stop, I will stop. If you tell me it's an accident, we will have a weekend-long crash course in safewords and their importance. It *won't* be sexy writing me an essay," he warned him.

Phainon swallowed, then dragged his tongue along the length of his cock slowly. In doing so, he bathed more of him with spit.

"Stop and answer me."

"I understand," he assured him, allowing the sticky tip to sit on his bottom lip as she spoke. "I won't scare you again, master."

He pressed the leaking head of his cock to the middle of his mouth. Slick dragged over his lips, and he hummed to himself over the slippery feeling.

Mydei exhaled, the sound a little shaky as he pulled his chin closer. “Are you kissing me right now?”

Upon the question, Phainon puckered his lips slightly and planted a kiss to the blunt head. Again, it twitched with interest from his advances, making him grin proudly.

“Oh,” a choked noise followed, and the hand on his head tightened to grip his hair. “You think you’re cute, huh? Well, what if I said I want to see this cute face tear up for me? *Open*.”

Jaw dropped, and he rolled his tongue over his bottom lip slowly to protect him from his teeth. The slide in was smooth and steady thanks to the spit glistening over his cock. With every inch he pushed inside, his lips parted further until the corners pinched.

“What else did you say to me over the phone, tough guy?” Mydei taunted him while filling his mouth as deep as his comfort would allow, remembering right where that limit was. “Right. You said I was ‘*rubbing one out to some guy online*’.”

Phainon could only blink as his cheeks puffed and body squirmed from the dull ache of his jaw. Heat pooled into his cheeks from the memory, warming them even more than they already were as he tried to breathe through his nose. The hand on Mydei’s chest dug deeper involuntarily, desperate for some kind of grounding as he was forced to sit there and take his cock.

Mydei’s gaze was fixated on him, on his wide eyes and filled mouth.

“Look in the mirror.”

His head shook weakly, not wanting to see what state he was in right now.

“I wasn’t asking. I was telling you.” He emphasized his point with a light tug of his hair. “Look.”

An extra hard breath pushed through his nose over the force, but he darted his attention to the left. He turned the entirety of his body as much as possible with his thighs still holding his boot, making it more comfortable to face their reflection.

“My brat acts like he’s so tough sometimes,” Mydei *tsk*’ed. “But you can’t talk back with a mouth full of my cock, can you?”

Slowly, he reeled his hips back, dragging slowly until his lips sealed around just the tip. With a push, it shoved against his cheek, filling it out obscenely.

Embarrassment made his chest tremble as he stared at his own face stretching to make room for him.

“Say something, Phainon.”

He looked up at him in the glass, at the euphoric glint in his eyes from watching him become reduced to muffled moans and heavy breaths. There was no way he could speak, and Mydei knew that just as he knew he would be late earlier. It was all a game to him, a twisted show of his sadism.

Each jab at his vulnerability made his stomach knot and his cock throb behind his pants, making it the most bizarre feeling to feel both ridiculed *and* aroused. Mydei held both in his hands, and he seemed to know just how to handle them without going overboard.

“What guy online is going to make a face like *that* for me?”

Mydei pulled back again, and Phainon turned his head so he missed his cheek and slipped towards his throat.

“What pornstar is sexier than having *my submissive* on his knees for me?”

He watched him thrust into his own mouth. He watched as inch after inch disappeared past his glistening lips, tapping just shy of too far before pulling back. Then again. And again.

The pace picked up slowly, faster than it had the last time they did this, and he squirmed as he tried to pull away. But Mydei’s hand slipped to the back of his head to hold him there. Those fingers on his chin pinched firmer to keep his face angled correctly.

“*Don’t run*.” Amusement was thick within his low voice. “You wanted my attention, Phainon, and you’ve got all of it now. You acted out because you wanted me to punish you, so take it like the brat you are. Take it like you said you could—‘*better than anyone else*’, right?”

Phainon dragged his hand down his chest deeply, eyes glued to the mirror and the hips pumping into his face quickly. Stray strands of hair that fell back into his face bounced, and his cheeks were slightly sunken in from how hard he was sucking. His head lightly bobbed, moving between the hips and hand fighting to push him back but hold him still.

Every jostle made the ring of his play collar *click, click, click* against itself, and the wet sounds of suction followed with it. He watched the metal move. He saw the spit shine over his rosy lips.

“Fuck,” Mydei panted out. “That’s it. Keep those pretty lips tight around this cock. Look at how plump and shiny they are.”

It was then that his clawed fist curled around his hip, and he pulled him weakly with every thrust forward. The light force made Mydei slow down, grinding into his mouth.

“What? Does this brat think he can take more?” His playfully condescending voice coo’ed. “Does he want to take his master’s cock down to the balls?”

Phainon pulled him closer, and Mydei pushed past that comfortable limit of his carefully.

“Come on, you can do it,” he egged him on, holding him still as tears pinched in the corners of his eyes. “Oh, what a pretty boy… Are you *my* pretty boy, Phainon?”

Muffled, choked noises escaped his lips. With it, spit bubbled from the seams and his cheeks puffed.

“Yes, you are,” he answered for him, and Phainon tore his eyes from the mirror to look up at him. “A little bit longer, pretty boy. You wanted this. You asked for this. Give me a few more seconds. One… T-Two… *Fuck*. Three…”

He choked harder, and Mydei eased himself back so he could cough. Saliva strung from his mouth down to his chin. Another connected his drenched lips to the tip of his cock. Tears dripped down his burning cheeks, blurring his vision into nothing but shades of gold and rust.

“Good boy,” Mydei commended him, petting his head lightly and allowing him to swallow down his breaths. “Breathe for me. You’re okay.”

The fingers on his hip pulled again.

“One more time,” he allowed. Carefully, he eased his cock back to his awaiting mouth. “Easy, Phainon. Relax.”

Another breath filled his lungs through his nose, and he willed his shoulders to relax as his mouth was filled again. A moan vibrated through his throat, but it left Mydei’s mouth from being wrapped around him. Deeper and deeper, he settled where it was comfortable, shallowly fucking into his mouth.

Then, he pushed deeper.

“Hold it until you can’t anymore. Relax. Stay calm,” he tried to comfort him, and Phainon’s nails curled into his skin. “Mm… My obedient boy… The only messes I could ever handle are the ones you make, you know.”

His cheeks burned.

“You’re making me feel so good, and you look so good like this too. Fuck, I want to ruin you. I want to see all the limits your body has. I want to take you to them nice and slow, then I want to see where I can push,” he breathed out, rambling on to himself. “Use your hand on the rest of it, Phainon. Can you do that? Can you jerk my cock while I train your throat to take me?”

Phainon was quick to wrap his hand in place. All the spit made it easy to move, and he gripped him tightly while pumping his fist up to his lips and down to Mydei’s pelvis. Slick, wet sounds filled the room, obscene in nature and louder than the ones of him just fucking his mouth.

He hissed in pleasure, panting loudly.

“That’s it. That’s it—*oh*, you’re doing *so fucking good*, Phainon. Keep it up.”

Mydei reeled himself back, and he jerked his fist all the way up to the slippery tip before dragging it down to the base. Two hands gripped his face, holding his cheeks tightly before wiping the tears from his eyes.

“I-I want to cum *for you*,” he said, looking into his eyes. “All you need to do is suck and move your h-hand.”

Nodding, Phainon brought his lips to the tip again, sucking firmly even if his cheeks ached and jaw felt sore. He braced himself for it, shortening the distance as his mouth was fucked once again. Each thrust was careful, calculated enough not to make him choke too much. Instead, he pressed at his limit carefully every so often as to not overwhelm him too much.

Their eyes stayed locked on one another, watching each other closely through it all.

Mydei’s face was flushed a deep rose, the color matching his two-toned hair. Jaw dropped, breathy pants and low groans fell from his lips, hot and heavy in nature. His chest heaved, lifting and falling faster and faster with the passing seconds.

“*Ph-Phainon*,” he called, and he hummed. Inside of his mouth and hand, he felt the veins throb. “I’m close. I’m so, *so* close. Listen to me, okay? Move your h-hand… *h-hah*… and put it under your mouth. Give my load somewhere to go s-since you don’t swallow.”

He cupped his palm beneath his mouth as he was told to. Quick, jerky thrusts ruined his steady pace.

”I’m g-gonna cum. *Phainon*,” he grunted, humping into his mouth. “Oh, you’re so good. My body’s s-so… *fuck!*”

Phainon learned, at that moment, that he *did* like the feeling of him pulsing between his lips while he orgasmed. There was no more speculation. He *liked* it for sure. The life in his body was so much different than the toy he knew, and it served as a reminder that Mydei was *real*. His cock was *real*, and he had made him feel so good that he was groaning loud enough to echo as he shot ropes of hot cum over his tongue.

He *made* him cum, and it was pooling in his mouth with every sensitive twitch.

“R-Relax,” Mydei choked out, pulling gently on his face when he kept sucking firmly. “You can s-stop sucking so hard, Phainon. Let me go. Come on.”

Phainon let him go, cum and spit dripping from his mouth as he looked up at him for direction on what to do next. The rest sat over his tongue and pooled on his bottom teeth, thick and salty.

“Just spit it i-in your hand.”

His head shook as he looked around the room, eyeballing the door to the bathroom before glancing back at him.

“You’re so damn cute with a mouth full of my cum. I should keep you here like this,” Mydei teased him.

The cotton stretched around his thighs were pulled up. His leather pants were worked around his hips again, making him cringe lightly from the tight fabric pressing down on his messy

skin. While dressed again, he carefully took either of his hands to help him on to his shaky legs.

“Careful.”

“Mhm…”

Phainon tried again to swallow. The thick, viscous texture slid across his mouth, but he shook his head before stumbling towards his bathroom on his weakened legs. Either palm slapped to the counter, and he spat the flood of cum out before panting heavily. It strung from his tongue and lips, slippery and messy.

“My poor boy,” Mydei said softly, and Phainon turned the sink on to wash it down.

“I-I’m sorry,” he rasped out through the scratchiness of his throat, spitting again. “It’s… It’s not *gross*, I swear. It doesn’t taste bad. I…—”

“You’re okay,” Mydei cut him off before setting a hand on his head to rub it soothingly. “Don’t apologize. You did so well, and I’m so proud of you.”

His steady hand grabbed a nearby hand towel, and Phainon gripped the counter as he was told to shut his eyes. The rest of the residual spit, tears, and cum was gently wiped from his face, cleaning it for him before he could stare too long at his own reflection.

“Do you want to end this?” Mydei wondered, dipping a corner into the water before shutting the faucet off. With it, he wiped his mouth again. “I can see how hard you are in your pants, and I bet it hurts. Did my good boy get off on pleasing me that much?”

Amber eyes stared back at him through the mirror, squinted slightly from a kind smile.

“M… Master,” he whispered to him. “Am I better?”

“Hm?”

“Am I better?” Phainon repeated hopefully, a tilt of desperation to his voice. “W-Will you think of me when you… you know…?”

“No one has a face quite as pretty to me as my submissive. I’m not interested in anyone else’s,” he reassured him, lifting his chin up to admire his rosy complexion. “Come with me.”

Dropping the towel, he took his hand and led him back into the bedroom. Heavy boots thumped to the wood as he walked backwards, and Phainon's knees still felt incredibly weak from kneeling so long. But he followed him anyway.

“Does your dick hurt from being neglected this whole time?” He asked him. “Do you want your master to take care of you, Phainon?”

“Please,” he whispered as Mydei gently nudged him onto the bed, still holding his hand. “M-Master, please… It *does* hurt. I’m so hard it *hurts*.”

Those pink lips twitched upwards, guiding him higher until he was comfortably lying back against the mattress. Cool blankets touched his hot skin, cooling him down even if he felt like melting.

“What hurts, my sweet prince? You should know to be more specific by now.”

Phainon gripped him tighter and pulled him closer, slowly guiding his fingers down his body to where his own cock was straining against his zipper. The fabric was way too tight by now, and he was so aroused that each twitch of interest was more like an ache. With all of his attention on pleasing Mydei, there wasn’t a moment to think of himself until now.

Palm to his zipper, he felt the heat of embarrassment fill his cheeks.

“Here…”

“Phainon, you need to ask,” Mydei reminded him.

A groan of frustration left his lips when he lined his fingers over his and pressed, pleased by the touch.

“Master, please,” he begged helplessly, bucking closer and chasing the pleasure. “I-I’m so hard. It’s so hard, and achey, and… and I need you to touch me. Please touch me. I’ve been good.”

“If I have to tell you one more time to ask, you’re getting left like that,” he was warned gently. His chest then fell with a pained gasp. “*Ask*. *Properly*.”

“Can you touch me?” He forced himself to speak, rushed and just a little pained. “Can I please cum, master? I’ve been good. I-I’ve been a good boy.”

On the days he woke up hard, he didn’t touch himself like he used to. He laid there and tried to will it go down, or he took a cool shower in hopes it’d help. When it twitched with interest while Mydei praised him and commanded him, he brushed it off until he forgot completely.

Since he walked through the door, all he thought about was pleasing him. How could he be better? How could he be the best?

Phainon had been so, so good. Hasn’t he *earned* it yet?

“There you go. Was that so hard to say?”

Mydei groped him through his pants, palm pressing down firmly with a squeeze as he watched his face scrunch from pleasure.

“I’m going to use my mouth,” he said to him, and Phainon nodded quickly in agreement. “This is how you take it, so pay attention.”

Another hand gripped his hip as the other man pushed him higher up, making more room for himself on the bed. He watched as Mydei quickly unbuttoned his work pants, yanking them down his thighs to expose the damp cotton of his briefs. A deep, darkened patch was left

right by the right side of his bulge, obvious with the gray fabric and embarrassing. But those weren't on for long either. Within seconds, his underwear was also around his thighs and tucked out of the way.

Shaky fingers threaded through Mydei's long hair, and the other was held over his mouth when a fist wrapped around the base. Hot spit was dribbled over the leaking tip and worked down, slicking his stiff and rosy length.

How did it already feel so good?

"M-Ma—*ah!*" A slick and tight pump made his voice raise, the word breaking into a cry.

"Look at me," Mydei's gentle voice said, and he watched as his mouth pressed a kiss to the hair just beneath his navel. "Mm… If you look away, I'll stop. Keep watching me, Phainon."

He looked good down there too.

He looked so, *so* good between his legs and planting open mouths kisses down the ivory trail of hair he trimmed but never shaved completely. Mydei *liked* it. He said so himself, and it didn't bother Phainon at all to leave it.

Soft lips lined lower and lower, peppering his skin and the surrounding body hair with kisses. It was as if he was praising him, thanking him for taking his preference and accepting it. As if he was pleased by his quiet display of submission.

His mouth then met lower down his pelvis, and he kissed around his cock rather than taking him into his mouth immediately. His fingers even gripped his balls, lifting them so he could kiss beneath the heavy sack.

Phainon twitched, eyebrows pinched as Mydei watched him in return.

"Look how hard you are." With the comment, he gave another tight jerk. "My sweet boy's all red and leaking…"

More kisses teased his groin, planting and sucking lightly over his lower body. Each made his cock twitch and his insides burn with need.

"You're so handsome down here too," Mydei praised him, then licked over his balls slowly. One by one, his tongue cupped beneath as his lips closed around them.

"Mas-ster, I… w-wait… What are you…?" He squirmed breathlessly, not used to the attention or sensations of someone being down there. "Why down there?"

"Because I enjoy being down here," Mydei said as if it was that simple. "I *want* to be down here, and I *want* you to feel *wanted* by me. All of your body is mine, and all of it should feel sexy and desirable."

Phainon's hips shifted and his chest stuttered as a pleased hum vibrated against the base of his cock, and he weakly pulled Mydei closer by his hair. Though he wasn't yet giving him

attention there, all the teasing was making him impossibly harder. Had he ever been that aroused before?

“With how sensitive and worked up you are, this shouldn't take long,” he teased him. “Ask me to cum when you get close, okay, Phainon? Even if my mouth is full, you should *always* ask for your pleasure.”

“Yes, master,” he panted, vision blurred from a wave of unshed tears over how much he needed to cum. “A-Always ask you.”

Lips then curled around the head, and a sharp moan filled the room as a hot, tight mouth sunk down over him. His hips bucked. The hand in Mydei’s hair gripped tighter. As he shallowly bobbed up and down, Phainon wanted so badly to push him lower even if he knew better than to. If he wanted more, he had to ask, but the words were caught in his throat from the pleasure.

On top of having his mouth wrapped around the top half of his cock, two fingers were still jerking the bottom half. Their speed only quickened from before, moving fast enough to jiggle his balls with each pump.

Phainon’s voice raised, pitched from overwhelming pleasure and shameless in nature as he sobbed out loudly. His back arched off of the bed, shoulders pushing back into the mattress and hips bucking.

“Mas… Oh, *fuck*,” he choked out, biting into the meat of his palm that still smelled of Mydei’s skin. “F-Fuck. Master, I can’t. I-I won’t be able to last.”

Mydei’s head tilted. His tongue swirled. How he could take so much at once, Phainon had no clue. How he could move his tongue in one way, pump his fingers in another, and still keep his mouth hollowed was beyond him. It was beyond comprehensible.

He could barely do two of those at once, let alone all three while taking it that deep, but he was meant to do *that?*

Oh, that was going to take *forever* to learn. That was going to run him *hours* of being on his knees for Mydei, lips stretched around him. He had a gag reflex that was easy to trigger. He had not even a fraction of experience in comparison. How—

The hand around him left, instead climbing slowly through the tufts of hair on his body. Pressed flush to his stomach, he used it and shoved him down firmly. An unmovable force pinned him to the bed, giving him nowhere to go and nothing to do but lay there and take it. Not that there was anything he wanted to do more than cum inside of the mouth dipping lower, and lower, and *lower* with each bob.

“T-Tight,” he whimpered, feeling his throat work the tip with a clench. “Master, I’m gonna cum. I-I’m gonna cum if you… i-if you keep going. Master, *please*.”

Mydei’s free hand reached to grip his chest, and he dropped the hand in his mouth to grasp his knuckles tightly.

“Yeah,” he whined, vision blurry. “Touch me there. Touch my chest. Pinch my—”

Two fingers pinched down on his nipple, and his legs writhed helplessly while trapped within his own clothes still. A throb flooded through his cock, balls tightening as Mydei lowered himself as much as possible.

Nose to his skin, he buried himself into the trimmed bush lining the base. Even then, as the walls of his throat squeezed him, his tongue wiggled.

Phainon wasn’t even ready to be in his *mouth*, let alone his *throat* after being left so hard for so long.

“Please, can I cum?” He panted out, hot, heavy, and faster than ever while pulling him closer by his hair. “Please, can I cum? Please, can I cum? Please, can I cum? *Ple-ease, can I-I—*?”

Mydei gave his nipple a tug. He gave his aching stomach three easy pats, then pulled back to suck tightly and firmly around the sensitive tip.

“I’m… M-Master, I can’t… I’m gonna—*ah*… F-Fuck,” Phainon hiccuped, a new wash of tears burning in his eyes from the overwhelming pleasure. “Master. Master. *Master!*”

His body was forced down once again when his hips raised, and he sobbed as he felt himself twitch helplessly. Teeth bit down hard into his bottom lip, threatening to break right through the skin.

Compared to the last few orgasms he’s had, this was a new experience entirely. The colors behind his tightly shut eyes were bright, vibrant, and ones he had never seen with anyone else before. The voice echoing through the hot bedroom was one that his ears had never heard with someone else before, sounding more pathetic than ever. Both were things Mydei pulled out of him like it was just another Friday evening for him, and he liked it. He *liked* it.

Phainon liked this.

Mydei’s movements slowed down as he began to fill his mouth, easing how hard he was sucking and instead calmly mouthing at him. He focused on the head, on milking every drop with a coaxing tongue on the underside.

Phainon could barely think as he laid there, one hand limp on his chest and one inside of Mydei’s hair. Fog clouded over his head for a moment, not one as dense as he remembered the last time they experimented, but thick nonetheless. Both legs felt completely useless as they lay limply on the bed, and sweat drenched every inch of his body. Ringing filled his ears for a moment, blocking the sounds of his own heavy breathing.

Suddenly, the room felt too hot and too stuffy around him.

“Mm…”

His heavy eyes opened as Mydei pulled off of him, and he looked down at him to watch as his throat worked to swallow. When he finished, his tongue licked slowly over his glistening lips.

“Are you okay?” He asked, voice scratchy from taking every inch of him down his throat. “How are you holding up?”

“How… How many have you sucked before?” He exhaled, and one eyebrow raised over the nature of his concern. “Where did you learn how to do that?”

“Years of practice. You’ll get there one day,” he told him, then swiped his thumb underneath his bottom lip to clean up what had spilled. “Come here.”

His pants and briefs were pulled up and buttoned, and Mydei stood up to take his spot by the edge of the bed. Each step had a weighty thump to it, and it sent a shiver down his spine to look up at him while boneless on his back.

“Did you enjoy that?” He asked, sitting beside him before guiding his head to his lap.

“Smells like leather.”

“I prefer it over metal,” he answered, and Phainon found that his sweaty cheek against the leather pants felt extremely uncomfortable. “What’s wrong?”

“Sticky,” he mumbled, pulling away from him.

Mydei’s hand cupped his cheek, cradling his face before laying it over his lap again. His wrist pressed to his collar, and his forearm was tucked between his shoulder and head to hold him steady. Like this, he could feel him skin to skin every step of the way. And, well, that was better than resting his sweaty face on his pants.

Phainon held his thigh back, touching his clothes carefully and following its inside seamline with his middle finger.

“Did you enjoy that, Phainon?” He asked again, using the thumb beside his jaw to gently trace the bone.

“Yes, master.”

His other hand picked the hair from his face lock by lock, strand by strand, revealing the flushed mess of his face. It felt cooler now for the air to hit his sweaty, exposed skin.

“Was that scary to you? Seeing me like that and having me take complete control of you, did that scare you?”

Mydei continued brushing his hair back, picking it from on top of his ears and off his sweaty nape.

“No,” he whispered as he curled deeper into his hand. It smelled like sweat and sex, but it was warm, comforting, and gentle beneath his face. “I’m not scared.”

“Good,” he returned. “What was it like to be beneath me?”

Phainon shifted, laying on his side and slipping his hand underneath Mydei's thigh. He held him tightly, and in return, another warm hand grasped his forearm.

"I've always tried to keep you on top of me when I please you, but what was it like to be beneath me for once?" He asked him, but Phainon's head was still too hazy to think up any complex responses.

"Nice…" He trailed off, then shook his head weakly. "I… I don't want to really… think right now, master. Can I… Can you just…?"

"I've got you. You don't need to *think*, you only need to *listen*," he promised. "Ten minutes, then we need to get you ready for your little playdate with your friend, hm? I'll even dress you up nice and handsome because I want you to show off the man I'm so proud of."

Phainon only nodded absentmindedly, having forgotten all about his other plans.

"You did so well for me tonight," Mydei said softly as he shut his eyes gently, focusing on his gentle traces and words. "Thank you, Phainon, for being so open and obedient for me."

Flutters filled his stomach, and he bent his knees to curl into himself slightly. Not that it helped in quelling it.

"Thank you for complimenting how I look dressed like this," he continued, and Phainon nodded again as his grasp over the leather loosened. "And thank you for trusting me to push you and making me feel so good. You're a good boy—*my* good boy. Can you hear me?"

Mydei's voice was so *hypnotic* as he sweetly praised him, and it felt so good to hear that over everything else his mind has ever tried to feed him.

"You're my good boy, my good *submissive*, and I'm so proud of you."

Ten minutes was *not* enough time. He wanted more than that of listening to his low voice sing his praise, of letting his body come down from the intensity of his orgasm, of being cradled and held like something precious after being pushed to the bed and made to cry. He wanted as much time as the clock had hours, minutes, and seconds. All of them should be spent in that sweet surrender. The two of them should have all of the time in the world to be together without the weight of their responsibilities beating down their backs.

But that was *his* experience.

For *him*, there was nothing but him and Mydei in that bed as they both came down. There was no outside world, no punishing shame, or no place to disappear to. It was just them. It was him with his sweaty cheek smashed to Mydei's palm, his arm tenderly held in the opposite, and the kind words around them in the midst of a sweet rosy and golden tint.

Mydei's experience was different, however, as he carefully wiggled his fingers and coaxed his head to lift.

"Come on," he coo'ed, looking down at him as he looked up at him. "I want you to get up now, Phainon. Let's get you some water, a small snack, and a shower."

“Master, I don’t wanna go anymore,” he mumbled. “Can I jus’… stay? Can I raincheck?”

“I’m sorry, Phainon, but you told her you would go, and you can’t flake on someone so close to the deadline.” His fingers wiggled again, disrupting his peace. “You wanted to go, and I’m more than happy to allow you to go have fun.”

“But—”

“You feel like this now, but once you meet up and start having fun, you’ll be happy you went,” he urged, and Phainon sighed. “She could be good for you.”

“*You’re* good for me,” he returned, not thinking much of what he said. “I can raincheck.”

“No, Phainon. I *want* you to go out. I *want* you to have fun, dress up, and let others see how handsome you are. Will you give that to me?” He asked, and Phainon frowned. “*Ah ah*, no pouting.”

“Not fair…”

Mydei *knew* what saying that would do to him. He *knew* requesting from him like that would make him cave even faster.

“I *want* to see you have fun. Send me videos of you guys dancing, photos of you over the night, and texts if you miss me,” he listed. “Let me see what you order, and show me the band that’s playing.”

He sighed, then nodded weakly while turning over.

“Do you want my card so you can open up a tab for you both?” Mydei offered kindly. “I don’t want you drinking since you’re a lightweight and you’re driving, but you can have virgin cocktails. You can order whatever food you both want—no restrictions.”

“No,” he shot down instantly. “Don’t want your money.”

“It’s a nice gesture to thank her for already getting you a ticket in,” he tried to convince him, but Phainon had already made his mind up.

“No.”

“Mm… Fine. We don’t need to talk about that anymore,” he agreed, rubbing his arm lightly. “Come on. Get up.”

The hand beneath his face lifted completely, and he willed himself to sit up. As he did so, Mydei stood up and took a few steps towards the bedroom door.

“Should I help you clean up before I go?” He tried to find an excuse to stay longer, but earned only a chuckle in response.

“I’ve got it,” Mydei hushed him. “If I can’t fund your night out, allow me to take all your other worries away. I can clean up while you shower.”

A hand was held out behind him, fingers pointed downwards and curling to beckon him to follow. It pulled on something in his chest, dragging him off of the bed and on to his feet.

“Keep your location on tonight too, okay?”

“I don’t think I ever turned it off,” he admitted to him as his fingers curled around his wrist. “My master has my tracker on all the time. I can’t hide from him.”

“It can stay that way,” Mydei teased him, allowing him to walk through the door first. “Do you hate that?”

“No. I don’t.”

It didn’t bother him. It didn’t hinder him. Having his location shared with Mydei wasn’t something he ever thought about as overbearing anymore, as Mydei never made it a big deal to randomly bring up where he was. He had it just in case, but those ‘*cases*’ never really seemed to come up.

“Good, it’s non-negotiable if there's a chance you’ll be drinking.” There wasn’t a chance to argue anyway. “Especially without me there to look out for you.”

“I can handle myself.”

“You can, but drugged people can’t fight. You have no control over things like road accidents either,” he brought up. “I’m not saying it’ll happen, I’m saying it could.”

Phainon knew he was right. There were sketchy and careless people everywhere in the world, but bars and clubs were the go-to spot for things of that nature. It wasn’t being paranoid to be cautious of potential threats.

“If something happens, will you even be awake?” He mumbled. “You’ll be in bed by the time I get there.”

“I don’t work tomorrow, so I’ll stay up a little extra to make sure you get home safely,” he promised him. “Will you go home, or will you come to me?”

He hadn’t thought about that. Not really. And as he tried to, his head just felt… messy, like it was attached by a singular thread.

“Um… I don’t… know. Cyrene might get curious. I think I…—”

“Come back,” Mydei suggested, noticing his spacey, slightly far away voice from having to *think* rather than simply *respond*. “I don’t want you alone tonight. We can wake up a little bit later, seven instead of six, and we can go about our days together. I want to be next to you, Phainon.”

“But, ‘rene…”

Mydei nodded. “I can deal with that. Don’t worry your pretty head with it. I wouldn’t try to put you in a spot where it burdens your relationships, okay?”

Phainon smiled, then nodded, trusting him to take care of it all for him.

Chapter End Notes

mydei in leather and phainon in his play collar is my fixation right now, tbh. i need to find my apple pen ASAP so i can draw them

Chapter 11: Chapter Eleven

Chapter Notes

some phainon and hysilens friendship things and some soft mydei and phainon things.

please enjoy his emotional rollercoaster and then some comfort

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The bar they agreed to meet up at was nice from the outside, but it was packed full of people which made finding a parking spot difficult. By the time he found one, he was almost ready to do a dance right inside of his seat.

A large glass window painted with colorful markers over it caught his eye, as did the group of people standing in front taking photos together. They were laughing and giggling in a cloud of cigarette smoke, and he was pleasantly surprised to see Hysilens was outside having a cigarette too. Tucked to the far side where no one else was, she had her back to a brick wall, knees pushed up to her chest and heavy boots flat to the floor. A leather jacket was draped over her lap, most likely to protect herself as he was willing to bet that she had a dress or skirt on beneath it.

He waved in her direction, earning only the attention from the people around her. One guy waved back enthusiastically, nodding at him with a smile before looking away.

Phainon shook his head and sighed to himself before approaching the woman so painfully anti-social that it *hurt*. He was *hurting* from this.

“Hey.”

Hysilens jumped, then looked up at him in surprise as if she didn’t expect him to be there so suddenly. Smoke fell from her lips before she waved it away.

“I thought you said your wife didn’t like you smoking?” He asked, recalling a text message that she sent him before. “What are you doing with that?”

“I got here too early and got nervous,” she admitted sheepishly. “I’m sorry. I’ll put it out.”

He watched her toss it to the floor, then step on it while standing up. She picked her jacket off her lap, and Phainon held out his arm while looking at her.

“We kinda match.”

Hysilens nodded, holding her leather sleeve beside his.

“Do you dress like that normally?” She asked as he reached for his wallet to pull his ID out. “Your social media pages show you dressed differently. Less… dark, more… How do I say this without being rude? *Average?*”

He laughed at that, making her wince as if she felt guilty for saying that. “I’ve been trying new things. Nothing’s wrong with a little bit of experimenting, right?”

“Experimenting is good,” she agreed, handing her ID over as well as their tickets. “It looks good.”

“Thanks.”

Mydei liked him dressed like this. Not that he hated his usual style, but he liked him in certain colors and certain types of clothes. He liked black leather jackets and jeans that hugged his legs nicely. He liked t-shirts that showed off his arms and chest too. Something about his supposedly ‘*sweet*’ face dressed in dark colors seemed to speak to him, and truthfully? Phainon liked showing off for him.

Forget the person who saw him and then looked once more as they passed by. He didn’t matter.

When Mydei saw him come out of his bathroom fully dressed, he grabbed him by the chin and whispered into his ear how *handsome* he looked. He told him how his jeans made his thighs look *thick*, and the jacket made his shoulders look *bigger*.

That was the only reason he ever dressed up in any kind of way. Besides simply not caring too much about what he wore, having Mydei tell him how good he looked always felt nice.

“Want a drink?” She asked, and he shook his head. “My wife is letting me start a tab for us. Whatever you want, please help yourself.”

“I’m driving,” he reminded her. “And I don’t need you to pay for me. I can get you though, if you’d like. Let me thank you for inviting me out tonight.”

She looked over to him, then smiled sheepishly as her head shook. “I can’t let you do that.”

“‘*Can’t*’?”

“My wife doesn’t like it when other people pay for me,” she told him. “I have to decline. Thank you, though.”

“You… let her do that often?” He wondered curiously, and her head tilted in confusion over his question. “I mean… obviously you’re married, but… how does that work?”

“We should find a table and sit down,” she offered, a gentle tilt to her tone that proved she understood where he was coming from. “I could talk about her all night, so this could get long.”

He knew.

Usually it would be annoying to hear someone drone on and on about their partner, but there was something in the way she spoke about her that made him want to know more. Hysilens praised her like she was some kind of all powerful queen, like she could do absolutely no wrong and whatever she said suddenly became law itself. Whatever she was told to do, she did to the best of his abilities even if it obviously made her uncomfortable.

This woman sounded a lot like Mydei from what he heard, and he wanted to see if they had any more similarities.

Wanting to spoil someone was another thing they shared with one another, on top of pushing them out of their comfort zones and deciding what they looked best in. Seeing her smoking when she asked to be friends, then again while alone and waiting for him, probably meant her wife pushed her to do this with him tonight too. Just as Mydei encouraged him to come out tonight even when all he wanted to do was stay in bed with him. They were encouraging them to go out without them, and that put them here while the other two sat back and watched through their phone screens.

“Are you sure I can’t get you something?” She asked again. “If you refuse, my wife might see it as you rejecting her generosity. It’s rude to refuse a gift.”

“I don’t usually like it when people pay for me,” he admitted. “It feels a little bit…”

“Selfish? Like you’re taking advantage of someone's kindness?” She finished, hitting the nail right in the head. “I used to think that way, but it’s okay to accept a gift just because someone *wants* to give it to you. Just your presence can be a gift for someone.”

Phainon hummed, and when someone pushed past Hysilens’ smaller body, he offered his arm for her to grab on to.

“Are you trying to gift me a free meal then?”

“My wife is,” she corrected him as they walked deeper into the bar together. “She offered to cover it as a gift for coming to meet me. She’s very grateful.”

“You both make it sound like I’m doing charity work,” he laughed, slightly awkward from the constant mentioning of it.

Was it not embarrassing to keep bringing *that* up?

Her eyes shifted, and she pinched her earring while curling into herself. “Isn’t it kind of like that? You just tolerate me while I talk about myself and my wife? That’s not fun for you to deal with, is it?”

Phainon only laughed in return, the sound light and easygoing. He pulled her closer, away from the crowds of people and on to his opposite side. There was more space for her to walk, less bodies to bump into, and therefore more room for her to breathe. Hopefully, that helped her relax a little bit more around him.

“You know, you really shouldn’t talk so poorly about yourself like that,” he advised her as she linked her arm with his. “I get it’s easy to do, but you deserve better than to feel like someone’s burden. ”

She was quiet, so he continued.

“This isn’t some drag to do. I’m here to have fun and get to know you better, so don’t think you’re forcing me into anything. I’m a grown man. I can say ‘*no*’.”

Hysilens nodded, but whether she was truly comforted by the statement or not, he had no clue. “Thank you, Phainon,” was all she said in return.

“And, for the record, I like listening to you talk about your wife. It’s cute how much you love her, and it’s obvious she brings you the most comfort,” he noticed. “So… will you tell me more about her over a drink? Preferably something without alcohol.”

That made her perk up.

“I’m not allowed to drink tonight,” she returned, and he thought about that word for a moment—‘*allowed*’. She wasn’t ‘*allowed*’ to drink, just as she ‘*can’t’* let him pay for her.

His eyebrow lifted. “Why’s that?”

“My wife doesn’t like when I drink without someone she trusts around,” she disclosed. “That’s not a slight on you, but the people who might be here.”

Phainon wasn’t offended at all, and part of him wasn’t surprised to hear that. Something in him expected a response like that.

More than just Mydei and her wife, maybe the two of them had more in common than he thought as he remembered those same words leaving Mydei’s mouth. It wasn’t *just* about him driving later. It was about him being a lightweight too, and Mydei didn't want him to drink without having him around to look after him. Who knew if someone would try to get in too close with the wrong intentions?

He assumed her wife felt exactly the same. She didn’t know these people, and she couldn’t trust them with her spouse. Hell, *he* was a stranger to her, so he couldn’t blame her if she didn't see him as trustworthy yet either.

“I hope to become someone your wife can trust so you can have fun around me,” he told her kindly. “Also, my finger’s a little bit itchy tonight. You don’t mind if I take some photos and videos of us, right? For the memories.”

Mydei wanted to see him have fun, and he wanted to share this night with him too even if he wasn’t around.

She held her phone up too, waving it shyly in agreement. “My wife requested I do the same…”

That made him think back to earlier that night, to her eyes on his day collar and the assumption of a girlfriend. Her potentially figuring him out was a terrifying thought, and it made his stomach knot uncomfortably all over again.

But he was being a bit of a hypocrite tonight.

The more she knew about him, the more he wanted to run away and hide it all inside of a locked box. But the more she casually shared with him about her, the more… *normal*… everything about him began to feel.

She spoke of her own permissions, and it made him think of himself and his own. If it was weird, over-protective, or out of the ordinary to have someone behind him to request this of him, then she was right there with him, right? Or was it wrong to relate his dominant and submissive dynamic with her marriage despite not having any kind of confirmation she was into the same thing?

They had similar rules. They had similar people looking over them. The only difference was the ring on her finger and the comfort she had in expressing it openly to people.

Phainon looked at that ring as he thought about it, then the earring he recalled matched her wife's necklace.

"I can send you the pictures I take, and you can send me the ones you take, and we'll have twice the memories of tonight to share," he suggested, and that made her eyes sparkle. Pink dusted over her pale cheeks, and both were pushed to a plush round from her wide grin.

She was always so pleased and so excited to make her partner happy, and part of him wondered if he looked nearly half as sweet in Mydei's eyes.

Did *he* look like that?

When he did something to make Mydei happy, and that made him feel proud of himself, did he have that same look on his face?

Hysilens grabbed his arm and dragged him towards the bar immediately after hearing his proposition, and he couldn't help but share that excitement. As much as he was here for himself and to have a good night, he wanted to share this with Mydei and let him see the result of his influence.

He liked keeping him updated on his life away from him. A lot.

—

Despite never knowing this place existed, Phainon enjoyed his time there. Drinking mocktails and munching on finger foods as they listened to the live band perform was nice. He took photos of him and Hysilens with their pretty glasses, videos of the band playing on the lit up

stage, and quick mirror pictures inside the bathroom with strangers who wanted in on the attention. Men who posed right beside him, smiled brightly as the shutter went off, and laughed before wishing him a fun time.

It made him so glad that he agreed to come in the first place, then beyond grateful that Mydei pushed him to come out when he tried to change his mind.

He learned more about Hysilens and her relationship too, like how she and her wife had been together for nearly ten years. They met in high school, explored what being together would be like, then committed to it before they could go to different colleges. She went to school for music, her wife studied law, and they moved in together after school. They then moved here for her wife's work, and Hysilens followed because she didn't care where she was as long as she was beside the other woman.

Though he didn't say it out loud, that sounded so romantic.

"You do whatever she says then?" He asked casually, hoping it wasn't too heavy of a question to spring upon her.

"She wants what's best for me," she replied, holding a french fry to her mouth before taking a bite. "All I ever need to worry about is having fun and coming home to her."

"Why do you still work if she pays for everything?"

"My money is put into our savings and used to save for vacations. Her money is spent on everything else," she answered like it was that simple. "I never need to worry about it because her card always has enough for whatever I need it for."

Phainon looked down at his drink, taking in the mint garnish and the half-empty glass full of limes before stirring it with his straw.

"You don't feel the need to… *I don't know*… hold on to that part of yourself? Is it hard letting her do it all for you?" He couldn't help but wonder.

"She's my wife."

One thing he noticed is Hysilens never used her name. In text messages, in social media posts, in verbal conversations, she never spoke her name when referring to her. She was '*her wife*', and it felt like that was the only thing that ever needed to be said about the woman.

Why did she do something? Because *her wife* said so.

And why did she listen so diligently? Because that was *her wife.*

"Are you not allowed to say her name?"

Hysilens hummed thoughtfully, and when he looked up at her, she shook her head. "I don't feel the need to say it unless someone asks me specifically what it is. Referring to her as what she is makes the most sense, and she feels the same."

When she met his eyes, he picked his drink up and took a slow sip, unable to hold on to her gaze for long.

“Can I ask you something, Phainon?”

He nodded while drinking.

“What do you think about relationships where… someone has more power than the other person?” She asked him, speaking carefully but getting right to the point. “Like my wife and I?”

“I… uh…”

What was he supposed to say without giving himself away?

“I don’t… ever see myself having a partner who would want to rely so heavily on me,” he confessed to her, hoping that would suffice. “It’s not for me.”

He couldn’t be like Mydei and her wife. Even if he had the means to support that kind of lifestyle, the stress alone would be too much to handle on a daily basis. Having to worry about himself on top of someone else so closely would make him panic over the right thing to do at every turn. Being a provider for someone else never once crossed his mind, not in the way they did it.

He could work. Being a breadwinner wasn’t the issue if he could bother applying elsewhere out of his comfort zone, and being someone reliable wasn’t what worried him when he knew he was.

But he couldn’t take someone’s life, hold it in his hands, then mold it to their combined image like clay. He didn’t have *that* in him.

“What about the opposite?” She brought up after, and he gulped quietly to himself. “What about… being someone like me? The one being taken care of?”

“I never considered that possibility,” he lied, attempting to protect his secret.

“Your necklace is very pretty,” Hysilens complimented him suddenly, then tapped a certain spot on her throat. “The lock on the chain needs to be readjusted though.”

His eyes widened over her observation, and he immediately reached for his neck before gripping the chain. Sure enough, the pill sized lock was front and center by his shirt’s collar for all to see. How long had it been like that?

Frantic hands spun the lock towards the back of his neck to hide, and as she looked at it, then at him, he exhaled shakily. Caught. Like a deer in headlights just awaiting the impact.

“I-I’m… I didn’t…”

She knew he was lying to her.

“It’s okay,” Hysilens told him gently. “No one would notice if they didn’t already know what it was.”

But she knew.

It wasn’t speculation anymore. The worry of being found out wasn’t just a worry anymore, it was reality. This was *real*.

She knew about him wearing a locked collar, and she knew there was someone behind him telling him what to do. She knew he reported back to his dominant to get permission to come out tonight, and she knew he was a filthy liar for saying he didn’t think much of a dynamic with a power imbalance.

“It’s not just a necklace, is it?”

He was quiet, and her fingers brushed over her pierced ear before gently brushing the dangling pearl.

“If it makes you feel better, this isn’t just an earring.”

His eyes watched it swing for a moment, unsure whether he wanted to run from her now or sit in his discomfort to face it head on.

The air around them was thick and heavy, hot from the bodies packed in and stuffy from too many combined scents. It didn’t go down easily. It didn’t taste like anything but fear. Even as he tried hard to swallow it down, his lungs felt as if there wasn't enough of it to go around.

This table they occupied was so public. There were so many people around them. Though no one seemed to care or notice what was happening, he couldn't help but fear that they knew. Somehow, someway, everyone knew, like when he first started this journey and had ‘*pervert*’ planted over his forehead everywhere he went.

Reason said no one but Hysilens knew. But his nerves didn't listen to *reason*.

With his collar in hand, Phainon dragged his finger over the golden chain and traced over each slender link. He circled around the ring and slid the attached pendant side to side, toying with it.

If Mydei were here, he'd tell him not to worry. He’d tell him that he didn’t owe her an explanation, and if he didn’t want to share a word about it, he didn’t need to. This was *their* business. This was *their* life. Even if she guessed right, or if he was careless enough, he didn't need to open his mouth.

But… he was caught.

Noticing his discomfort, she sighed. “I pierced this ear for my mistress.”

Phainon looked at the backs facing them their way from the people ignoring their presences, then back at her as she smiled lightly. There was a look in her eye that made him wonder if he she cared at all that anyone could see, or potentially hear, her.

Was she really *that* shameless? Did her wife not care if she told people?

No. Did her '*mistress*' not care?

"I wear too many chokers, and I have so many necklaces. I didn't want her ownership to look like just any old necklace," Hysilens shared with him, and his eyes darted to her neck full of layered accessories. "I pierced my ear, and she gave me this earring—a pearl, because I love the sea and my mistress loves me."

'*Mistress*'. Mydei brought that title up when he tried to poke and tease him, but even thinking about that name when referring to someone whose face he could point out made him uneasy. To him, that was *her wife*. He didn't like the title so much as floating around in his head even if Hysilens was quick and comfortable to share it with him.

Phainon liked his *master*. He liked the thought of Mydei being the only person in his head with any kind of title attached to him. That was *his* thing. That was reserved only for *him*.

"Is she your… *wife*… all the time?" He managed to force himself to ask, and one dark eyebrow lifted over his question. "Is that why you don't say her name?"

"Yes. She is my *wife*, nothing less."

So many questions plagued his head, but Mydei didn't want anyone to know this side of him. Only his submissive was allowed to know he liked this kind of relationship, and that meant he couldn't speak a word of anything that could identify him as his dominant. But he was curious. It was eating away at him.

Was this '*normal*' for her too then? All day and every day, were they practicing it like he and Mydei were? Was she as ashamed as he was when they first started exploring this?

A part of him wanted to know how she handled it, if she could give him tips, and if he came across as obvious. He wanted to know how similar his experience was to her own, and if he was '*normal*' to be enjoying it as much as he did. Reassurance from someone other than Mydei could be nice, as the shared experiences between them so far have brought him a little bit of comfort in opening up. Could she offer him advice on how to feel better *inside*—one submissive to another?

But another part wanted to run. He wanted to jump out of his seat, hop into his car, and drive as far as possible from her. The door was so close, and he just needed to move his feet. They could pretend this night and conversation never happened, and he could just… ignore her the next time they saw each other at—

No.

He couldn't do that. That was too cruel to imagine.

She came clean, and she was trying to make him feel better. He wasn't that kind of person, and Mydei would be so utterly disappointed in him for being a coward like that. He wouldn't just scold him, he'd punish him, and not the '*fun*' kind either.

A submissive who just kept misbehaving on purpose and racking up the '*bad*' kinds of punishments wasn't a good one, was he? If he suddenly stopped playing the role he agreed to, that would be upsetting to the stability they've slowly created together. If he stopped giving him obedience, then why would Mydei keep giving him his guidance?

Phainon exhaled, pulling harder on the necklace as he tried to recall the way Mydei said he was okay. *This* was okay. He had no reason to be ashamed, and he had nothing to feel dirty about.

He was okay.

Hysilens knew, but she was in the same boat as he was. How could she see him in any kind of way if that reflected on her as well?

If he was dirty, *she* was dirty. If he was weak, *she* was weak. If he wasn't normal for being collared every single day, *she* wasn't normal for using '*wife*' as a secret title for her dominant.

"Phainon?"

"I-I need some air. Please excuse me."

His chair scraped to the tiled floors, and he winced while heading towards the exit. Bodies bumped into him in his pursuit to leave, and he stumbled over his own boots from his own clumsiness. People scoffed behind him, and some managed to see him barreling through to step out of the way just in time.

When he managed to make it out anyway, he took a slow and deep breath of the cool, crisp air around him. There weren't many people outside now that the band had left and the night matured, leaving the stench of cigarettes distant. It was refreshing, and it grounded him as he stepped away from the building and pulled his phone out.

Shaky fingers fumbled with it, and there were two things he noticed when turning the screen on—one being it was nearly midnight, and the second being he had about four percent of battery left from all the time he spent recording his night. He kept all his memories, but sacrificed his comfort in this moment as he watched the number drop to three.

Three percent, just enough to open their messages and see that the last text sent was his own unopened string of pictures. They were left on '*delivered*', and that made him realize Mydei probably fell asleep. It was so late, and he probably tried to stay up, but couldn't bring himself to.

Oh, was he going to be in trouble *anyways?*

Maybe not seriously. Knowing Mydei, he'd probably make his punishment something like waking up early despite going to bed so late. That was the natural consequence of being out like this. Or he'd make him sleep earlier the next few nights, meaning no movies, shows, or videos before bed.

He could deal with that. It was boring, and he would prefer to have it, but punishment was punishment.

While thinking, he felt someone stand beside him, and he knew the silhouette in his peripheral vision well.

“We still match,” she told him, and he looked down as she held up her bare arm beside his leather clad one. “You don’t need to talk about it, and you don’t need to worry about me talking about your business. The only person I’m obligated to share information with is my wife.”

That made sense.

“If you don’t want to bring it up, I won’t,” Hysilens promised, and he nodded quickly. “If you need anything, ask. I’m pretty open about this to people I get close to. It’s been my life for almost… six years now, maybe? I think I have some knowledge of it… trials, errors, successes, and all.”

Six years.

Mydei said he had two years under his belt of practicing it, then a few more of researching and being interested in it in silence. She had more than that. She must know even *more* than he did about this.

“If you don’t feel comfortable talking about it with me, here. You can look at this blog, and you never have to talk to me about it again,” she offered, and he held his hand out as she placed a napkin in it. “I document everything there. It’s my online journal.”

Vaguely, he remembered Mydei saying he stumbled across someone’s journey online when he first got into everything. He didn’t get the violent videos and crude fantasies of fanatics like he did. He found *this*, blogs and communities of real people doing real things in their day-to-day lives. Nothing fabricated. Nothing exaggerated.

“Are you sure this is okay?” He asked quietly, gripping it tightly. “I… I don’t mean to pry, or be weird about this. I’m just… new to this all. Like really new.”

“Consider it a ‘*thank you*’. You’ve done your best to make me comfortable, so if I can help, I’d like to as well.” Her sincere expression made it difficult for him to deny her kindness. “We’re friends now, right? Nothing has to change because of what we do in secret on our own time.”

Where did he hear *that* before?

He looked at the name written on the napkin, then watched her check her phone for the time.

“My wife will be angry at me if I’m not home soon, so I should call it a night.” She sighed to herself after. “And you?”

“Yeah, I should have been back a bit ago,” he admitted, not able to admit he had someone waiting on him too.

“Are you okay to drive? You’re not shaken up or anything, right?” She asked, and he nodded in response. “*Yes*… you’re shaken up?”

“No,” he laughed, getting a sense of deja vu from this too. “No, I’m okay. Thank you. Really. I… uh… I had a good time, and… thank you, again, for *this*.”

He held the napkin, and she elbowed him gently. It didn’t hurt, nor was it particularly hard, but he allowed himself to sway from the push.

“Don’t tell anyone,” she requested. “I’m open with you because we’re friends, but I’d like to keep my intimate little journal, well, *intimate*. It isn’t that popular, and I like it that way. It’s just me, my wife, and a small community of people like us.”

“I don’t even know who I’d tell,” he confessed awkwardly. It wasn’t as if he wanted people to know he looked at stuff like this, let alone practiced it. “Text me when you get home so I know you made it safely.”

“You too,” she returned. “I’ll see you at work—”

“And come out with my friends and I sometime,” he cut her off with a rush. “You should have more than just me and your phone to hang out with. The girls will love you, if you don’t mind Cyrene’s preppiness, Cassie’s timidness, and Cifera’s curiosity.”

“I’d like that,” she said while holding her keys in hand. “I’ll ask my wife. I’m very sure she’ll be happy to let me go. Who knows? Maybe I can convince her to come out and meet the guy she allowed to take me out.”

Phainon liked that idea. He wanted to see how they acted in public too, if it was like him and Mydei or if they knew how to be more discreet. Maybe they could learn from them, as they had so much more experience.

Maybe Mydei could make a friend with her wife too.

“I’d like that too,” he repeated. “Good night, Hysilens.”

“Good night, Phainon.”

He watched her walk towards her car, waving as she started it and laughing when her music boomed louder than it should have been. For extra measure, he waited for her to pull out completely from the parking lot, then his feet carried him towards his own vehicle.

Oh, he couldn’t wait to lay down beside Mydei and finally go to bed. His head was hurting, and he was exhausted from the nerves burning up his energy.

—

It was past midnight by the time he got back to Mydei's place. His fingers carefully took his borrowed boots off, gently pulling the zipper and setting them on the rack beside him. The borrowed jacket was hung up in a coat closet nearby as well, left so it could be wiped down and cleaned at a later time. All of it was routine the moment he walked into his home.

Phainon's busy, thought-riddled head didn't even notice the lights were still on until his fingers pushed gently to the wall and found the switch already flipped. Beneath the refrigerator hum, beneath his own shaky breathing, soft and steady snores filled the open floored kitchen and living room. They were welcoming and familiar in every way, easing his frustrations almost immediately.

He found Mydei right there by the kitchen bar. There was a cold cup of coffee by his sleeping figure, its contents half empty with a beige lip stain on the edge of its white rim. Beside that sat a glass cake dish full of fluffy, gooey cinnamon rolls stacked into an uneven tower due to their differing sizes. They were slathered messily in icing, so much so that it dripped over one another and made a complete mess over the bottom of the dish and its dome.

It looked as if he had fallen asleep while resting his head in his hand, as if he tried to stay up but ultimately ended up succumbing to exhaustion. Hunched over the counter with his face tucked into his inner elbow, the way his arm and wrist hung over the back of his head looked anything but comfortable.

His best friend *was* waiting for him. He probably went and baked to stay up longer, made some coffee to fight his own internal clock, forced himself to finish the desserts even if he could barely bring himself to care about aesthetics, then passed out trying to wait some more. Not that Phainon could blame him. This was later than he ever stayed up. He slept by ten, but it was past midnight.

Guilt settled in his stomach as he looked at his uncomfortable position, at his crooked arm and slumped over back.

How long was he asleep? His back was going to *hate* him in the morning.

One hand gently settled over his shoulder, sliding along his cold skin from underneath the cut out of his tank-top. Phainon rubbed him gently, not wanting to shock him or scare him awake.

The action caused Mydei to shiver before curling deeper into himself, fingers twitching and balling into his fist slowly. His next breath was deep and clearly disturbed, before it slowly mellowed out once more.

"De," he whispered carefully, and the other man hummed just shy of inaudibly. "Let's get you to bed."

"Mm…"

"You don't look very comfortable."

"Mm…?"

Amusement twitched his lip upwards over the confused rumble.

"*Master*," he said into his ear lightly, dragging the name out almost teasingly to coax him awake. "Can I take you to bed?"

At the sound of that, Mydei's arm lowered slowly, stiffly, carefully against the counter until it was flat to the cool surface. Then, he wiped his mouth. One eye cracked open just enough to look at him before he turned to look at his hand on his shoulder.

Phainon couldn't help but wince when his joints popped and cracked from him sitting up.

"…—is it?"

"What's that?" He mused, unable to understand the quiet, rumbling sound that left his lips.

Mydei hummed again sleepily, his voice still low and raspy as he slowly let himself wake up. "What… time… is it?"

Phainon sighed quietly, disappointed in himself when a pair of rosy eyes stared back at him, half-lidded and exhausted. "It's after midnight. I'm sorry, master."

"Did you have fun?" Mydei asked him while picking his elbows off the counter and straightening himself out in his seat. "Did your friend have fun?"

He was sweet.

Forget his misdemeanor, and forget that he was just woken up in the middle of the night. He wanted to know how *he* was tonight.

"I had a lot of fun. It was an… interesting night."

A quiet groan then left his lips, and Phainon laughed quietly while watching him immediately reach to hold his back.

"Shut up…" Mydei grumbled as he pushed his shoulders back. "I should be sleeping in my bed…"

But he fell asleep waiting up on him, he knew. It didn't need to be said out loud to hang heavy in the air.

"Do you want me to rub your back?" He teased him, sliding his hand deeper beneath his tank-top to brush between his shoulder blades. "I'll put you to bed with a massage."

A low hum filled the quiet room, pleased by the feeling of him pressing his fingers down and rubbing. His head tilted back, eyes shutting in gentle bliss and drowsiness.

"Did… you eat enough tonight?"

"Yeah, I ate and drank plenty. Hysilens ordered us a ton of food, but I might have had a few more mocktails than I should have. Please don't punish me for being so careless with my

sugar intake," he joked, and Mydei's lip curled upwards with his own.

Clearly, he was feeling more playful than anything.

"You're fine. It's a single night, and you were out," he reassured him. "Make sure you drink water before you lay down. Those aren't hydrating."

"I will," he reassured him.

"Did you treat her tonight? Or did you guys split?" He wondered, rolling his head to the side. "I'm… mm… assuming you split…?

"Actually…" Mydei's eyebrows furrowed upon hearing that. "The tab was on her wife's card. She said they wanted to treat me, and… I wasn't going to argue in front of so many people. She basically told me it's rude to refuse a gift."

"Oh."

It was only one word, but Phainon could feel that something was off the moment it was spoken. His body didn't feel any different as his shoulders weren't tense and he didn't notice his jaw flex, but his voice sounded stiff. It sounded displeased by the revelation.

"Is something wrong?"

"Stop touching me," he murmured after another moment of quiet, and Phainon's hand stilled mid-rub down his back. "Please take your hand off of me."

He pulled back, watching as Mydei's head straightened out and his hand went to wipe his eyes again. A sinking feeling filled his stomach as he watched his eyes open, squinting from the light but focused on him.

"You… let her wife pay for you?" He asked him as if he didn't believe the words leaving his mouth. "You let *another person's dominant* provide something for you that *I* could have given to you?"

"Did I do something wrong by accepting?"

Mydei was silent for another moment, then his head shook lightly. "No, you didn't do anything wrong. That just surprised me."

The stool lightly creaked as he stood up carefully, and Phainon looked down at the counter while chewing on his bottom lip. He thought about his reaction, about his fallen smile and the immediate denial of being touched when he had been previously enjoying it. He repeated his words, thumbing over their confusion and wondering what could possibly—

"Wait, how did you know that…?" He brought up unsurely, watching as Mydei grabbed his coffee cup. "I never told you Hysilens and her wife were…—"

"No, you didn't," he agreed. "I follow her blog online, and I was surprised you knew her and worked with her. It's also why I really wanted you to go out with her tonight. She could be

good for you and your confidence, Phainon."

He didn't know what to say to that.

Mydei was playing match maker with him, pushing him to be friends with her tonight so he could… *what?* Confide in her about what they did? He could barely talk to her after she pieced him together and saw the lock on his collar. In fact, he ran out on her and needed to be chased into the parking lot.

It was wishful thinking to hope he could ever confess about the things they did.

"I can reassure you, but maybe another submissive could make you feel more understood than I could," he tried to explain to him.

Phainon wanted to say he didn't care about what other people did like he always did, but… that would be lying now. He was curious. He was so curious how her experience was similar to or different from his own, especially in their daily lives.

Mydei's style of dominance was what he knew, but what did she experience with her wife? Was it just like him—minus the marriage part?

"You were looking out for me in a way you thought was best, and I appreciate that. I had a really nice night because of that push," he settled on, and Mydei looked at him as if he didn't expect to hear that from him. "But I would have appreciated you telling me that more though, Mydei. You didn't need to hide that from me."

"I should have said something to you," he agreed quietly. "But understand that it wasn't *my* business to tell you what she did in her own time. Just as it isn't *your* business to tell anyone what you do in yours."

That was reasonable. He could understand why he didn't tell him as that was how Mydei always was.

"But you still should have given me a head's up," he argued. "I tell you everything you need to know. I feel like I deserved to know that."

"I know. I'm sorry, Phainon."

A moment of silence passed between them, and Phainon's hand reached slowly for his arm before leaning into his shoulder. He held him gently, fingers wrapping around his upper elbow as his nose turned in deeper to the cold bicep beside him. As he closed his eyes, another breath interrupted the silence.

"On the topic of sharing things with you… I wish you allowed me to pay for your night, not her," he brought up. "I know we didn't agree to you giving me that, but I'm a little *disappointed* in knowing someone else could do something for you that I was refused."

"'*Disappointed*'?" He repeated playfully, trying to shift the heaviness in the air. "Or *jealous?*"

He didn't even need to answer. It was the lack of response that said more than his words ever could.

“My master’s cute when he’s jealous,” Phainon teased him, and a scoff followed. “I won’t let her do it again. It was a one time thing, so don’t think too much about it, okay?”

“Good.”

One weighty hand dropped on top of his head, and he couldn't help his smile when it ruffled the ivory strands. They fanned over his face messily, slightly stiff from him meticulously styling it earlier in the night.

“I don’t want *someone’s mistress* looking after *my prince*.”

“I… told Hysilens about us too,” he added after, unable to open his eyes and meet Mydei’s in fear he’d be upset. “Well, I didn’t tell her about us. She saw the lock on my collar, and she put it together herself. She knows that I’m *someone’s* collared submissive now, just not *whose*.”

“Does she? How does that make you feel?” Mydei asked gently, turning his body so he was face first into his collar rather than his arm. “Are you okay?”

He shrugged weakly, pushing deeper into him as a pair of arms wrapped around his shoulders. “It’s really scary, and I feel really exposed when she looks at me, but… maybe you and her are right. Maybe it’ll be good for me, but I just won’t realize it until later.”

It could be similar to how he enjoyed exploring this *now* but was so sure he’d hate it when he first thought about it, or when he used to call him ‘master’ as a way to ridicule him but *now* he used it as a way to address him.

Maybe now it felt intimidating to be so open, but later he’ll look back and realize he needed this. He just needed to trust the judgement of people who knew more than him about it.

“She gave me her page. She said to look at it sometime if I can’t bring myself to talk to her directly about it. Will you… look at it with me sometime?” A tilt of hope laced his words, but it didn’t encompass the *desperation* he felt inside for him to agree. “I’m scared to look at these things online by myself. I don’t want to see the *bad* parts all over again.”

“An important thing to realize is that both sides can co-exist together, Phainon. There is no ‘*good*’ side or ‘*bad*’ side, just what’s ‘*comfortable*’ to you and what’s not,” he said softly. “You can be uncomfortable or repulsed with what some people practice and take part in, but that doesn't necessarily make it ‘*bad*’. They’re not bad people for wanting heavier plays or dynamics.”

He didn’t even consider the possibility.

“Is… her page heavy?” He forced himself to ask, unsure if he even wanted to know.

Could he stomach seeing Hysilens, someone he considered his friend now, in that same position of the girls he saw before? Would he be able to look at her the same if he somehow

saw pictures or videos of her body in an explicit kind of way? Should he actually look at that page?

“Her mistress is much, much more strict than I am, and her punishments are heavier than the ones I deliver. Their dynamic has been sharpened and developed over years of trust, experimenting, and love,” he explained carefully. Phainon’s stomach dropped at what was, essentially, a *warning*. “You might read some entries of hers and get squeamish, but you might also find some things helpful. I don’t want you on it without me.”

“I won’t,” he promised, and Mydei rubbed his stiffened shoulders soothingly. “Can we go to bed? I’m really, really tired. The day has been physically and emotionally draining.”

On top of work and being up later than he has in a long time, it felt like his emotions were on a rollercoaster. He had been anxious and afraid. He had been jealous and upset. He had been so blissed out he couldn’t think, then so deep in his head that time completely escaped him.

Now, he just wanted to go to bed with Mydei cuddled up behind him, his fist on his neck and their heads on the same pillow.

“I need to clean up my mess, and you need to go change before we can prepare for bed,” he reminded him. “We have to be up early to work out, then we need to pack these cinnamon rolls up after breakfast.”

His eyebrows furrowed in confusion.

‘*Package*’?

“I told Cyrene you came over to help me make some sweets for everyone,” Mydei chuckled over his confused silence. “She sounded happy. So, I want to spend some time tomorrow handing them out to our friends. Don’t worry, you and her can have most of them, but only if you promise not to eat them all at once.”

Oh.

Mydei made that towering stack of cinnamon rolls a little funny looking to make it look done by his unskilled hand, and he did it to protect him from Cyrene’s interrogation of why he didn't come home after work. When he said he would take care of it for him, he actually did. He *meant it.*

Phainon’s chest fluttered as he looked down at his tank-top, but guilt pooled into his stomach the more he thought about it.

“You… *lied?*”

For *him?*

“If you package them, it’s not lying,” he reasoned. “I didn’t say what you did, just that you’re helping me. If you don’t correct their assumptions, it’s not lying. It’s protecting your business.”

He guessed that made sense. Mydei did that often with most things to keep his privacy, or maybe to avoid an unnecessary confrontation, but it still didn't make him feel any better that he was still, essentially, *lying.*

"Go change. I'll join you in a second," Mydei said to him finally, patting his shoulder firmly to symbolize their hug was over. "Come on, prince."

Phainon pulled away from him, and he let his fingers trace over the muscle on Mydei's arm slowly. They lined from his bicep to his inner elbow, and he curled them gently when they met his outstretched hand. In doing so, their fingers linked together for a second, holding each other by the knuckles.

"I better have my pajamas ready and my things out, *master*," he taunted him, referencing their usual routine.

Mydei always had his clothes tucked neatly away from him, and if he wasn't tasked with grabbing them himself, his skin care was the same way. The bottles and tubes were left out to be easily grabbed by him, and it was his job to put them right where they belonged after he used them.

"Your things are where they always are, ready for you to use them."

Their fingers broke apart when he took another step away from him, and while his arm dropped, Mydei's own lingered for a moment. His fingers stayed bent at the knuckles, then curled into his palm before raising towards his chest.

"Don't take too long." Phainon pointed at him, then turned around while feeling Mydei's eyes on his retreating body.

"You forgot to drink water!" He called after him. "I'll bring you some, but now you owe me *two* bottles before bed."

"Yes, master!" He returned, laughing to himself over how protective he could be. It was cute. It was sweet.

With rules like that, why was he ever nervous of them again?

Chapter End Notes

i want to write them looking at her page together so badly. i want phainon to see these things and look at mydei like "i WANT to try this" or "i DONT want you to do this". because he started this not knowing anything, but now hes interested and has wants for this. itd be nice character development.

i also want to write more of mydei explaining things to him and opening up more about his own feelings and interest in bdsm. and some more kink exploration. hes so passive

with his feelings its sickening. stop repressing yourself and just admit what youre thinking already, mydeimos

good night. mwahmwahmwah. thank you guys for sticking even if this isnt particularly smutty and dirty.

Chapter 12: Chapter Twelve

Chapter Notes

> a sweet lil chapter thats starts with bratty phai, a slightly meaner mydei, some fingers in the mouth and limit pushing, then them with their friends!!
>
> wanted to show how they all interacted and got along, especially mydei, as i feel hes a character thats understood more when hes interacting with others (or NOT interacting with others). but, phainon is obviously a cutie pie who tries to figure him out anyways because thats his bestie guys!! of course he knows everything about him, right??
>
> i love my humbled son. i wanna kiss his rosy lil cheeks

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"*Phainon*."

He hummed, licking his fingers of sticky and sweet icing while plastic clicked lightly beside him. As Mydei gently and delicately closed the small packaging around a trio of cinnamon rolls, his elbow came poking into his ribs.

"Stop eating and start helping me."

Phainon laughed, leaning into his shoulder. "But, *master*, they're so *yummy*."

Mydei shook his head, snipping a strip of red ribbon before tying it around the small, black tray. His fingers carefully lined the box, keeping the decoration straight and pretty. Around a nice little bow, he knotted a name tag's glittering gold string. With a click of his pen, he carefully and swiftly wrote the name '*Castorice*' in a beautiful, practiced cursive. At the end, he drew a couple of butterflies.

A proud smile lit up his face as he examined the tray, and he set it off to the side before looking at the one he was meant to do—the one meant for him and Cyrene.

"She'll definitely be able to tell *you* did it."

"*Hey!*"

It was true, but he could have been *nicer* about it. Maybe his didn't look as polished as his, but the ribbons were still pretty and his penmanship wasn't terrible. He even drew a little flower in the corner for her!

What flower was it? He didn't know. This '*flower*' was essentially just a bunch of oddly shaped circles grouped around each other, but it was close enough to resemble one. Maybe.

Possibly.

It had character, and that had to count for something, *right?*

“I told you to stop,” Mydei scolded him, watching when he dragged his finger across the messy glass dish. “Get your damn finger out of your mouth.”

“Why? Does my master wanna put his in there instead?” Phainon teased, and Mydei also watched when he popped his clean finger inside his mouth to clean it off.

Those hot, amber eyes raked over his face, focusing on his shining lips before meeting his playful wink.

“You’re asking for it.”

“No, ‘*asking for it*’ would sound like this.” He then cleared his throat. “*Can you please put your fingers in my mouth, master?*”

Mydei made two movements, both swift and firm. One hand cupped his jaw, fingertips pinching into either cheek to hold him still. His other hand dragged two fingers through what was left on the dish, then planted them right against his steady tongue.

“Work.”

Ivory eyebrows furrowed as he looked at him, unsure what that meant.

“Wash your hands, and *work*,” Mydei repeated, nodding towards the sink right beside him. “No one wants dirty fingers on their gift. Go on. Wash your hands.”

He pushed his fingers deeper with his command. They hooked over his tongue and settled heavily against it, giving him no room to talk back.

Phainon reached for the sink, dropped a pearl of soap into his palm and lathered them until Mydei told him to stop. He scrubbed his hands and cleaned beneath his nails until the other man said it was enough.

“Dry them.”

He swallowed the best he could, spit pooling in his mouth as he picked a hand towel up.

“Good,” he encouraged him. “You *can* listen. You simply choose *not* to.”

A twitch sent his lip upwards, but the flex of a grin made Mydei dig his fingers deeper. He repositioned himself behind him, moving out of the way but not removing his presence or power altogether. Those fingers pressed to the back of his tongue, teasing his body’s limits.

“Package Cifera’s,” he instructed him. “You know she’s the hardest critique. She’ll point out the icing on the lid, the mismatched size, and whether or not the bow is straight. Make it pretty.”

Of course he would leave the most vocal of their friends to him…

Phainon looked down at the counter, and he grabbed the black bottom to the plastic tray before picking up the sticky tongs. Of the laid out rolls, he picked three of the same relative size, then tried to fit them inside nicely without smashing them. Icing dripped over the edges of the tray, and he stared at the mess.

“Clean it without sticking your fingers in your mouth, unless you think there’s some room beside mine,” Mydei taunted him, speaking directly into his ear.

A spark of arousal popped inside of his stomach, and he quickly ripped a napkin before gently and carefully cleaning up the edges. Once clean, he fit the lid on slowly, trying not to let it touch the tops and smear. They needed to be pretty. The cover needed to stay clean and transparent so as to admire the treats inside.

But then Mydei pushed deeper, and his hands slipped, smashing the top into one and smearing icing all over it.

“*Oh*,” he feigned in mock disappointment. “Try again. Clean it off, then put it on.”

Phainon choked. Heat pooled inside of his cheeks, and one hand grappled around Mydei’s wrist before pulling weakly. Not that it budged.

“You’re supposed to be assisting me. Come on, my little helper,” he urged. “Stop trying to fight me. Relax.”

Upon being told to, he dropped his hold on his wrist. Shaking fingers grabbed the lid and rinsed it underneath the sink, drying it off with a towel before shaking it to air dry it the rest of the way. A flex of his knuckles made him choke again, but Mydei only shushed him gently.

“You asked for this. You buckled down, opened your mouth, and *asked* me to do this,” he taunted him, and how could he argue? He did do that. “I’m beginning to think my naughty prince loves having his mouth filled with the way he drops this jaw so freely.”

Phainon hesitated, then nodded weakly.

“If you mess up again, I’m going deeper,” he warned him while gently sliding them out to relieve the pressure. “Package them, Phainon. Do the task I assigned you with—*properly*.”

Once again, he took the lid and gently rested it on top. Two fingers pinched it closed all the way around, securing them within the tray.

“Halfway done. Cut the ribbon.”

Mydei eased his fingers back more. He stilled them and steadied himself as Phainon took the ribbon, measured it around the box, and then snipped off the right length. As he tied the bow, a mouth pressed against the back of his neck towards the left. Judging by the press of metal into his body, he assumed that was directly over the lock of his collar.

“Even out the tails,” he nitpicked, using his other hand to point out how one was longer than the other. “Good boy. Write her name on a card now, nice and pretty.”

He took the pen, raised it to write their friend’s name on it as neatly as possible, and then tied the string around the bow. With it finished, he placed it beside the other box meant for Castorice, then raised the pen woven between his fingers higher. Its butt clicked to Mydei’s hand once, twice, then three times before dropping it, and he felt them slip deeper over the signal.

“You did good,” Mydei praised him, and he slipped his fingers around his wrist again when he choked. “That one’s much prettier than the one you’re taking home.”

Phainon’s eyes shut as he leaned back into his body. Breathing heavily, he guided the tips of Mydei’s fingers deeper by pushing his hand, allowing them to pass what he was comfortable with.

“Easy,” he whispered, stilling his hand as his throat tightened and eyes watered.

When he flexed them with a curl, the sound of his muffled gag filled the room, and his hand gripped his wrist tighter. There wasn’t another movement after, just the weight and pressure of his touch mixed with anticipation.

“Two more. Give me two more and we’ll be done.”

He nodded weakly, spit rolling down his bottom lip and eyes full of water. The slots between Mydei’s fingers pushed to the corners of his mouth, and he flexed them again to tickle his gag reflex again. As he did, Phainon’s shoulders raised and his chest lurched.

“Shh… You’ve got it.”

They were held there, forcing him to take them even after he gagged. It left him on the edge, slightly panicked as his throat flexed repeatedly.

He could feel it. He could feel himself silently gagging, his body buckling and trembling underneath the presence of his too-deep fingers. More heat ticked his face. More tears filled his eyes.

Shaking fingers rubbed over his wrist, the index and middle lifting high so he could see them both.

“One,” Mydei said, speaking firmly. “One more, and you’re done. You can do it for me.”

Phainon felt them slide down his tongue, tucking as deep as possible again to drag another gag from him. This one came with sticky, copious amounts of spit, and it spilled down his chin messily. It also caused his fingers to curl, desperate to claw at his hand and peel it away before they made an even bigger mess. But it was his *only* job to keep this safety signal up.

He just *didn’t* want to throw up. He *didn’t want* to *throw up*. *He didn’t want to—*

Soon, just as he was going to drop one of his fingers, they reeled back slowly, and he gasped loudly through his opened mouth after forcing down the pool of his saliva. Swallow by swallow, he gulped the air down to try and soothe the tickle in his throat from having something so deep in there.

Those two fingers were pulled free completely. Drenched down to the bone, he held them out for him to see, to look at how the wrinkled skin was connected by ropes of saliva. Even when he scissored them apart, there were translucent strings stretching wide between them.

“We’re done here,” Mydei said with an air of finality. With it, he balled his fist and headed towards the sink in an attempt not to drip his spit everywhere.

That… was it?

Mydei wasn't going to touch his body? He wasn’t going to make him do the same?

All he wanted to do was stick his fingers in his mouth and mess with him? Rile him up and then just… *what?* Leave him like this? Like a *mess?*

He exhaled deeply, watching him wash his hands before he grabbed the nearby towel. When he did, he looked over to him and beckoned him closer with the sopping wet fingers that were in his throat less than a minute ago.

Phainon walked towards him anyway.

“Messy boy,” he murmured, taking the towel to wipe his slick chin.

“You’re not… gonna make me suck you off for being bratty?” He rasped out, still trying to catch his breath, and Mydei shook his head. “You won’t do it for me either?”

“No.” The answer was so short, so clean cut and simple that it was *obvious* whatever happened wouldn’t be continued. “But if you keep doing that, I’m going to give you less enjoyable things to fill your mouth with.”

He hummed quietly, then closed one eye when the towel dipped beneath it. “One of your gags, right?”

“Yes,” he said, leaving no room for doubt. “I feel like you enjoy talking back too much. Maybe some time tasting rubber will teach you how to be more reserved.”

“But my master likes when I’m bratty,” he accused him, and Mydei lifted an eyebrow as he went to wipe his other eye. He quickly switched which one was close to accommodate.

“I like that you feel as though you can have fun with me,” he corrected. “I enjoy seeing you enjoy what we do together, so much so that you’re not scared of being punished by me. It brings me comfort that I’m not forcing you to like this or behave a certain way."

Phainon nodded, but he knew there was something else coming.

“However, had you been more experienced in this and more confident in your interests, I would not allow you to be this mouthy,” he told him while holding his jaw again. “Sometimes you make me feel like a *pushover* because I’m not used to being this *forgiving*.”

“What would you do otherwise…?”

Mydei’s hand squeezed his jaw tighter. The juncture between his thumb and index finger pressed beneath his bottom lip, and his fingers climbed to sprawl across his heated cheek. Slowly, they raised until just his thumb was touching his skin, then they dropped with a light and painless tap.

A breath caught in his throat over the implication.

“I won’t,” he promised, holding his face again. “You are safe, and I won’t hurt you. But if you make me feel like a *pushover*, I’m going to push you back. *Harder*.”

He held his gaze as Mydei loosened his grasp, nodding softly. “Yes, master,” he forced himself to say.

“Clean this mess up, and keep your fingers out of your *fucking* mouth before I stick a gag in it,” he demanded, keeping his voice quiet but firm. “Whatever’s left from the batch can be tucked into a tupperware and put in the refrigerator. I’ll eat it myself throughout the week.”

His eyes darted down to the front of his sweatpants, then back up at Mydei who didn’t seem concerned at all.

“I won’t repeat myself,” he warned him, tapping his fingers to his cheek lightly again. “I’m going to text our friends and see who’s home so I can drop them off. When you finish up here, shower. Make it cold if you need to because I’m *not* touching you even if you get on your knees and *beg*. Got it?”

“Yeah. I-I got it.”

He walked off, and Phainon took a deep breath before looking at the last two cinnamon rolls left. They were smaller than the rest, had the least amount of icing, and had been at the very top of the tower if his memory served him correctly.

His eyes darted to the large tray packed with his and Cyrene’s, and he carefully unraveled the packaging he did before swapping them out. After all, Mydei spent so much time baking these. It wouldn’t be fair for him to get the least appetizing ones of the bunch.

This time, he carefully tied it up like he had Cifera’s, making the ribbon pretty and writing his best friend’s name just as neatly. It was placed beside the rest of the boxes, and he took the glass dish before setting it in the sink.

As he looked down once again, his feet shifted.

Mydei said he wasn’t, but he could be so *mean* sometimes. Leaving him pent up like this was just *cruel*.

—

If he was being honest, he didn't have to accompany Mydei to deliver the treats. That wasn't necessary in '*helping*' him, and he knew if he turned the offer down then there wouldn't be any hard feelings. But he wanted to see his friends real quick, and he didn't mind tagging along after dropping his car and tray off at his apartment.

Cyrene wasn't there, but that was fine by him. She said she was with Castorice going shopping for a little '*date*' before they hung out with Hyacine, that she might stay over and spend the night for a little bit of extra '*girl time*', and he understood that. If he wanted his own space to be with Mydei, then it was only reasonable that she needed her space with the girls.

The only one to be home at the time was Cifera, and that meant the giant wooden door they were standing outside was hers. Well, her older sister, *Aglaea's*, but what belonged to Aglaea belonged to her too. That was how they worked.

Holding the plastic tray he had packaged himself, Phainon smiled brightly at his friend when she opened the door. Her hair was a mess, the clothes she wore were crinkled up with a slightly stretched collar, there was a slight darkness beneath her tired eyes that he wasn't used to seeing, and she looked surprised to see him, but that melted away quickly.

"Well… Goldilocks said he'd be comin' with treats, but I didn't expect him to bring company," her mocking voice purred, looking up between him and Mydei. "What? Feelin' like a couple of strangers? Come in already! It's hot out here."

That tone didn't quite meet her tired eyes, and his smile faltered over the sight.

"Thank you." Mydei nodded, planting a hand on the small of his back as a gesture at him to walk first. "Aglaea isn't here, right?"

"Big sis' is out *God knows* where for the next few weeks." She waved carelessly, then readjusted her shirt. "Make yourselves at home. Or don't. I don't reckon you're stayin' long, are ya'?"

Phainon followed her towards the kitchen as he chuckled, hearing the front door close and lock behind Mydei. It was odd hearing their shoes against the tiled floors as he was so used to taking them off at this point.

"Awh, are you kicking us out so soon? I thought we were friends," he pouted, and she giggled.

"I'm just here for the goods, whatever else you need to talk about can hit the curb." She flashed a toothy grin at them before holding her hand out. "Mm… Thank you, kid. My sweet tooth appreciates it."

“Don’t eat them all at once,” he warned her.

“And what’re ya’ gonna do? Tattle to Aglaea on me? Don’t be so immature,” she mused. “When did *you* start tellin’ people what to do?”

“I don’t, but it’s not good to eat so much sweets at once,” he insisted. “Your teeth won’t come back if you rot them with sugar, Cifera.”

“My teeth are fine, thank you very much!” She hissed. But even with the sharp words, she licked over her top teeth slowly before rolling her eyes. “*Tch*. You’re just like she is—*condescending*. I’m not a child.”

“I’m only looking out for you,” Phainon said back. “De? Help me out here.”

He hummed, then looked between them both as if he had zoned out while looking at her. “When was the last time you saw a dentist?” He asked.

“*Oh* how I hate when you two muscleheads get your last little brain cells together to form an impenetrable wall of *lame*,” she grumbled, then looked down at the box in her hands. “Hey… these are kinda ugly this time. What gives?”

Mydei snorted quietly from behind him, and Phainon felt his lips wobble as she rotated the tray and examined them. With one eye shut and the other wide open, it was as if she were searching for clues in a murder scene, not flaws inside of baked goods.

An elbow poked into his side, and he jumped before shooting a look over at Mydei, who had his hand over his mouth. With a subtle nod towards their friend, he could hear the words loud and clear even if they were unspoken.

‘I told you so.’

“This one is caved in on the edge like you dropped something on it! And that one is smaller than the other ones! Oh, and the writing is different from usual—this doesn’t look refined at all! Finally, goldilocks always puts a sneaky little cat face on mine, but I don’t see that either,” she pointed out, just as Mydei said she would. “This ain’t the work of my usual baker, so *spill*. Did you tamper with it, snowy?”

Phainon turned to face her, watching as her eyes narrowed skeptically at him.

“I tried my best in helping him,” he settled with, not wanting to get too in depth about it. Specifically, he didn’t want to think too much about how he helped him this morning. “They taste good though. There was meant to be four in there, but…—”

“*Hey!*”

He laughed as she pointed one sharpened nail at him, slowly walking up as if to be menacing. But between her being eye-level with his chest and the childish pout on her lips, he couldn’t find it in himself to be intimidated. Especially when she was slowly starting to grin up at him the longer she tried to hold that pose.

“You’re fired,” she said to him, and he lifted one hand to flick against her forehead lightly. “First, you come into *my* home and bully me. Now, you take *my* desserts and deprive me of *my* little cat face doodles. What are you taking from me next, kid?”

“What do you have left to take?” He asked, and she pushed his chest before turning away from him.

“Did’ja have to get a pet dog, goldilocks?” Cifera taunted, looking behind him with a pointed look. “What? Are ya’ scared of a lil’ cat now?”

“I don’t have a pet,” he said simply, shortly. An edge lined his voice, and it was one Phainon knew well. “Do you like the gift or not? He tried his best.”

Phainon really did *try*, but truthfully, it was a little bit difficult to make things look perfect when he had two fingers ticking his *gag reflex* the whole time.

It wasn’t as if he could just say that, though…

She laughed, the sound light and airy. “Don’t get your lil’ red panties in a twist, kitten. You may eat with your eyes too, but my tastebuds will surely love it anyway. Thank you two muscleheads for the goods, but don’t forget my cat face next time, ‘kay? It’s the little things.”

He nodded silently, storing that in his memory for next time.

Mydei hummed, pleased by the show of gratitude. “Had Aglaea been here, I would have brought more.”

“*Please*, that woman doesn’t eat junk like this,” she scoffed. “The fashion industry is a killer. She’d barely take a bite! Guess that’s what I’m here for though, to finish up what she can’t and give her a little mouse-y nibble of things. *Oh well.*”

“So I’ve heard,” Mydei agreed. “I wouldn't want to be tangled up in that business.”

“Being reduced down to your body ain’t for the weak.” Cifera sighed deeply after that. “*But*, Aglaea’s never been one to back down from a challenge. She’s gotta keep a sharp eye to deal with that kinda pressure, but I worry sometimes about her gettin’ lost in it all. Those fancy camera lights can be *real* blindin’, ya’ know.”

“She has you in her corner,” Mydei reminded her. “I’m sure that motivates her plenty to get through her day.”

Cifera smiled wide at that, one of sincerity rather than mockery. Her eyes glittered brightly too, like she was glad to have her efforts acknowledged by someone else.

“Yeah, huh?” She said thoughtfully. “*Heh*. See? This is why you’re my favorite behind princess homebody and pinky-pie. You sure know how to make a girl feel good about herself, don’t’cha?”

Phainon then pouted. “What about me?”

“You’re after him,” she said, moving her finger to motion him being behind Mydei in her list. “But you’re there. Promise.”

“I’m last!”

“Oh, the specifics! Who really cares about those?” She waved her hand after. “You know I love ya’, snowy. Don’t make me spell it out for ya’.”

“Yeah yeah,” he sulked, dropping his shoulders and rolling his eyes. “Love you too…”

“D’ya want some water?”

“I’m okay.”

“Please,” Mydei requested, and she pulled the fridge open before tossing him a bottle. “Thank you.”

“Where are you two headed after this?” She wondered. “Pinky-pie is out with the princess, so they’re not home. Don’t tell me you two are gonna loiter around *here* until then. Ya’ know how long they take and how bad I am at entertainin’. What do I look like? A circus lion?”

“Glorified house cat,” Phainon corrected her, and she pointed a warning finger at him while using the other to unravel the bow on her gift.

“Can it, *dog*. No one asked you.”

His lip curled into a grin over the sassy remark, and she laughed before looking down to pop the tray open.

“Got a taste for somethin’ sweet?” She offered them both. “I’m askin’ to be nice, by the way. Say ‘*no*’ for me.”

“For *you?*” He asked, pointing at her before looking at Mydei as if he heard the same thing. “For *her?* After she keeps calling me a ‘*dog*’?”

He shrugged, keeping a neutral expression as he cracked his bottle of water open.

“You know what? Give me half—”

“Oh, come on! Don’t you have a green smoothie to gulp down?” She groaned, and he rolled his eyes.

“*Actually*, I had fresh pressed juice,” he said proudly, ignoring her deadpan expression. “It was ginger flavored because ginger helps with your metabolism.”

Her lip curled upwards as she ripped a piece of cinnamon roll off and placed it in her mouth. “Oh, yeah…” Cifera dragged out as she chewed slowly. “That sounds *so* delicious… You must be *so* satisfied with yourself…”

Mydei chuckled lightly. “Don’t mind this fool. He has his own at home.”

Phainon gasped in betrayal over him siding with her, then jumped again when he felt the toe of his ankle boot tap his leg. It wasn't rough, nor was it loud, but it was sudden. He didn't expect it.

"You good?" Cifera asked, eyeing him. "What? Upset goldilocks prefers cats over dogs?"

"Hardly," he protested. "Mydei likes *both* cats and dogs."

Mydei liked *cats* over dogs. He liked that they were independent, that they came and went as they pleased. If they wanted attention, they'd come. If they wanted to be left alone, they'd walk away. He liked that they cleaned themselves, used the bathroom by themselves, and they could be happy just sitting in a warm spot by the window.

Phainon knew that. But he wasn't going to give her the satisfaction of winning this argument.

"Someone's in *de-ni-al*," she sang, amused.

"*Someone* thinks she knows my best friend better than me," he mouthed off.

"Mydei likes *quiet*," the man in question huffed, and they both turned to look at him. "That being said, I believe it's time we take our leave."

Phainon nodded, and Mydei walked around the counter before reaching his hand out.

"One more bottle of water, please. For the road."

Cifera walked over to the refrigerator, grabbed another, and then handed it to him as he thanked her. Both bottles were then shifted over to one stretched hand.

"Thanks for the treats, Mydei," she said after, raising two fingers to her forehead before saluting him casually. "Me and my stomach will be here when you decide to visit again. Try not to make it so soon. I don't like visitors."

He nodded, and Phainon watched him plant his hand on top of her head before ruffling her already messy hair. The ashy locks fanned over her forehead, causing one eye to shut while looking up at him.

"Be good while Aglaea's gone, or you won't be getting any treats the next time I make them."

Her jaw dropped.

"Well… I suppose I could be a little nicer to snowy…" She caved, flicking her gaze over to him briefly before looking back up at Mydei. "Let's not be rash, now…"

"No. I mean brush your hair," he scolded her, and she winced. "And brush your teeth. Every morning. Every night. If you don't, Aglaea will be very disappointed when she finds out you've been neglecting yourself again."

Phainon's head tilted as he watched them, unaware they were *that* close to one another.

It was sweet though, like watching an older brother with his younger sister when their parents weren't around. Not that she was *younger* than them, but she definitely behaved more youthfully than Mydei did. *Most* people did, though.

"Yeah yeah…"

Mydei pulled away, and she turned her head before looking away from them both.

"And schedule a dentist appointment, Cifera."

"*Tch*. *Scram* before I kick you out," she hissed, pushing him weakly away from her. "I'm fine, got it? It ain't time for one yet anyway, so stop naggin' me."

"Good," he said before turning around. "Phainon, please hold this for me."

He took the unopened bottle, then followed him towards the front door. As he did so, he watched the way he peeked into the living room briefly before looking away, almost like he wanted to check on something.

"Don't let the door hit you!" She called after them, and Phainon glanced over his shoulder to see her arms crossed over her chest. "Especially you, *dog*."

He laughed, and Mydei held the door open for him to walk through first—as he always did.

"I'll see you around. If you're free sometime, let's get you out of the house," he said after.

"I'm *never* free. You'll have to plan up somethin' *real* fun to get me to go out with you two *buzzkills*," she scoffed, but a smile was on her lips anyway. "*Buh-bye now!*"

The door shut behind them quickly, and Mydei took a deep breath as they made their way to his car.

"You two are close," he noticed, earning a nod in return. "It's pretty cute. You talk to her like some kind of older brother."

"That girl acts like she's got it all figured out, that no one needs to worry about her, but it's obviously a front," he scoffed quietly. "Simply waiting for someone to reach out isn't enough. Sometimes you need to check in yourself."

Phainon never really noticed. In his memory, she's always that same kind of energetic and playful. No matter what occasion, she was loud, mocking, and quick to chase someone around or jump on their back. His back was victim to it plenty of times as he was supposedly '*more fun to surprise*'. By her standards, he was the most fun to *bully*.

He never really looked at her beneath her makeup or their friend group, but he guessed those were things Mydei saw when he dropped by randomly to give desserts away. Those bags beneath her eyes and the messy state she was in at home, that was something he never really thought could be hiding behind someone like her.

"You think a lot of other people."

“A good friend does,” he brushed off casually.

Phainon grabbed his arm gently, and Mydei stopped to look at him as they stood in front of his car. When his grip tightened, one golden eyebrow raised as if to warn him of his next move.

“Be honest. Do you do this so you have a reason to check up on everyone individually?” He wondered, and Mydei nodded curtly. No other words needed to be said.

It wasn’t just ‘*leftovers*’ that he couldn’t finish. It wasn’t just ‘*my submissive misbehaved, take his treat*’ to dump on them.

This was calculated. Mydei did these visits for a reason, only he didn’t tell anyone why. If he did, *he* would have been the first to be told.

His eyes raked over Mydei’s face, over his slowly relaxing expression and the sunlight beating over his fluffed bangs. It bathed him in warm, summer gold, in a brightness that he knew was there but had never really *seen* before. Not in its entirety, anyway.

Mydei really was good at taking care of people, wasn’t he?

“Cifera’s always been a… ‘*fake it until you make it*’ kind of person. As you can see, she tries very hard,” he decided to share, even if he wasn’t one to speak on other people’s business. “Sometimes she doesn't see the point in anything, especially in simple things like brushing her teeth or changing her clothes. Aglaea takes care of her, but when she’s gone, I like to give her a little push. That’s all.”

Phainon thought back to his rules, to Mydei mentioning that if he was ever too tired, too sick, or just flat out didn't see the point in taking care of himself, he would step in. He would tackle any problem with him, from dish washing and laundry to reminding him to brush his teeth or wash his hair. As long as it was done, that was all that mattered to him, since living in filth was *not* a healthy way for anyone to live.

If he wasn’t feeling up to bathing, he had no doubt that Mydei would dump him into a tub and wash him down himself. *Especially* now that he’s seen him pretty much naked.

Maybe he wouldn’t do that for *her*. That was a line he wouldn’t dare cross for someone else not inside of his bed. But he also knew if it was that bad for one of their friends, he’d probably push them in the bathroom and guard the door until he heard the shower running from the other side. Because that was just who he was.

Mydei was so full of love and care that it burst from him in every way, and he showed it to everyone—stray cats, strangers on the internet, his close friends, and even his *father*, as he still pushed himself to be the man he needed to one day accept his company. He could ‘*complain*’ until his face was cherry red, or he could act as unbothered as he wanted, but it was obvious that he did nothing but *care*. He did nothing but *try*.

While staring at his still face lit up beneath the sun, Phainon’s stomach lightly fluttered. It was airy and gentle in a way he wasn’t quite used to, and *sudden*.

Anxiety was common as he slowly opened himself up completely to him. Arousal was new, but it was slowly becoming just as normal the deeper they dove into their dynamic. Admiration had lived inside of him since they met and Mydei was the only person who could run their high school mile just as fast as him.

But this felt… *different*… from all three of those.

It was lighter than that old competitive gaze he set over him, innocent in a way that their lust wasn't, and not nearly as scary as his nerves could be. In fact, it felt warm.

His stomach was full of that same sun-kissed warmth as he slowly discovered more about the man he thought he knew.

"Phainon, are you okay?" Mydei asked him, setting the back of his hand over his forehead. Afterwards, he touched his cheek. "Mm… your face is hot."

Was it? He couldn't tell.

He had grown so used to being flustered and nervous that his body just felt hot all the time at this point. Like a perpetual flame burned inside of his body.

That was all it was, right? A flame. A spark. He was flustered as he always was, and there was nothing deeper to it than that.

"I'm fine," he murmured. "I should… uh… call Cyrene and tell the girls to meet us at Cassie's. We can drop her tray off then head back to mine."

"Is that what you want?"

"Yes please, master," he agreed quietly and politely, making Mydei softly smile. "I want to spend another night with you. If she's going to be with Cassie, then who cares if you're with me?"

"I have to visit my mother tomorrow morning around ten. I promised to take her to her doctor's appointment, then pick some groceries up with her," Mydei brought up, and Phainon nodded understandingly. "But we can have another repeat of feeding those cats and going on a run. I'd like that a lot too."

"Do you like the fat orange one?"

"I love him," he said. At that, he laughed while remembering the two together. "I want to see him again. What if he's starving to death without us there?"

Phainon highly doubted that, as they stayed by that bush and that family's apartment for a reason, but he let his worry linger. He *cared*, and that was all that mattered.

"Let's go then. The faster we finish this up, the faster you can see him," he reminded him.

Mydei nodded, pulling his hand away to reach for his keys. As he did so, Phainon cracked open the water bottle in his hand.

“I didn’t even need to tell you to drink it. You just knew it was yours,” he said, watching him gulp down the still-cool water. “Good boy.”

Plastic crunched underneath his fist from the praise, and he looked over to him one last time as a breath fell from his lips. With it, a few droplets of water followed.

The back of Mydei’s knuckle wiped under his lip, then he silently nodded towards his car for him to get in. Without so much as a word, Phainon followed, allowing him to open his door and shut it for him.

—

Both he and Mydei sat in his car while waiting for the girls to show up. With the engine off, they spent their few minutes of their downtime talking about what they planned to do when they finished up here. Dinner plans, lounging plans, and things alike were tossed back and forth between them, giving him a choice even if the decision ultimately landed on Mydei’s shoulders.

But he liked that. It was nice.

He didn’t need to worry about what to buy for dinner unless Mydei wasn’t there, and getting to share it with him was always a treat.

When Castorice and Cyrene finally made it, Mydei was quick to offer his arms to carry Castorice’s shopping bags. He did too, but Cyrene only looked at him before throwing them over her shoulder. As she lifted her nose, he grumbled playfully.

“I’m trying to help.”

“I don’t need your help. You left me all alone,” she told him, and he rolled his eyes before following her to the front door. “You know what I need instead? A sweet treat! We skipped out on one to come here since Mydei said he was bringing some!”

“These aren’t for *you*,” he hushed, following her through the front door while yanking the tray away from her. “*Ours* are at home, and you can have whatever’s left tomorrow when you come back.”

Cyrene whined loudly at that, and he tapped her head with the tray before turning to face his other friend.

“Cassie, these are for *you*.” Phainon emphasized his words by holding it out for her to take. “Please enjoy them.”

She smiled, taking the gift before smiling sweetly up at him. “Thank you so much. Would you guys like to share them with me? I can’t possibly eat them all by myself.”

“No thank you,” Mydei denied. “I have some at home.”

“Yeah, I have a few at the house calling my name,” he chuckled, then felt as two hands held on to his arm. A quick glance revealed a head of pink hair, and he let her lean her head into his shoulder.

“We can’t stay for long. Hyacine finally has a night off from the hospital and us three are going to hang out,” Castorice said happily. “It’s been so long since I got to see her in person.”

“Tell her we said ‘*hello*’,” Mydei spoke when he joined them, having just gotten back from placing the shopping bags neatly by the coffee table.

In his right arm was a small gray cat, and he had his left hand outstretched so she could claw and bite at his wiggling fingers. Though he kept his eyes on them, he continued playing with Castorice’s pet absentmindedly.

“Why not invite Cifera?” Phainon asked after, and Cyrene’s shoulders sunk over the mention. “I don’t believe she’s up to anything today. Save her from sleeping and playing video games all day.

“She hasn’t texted me back! But, watch, I bet she will at some obscure hour when it’s too late,” she told them, then quieted down slightly. “*Should* we just drop by and pick her up? No warning?”

“Warn her first,” he decided, then reached his opposite hand around to cup over her mouth. “Cassie, you should text her and tell her that you wanna take her out. I’m sure she’ll enjoy being surrounded by her friends.”

She nodded curtly in response. “Very well. I will send her many texts. So many that she can’t possibly sleep through them all.”

“Good idea,” Mydei agreed.

One smaller hand pried his off of Cyrene’s mouth, and she huffed as he laughed. “This is why you’re not allowed to join. All you do is bully people,” she accused him.

“I’m also not a girl. You can’t have a girl’s night with a guy hanging around,” he reminded her. That caused her eyes to roll. “However, the next time we can all get our schedules aligned, I have someone I’d like you both to meet. She’s sweet. Maybe a little bit timid, but I promise she’s very kind.”

That made both girls gasp, eyes wide as they looked up at him.

“Oh, Phainon… Is it your girlfriend?” Castorice’s voice held an edge of excitement to it. “Do you have one already? We haven’t even seen what she looks like!”

His stomach dropped.

“And you never told me?” Cyrene’s fist punched into his upper arm lightly. “Is it your coworker? The one you said you’ve become friends with? Phainon, it’s so soon!”

"*No!* No, no, no! You've got it all wrong!"

Mydei watched, a slight grin on his face while watching him fumble over his words and wave his hands frantically. Soft growls rumbled from the cat gnawing on his fingers, but her green eyes were on him as if she were *also* trying to find out if he had a girlfriend or not.

"Is she pretty?" Cyrene asked. "I wanna see! Show me!"

"There's no need to be nervous," Castorice tried to reassure him. "It's… really refreshing to see a guy act this shyly, though. When you read romance novels, the men tend to act indifferent and suave. Sometimes I forget guys can be *cute* too. Phainon, your flustered reaction is quite *cute*."

Phanon groaned quietly, feeling as if someone was watching him. "What I'm trying to say is that she has a *wife!* What makes you think I'm seeing someone?"

Her gentle, amethyst eyes raked over his outfit, lingering on his neck before dropping.

"Not only did what you *sound* as if you were announcing a secret partner, but you dress like you have one," she reasoned with him. Now standing beside her, Cyrene also looked at his clothes with one hand holding her chin. "You have that… *touch*. You're wearing jewelry suddenly, and you carry yourself with a higher regard. Guys with girlfriends always tend to act more confidently, and they look better taken care of too. They have someone to show off to."

"Perhaps he discovered what matching colors could do for a person's look," Mydei added, noticing the way he froze underneath their analytical gazes. "I also gave him a new facial cleanser and moisturizer. Has he been using it, Cyrene? You see him most."

Did she?

At this point, did his own *roommate* really see him more than *Mydei* did?

"Yeah! We both have," she beamed, obviously not thinking as much as he was about that. Maybe to her, she was still the person closest to him. "It's pretty nice. That could be where the '*touch*' is coming from, Cassie. You know how much a person's skin can change how they look and feel about themselves."

"Maybe," she agreed, and he exhaled quietly as Cyrene looked away from him. "Your necklace is very pretty, by the way. The blue really matches your eyes."

One finger reached to touch the chain, and Phainon touched the diamond shaped gem before pressing over its pointed face. He remembered seeing it glisten in the golden sunlight, and he remembered the light reflecting off of it under the bar lights in his selfies.

It *did* match his eyes nicely.

"Thank you, Cassie." She only nodded kindly in return. "And, for the record, I'm *not* in some secret relationship. I've just been… *experimenting* with some things."

That wasn't technically a *lie*, but he knew it also wasn't the full *truth* either.

"Maybe this will work. You know, I've been trying to help this guy get a date *forever*," Cyrene dragged out, holding on to Castorice while leaning into her. "But he's so picky. He needs a golden *somebody* to descend from the sky—guy, girl, both, neither, *whatever*. They need to be bathed in sunlight and holier than thou to catch his eye."

Her exaggeration made him curl into himself, just a little insecure.

"Someone *kind* and *respectful* who likes to talk about more than themselves is good enough for me, okay?" He mouthed off.

"You're asking for *so much* in this day and age!"

"I don't think that's unreasonable," Castorice sided with him, and he thanked her for her solidarity in this. "People become much *more* attractive when you enjoy their personality too. Just as people become *less* attractive when you don't. What are good looks worth without a kind heart behind them?"

Thank you.

Phainon could grab her by the face and kiss her forehead for being one of the few people to understand why he wasn't into hooking up. It wasn't *enough* to be attractive. It wasn't *enough* to simply make him turn his head.

She got that, and it made him feel better about himself.

"At this rate, we'll be best friends who get married because they've been single too long and gave up. Mom would like that," Cyrene sniffled dramatically, and his eyebrows furrowed while glancing over at her.

Cyrene liked girls, and he loved her deeply, just not like *that*.

She was always there in his life. Even if she liked to come and go from his apartment to run around, gather inspiration, then work on her books, he could count on her. If not a door away, she was always a call or text away, and he knew she'd come if he ever needed her badly enough. The same could be said about him too. He'd run to her without question if she needed him.

They grew up together as children, split when his family moved to the city, and he opened his door for her when she came to live with him to go to college. She was *family*. Not in the way a wife was with her husband, but in the way a sister was to her brother—free to hold if times got tough, to leave without remorse, to find what she wanted in the world, then to come back like they were never apart to begin with.

What did she mean her mom wanted them together in any *other* way?

"My mom was asking if you asked me out yet when I visited," she confessed to him in front of their two closest friends. "A boy and a girl are best friends growing up together then move

in together as adults… it's *romantic*. She thought we were already dating for years now. She asked me when her grandchildren are coming to see her."

Oh.

Grandchildren, huh?

Not *once* has he ever seriously contemplated dating her. Besides a random joke here or there, or a stray thought that felt more intrusive than ever while growing up, it never *really* crossed his mind. Not in anyway that could leave up to *grandchildren*.

Castorice also looked down at her, one hand holding the one on her arm. "You don't like guys," she said as if they all didn't know that.

"*I* know. *Phainon* knows. But *she* doesn't know that! I'm scared it'll break my mom's heart. She's fragile, you know."

"That would be an unfulfilling relationship," Castorice tagged on immediately, glancing between them both slowly. "If Phainon ever felt any kind of romantic way, it isn't as if you can return it."

"Well… even if I could, this guy is the densest brick there is!" He was too amused by her ability to stay so upbeat after what she *just* said than offended by the jab. "Cassie, someone could smack him in the face with an '*I love you'*, and he'd say it back thinking they meant it to be *nice!*"

Their friend giggled at the thought. One hand covered her mouth, and a soft rosy hue dusted over her plush cheeks.

"Be nice to him. Phainon has love for everybody around him. Whoever can break through that and force him to see them in a special way has to be someone very special," she teased. "Or, maybe, someone very *strong*. They might need to hit him pretty hard with that brick."

"But who is stronger than he is? Look at his arm!" Cyrene pointed at him, and he grinned before flexing for them. "Oh, stop showing off! We get it!"

"Not to interrupt your… romance talk, but I texted Cifera for you," another voice spoke up, and he shifted his attention to Mydei. As he talked, his eyes were glued to his phone, and the cat was draped over his bent figure to stand on the back of his neck. "She's getting dressed now."

"Thank you, Mydei. And if Pollux becomes a nuisance, please just bat her away," Castorice mused, but Phainon wasn't sure if she recognized just how unbothered Mydei seemed by it. "You've been very quiet. As Phainon's second best friend, what do you believe? Is he simply being picky? Or does he just need someone extra special?"

'*Second*' best friend.

Cyrene grinned proudly at that, but Mydei only looked up before giving each of them a once over. When he finished, his gaze lingered on him for a moment.

“Phainon’s entitled to his own standards and expectations,” he offered his opinion. “We all have them.”

“Mydei’s probably got the highest of us all,” Cyrene teased him. “Mr. Big-Shot over here has never even had a relationship, right? I’ve never seen him with someone.”

“Mydei’s a private person,” Castorice defended him. “He does not kiss and tell, so to speak.”

“*Ugh*… Boys are no fun,” she whined. “One can’t find a date to save his life, and the other wouldn’t tell us even if he had one. What do we tease them about if not girls?”

“You could *not* tease us,” he suggested, but the deadpan expression on her face made him sigh. “Girls are mean…”

“Boys are lame.”

“Cats are better than both,” Castorice giggled, slowly approaching Mydei to pick her pet off of his shoulder. “Come, Pollux. Please leave Mydei alone now. You’re going to hurt him.”

She really must not have noticed that the expression Mydei wore wasn’t one of annoyance, but *peace*. He didn’t mind being walked on by the slender animal. In fact, he was even watching as she pulled her away from him and set Pollux on her way, slightly disappointed by the missing presence.

“She’s clingy. I apologize.”

“She’s very much welcomed,” Mydei said as he straightened himself out. “By the way, how is your sister doing?”

“She’s doing very well, thank you,” Castorice returned. “I plan to visit her tomorrow. I’m going to take her through the new flower garden they opened up a few cities over, then possibly grab lunch.”

He hummed thoughtfully. “That’s wonderful. It sounds like a very nice day. If you need a recommendation for a nice restaurant, I can send you links to a few places my mother and I have visited in that area.”

“Oh, I’d love that. How is your mother?” She asked him just as kindly. “Is she doing better these days?”

“She’s exactly the same as she always is.”

“We should get going,” Cyrene told them, cutting their conversation short. “Hyacine texted me, and she’s asking when we’re leaving so she can leave too.”

Castorice’s eyes widened as she seemed to remember their plans. “Oh, right! We still need to pick up Cifera too!”

Phainon stumbled lightly when Cyrene’s hands pushed on his back, and he laughed over her attempt to shove him to the door. It didn’t move him much, but it was funny that she thought

she could.

“We won’t keep you,” Mydei promised. “Come on, Phainon. Let’s call it.”

He followed towards the front door, then pulled it open for the girls before Mydei could get his hands on the doorknob. As he held it, a pair of amber eyes shot him a sideways glance, one their friends didn’t see when passing through.

“Thank you, Phai,” Cyrene gave him a smile, then a wave. “I’m gonna start the car, Cassie!”

“Yes, I’ll be right there!” She rushed out, and he closed the door behind himself. “It was nice seeing you both. Let’s please hang out soon.”

“I could never say ‘*no*’ to something like that,” he chuckled as she locked the door. “Have a nice night. Take it easy.”

Mydei reached for her, and he watched as the two shared a hug. Her arms wrapped around his shoulders, and he settled his own just above her waist.

“Be safe. Tell your sister I said ‘*hello*’,” he told her, and she nodded. “I’ll see you around.”

“Yes, I’ll see you around, Mydei.”

When they finished, Phainon offered her a hug as well. His hand patted over her shoulder, and she rubbed his own lightly before letting go.

“Tell Hyacine to stop being a stranger. I never see her anymore,” he said, which made her promise to relay his message. “All that girl does is work and sleep. Nurses need to take breaks too.”

After their hug, she waved to them both, running to catch up to Cyrene before making their friends wait any longer. Once more, it was just him and Mydei standing outside of their friend’s place, and he turned to look at him.

“You don’t bake Hyacine anything?”

“Sometimes. Hyacine is hard for me to meet up with so freely,” he explained. “She works the night shift, and I work all day. Our schedules hardly ever align like this, but had I known, I would have made more.”

Phainon nodded, then felt a hand lightly thump against the back of his head before pulling him in close. The sudden proximity made his heart skip as his body shifted to face him completely.

“While we’re here, I’ll say this once—let me open doors for you,” he told him, holding his gaze now that they were alone. Thanks to Castorice having a bottom floor and corner apartment, they were tucked deep enough to be completely hidden as well.

“I can’t be chivalrous too?”

“You can be,” he allowed. “But practice it in other ways. *I* open the doors for you, and *I* close them behind me. That’s *my* job.”

“Why don’t you just lay out the red carpet for me?” He mocked, then felt his breathing hitch when he pulled him closer.

Mydei dropped his attention to his mouth briefly before meeting his gaze again. While there, he narrowed his eyes.

“Your tongue,” he warned him. “I said that’s my job. Your response should be something along the lines of ‘*yes, master*’ or ‘*I understand, master’*. Nothing more.”

Oh.

Mydei was in *that* kind of mood, but he probably should have known after this morning. That was his fault for getting a little too comfortable around their friends.

“Y-Yes, master,” he repeated, and Mydei nodded before letting him go. “Are we… done? Can we head back to my place?”

“Yes,” he answered. “Mind your manners for the rest of the day, Phainon. If I have to say this again, you’re going to upset me.”

“Yeah, I-I got it,” he promised, not wanting to do that. “I’ll be good, master.”

As much as he liked toeing the edge of his nerves, he also liked being *good*. He *wanted* to be good.

Maybe he was right. Maybe he had been too bratty recently, and he needed to tone it down before he started to make Mydei second doubt his commitment to their arrangement. There was a balance, right? A fine line between *playful* and *disrespectful*, but it was one that he was trying to comfortably find.

One thing was for sure though, he was going to be good for the rest of the day. If not to save himself from another punishment, to give Mydei the control he wanted from this.

Chapter End Notes

mydei wants to spank his ass red and raw so bad that it makes him look stupid. i wonder if phainon realizes just how much he’s holding himself back.

i also wonder if this next chapter is gonna have a little more of mydei letting loose/opening up and some more limit pushing like this one did. hm.

Chapter 13: Chapter Thirteen

Chapter Notes

this is longgg. i'm sorryy. i tried slimming it down but it did NOT work out. mydei yaps so much in this one and it drove my word count up so high…

going to preface this chapter with some cw's that arent big enough to tag in the main story but still are implied/mentioned here:
• total power exchange, free use, spanking, exhibitionism

then the tags that WILL be added to the main list:
• face slapping, verbal degradation (mydei calls him a slut, thats all), somnophilia

See the end of the chapter for more notes

With the rest of the day to themselves, the first thing Mydei did when they got to his apartment was take a lid to some old food container and rinse it off. He dumped two tins of cat food into it, poured some water into its accompanying bowl, then walked it out to the cats by his mailbox.

Phainon *was* going to join him. He *wanted* to join him. Only to be instructed to put the groceries away and start marinating their chicken for dinner. Which was what he did, swiftly and efficiently, even if he pouted at his retreating figure and gave him a light glare when he came back inside.

After washing his hands, Mydei then ruffled his hair lightly just to further toy with his attitude.

"Good boy," he coo'ed. "Cheer up. I'll pick up the mess once I'm sure they have eaten their fill. That garbage won't be there overnight. We can wash it and reuse it in the morning."

Nodding, he looked to where his glass of water was leaving a slick ring of condensation over his counter.

"Master, would you like a drink?" He asked, realizing he had yet to get him anything since they got here. "I'll pour you one."

Amber eyes rolled playfully. "It's far too early for that. I'll wait until dinner later. Thank you for the offer though, prince."

"No, not *alcohol*. Water? Soda? Juice?" He listed all the things that were in his refrigerator.

Mydei shook his head, then tilted his head lower. "How are you feeling right now? Are you comfortable? Are you relaxed?"

“Yes, master.”

“Are you feeling particularly… interested in exploring some things?” He pressed, taking in the way his eyes shifted away for a moment. “Don’t look away from me. Come on, address *me* and not the counter.”

Phainon met his gaze once again, and his hands reached to hold his shirt and pull him closer. Leather met leather when their shoes brushed, knocking together from the proximity that he craved despite spending the whole day together.

“Careful.” Mydei’s voice lowered, speaking gently as he kept him from stumbling “I’m right here. You don’t need to be inside of my ribs to feel me here.”

“Was I *that* bad today? My master usually pushes me like that when I misbehave,” he worried, and Mydei hummed thoughtfully. “Seriously.”

“I’m not upset, and this isn’t any kind of punishment. I’m asking because I already went and tested your limits this morning. Do you want me to do it again?” He asked again. “If you don’t want to do anything, safeword right now. If you do, I’m going to act until you say it yourself. I trust you can do that.”

Phainon closed his mouth, but that didn’t stop the nerves from tingling throughout his stomach as he wondered what was planned. They talked about just relaxing, talking, and hanging out together. Was he planning this in secret since they agreed to come back to his?

“The chicken is marinating, the vegetables were washed and put away, and your bedroom is clean, correct?” He double-checked.

“Yes, master.”

“Grab two bottles of water, bring them to your room,” he instructed him firmly. “Take your choker off. Take your shoes off. Sit in bed with your laptop out and ready.”

When Mydei let go of him, he nodded, easing his own grasp over him. “Anything else?” He asked just in case.

“I’ll tell you when I get there. Go on.” He nudged him with a light push to the shoulder. “Show me how well you can listen.”

He was quick to turn towards the refrigerator, grasp two bottles, then shut it carefully after. His feet carried him quickly to his bedroom without pause, rushing as he tried to contemplate what Mydei could possibly be up to. What did they need to do on his bed with his laptop?

Were they going to watch something? Couldn’t they just use the television?

How was that exploring anything or pushing his comfort zone?

Both bottles thumped to his nightstand, and he popped his choker off while falling into his bed to unzip his boots. They were tucked beneath, only the heel sticking out so they couldn’t

be tripped over. His socks were then tossed into his hamper to be cleaned when he did laundry next, and he hissed a cheer quietly when they made it in cleanly.

Mydei joined him soon enough, placing his own boots beside his once he noticed them there.

“I want your phone face down on the nightstand. No distractions. You can leave it on, but I just don’t want you on it.”

Phainon moved his phone as requested of him, and Mydei did the same with his own. Beside it, he also placed his wallet and keys.

“Shirt off.”

One finger slipped his day collar beneath his shirt so it didn’t get caught. He pulled on the back of his actual collar to take his shirt off, lifting it overhead casually. With it balled in his fists, he tossed it towards his hamper as well, grinning when it rocked back and fell inside.

“Two for two,” he praised himself, and a soft chuckle came from beside him.

“Nice shot,” Mydei commented, having watched it travel across the room. “Are you comfortable being shirtless in front of me?”

Like this, he was sitting on the edge of his bed with his hands rubbing over his jeans to wipe the sweat off. His back was straight. His chin was lifted to look up at him. Mydei did *not* like slouching when he was meant to be alert for any command or task, and he was trying to remember that.

Wordlessly, Mydei’s fingers readjusted his collar, straightening it out before lightly brushing beneath his chin. When he noticed that it didn't need raising, he smiled lightly, silently proud.

“I’m fine. I would like to take my jeans off too though, master,” he requested.

"Change. Put something comfortable on, and bring me something too,” he instructed, then reached to take his belt off. “Shorts, preferably.”

“Yes, master.”

He got up to grab what was requested of him, hearing the exact moment Mydei’s zipper was pulled down. With it, his belt clinked as gravity dragged it to the floor.

A singular glance over his shoulder revealed thick, golden thighs beneath a plump bottom, and he watched as Mydei bent over to pick his pants up. Tight, black boxer briefs clung to his body, leaving little to the imagination. Especially when he turned to face him and he was given an eyeful of his soft cock bulging from the front.

Even though he didn’t seem particularly aroused in any way, it was still big. It still looked heavy.

His mouth immediately recalled the way he throbbed against his lips when he was close, and the warm scent of his skin when he had his tongue around the base. He couldn’t yet take all

of him, but he wanted to. One day.

This pesky gag reflex stopped him from taking so much, but Mydei's fingers could tickle it three times without him throwing up. Could his cock bump against it a few times too, or would he be too weak to take something that thick?

"*Phainon*."

His eyes shot upwards, alerted, as Mydei walked up to him. One finger pulled him gently by his day collar, coaxing him to step closer.

"What are you thinking about while looking down there, hm?" He taunted him, voice quiet but firm. "My eyes are up here."

"I was thinking about my master's uh… mm… h-his cock," he answered shyly, honestly. There was no use in lying when he was already caught staring.

Mydei *tsk*'ed lightly before tapping his fingers to his cheek once, twice, then three times in a row. "My innocent prince has become a naughty slut, hasn't he?"

Phainon's heart jumped from the casual drop of that name, and he looked away from him before pushing his hand to his chest. Slowly, his fingers curled into the fabric of his t-shirt, fisting it as the word echoed inside of his head in his best friend's voice.

'*Slut*.'

Mydei called him a '*slut*'. That terrible thing people called girls who slept around to degrade them—*not that he ever would himself*—and Mydei said it freely right to his face, aware that the only man he has ever been with was him. How was he a '*slut*'? All he did was admit that he thought about the things they did together.

"A… Am I?"

"Are you?" Mydei goaded him with that still-quiet voice. "Are you a good little slut, Phainon?"

It felt as if his entire body went into a shock as he was fed both praise and humiliation at the same time. His stomach both twisted and tingled, alive in the way it felt when he was kneeled down to sit on his boot and left powerless while handcuffed to his headboard. There were two halves of him at war. One wanted more of this electric buzz, and one wanted to hide away from what his skin was just barely able to hide.

But Mydei knew.

He knew from the start what his body was saying even if his mouth said otherwise, and he knew what was tucked inside of him just waiting to be brought to light. He studied him, from the way his body reacted against his will to the way his mouth spit fired words like bullets in a chamber. Some were made of rubber. Some were made of metal. Some were swallowed down with nothing but the shell left on his tongue.

This time, it was the last.

Because bullets made of metal pierced, and he knew better than to puncture holes into either of them. Mydei would *not* let him get away with a slap on the wrist for being that unnecessarily cruel again. He was not the same ignorant man he was all those weeks ago when he first spoke to him about this.

The ones made of rubber hurt significantly less, but they still left a tender bruise in their wake. He knew they were frustrating even when non-lethal too. Why did he need to arm himself in the first place? Why couldn't he just speak the way he was meant to?

Swallowing, he looked back at Mydei as his fist loosened, giving in to that confusing and powerless feeling. The mess in his chest and stomach, the one tightening and buzzing as he stared at him, needed four hands to unravel. Not just two.

Phainon grabbed it the way he grabbed Mydei, gently, easing his knuckles from their firm clench and awaiting instruction on where to start pulling.

Mydei grabbed it the way he grabbed him, tightly, pulling him close until he grasped his hand inside of his own.

"How does it make you feel when I call you that?" He asked.

"C-Could you say it again, master?"

He leaned in close, lips tilted towards his ear as his opposite hand held the side of his head. One thumb brushed in front of his earlobe, and his four fingers sprawled over the back of his neck to curl into his hairline. The hold was just as firm, rooting him in place and giving him nothing to do but to listen to his own degradation.

"Are you a *good… little… slut…?*" A mocking tilt laced the cruel words that wrapped tight around his lungs.

"But I wouldn't let anyone else do this to me," he breathed out, speaking the obvious.

"So you're *my* slut then?" Mydei mused, and he sealed his lips shut when warmth bled into his veins. "I don't even need to handcuff you or punish you, do I? I could do whatever I wanted to you right now as you are. What would we blame then, Phainon? Can you tell me?"

Whatever it was he wanted to say dissipated right then and there. Nothing but the taste lingered, confusion mixed with that addictive hit of *arousal*.

His slut.

No one else's. *Never* anyone else's.

His.

"What is there to blame besides you wanting to keep exploring with me and me wanting to help you?" He asked, and Phainon gulped. "Besides you wanting *me* and me wanting *you?*"

Nothing.

There was *nothing*.

“Taste it,” he encouraged him, brushing his lips over his earlobe gently. “Tell me what you are, my sweet, sweet prince. The man I put before myself, the man I hold in such a high regard, the man I’d do anything for, tell me. *What are you?*”

Phainon took a deep breath, his stomach in knots and heart trembling inside of his chest. Eyes casted down to his shoulder, he parted his lips, first feeling what it sounded in his head before testing their weight on his tongue.

‘*Master’s slut.*’

It was weighty. It sounded terrible in that voice inside of his head, like he was someone *anyone* would stick their nose up at in disgust.

But no one was here in his room besides him and Mydei, and Mydei wouldn’t stick his nose up at him. No one was here in his head besides him and his consciousness, and if Mydei wouldn’t dare to do it, why should he?

“I…” His voice broke, weak beneath the foreign heaviness of degradation in a way that wasn’t in *anger* or *disgust* at himself.

“Go on…”

“I’m… master’s… slut…” Phainon said slowly, tasting each word as they came out.

“There you go,” he praised him, his voice rich with pride and encouragement. It tickled him the way it always did—deep enough to coax him into *anything* if he wished. “How does that feel, Phainon?”

The hand on Mydei’s shirt lowered, gliding slowly down his chest and stomach before twisting to push their combined hands over the front of his own jeans.

“I’m not going to touch you if you don’t ask me,” Mydei reminded him. He kept his own touch on his hand, avoiding the denim still wrapped around his lower half.

Phainon nodded. He understood that, and he didn’t mean to make him. It was involuntary. His body was moving on its own, shocked to the bone and almost afraid to know what he’d find. The feelings in his body told him a million different things all at once, so he needed physical confirmation.

Shaking fingers curled to hold the front of his pants. His insides felt like radio static, and his skin felt like the thinnest, most transparent veil over it all. But there was no mistake.

He was hard.

His jeans were tighter than they had been, and he could feel himself behind the zipper. Though it wasn’t *completely* stiff, it wasn’t completely *soft* either.

“That’s enough,” he was scolded, and every part of him forgot that he wasn’t supposed to be doing this. “I didn’t give you permission to touch down there so freely, and you still haven’t answered my question. *Focus, Phainon*. Focus on your master.”

His hand was forced to lift slowly up his own bare belly and chest, guided by the one still holding it. Those were his fingertips trailing over his body, the divots of and plumpness of muscle making them sink and rise. Right above them, however, feeling each dip and rise were Mydei’s own as he touched his skin through him.

“I-I’m sorry. I’m sorry for getting distracted. I just think…” He cut himself off with another swallow. “No, *I mean* to say that I’m hard, master. It’s very confusing to be aroused by being bullied, but I think…—*I mean* I might… *like it…?*”

“Is it confusing in a *good* way, or is it confusing in a *bad* way?”

Phainon nodded weakly, unsure what he was agreeing to but agreeing nonetheless. “If I’m your’s, I wanna keep hearing it. I wanna figure that out too.”

Mydei took a step back. Painted across his lips was the stretch of a smile, light and reassuring in nature. It was nearly a complete one-eighty from the word he had just flung at him multiple times.

Could a man really look *that* kind after calling someone his *slut?*

“I want you to know me calling you by that does not mean I think of you in that way. You are my prince, and I will continue to treat you like someone precious to me,” he promised him. There was no reason to believe otherwise, really. “But I like the flustered look on your face when you’re shocked that your body enjoys something. It makes me want to say it again and again.”

He had… a *look?*

“When I offered this to you and you seriously considered it after only joking around, when I praised you for the first time in my kitchen, when I made you finish while clamped and cuffed…” A soft, shaky breath left his lips as he seemed to remember each and every moment with unwavering clarity. “I want more of that. I want to find out where all of your limits are.”

Phainon vaguely remembered him saying that while fucking his mouth, but he thought it was just *talk*. Back then, he figured it was nonsensical rambling from a man desperately chasing that last push to orgasm. That was what Mydei said it was the first time he went on and on about training him to suck him off better.

‘*Impractical*’ was what he called it. Was it still that way? Or were these two completely different fantasies?

“I want to push you until you find out everything you want to know about yourself,” he whispered earnestly. Rose tinted his golden cheeks as he looked over every inch of his face.

“What are you saying…?”

Mydei watched his lips ask that question, then watched his eyes as they looked into his own.

“I want to watch you come out of your shell some more,” he answered, though his voice still sounded a little lost in his own head. “You might want to explore this, and you might like what we do now, but I want to see you *love* the things you never even knew you could have, Phainon. The things you thought you hated—was it the action itself, or was it the lack of someone trustworthy to try it with?”

The unspoken ‘*I’m right here*’ did not go unnoticed, but that wasn’t the point. What he was asking for, at heart, was *a lot.*

Knowing Mydei meant that was both nerve-wracking and exciting all at once, as he was finally being more open with his own enjoyment but at the expense of pushing him even deeper. More than just dipping his toes in, he wanted to push and push just to see when he’d throw the towel in. Then, like he did with his fingers in his throat and the clamps on his chest, he wanted to go further to see just how long he could last in the deep end.

There was a fire in his eyes, a kind of flame that burned only when someone had their sights set on something they didn’t plan to let go of.

Hunger for more. Excitement for the possibilities.

Mydei didn’t always have that much energy. He didn’t always talk so much about his own wants, needs, and hopes. The most he ever spoke or let himself open up was when comforting him, ranting to him, or being pulled apart from pleasure. Everything else was casual small talk, information gathering, or instructions to follow.

He wanted *this* more than anything, didn't he? He wanted to teach him what he knew about the thing he loved so much, and he secretly wanted him to *share* that love with him. This was his interest. This was his *life*.

It might be roleplay *for him*, and it might be a temporary arrangement *for them*, but this was still *Mydei’s forever.* Even if it wasn’t him, *someone* was going to be his submissive until the very end. *Someone* was going to be guided, punished, and pleased by his hand until he could no longer raise it.

Someone… even if it’s *not him*...

A moment passed without a response, and Mydei pulled away from him before covering his mouth and looking away. His eyes fell, and his fingers dug into his own cheek and jaw.

“F… Forgive me,” he apologized as if he just realized all of what he said. The slightly muffled sound was *pathetic* in comparison to how bold he just was. “I’m getting ahead of myself again. I always do this… especially with the things I love.”

The dejected look on his face made his stomach ache. He might as well have been a puppy that was kicked in the ribs for being too excited to play with him. Mydei didn’t whimper, and

he didn't ever whine, but he might as well have as he shrunk into himself.

"This was never about you loving it. This… This was only ever about you *trying* it. I sound l-like someone terrible right now," Mydei back tracked immediately. "I'm sorry, Phainon."

But truthfully?

Phainon would do anything to bring that fire and excitement back into the man who lived in a constant state of *restraint*. It was at these moments that he felt like someone alive rather than just a person passing time, a person who lived to support others but dealt with life all on his own.

"My master can," he allowed. As he spoke, he watched his eyes specifically to see if he could bring that desire back.

They widened out of shock from his agreement, then narrowed skeptically as if they didn't believe him. But even with the daring look, there was a glint. A sparkle.

"I can… *what*?" Mydei pressed, dropping his hand so his voice was much more clear. "Be specific, or I'm going to get the wrong idea. What can we figure out? What *exactly* do you want?"

"I said you can have everything," he reminded him. "If you want me to try something new, tell me."

His bottom lip was pulled between his teeth, and Phainon watched him chew on it for a moment.

"I plan to show you Hysilens' page while we have some down time together," he said, keeping his voice steady. "I… want you to remember that as much as I soften myself and restrain myself for you, there are things I enjoy that I understand you won't. You're going to see how I responded to her posts, or the things I liked from it, and I need you to realize there's no '*bad*' side to this, okay?"

Phainon nodded firmly.

Still, he continued to speak. "I need you to understand really quickly that I am capable of being a loving and kind person, while also wanting to be rough and disrespectful sometimes. Like the way I praise you endlessly, just to call you a slut right to your face."

It almost sounded like he was *begging* him to not think of him differently. Even if he kept that same strong and reaffirming tone woven inside of each word, he was *begging* to have this part of him accepted.

"Yes, master. I understand," he reassured him, then held up a pair of shorts for him to finally take. "Let's get comfortable. Then, we can take a look."

Mydei stopped him before he could walk away and head towards the bathroom to change. One hand wrapped around his elbow, gripping it firmly to bring him right back.

“Undress in front of me,” he instructed him.

He didn’t say it forcefully. The tone he used was more guiding, as if gently encouraging him rather than demanding he give this to him. He *wanted* to see him undress, but he wouldn’t *make* him do it if he felt uncomfortable by it.

Phainon’s belly tingled, and he took a deep breath before dropping his hands to his belt and pulling the leather free. Metal clinked when he jostled the buckle while unzipping his jeans. Denim dragged down his legs, and he stepped on the fallen waistband to pull himself free from the slim-fit material.

It wasn’t sexy. He wasn’t here to give him a strip tease or try to rile him up.

All he needed to do was *undress*. That was his ‘*command*’.

Standing in just his boxers, he awkwardly raised his hands and gave them a little shake as if to silently say ‘*here you go*.’ Because if he gave him that verbal attitude, it’d probably land him somewhere unfun. Luckily for him, Mydei let the gesture slip with just an eye roll.

Two hands pressed to his shoulders and guided his body to turn slowly, giving him a good look at his bare skin. While standing tall, he made sure to keep his eyes lifted and back straight. Even if all he wanted to do was curl into himself and hide, he needed to keep a *respectable* posture. He needed to carry himself with *confidence*.

He was almost naked, and it was nerve wracking to feel those eyes rake over his body as if to analyze every ridge of bone, dimple of skin, and shift in muscle. His palms were sweaty from where they hung by his sides now. Each breath came a little slower than it should be to calm himself down.

But it wasn’t that he was insecure of his figure, just that it felt weird being looked at so intently.

Mydei *liked* his body. He liked touching him, praising his hard work, and showing him off for other people to look at. He liked taking care of him too. Those fingers once tenderly rubbed ointment into his bruised skin, and they always prepared him meals that kept him healthy. He even reminded him to do things like exfoliate a few times a week and moisturize every day, not just his face but everywhere. It kept his skin soft and smooth, and it made him feel even better about himself.

There wasn’t a reason to really be nervous of him hating any part of him when he knew that’d never be the case. But he felt *less* admired by standing here and *more* like a doll on display.

It just wasn’t confidence-inspiring.

“Please touch me, master,” he requested quietly while facing away from him. His eyes were on the wall across, trying as much as possible not to bow his head or sink his shoulders.

“That’s not asking.”

Right. That's begging. And Mydei liked begging, but only if he was *asking* at the same time instead of *telling* him what he wanted.

"Can you please touch me, master?" He corrected himself in that same desperate tone.

Two hands slid from his shoulders to the thinnest part of his waist, thumbs gliding down the dip of his spine gingerly. They were hot, taking in his body slowly and steadily like he was learning how to read it. Every twitch from the feeling of his bare skin being touched. Every shift when he found himself fidgeting nervously. Every breath that filled his lungs then deflated his chest from trying to steady himself. Mydei held him through it, watching from behind where he couldn't see what expression he wore.

Did he like this? Did he enjoy feeling him up like this?

"Shoulders back," came a soft, almost far away voice.

It didn't need to be said, and it didn't need to be seen. The reverence was rich right there in his tone alone, whispered like he was barely able to focus long enough to get it out.

Phainon pushed his shoulders back, flexed, and the hands on his waist lifted to touch the muscles in his back and behind his arms. They traced carefully, lining each plump mound before one hand planted firmly in between either shoulder blade. The other lowered, falling down, down, down until his thumb slotted into the dimple at the bottom of his spine. His boxer briefs were pulled up just beneath them, leaving them open and exposed for him to do as he pleased with.

He gasped quietly, not expecting him to touch so low on his body. But Mydei only squeezed his hip reassuringly, holding him firmly as the hand on his shoulders pushed forward.

"M-Master…"

"Come on," he encouraged him. "Give this to me."

Phainon knew he didn't have to. He could use one of his safewords if he needed to. All of this could end right here and now if he wished it too…

Slowly, he bent himself over. With every inch, his heart pounded harder and heat bled deeper into his cheeks, especially when Mydei gently nudged his feet apart.

"Phainon, you look so good like this…"

What kind of position was he forcing him into right now? Bent over in front of him as he held him like this, just what was he imagining while staring at him from above? Where was *his* head right now?

"Do you happen to touch yourself back here?" Mydei asked, stealing the last of the breath from his lungs. "Have you ever thought about it?"

"I… sometimes… I mean, sometimes I…—"

“Shh… Relax for me,” he hushed, inching his fingers higher up his neck. To accommodate the reach, he brushed against his bottom when standing even closer. “Breathe.”

Phainon gulped, feeling his day collar slide briefly against the back of his neck as it was traced over. Above its golden chain, his fist wrapped around to cup his throat lightly. It was careful not to push on his Adam’s apple, settling over the bulb but not pressing down.

“I have… a… thing that I keep for uh… stuff,” he tried to explain, but the dumbed down words felt so *stupid* to say out loud. Admitting it felt *so damn humiliating*.

Part of him wanted to laugh at himself for stumbling so much. What was so embarrassing when Mydei used and saw *worse* than a couple of sex toys in his life?

“Come back to me.”

Mydei’s hand closed to press around his esophagus, and he picked himself back up until he was standing upright. The hand on his hip rotated, brushing beneath his belly button and pushing their bodies together.

It was one thing to feel him through their pants and clothes, but Mydei was a t-shirt away from being as exposed as he was. Meaning, he could feel almost all of him pressed even *closer* to his ass right now, and it knocked whatever was left inside of his lungs out.

That cock he had taken into both his hands and the depths of his mouth, how would it feel inside of him? Those pulsing veins and hot ropes of cum, what would it be like to have that instead of still silicone?

Would they ever go that far? Did Mydei want to, and was that why he pushed him into that position?

Did… *he* want to, and was that why *he* allowed him to push him into that position?

“What do you have?” Mydei asked him gently, pulling him from his racing thoughts.

“A… A uh… toy,” he choked out, trying to relax enough to think. “I h-have three. I have one for inside, one for outside, and a… little um… pink… thing.”

“I’m going to need you to be a little bit more specific, okay?” Mydei coaxed, allowing his thumb to rub carefully over his neck. “Do you want to say it? Or do you want to just show me?”

Both sounded equally as terrifying, but at least one meant he could move from feeling his body pushing against him. Maybe then he could speak and think without it all turning into mush.

“Yeah. Can I just… sh-show you, master?”

Slowly, his body was let go of. The hands left, and then the figure behind him stepped back to give him some space.

He went to his dresser beside them, peeled the very bottom drawer of the heavy wooden furniture piece open, then looked away in shame after flipping a towel up. With his hand over his face, Phainon hid himself away from where he kept his small stash of toys, his lube, and the condoms he used for his dildo.

It was just a little bit embarrassing that he wrapped the toy up more than himself, wasn't it? Because he didn't just sleep around.

Unlike Mydei, who had an opened box in his locked cabinet because he *did* go around fucking other people freely.

When was the last time he did it with someone? Was it so long ago that he needed to imagine fucking *him?* Did he even *want* to think about sex with him, or was he just pent up?

No.

His head shook as he held his face tighter.

He can't think that way. He can't think of *Mydei* like that when he knew the man would never treat him that way. It wasn't fair. It wasn't right. That wasn't the kind of person he was, just his own imagination giving way to whatever part of him that *craved* to make him feel bad about himself.

Mydei reached for the wrist in front of him, then pulled it away to reveal wobbled lips and red skin. He watched him, offering a kind smile in an attempt to ease his nerves.

"I showed you mine."

"You don't put a ball gag up your ass…" He accidentally bit, then sucked in a sharp breath when he was given a pointed look. "I-I'm sorry, master. I didn't mean to say that. I'm nervous, a-and embarrassed, and I shouldn't snap at you like that."

"I should put this in your mouth instead of my fingers or cock," Mydei chided, bending over to pick up the purple toy in front of him. "It's long, not too thick, and could do well to keep you pliant without being too much to take. It'd definitely be easier to take and maneuver with how soft it is too, as it would bend right down your throat nicely."

He looked at it, noticing the way Mydei handled it without any kind of shame. His fingers bent it, squished it, and held it as if it *wasn't* something dirty. That toy had been *inside* of him so many times, but he touched it like it was any other ordinary object.

"Have you tried to fit it all in your mouth?"

"No… It's not fun to do that on my own, master."

"I'd like to see you use these," he told him. "Especially this and that vibrator. Has *that* been inside of you?"

His head shook. "I'm nervous the wire could rip trying to pull it out…"

Mydei let out a short and amused breath, then placed his purple toy back down before closing the drawer with his foot.

“It won’t. It’s stronger than you might think,” he promised him as the drawer thumped shut. “And let’s not be embarrassed of pleasure anymore, okay? Let’s not treat it like it’s dirty or shameful to want and indulge in.”

He hummed, trying to convince himself that was true.

“You’re a grown man that has needs. I don’t care if you own a fleshlight, a vibrator, or a dildo. If anything, I’m still a little surprised that you’d ever put anything back there,” he commented.

“What? Why?”

Did he see it as embarrassing? Did he see it as humiliating?

“For a guy that’s only had girlfriends, I assumed you would be the kind of person to avoid exploring anal.” It was said so honestly that Phainon wasn’t sure if he should be offended or not. “Most guys won’t. They think it’s gay… or the most embarrassing thing a guy could do.”

A scoff fell from his lips.

“I’ve always liked guys! I’ve always been into *anyone* who is kind! I just… never had a boyfriend before,” he defended himself. “If there was ever a possibility of getting one, I mean… I had to know if I could… a-and I can!”

Why did he feel the need to *prove* himself right now? It felt as if Mydei *doubted* that he even liked it.

“You told me you owned one before. I don’t know why, but part of me just couldn’t imagine you *actually* using it. Maybe it’s because you’re a little uptight about things like this,” he explained. “Seeing it in person is making me think about you using them now… That’s a pretty sexy thought.”

Phainon bit his tongue, aware that if he kept thinking Mydei was looking down on him, he’d say something he'd regret. Instead, he took a moment to compose himself and remind himself that Mydei was just *surprised*. He had every right to be. It wasn’t as if his reasoning made no sense when multiple times he, himself, told him he didn’t *want* to be fucked. He wasn’t *ready* to be.

“My master really wants to watch me fuck myself then…?”

“I have made it so clear that I want *everything* you have to offer me,” he stated. “And when we scroll on your laptop, you’re going to see parts of me just as deeply hidden as those toys of yours. Consider this an even trade of sorts, and please get some clothes on before I lose any more of my control. I’m trying very hard right now to not stare you down.”

Mydei liked his body that much then? To the point his self-control slipped just enough to bend him over to imagine what he’d look like beneath him? To the extent that he was

thinking about what he'd look like taking that toy inside of him?

"I could… stay like this if it pleases you, master," he offered him shyly, and Mydei groaned quietly.

"It *would* please me," he murmured, eyeing his chest and shoulders for a moment. "I won't turn down an offer like that. Not when you look *that* good blushing and showing yourself off for me."

That was all the response he needed.

Phainon took the shorts in his hand and stuffed it into his dresser. Without being told, he then picked his jeans off of the floor to toss with the rest of his dirty clothes.

Behind him, Mydei was folding his own pants and setting them neatly down with his belt. He had pulled his shorts on some time in between him turning around and walking to his hamper, standing fully clothed while he, himself, was only in his boxers.

"You can stay that way until I *allow* you to cover up since you *offered* me this," he decided. Truthfully, Phainon already expected that to be the case. "Come."

Mydei went to lay back in his bed with a few pillows propped behind him for support. The laptop was placed on his lap, fully charged and ready to go.

"Password?"

"My mom's name and birth year," he shared, and Mydei typed it in swiftly. "Where should I sit, master?"

"You can lay down beside me," he offered him. "I left plenty of room by the wall with your plushie. Take it."

He grinned, climbing into the bed beside him before pulling the toy puppy into his arms. His head rested over Mydei's lower ribs, cheek pressed firmly to his body. His body twisted to lay comfortably on his side. The sheets were picked up, something he realized while squirming around, but he used the bunched blankets as a place to rest his bent leg instead.

An arm settled over his jaw and neck. Its weight was heavy but comforting, and he could feel each flex when he typed into the keyboard. To his surprise, being trapped in the bend between his forearm and bicep didn't make breathing all that difficult either.

"Do you enjoy being there?"

"Mhm."

"You have a voice, use it," Mydei chided while clicking on a webpage. "Do you really enjoy being squished underneath my arm?"

"Yes, master."

He chuckled, then held his bicep with a firm and reassuring grasp before placing his arm back where it had been.

There was always talk for *his* body. It was always *him* being handsome and *him* having a figure meant to be shown off and praised, but Mydei was right there with him. His body was almost the same as his own. The only noticeable difference at first glance was that his waist had a few more inches tacked onto it and his thighs were slightly thicker with more muscle. But *his* arms, chest and shoulders were just a little bit wider, especially when he bothered to flex them.

There was also the added bonus that Mydei didn't light up like a bulb every time he got the littlest bit flustered.

Castorice said it was refreshing for a guy to express themselves so freely, but wasn't it also a little bit silly? He was *grown*. He wasn't a *kid* anymore. Should a man really be so easy to fluster?

Oh… but Mydei said he liked that flustered look. He liked the expressions he wore when they were alone together, and he wanted to keep seeing them. He wanted to see them *all*.

"If you laugh, I'll pinch you."

Phainon hummed, tuning back into what they were doing together as he watched him type a username into the bar to log in.

'*daddy-likes-red33*'.

It wasn't funny. Not really.

But he was suddenly reminded that this account must have been made when Mydei was in college, as that was when he found out about this. This '*daddy*' was smaller than he was now, less restrained in the way he carried himself, and less confident in what he had to offer someone. He was quicker to lock himself in his room with his books and computer all by his lonesome, then grumble freely when people began toeing on his nerves by being loud or nosy. His mouth was a loose cannon when he snapped back at him over minor competitions, and he would wind himself up so tightly until the spring popped and left him bed ridden.

That was a little bit funny of a thought. The same guy who would laugh at him for scoring a lower grade in one of their shared classes wanted someone to call him '*daddy*'.

Had they been around twenty-two again, and had Mydei confronted him to call him '*daddy*' with a straight face, he probably would have asked him if he was *out of his damn mind*. Then he would have laughed right in his face with no remorse.

Who was calling him *that* back then?

"You're laughing."

"I'm n—*a-ah!*" He gasped when two fingers pinched his side tightly. "Master, I'm not l-laughing! *I'm not!*"

He *was*. He was giggling to himself as Mydei watched him squirm and try to dodge his rapid pinching, but he failed every time.

“You’re a pain in my ass,” he muttered, grabbing his side to still his wiggling. Even then, he was snickering softly while imagining his younger self. “I guess it is funny to think about. Go ahead and laugh then.”

“It’s not funny,” he lied, but that earned him another pinch for being dishonest. “*S-Stop!* Okay, I get it! It *is* funny! It’s funny thinking of you *back then* trying to be the way you are *now*.”

College Mydei would have *never* been able to live this kind of life, not the way he did now, with compassion, patience, and maturity. That kid would have taken one look at him when he called him ‘*abusive*’, and he would have yelled that he was ‘*senseless*’ before walking right out without a singular word. No explanation would be given. No defenses would have been put up. Nothing.

And they would have had to pretend it never happened if they wanted to stay friends. Because Mydei didn’t like drama, and he didn’t like people inside of his business unless he invited them in. They’d just avoid it with silent acceptance, and he'd have to live with the fact he thought his best friend was some kind of *violent* person.

“I wasn’t trying to do all of this right away,” Mydei protested, which was comforting to hear. “I just wanted someone to call me that because it made me feel good. It was sexual before it was anything else.”

“Are you sure you don’t want me to call you ‘*daddy*’?”

He seemed to like the title a lot. His account was named after it.

“Positive.” He was shot down immediately. “I like the way you call me ‘*master*’. It feels more personal for us because I know the comfort it brings you, and it makes me feel like someone more important to you.”

Phainon nodded as he settled down, finding comfort in lying still now that Mydei was done attacking him. They found a comfortable position once again, even if his side still tingled and lightly ached from the pinches.

“Do you still use this account?”

“I’m not as prone to being online when I’m with someone. As of recently, I’ve checked it maybe a couple of times a week when you’re not around,” he answered honestly. “If it’s just me and I’m not with someone, I use it more often.”

“Do you… talk to people on it?” Phainon found himself asking, watching as he opened his inbox and showed him all of his messages freely. “That’s pretty recent, My… *master*.”

If he didn’t have someone with him, then did he get his fix online from random people?

Mydei hummed. “Before we started this thing between us, I found this person asking about gear somewhere. I linked them to where I bought my own. That’s all.”

So he helped strangers on the internet too. Not just ones like Hysilens, who he followed, looked up to, and just so happened to know, but completely random people who happened to throw a question into the void that was the internet.

“You’ve never met a sub on this?”

“I’m not interested in online relationships or long distance,” he brushed off. “If I can’t have someone with me, there’s no point. I want a partner, not a face on a phone screen.”

That brought him a bit of comfort.

He clicked through his own page, but it was clear he didn’t post his own content as he slowly scrolled through it. There were plenty of reposted things though, from diagrams about how to play safely, text posts of discussions with tons of comments, to straight up *porn*. He kept it *all* on this account, it seemed.

They weren’t as rough as the ones he saw. The two people weren’t by some metal bondage contraption with someone shoving, throwing, and forcing someone else into an uncomfortable position. There were no heavy, metal locks and blood tainting their skin from where it broke. No one was screaming—though that *could* just be from the volume being turned down too. All in all, it didn't look terrifying to look at.

This one looked *rough*, enough to make him cringe when he watched a palm crack down on a man’s cheek. His skin blossomed red from impact, and there was a glossy, far away look in his eyes as he looked up at the camera. No way was it being professionally recorded, either. He could imagine something this blurry and shaky was the result of two people pumped up on lust with an outdated phone. The video couldn’t have been more than five seconds long, as he was still scrolling down the page when it started again.

Mydei *liked* that kind of thing.

He knew. He was aware Mydei could do so much worse than he did, but he couldn’t imagine him cocking his hand back and cracking it over his cheek enough to make his head turn. Not for anything. Not even the worst of arguments or betrayals could make him think of him *smacking* him across the face.

“I’m not here to show you what I repost,” he acknowledged, reaching to gently rub his cheek and cup his jaw. “But… I figured you deserved to know a little bit more of what I keep hidden, so… Here it is.”

“I don’t… like that…”

“I know.”

“I-I don’t want you to hit me in the face like that, master. *I don’t.*”

Sometimes he tapped his cheek with his fingers, and that was okay. Really. If he put just a little bit into it and left the lightest sting, like a playful slap on the shoulder or back, maybe he could handle it if he felt particularly playful or secure. If he hit even harder than that, maybe he could place it underneath all his '*yellow*' limits—like those nipple clamps he has stored away.

Maybe it could be a punishment for being mouthy or forgetting to ask for something. Or if Mydei felt just a little more mean, he would let him *tap, tap, tap* his cheek a few times just enough to warm his face and paint it rosy. That could be okay.

But if he ever swung at him *like that*, he'd cut the collar off his neck and walk away for good.

"You're allowed to have your limits," Mydei returned.

As a moment of silence passed, he saw less intense videos and photos pass by. Those had men going at it, some dressed in leather gear and others stripped completely bare. One man had his hands behind his back as he sat on his knees, taking it from behind *roughly* but not *violently*. Another glimpse of a video had a man on his back with his hands cuffed overhead, and his body moved together against his partner's with rolling hips.

Some photos were of people wrapped up intricately in ropes—men, women, *anyone*. Suspended in the air, laid out on the bed, casually sitting on the couch, it didn't matter. And if it wasn't rope, it was leather. A lot of it. Leather bands on their thighs, wrists, and ankles. Leather harnesses with delicate chains decorating them. Collars and corsets. Not *sexually*, just *casually*, as if they were meant to be admired for its fit, craftsmanship, and allure rather than just straight up porn to get off to.

Other photos were of rose-painted skin. A man with his chest clamped and either pec engulfed in the fiery color. Then another one bent over with his ass in the air, cheeks bruised into a deep scarlet. The fingers and handprints were obvious, which brought him just a hint of comfort that there weren't any outside instruments.

Phainon wasn't sure how he felt knowing Mydei might want to spank him until his ass looked like that, so he didn't say a word about it. All he did was look and wonder… would he ever let him put a hand on him in that way?

"I… like the other pictures," he said, and Mydei hummed while scrolling up again. "The ones where people are dressed up in ropes or leather. They look nice."

"Don't they?" He sighed wistfully. "The designs some people come up with are so intricate, and I like thinking about practicing them."

"I like this one." One finger pointed at a bare chested woman with brown ropes crossed around her breasts and waist. "It looks like a harness out of rope. It's not as… scary looking as the full body ones."

"I could learn that," Mydei offered, and his finger dropped at the thought of wearing it himself. "I could tie you up just like that, and you could walk around with it to see if you like

it. There's no name on it. I believe she just played with ropes and made it herself, but if you give me a few days, I can try to replicate it for you."

Phainon could hear the excitement in his voice, like he was suggesting to watch his favorite movie or play his favorite game. There was passion in it, and just him offering to learn something for him made his heart skip.

More than just *teaching* him, he was willing to *learn* with him.

"Okay," he agreed quietly, going back to holding his plush toy. "Make me look as good as she does in them, okay?"

"You'll look better," Mydei promised him. "My rope work might not be as good as hers, but if it's you in those red ropes, no one compares."

He flattered him *way* too much sometimes.

"Are we still going to look at her page?"

"Huh? Oh, right. That's enough about me," he said absentmindedly, having been distracted. "I liked one of her posts from last week, so it should be right about… there. Are you ready to look at it with me?"

"Yes, master."

He clicked on an account from a text post, and Phainon clutched on to his plush toy enough to suffocate the poor puppy when he realized this was the woman he knew. That profile picture of a girl in a black half-mask with her earring dangling in the corner and a sky-high leather collar encompassing her entire neck was Hysilens. That was his *friend*.

"These are her mistress' rules, okay?" Mydei said, then clicked a link in her bio. "Some of them might look familiar to you. Some of them might seem completely arbitrary by your standards. Remember, they're not '*bad*' because they make you *uncomfortable*."

His heart pounded harder when it loaded.

He saw it there, the one where she will never refer to her wife as anything other than '*wife*' or her dominant title. It was the first one. It was the only one in bold print. Her name will not be spoken unless absolutely necessary—online was *not* necessary.

Online made sense. Digital footprints were a thing, and her wife could be traced back to this. *In person*, it seemed a bit much to adhere to.

And another rule that said she was not to harm or alter her body in any way without her wife's permission. No surprise tattoos or piercings. No extreme haircuts. No smoking or drinking. It was not *hers*. She gave that control up to her wife.

But Hysilens smoked. He's caught her twice already, and both were around him while trying to hang out with him.

Did that mean seeing him made her get punished? Did he play a part in her wife punishing her unknowingly?

It wasn't as if he could just ask though.

Phainon noticed they did have a few of the same rules too, like exercising and eating regularly, having their outfits picked out or inspired by something their dominant wanted, and needing to relay to them wherever they went with who they were with. Those were familiar and comforting, and the wording reminded him a lot of what Mydei had in their folder.

Maybe he plucked it right from her page because he liked it so much, and that was a cute idea.

"Likewise, these are some of her punishments," Mydei added, clicking another link to bring up a detailed list with their clauses.

"You can… uh… tell her wife studied law. These pages look scarily official, like some kind of *real* contract," he commented, uncomfortable from how serious it read. "It's more organized and detailed than our list, master."

"Well, we don't have the same dynamic."

That was obvious.

Mydei kept their things color coded and number oriented except for their revisions and sticky note reminders. Those were lined over or under their rules, expectations, and things alike. It was detailed, just *simply*. He didn't have paragraphs of lists.

Hysilens' wife's clause *2-D* and *section A* stated that if she was found out to be smoking behind her back, her wife had the right to refuse her entry into their house until she found a way to rid herself of the smell and disposed of the pack and lighter.

He pulled back in shock after reading that, and Mydei held his arm for comfort as he turned his head up to look at him.

"Her rules are also different because her mistress is *absolute*," he reminded him. "I couldn't be that cutthroat, personally, but I admire her ability to seize complete control. That takes a lot of trust and responsibility."

That didn't matter to him.

"She… gets locked out of the house if she smokes…?" He asked quietly, earning a nod in return. "Hysilens doesn't have any friends here but me. How is she meant to get rid of that smell if it's on all her clothes, her hands, and everywhere? She'd have to shower and change. Where is she gonna do that if she can't go inside her house?"

"Creative freedom…?" Mydei offered a response, looking as if he knew but didn't want to share it. "Phainon,—"

"She smoked twice around—"

“It is not your fault if she smokes,” he cut him off, giving his arm a gentle but firm shake. “It is not your fault if she chooses to give in to the urge while knowing what her punishment is. That is between them, Phainon.”

“But—”

“No. *Stop*. This has *nothing* to do with you. This is *their* business that she just so happens to document online. *No one* who looks at her page is important enough to *make* her do anything.” Mydei’s stern voice held no room for arguing.

He shrunk back at the sound, lips sealed tightly.

“I know you care, and that is so very kind of you, but she loves her mistress and her mistress loves her. She’s not helpless. She’s not a victim. She’s *exactly* where she wants to be, Phainon. *Calm. Down*,” he demanded.

Slowly, the hand on his arm began to gently stroke it, brushing over the dips and bulges while holding him gingerly.

“Yes, master…”

“You are a guest here on her page, and if you’re uncomfortable, we can leave.” He didn't want to do that yet though. “You’re not obligated to stay and look at things you don’t like.”

Phainon took a deep breath, following the upwards trace of his hand before exhaling during its drop.

“Does… she get equally nice rewards to compensate for those punishments?” He wondered, not wanting to look at that list anymore now that he understood they were *not* alike in that nature.

Fingers in his mouth and not being allowed inside after a long day at work were *not* the same thing. Kneeling on the floor with a leash was not like being kept outside on the porch when it could be too hot to breathe or too cold to bear outside. If *that* was bad, he didn’t want to know a single thing else on the rest of that list.

He didn’t look again, but Mydei did. Those golden eyes lifted to the laptop, and a few clicks sounded.

“Weekend trips to the beach,” he read for him. It seemed he silently understood his need for a break. “Concert tickets to her favorite bands. Festival passes. Camping trips in the mountains. Freedom from certain chores.”

Those sounded really nice, especially since music festivals and concerts could get pretty pricey depending on how popular an artist was. Trips to the beach must have been her favorite reward, as Hysilens loved the sea and posted about missing it so much. And everyone liked to skip out on household chores like dusting ceiling fans, scrubbing the tub, or mopping floors.

“Mm… a lot of these are sexual in nature though,” he warned him, and Phainon shook his head. “The gist is she’s allowed to orgasm freely, or she’s allowed to have her mistress touch her.”

“Being touched can be a reward?”

“For Hysilens, she pleases her wife dutifully whenever, wherever, and however. Being allowed to be touched by her hand in return *is* a privilege and *not* a requirement as she *should* be pleased by simply serving her mistress,” he explained, flicking his gaze back down to him.

That sounded unfair. Her own wife would *only* touch her for a reward?

“My master touches me as punishment though,” he thought out loud, comparing them both even if they were proving to be completely different in that regard too. “If I misbehave, you make me ask to be touched by you.”

“You’re not ‘*free-use*’, and you’re not a toy for me to play with as I please,” he said simply. “I don’t touch you unless you ask me to. It just so happens that the only time you ask is during a punishment.”

While looking at each other, Mydei’s hand gently reached to cup the back of his head and neck. The twist to keep looking up at him hurt, but the added support took some of its strain away.

“Yeah…”

That was true.

The only time he asked to be touched was during punishments, except for the singular time he wanted to be handcuffed and played with. He didn’t just go around asking him to suck him off, jerk him off, or play with his chest. Even if Mydei said he was his all the time, he just… *didn’t* ask.

“I think you’re still too shy for that,” Mydei accused. “I think you’re too insecure to confront me for your pleasure, so you misbehave for me to push you into it.”

Phainon felt his lip twitch upwards.

“Do you really think that, master?”

Was he *that* readable?

Mydei nodded lightly. “You throw yourself in a spot where you don’t get a choice and that makes me have to choose for you. You don’t want to risk admitting your feelings by *asking*, you simply want to be forced to *receive*.”

He hated that he was right. It was intimidating asking for something sexual, especially something on his own as it felt selfish to do. Dirty, even. How could he treat him like he was just a sexual object to use?

“I don’t really know when to ask or what to ask for, master,” he confessed. “Can I really just ask you to get me off? Isn’t that… degrading for you?”

“Yes, you can. The worst thing I’ll say is ‘*no*’. And no, it isn’t degrading for me to provide for you.”

“Hysilens’ wife makes her earn her pleasure,” he brought up, and Mydei nodded. “Do I have to do that, or can I really just ask and expect you to give it to me?”

A chuckle followed, the sound low and almost teasing. “You asked me to handcuff you out of the blue one night, and what did I proceed to do?” He mused. “You asked to get me off in my office after I said that wasn’t necessary, and what did I allow you to do?”

Phainon felt his stomach tingle at the memories.

“You asked me to stick my fingers in your mouth, and where did I put them not even ten seconds later?” He continued his pressing to prove his point.

“I-In my throat, master.”

“*That’s right.* I stuffed my fingers in my slutty prince’s throat until he gagged on them,” he said, and his legs squirmed over how *crudely* he worded that. “Pleasure is more than a reward *and* a punishment. But for men who don’t want to be freely touched and used like a toy, you need to ask for it.”

“Yes, master.”

“Turn around now. We’re not done looking,” he instructed, letting his head down as he twisted back to his laptop screen. “Let’s get out of these and open her frequently asked questions…”

He clicked another link, and Phainon looked through the page as Mydei scrolled slowly.

“‘*Why?*’” He read, then highlighted the question for him to focus on. Afterwards, he highlighted the response. “I want you to read this out loud for me, Phainon. Do not mumble. Why does Hysilens have this relationship with her mistress?”

He shifted, tugging his plush closer. “Do I really have to call her that? I don’t want to say that name.”

“Are you ashamed to say it? That’s what she is.” Mydei emphasized his point by highlighting only her title. “You shouldn’t find these titles distasteful. It’s a sign of respect.”

“But she's not *my* dominant. She’s not my… ‘*wife*’,” he tried to reason with him. “I don’t want to—”

“*Don’t*.” Phainon didn’t expect him to change his tune that quickly or say it so firmly. “Don’t call her that. Refer to her as Hysilens’ wife, making the only title you should ever say *mine*.”

“*Yes, master*.”

Butterflies fluttered in his stomach over the possessive tone and command, and he closed one eye briefly when Mydei's hand was placed on top of his head. Each ivory lock was tucked back away from his face and ear, something he learned Mydei enjoyed doing. Maybe it was to see his face better, but, truthfully, the specifics didn't matter when he enjoyed the soft gesture.

His eyes looked over the text, and he shifted while taking a deep breath.

"'*My wife and I have this dynamic because I wanted someone to push me out of my comfort zone when I got too comfortable with my complicity,*'" Phainon read word-for-word. As he did so, Mydei's fingers rubbed his head gently to silently encourage him. "'*I struggle to push myself, and she struggles with seeing me struggle. In her perfect world, we would be at the top of the tallest mountain, alone, a king and her knight fighting to conquer anything that comes our way. I want her to have a partner that fearless, but I refuse to let it be anyone else.*'"

A quiet hum filled the room when he took a moment to breathe, warm with admiration.

"'*I strive to be the partner she deserves to have every day—someone proud to be hers and hers alone, someone always trying to be better than they were, and someone willing to make her life as peaceful as she makes mine easy. My wife doesn't need to fight the way she has all her life if I'm here. I don't want a thing in this world if I can't have it beside her. My wife loves me more than anything. I love my wife more than anything. Her happiness is my happiness, and my success is her success. I entrust the rest of my life to my wife, as she has gifted me with hers all the same.*'"

Phainon wasn't sure if he said the word '*wife*' enough yet as he quieted down, rereading the text inside of his head.

"Isn't that sweet?" Mydei asked him, his voice far away as if he were imagining a love like that. "The way she gives it all to her mistress is… beautiful. The trust she has in her. The reverence she speaks with when referring to her. They belong to each other, and there's nothing else that matters but being what the other needs."

He hummed, wondering if Mydei wanted something like that.

"When I first stumbled across this blog, they weren't married," he recalled. "Hysilens… Well, she logs herself off as '*pearl*', so '*pearl*' would write about their daily lives and how she served her mistress. It made me realize that I would like to have someone talk about me that way."

Did Mydei really want to be worshipped like that?

"I don't need to be revered like royalty. I don't need to be crowned king of the world. I just… I… I wanted someone who wanted to please *me* for once," came the soft spoken confession. "I still do."

That answered it. He *didn't* want worship.

“I try my best to be deserving of that much subservience, but it doesn’t ever seem to work out with the men I meet. I’ll keeping work on myself until then. Surely, it’ll happen.”

Mydei wanted someone who tried as hard as he did every day. The energy he put into being someone selfless, strong, and hardworking, he wanted given back to him from his submissive in their own respective way.

For being *selfless*, he wanted someone willing to give him a space to be *selfish* with his desires by wearing the things he liked and partaking in the things he liked. The collar and clothes were there for him to feel in charge of things, and someone who shared in his kinky tastes meant he didn’t need to hold back on them.

For being *strong* enough to hold himself up, he wanted someone to give him something worth *protecting* and *nurturing*. Those insecurities, worries, and stresses, he was strong so he could take them away and plant something better in their place. He was there to help inspire confidence, security, and peace in someone instead.

For being *hardworking* every day, he wanted someone to give him something *relaxing* to come home to. Obedience and servitude took some of his own stresses away while also giving him the taste of control he craved. While he was insistent on certain duties being *his* only, he seemed okay with sharing some of the load if he was being listened to every step of the way.

For being so *independent*, he wanted someone who would allow him to *take care* of them the way he did for everyone. Every day. Every night. All the time with very little breaks.

Phainon blinked, and he looked down at the body beneath him as Mydei scrolled again on his laptop. They were no longer on that link, but on her actual page itself. He could see the entries when his attention shifted back to the screen. The words were blurred as he exhaled shakily. Some pictures followed.

Mydei liked some posts of her bare ass with straight laced welts over either cheek. He reposted some blocks of text with the word ‘*punishment*’ written boldly at the top. On one he stopped at, there was a reply with his username asking just how safe numbing cream could be inside of someone. Maybe she talked about it in that post, but Phainon didn’t really read it. He just *looked*.

Why would he ever need to know that? What drove him to think up something like that?

How did the gears inside of his head turn when he looked at things like this? He couldn’t get off on these pictures and stories—*Mydei wasn’t sexually attracted to women.* What did having these things saved do for him?

“Are you okay?” Mydei asked gently as he held him firmly. “Is this too much for you to see? You’ve stopped talking.”

“What’s numbing cream gotta do with anything, master?”

He held him closer. “Well, I was contemplating using it as a punishment in a similar way her mistress did. Nothing I did seemed to work, so I thought this would.”

“Did you?”

“Twice, but… I don’t like it.” His voice was still light, still honest. “I hated everything about it. Depriving my partner of feeling me feels like a punishment to myself.”

”How?”

“It’s sex. What’s the point if my partner doesn’t feel anything from me? No pleasure. No pain. Just… nothing?” He asked him. “I decided quickly it wasn’t for me. I refuse to do it again.”

Phainon nodded, reading another post he replied to, where he asked about the safety of leaving things overnight inside of someone. When he read the entry itself, Hysilens talked about her wife forcing her to wear a toy as she slept.

“Would you do that, master?”

The thought of sleeping with his toy inside of him made him squirm. Wouldn’t the lube dry out? He moved around a lot, wouldn’t it just keep moving inside of him and make it hard to sleep? Stretching down there for so long had to have some kind of side effects, right? How long until it went back to normal?

His nerves absolutely hated the idea.

“I don’t put anything inside of myself,” Mydei mused, pinching his cheek teasingly. “Would my partner? If they wanted to. I kind of like knowing I could wake up and just slip it in at any point of the night.”

His face heated. “You wouldn’t wake them up first?”

“I would during it. Being woken up with sex is sexy, isn’t it?” He mused, and Phainon thought about it for a moment. “I’d love to wake up with a handsome man taking care of me. But I wake up so early that it’s unfair to expect someone to be up before me.”

Was that why Mydei liked to say his body was open *all the time* for his partner? To give consent to things like that?

Phainon nodded, wondering if he should do that for him sometime or if he meant that for his *real partner.* He liked getting him off. He liked having him in his mouth. A morning blowjob would be nice if *he* did it, wouldn’t it?

Mydei probably wouldn’t do it for him in return though. Being asleep, there was no possible way to ask him unless he gave him permission the night before. That kind of took away the surprise and spontaneous-nature of it, didn’t it?

“You might like to hear this,” Mydei circled over a chunk of text. “If you ignore the part where she’s punished for smoking, you can focus on the part where she’s given a reward for

making a friend. That's you. Being friends with you gave her a nice gift."

He read it, eyes raking over the highlighted text and nothing else. It was specifically pointed out for him, allowing him to skip over the parts that made him uncomfortable.

"Date night is cute. I'm glad she could have that," he agreed, then looked at the rest. "Wearing a remote control toy is… uh… an interesting way to dress for being at an expensive restaurant."

"They're very sexual people."

He noticed. It seemed they incorporated something sexual into everything they did, even things like household chores and outings together.

Maybe Mydei had handcuffed him while they spoke, but that wasn't exactly *sexual* as much as it was just getting him used to the feeling of them. Wearing sex toys and gear to tease and play with during public outings *was* some kind of play between them. Hysilens really was someone who was available all the time for her wife, no matter where, when, or why.

"Which is okay. Some people are, and some people aren't. If they want to incorporate sexual things into everything, that's fine."

"My master is someone like that," he pointed out, just to have a hand cup over his mouth suddenly.

He had a '*touch whenever he wanted*' rule before. Just because it wasn't implemented didn't mean it ceased to exist in the first place.

"I'm open to it, but only if my submissive is. I'm not forcing anyone to do anything they don't want to." Mydei held his mouth tighter, making him chuckle. "I'm not that shameless, though. Things in public are far too risky for my tastes."

Like when he teased him that one time while he was out with his mom, right? When he came back to him, pinned him to his door, and warned him to behave.

As his palm moved, Phainon grinned, twisting his neck to look up at him again. That same hand held him, supporting his weight.

"My master's seeing his mom again tomorrow…" He teased him. "Would you be mad if I did what I did last time?"

"If you rile me up while I'm with my mother, I'll bend you over my lap and spank your ass so raw that you'll try *standing* when you *drive*," he warned him. The only other time he had a tone that serious was when he was scolding him to keep his fingers out of his *fucking* mouth. "That's a promise, Phainon."

"So mean…" He pouted, even if the thought made his heart jump. "You wouldn't even give me a warning?"

"You got your warning the last time you did that."

“I could just ask you to spank me if I wanted to try it, couldn’t I…?” Phainon trailed off, and Mydei nodded. “But what if it’s fun making you annoyed?”

What if it was exciting for him when *he* was the one to let go of his usual self?

“If you want me to be rough, you can ask for that too. I’ll either give it to you or make you wait until I feel up for it,” he told him simply. “I don’t like when people disrupt my time with my mother.”

“I won’t then,” he promised him, sensing that was something he really, *really* cared about. More than anything, Mydei always did fall underneath the category of ‘*mama’s boy*’. “I’ll be good, and then my master can reward me for it, right?”

“I should reward you for behaving the way you’re meant to?” He scoffed. “I don’t want a performer on a stage. Behave simply to behave for me, or there’s no reason to be collared even when I’m away.”

“I like having you with me though…”

“Then prove you deserve to keep it.”

Phainon sat up, twisting his still-half-naked body until he was on his hands and knees. With one arm tucked beneath him and his other stretched across the opposite side of Mydei’s waist, he looked up at him and his confused expression. Gold dangled in front of him, heavy and swinging, drawing those amber eyes in for a moment before they flicked back up to him.

Like this, he was turned away from the laptop completely, not quite as interested in the screen as he was in *Mydei*.

“Yes?” He hummed, keeping his attention on his face even if he was stripped down just for his viewing pleasure.

“I’ve been thinking… what else do you gain from this besides just the pleasure of being served?” He asked honestly, and a soft click from a closing laptop sounded beneath his voice. “You have rules and expectations, and you’re very clear with them. But… why do you have them at all?”

“What does that mean?”

“You want a submissive, and you want someone to please you.” A nod of confirmation followed. “But what exactly made you so deeply interested in it?”

He wanted to know more about how Mydei felt. He wanted to know everything he thought of when he looked at *BDSM* in its entirety—sexual or not.

What kind of beauty did he see in this kind of lifestyle? What other comforts did he find in it if he treated this like his deepest, darkest secret? What drove his interest to crave a relationship *only* like this?

“What do you want to know then?”

“Why?”

“I’m good at—”

“No,” he cut him off. “I-I’m sorry for speaking over you, master, but I don’t want you to tell me you can take care of someone. I saw that all day today. I felt that every time we did something. I want to know why you have so much *passion* for it.”

His eyes widened slightly.

“You wanting a relationship like this isn’t enough for you to *love* it. You wanting someone to be so vulnerable and loyal to you *isn’t enough*,” he tried to explain to him. “What is it about *BDSM* that draws you into having books on the psychology of it all and to follow *women-led blogs* that don’t even arouse you? Why do you want it? Why do you respect it—*all of it*—so much, even the parts that do nothing for you?”

Golden eyebrows slowly dropped from their raised state. Pink lips met in the middle as he picked his jaw up, pursing as he took a moment to assess the weight of his question.

“I like things… *clean*,” he said tentatively. “I like *order*.”

Phainon *knew* that. He learned what his color tupperwares meant, and he sat with him to create all those pages painted in red, yellow, and green. Mydei chased clarity and precision, and when things became muddled and messy, it became extremely frustrating to him. It meant he didn’t know where to go, what to do, or when to stop himself. He didn’t like being too much. That wasn’t news.

“Why?”

“I just do. I want everything in its place all the time.”

Phainon knew that. He learned how to tuck his laundry away without upsetting him and how to organize his medicine cabinet accordingly. He understood that Mydei liked stability and reliability, that he counted on things being set a certain way if he decided it was meant to be that way. More than just wasting his time, it threw him off his momentum to have to stop and search through his things. It was overstimulating for him. That wasn’t news either.

“Why?”

“I-It’s my life,” he stammered, backing up slightly when he pushed closer to him. “It’s what I practice.”

Phainon. Knew. That. There was more to it than that though. He lived in this, but there was so much *passion* in his eyes when he let himself off into the deep end of it. There was something inside of him that came *alive* when he pushed aside their every day behavior and took it somewhere further. Whenever he responded *positively* to the things they did, it was like all his walls crumbled down for a moment and someone else was allowed to play.

“*Why?*”

“Because it just makes sense, Phainon!” He snapped from all the pressure being layered over him. “I-I can have *rules* to follow. I can have *expectations* to meet. I can lay it all down on the table with someone else who needs that structure as much as I do, and we have *tangible roles* to adhere to. There’s *communication* like nothing else. There’s *trust* like no other. It’s… It’s *perfect*. I love it. I love the *freedom* in it to just *be myself*.”

Phainon listened to him breathe quickly, shallowly, and his head tilted as he watched that polished facade crack for him.

Mydei spoke like he needed him to understand where he was coming from. His words were desperate and laced with an air of vulnerability that he didn’t use often. It was like he had taken his hands and ripped open his ribs to peek at what made his heart pump, and with everything splayed open, there was nowhere and nothing left for him to hide. Not from him.

A tilt tugged over his lips soon enough, pleased by the confession.

The hand farthest from him raised slowly, and it pressed lightly against his clothed stomach. He touched him gently, offering his own arms to help carry the mess of guts he just spilled. If his skin was stained from the blood, it didn’t matter to him. Messes never really bothered him.

Phainon crawled closer, his knees shifting so he could drag one over Mydei’s lap. While settled on top of him, he fixed his posture and held his gaze the way he always asked of him.

“You told me you liked the look on my face when we experimented together,” he brought up carefully when his breaths began to even out. “Well, I like the look in your eyes when you’re passionate about this. It makes me want to be even *better* and *bolder*.”

Mydei’s hands held his forearms, gripping the muscle tightly like he needed something to ground him. And that was a feeling he understood well.

“I don’t… mean to pressure you.”

“It’s not pressure. It’s more like… inspiration,” he corrected him. “My master *inspires* me to try more things out or consider more possibilities.

“Like what?”

Everything.

Throughout this entire arrangement, disregarding his own innate curiosities, getting to please Mydei has driven him to do so many different things that he didn’t think he'd ever like. Handcuffs. Collars. Being pampered and protected like someone more precious than anything. Being choked while giving head and made to gag repeatedly on fingers. Everything they did was brought about simply because Mydei made it *less* intimidating and *more* appealing.

Even what he wanted to try next.

“Can you please touch me, master?” He said softly, quietly. A shiver wracked his body once his hands lowered to slip over his waist. “Can you please give me one of your hands?”

He reached to grab it once it lifted off of his body, fingers lining the back of his knuckles and joints. They covered the ones beneath with his own, guiding them to meet by closing his own. Together, both hands brought his heavy palm to his cheek, and he rubbed his face into its warmth for a few short moments.

“Can you…” He took a breath, then exhaled just as deeply. “Can you give it a tap?”

The hand beneath his twitched, fingers stiffening to a firm line before curling once again. Like he wanted to do it but was hesitant to try it with him.

“Don’t hurt me,” Phainon rushed. “I just want a tap to see if it’s still ‘*red*’, or if we can put this somewhere else… Maybe ‘*yellow*’. M-Maybe ‘*green*’. I don’t wanna be bruised, I just want to see what you were talking about when you tapped my face earlier.”

Mydei shook his hand off, then nodded. “I won’t hurt you.”

Phainon dropped his arm down to his lap, and he let go of him completely to offer him all the trust he could muster. Palms to his thighs, he told himself he wouldn’t grab him. He wouldn’t stop it from happening.

It wasn’t going to *hurt*. He didn’t need to *protect* himself.

Straightened fingers tickled over his face, playing with the softness of his cheek before stilling.

“One,” his steady voice counted, making a twist knot his insides with anticipation. “Two.”

Shifting, his breaths were held as Mydei’s opposite hand cupped his jaw on the other side. The pad of his thumb rubbed over his face gently, soothing his bubbling nerves.

“Relax, please.”

“Yes, master.”

Fingers lightly tapped exactly where he was going to be hitting, silently warning him to prepare.

“*Three*.”

When his fingers connected with his cheek with a soft slap, he almost wanted to laugh out of the sheer surprise of how *painless* it was. He expected something harder. Maybe not rough, but something more than a genuine tap.

Upon seeing his amused reaction, Mydei lifted his hand and did it again, harder, and he felt his heart skip. His stomach jolted. That one didn’t hurt either, but the suddenness of it stole the breath from his lungs.

“Talk to me,” Mydei said, holding his face.

“D-Do that,” he encouraged him, then felt as his jaw was gripped tighter to support it better. “Again.”

“I want your attention on me,” he demanded, then pulled his hand back before smacking it down on his cheek just as firmly as he did before. “I want you to focus only on how it feels.”

A light tingle was left in the wake when he planted another one down, tickling over his heated face and traveling right through his body.

“I want to see your handsome, red face blushing for me like you’re *innocent*.”

Another came, the hardest of them all, and he rushed to grab his wrist after to keep him still, breaking the rule he tried to place for himself.

“*Yellow!*” He yelped in surprise. “N-Not any harder. *Please*. It’s already stinging, master.”

“But you’re *not* innocent,” Mydei accused him, eyeing his cheek before gripping it instead. The base of his thumb pulled it back, and his fingers pressed underneath his jaw to pinch, to press on the hot skin so he could feel the aftermath of it. “Not anymore. Are you?”

It didn’t *hurt*.

The impacts weren’t particularly heavy up until the last one. They weren’t uncomfortable to take on their lonesome. Each was light enough just to tickle his senses, and the last was surprising more than anything. It alerted him of the words leaving Mydei’s mouth, and it reminded him that he was here to give *all* of his attention to him. There was hardly any sound from the skin connecting, nothing like the cracks he remembered hearing from videos.

He didn’t slap him as if he wanted to *bruise* him, but like he wanted him to simply look at him and wonder ‘*why*’ he did what he did.

And he did. He thought about it. His tongue pushed to his cheek and pressed it deeper into the hand holding him. A sting burned in the corners of his eyes as he thought about how pathetic he must be to not… *hate* that.

Why didn’t he hate being *hit* by him? Why didn’t it feel terrifying to be *slapped* by him?

“I’m not innocent because I’m your… slut… now, right?” He asked shakily, alive once again with that nauseating mix of arousal and shame. “Someone… dirty?”

Mydei shook his head lightly, shooting down the statement. “You’re my good little boy, and I’m so proud of you for having the guts to ask me for this. I’m so proud of you for being able to use your safeword and tell me how you feel without me asking.”

Right.

He wasn’t supposed to talk bad about himself, and he was supposed to remember that it wasn’t *embarrassing* or *shameful* to do these kinky, sexual things with him. His exploration

wasn't dirty. What people might think of him if they found out shouldn't matter. No one needed to be in their beds but them.

He was not *dirty*, and enjoying this was not something to be *ashamed* of.

"What… What else do you want to do to me, master?"

"Nothing. I just want my sweet prince in my arms right now," he denied him as his face closed in on the crook of his neck. "I want to hold you for a second, then I want you fully clothed so we can start dinner. No more kink. No more exploring. Just me and my prince, and whatever superhero movie he picks for us."

Phainon hummed as he felt the point of a nose brush his skin. "My master can put this in our folder too, by the way. The small ones are green, but the last one is yellow. Anything harder is red."

"I'll write it exactly as you said it," he reassured him. "Thank you for being honest with me and stepping out of your comfort zone."

Phainon pulled him closer, resting his head on top of his and bringing his arms around the back of his neck. He tangled his fingers into his hair and hid himself into the two-toned locks. While doing so, Mydei's hands fell from his face to wrap around his back. One did, anyway. The other grabbed a bottle of water and then raised the cool plastic towards his cheek.

"Thank you for taking care of me," he said back, eyes closing as the bottle soothed the heat in his face. "My master's really the best dominant there is, isn't he?"

Mydei gripped him tighter.

"It's simply my job to guide you and make it as comfortable as possible."

"And you try so hard to do it," he added after. "You're doing your best for everyone all the time, especially me. Thank you for everything you do, from making it feel safe when trying new things to praising me endlessly. I couldn't ask for a better master."

Fingers curled into his back, and they dragged lightly down his skin slowly as his body curled into itself.

"Thank you, Phainon," he whispered just shy of being inaudible. "That means so much to me."

He should probably praise him more. Not *worship*, as he said he didn't want that, but he should at least give him more *acknowledgement* for the things he went out of his way to do. More than just giving him submission, he should say that he was grateful for him more often. Maybe he could give him some kind of gift too, like little things that reminded him of his dominant.

It might not be his place to reward him, but he can still give him a nice gift, right? Something more than words. Something more than just a '*yes, master*'.

Just… something. *Anything*. Because Mydei deserved it. He deserved to have whatever he wanted and to feel as appreciated as possible, and Phainon wanted to give him exactly that.

Chapter End Notes

phainon, reward your man with some morning head and flowers. please, bro, im begging you.

or grab him and let him info dump on his fixation for a little bit as he practices how to tie the harness you like. pour him a drink, rub his back, and let him lay in some quiet for a bit so he can relax his thoughts. you know this man thinks way too much.

-

and here's a reminder to take care of your dom. tell them youre grateful that they look after you and give you nice things like headpats and orgasms and food or whatever your dom gives you. tell them to drink water and get sleep.

if you are a dom reading this, i love you. thank you for your hard work. regardless of how gentle or rough you are, how often or how little you play, or how involved or detached you are from kink, i love you and you're valid. take care.

Chapter 14: Chapter Fourteen

Chapter Notes

> somnophilia !! if that's not your thing, sorry, but i technically did hint at it. also some orgasm denial as mydei felt like a punk.
>
> things are gonna start heating up between them, and mydei's own desires are gonna start becoming more prevalent. here's the warning that things are gonna get kinkier and dirtier while also becoming even deeper than before. maybe even emotional? who knows…

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Waking up with Mydei in the room wasn't new. It was comforting to hear him snore in the middle of the night when he flipped around, and it was nice to see his face the first thing in the morning.

But to be awake *before* Mydei was something new. And it was a complete accident. He swore by that.

Phainon only needed to use the bathroom, so he carefully wiggled himself free before crawling downwards out of bed. His plush was left there, tucked into Mydei's arm instead so the other man didn't miss him too much. When free, he walked on his toes carefully and quietly to do his business without waking him up.

While coming back, he looked at his sleeping figure for a second, ambient lighting from his opened curtain and window illuminating his body in a pale blue shade. One arm was tucked around his toy, and the other was curled beneath his pillow to rest his head. Golden hair spilled messily over the dark bedding and his nape, and his skin was left bare as the room got too hot to sleep with a shirt on. Sheets were draped over his lower body lazily, kicked off his hips but still left around his knees.

The sun was already coming up, and that meant his alarm would probably be going off soon. A singular click to his phone proved that he had about fifteen minutes until it went off.

Fifteen minutes to decide if he *really* wanted to do this with him… to decide if he was going to try and wake him up with head or just give up to start his morning.

He left the room quietly, heading to the kitchen for a glass of water while he contemplated.

Mydei *liked* it. He said so himself that it was sexy, that his body was free to be touched by his submissive, and if it wasn't unfair to ask someone to be up before him then he'd want it more. All signs pointed to this being encouraged. Waking up to a blowjob would be something he *liked*.

But how shameless would it be to just… pull his shorts down and start sucking him off? No warning. No nothing.

In the back of his head, as he set his glass down on the counter and wiped his mouth, a low voice whispered hauntingly. It called him a '*slut*' so mockingly that he could hear its smirk through the four-letter word. Better yet, it called him '*my slut*' so convincingly that he began walking right back into his room. The disembodied voice sounded so good, *too good*, and it beckoned him so sweetly that he didn't even realize he was moving until he was in his room again.

Phainon grabbed Mydei's phone, dragged the top down to get to his alarm, and he shut it off since he'd be up to do it himself. *That* was already decided.

Between him getting water and coming back, Mydei didn't move an inch. He was still on his side, still snoring softly into the room, and still clutching his plush Cinnamoroll.

For memory's sake, he grabbed his own phone and snapped a photo of him. It was cute. If the puppy reminded Mydei of him, then he was *technically* cuddling him still, right? With his arm so tightly curled around it, it was as if he never left his side.

A thought struck. Did he *really* want to disturb him right now?

Phainon looked at him, at his bare hips as he walked close enough to see the crimson ink and the tent inside of his shorts.

Ah. There it was.

Mydei always woke up first, so it was rare to ever feel him against his body like that. The only times he did was when he was too sleepy to think much of it while flipping over, then the day previously when he touched him so intimately. Other than that, though he could see it through his clothes or sometimes sat over it through their jeans, the only places to ever meet Mydei's cock were his hands and his mouth.

And he was about to do it again.

Slowly, he placed both hands on Mydei's body and coaxed him onto his back. One touched his hip. One sipped over his arm. His sleeping figure shifted, slowly rolling until he was laid on his back.

A disturbed hum filled the room, as did an agitated breath as Mydei gave a little squirm to get comfortable again. His feet kicked the sheets lower, and one arm draped over his eyes as he turned his head away from the window. The toy was left stranded to face the wall, pushed away from him so he could plant it on his chest.

Good. His poor plush did *not* need to see what was about to happen.

Mydei's breaths steadied again. He went right back into his peaceful sleep as if he was never disturbed in the first place.

Phainon felt like a pervert while looking at him and admiring his unconscious body. His fingers wanted to touch his chest and stomach, to learn the way it filled with a breath and deflated with an exhale. Each dip was calling to him, beckoning him to trace and learn them in earnest. Each muscle begged to be touched and admired, as Mydei put so much effort into keeping himself healthy and in-shape. It was, *truthfully*, more effort than Phainon did himself.

One hand touched his abdomen tentatively, nervous of waking him up prematurely. Fingertips followed the jolt of red ink on the right side of his hip, tracing it towards his pelvis. He touched the golden hair peeking from his briefs and shorts, rubbing up and down the prickled tufts while trying to find the strength to buckle down and commit.

He was so close already. All he needed to do was pull both down and then put him in his mouth, and it wasn't as if either were new to him. He's done it before. He *enjoyed* it both times.

The curl of his fingers lowered, slipping underneath his shorts before pulling the waistband down slowly. From right to left, he dragged one side lower before the other followed, then took a moment to look at the bulge inside his briefs.

Phainon used his opposite hand to slip inside of the cotton, gently pulling him free before flicking his gaze up to him.

Mydei didn't move. He didn't shift.

Taking a deep breath, he brought himself down to the bed. His left arm pressed flat to the mattress beside his hip, and his right hand lightly gripped the base of his cock. One of the legs beneath him was pushed gently aside, giving him a little more space to comfortably lay between.

With him being asleep, it meant he was free to move at his own pace. There was no '*mouth fucking*' to sit there and take, and no hand pushing him down when he was bumped back too far. Mydei wasn't really *there* to guide him how he wanted it.

What if he was bad at it? What if he went through this whole thing, and Mydei woke up completely oblivious to the fact he even did it because it wasn't good enough to stir him awake during it?

Phainon leaned closer, eyeing his cock underneath the bright blue light of the morning sky. He took a moment to admire it, to trace the veins on the underside and the rounded pink tip. His fist squeezed before lowering to just his thumb and index finger, pinching like Mydei had done to him before. Spit pooled in his mouth, building by the second so it could dribble over the head. While bathed in the newfound slick, he pushed his tongue closer and dragged it down.

Was it right going top to bottom? Should he have gone bottom to top like before?

Did it even *matter?* Mydei was *asleep*.

A sinking feeling filled his stomach as he licked his way up, tasting that familiar salt of his skin. Pulling away, he felt the mess of spit string them together, lightweight and broken to swing against his chin. Slick touched his tightened fingers, and it probably seeped into the briefs where either half split open.

When did he become the kind of person who did these things so freely? Especially to someone *unconscious?*

He squeezed harder, pumping his fingers slowly while swallowing down his nerves because Mydei wasn't *making* him do this. There was no rule and no expectation for him to be here right now, just pure *want*.

Phainon *wanted* to do this even if his nerves were making him hesitate. That was the bottom line. That was the truth.

He was going to do this.

A deep breath deep breath filled his lungs, then he set the thick tip on his tongue before swirling around it. Once. Twice. Three times. The tang of pre-cum danced over his tastebuds, sticking when he stopped and gave a light suck. Lower and lower, he tried to take as much as he could with each dip down before pulling back. Spit glided his movements, making it easy and comfortable to speed up while keeping his cheeks hollowed.

Instead of moving his hand with his mouth, he wiped the spit on Mydei's borrowed shorts. Once clean, it reached for the fingers closest to him. His palm slipped underneath, allowing Mydei's still hand to rest over his knuckles and keep it pressed between his touch and body. Even if he *could* move it, he didn't *want* to.

An extra inch slipped deeper, and tears burned inside of his eyes as the thick head touched the back of his mouth and beginning of his throat. His jaw opened wider, teeth parting out of desperation to *not* touch his delicate skin.

This was so much harder than his fingers as fingers were slender and easy to curl against his tongue. They could slip deeper without problem for his jaw or teeth. But his cock? This was thick, heavy, and it felt almost impossible to take so far.

When he willed himself to go even lower, a sharp gag filled the bedroom. It was sudden and loud, and the disruptive nature made him reel back quickly, panting and messy. Vision blurred, he swallowed down the mess of spit before looking up at Mydei's still-sleeping body.

Was he *ever* going to wake up? How long did he need to do this before he'd gain consciousness and take control for him?

Phainon sucked over the head again, deciding to sparingly try to take so much out of fear. More than just feeling nervous, it was hard to relax his body enough to let him in. Maybe he needed more experience. Maybe he needed that firm, coaxing touch of his dominant *making* him. Regardless, it was too much to force himself to take on his own.

A quiet moan soon filled his bedroom as he sucked harder, cheeks tingling from the constant force. His mouth was full. Tears were dripping down his face from his attempt to take him into his throat. Saliva was thick and shiny over his bottom lip and chin.

The arm on Mydei's eyes dragged slowly. His fingers curled into a shaky fist while reaching to wipe over his eyes, and one knee bent upwards before stopping when it met the body leaning over him. Slowly, it lowered, aware of the restriction.

"Mm…?"

Phainon hummed back, lips sealed tightly around him.

Mydei's next breath was sharp and disturbed, and the hand on top of his tightened weakly to hold him. In turn, he dug his fingers into his body lightly too.

As he went back to bobbing his head, Mydei's hips bucked from the pleasure. His back arched off of the bed, shoulders pushing in deep before he settled back down.

"Ph… Phainon…?" He asked groggily out when he gagged once again from Mydei's accidental thrust forward.

The hold on his hand tightened even more, and he pulled back without bothering to pull him out. Mydei's cock stayed warm in his mouth while he breathed through his nose to calm himself.

"*H-Hah*… Hot…" Came a breathy, raspy voice. With it, a heavy palm cupped the back of his head, settling lightly on top.

Well, he woke up. *Thankfully*.

Whether it was exactly six in the morning or not was a different story, especially as Mydei's figure appeared much more visible underneath the morning light. A little bit past wouldn't hurt too much, right? He could make an exception for a morning blowjob, couldn't he?

Phainon pushed his head down again, massaging him with his lips while building back to his steady pace. Slick, soft sounds of his sucking, heavy breathing, and Mydei's half-conscious moans filled the room, quiet beneath the occasional chirp of a nearby bird outside. There weren't any rambled words. There weren't any more choked noises or gags. Just a gentle pleasure.

"*Phainon*…"

The way he called his name was so attractive. Deeply. Huskily. There was an underlying neediness to it too as he pleased him, one that made his body hot underneath his skin. Even if it was cool from the early morning breeze, sweat dampened his forehead and warmth pooled in his veins.

A twitch flexed against his tongue, and he closed his eyes while focusing on pleasing him. *That* was all that mattered. *That* was the entire point.

Mydei *wanted* this, and he *wanted* to give it to him because he *could*.

Phainon got whatever he wanted, and though he knew it wasn't a matter of tallying up the board on who did what, it felt right to give back. It felt right to offer him this. Blowing him wasn't an *inconvenience*, and he even *liked* the feeling of it. Why not, right?

The fingers in his hair repositioned. It threaded through his bangs and pushed them back, exposing the flushed skin of his face and teary eyes. Though they didn't push him any further, they held him, following his head through each careful bounce.

"I'm… mm…" Mydei's breaths quickened. His groans picked up in both volume and pitch, voice raspy from sleep. "*Fuck*… L-Lil' bit faster, handsome. *C'mon*…"

Phainon moved faster, fucking his own mouth on to him even as an ache built up in the hinge of his jaw. Both cheeks felt tired from being sucked in so deep for so long, but he kept them tight. He kept himself *good*.

"*That's it*... That's m-my boy…" He praised him, panting lightly. "Look up at me."

His eyelids lifted, and he looked up at him through his blurred vision. The eye contact made the cock in his mouth throb. It made his own ache when he watched Mydei take the hand off of his and push himself off of the bed.

Blinking, Phainon pushed the unshed tears from his eyes just to better admire how *handsome* Mydei looked like that. Bent at the waist, hair falling messily into his face, jaw dropped and panting as he watched him intently—*fuck*. He was so *hot*. It wasn't fair that he wasn't even trying to be, yet he just woke up looking *that attractive*.

Flutters awoke in his stomach, and he choked not because he took too much but because it took him by surprise.

Did he need to start waking up before Mydei just so he could see him like this?

A lopsided tilt tugged on Mydei's parted lips from the blatant staring, stretching them into a light smirk. "That's my slut," he purred, more awake than he was a few moments ago.

The hand on his head pushed lightly, forcing him to take a little bit more with every bounce. Mydei tried to keep his speed as closely as possible, only really pushing him to keep going when he slowed down.

"I'm close… Try a-and swallow it this time like a good slut does," he encouraged him. "I'll give you a reward if you manage to do it."

Phainon wanted that. He wanted a *reward*.

Mydei's head tilted back as he groaned, moving on to pushing and pulling his head rather than bouncing it. His added touch made him take the hand on his chest and push three fingers up. Once they lifted, he stopped moving altogether to let Mydei guide him as he pleased. If he pushed him too far down and tested his limits, that was on *Mydei*, as Phainon trusted him not to go too far with it.

All he did was watch as his Adam's apple bobbed, as his long hair slipped back over his shoulders and away from his face. Quick breaths filled his chest, pushing it out and drawing it back in.

Phainon wanted to touch him even more than he did earlier. He wanted to grab his chest and feel each breath as he took them. He wanted to dig his fingers in and squeeze the muscle the way Mydei did to him. They looked so soft, and his darker, pinkish nipples looked so nice while pebbled that stiffly. His fingers longed to pinch. His mouth craved to lick over them and suck. Maybe even *bite*.

Did Mydei like things like that? Did he like his nipples being played with too?

But he kept his hand still. He kept his three fingers lifted and pressed to his body, giving Mydei the signal he wanted from him whenever his mouth was too busy to speak. With his thumb and pinky tucked into his palm, it made the symbol unmistakable.

"I'm close," he panted, and a twitch filled his mouth. "Ah… You're sucking harder. Do you —*f-fuck*—want it that badly, Phainon?"

He didn't even try to nod, too busy working Mydei's cock as tightly and as dutifully as possible. His mouth slipped when pulled back too far, and he worried when his teeth accidentally touched while trying to readjust his jaw, but he didn't dare stop. He didn't dare try to make Mydei slow down when he sounded *that* close to finishing. Especially since Mydei would stop him himself if he was doing a bad job.

But because Mydei didn't stop him or redirect him, he assumed he was doing just fine.

The hand on his head stilled while pushing him as far down as his body could manage. *That* was his warning, it seemed. His pubes tickling his nose and lips, and his hips rolling into his still face for that last push, was his way of telling him he was close.

A throb fluttered between his lips within seconds, heavy and pulsing as ropes of cum shot against the back of his tongue and teeth. It pooled into his mouth pump after pump, salty in the way he liked but sticky in the way that made him want to recoil.

Phainon looked up at him, at his amber eyes as they focused on him and the part of his pink lips as he panted. Shivers wracked through his body from being trapped between his cheeks. Sweat glistened over his forehead from fucking his mouth.

"Lick it up," Mydei instructed him. "All of it."

His tongue swirled around the head before meeting the very tip, cleaning every drop right from the slit before pulling back. The flood sat in his mouth as he held eye contact with him, noticing the curt but encouraging nod.

So, he tried.

Phainon's throat tightened as if to swallow, but it didn't make it far. It took another one and a little bit more force to let the warm, thick load go down. Its texture was still off putting, but

he *wanted* to do it for him. He *wanted* to be good, and he *wanted* to be someone sexy instead of having to rush to spit it out every time. After all, the way Mydei swallowed down his own so swiftly and easily was *sexy*.

When he managed to gulp the mess down, Mydei tore the hand from his head and swiped a half empty bottle of water from the nightstand. It was held out for him immediately, there to help wash his mouth of the sticky coating.

He took it, ripped the lid off, and crushed every last drop before wiping his mouth with his bare arm. Plastic crinkled in his fist, clutched tightly as he tried to swallow the fact he did *that*.

He just swallowed Mydei's cum.

"Fuck," Mydei whispered, eyeing his mouth. "Show me."

Lips parted, he showed off his clean tongue before flicking his gaze up higher. Nothing remained on it.

"*Fuck*…" Came the repeat. This one was even quieter and dragged out even longer than the last. "On your back. Ask me to get you off, Phainon. *Now*."

A laugh bubbled up his chest, and he watched as Mydei pushed himself higher and sat up straighter. His body twisted, spinning beneath him to slide lower down the bed until they were side by side.

"My master might want it more than I do," he teased him, his voice slightly rough from the fucking. "What about our run? Or the cats? Or breakfast? You have a busy morning, right?"

One hand pushed him on to his back, and Phainon rolled over with ease. He watched Mydei lean over him, laughing lightly when his hair draped around them and fell into its face.

"Mm… my master needs a hair cut."

Steady fingers threaded through them, tucking the golden locks back so he could better see the face above him. Warm, golden eyes stared down at him, watching his lips move.

"Ask me to suck your cock and get you off," he repeated, then flicked his gaze higher. "I only need about six minutes."

"Geez, you make it sound like I have no control…"

"If I have *such* a busy day, stop beating around the bush. Tell me if you either want me to suck your dick or to get off of you," he demanded. "You have five seconds. *Five*."

Phainon felt his stomach buzz with excitement and nerves, feeling playful since his earlier gesture was so well received. He tucked Mydei's hair back even more, using both hands to card through it.

"*Four*."

All of it was tucked back into one hand, then held into a makeshift ponytail that left his bangs hanging between them both.

“*Three*.”

“I take it back. Don’t get a haircut. Just let me hold it for you like this,” he offered as Mydei’s eyes narrowed.

“*Two*.”

He grinned over the impending finale. “Please, master," his light, mocking voice begged just as those lips parted for their very last warning. “Can you please suck my cock?”

Those parted lips curled upwards. “That’s it?” Mydei double-checked. “You just want me to suck your dick?”

“And touch me,” he added quickly, wanting his hands on his body. “Can you please touch me, too, master?”

“Well… your wish is my command, my little prince,” Mydei agreed a little *too* happily.

He was quick to lean down and press a kiss to his clothed collarbones, eager for his permission to finally let go. Lips brushed where his pendant usually sat, then lower between either half of his chest, taking in his body kiss by kiss.

“Pick your shirt up before I rip it off,” he threatened.

The hand not holding his hair dropped to lift the cotton higher, raising it to his neck and exposing the expanse of his torso. It was immediately felt up with hot palms, hot lips, and the light tickle of hair falling victim to gravity. They travelled further down, groping his body tightly. Even when his back arched, his fingers followed, sprawling beneath him to pull him closer.

“Master…” Phainon mumbled, looking down at him as that mouth touched his ribs. “My chest. Can you please touch my chest?”

“Mhm. One second, handsome.”

Mydei positioned himself between his legs, both hands moving to pull his pajama shorts down. With them went his briefs, and they were dropped off the edge of the bed to leave his entire lower half completely bare. It was unlike pushing his jeans down his thighs or standing around in only his briefs, as everything was exposed to him from the stiff length of his cock, the hang of his balls beneath, and his bare ass as his legs were pushed further apart.

“I-Is this necessary?” Phainon mumbled, shifting underneath his hungry gaze. “Master, do you need to see *all* of this?”

“Mm…”

Hot breaths fanned over his balls, and he covered his face with one hand when the flat of a tongue dragged over them. The left was bathed with his spit. The right followed before getting sucked between his lips.

"*H-Hah—*"

Phainon's hand gripped his hair tighter, pushing the bangs from Mydei's face. He watched him lick up the underside of his cock after, gliding slowly and steadily until he reached the plump head. There, his skilled tongue swirled as his lips closed around it, toying with him.

Just as he was about to look away, to turn his head and close his eyes, he remembered Mydei telling him that if he stopped looking at him then he'd stop as well. That was what he said the last time they did this, and it was the *last* thing Phainon wanted. Especially as the tight heat of his mouth lowered, bobbing back and forth to play with his tip.

"Master," he moaned softly, wanting him to go deeper but not daring to push his head down. "Y-You're so good with your mouth."

Those pink, slick lips were tight. His cheeks hollowed deeply. As he slowly took him to the back of his mouth, his tongue massaged along the underside. One arm pressed down and barred across his hips, serving as a place to keep them both steady. The other reached to grope his chest, fingers digging in deep before massaging the pec.

Phainon wanted to grab his hand. He wanted to wrap his fingers around his wrist and squeeze just for a sense of control over it all. But he didn't. He couldn't. His hands stayed in place, still, holding his golden hair back so he didn't need to worry about it.

Mydei lowered, taking him down to the balls before pulling back slowly, allowing him to feel the walls of his throat tighten momentarily.

While watching him, he couldn't help but think of how *sexy* he looked while down there. Mouth full and stretched around him, rose in his cheeks while breathing heavily, and only a few random stray strands of blond in his face, it was a face he would be happy to see more often. In that same breath, it was the only face he could even think to *imagine* down there.

"Again," he begged weakly. A hum then vibrated up his cock, forcing his hips to jerk shakily. "Can you please take more, master?"

Just like before, his mouth sunk to the base, throat tightening for a swallow and working his cock deeply. The arm over his hips hid his face now that he was tucked so deep, but Phainon was thinking *less* about seeing him and *more* about how good it felt.

The fingers tangled into his hair gripped harder. A throb pulsed through the vein pressed flush to Mydei's tongue involuntarily, pleased from the heat clinging around him.

"Oh, I-I wanna cum," he choked out, wanting so badly to hold him there and buck his hips as deep as physically possible. "My master's throat feels so good. *Please*."

Mydei hummed again, then pulled away enough to grin sloppily from behind the glistening tip of his cock. Mischief glittered in his eyes. Playfulness rolled off of his body in thick, terrifying waves.

There it was, that *way-too-happy* expression again.

“You’re not allowed to cum,” he decided.

Phainon exhaled heavily, processing his words slowly and carefully. “Y… You’re joking.”

But the look on his face did, in fact, point to him being *completely serious*. Especially as he licked up his cock once more and properly kissed the thick, dripping tip. Even through the mess of his spit, the bead of pre-cum oozing from the slit was obvious.

“Master, can I please cum?” He asked quickly, earning a shake of the head. “No. No no no, I-I was good. I was good for you, a-and I did good, but…—”

“I told you to ask me to suck your dick and get you off. I even asked if you were sure when you missed that second half,” he taunted him. “You asked me to suck you and to touch you, but *never* if you could finish.”

Groaning, he threw his head back as two fingers pinched his sensitive nipple.

“Please,” he begged him. “Master, I was good.”

“Mm… and I will reward you,” he promised. “But maybe this way you’ll remember to ask for *exactly* what you want when I ask.”

“Come on,” Phainon whined, pulling on his hair when he tried to back away. “Th… That wasn’t even… Don’t I deserve…?”

“Don’t you deserve *what?*” Mydei pressed, eyeing him while bringing his other hand towards the opposite side of his chest. “Awh… Is your master being unfair, Phainon? Are you mad at him?”

Rough hands gripped the muscle, fondling him before closing in on his other nipple. Both were pinched tightly, and as either were pulled, his back lifted off of the bed to ease some of the tension.

“Unfortunate… Oh, and by the way, I want your toys, Phainon,” he brought up casually. Before he continued, his tongue swiped over his top lip. Another mischievous glint sparked in his eyes. “I want them locked in my cabinet, and I want you to ask if you can use them.”

“H-Huh—”

He wanted *what?*

Not only did Mydei want to control when he was touched and when he could orgasm, but he wanted to take his sex toys too? The ones he couldn’t even use without asking *anyway?*

“I want you to learn how to ask me for the things you want.” Mydei gave his cock another lick after, toying with his body. “I want to see you use them.”

“Sadistic,” he panted. “My master is being *sadistic* by getting me close just to deny me.”

“Maybe,” he agreed while letting his heated chest go. With the sting of his hold gone, Phainon’s back eased against the bed again to relax. “Maybe denying you pleasure feels good after all the times my spoiled prince was a brat to me.”

Two thumbs brushed his nipples, pushing against the sensitive and rosy buds.

“Or, maybe, I just like to test how far you’re willing to let me push you into your discomfort,” he added, and Phainon looked down at him again. “If you safeword, I’ll get you off.”

“Huh?”

“If you safeword,” he repeated. “I will let you cum.”

Saying ‘*red*’ or ‘*yellow*’ just to orgasm didn’t sound right. It didn’t *hurt* to be left like this. It was just *annoying.*

“I was good.”

“It’s not about you being ‘*bad*’,” Mydei reassured him. “It’s about teaching you what to ask me for, and that I want your obedience even if it’s frustrating to you.”

Phainon sighed, letting go of his hair and bringing his hands to his face so he could hide his flushed expression.

“No amount of asking or begging will make you get me off, will it?”

“No, Phainon.”

A kiss was planted against his hip, and he groaned quietly as his cock gave a twitch in interest. The arousal boiled in his veins didn’t get a chance to go away with Mydei kissing up his abdomen.

“Please, master?” He tried anyway.

“No, Phainon,” he said firmly, and another kiss was planted in the middle of his sternum.

“Pretty please? Can I *please* cum?” He begged one last time. Lips then pressed between either half of his chest. “I’ll be good. I won’t be a brat anymore for all of next week. *Please*.”

“What did I say?” Mydei asked against his skin, causing him to whimper lightly.

“‘*No*’…”

This was torture. It was so unbelievably unsatisfying that he could cry tears of frustration.

But then his bunched shirt was yanked *down*, stretching the collar lower and exposing his neck. One finger brought his day collar out, letting it sit on top of the crinkled cotton where it was completely visible.

Mydei's mark of ownership. His mark of possession.

Right. He belonged to *him*. If Mydei wanted to say '*no*', he could. There was always a way out of anything with him, but if he didn't want to say it, there was nothing really stopping his dominant from doing as he pleased.

Phainon brought his hands around Mydei's bare back, holding him as he looked down and found him so close that it stole the breath from his lungs. Nose to jaw, if he came any closer, it'd be as if he were trying to hide inside of his neck. Maybe kiss it like he did the rest of his body just seconds ago.

"Your toys are *mine*," he said quietly, firmly, and Phainon gulped. "Your pleasure and your discomfort are *mine*."

"They are," he agreed, resigned.

"*You are mine.*"

"Yes, master. I'm yours," he whispered back, craning his neck for the fist reaching around it. Fingers lifted towards his jaw, picking it up and forcing him to stare at the ceiling.

Mydei came closer, dipping beneath his jaw and ear.

"And we're going to start our days after this. We'll have our usual morning, then I'll go spend time with my mother, and you'll visit your own parents, understand?" He instructed him. "Don't stay home all day."

"They work."

"Then bring your mother flowers to her office. Buy your father a meal for his lunch. When Cyrene comes home, spend time with her. *Don't* be alone, and don't think of touching yourself," he demanded, and Phainon took a deep breath. "I will reward you and get you off the next time we meet."

"Yes, master," he returned, quiet. The strength to argue and beg had disappeared.

"I'll send you money. Buy them something nice."

"Wait, I-I—"

A breath was caught in his throat when Mydei's lips pressed to his neck suddenly. Shock and heat burned inside of him, rooting him completely still. Whatever words were in his mouth ceased to exist on both his tongue and in his head.

"Hm?" Mydei hummed teasingly, breaking the contact to let his lips ghost over the skin. Only a hair's width separated them. "What was that?"

The hands on his back lowered, meeting his shoulder blades and pulling his body closer even if it wasn't physically possible. Nails carved into his golden skin. They dug in deep, and the muscles shifted beneath them over the sting.

"I… um… don't… *h-hah*—"

Another kiss was planted on his sensitive neck, and he gasped quietly while turning his head away.

"You don't *what*, Phainon?" He asked, lips moving to his sweaty skin so he could *feel* as he chastised him. "Come on. Use your big boy words."

His master was *evil*. He was *cruel*.

Mydei used the things he liked against him to get a one-up on him, and he denied him pleasure even if he was a good boy for him. Those lips, his hands, and the sound of his voice were weapons all wrapped up in an alluring disguise, and they were all pointed at him to get him to do whatever he wanted.

Everything about him was one big coercion, and Phainon was so pathetically *weak* to it all.

One more kiss touched his neck, this one deeper than the last, and he moaned shakily while bucking his hips helplessly into Mydei's. The shorts added a light friction, but that was all he was allowed—a single kiss of silky fabric against his straining cock.

He wanted *more*.

Fuck. Phainon wanted *more* of Mydei kissing his neck and pushing his weight on top of him. He wanted *more* of his throat closing in around his leaking tip before he swallowed down his load. He wanted *more* of his hands pinching his sensitive nipples and touching his body like it was *his*.

He wanted to feel him *closer*, rib to rib, skin to skin. He wanted it so badly that he could hardly bring himself to think of anything else.

"What are you going to do, Phainon?" Mydei asked right into his ear, and he sucked in a breath.

"I'm gonna… g-gonna… buy mom flowers… buy dad lunch… um…" His brain paused for a second, so full yet so empty at the same time. "'rene… What was I supposed to…?"

He wanted another kiss. *Please*.

And as if he could read his mind, Mydei kissed just beneath his earlobe right where it met his jaw.

"You're going to spend time with your best friend, okay?"

"I-I'm gonna spend time with my best friend," he repeated shakily, earning a positive hum of agreement.

“And you’re going to text me before and after each task, okay?” Mydei continued to speak. “I’m going to send you money, and whatever’s left, keep it to buy yourself something. I expect you to show me what you buy. Do you understand, my prince?”

Phainon nodded quickly. “Yeah. Y-Yeah, I will. I’ll… I’ll show you, master,” he promised.

“Good boy,” he coo’ed into his ear sweetly, hauntingly, like an echo that would stick with him for the rest of the day. Maybe even days. “I have such a good boy, don’t I? So eager to obey me even if it’s such a mundane task…”

Mydei pulled away, and he looked back at him as heat pooled inside of his belly. It licked upwards towards his chest, and it sunk deep between his hips. Everything felt so *hot*.

“You make your master so proud, Phainon.”

He nodded again, weak and just a little bit dazed from all the sensations coursing through his body.

“Let’s start our day. We’re very, very late,” Mydei chided. “Now we need to cut our work out short so we can have breakfast together. What a shame.”

Phainon didn’t even realize how long they spent in bed. Time didn’t ever feel real when he was beside Mydei, especially now that he’s pretty much turned the responsibility part of his brain off while in Mydei’s presence. He didn’t need to worry about anything as Mydei typically had it covered for them both—all he needed to do was tell him.

But it seemed as if they *both* got a little bit too distracted in one another this time.

“Can… we still feed the cats?” He asked shakily, and Mydei pinched his jaw a little bit tighter. “And… can you kiss my neck more in the future, master?”

He was waiting for it. Mydei knew he liked it, but he never did anything with it until now. Now that he had a taste of it, he wanted *more*.

When did he become this *greedy* type of person?

“Yes, we can. And yes, I will,” Mydei assured him, then lightly tapped his cheek a few times. “Focus, my prince. No more dazing off. We have a busy day ahead of us.”

Tingles were left in the wake of his fingers, and he nodded helplessly while nuzzling into his hand.

“Y-Yes, master.”

—

Every part of him wanted to be mad. He wanted to be upset that Mydei took his wrapped up toys inside of an old clothing bag because those were *his*. It wasn't so much that he used them without permission, but keeping them meant he had *some* kind of autonomy over his pleasure. Now, even his *lube* was locked beside Mydei's.

Then, he had to will his boner to go down before Mydei even let him leave the apartment. Between incessant teasing and the loaded spring of his arousal, it was one of the most difficult things his dominant has ever asked him to do. But running with a stiffy was both uncomfortable and embarrassing for anyone who happened to be around, so he had to. By enforcing that task, he had set their schedule back *even more*.

They were barely able to have breakfast together before Mydei had to grab his keys and book it back home. He left in his running clothes, taking a pair of his sneakers and leaving his expensive boots beneath his bed.

Finally, no matter how much he tried to deny him once his brain cleared out, Mydei sent him way more money than necessary to give his parents gifts. By the time he had bought the bouquet of flowers, had two bags of takeout in his passenger side, and filled up his gas tank, he *still* had more than enough money to buy himself whatever he wanted. Clothes. Shoes. It didn't matter. He had it sitting in his digital wallet, waiting.

When showing up for his mom, she accepted the lunch and vase with a wide smile. Her lips pressed to his cheek, leaving a stain that made her coworkers giggle and coo over.

While visiting his dad, he laughed and pulled him into a one-armed hug. One hand ruffled his hair from behind, and the other pointed as he bragged to a friend about what a thoughtful son he raised.

Both of them promised that he didn't *need* to do that. It wasn't his job to look after them, especially to the extent of stopping by at their jobs for lunch. But they were grateful nonetheless. His visit made working on a Sunday morning better, and that was all he wanted to hear. That was all he *ever* wanted to do for them—make them proud and make their days better. If he could be a better son, he wanted to be. He *strived* to be.

Truthfully, he never thought to disrupt them at work as he figured it'd be awkward to show up out of nowhere, but the surprise was well received. Should he have done that sooner?

When he visited on their days off, he brought sweets from a bakery they liked or flowers to display on their coffee table. But should he show up to their jobs and give them gifts out of the blue too? It wasn't a *sustainable* habit to make consistently, but every once in a while was possible. Especially since it made them look so happy, and seeing them happy made *him* feel happy.

And him being happy made *Mydei* happy, it seemed, as he told him that he was glad to help. The photos he sent and updates he provided made Mydei proud of him, and making Mydei happy made *him* even *happier*.

It was a good morning. Everyone was in a good mood because of a simple and thoughtful idea Mydei pushed on to him, and it made his heart flutter whenever he thought about it.

Until he sat in his car outside of his dad's job, stumped on where to go next. What he was meant to buy himself was where he came up blank in his endeavor to please the people around him. There wasn't much he wanted off the top of his head, as he was never someone who wanted materialistic things.

Maybe he could just save it later for gas, as it did cost a bit to drive over to Mydei's all the time. Or he could use it to buy some dinner for him and Cyrene tonight, as he promised Mydei that he'd spend more time with her.

But Mydei wanted him to buy *himself* something nice. He didn't intend on the extra money being used for something as simple as gas or food, which was why he wanted pictures of what he chose to use it on. He wanted proof that it went towards a *want* and not a *need*—as Mydei was very clear that even if he didn't *need* to spoil him, he *wanted* to provide financially for him too.

Maybe he could get them things to do together? He could get some new games to play on that old console of his, or a couple of books to read together while lounging around the house.

Phainon, ultimately, ended up getting both.

He bought a single-player video game that he and Mydei could watch each other play, sets of floral legos to build together when they got the chance, and a book about an immortal prince who fell in love with the savior of his world. It sounded good when he picked up the spine, and Mydei liked books as he had two shelves of them, one in his living room and one stashed away in secret.

One picture of his haul was sent to him, and though Mydei didn't read it right away, he knew he would as soon as he got the chance.

The bag was set on his table, and he felt a hand wrap around his arm as a face peeked from behind him.

"What's that?"

"Nosy," he mused, looking down at his roommate as she eyed the bag. "Nothing. Just some things I grabbed for Mydei since he was busy today."

"Oh?"

"He's with his mom," Phainon shared as she pulled open the bag to look inside. "'rene, it's rude to snoop."

She gasped in offense. "I'm not! I'm just curious where you were all morning! Did it take all morning to grab those?"

He took the bag while shaking his head.

"I went to see my mom and dad too. I figured I'd bring them lunch at work," he told her. "Do you wanna do something today? I haven't been home recently, so I figured we could relax here together. Unless you wanna go out, then we can go catch dinner."

A sparkle lit up her rosy eyes as she looked away from the bag and up at him instead.

“Just us?”

“I don’t see anyone else here…” Phainon trailed off, looking around them both. The sarcastic remark made her push on his chest, and he grinned as she nodded.

“You’ve been so busy with Mydei that I was beginning to feel a little bit left out,” she sighed dramatically. “Let’s stay home tonight and catch up. What have you been up to with him?”

A twinge of guilt struck him in the chest as she immediately ignored whatever he had bought in favor of heading towards the kitchen. It hung heavy in his gut when a bag crinkled, then even heavier when she looked over her shoulder.

“Also, what’s with this new style?” She teased, eyeing his dark jeans and white t-shirt. “I’m starting to miss that old country charm, the blue jeans and brown boots look was real cute on you. Or the comfortable look of you throwing whatever was clean on. Now, you look like some kinda bad boy in your black leather and gold chains.”

“Is it ugly?”

Mydei liked it, and Phainon didn’t mind dressing up for him so long as he kept telling him how good he looked. The moment he stopped complimenting him and caring about how he looked was the moment he stopped caring about what was on his body again.

“No, it just doesn’t look like the Phainon I know,” Cyrene said simply. “I miss Mr. Purple-Hoodie.”

“I still wear that, you know,” he defended himself. “Just… around the house or when running to the store real quick. I’m not gonna wear it to see my mom at work.”

“Well, if you keep dressing like that, then you won’t have to worry about being single for long. Some girl or guy is gonna come in and try to whisk you away.” Cyrene winked at him while tossing a bag of chips to the counter. “Is that what you want? Some older lady from auntie’s job to come whisk you off your feet?”

No. He didn’t care about drawing anyone else’s attention anymore.

Maybe before he did. Maybe before he wanted to try and look good for someone who would possibly find him interesting enough to talk to for more than a night. More than a dance. More than a drink. More than *casually*.

But now? The only person he wanted to impress was *Mydei,* his *dominant.*

“You know who you dress like actually?” She brought up casually, and he hummed curiously. “Mydei.”

His stomach dropped.

“Mydei’s usually wearing darker colors like that. Were you inspired by his closet?” The joke made his breathing hitch. “You two hang out so much, it’s like he’s rubbing off on you! Soon, will we even be able to tell you apart?”

“Yeah…” Phainon laughed awkwardly after. His grip on the bag tightened. “Maybe. If it works for him, it should work on me, right?"

Her eyes raked over his clothes. Those warm, blush-colored eyes stared as if trying to dissect every piece of him, to pull him apart and examine every single fragment closely. His black boots, his black jeans, his black leather watch, and his golden necklace. All of it was taken in by her, and she hummed a low, drawn out sound.

A spotlight was cast over his head, and a jury surrounded him, waiting to declare him guilty of deceit.

Could she see right through him?

Cyrene then shrugged casually and exaggeratedly, hands lifting into the air as she turned her attention away. While facing her back, he exhaled, glad to be released from the choking hold.

“It looks fine. I like how much confidence you’ve been radiating recently, and Cassie was right when she said you have a kinda ‘*glow*’ to you. But honestly? As long as you continue to be the same genuine and kindhearted guy inside, I’ll love you through any identity crisis you have,” she told him, then waved her hand dismissively. “Just… don’t try too hard for some attention, silly. People who are worth the time will like you for *you*, not an *act* you’re trying to put on.”

His lips sealed tightly together as he wondered what that was supposed to mean. After all, it wasn’t as if he was *trying* to be someone else. He wasn’t just letting Mydei take him and push whatever he liked onto him like some kind of blank canvas.

He was still him, just dressed up a bit more with a little bit more thought into the things he did.

There was a *choice*. There was *always* a choice even if he agreed to give up his control. Mydei held his cards and played them as he wished, but *he* was the one to deal the hand to him. Whatever his dominant ‘*made*’ him do was nothing more than a gentle push in a direction he *wanted* to walk down anyway.

That was fine, wasn’t it?

He was *learning*. He was *experimenting*. With both came changes, and he welcomed them as they came because they felt good. Physically and mentally, he felt better than he used to.

If Phainon looked past the shame that clawed at him when things got particularly heavy or foreign, Mydei never made him feel as though he wasn’t good enough. Even when he was being ignorant and unnecessarily cruel for no reason, Mydei did his best not to talk down to him but to explain why he was wrong. He didn’t shame his feelings, only supported them and their suffocating weight.

It was his own mind playing tricks on him that made him feel inadequate. Those were his own insecurities painting over the things that didn't make sense. All Mydei ever did was tell him that he should have more respect for himself and those around him, he should dress to better accentuate his handsome features, and he should be more confident in his body and his interests. That didn't mean he wasn't *good enough*, just that he could be *better*.

Was that *bad* for Mydei to do? Was it *wrong* for him to guide him in that way?

"You hear me, Phai?"

"Huh?" He asked, having zoned out completely. "Yeah. I heard you. Something about not changing myself for people, right?"

She nodded while giving him a smile. The gesture was so sweet and genuine that he couldn't find it in him to defend himself or protest.

It wasn't her intention to drag anyone, he knew that. She didn't suspect Mydei was changing him in any kind of way, so she didn't blame him. She didn't insist that this newer version of him was bad for trying to change things up a little bit, just that he was different. Confident, but different from the guy she knew him as.

He couldn't really fault her for a word that she said.

"I'm… gonna put this bag in my room," Phainon settled on, wanting to remove himself from the subject completely. "I'll drop it off at De's some point this week."

"Okay! I'll get together a snack tray so we can binge some television," she beamed happily. "I missed hanging out with my best friend."

"Yeah. I missed you too."

Phainon rushed to his bedroom, and as if Mydei had a sixth sense of when he was alone, his phone buzzed. Because he was the last person to text him, everything in him just knew it was his dominant finally responding to his messages.

The bag was placed neatly by his nightstand. With his phone in hand next, he checked the few messages that were sent.

One was a photo of Mydei and his mom inside of her kitchen, and she was leaning against his arm while smiling sweetly up at his camera. Behind them was a dainty vase of red, white, and burgundy flowers all wrapped up in gold ribbon. Beside that was a pink pill-container stocked full of medicine for the next week. Both him and his mom had a similar side braid, their cherry ends tucked into a golden cuff and amber eyes mimicking one another's softened squint from their wide grins.

> [Mydei: My mother misses you. She said to tell your mother that they need to meet up for coffee soon.]

> [Mydei: Also, I look forward to watching you try to build that lego set, get upset when you mess up, then quit half way through. It'll be amusing.]

Phainon laughed, rolling his eyes over the light jab and choosing to ignore it. They could bicker over it in person while building it together, as he never intended to do it on his own.

> [Phainon: You look more like your mom every day, you know. I hope she's okay. That container looks pretty heavy.]

He didn't remember her ever being sick. She was always so lively and bubbly when he saw her, diligently running her household while her husband did whatever he wanted outside of it. The only time she was ever upset were the handful of times he heard them arguing behind closed doors, but every family had their arguments. Even his own.

> [Mydei: They're just to manage her glucose levels, blood pressure, and cholesterol. She's fine otherwise.]

That sounded right to him. Their parents *were* getting older, and their bodies needed the extra help. His dad took medicine for his blood pressure too, and that wasn't anything to worry too much about. He lived as he pleased and ate whatever he wanted, just within moderation.

Maybe that was why Mydei was so strict with his body, diet, and work out routine, to stave off having to eat several pills every single morning like his mother did. It didn't sound fun. It didn't look fun, either.

> [Mydei: Thank you for the concern though.]

> [Mydei: I'm going to put my phone on silent and spend some more time with her. I'll text you later. Feel free to spam me with messages if you'd like.]

Phainon smiled to himself, grateful that Mydei was always so clear with him. It wasn't as if he'd just stop texting and disappear for hours, then respond when he remembered to. If he planned to leave, he said as much. If he planned to not check his phone, he warned him of that.

> [Phainon: I'm home with Cyrene. I'll be around if you need me. My phone's always on.]

Mydei reacted to that with a thumbs up and a red heart, and Phainon shut his screen off before curling a finger into his day collar. Pulling, he lined the front and then sighed happily while feeling on the golden links.

"Phai!"

His head turned to the door.

"Are you actually gonna eat peach rings with me this time, or is it a waste to put that many in a bowl?" Cyrene called out to him through the wood. "Same with the sour watermelon!"

"Just a little bit!"

"'kay!"

He heard her footsteps leave, and the hand not on his collar turned his phone back on just to see the picture Mydei sent again. The little crinkle by the corners of his eyes from genuine joy and the sparkle in his golden gaze made his heart kick a lot like it did in front of Aglaea's home, warm like a kiss from the sun. It was both terrifying and comforting, foreign yet so familiar, because this was *Mydei*.

Everything they did together was tinged with those two emotions, though. It also wasn't anything new to feel hot underneath his skin when looking at him, so he brushed it off just like he did back then.

Phainon's finger pressed over it before he could even think and he saved it to his camera roll. It wasn't often Mydei looked that happy these days, yet here that look was captured in a photo meant for only him and his mom to see. How could he not?

Mydei was just so handsome when he let that cool, collected exterior melt just a little bit, and he wanted as much of that version of him as possible—sexual or not.

Chapter End Notes

hm. wonder what phainons reward is gonna be the next time they meet up. any guesses? id love to pick your guys brains n see who gets it right/what you think of them ehe

also. poor cyrene. she just wants to look out for her best friend. hes changing so quickly and is being so vague/avoidant. my poor girl.

Chapter 15: Chapter Fifteen

Chapter Notes

> THIS TOOK ME FOREVER. I'M SOSOSOSOSO SORRY.
>
> my bf visited for a week, my mom got sick (shes getting better tho), and i rewrote this FIVE ENTIRE times to try and get mydei where i wanted him because his character means a lot to me.
>
> i love phainons character too. i think they both have their own specific way of caring for each other that sometimes it clashes because it's not exactly the same. they crave similar things, but they also have different needs.
>
> but mydei is so careful and as much as i wanna make him blow up and rant, hes just… not that guy. it makes it a lil difficult to write disagreements/arguments.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The next time Phainon found the time to visit Mydei, with his bag of activities in one hand and keys in the other, he actually happened to see the other man.

Mydei was walking into the lobby when he spotted that familiar two-toned hair. His hands were taking down a ponytail as he nodded curtly at the receptionist. That same flirtatious, finger wiggling wave she liked to give *him* was given to the other man, though his attention was already turned away from her.

It seemed the only thing he cared about was going home after a long day, and Phainon couldn't help but feel a little bit bad for the poor woman. He hoped she found someone else soon.

Mydei, who was typically well aware of his surroundings, not interested in looking her way for more than a second.

"Mydei!"

He paused midstep, then looked over his shoulder while dropping his hands. Surprise was written across his face, lifting his eyebrows and picking up his frown.

"What are the odds?" Phainon grinned at him as he wrapped an arm around his shoulders. "I don't ever catch you here. You usually make it up before I do."

"I had a lot of things to do, so I'm late coming home," he sighed. "I must have missed your text, but I'm glad you're here."

“No worries,” he beamed happily. While speaking, they walked closer towards the elevator. “I hope work wasn’t too hard on you. You look a little bit beat…”

Mydei’s lips pursed. “I’m more annoyed than I am tired right now,” he admitted. “Please behave for me.”

His voice was tight, like he was trying to hold his composure together and was one wrong move away from snapping. That edge was familiar.

One of his hands was already reaching to undo his tie as the elevator doors opened for them. Its knot loosened, dragging lower so he could pop the button holding his collar together. The other gently brushed Phainon’s back, fingers settling just over his shirt but not quite his skin, to silently nudge him inside first.

Phainon walked forward with a quicker step to get in front of him.

“Was it really that bad of a day?”

“I work with grown ass children,” he grumbled crudely, following in behind him. But when he went to push his floor number, the button was already lit up thanks to Phainon’s quick touch. “How can someone be pushing thirty and still be breastfed by their mother?”

“Some people work just because they need something to do, not because they need the money,” Phainon added casually.

He opened his arms once the doors sealed shut. Upon opening them, Mydei filled them, leaning his head into the right side of his own and resting his back into his chest. It was silent and swift, almost like he was too exhausted to keep up his usual independence.

Another sigh left his lips. “I wish they’d bum a job off of someone else. My father works hard for this company, so watching him play nice guy to his friends at *our* expense really pisses me off.”

Phainon held him tighter. The stiffness in Mydei’s body didn’t ease, but he did stay within his arms.

“So you care about him.”

“I can acknowledge his hard work and his ability to provide for the people around him. He’s my father, of course I *love* him for what he’s done for me and my mother. But that doesn’t mean I *like* him as a person or a boss,” he reasoned. “It’s… complicated. It makes sense in my head, just not in the mouth.”

It *sounded* complicated. Phainon couldn’t imagine being in that kind of spot with his own dad.

“What’s in that bag?” Mydei asked suddenly, clearly wanting to change the subject, and Phainon raised it higher for him to look inside. “Mm. I remember now. Your games and toys.”

“The things you *forced* me to buy,” he reminded him, shaking the bag a few times for emphasis. “Never do that again, by the way. That was a dirty, *dirty* trick you pulled on me…”

“But it was a good day.”

“Don’t pull that card,” he huffed. With a lift of his shoulder, he nudged the other man just enough to disrupt his comfort. “It was a nice gesture, yeah. My parents loved it. But I’m not here to milk your wallet. I told you so many times that I *don’t* wanna be that person.”

Mydei was silent as the doors opened for them on his floor, and he guided him forward with the ghost of a touch while slipping away from him. Phainon walked ahead as he was silently instructed to, allowing his dominant to follow a step behind him.

“I got a little too trigger happy,” Mydei admitted, his voice softer than it had been when discussing his job and father. “With everything that happened, I was on a bit of a head rush. I thought about you and how I occupy a lot of your time now, and I wanted you to go see everyone else important to you. It’s important to make them feel special too.”

That was sweet. Phainon could agree with that. The gesture was clearly brought up from somewhere genuine, its intent pure of heart.

“Then I remembered someone you didn’t even know took care of your wants the night before, and it made me want to do that for you too. I just went for it,” he continued. As he spoke, his words grew slower. They grew heavier. “I… I wanted to do more. I wanted it so badly that I thought to myself, ‘*I want to provide this’*. That made me go for it.”

Phainon could *kind of* understand that.

That morning, it felt like all he wanted was *more* from him too—*physically*, at least. To touch his body while at its most peaceful. To hear him feel good without any kind of kinky rambles. To see him raw and real without any kind of walls up or clothes on.

He thought that he wanted to wake his dominant up with a blowjob, then he simply did it before his nerves could get the better of him. Mydei didn’t know he would try it. There wasn’t a clue to lead up to it. All that needed to be said was that he wanted it, and Phainon wanted to make it happen for him.

But *this* wasn’t like *that*, was it?

Mydei’s body was always open to him. He made that clear so many times. The only limit was if he specifically asked not to be touched, which was very, very rare.

Phainon did *not* like when Mydei bought him things more than he already did, but he knew that. Even if he let most of it go as if he didn’t notice, *this* was something entirely different. *This* was blatant spoiling. *This* was turning him into some kind of ‘*sugar baby*’.

Food for two didn’t just magically appear inside of his refrigerator, that was obvious. His collars didn’t just materialize out of thin air in his exact size and Mydei’s design. Skin care,

toothbrushes, and soaps tailored for him didn't walk from the store and sit themselves inside of his cabinets. All of it came from somewhere, slowly, and over the days he wasn't around.

'*Spares*' are what Mydei called them, but he knew better than to believe that. Mydei did this when they were just friends too, like the night he ordered groceries to his house without asking because he knew he'd turn him down otherwise.

But *never* had he sent him a sum of money and told him to go spend it how he pleased. *That* was way too much to accept. *That* was precisely what he meant when he turned him down while making their rules. *That* could not happen again.

As their feet stopped at the front door, he turned to let Mydei open it for him.

"Look at me," Phainon spoke up, stopping him when he tried to fit his key into the door. As a pair of amber eyes met his, he smiled softly. "There's a time and place for your generosity, De, but don't make a habit out of sending me your hard earned cash. I can accept your gifts as *rewards* from a dom to his sub. I tolerate you buying me collars and gear on the excuse of *experimenting*. I turn a blind eye to the '*spares*' you keep for me to use in your bathroom. But this act of straight up slapping money in my hand cannot happen again."

"I… might have overstepped."

"No. You did overstep," he repeated. "Thank you for helping me make everyone's day, but don't do it again. We can figure something else out that doesn't involve you transferring hundreds of dollars to me."

They looked at each other, and Mydei nodded gently.

"I only wanted you to have a good day and feel closer to the people around you," he tried to explain himself again. "I'm sorry, Phainon."

"If you do it again, we're gonna need more than a talk to fix it, okay?" Phainon's free hand lightly pushed his shoulder to let him know that he wasn't *mad*. "I carried it out because the damage was already done, and it did feel really good to see everyone around me smiling, but you do enough for me as is, okay? There's no need for more."

"I'll do better," he promised, voice quiet yet firm. "Someone who is given as much trust as I am shouldn't misuse it like that…"

"I got these for us with that leftover money though." Phainon jiggled the bag a few times again. "No matter how these came to be in my hand, just… promise me we'll get to them sometime. They'll be kept at your place, so it's more like you bought them for yourself anyway. I just picked them up for you like some kinda delivery service."

Mydei nodded. "I'll happily join you no matter how childish it might be."

'*Childish*'.

There wasn't an age restriction on lego-sets and video games. Just because they weren't fifteen anymore didn't mean they couldn't still enjoy a colorful little puzzle or a nice story

game.

“You really gotta let loose a little bit. Life’s more than work and sleep, you know.”

“I have no interest in games or toys for myself, but perhaps they’ll make for a cozy night in with you,” Mydei caved.

“You can open the door now, by the way. Standing out here and talking so seriously is awkward, isn’t it?” He chuckled, and Mydei slipped the key into the knob before twisting. “What do you wanna do tonight?”

The door was closed behind them, locked swiftly to protect their privacy, and Phainon threw a glance over his shoulder.

“How do you feel?” Mydei asked. “Are you mad at me?”

“I’m not *angry*,” he answered while kicking his shoes off. “I asked you to let go, so… if things like this happen once or twice, it’s because I asked for it, right? We’re allowed to mess up a few times before getting it right.”

“It’s not *your* fault that *I* overstepped your boundaries again. You can’t exactly *ask* for someone to trample over your security,” he shot his statement down. “We agreed that I didn’t have that authority, yet I coerced you into it anyway. That was your autonomy, and I infringed upon it. I… should have bit my tongue, kept it to myself, and let you do it on your own.”

A hand settled over Phainon’s shoulder, squeezing it tightly and reassuringly when he didn’t respond.

“It’s a part of me that wants to come out because I’m used to it,” he apologized again. “That doesn’t make what I did any better, I know. I crossed one of your limits like it was nothing, and that makes me no better than the fakes I was trying to protect you from.”

Phainon wasn’t really sure what to say to that. It felt like Mydei was more upset at himself than he was, like his guilt outweighed the crime somehow. But was it really a crime if he wasn’t *hurt?*

They *did* draw that line together, but he could have sent it back once it was transferred. He could have been more adamant against the transaction than he was, as his head was far from that foggy state of being by the time he was behind his wheel. Never would Mydei have allowed him to drive if his head wasn’t attached to his shoulders.

But he *didn’t*. He kept it, bought a pretty bouquet full of his mom’s favorite flowers in blue and white and ordered a nice barbecue lunch for her and his dad. Then he kept the leftover change to buy these activities for them to do together. After all, he liked spending time with Mydei too, and there were only so many nights they could waste on movies, shows, and funny online videos before it became repetitive and boring.

He backtracked on his own limit too. He accepted it the way he accepted the small things given to him behind his back—begrudgingly and ready to chew him out.

Was a simple action really worth calling himself a '*fake*' over?

"I want to pour you a drink," Phainon offered, holding Mydei's hand when it didn't lift. "And I want to move on from this already. It's okay."

"I don't deserve to have you do that for me," his dominant protested. "Would you like something to drink with me?"

"… Sure."

"Go sit down for me then."

Mydei was the first to walk away between them, and Phainon's shoulders fell as he placed his sneakers down on the shoe rack.

It hurt inside his stomach as he stared at his back. Being rejected the opportunity to pour him a glass after their heavy conversation felt as if he were being punished for bringing it up, as if he wasn't allowed to *want* what they normally did. This desire to take care of him in return didn't simply *disappear* because Mydei felt guilty for something.

Phainon carried his bag to the kitchen counter before setting it down. Beside it, he dumped his phone and keys before avoiding the barstool completely.

"H-Hey…"

He grasped Mydei's arm to turn him around gently.

"I don't like when you brush me off like that," he said, letting him in on the bitter feeling. "Just because you don't feel you deserve it, doesn't mean I don't still want to do what I usually do."

"Phainon, it's okay."

"If you feel guilty over it, then sit with it for a while until we figure out a way to fix it. That's the natural consequence for doing something wrong, isn't it?" He suggested.

It made him think back to the only *uncomfortable* punishment Mydei had ever given him. To kneel in quiet like a leashed dog and be stuck with his own thoughts while unable to speak or move was a terrible time. The things he thought of himself weren't kind back then, and to physically feel like the things he said about himself was worse. But he hasn't had a lot of those dark, depreciating feelings since that night. In a way, maybe it really *did* help.

If Mydei felt guilty, he could handle a little bit of time with his thoughts to sift through them too. But unlike a punishment, he wasn't going to ask that he kneeled, bound and silent, like some kind of pet. Being serviced while harboring that inner negativity would be more than enough for a man like him.

The hand on the cabinet slipped, lowering bit by bit until it touched the counter.

“It is.”

“Can I get us both a drink, master?” Phainon asked softly, and Mydei exhaled shakily before looking away from him. With a hand on the lower half of his face, he nodded. “Can you use your words?”

“Yes,” he mumbled, walking around the counter to take the barstool. “I need to think. Please don't talk to me for a couple of minutes.”

Immediately, Mydei’s face was covered with both hands as he hung his head in silent shame. His elbows were pressed to the counter, and his fingers interlocked over his forehead. Heavy but steady breaths left his nose, lifting his shoulders slowly before sinking them at the same pace.

Silence fell between them as he turned to the cabinet and grabbed two glasses, careful not to knock them into each other. Heavy ice clinked to the bottom of them both once he cracked the freezer open, and those glasses clicked to the countertop after.

Phainon reached for the almost empty bottle left on a tray in the corner of his kitchen, eyeing what was left before pouring it. Warm, caramel-colored liquor filled them one by one slowly. The steady pour was almost completely silent if not for the crackle of ice when met with alcohol.

One glass was placed in front of Mydei, and the one meant for him was topped off with a splash of water to dilute the strong taste. Unlike the other man, he did not like to drink for the taste or to unwind after a long day. Whiskey, on its own, was gross. Alcohol of any kind, on its own, was gross.

But he carried the drink to where Mydei sat. His free hand then gently touched his shoulder, sliding towards his stiffened back to rub. The sound of his palm swiping back and forth against the smooth fabric of his button-up followed as he rubbed, coaxing him to calm down.

No words were spoken, and they didn’t need to be.

Mydei winced from the touch before he began to relax. His arms slowly lowered, elbows dropping and hands folding into his lap. Much like he always requested of him, he picked his chin up and straightened out his posture until he was upright.

Their eyes met, and Phainon tilted his glass towards him. A soft smile tugged on his lips, warm and inviting him to stop punishing himself with his guilt, to focus on him instead of his thoughts, and to pick the drink he made for him up.

With a soft, ringing clink, they were brought together. Afterwards, they both took a drink.

“You make cute faces when you try to drink like I do,” Mydei quietly teased him, watching as his nose crinkled from the bitter taste burning down the back of his tongue and throat.

Phainon rolled his eyes. “‘m not an alcoholic,” he defended himself.

“I’m not either.”

“Mhm.”

Mydei continued to look up at him, allowing him to trace along his spine and touch his body as freely as he wanted to. As he did, his own fingers reached to fully unravel his tie and unbutton his shirt.

“What do you want to do tonight, handsome?” He asked, and Phainon’s eyes dropped to his exposed skin. The neckline of his undershirt was low, showing off the divot between either collarbone.

"Do you feel any better, master?”

“I think I’ll be okay,” he told him. “Knowing you’re not hurt in any way will make the guilt go away over time.”

“Do you need anything from me?” He offered, then pulled him closer anyway. “Can you hug me?”

That’d help. It was what he wanted the last time he needed comfort, and it was something Phainon was more than willing to provide for him.

“Yes.” He felt him stand up before engulfing him within his arms like he was waiting to be asked that. “Always.”

His still figure stood there, tall and unwavering, allowing himself to be grappled onto tightly. Fists balled his work-shirt up within them. Breaths fanned over his skin as he hid inside of the crook of his neck.

“I’ve got you,” he promised while wrapping his arms around his waist to hold him just as firmly. “Mm… My master is as sensitive as I am, isn’t he? He’s just better at masking it.”

“I try.”

“Hm?”

“I try very hard to control myself,” Mydei confessed to him. “I try to keep my head as clear as possible, to shove the feelings away so I’m not acting out irrationally. I can’t be someone safe if I respond in anger or hurt.”

Phainon frowned.

What about him? Why was it that *he* was allowed to be as emotional and as sensitive as he wanted, and yet Mydei forced himself to always swallow his own down before speaking or reacting?

It wasn’t as if he didn’t see him grit his teeth or bite his tongue when he was upset. Whenever he was angry, he always covered his mouth and looked away, physically stopping himself from saying anything he might regret. Whenever he was too forward or excited with

something, he back tracked himself and apologized for behaving out of line before settling down again. Phainon noticed that part of it too.

But he hated that. He hated knowing that for certain. He hated that Mydei was afraid to let himself *feel* because it could cloud his judgement, thus making it difficult to look after someone else. To him, that wasn't fair at all.

One hand held the back of his head, fingers threading through the sunset locks to hold him closely. Cerulean eyes dropped down to the wine red shirt he wore, looking down his shoulders and back where his other arm was planted firmly around his waist.

"What do you do if you're upset?"

"I brush it off until I can deal with it later," Mydei said as if it were the simplest thing in the world. "I vent it while working out the next day, or I make myself rationalize it. Sometimes I don't deserve to be upset. It's pointless."

Phainon held him tighter. His nose brushed the side of his head, and he took a deep breath.

Voicing his frustrations was the same as '*complaining*', and feeling upset was something '*pointless*'. These things were nothing but a burden for him to have, but that couldn't possibly be right.

Was that really the healthiest way to view negativity in his life? He wasn't a psychologist. He wasn't a therapist. He didn't take classes to study emotions, and he didn't keep self-help books. Did Mydei know something he didn't, or did he delude himself into thinking that was the best way to handle things?

"When you thought of me, or people like me, as '*abusive*', I was angry and hurt," he brought up, and the memory made his stomach drop painfully. It was sour, bitter, and full of chokingly thick regret. "I wanted to be mad so badly. I wanted to yell and ask how you could ever say that to me after knowing the kind of person I am. But when I broke it down, there was truly no reason for me to be angry. It made sense given what you saw, so how could I be?"

He did say that to him, didn't he? He called him '*violent*'. He called him '*abusive*'. He told him that he was '*crazy*' for wanting a life like this, that the things he did were '*weird*' for a relationship.

While belittling himself, he dragged Mydei down by accusing him of *wanting* to treat him like a pet or an object. It happened even after Mydei said all he wanted to do was treat him kindly, spoil him however possible, and take care of him.

"I have to let it go and be realistic," Mydei repeated, pulling him even closer until his leg stood in between his. "The best way to avoid unnecessary conflict is to drop it completely and focus on calming down."

"That makes me feel like someone out of control," he chuckled dryly. "Am I a bad person because I react emotionally?"

“Anger and hurt are normal emotions everyone feels. You’re not a bad person for feeling them and being driven by them.” Why did that trigger a sense of deja vu within him? “It’s what you do after that matters most.”

Mydei’s hands lowered, stopping before meeting his waist. Never did they touch any lower than his shoulders and collarbones, or any higher than his lower thighs, without being allowed to. Was he always so conscious of touching his body?

Phainon couldn’t remember when that started, just that he adhered to it like law.

“You’re a good person who just gets blinded by his confusion sometimes, Phainon. You do your best all the time, and I’m very proud of you for how far you’ve come since we started this,” he told him gently. “You continue to amaze me every day.”

“*I* should be the one comforting *you*.”

His head shook. “Your presence and commitment as my sub is all the comfort I need in this. The rest is up to me to work through.”

“Did I ever apologize for the things I said to you back then?” He wondered suddenly, unsure if he ever got around to taking those feelings back. “I’m sorry.”

Teeth bit into the lip across from him for a moment, dragging slow and deep. Then, they parted. “Probably. But you don’t need to,” was all he said. “I don’t need words when I can see how much you’ve grown. It’s clear you don’t see me that way anymore, so either *I* stepped up to prove myself or *you* found more acceptance within yourself.”

That didn’t help to completely subdue the lick of guilt inside of him, but he knew how to handle the feeling all too well by now. It lived inside of him most days, dormant and just waiting to come out.

“Both,” Phainon decided. “We *both* try really hard for one another, and we both keep trying to learn how to do more for the other. It shows.”

Mydei seemed to like that answer as well as he raised one of his hands to plop on the top of his head. The weight was comforting. The ruffle of his hair was already expected as he closed one eye to defend himself against the hair spilling over his face.

“That might be easier if I was kneeling for you.”

“I’d never force you to kneel on these floors as is. It hurts, and you said so yourself. We’re too old to be playing with our knees like that,” he scolded him, and Phainon laughed loudly over his reasoning. “Nerve damage is a very serious thing.”

“We aren’t even *old!*” He mused. “You’re a little too health-conscious sometimes, master.”

“I plan to live a long and healthy life. I want to be seventy years old and still going on a run every morning,” he said stubbornly. That thought made him snicker. “If you don’t want that for yourself, I don’t know what to tell you.”

“I just wanna keep running faster than you, so I guess I shouldn’t press my body too much…” Phainon trailed off playfully, earning a lighthearted scoff in return. “Guess you’re stuck being in second place until we die.”

“You’re *not* faster.”

“I have been since we were fifteen,” he bragged. “Fastest mile every year. Plus, I did sports while you took the weight training route. Don’t suppose *that* helped you out.”

“Heh… Maybe having cheerleaders and stadiums full of people cheering for you must have given you a praise kink,” he taunted him, making Phainon gasp over the shameless accusation. “Did you like having me cheer you on in the bleachers the same way I do now when you’re on your knees?”

Where did *that* come from?

“As if! I had a girlfriend then!”

Mydei only chuckled. He watched as his face grew red hot, amused by his reaction.

“Mm… Yes, I remember. You were head over heels for her,” he recalled. “You gave her a flower every Monday. You were going to take her to your hometown and introduce her to Cyrene, then marry her after college. Oh, the plans of a teenager in love. How sweet.”

“Shut up,” he grumbled, pushing on his chest. “Just because you never felt that way for someone…”

… Has he?

In the grand scheme of things, in this secret life he never knew about, did Mydei ever get close enough to someone to imagine the rest of their lives together? Was there a man that behaved so well, treated others so nicely, and looked so handsome that he thought he could settle down with?

“You’re fun to poke at,” Mydei teased him. “I’ve never felt that way before, no. Forever is a long time, and no one’s given me the comfort that forever needs.”

Phainon had to fight not to let out a breath of relief.

“If that persists, I guess we really *will* be running partners until one of us kicks the bucket,” he said thoughtfully, then shrugged. “Enough of that talk, though. What would you like for dinner tonight, handsome? We need to eat.”

“Let’s order in. I haven’t had pizza in awhile, and we’ve been good with our diets. No need to cook tonight,” Phainon suggested, and Mydei thought for a moment before nodding. “And add a bottle of soda to that order too, please. I need more than water, juice, and liquor. Master, my tastebuds are *dying* without it.”

Laughter followed over his dramatic whining, as did an eye roll. “Dead men can’t pay, so shall I?”

“Heh, *no*,” he denied him immediately. “*I’m* paying for it. If you fight me on this, I’ll get mad.”

“It seems I’m still being punished tonight,” Mydei sulked lightly while leaning his forehead over his shoulder again. “What kind of power play is this? *My* sub is telling *me* what to do in *my* house.”

“You can call me—”

“*Don’t* push your luck with the nonsense I think you’re about to say,” he warned him, and Phainon grinned over the sharp tone he missed. “I am still your *master*. Behave.”

“I was kidding,” he joked. “I’ll be good tonight, and you’ll be good tonight, and then you can reward me like you promised you would.”

Mydei nodded, then held his opposite shoulder gently. “Truthfully, I don't feel good at the moment, but a promise *is* a promise. Give me a little bit of time to come down. I will let you know how I feel after we eat and clean up.”

“You don’t have to if you don’t feel up to it.”

The very last thing Phainon wanted was for him to feel pressured into doing anything with him. He didn’t need to be rewarded for acting out on his own desire, even if he was excited at the idea of what Mydei could do for him. He didn’t expect Mydei to put his feelings on the back burner just to make him happy. That wasn’t healthy, and that wasn’t fair of him to do.

“No, I promised something nice the next time we met,” he insisted. “Feeling down doesn’t mean I get to stop showing up for you, but that I need to redirect. I’m going to get your things ready so you can change and clean up, and you’re going to give me the card you want to pay with. I’ll have an answer before we eat.”

Reaching into his pocket, Phainon grabbed his wallet and plucked his debit card free. While holding it between his fingers, Mydei took it.

"Do you promise to use it?” He asked. “No tricks?”

“If you don’t believe me, feel free to check your banking app when you get out of the shower.”

Phainon trusted him. He’d trust him with anything because Mydei wasn’t necessarily a *liar* even if he made mistakes, but he was still going to double-check anyway.

—

As he said, Mydei *did* end up using his card to pay for their dinner, and the delivery came as his dominant was finishing up his own shower. Phainon got it all ready—the plates, the

glasses, and the napkins needed were set up nicely at the kitchen table. Whether they sat there or ate in the living room by the coffee table, he left that up to Mydei, but everything else was prepared for him.

Now, he was sitting on the couch while looking at a box of legos, contemplating ripping it open to do tonight.

The floral arrangement was meant to be hung up on the wall, but as he admired the box, he began to wonder if it'd be more of an eyesore than something fun for them to do. Mydei's home was clean. It was almost like a magazine cover. Between his moody interior full of neutral, monochromatic colors, the most color it got to see was a few potted plants, his shelf full of various books, and some wall art.

Was this even a good idea? Who was he *really* thinking about when he bought this?

"What did the flowers ever do to you? You're staring pretty hard at them."

Phainon turned to the hallway, to where Mydei was dressed in a t-shirt and some shorts rather than his work clothes. His hair was still slightly wet, hanging limply in his face.

"Did you buy glue?"

"Hm?"

"When you build things like that, you need to buy glue so they don't break apart." Mydei approached him while rubbing a short towel to his damp hair. "Otherwise, it'll chip off piece by piece."

"I did," he answered. "Where will you hang it? It's not your style at all."

"Who said that?" He chuckled, then squatted down beside him. As he did, he tossed a bundle of something red behind him. "I like the color pink."

"You like red and black."

"I *wear* red and black because it's hard to go wrong with *anything* and black," he corrected him. "I like pink too, and light purples, and this cute shade of blue that kind of reminds me of *you*."

One finger poked his forehead, and he grumbled before batting his hand away.

"We can glue it together, and when it dries, let's hang it up in my office," he suggested. "I spend most of my time there when you're not around, so it'll bring me comfort to look at it while working."

His heart skipped.

"Then, when we do the red one, I'd like that to go on top of my bookshelf. But it'll look out of place, so I'll buy a few trinkets to go with it."

Phainon clutched the box tighter, not even caring about what Mydei brought him when he was too caught up on the fact he *wanted* these things on display. He wasn't afraid to put them where his guests could see them and comment on them, and he wanted them in the places he could always see them—no matter how '*childish*' he insisted it was through texts.

"They're very pretty, Phainon. I do like flowers."

"I-It was your money anyway," he muttered, not wanting to take credit for them. "And they're not real. If you like flowers so much, I can get real ones next time."

"Yes, they're plastic, but real ones will wilt. I can keep these as home decor forever," he reminded him. "When this is all over, and you've found out everything you want to know about yourself, I'll keep them to remember this part of our lives. Just as I keep picture frames of us from high school and college."

"Sap…"

A tingle buzzed inside of his chest, wrapping around his ribs and tickling its way into his stomach. The jagged bolt branched into every nook and cranny, hot, airy, and all consuming.

"You are the person closest to me. I value all of our time together."

"Because our other friends haven't sucked your dick before," he retorted, and a singular golden eyebrow lifted at the response.

"I wouldn't want them to even if I did like girls," he brushed off. "I'm not interested in them."

"So, what? You've thought about it with me before because I'm the only other guy?" Phainon mocked him, shoveling that electric feeling in his gut down before it could spread. "Before this happened, did you think about me like some kind of *pervert* would? Did you lay awake at night and wonder what your best friend looked like crying on your dick?"

Mydei gripped his chin with the hand used to poke him. His thumb pressed deeply over the bone of his jaw, and he planted his fingers against the softness of his cheek.

"If you wish to tease me, do it in a less accusatory manner. Don't *shoot* when I simply *poked* you."

"Did you?" The question was less dangerous this time, softened from the bullet it had been into genuine curiosity.

"I have my type in men," he answered simply.

Right.

Mydei's type was different from who he was in the past. He only got with people who had the same interests in *BDSM* as him, meaning those who weren't in this same community probably didn't even cross his radar. The *innocent* who didn't know about this or enjoy any

of it, and the *ignorant* who saw it the way he did when he first confronted him, weren't men he typically entertained.

Surely, that included *him* until they started this.

"That was a dumb question to ask you," he mumbled. "Sorry. I don't know why I asked that."

"It's not dumb," Mydei reassured him. "My type in men has changed a bit since I first found out I was interested in them, but I still look for the same core values."

"Submissive?"

"Well, yes, but… I wouldn't want a jerk who just so happened to be submissive." His chin was raised, keeping him from looking away. "Kindness, thoughtfulness, and respect matter the most to me."

Phainon nodded weakly. "And…?"

"And you are kind and thoughtful," he praised him, circling back to what he asked him. "You can work a little bit on your respect, however. This mouth of yours is a weapon, and you sure like to fire it freely, don't you?"

"What else?" He pressed. "Like… what else do you look for?"

"That's not relevant," he chuckled, tapping his cheek lightly. "I have my eyes on no one but you until we end this. Take that as you please, my nosy prince."

Soon, the hand on his face left, and Phainon shifted to the edge of his seat. As he did, something rolled into him. When turning around, he found and remembered the bundle of red rope that was thrown there.

"What's that for?"

That was probably a dumb question too. It was for bondage, for tying him up, and he knew that.

But a part of him hoped Mydei would give him *more* than a short, simple answer without the added prying. Maybe he'd give him a step by step run down of what was going to happen with it, and he'd save him from needing to start an interrogation. Sometimes he wanted him to just *talk* instead of waiting to be *asked*.

"Unfortunately, I don't think I have the energy to be the kinky, domineering man you want to explore with," he admitted. "Instead, let's build one of our flower sets, or let me practice that harness you liked. Both are things you want to do, right? Which would you like more?"

His lips curled slightly, a corner dropping downwards.

"The very moment I'm ready for leather and sexy talk, we can. I'll buckle up, buckle down, and give you what you so rightfully earned," he rushed to say as if that was his biggest

concern right now. “You deserve to have my all, not some half-assed performance from a guy not feeling it. I *can* still get you off, though. You just need to ask.”

“I’m not upset at you for not being in the mood. That’s stupid. You’re not my sex toy,” Phainon tried to ease the worry that laced in his tone. “I just… feel like I don’t know how to cheer you up when you’re upset. Yeah, I can give you a little bit more control, but when you wanna reject it like you did earlier, what do I do? What should I say?”

Simply sitting here can’t really be enough for him if he feels so low that he’d offer him an orgasm ten seconds after telling him he wasn’t in the mood. Did he seriously think he’d ever agree to that?

“It’s not your fault, Phainon.”

He knew that, but his feelings didn’t like to listen to reason. And he didn’t have it in him to try and self-soothe when Mydei was right in front of him admitting that he didn’t feel good.

“There’s not a lot you can do for this, okay?” Mydei said softly. “I just need you to let me work through it. A lot of this, for me, is made better by taking care of you and talking myself down.”

Phainon sulked, unhappy with that response.

There had to be more. That couldn’t be it, right? No way could Mydei self-soothe everything he dealt with all of the time.

But it was clear he wasn’t going to give him another response, and he didn’t have anyone else he could talk to about it.

Well…

Discomfort burned inside of him, making him squirm in his place as he realized he could, *technically*, ask Hysilens about it. Their dominants were completely different, and her wife terrified him to no end over how casually cruel she could be, but *something* had to connect between them, right? Regardless of their personal desires and style, at the end of the day, they held similar responsibilities and feelings, didn’t they?

That meant opening up to her about this, though. Truthfully, he didn’t think he had it in him to come clean so easily, especially since Mydei didn’t want people to know this side of him.

“You look unsatisfied,” Mydei noticed, head slightly tilted to the side as he eyed his expression. “Does my answer upset you?”

“Kinda…”

“I’m not sure what else to tell you,” he apologized while taking the box from his hands to place on the table. Without it to fiddle with, Phainon toyed with his own fingers. “I’m upset at myself for going too far again, and that’s a problem I’m not sure how you can help me with.”

“Do you need me to… I don't know… back off a bit? That’ll give you some more time and space to think and look after yourself. Maybe I’m taking up too much of your time and energy,” he offered.

Even if he, himself, didn’t like being alone, Mydei seemed to not mind it at all. Quiet didn’t bother him, being all by himself didn’t bother him, and he knew himself well enough to soothe his own anger or hurt. Why wouldn’t that work for him? Why wouldn’t some personal space to better grasp his control help?

In his head, that made sense. He hated it, but maybe Mydei needed that from him anyway. At that point, it wouldn’t matter how he felt when this was for someone else.

“No,” he protested firmly, immediately. It was so quick that he almost felt *stupid* for suggesting it in the first place. “That’s not an option.”

His eyes widened over the authoritative tone.

Mydei, still holding on to that same strength, hardened his gaze. “If you aren’t here with me, the things that remind you of us being friends are going to be skipped. I can’t let that happen.”

Oh. Those words *still* floated around inside of his head? He was *still* worried about that?

“Aren’t we over that now?” Phainon asked gently, not wanting to dig up any negative feelings from that day. “C’mon… That was so long ago. We didn’t know things would end up that way.”

His jaw tightened as if somehow angered by his attempt to reassure him. It didn’t make any sense as to *why*, so Phainon continued to speak. He tried to calm him down.

“You said it yourself before that exploring has trials and errors. That was an honest mistake.”

Mydei didn’t look any more pleased.

“Plus, I kinda overreacted, right?” Phainon laughed awkwardly, running out of things to say to try and salvage a good mood. “It was an acc—”

“Stop saying it was an accident,” he cut him off. “Stop downplaying it like that was nothing. If you could have seen yourself through my eyes, you wouldn’t be *laughing* right now.”

The sound of his deepened, darkened voice made him gulp, cutting his statement off immediately to listen. Shock froze him still and kept him silent, unable to do much but look at his pinched brows and sealed lips.

It was as if his words punched him right in the chest. Breathing was difficult as he mulled the sharpened words over, reliving that angered tone again and again like a broken record on repeat.

Phainon didn’t even *think* about how that morning could have affected him past a hint of guilt. All he remembered was the hurt and the soreness of his body, then the loneliness of

being left in bed while Mydei went to do his own thing in the morning without him. Sleeping in might have *sounded* nice for his exhausted body, but being beside him would have *felt* nicer mentally and emotionally. Not that Mydei knew that because *he* didn't even know that until living through it.

He also remembered that Mydei tried so hard not to verbally admit that he liked what they did. Maybe it was to protect that fragile and crumbling image of himself, something Phainon assumed to be true when looking back at it with a clear mind. Maybe he was scared to admit he liked him being in pain when he was so upset over the thought of it.

What he didn't remember was Mydei ever really admitting how he felt that morning, just the way he fought tooth and nail to try and get through to *him*.

"I'm just… being honest," he said back. "You shouldn't beat yourself up for it. I'm not holding it against you."

The man in question soon covered his mouth, and he shook his head as his fingers curled into his cheek. Though he wasn't *loud*, that wasn't a tone of voice he used lightly or often.

"I apologize. I should be more gentle when addressing you," he apologized stiffly. "But you're wrong. I need to be strict with myself or else I'll get too comfortable making mistakes."

"It's fine," he said again, holding on to the excuse while keeping his voice as steady as possible. "You didn't mean to hurt me so badly then, okay? Calm down."

The dull edge of Mydei's nails left ribbons in their wake as he scratched into his own skin, indents pressing into his face from the depth of his grip. Scarlet blossomed along his cheek, tinted the same shade as the hair tickling his jaw.

"I should have known," Mydei said simply, *dully*, not giving in to his reassurance. "I should have assessed the possibility. I should have taken into account how sensitive you are as a person, then how much you were afraid of me."

"You don't know it all."

His head shook. "Phainon, *please*. I need you to stop arguing with me over this. It's only making me more upset at myself, and I'm trying to stay calm."

"Why? You tried your best to help me after." He stood his ground. "Stop thinking about that and thinking we're the same people from then. It's in the past."

"Shut up. Listen when I speak to you," he snapped. As he glared at him, his hand dropped to let go of himself. "That *doesn't* comfort me. That *doesn't* make me feel better. I tried my best, but I still fucked up. I did what I thought was right, and it turned out to be wrong. My '*accident*' that night, made you break down into *fucking hysterics*. Do you understand me?"

Phainon winced weakly.

“You didn’t just *drop*. You didn’t just have a little bit of nerves. You were frantic, begging me to be seen as a person, and terrified of being alone,” he explained, painting the most *pathetic* picture of him that he knew was *right*. “I said we wouldn’t choose a path to bring you back there, yet I can’t seem to get a hold on my self-control when I’m around you. I’m better than this—*I know that I am*—yet here I am behaving like the very people I wanted to protect you from.”

“But—”

“If you're just going to make up excuses for me, then what’s the point in me trying to learn or do better?” Phainon wasn’t sure if he had ever heard his voice sound so… *angry*. He was quiet, but he was *pissed*. “All that I’ve done since then to try and be better than I was, to try and reassure you of myself and absolve your insecurities, what is all of it worth if we don’t acknowledge my mistakes?”

Phainon shifted, unsure what to say back to something as heavy handed as that. His protests and voice quieted down, too overwhelmed to argue the point back. It was a losing battle.

“I’m sorry,” was all he could muster instead. “I-I didn’t think you felt so strongly. You don’t ever talk about how you feel, so… this is new to me.”

Mydei took a deep breath, then straightened himself out before pulling harder on his shirt. His eyes darted around the living room almost frantically, never lingering too long on one space.

“*I’m* sorry. I need to calm down. I need to shut up and find something to focus on before I get antsy… My head's too busy right now,” he muttered just loud enough to hear. “I don’t… really feel like talking anymore…”

It went just like this inside of his kitchen after he ranted about work, his father, and his coworkers too. He talked, and he talked, and he talked, until he simply… *stopped*. No words. No nothing. All he did was force himself to sober up, swallow it all down, then move on.

It happened earlier too. Mydei didn’t want to be spoken to while he was thinking, and that meant he didn’t want to talk in return until he was ready.

The back of Mydei’s hand wiped across his left eye as he exhaled shakily, and a glitter of light reflected off of the skin. *Tears.*

“Do you want to build the flowers with me, master?” He asked tentatively, and Mydei glanced at the box.

“All the different sized parts, the sticky glue, the tediousness of fitting small, plastic pieces together in my sweaty hands and them breaking apart into a—*no*. No, I-I don’t want to do that,” he shot down shakily. “Next time, I promise. Not tonight anymore.”

Mydei needed to be busy. He needed something to get his mind off of his thoughts and invested somewhere else. Phainon knew him better since started this, and he knew his hands itched for something intricate to do. Like the night in his kitchen.

Cooking and baking were things he enjoyed and did multiple times every day. There was so much thinking required since all the steps needed to be executed perfectly, as Mydei strived to make things as gorgeous and delicious as possible. The careful attention to detail involved precision and a focused mind, leaving no room for anything else to bother him.

“Would you like to bake something?”

Mydei shook his head. “I don’t have ingredients for anything like that.”

Phainon stood up from his spot on the couch, and he approached him slowly before holding his arm gently.

“Can I please hug you?”

Without a word, his face tucked into his neck, hiding away from him. Both arms wrapped tight around him, fisting his shirt and pulling him close like before. Heavy, trembling breaths beat against his skin, and he hummed softly while rubbing his shoulders.

Mydei didn’t like movies really. He didn’t care for video games. Reading probably wasn’t stimulating enough to combat what was happening in his head, and what was there to clean in a house that was usually spotless?

His attention shifted over a thump from behind, and he saw the bundle of rope Mydei offered to him earlier. It sat on the floor, having fallen since he stood up, and eyed him back.

“Master, if you eat dinner with me and have some water, I’ll ask you to practice that tie on me,” he offered carefully, hoping not to pressure him into anything. “Will that help you calm down? We don't need to talk. We don’t need any background noise. You can sit and focus on it, and all you need to do is nod or shake your head.”

At that, Mydei nodded, and a smile tugged over his lips.

So, he *could* do something to help him.

“Whenever you’re ready to eat, I am too. Will you please make me a plate?” He asked, aware he *wanted* to do that. He probably *wanted* to do as much as possible.

Another nod.

Phainon already missed his voice, and it hadn’t even been that long without it. Playful, gentle, or firm, he liked listening to him speak and laugh. The sound combated a lot of his internal negativity, and it brought him so much comfort.

Mydei would talk when he was ready, though. All he needed to do was wait, listen to what he needed in his silence, and do his best to keep him company.

—

A little bit after eating, while he sat down on Mydei's lap comfortably, shaking hands started by lifting his chin up. They cradled his jaw gently. Amber eyes then met his own, softened drastically from their previously angered gaze. Now, he just looked vulnerable, like he didn't have the energy to be anything—not upset, not confident, not even his usual stoicism. *Nothing*.

"Please ask."

Phainon shivered from the husky tone, glad to hear him talk even if it was two words.

"Can you please use me for your… uh… bondage practice…?" He asked, unsure what to call it. "I'm sure what the word to use is."

"I guess this could be seen as beginner-level Shibari."

"Hm?"

"It's not just '*bondage*'. It's more specific than that," he explained quietly. "I am not tying you up just to restrain you for sex. This is more to look pretty than anything."

Phainon nodded, feeling as his hands left his face and grabbed his crimson bundle of rope. It was offered to him, held out for his fingers to touch, grab, and carry. Getting acquainted with his gear was always the first step in anything, and he appreciated that moment of exposure greatly.

The thick, twisted material felt heavy inside of his hand when he held it, but it wasn't nearly as scratchy as anticipated. When he pulled, there was hardly any stretch to give, meaning once his body was dressed in this then he couldn't expect it to bend with him and breathe with him too much. That didn't scare him, however, as he trusted Mydei not to *hurt* him.

"Is it like art, master?" He teased him. "Does that make me an art piece once you start?"

Mydei nodded. "I'm going to do my best to make it perfect."

"It doesn't need to be *perfect*, it just needs to be *made*," he reassured him, focused on the way he began to unravel the bundle.

"Please tell me if you get uncomfortable," he instructed. "Once I get focused on this, I'm not going to want to stop until I get it. This could take awhile."

"What about our bedtime…?"

"I can't go to bed when I'm like this. It's too hard," he sighed. "There's too much going on in my head, so…. Please bear with me until it goes down. I'm sorry if it's troublesome."

Phainon remembered that night after they messed around with his toys, the scratching sound of him scrubbing the inside of his leather cuffs. It went on for what felt like forever, maybe even after he fell asleep. More than just being cautious of cleanliness and order, had he been

just like this? So full of thoughts that his hands just itched to move and focus on something until he calmed down?

Then, before that, when Mydei admitted to baking a lemon cake instead of sleeping. After he confronted him, was he so on edge from their conversation and newfound arrangement that he needed to clear his mind well past his bedtime too?

“Don’t be sorry. I’m comfortable where I am,” he said, smiling for added measure. “Take your time. I’m here for you, and I’ll do whatever I can to help.”

“Let me focus.”

“Yes, master,” he returned.

With his lips pulled between his teeth, he sealed them shut and sat up straighter on his lap. Both hands were placed on his thighs, holding himself, and he kept his eyes forward rather than dropping it shyly. Breathing steadily, he wasn’t as anxious as he thought he’d be when the folded rope was brought to the back of his neck and pulled around him.

Maybe it was because Mydei was clear that he wasn’t going to be bound in any way. None of his bodily functions were going to be taken away from him, unlike when he’s handcuffed and can’t move his wrists or arms. This wasn’t going to hurt in any way either, as the ropes felt even less daunting when hanging off of his clothed body. The shirt muted a lot of the fibers twisted into it, making it even more comfortable.

Without a word, Mydei opened his phone and pulled up his account to find a photo of that woman. The intricate design of her tie made him stare for more than just a moment, unraveling it step by step to figure out where he needed to start first. As he did, his hands moved blindly, crossing and uncrossing the rope over his chest, then motioning the right over the left.

Had he been some other guy, maybe Phainon would poke fun at him for staring so intently at a stranger’s bare chest. But with everything in his head, the sexual nature of bare breasts right in his face was probably the last thing in his mind. It was just nudity, and nudity was *not* inherently sexual.

Mydei twisted the ropes around one another between his chest, straightening out the rest of the length before tightening them. Pressure pulled on his neck, not uncomfortably but firmly, then around his ribs when either half was pulled beneath his chest and around his back. It made his breaths hitch to be hugged by the unrelenting and tight rope. Electricity tickled beneath his skin, burning even hotter when Mydei looked up at *him* rather than the phone.

Those warm, golden irises darted to his chest, to where he was slowly fixating the rope above either pec to highlight them. Framed in tight crimson, the color was stark and eye-catching against his white shirt, and it felt as if either were bulging even further thanks to the tie. When he took a breath, his expanding body pressed deeper into the stiff ropes from how firmly they gripped his body.

“Please don’t tighten them anymore, master.”

Mydei nodded, staring at him for a second before glancing back to his phone.

This wasn't *scary*. If anything, it felt almost intimate the way Mydei raked his eyes over his body and began to carefully feed the ropes through the twist he made. He touched him gently despite the ropes being tight, flicking his eyes up to his every so often before focusing again.

Slowly, while raveling and unraveling his work when he wasn't pleased with the way it turned out, Mydei stopped looking up at him. He stopped tentatively checking in, no longer conscious of being watched and doubtful of his participation in all of this. Not that he stopped caring, as Mydei would loosen the hold if he gasped too loud and slow down if he squirmed too much, but he stopped *worrying* about him not wanting this. He dropped the concern that he *didn't* like it.

Instead, his attention sharpened on his work at hand, eyes shifting and moving as if imagining the next move. He wasn't afraid to try it and then backtrack, look at the photo, then try again. He didn't let a mistake stop him from taking a deep breath and doing it again. His fingers moved as if they couldn't stop, tracing over the rope again and again to visualize where it needed to wrap and how he needed to knot it.

The look on his face reminded him of when they used to study together. Nose deep in a textbook for their shared class, he always used to get lost within the pages for hours on end. It was always easier for him to settle down and focus for long periods of time.

Phainon smiled softly, aware that he couldn't even see him with how fixated he was on keeping this harness clean, pretty, and precise. Tunnel visioned into the task at hand, he was sure nothing could distract Mydei unless it went out of his way to do it. But he wouldn't. He didn't want to interrupt him in the middle of something that was both comforting him, distracting him, and important to him.

His head tilted back gently, resting on the edge of his collar as the sound of rope sliding against itself filled the room. He could feel the mass of delicate and careful knotting right against his sternum, and he was beginning to really like the way it held him closely. They weren't suffocating. They weren't panic-inducing, as not once throughout this whole thing did he feel a hint of anxiety the way he did when handcuffed.

On that same note, it wasn't particularly arousing either. The sexiest thing about this all was Mydei's determination to get this right for him. More than just an activity to calm himself, this was, essentially, what *he* wanted. *He* told him this looked nice, and *he* told him he'd wear it for him if he learned.

But it was supposed to take him *days*. It was supposed to be broken up into short segments, not done in a single sitting. Yet Mydei continued.

When the first yawn came from Phainon's lips, he continued with that same diligent effort. When the low-battery notification flashed at the top of his phone screen, he simply swiped power-saving mode on and continued.

As exhaustion crept into his body, he hummed quietly, disrupting the comfortable silence that had been going on for what felt like an hour.

“Thank you, master.”

His eyes flicked upwards, slowly pulling rope free from beside his waist. That antsy and overstimulated expression had long since left his face, leaving behind only the cool, composed mask he frequented. There wasn’t a hit of desperation in his eyes, and his lips were safe from being bitten raw.

Phainon could still imagine the scratches he left in his own cheek, and he looked down at where they once lived—bright red and terrible against his soft, well-taken care of skin.

“Is this hard to learn?” He asked him softly, eyes half-lidded and lips wearing a kind smile.

Mydei, still not wanting to talk, shook his head before looking back down.

“Do you like doing this?”

He nodded, bringing the rope around his back to double up on the structure.

“I like it too,” he whispered, and the hand on his body paused. “I like how comforting it feels. It’s like a tight hug or a weighted blanket on top of me. The pressure is kind of nice.”

Mydei nodded again, leaning closer in order to look over his back. His hands fumbled around, tucking and tying the tail ends of his scarlet ropes.

“Thank you for practicing this for me.” Phainon yawned, leaning into his shoulder. “I… wanna do it again with other kinds of ties like this. No restraints, just being close to you.”

The ropes dug into his skin, bulging the fat around his stomach and waist slightly from his slouched posture. Each breath made them tighter. Every shift reminded him that he was bound in some way, even if his limbs were all free.

Hot palms touched his shoulders, gliding between his shoulder blades to hug him gently.

“Can you please touch me, master?”

They dropped immediately, needy for more. Mydei touched his lower back where the ropes weren't wrapped around him, and he pulled him closer to his body until their chests touched and stomachs brushed. Nose to his shoulder, Mydei inhaled deeply, holding his breath for a moment while squeezing him tightly.

“You look better,” he said, and Phainon felt a tickle of butterflies in his stomach from the sudden compliment. He remembered why immediately.

‘*Make me look as good as she does*.’

“Am I? You stared at that lady’s boobs pretty intensely for a while,” he teased him. “Maybe longer than any guy into women would.”

“I could look at you forever.” It was said so earnestly that he wondered if his joke even registered as a *joke* to him. “Thank you for letting me do this, Phainon. I’m sorry it took so

long.”

His shoulders shrugged, uncaring. There was something else he cared more about.

“How are you feeling?”

“Better,” he answered. “So much better because of you. Thank you.”

“Then I don’t care how long it takes. As long as you’re feeling better, that’s all that matters to me,” he promised, allowing his eyes to close in comfort “Mm… I feel sleepy, master…”

“Can you wear this while washing your face and brushing your teeth?” Mydei requested. The softness of his voice betrayed just how confident and focused he was less than two minutes ago, as if he was afraid of asking for too much too soon.

It was cute.

“Can I wear this while getting ready for bed, master?” He repeated back to him, and a soft, amused breath followed from his attempt to turn Mydei’s question of comfort into permission to continue.

“Yes, you may.”

They left each other’s arms, and one guiding hand held him as he stood shakily in front of the couch. The first step made his knee buckle, only for a pair of arms to hold him up and keep him from stumbling.

“I’ve got you,” Mydei said almost instinctively, and he gulped while taking another step on his sleeping legs. “There you go. Can you take another?”

Did he have to say it like that? Warm, deep, and full of praise? Like he was genuinely concerned about his ability to walk?

His legs were *asleep*, not *broken*.

But Mydei didn’t care about specifics. He saw him struggle, then rushed to help him regardless. One hand held his own gently, and the other pressed to the small of his back to encourage him to keep walking.

There was a bit of a haze over his head as he was helped to the bathroom, still lost in that sensation of being handled so firmly but gently. It only deepened when he stopped and looked at himself in the mirror for the first time.

He gripped Mydei’s hand tighter, unable to look away from the ropes crossed over his torso. If a photo was taken of him right here and now, he’d look exactly like the men and women Mydei admired casually online when scrolling. The ropes pressed deep into his body, pressing in by his waist and emphasizing the shape of it. Even on top of his simple t-shirt, they made it obvious how wide his chest was and how slender his body dipped as it lowered towards his hips.

That red color looked good. It was brighter than his leather collar was, and the shock of color was vibrant as a rose. Twists, knots, and straightened lines curved to fit around him. The way the ropes were woven into each other looked so confusing at first glance, like those cereal box puzzles of a maze with the difficulty cranked up by a hundred.

Mydei figured it out though. He broke it down for himself silently, mentally, straightening the design into one long strand before fixing the rope into what it was now. Watching him slowly dip into that focused state from his previously antsy self, take hold of what he wanted to do, then not stop until he got it done, was amazing.

“Do you still like it, Phainon? Or is it too much for you?”

“It’s cool,” he accidentally said, and Mydei’s lips pursed over the nonchalant response. “No, like… sorry. I’m a bit out of it right now. I-I meant to say that it was really cool watching you up close and personally as you just… What am I saying?”

Words were difficult to think up and say as he just stared, allowing himself to continue being held.

“I just followed the natural shape of your body,” his dominant explained, brushing off the praise. “The basic shape of what we wanted to achieve was fairly simple. The trickiest part was keeping the ropes symmetrical and from twisting up on itself while trying to tuck and knot the design, as they need to sit a specific way. The whole point is to look beautiful.”

“Does it?”

“You do,” he answered, and Phainon watched him through the mirror as he admired him in the flesh. “I don’t have a long enough rope for anything intricate and show-stopping like other people. I don’t have hooks in my ceilings for suspension. But I’m sure you wouldn’t like to be *restrained* that heavily anyway. This is enough for you, and if it’s enough for you, it’s more than enough for me.”

“Yeah,” he agreed absentmindedly, feeling as his fingers brushed his side.

Mydei touched him like he was something precious, something *delicate*, and too firm of a press could break him. It didn’t matter if he had been tied up, handcuffed, and even slapped by his hand. It didn’t matter that he was built of strong bones and thick muscle. His fingertips knew the fibers of his rope, and they ventured over the wrinkled cotton of his t-shirt, but only the lightest touches met where skin bulged through both.

Even if his chest was bulged and popped from his ties, he didn’t grope his body or tease the little bumps where his nipples poked through his shirt. If he noticed it, then he must have pretended not to see it. If he didn’t notice it, then it was because all of his attention was elsewhere on his body. Arousal must not have been in orbit at all around his head.

As if he could read his mind, Mydei hummed quietly and traced along the very bottom of the harness.

“Leather ticks the dominant part of me better. I like the feel and the smell. But I have a soft spot for the rustic and raw look of ropes, then the marks they leave behind on the skin. They’re really beautiful,” he rambled without being asked, voice far away like he was deep in his own mind. “I like being able to weave them in nice designs too. A buckle is convenient, but this feels a lot more intimate to put on and take off. It makes me feel good inside too when it comes out as I hoped."

“Have you… done this before?”

“I practiced with my last submissive, but it wasn’t like this.” Mydei finally looked up to meet his gaze through the glass. “I tied him up for sex and sexual sessions. I’ve never done it just to admire it.”

It was there. The answer he wanted to hear was right there even if he didn’t say it explicitly.

No.

No, his dominant has *not* done this with someone before. He has *not* tied someone up just to watch them walk around innocently in his work, and that meant he was the first person to give him that.

Phainon felt a burst of pride pop inside of his chest. The revelation made him exhale shakily, heart racing even if he was simply standing there and listening. Each pulse was loud in his ears, rhythmic and familiar because of how often Mydei made it pound.

Another soft hum vibrated through the calm air, and the hand on his back gently nudged him forward. His feet stumbled just a bit, not expecting the sudden movement with how lost in his head he was.

“Someone meant it when he said he’s not all there. Come on, enough talking then,” he decided for them. “My prince needs to prepare for bed. Can you do that for me?”

“Yeah, I-I can do that,” he mumbled, walking forward until his body met the bathroom counter. Both hands held on to the marble top, and he closed his eyes for a second. “My head feels a little bit… weird.”

“Does it?”

“Mm…”

“I’ve got you,” he told him, rubbing his back. “Once we finish in here, I will take all of this off of you so we can rest.”

His head turned, but his eyes were still closed. “But my master just put it on…”

“I’ve had my fill, and I need to get this sleeping beauty to bed before he starts tripping over his own feet,” he hushed. “Thank you, again, for doing this for me, Phainon. You’re always so quick to indulge me, so I’ll work harder to be deserving of it too.”

If he could, he'd thank him for being so open and honest with him tonight, for giving him a longer and more intimate peek into all of the things he hid inside. But the hand rubbing his back made the words crumble and fall to dust. The warmth in his voice flooded in his head and replaced his own.

Mydei sounded so much better than he did earlier, and it made his heart beat even faster to know he was the one to cheer him up. Had it been any harder, it could have popped right into the hand pressing against his chest as it straightened his posture out.

But his head felt a little too hazy to really think about it. All that lived inside of it was Mydei's sweet little tilt of the lip when he opened his eyes.

Happiness looked really good on him, better than any other mask he put on, and Phainon wanted to keep it there.

Chapter End Notes

mydei: i cant control myself around you and it pisses me off inside. why am i so weak all of a sudden? i know i'm better than this.

phainon: hes so cool and composed and full of restraint all the time. i want to give him a safe place to be open and indulge us both.

oh my god these guys are so fucking gross and obvious. just make out already. im sick of this.

Chapter 16: Chapter Sixteen

Chapter Notes

> the next two chapters were gonna be one LONGG one but i thought two would be better. together, there were like 14-15k words and if im doing all of that its for straight up PORN or PLOT and not like a bunch of little scenes like this.
>
> also, i wanted to highlight/showcase a bit more of mydei's dom drop. i was pretty in depth about phainons, so have a little extra of mydei.
>
> the next one will also be about mydei. hes v important in the last few n upcoming chapters. my poor son.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Upon learning more about how Mydei felt, Phainon realized that if he wanted to cheer him up when he felt down, there were certain things that helped.

One was that he did want to be *reassured*, but it didn't count if it excused the mistakes he made in the past. Mydei liked affirmations when he did something well and to be told that he was doing good as he was. More often than not, he wanted *encouragement* to keep going instead. He wanted his efforts praised and his growth acknowledged, as that meant he was learning to be better. To him, progress was more important than being perfect.

The second was that sometimes he craved *quiet* and *space*. His head could be a loud place when he was upset. Rather than being smothered with attention and bombarded with extra noise, there came moments where he just needed everything turned off for a little while so he could try to drown his own thoughts into something manageable. Something smaller, quieter, and less daunting to approach. Though he allowed the occasional question or comment, if he didn't feel like it, then he simply didn't speak. Maybe a hug was needed for grounding too, but if he didn't want to be touched, then he was always sure to make it known.

Most importantly, he liked *company*. Even if he couldn't handle speaking or touching sometimes, Mydei liked him being in the same general area as him. Whether they were doing the same thing, one by the stove while the other helping off to the side, or doing completely opposite activities, one on their phone with the other reading a book nearby, he liked Phainon there. It was comforting to simply be *present*, even if not active all the time. Though, bonus points were included if he asked permission for little things like leaving the room. More were rewarded if he offered to get him anything he might need for comfort's sake.

Phainon knew, to an extent, that he had some of these quirks. In school, he'd hide in his room when he wasn't feeling like company or bury himself in whatever he could to keep busy. That

ended up being his textbooks and other educational books from the library. Those were his little quirks. Those are what made him, him.

And he did his best to help.

A few days passed by with him trying to help Mydei feel better and work through his thoughts. Though he couldn't spend every night by his side, he carried his duties through the occasional text message, photos, and audio messages.

Of course he didn't *need* to. Mydei was incessant that this was not necessary as he could handle it. But he wanted to, and since he was putting in so much effort, he was allowed to.

The night Phainon did choose to visit was spent comfortably and casually as Mydei wasn't yet feeling his best. He kept him busy by baking a honeyed tea cake with him, going as far as to join him in shopping for the ingredients after work. He asked for more things from him, like if he could have his phone when it was off charging in another room or if he could refill his glass of whiskey when it emptied. They felt *so little* for him to do, but Mydei looked *so grateful* for the attention, effort, and care.

And as always, pleasing Mydei brought him a gentle sense of fulfillment. So when *he* was happy, so was *Phainon*.

After dinner, while they were relaxing into a quieter part of their night, he was sitting at the dining table to put their flower set together. Beside him, Mydei was looking through the instructions and sipping on his *God-knows* glass of whiskey. Somewhere after the fifth or sixth pour, Phainon began to lose track of how many times he refilled it. At this point, he didn't even ask if he could, he just did.

Soft music played lightly in the background, quiet enough to miss when they spoke but loud enough to hear during silent moments.

A thump of his glass to a coaster made him turn his head, and he reached for it instinctively.

"Are you sure you should keep going, master?"

"'m fine," he answered slowly, but doubt filled his gut as he hesitated pulling the cup any closer. "Please, Phainon."

"Mm… I guess," he caved, then grabbed the half empty bottle to give him another drink. "At least you don't work tomorrow."

Mydei nodded. His head was resting in his hand, elbow pressed to the table as he watched him with tired eyes. It was a gaze Phainon could feel even as he twisted the cap and set it back on to its tray.

"For my master."

"Thank you," he returned.

His hand wrapped around the glass, and he raised it to his lips before swinging half back at once.

Phainon didn't like watching, but he did anyway.

Mydei wiped his mouth sloppily, then shifted his attention down to the opened box full of bags and pamphlets. He brought it closer, knocking the edge against his glass before pulling bag after bag out. They were numbered to make it easier, and each was placed in order.

"Please be careful," he commented. "My master hates a mess."

One arm stretched to move his drink out of the way, aware that shattered glass was the *last* thing that needed to happen tonight.

Mydei grabbed the guide before he could after, flipping it open to look over the pictures and details. Page after page was flipped, faster than anyone could realistically read, only to be brought back to the front.

"I buy my mother bouquets of roses in shades of red since she loves them," he said casually, and Phainon chuckled softly over his openness.

"Red roses remind me of you when I see them," Phainon admitted to him, looking over all of the bags before opening the first one. "You're an awfully romantic guy, you know."

To this day, he still had no clue how Mydei never had a boyfriend before he figured out the full extent of his desires.

"Me? A romantic?" He repeated as if he didn't understand. "You've got the wrong guy, Phainon."

"No. I've got the right one."

The pieces clicked and clacked over the wooden table into a mess, one that made Mydei shift and look around as if anticipating them to be all over the floor. To help ease some of that worry, Phainon quickly stored them into grouped piles of the same pieces and tucked the bag into the box to minimize the mess. Its manuel was placed in front of him once Mydei decided he was done with it.

While looking between the toy and the instructions, he began to dig the pieces out to fit them together.

He wanted to build it first to make sure he did it right, then he'd take it apart to use the glue. In his head, it'd completely minimize the risk of it falling and shattering into pieces in the future that'd inconvenience Mydei. That was his game plan.

It definitely wouldn't all get done tonight, but that was the fun. This would be an activity they could finish into tomorrow as well.

"You'll find that my life is void of any and all romance," Mydei insisted, watching his fingers work. "I'm quite an unromantic person."

Phainon's lip tilted downwards, slightly annoyed that he would think such a thing about himself when everything Mydei did was effortlessly charming. Even if his casual actions and care didn't have any *real* feelings behind them for him, that didn't suddenly make them any *less* romantic of a gesture.

"Who said that to you?"

"No one," he rushed a little too fast to say. "I simply don't find myself to be romantic. There's a difference between chivalrous, responsible, and romantic."

"Romantic people tend to be both chivalrous *and* responsible," he reasoned. "What makes my master think he's not a romantic person?"

Mydei hummed thoughtfully. "I've never even asked someone out on a date before," he shared with him.

Truthfully, Phainon didn't expect an answer at all, let alone one that sounded so sincere.

He clicked two blocks together, then glanced over to his dominant.

"You've never been on a date?" He asked in quiet disbelief. "You've never agreed to one either?"

That didn't sound right to him at all.

"No." He said it so casually and surely that Phainon had to set the pieces down to give him his full attention. "I've never felt the need to formally ask someone out on a date."

"But… you've had past submissives before. These guys you've met up with, did… did you not take them out? Or did you jump from a few text messages to sending them your address?"

There was no way.

Mydei wasn't a guy who went around sleeping with just anybody who shared a kink with him, right? He didn't match with someone then take them home a few days later, did he? That was far too reckless for such a calculated person. There was too little thought for someone with a head as loud as his.

"What? No," he defended himself, and a quiet breath of relief left Phainon's lips. "I meet them up somewhere public to see what they're like, take them to a place more private, and if it feels right, *then* I'll visit their place."

Phainon, to save some of his sanity, prayed that it was a schedule made up over weeks. He hoped there was time and effort put into protecting himself from people who might want to hurt him or take advantage of his—*painfully obvious*—fixation on *BDSM* and innate generosity. Each stage should have weeks between them, especially the last one that had him going to a random stranger's home to do whatever they did. *Sex*, probably.

But he did *not* want to think about *his dominant* with some nameless, faceless man in his arms and lap. He did *not* want to think about his husky voice moaning someone else's name as he came undone, then praising them for being so good.

Fuck.

Now that he was, he felt sick to the stomach.

"Somewhere public *is* a date," he argued instead, tuning back into the conversation they had in an attempt to drown the thought. If his voice came out a little bit rougher, he hoped Mydei didn't notice in his drunken state.

That was *his* dominant. No one else's.

Mydei shook his head. "You have to *ask* someone out on a date. We simply make a plan to go to a bar one night or out for lunch some afternoon. It's *not* a date."

"How do you think a date works?" Phainon mocked him, unable to overlook how serious he seemed about the qualifications of a '*date*'.

"First of all, *I ask*. That's a responsibility I'd choose to take as a dominant," he repeated, making him roll his eyes. "If they agree, I'd bring them something like flowers or sweets, and I'd pick them up to go somewhere nice or somewhere they'd like. Then, I'd take them home."

"That's *romantic*, master."

"That's a *theory*," Mydei corrected him, then reached to grab his drink. "I've never done it. That's just what they do in movies and books, so it must be proper dating etiquette. Therefore, that's what I would do. But I don't exactly *date*, so I'll never know how it *really* goes."

A twinge of something twisted inside of his chest, aching and uncomfortable at the thought of him not *wanting* to date.

"Why not?" He pressed. "Can't you have a *boyfriend* who is also your *submissive?*"

"'m sure I could, I just…" His words trailed off for a second as he seemed to think about his response for a second. "I never felt the need to ask because we agreed a dominant and submissive relationship was fulfilling enough for us."

"People just agree to it? Like that?"

Mydei threw back the last of his drink. "Mhm… This' just a different kind of relationship, after all."

Phainon's nose crinkled slightly as he looked away from him, aware of Mydei setting his glass aside.

"'m good. No more."

He wasn't sure how he felt about that. These men, these strangers, Mydei had gotten involved with, while he spoke highly of the few they talked briefly about, how could he let them in his life so easily? On the other hand, how could they let Mydei into their lives so freely?

How did Mydei trust them the way he trusted *him?* The ways in which he opened up to him, how could he do that with just anyone willing to be his submissive?

How did *they* trust Mydei the way *he* trusted him? This was intense, and it required so much reassurance to uphold, how could anyone give someone that commitment so casually?

"You've got a look on your face," Mydei teased him playfully, and he hummed quietly. "Spit it out for me. What's going on in that pretty head?"

"The way you treat me, you treated them despite not knowing them at all, right?" He accused. The words were even more uncomfortable to say out loud, as if they were a hammer coming to smash the untouchable image he saw in the mirror. "I've known you for so long, but what's the difference between me and them if you can do this for *anyone?*"

Amber eyes looked up and down his face, taking in the lip between his teeth and the narrowed gaze being sharpened at him.

Mydei looked like he had too much to drink. His face was slightly rosy, tinted a cute shade of rose that matched the hair swept over his nose. The way he looked back at him was caught somewhere in between amusement, exhaustion, and kindness. His sudden openness tonight was the direct result of too many glasses, but Phainon didn't care about specifics right now. He just wanted to know more.

For a moment, he was silent. It was the world's longest moment and loudest silence as they stared at one another.

"You're my best friend," he said simply.

Phainon scoffed. "That's not what I wanted to hear."

Mydei was so good at pointing out the obvious and keeping things vague, wasn't he?

It was, *technically*, still an answer, but he had to know that it wasn't satisfying enough on its own. It wasn't the right kind of answer he was looking for in response to a question that heavily handed.

"'m not finished," his dominant said firmly, making him purse his lips tightly to bite back what he wanted to say. "Can I continue?"

He nodded, waiting.

"The biggest difference is that this isn't really sexual. It is, but also, not really," he pointed out. "This is a lot more *domestic* than I thought it'd be."

His jaw tightened over that, and a flare of hurt was lit inside of his chest.

“So, what? The second you nail me, I'm going to become the same as anyone else?” Phainon hissed, bitter at the thought of going from someone *precious* to someone *disposable*.

“Watch your mouth,” Mydei snapped while sitting up. “Who do you think I am, and who do you think you’re talking to like that?”

The restraint he usually practiced while completely sober was nowhere to be seen. His words were sharpened to a point, one they hardly ever took. Each pierced through skin, stitching his lips shut and leaving him only able to frown.

Phainon looked away from him as he physically bit his tongue harder, trying to calm himself down and remind himself Mydei *wasn’t* that kind of person. He wouldn’t do that. His heart was too big for his own chest, and if he ever got the chance to have sex with him, he’d never just use him.

He wasn’t a toy. He was someone special and dear to him, and that didn't just go away during their sexual encounters. If they went all the way, it’d *still* never go away.

Sometimes he hated the disconnect between his mouth and his head.

“I’m getting *real* tired of reminding you to keep your attitude in check,” Mydei warned him, and he nodded weakly. “I meant to say that I’ve never had a sub who enjoyed the *casual* side of this so much. I’m used to a lot of sex and sexually charged situations.”

His gaze dropped to the table as guilt seeped into his chest for accusing him of being someone so cruel.

“That’s just not how we are though,” he bit, still upset but not speaking as roughly as before. “The person I am around you is different from who I was with my past submissives. *Everything’s* different, and it’s frustrating.”

“Why?”

“I don’t know,” he answered.

“My master doesn’t usually like that answer,” he reminded him, then glanced back at him.

When their eyes met, Mydei took a deep breath and then shook his head as if trying to dispel the frustration. With eyes closed, he willed himself to relax his jaw and his pinched eyebrows.

“For once, I… I have someone personal to me catering to me,” Mydei clarified. Liquor stained his breath when he exhaled shakily, pungent and thick. “With strangers, if it didn’t work out, I never had to see them again. If I never saw them again, my life didn’t really change much. I might be sad for a while, but it won’t *break* me.”

Even if it might be *terrible*, Phainon’s heart throbbed at the thought that he was someone Mydei couldn’t risk losing.

No one else was as important as *him*. No one else who has been in this spot held a candle to *him*. It brought about a sickening sense of fulfillment, a horrible flood of pride and power, and the heat made his face rosy with a blush.

“You being someone close to me fills me with so much desire,” he confessed. “I wanna give you everything you ask of me, and I wanna share this with you so badly. It’s a bit… lonely… not feeling connected to the person I do this with, and now that I’ve got it, it feels like I’m learning all over again.”

Mydei’s fist then balled tightly over the table, shaking from the strength of his grip like he was trying to hold himself back. If Phainon didn’t know him as well as he did, he would have thought he’d slam it into the table from just how frustrated he was beginning to look.

Not at *him*, but at *himself*. Most of his grievances seemed to come from *himself*.

“But if I mess up, it’s all over. So I *know* I need to be stronger than I have been.” His voice then raised. “Tch… I *know* how to bite my tongue and move on too! I’ve done it so many times in the past that people called me *robotic!* But it’s *so hard* to do that with you during this… It makes me *so fucking mad* that I have so little control over myself when I’m usually so good at it.”

He watched his fist slowly and carefully open. His fingers curled and shook as if an invisible force were holding them down, as if it hurt to let the anger go. Crescent shapes were embedded into his palms, and Mydei sighed to himself before placing his hand flat to the table.

“I promised that you would be my… my best friend first and my submissive-in-training second,” he recalled carefully, voice weak. “I promised I wouldn’t become someone you didn’t recognize anymore. *I promised*.”

Another throb struck him in the chest, sharp and dangerous. Whatever air was left in his lungs was held tightly, leaving no room to escape or accept more in.

He remembered that? The little joke he made while they wrote up a bunch of rules and expectations in his living room, Mydei took it right to heart. He peeled back the forced and fake humor when he said it, noticed the insecurity and truth behind it, and internalized the plea. From the moment he said it, he ingrained it into himself.

“Every time I get too excited, every time I fuck up and step over your boundaries, I take a step closer into becoming someone we both don’t know. What’s… wrong with me?” He whispered while bringing his hands to his head. “If I can’t learn to bite this desire back, I don’t deserve to practice this. A selfish, out of control, *liar* has no place claiming responsibility over someone else…”

“You’re not,” Phainon protested. “The fact you try so hard for other people means that you’re not selfish. Everything you do, you do for someone else.”

Mydei sucked in a sharp breath as he held his head tightly, fingers curled into his hair to pull like those weren’t the words he needed to hear.

“If you make a mistake, you do your best to fix it. If you notice someone’s in distress, you step in right away. Would a selfish person do that every single day?” He asked him, but his shoulders only shrunk in on themselves.

“What kind of ‘*supportive*’ guy wants to see the person closest to him pushed to his limits? Especially ones he doesn't even know?” He choked out.

Sure, it was intimidating.

Sometimes when Mydei got fired up, it was hard not to feel nervous about all of the things he wanted to try with him because of how new they were. But it wasn’t selfish to want to share his passions with someone willing to listen, learn, or take part in. It wasn’t ‘*bad*’ to want him to enjoy this, to *love* this.

“The kind of guy who knows he’ll take care of his every need immediately after,” Phainon reasoned, trying to get through to him. “We made some mistakes, but we know better now. *You* know how to take care of me after we do something, and *I* realized that if I’m not clear with how I feel about things, *both* of us get hurt. A selfish person wouldn't care about those things. He’d take what he wanted and leave.”

He didn’t respond, but that was okay. It wasn’t necessary.

Phainon stood up out of his seat slowly, and he gently set a hand on Mydei’s shoulder before tapping.

“Can you sit up for me real quick, master?” He asked gently, and Mydei took a deep breath before sitting up.

He looked up at him, and Phainon looked down at his lap for a moment. The singular glance had the chair scooting back in silent invitation, encouraging him to take a seat and give him a place to calm down. Which he took slowly, cautious of overwhelming him, but happily, as he enjoyed being close to him.

Two hands held his face, and he looked down into his distracted gaze.

“Stop calling yourself something you’re not,” he scolded him. “By saying you’re this terrible person pushing your wants onto me, that implies you’re *forcing* me to do this for you.”

“Aren’t I?”

Phainon scoffed as a blossom of hurt and disbelief bloomed inside of his ribs.

“Was someone else in *my* apartment with you when *we* were making our rules? Was there a gun to my head when I woke up early and decided to suck you off?” He demanded. “How could you think I don’t want this after all that I’ve done for you? All that I’ve said I wanted to do? Are you stupid?”

Mydei’s eyes narrowed. “*Attitude*.”

“I’m sorry for my tone, but that was a stupid question to ask me, master,” he mocked him, holding his ground. “I don’t *have* to do anything, but I *want* to. Do you think I’d want to submit my effort and body to someone who didn’t give a damn about anyone but himself?”

Did he think he was *that* pathetic? That he was so desperate for it, *anyone* could fill his shoes?

“I give it to you because you deserve it,” Phainon said, glancing down at the way his hands were limp by his sides. “Look. You’re not even touching me because I haven’t asked you to. Because it matters to you even if it's as simple as a hug. Because you care about overstepping even if you know all you want is to be held right now. Isn’t that thoughtful of him?”

Those softening eyes looked over his body, over the black hoodie he borrowed and the way he sat comfortably over his lap.

Phainon knew he wanted it. He could see that he craved to burrow himself into his body and hold him so tightly that it was hard to breathe. It was written all over his face and his twitching hands.

A breath fell between them, and he willed his frustration to take a seat on the back burner. Instead, his lip twitched upward.

“Does my master want to hold me?” A nod followed. “Can you please hug me nice and tightly then?”

Mydei wrapped his arms around him the very moment he finished asking, fingers clutching the hood draped by his shoulder blades before tucking into his chest. His face nuzzled so deeply to the point he wondered if he could use his ribs to hide inside of.

“My master’s cute when he hides like this,” he chuckled, sliding his fingers into his hair before brushing through it slowly. Thick, two-toned locks cascaded over his knuckles, silky and well groomed when he fanned the ends out.

Had this been a few months ago, he never would have known Mydei bottled up so much responsibility inside of himself. He came across as so put together that it was so shocking to see him so pulled apart, and he didn’t let anyone get too deep into his personal affairs. Yet here he was, present through the days it was taking for him to feel better.

That Mydei worked endlessly, and he spent his free time at home unless someone called him to come out. Never did he offer first unless it was to drop something off, always waiting to be invited instead of just assuming it was okay to come around. He liked to drink with dinner, and he liked to talk about everyone else to keep the conversations away from him. If he did talk about himself, it was about looking after himself or being with his mother.

His best friend dressed semi-professionally wherever he went in case someone saw him, and he treated himself to luxuries like expensive jewelry and shoes. They made him look well-kept. They made him look like someone too busy to stop and have a conversation with, especially with his usually stoic demeanor. It protected his privacy to come off as better than anyone else, even if he didn’t feel that way inside.

Never would he have guessed *that* Mydei could also be the same one who was currently non-verbal inside of his chest.

Phainon brought his face closer. Soft lips pressed over the top of his golden head gently, ignoring the way his collar lightly pressed into his throat from the bend. But they didn't pucker for a kiss. All he did was plant them there, breathing in the scent of Mydei's fancy hair care mask mixed with his shampoo.

His fingers never stopped rubbing his scalp and playing with his hair, fixated on moving in a moment so still. His eyes closed in peace, unsure what to say to him next.

All of the things he wanted to say tonight were already laid out between them. If there was more, he couldn't think it up. And if he couldn't think it up, then they must not be that important.

But that was okay too. They didn't need to talk anymore. Mydei just needed him to be there in his arms, and he could have him for as long as he needed.

—

That next morning, as they stood in his empty roof-top gym, rather than immediately working out like he usually did, Phainon took a seat on the ground and admired the soft, golden glow around them. His arms wrapped around his knees, pulling them to his chest. The cool, crisp breeze tickled his nose and brushed the hair from his face.

No one was typically here this early. They joined towards the end of their work out, when the morning matured a little bit more. They'd have their headphones on and hyper-focused on themselves, never giving them any attention.

It was just him and Mydei on top of his building, the sunrise they loved to watch, and whatever they wanted to do that particular morning.

"Feeling lazy?" Mydei teased him, standing beside him with one hand on top of his head.

"Can I ask you something?"

"Always," he told him. "I encourage you to ask for whatever you need or want. What's up?"

"Did you do this with anyone before?" He asked, leaning into his leg while admiring the sky. "Have you brought anyone up here to work out with? Anyone at all?"

Mydei chuckled softly. "No, Phainon. I like to wake up at the crack of dawn to work out for hours, and you're the only person who would too. No sane person willingly does this."

A smile tugged on his mouth over the answer.

“I like this,” he agreed, and Mydei squatted down beside him to be closer. “I also like that no one else has done this with you.”

“Do you?” He teased quietly as Phainon turned to look at him. “Possessive little prince.”

Maybe.

It brought him so much comfort to know that there were things exclusive to just him and Mydei. This was a privilege reserved for him, and it wasn’t some rinse-and-repeat scheme he pulled on people in the past. He wasn’t just *anyone*.

More than just casual bondage around his home and domestic service, the other things they did were theirs alone. That made them even more special to share.

“What else?” He wondered.

“I didn’t allow my other subs to take my clothes home,” he brought up, and Phainon nodded. “I didn’t let them come over as much as you do either. Typically, I went to their place.”

“… So, my key…?”

“Only you have a key to my home,” he shared with him, and that made him pull his knees closer to his body. “*You* are the only person in my life who needs that much access to me and my things.”

He smiled wider.

The hand on his head lowered, and he craned his neck when he felt it inch closer. He didn’t have his collar on because this was still a public space. He chose not to wear his choker since his collar would just be clicked on inside of Mydei’s home again. The palm curled around his throat, taking advantage of the underdressed skin to cup gently. Fingers pressed beneath his jaw, keeping his chin lifted.

Mydei’s eyes raked over his face, meeting his eyes before making their way down. He watched him, aware of their weight but pretending not to notice.

“Do you remember last night?”

“It’ll take more than that to get a man like me black-out drunk,” he mused. “I’ve never been drunk enough to forget what I did the night before.”

“Then, you remember what I said about us…” Phainon trailed off. “About if we ever… *you know*… had sex…”

Mydei gave a single nod of the head. “You need to stop thinking poorly of yourself and of me. I would never treat you with anything less than what you deserve.”

“That’s not it. I don’t think I’m *lesser* than anyone, actually,” he confessed. “It’s more like… I think I’m *better* than them.”

“You ‘*think*’?”

He rolled his eyes. “Yeah. I *think* I’m better than them, and that’s why I don’t like being compared to them. After all, you said so yourself, this is different with me because we were already close. This is different with me because you have something to lose.”

The hand on his neck gently pinched as if to warn him of his next choice words, and he twitched his shoulder briefly to combat it before relaxing it.

“You won’t lose me,” he reassured him. “I *want* to be here with you, master.”

“I’m glad.”

While those fingers loosened around his throat, they began dragging slowly against his skin to release him. He already missed the heat of his touch the very moment they broke apart, wishing they could’ve stayed like that for a little bit longer.

Mydei stood, then held that same hand out for him to take.

“But you shouldn’t go around thinking you’re better than anyone else around you,” he advised. “Confidence in yourself is a good trait to have. Arrogance is not.”

“Is that your way of telling me I’m *not* better than any of your exes?” He mused, reaching to grasp his hand. Palm to palm, thumb crossed over thumb, he squeezed down tightly for a pull.

“Not all relationships end poorly.”

“That’s not what I asked,” Phainon pointed out while lifting himself off of the ground. “Am I better? Is what we *have* better than what you *had* in the past?”

Mydei’s eyebrow lifted, staring at him as if he didn’t expect him to ask that so blatantly. But how could he not? This confidence and openness was something *he* instilled in him. *He* coaxed him into learning how to ask whatever was on his mind, so there was no point in him being surprised with what came out.

Standing eye to eye, Phainon tilted his head innocently as Mydei’s mouth tilted upwards slightly. Just the smallest lift of that grin underneath the gleaming morning sun made his stomach flutter terribly.

“They were good men at heart. If it ended nicely, it was mutual. If it went wrong, I was to blame for being so naive,” Mydei shared, still dodging his question. “Not all of them were necessarily *bad*, Phainon.”

“*Am I better?*”

The grip around his hand tightened for a second, and it looked almost as if Mydei didn’t want to answer that. A small ache burned a hole through his stomach at the thought of someone giving him what he couldn’t, of someone being better than him despite all that he was in Mydei’s eyes.

But then he nodded, and the humbling thought shattered right then and there. Pride burst throughout his chest.

“You’re better, Phainon,” he agreed softly, feeding into his ego.

“And you didn’t need a drop of alcohol to tell me how you feel,” he teased him. “Was that so hard, master?”

“I don’t like your condescending tone.”

He laughed, then felt his opposite hand grip his face. Fingertips dipped into his cheeks, pinching them firmly before tapping his cheek.

“Be good,” he chided. Phainon felt a tingle burn underneath his skin from both the slap, the early morning air, and his own interest. “Are you going to be good?”

“I can be.”

Another light handed smack clapped against his cheek, and he pushed his tongue to his cheek as the tingle became a buzz. Electricity burned through his nerves like a live wire, coursing through his body from cheek to chest to groin. Being underneath Mydei’s firm and narrowed gaze only made it burn hotter, as he liked when he held every ounce of his dominant’s attention.

“Are you going to be good?” Mydei repeated.

“Do you… know how hard it is waking up and being unable to relieve myself?” Phainon whispered, tucking into his hand. “If you keep this up, I won’t want to work out. You’re… This is putting me in a *different* kind of mood…”

“If you ask, I’m going to say ‘*no*’. I’m not in the mood for sex, just teasing you.”

A soft groan left his lips as he pulled away from his hand, hoping to save himself the frustration of getting worked up just to wait it out. It was torture every time.

“Ah ah.” Mydei snapped his fingers beside him, then held his palm in a cup shape. “Put your face back in my hand. *Now*.”

He tilted back into it, still looking up at him.

“Why don’t you ever ask me for relief?”

“My hands aren’t enough fun,” he murmured, then glanced at the door to make sure they were still alone. “If I’m going to go through the whole process of asking, I don’t want to do it by myself, master.”

The thumb on his chin lightly brushed his bottom lip, and he took a deep breath to try and calm himself down.

“Ask while you’re here so I may help you,” he said simply.

“You haven't been feeling good recently, and I usually get so caught up in everything else that it just doesn’t matter as much,” he admitted. “Most of the feeling comes when I remember that I *can’t*. I don’t have a choice even if I *don’t* want to, and it just gets me worked up even more.”

“Does it?” Mydei feigned sympathy. “Oh, my poor…” His palm tapped to his cheek. “… poor…” And again. “… little prince.”

Shaky breaths left his lips, and he glanced back to his eyes.

“Maybe if you were good last night and didn’t speak poorly of us both, I’d suck it up and get you off when we finished up.” Mydei then tsk’ed. “Maybe if you had some shame and humility in telling me how big that ego has grown, I’d have let you go about your day normally.”

Phainon immediately shot his gaze back to the door upon seeing it swing open from his peripheral vision. Vigilant. He pulled back slowly, and Mydei tucked his hand into his gym shorts before leaning in to whisper.

“You are what I allow you to be,” he reminded him quietly. “If I want a spoiled prince, I’ll cater to one. But if I want a denied slut, I’m going to make one.”

His eyes followed the stranger as she fixed her too-big glasses and checked a compact mirror. She was so far away that he knew she couldn’t hear them, and two guys just standing around wasn’t incriminating at all. They were just talking. But the twist of anxiety and arousal in his gut at the prospect of getting caught was too strong.

Just standing here and listening to Mydei’s casually cruel words was making his head feel fuzzy, and his pants were not going to hide the entirety of his boner if he kept thinking about it. But he couldn’t stop.

“Are you hitting your shoulders and chest today?” Mydei asked, pulling back to grin at him. “I’ll spot you.”

Laying on that bench with his dick in front of his face as he stood over him was going to be Hell. Especially since he really, *really* liked the scent of his skin, and working out only made it *stronger*.

“I’m not gonna be able to lift that bar,” he warned him. “Mas… —*Mydei*, I’m not… gonna be able to focus enough to be safe with weights like that.”

“Shame,” he said. “I was looking forward to it. Play it by ear then. Do what’s comfortable, and if you need my help, just let me know.”

Phainon nodded, then looked down at his body when he turned around. The leggings hugging his legs really highlighted his thick calves, and he almost wanted to curse his shorts for hiding the way they’d do the same for his thighs and ass. It was a curse.

One hand covered his face, and he groaned quietly before sneaking one more peak at the way his long sleeved compression shirt was glued to every inch of his upper body. He could make out his shoulders when he walked, each muscle in his arms, then the twist of his waist when he turned around to look back at him.

He was going to crush himself with a dumbbell. He was going to get distracted and get flung off of a treadmill. He was going to hit his shoe on the stair climb, then smack his head into the machine.

“Don’t be lazy, Phainon!” Mydei called to him, and he walked over to him. When close enough, he glanced between him briefly before looking right at him. “Good boy.”

An involuntary whine clawed its way up his throat.

He was going to die up here, and it’d be Mydei’s fault for being the biggest distraction known to man kind.

Chapter End Notes

oh to be a security guard at this place just watching this hot guy slap another hot guy like 5 times or something before noticing they both have boners

also. its 7am n i was up all night writing this so im about to crash. i will double edit when i wake up. if there's a typo, shhh… afternoon mari will handle it. this mari has one eye open n her phones at 12%

Chapter 17: Chapter Seventeen

Chapter Notes

dont ask how many times i rewrote this and drafted this. or how little sleep i got for this.

my heart strings were not just tugged, but yanked.

also, im certain i mentioned it, but cyrene and phainon were childhood friends before he moved around middle school/highschool where he met mydei and the others. then cyrene came to live with him/his family for college, and now she stays in his apartment. and has for awhile. but she comes and goes to travel back and forth

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It was Monday morning when he woke up to a text from Mydei, one that told him that he was going to stay over that night. He wasn't *asking*, either. That text was a demand, flat out and not even attempting to masquerade as anything else.

As if he planned to go against it anyway. Spending time with him was his favorite thing to do, and if he was given an order, he wanted to follow through with it.

"Hey, 'rene?" He asked after coming back from his morning run, and she hummed sleepily while holding her pink toothbrush still. "I'm gonna be at De's tonight again. Don't wait up, 'kay?"

"What's over there?" she mumbled, eyes closed and toothpaste dripping down the corner of her lips. "Are you gonna be sleeping over again?"

"Yeah, I'll be home tomorrow morning."

"Hm…"

Phainon watched as her head tilted, as she moved her toothbrush and pushed the messy beadhead from her face. One eye peaked open, squinting to look up at him as it wasn't yet used to the brightness in their apartment.

"Can I ask you something, Phai?" She asked, the sound slurred and muffled by her full mouth. "What's the deal?"

"It's kinda rude to talk with a full mouth," he mused, and she groaned before stomping to the bathroom to spit into the sink.

“I said, *what’s the deal?*” She repeated, then rubbed her eyes to better see him. “You’re up so early all the time now, even on days you work. It’s a little bit weird. Like just a smidge.”

Phainon forced a smile as she pinched her fingers together to emphasize a ‘*smidge*’.

Guilt struck him right in the depths of his stomach for the truths he was about to stretch. It wasn't as if he could tell her that he had rules to follow and expectations to meet, so he had to come up with *something*.

“Are they loud?” He deflected. “I can turn them down.”

Her head shook at that. “No, they’re not loud at all. I just hear the front door open and close sometimes when I’m in bed, then your shoes hitting the stairs *way* earlier than I’m used to."

“I’ve just been on top of my exercise recently,” he brushed off, keeping it short and simple. “It’s good to keep active. Since I’m too tired after work to commit, the morning is the best time to get it done.”

At least that wasn’t a *lie*. He really was tired after work, and that typically made him not want to do anything. Who wanted to go on a run or work out after a full shift of being on their feet?

But working out in the mornings with Mydei was refreshing and left him more energetic, so he changed it to match even when he was alone.

“It’s just weird. It feels like I left to visit my parents and came back to someone completely different than I remember,” she sighed dramatically, then eyed his outfit. While examining it, a soft smile tugged on her lips. “Well, you really do still wear this *disaster* of a hoodie… I guess you weren’t lying that time.”

One hand grabbed half of his zip-up hoodie, then closed it around half of his chest gently.

“All I did was try to change a few things that weren’t good for me, that’s all. I’m still *me*.”

Her eyebrows furrowed as she fisted his sweater tighter, visibly confused by that statement. “Like?” She pressed curiously.

Damn.

Phainon was really hoping she wouldn’t press too deep to keep him from lying too much, but she wouldn’t be his best friend if she didn’t. That was who she was, a curious little cat who liked to explore and paw at her surroundings no matter where it took her.

And it really *wasn’t* like him at all to be so vague with her. He could tell she noticed even if she didn’t say anything.

“Like…” Phainon struggled to word his thoughts without giving away too much information. “I don’t *have* to sleep at three in the morning, rush to get to work, then crash right when I get home. That’s not very healthy, you know? I could tackle my day in a better way than that, and I’m trying to learn.”

Cyrene eyed him closely while listening. Then, she nodded slowly.

“It’s not,” she agreed with him gently. “But it’s familiar. We used to stay up late watching dumb videos or old movies, now you’re in your room before I even remember to brush my teeth. It’s, honestly, a bit weird to see and get used to it.”

His hand cupped hers, and she met his eyes as he gave it a reassuring squeeze. The light touch made her grip loosen, sliding slowly down the length of the zipper as if too weak to hold on. He stopped it before it passed his waist, and he held them both there for a moment as a beat of silence passed.

“Do you hate it?” He wondered while watching her expression slowly shift from confusion to guilt. “The changes and all of that… Do you look at me and think it’s something bad?”

It didn’t *feel* bad to him as he took it day after day. It felt natural by now, like he couldn’t imagine a different way to live. If anything, Mydei often told him this whole arrangement was encouraging him to grow as a person, and their other friends threw words like ‘*glowing*’ and ‘*confident*’ around when they looked at him. Feelings became easier on the chest. Thoughts tasted better in his mouth.

But she said he shouldn’t change for anyone’s attention. He should stay true to himself, as someone who was worth his time would like him the way he was. It was cliche, but objectively true.

In his eyes, he didn’t change much inside, but it wasn’t as if he had a side-by-side comparison of himself from day one until now. Did she see him and hate the person he was slowly becoming? Was he really that much different from who he used to be?

Cyrene immediately shook her head, and he bit back his nerves to remind himself to stay *calm*. To stay *cool*.

He was okay. It would be okay.

This thing between him and Mydei was *okay* because he asked for it, pushed for it, and accepted it.

“Of course I don’t hate it. I’m just… not used to it,” she defended herself. “I can’t *hate* you for trying to live a healthier life, dummy. It’s not a *bad* thing to clean your act up and start looking out for yourself…”

Phainon couldn’t help but feel like there was something she wasn’t telling him, but it would be hypocritical of him to dig deeper, wouldn’t it? She wasn’t obligated to tell him everything she thought of, did, and felt. That was her business, and she could keep it as close and as dear as possible.

In return, he knew he wasn’t held to that same exact standard, yet it felt… wrong to hide things from her. Even if they were both allowed that privacy, it was natural to simply come clean and share everything with each other. The concept of ‘*TMI*’ was long forgotten after living together.

Cyrene noticed his expression, then glanced away briefly while biting on her bottom lip. Within seconds, she looked back up at him and held his sweater tighter.

“Mydei’s helping you do this, right…?”

He hummed in agreement, feeling a tickle of fear inch throughout his body from the mention of his name and involvement.

“That’s really nice of him.” She accepted that silent response with a soft giggle, but the sound wasn’t quite as sweet as it usually was. This was almost forced, like the way he laughed when things got too uncomfortable or too much for him to handle at once. “He’s been with you a lot recently too since I’ve come back. Did he talk you into some kinda health kick?”

Unlike the last time this conversation came up, now it sounded as if she was pointing her finger in Mydei’s direction. Cyrene wasn’t just *comparing* him to Mydei’s likeliness anymore. She was connecting the dots between them and *accusing* the man of trying to change him. This change wasn’t an *influence* as much as it was *coercion*.

In her eyes, did she think he was being *forced* into this?

“I should take better care of myself, that's all,” Phainon defended him, hoping to shift the narrative in her head. “He’s like that with everyone, you know. The wellbeing of his friends matters to him, and I care about how he feels.”

“That *does* sound like him,” Cyrene agreed simply. “He’s always telling everyone to look after themselves or checking in on them himself. Cifera said he’s like an annoying older brother who doesn't know when to back off.”

“Well, Cifera’s left alone often with Aglaea traveling for work,” he reminded her. “De makes sure she’s not missing her too much.”

Cifera probably didn’t want anyone to know about the closeness of their friendship, which was why she tried so hard to mask herself with makeup, humor, and teasing. If she wanted to share her problems with them, she would. If Cyrene didn’t know about them, then he didn’t want to be the one to tell her.

“Cassie said he’s a very mature person who appreciates quiet things in life,” she added, but he didn’t quite understand why that mattered. “They talk a lot about things other people might find boring, like flowers, art, and cats. Apparently he doesn't go out much though, just when he takes his mom out.”

His shoulders shrugged weakly. “Mydei’s the kinda guy who likes being at home. If he isn’t invited out or bearing gifts for someone, he won’t just show up uninvited.”

He was never the overly social type. Though he didn’t outright reject people’s advances, once a civil or polite exchange ended, he didn’t care to continue it if it didn't interest him. If asked, he showed up on time and as present as can be. If not, he kept completely to himself. That was it. Was that suddenly wrong?

“Hyacine said he used to dig into her medical knowledge with all kinds of questions. Apparently the human body is interesting to him,” she shared.

“You’re a writer, and he picks your brain to talk about what you do as well. What’s that supposed to mean?” He asked, still not grasping what she was trying prove.

Of course Mydei was interested in her area of expertise. When pushing people to their limits and looking after them, there were certain things he needed to know. The parts of the body that were overly delicate, the most common ailments and how to treat them, and how to keep both himself and his partner healthy were key factors in what he practiced. There were anatomy books in his bookshelf too that proved his dedication, but it must have been nicer to consult a friend than a piece of paper.

“The girls all agreed he’s this perfect person—”

There it was.

Phainon looked away as the truth spelled itself out right in front of his eyes.

“You asked them all about him.” That left a sour taste in his mouth for a person who was always so bubblegum sweet. “Why… would you even do that? Do you not trust him or something? What does pressing them about him do for you when this isn’t about *them*, it’s about *us*.”

His chest hurt at the thought of her not trusting either of them. She didn’t trust Mydei’s intentions even if everyone spelled out how kind he was, and she didn’t trust him to be stronger than to, *potentially*, get taken advantage of.

Cyrene didn’t trust them *together*. This thing they started, she didn’t like it for him.

“I love you, Phainon. You’re family to me, and as much as I trust you and your judgement of people, seeing you change so much feels… intimidating to watch. You get that, right?” She carefully explained, and his fingers twitched to cover the bottom half of his face.

A frown pulled on his mouth, one he didn’t want her to have to see, and his jaw tightened for a moment. Just one. Then, he willed the clench to soften as her response answered his previous question.

She didn't like him.

She didn’t like, or trust, the person he was becoming. What he and Mydei decided was good for him, was something she thought was intimidating.

It wasn’t… *wrong* to be taken by surprise, but… it wasn’t *right* to go as far as she did, right? Gossiping and gathering information from their friends left curiosity and casual concern, didn’t it?

What did she tell them when picking their brains? Did she ask if they also noticed something off with him? Did she sow seeds of doubt inside of them to look at both him and Mydei differently?

“I guess I thought that maybe you’re trying too hard to show off to him or idolizing him too much because everyone praises him so highly…” She trailed off unsurely as he gulped. “I know he’s a good person, but I was just curious if he’s *that* clean. No one is *that* perfect, Phainon, and him talking you into this feels… *wrong*.”

“He tries,” Phainon continued to defend him. “He cares a lot about the people he loves, and he does his best to make sure he’s someone reliable for his friends. There’s no dirt to dig up because he’s just a good person, Cyrene.”

“Don’t talk to me like that,” she pleaded since his voice was sharpened to kill, the way it always was when he got too upset. “You sound like you’re mad, but please don’t be mad. I’m just trying to look out for you, Phainon. You’re worrying me.”

He wasn’t *mad*.

It just… made him feel *some* type of way to know she was gathering all of their friends to try and pinpoint a flaw in Mydei.

What would she do if she found something she didn’t like? Pin it all on that and paint him as someone untrustworthy? Tell him that the man he’s known since high school—*the man he’s seen in nearly all of his most intimate moments now*—was someone he can’t listen to?

She cared, and he knew that. Every part of him knew that Cyrene worried about him and the person he was that she knew closely.

Yet it felt like betrayal to know she was so against this, against what he *wanted* to do with his own body.

“What were you hoping to find out?” He demanded. “Did you think one of the girls would tell you about some deep, dark secret everyone’s worked to cover up? Did you think they’d tell you he’s manipulative? That he’s… he’s some kinda *abusive* person?”

“Of course not!”

He didn’t believe that. Not one bit.

“Do you think he’s a liar that’s playing everyone around him?” He couldn’t help but snap again. “Can’t he just be a good person without being doubted, Cyrene? I don’t understand what snooping around gets you. I don’t understand how everyone can praise him, yet you’re the only one standing here and doubting him.”

Mydei had been so hurt over the thought of being someone like that. He had nearly been brought to tears when sharing that he was upset over not being able to control himself.

Fuck. He even admitted that when he called him ‘*abusive*’ in the past, it hurt him so deeply that he tried every single day to prove he wasn’t.

Yet Cyrene saw him that way. *Why?* Because he was a grown man making different choices with his life? Because he agreed to follow some rules and they ended up feeling good?

“I just don’t know him as closely as all of you do! In fact, no one really knows much about him because it seems he only talks about certain things with each of them. It’s as if they all know *different* versions of the *same* person.”

She was begging him to understand where she was coming from, but the more she talked, the more upset he got.

“He’s entitled to his privacy—just like I am!”

“He comes and he goes, and he dodges questions left and right or refuses to talk more than necessary. I-I noticed this when he’s around. He’s not… *honest*, Phainon. Not like everyone thinks he is,” she tried to explain to him, but he was tired of listening to her. “He’s just good at deflecting. His answers aren’t *answers*, they’re carefully crafted responses to brush things off and keep to himself.”

“What he does is his own business. Why does it matter to you?” He argued. “What do you even want to know, Cyrene? Do you want me t-to tell you he’s this clever mastermind that has everyone wrapped around his finger? The guy can’t even talk sometimes because he gets too overwhelmed, or he just doesn’t know when to jump into a group conversation without invitation! Do you want to know that he can’t ever have the girlfriend you pester him about constantly because he likes *men?*”

“That’s what I mean, Phainon! Why didn’t he correct me instead of just letting me assume that about him?”

“That’s *so fucking trivial*, Cyrene!” His voice raised, and her eyes narrowed up at him over the volume. “Because he didn't say he’s gay, he’s suddenly untrustworthy?”

“It’s the *principle* of his secrecy, Phainon! I-I’m just worried about what he wants with you!”

He scoffed in disbelief at that, eyes rolling over the petty excuses she was trying to serve to him.

“Don’t scoff at me! All I know is that I left to go back home for a week,—*one singular week*—and when I came back, you changed completely!” She cried, tears glistening over her rosy eyes. “And you changed *because of him!* I didn't want to believe it at first, but it’s been long enough! I’m not this… this stupid, air-headed girl that can’t notice a pattern! What did Mydei do to convince you to change the way you live your own life? We’re both your best friends, yet you’re siding with *him* and not even listening to *my* worries! I’d never try to change you into someone else, so why is he talking you into all of this so suddenly?”

“Because *you’re not Mydei!*” He yelled back, and her eyes widened. “You are not entitled to my privacy like you *own* me, Cyrene! Why should *I* have to argue with *you* about how I’m choosing to live *my* life? It’s mine for a reason! *I* decide who gets to know what, and *I* decide who I want to listen to! Stop being so nosy for once in your life, and just mind your own business. *Please*.”

Her lips wobbled weakly as she whipped her head around. The fingers on his hoodie let go with a snatch, dropping it to hold herself in a white knuckled grip. Her nails indented into her

arm, dug deep and firm into plush skin.

At that same time, Phainon shoved his hand into his pocket with a fist balled tightly in a mix of anger at her prying and his flagged restraint. The sight of her hurt, confusion, and desperation only made another jolt of guilt bolt through his heated veins, but it paled in comparison to his own frustration. Nails dug into his palms, carving crescent shapes into the sweaty skin until it hurt. Then, he clenched tighter.

Tension was thick in the air, hot and choking in the lungs when he tried to take a deep breath.

“There it is… I’m not him," she muttered brokenly, and hearing her make that comparison out loud in her hurt voice made his skin crawl. “*He’s* your real best friend, and *I’m* just the girl living in your apartment because she can’t let go of the past. My bad, Phainon… I didn’t realize how much more important his voice was than mine.”

He exhaled, rough and shaky.

“W-Wait… Wait, ‘rene, that’s not what I—”

Cyrene walked back into the bathroom with rushed steps, then locked the door behind her once it slammed shut hard enough to rattle. He heard their faucet run, the knob knocked up as high as possible with a sudden bang.

Guilt immediately pooled inside of his stomach, heavy and thick enough to physically ache. The concoction of his anger and regret was sickening. It brought a sharp, acidic taste to the back of his tongue to think she was beginning to see both him and Mydei in a different light. One darker than it was. One he remembered when they first started this.

He didn’t mean it. Not a single piece of him meant to say that she was less important than Mydei was, or that he didn’t care about how she felt. His intention was never to pit them against each other or make her feel like an outsider in his life.

Phainon just… wanted her to back off a bit, that was all. She was venturing too deep, and he only meant to ask that she calm down and let the subject go. That was it. He didn’t want to fight, or yell, or snap.

An apology sat on the tip of his tongue, but the longer he stood outside of the door waiting for her to come out and hear it, the lonelier it felt just listening to the water run. There were no breaks in its stream. She wasn’t putting her hands under it or rinsing anything off. The sound wasn't being used for anything other than noise.

Phainon bit down on his bottom lip painfully, tearing the skin and tasting the blood beading free. He turned away from the bathroom stiffly, angry at himself for the way everything turned out.

His mouth was a weapon, and it hurt everyone around him, didn't it? Mydei. Cyrene. Himself. Sometimes he could control it, but it was so hard in the face of his anger. No matter what, it just fired.

It felt like no matter how many times he was reminded or punished for it, his fingers just itched to pull that trigger.

How did Mydei do it? How could he feel like this and just… let it all go?

—

His phone was off for most of the day. Usually, he checked it often and kept the buzzer active on the off chance that someone needed him. But today, he kept it silent. Between being at work, sitting in his car to drive, and spending a lot of time in his own head, there wasn't any drive to check it. Not once.

He didn't want to see an empty notification bar because Cyrene was too upset to send him the texts and videos she always did, and he didn't feel like responding to their other friends. They could all wait. Castorice, Cifera, Hysilens, and Hyacine were *not* Cyrene in his eyes.

It took Hysilens chasing him to his car to make him stop and pause, to realize his whole day was put on auto-pilot so he could think. The last thing he remembered was his best friend slamming her bedroom door shut as he got ready for work, then the scent of her too-sweet perfume in the air when he went to leave. He didn't remember driving to work, actually working, or even walking out. Did he clock in? Did he clock out?

"Are you okay, kid?" She asked gently, and he nodded out of reflex alone. "You're like a zombie. I tried talking to you earlier, but you looked so deep in thought."

"Yeah, sorry. Um… what's up?" He asked, holding a hand to his head. "I just… had a rough morning. My best friend and I got into a bit of a fight."

Hysilens' head tilted, eyes soft as she stuffed her keys into her pocket of her leather jacket.

"Do you want to talk about it while I'm here?" She offered kindly. "If I can help, I'd like to."

His shoulders shrugged as he looked around, unable to keep holding her gaze. It felt like too much when he was so messed up inside.

"I'm pretty sure I made her feel less important than another one of my other friends," he said, thinking back to the glitter of unshed tears when she looked up at him. "They're *both* my best friends, but…"

Mydei was… different. He *felt* different from her.

Cyrene was comfortable. Coming home to her clicking on her laptop like a madwoman and giggling in her room was normal, and he liked the constant company of her being there with him. It was like coming home from school and hearing his mom talking to her garden about how big the tomatoes were growing, or waking up from a nap and listening to his dad grumbling over how he can't find the ketchup that was right in front of his face. If things in

life went roughly, they could turn a movie on, kick their feet up on the table, and push it away just long enough to feel right again. She was family.

Mydei was comfortable in the sense that if his nerves bubbled too wildly, just his thought helped cool it down until they could tip the overflow out together. That tone of voice replaced the one in his head when he tried to self-soothe, and his presence brought him a sense of peace and warmth unlike no other. Things just felt right with him, like nothing he had ever felt before.

The two were so distinctly different. Familiar, but different. If they were both his best friends, how could the canyon between them feel so wide?

Cyrene was sweet, like a rose-colored film over life that made everything feel like a light hearted joke. They hardly ever got too serious with one another, reminding him that no matter how stressed or rough days got, there was always a smile that could be shared.

Mydei was gold like the collar around his neck and the sun tucked into the sky. It was wrapped around him like a reminder that he'd never be alone and someone was always in his corner. It bright over all of the dark feelings he tried to hide inside of him and warm over his skin like a school girl's blush. Sometimes it burned, and sometimes he felt too hot for his body to handle, but he loved the heat of that flame anyway.

Phainon loved being outside. He loved morning runs and work outs with him where the air was crisp and the cool could fan the burn away, and he loved seeing him underneath morning's glow instead of the dimmed lights in his bedroom at night.

He was so gorgeous that day they went to see all of their friends. The way he went out of his way for them just to check in, insisted on rolling out the red carpet for him wherever he went, and held him so closely inside of his bedroom, all of it only made him appear more than he always was. All of it awoke something in him that started as a candle's flicker but grew into a blaze.

How could something so light and gentle feel so intimidating all at once?

"But?" Hysilens encouraged him, and he swallowed.

"You and your wife," Phainon brought up instead, causing her to nod. "You were friends in high school first, right? How did you…"

"She's bolder than I am, and she told me that she wanted to try something with me," she said easily, like it wasn't at all an issue to speak on. "My wife fell for me first, but I am much more vocal about my feelings than she is."

That was cute.

Mydei admired her devotion and her openness of her feelings for her wife, and it was something he could understand. It would be so… *nice* to have someone talk about him the way she did her wife.

“The… um… *you know*... came after she confessed?” He managed to ask, and she nodded. “Okay. So it’s different for you two.”

Hysilens lifted an eyebrow. “‘*Different*’? Your best friend collared you then?”

Taking a deep breath, Phainon looked around the parking lot before nodding softly, hoping that wasn’t too much information to share. Could she see Mydei on his social media pages and figure out he was his dominant? If they ever met, could this indicate who he was right off the bat?

Mydei wanted them to be friends, and he wanted him to confide in her about the things he couldn’t help him with. Did that mean he wouldn’t mind if he shared a few small details?

“They’re experienced. I-I just wanted to understand their life better…”

“Hm…” Her eyes dropped to his day collar. “Have you learned what you wanted from this person?”

His lips wobbled.

What did he want to learn again? Was it *why* someone would want to be in a relationship like this? Was it to discover *who* Mydei was when he wasn’t around him? Was it *how* it felt to be a submissive?

Was this now just a series of trying out things he never did with Mydei like he was some kind of *sex guide*? Of him *wanting* Mydei and Mydei *wanting* him?

“I don’t… know…” Phainon confessed shakily, rattled from the questions flooding his head. “When does it end? Does it ever end?”

“Phainon, did you not discuss an end with them? Your dominant should have placed an end date before this even started,” she scolded.

And now even *Hysilens* was thinking poorly of Mydei.

“They told me that we can do this until I discover everything I want to know about myself,” he defended him again, and she hummed quietly, thoughtfully. “I… I didn’t know what I wanted, okay? I’m not sure if I do even now. Is that… okay?”

Was he using Mydei?

No. Knowing him, Mydei was allowing himself to be used for this. Because when he talked about an end, it was when *he* called this quits and when *he* found out everything he wanted to know. Never did he insinuate that he, himself, would stop what they have together.

Mydei would probably never throw in the towel and leave him confused or unsatisfied, which was why he never placed a definitive end on it. It was so like him to sacrifice his own chance to find someone for himself to help him navigate this.

“Your dynamic sounds indefinite then. There will always be more to learn with this person, and that’s okay so long as you both understand that,” Hysilens reasoned. “This person is your dominant for the foreseeable future, so I feel as if they take precedence over others. Much like a girlfriend or wife does. But that doesn't mean you can ignore your friends’ feelings or push them away to make this person happy. Unless you agreed to such extreme behavior… Some extremists do.”

“I never did, and they'd never accept that,” he rushed to say. “They push me to deepen my current relationships, if anything. I’m meant to be less passive to those close to me.”

She smiled softly at that. “That’s very kind of them to enforce. Do they push you to do things often?”

Phainon nodded as a tickle of anxiety carved into his chest. “I changed a bit to accept their expectations and rules, to be better for us both, but my other friend is afraid they’re forcing me. She blames them completely, and I don’t think she trusts them anymore because of it.”

“Do you like this person that you are?”

His eyes met hers briefly before he dropped them.

“I like it,” he confessed quietly. “I like this… thing… we have going on, Hysilens. I like how it makes me feel. But she doesn’t think it's good for me. It’s making her think poorly of us both. A-Am I making a mistake? Am I seriously losing myself to this but not realizing it?”

“Have you considered that you’re *finding* yourself?” She suggested, and he gulped. “Phainon, I’m going to assume your dominant is a good person. I’d like to think you’ve given your effort to a deserving person, someone who treats you the way you like to be treated and cherishes your gift of submission greatly.”

“They are, and they do. They deserve so much.”

“If you’re happy, and if they’re happy, then the only conversation you need to have is telling your friend that this new version of you is *part* of you. It’s not any different because you have certain… protocols or rituals to adhere to,” Hysilens told him, but her choice in words made him shift his weight awkwardly.

“‘*Protocols*’… ‘*Rituals*’… I know what those mean normally, but in this sense, I have no clue what you’re talking about,” he admitted, not liking how professional the words sounded. “They’re not like your wife. They’re much, much more gentle and lenient with me, and we have our daily tasks to do, but—”

“Daily tasks that are enforced are rituals, just under a different name,” she teased him while also teaching him. “Do you greet them every morning no matter what?”

“W-Well, yes, but—”

“That’s an example.” He nodded, unable to think up a response. “Your dominant didn’t explain that to you?”

“I think they avoid using certain terms and doing certain things because it’ll scare me… It's very… loose.”

This time, it was her turn to nod. “So your dynamic is different from my wife and I,” she noticed. “We have a very long list of protocols at home.”

“I’m not held to that standard, and they aren’t that kind of dominant.”

“Regardless, we are still one of the same. I’ve only known you for a short while, but I think you and your dominant are doing your best to accommodate one another by the sounds of it,” Hysilens complimented them both. “If you like this life, then reassure your best friend that you welcome these changes. You don’t need to tell her about your dynamic, just that you want to better yourself. A real friend wouldn’t deny you the chance of experimenting to find what works best for your life. People are *always* changing.”

“She *is* my real friend,” he said firmly, making both of her arms raise in defense. “They’re *both* my friends, and that’s the problem. They mean the same to me, yet I’ve made her feel like lesser than my… my dominant. ”

“Then I ask you this, kid, would you let this woman collar you instead of your dominant now?” Hysilens asked him honestly.

Ice chilled over his bones.

“I…—”

He would *never* let Cyrene see him the way Mydei did, but that didn’t mean she was anything *less* than his closest friend and sister. But if she wasn’t *less*, did that make… Mydei *more?*

His heart throbbed painfully, and he gulped loudly before looking away.

“I-I talked too much. I have somewhere to be, and I can’t be too late,” he mumbled, and she laughed softly over his sudden response. “I’ll see you around, Hysilens. Have a good night.”

“Take it easy, Phainon,” she returned. “I hope I was able to help.”

He didn’t have the heart to tell her that she made this much, *much* more complicated.

—

There was an unsettling feeling lodged inside of his chest as he stood in front of Mydei’s door, and it only grew bigger the longer he waited. Why he was waiting, he didn’t know. But he needed a second. Just one… or two… or *five*.

The key on his ring slotted into the lock, and he twisted it slowly before pushing the door in. His shoes were immediately on the rack. His work shirt was quickly and casually unbuttoned as he walked in, aware that it'd be coming off quickly.

A sound came from the bedroom, indicating Mydei was in there since he didn't see him in the kitchen or living room, and he made his way directly to the other man. No stops.

Phainon needed him, his embrace, and his grounding. He needed to be held so tight that all of the frayed edges of his thoughts came together, to be made present when he's been running on auto-pilot with his head up in the clouds all day and night. There was a weight on his chest too, one only Mydei's firm hands could help carry and guide him on what to do.

Those feelings, the thing Hysilens poked at, could wait. They could *always* wait.

"Master, I-I need to tell you something," he rushed to say before he could even register the sight before him. "I did something bad today. I did something r-really bad today."

"Hm?"

Mydei was there, sitting on the bench by his bed and bent over to lace a pair of heavy, familiar boots. He didn't have a shirt on his back, and the shiny leather pants over his legs were enough to make him stop dead in his tracks. Silent.

Right.

The whole reason he was supposed to come over tonight was for *this*, for kink exploration and play. Not so he could vent about how terrible of a person he felt like and how confused he was, then be told how to go about fixing what he broke.

But Mydei, even dressed in his kinky leather get up, looked at him with an alerted gaze.

"What's wrong?" He asked immediately, closing the buckle over the knot laces. Then he stood up quickly. "What do you need to tell me, my prince?"

Mydei was just as sexy as the first time he saw him like that. He stood tall and proud like the world catered to him, and it wiped his thoughts away for a second. All he could focus on was his bare chest and leather-framed legs, then what it felt like to touch his body while he was like that. Hot skin. Cool leather. Every step was heavy with purpose. Each word was firm and absolute.

"Focus," he demanded, snapping his fingers loudly. "My eyes are up here. Talk to me, Phainon."

"I got into a fight with 'rene," he answered, dragging his eyes from his body to his face. He kept them there as he continued. "I think I made her cry. I said some things I shouldn't have… or, I-I guess I could have worded them better than I did."

When close enough, Mydei opened his arms for him, and Phainon felt his bottom lip wobble before he rushed into them. They were warm and comforting when wrapping tight around

him, pulling him in like there was nowhere else in the world he needed to be but here with him.

Yeah, he opened up to Hysilens about his worries, and she helped him realize this was what he wanted, but she was *not* Mydei.

Yeah, he could try to convince himself that he was going to be okay, but even the voice that resembled Mydei was *not* Mydei.

Underneath the heat of his body and the pressure of his arms, rather than coming together as he hoped, he cracked.

“I made her feel bad about herself for worrying about me. I pretty much told her that her feelings don’t matter to me and she’s not worth anything to me,” he rambled, clawing into his strong back. “She hasn’t talked to me all day. She locked herself in the bathroom with the water running, and when I left, she was locked inside of her room. I think she went out, a-and I don’t know if she’ll be home tonight or tomorrow. She didn't tell me where she was going—what if something happens to her?”

“I’ve got you,” Mydei promised gently. “Why would you say that to her, Phainon? What happened?”

“Because she’s… Because she just cared too much, and it m-made me feel trapped,” he choked out. “She said I’m different, and it’s confusing to her. She was worried about how much I’ve changed so quickly, but that’s just who she is, master. She’s sweet, and she cares, and she worries. But I… I made her feel like *shit* for it because it felt like an invasion of privacy. It felt like she was searching for a reason to reject me.”

Mydei nodded, dragging his hands up and down his shoulder blades before carefully rubbing the back of his neck. They dug in deep, enough to press over the stiffness of the knots underneath his skin.

“Phainon, there’s a reason why she’s being nosy about your business, and it’s not to look down on you. She just wants to understand you because she loves you and cares about you,” he said gently. “*You* did this to *me* before, you know.”

His body flinched at the memory of him hounding Mydei inside of his apartment, yelling and begging for him to spill his business so he could see him in a way that made sense again.

Was she really just like him back then?

She didn’t get the accidental slip of the lip of being called Mydei’s submissive, though, only the result of his experimenting. His online searches were the same as her going to their friends—information gathering to try and explain what they weren’t understanding. Both ended up with them not trusting their own judgment of the other person. Both ended up with arguments.

And that made him feel *worse*.

At least Mydei could control himself. He could swallow his hurt and anger from being accused, then have a civil conversation after to express himself.

All he did was yell and accuse her of being a terrible person like a *hypocrite*.

“You stuck your nose into my business to make sure I wasn’t someone dangerous to the people around me,” Mydei recalled, and he hid his face further into his body in shame. “Well, she sees you’re behaving differently, so she’s sticking her nose into your business to make sure no one’s being a danger to you.”

“She thinks it's your fault,” Phainon blurted out, unable to hold himself back from hiding it. “She… went to our friends to ask about you because she thinks you’re forcing me to change.”

“It appears that way on the outside, doesn’t it?”

He didn’t respond, unsure whether it was *right* to blame him or if it was *unfair* to do so when he agreed to it all. Like Hysilens said, they chose to do this together until he decided this was over, so could it really be considered ‘*force*’?

“If *you* don’t like the person you’re becoming with me, that’s something you need to communicate with me. I’m not here to make you hate yourself or change who you are fundamentally,” he urged him, pulling on his shirt to coax him into meeting his eyes. “If *Cyrene* doesn’t like the person you’re becoming, maybe you should tell her that these changes are something you want.”

“Doesn’t it upset you that she blames you? I-I was upset on your behalf. I yelled at her because of how she talked about you,” he admitted, and Mydei’s hands slowly dragged over his neck before gripping his cheeks and jaw.

Why didn't he look angry? Or hurt? Why didn’t he take her accusation as heavily as the one he threw at him in the past?

The same way Cyrene wasn’t Mydei to him, was she not the same as him as well?

“Phainon, if you are any worse for wear, it’s because of me and this thing we’ve started.” Mydei claimed the responsibility tightly, gripping it like it belonged to no one else but him. “I shoulder the blame whether it's good or bad because I proposed most of these expectations and tasks for us.”

He gulped, sliding his own fingers down his back and waist. “I just… don’t want people to think of you the way I did… It’s not fair.”

Every time he thought about it, he wanted to clamp a hand over his own mouth and tell himself to shut up. It hurt each time he remembered it.

“Hey.” Both hands in his face forced him to look up and meet Mydei’s eyes completely. “Thank you for trying to protect me, Phainon, but that’s not your battle to fight. Your words might not mean anything when she’s *seeing* you change in real time.”

“But…—”

“Ah ah. If your friendship is being tested by the things I ask of you, that means this could be harming you. We will figure it out,” he hushed. “*I* will help you figure it out. Please try to calm down for me, okay?”

Phainon’s lips pressed together firmly, pinched between his teeth before he nodded softly.

The hands on his face pulled him closer, tilting his gaze down so a pair of soft lips could brush his forehead. They lingered there, sweet, gentle, and unmoving as he tried to steady his own breathing.

“I talked to Hysilens today too after work,” he brought up, deciding that he deserved to know. “I told her about the fight, and I asked her for her advice. She said the same thing you did.”

“Did you tell her about me?”

He nodded shyly. “I didn’t say your name, and I didn’t allude to anything about you. But I did talk about *this*.”

“Okay,” Mydei whispered softly, holding him tighter. “She’s someone who understands this kind of life, so I anticipated you opening up to her at some point. Please leave it at Hysilens.”

“I will,” he promised.

“What do you need?” He asked while kissing his head again, and Phainon's eyes shut while basking in the warmth of his attention. “What can I do for you to make you feel better?”

“Do I… need to be punished for making Cyrene feel so terribly, master?”

“You need to remember that your words have an impact whether you mean them to or not,” he said, but he didn’t stop holding him as delicately as he was. “Do you feel you *deserve* to be punished? Why?”

A pang shot him in the chest.

“Because I… I made someone cry when they didn’t deserve it,” he answered shakily. “I did th-that thing you said I do when I’m upset. I accused her of being someone worse than she is, and I made her feel bad about herself for just being worried. I *do* deserve it. I deserve to be punished, master.”

“I will keep that in mind, but I will not punish you while you’re like this,” he agreed calmly, then kissed closer to his hairline. “You begging for it means you want it for the wrong reasons, Phainon.”

He inhaled deeply, shakily. “I deserve it.”

“A proper punishment is for learning, not feeding festered negativity,” he explained carefully. “Yet a slap on the wrist won’t do any good. I’ve been dancing around your mouth for awhile,

and I've told you so many times to be conscious. Not just to me, but to strangers and friends."

"I'm sorry."

"I know you are, and you'll have a shot to prove it to both me and Cyrene later." Another kiss was planted closer to his left temple, light and feathery. "Breathe for me, my prince. Nice and deep. Let's calm down, and let's see where this pretty little head is after."

Phainon closed his eyes while leaning deeper into him, allowing his cheek to press against his neck.

"Ask me to touch you."

"Can you please touch me, master?" He asked weakly.

A pair of hands held his waist before dipping closer towards his spine. They tickled up and down, following the curve from neck to hip, then back again. His breaths filled and fell carefully, matching the slow drag of his tentative traces.

"There you go. Just like that," he encouraged him. "Mm… Must you always come to me just short of a panic attack?"

The nails on Mydei's bare skin dragged lightly, fingers curled into claws as he held him tighter.

"I'm sorry… I can't help it."

He was just so comforting when everything felt like too much to handle.

"I wish you could give it to me, if not forever then just for a day," Mydei whispered. "I want to sort through it with my own hands so I can better understand how to help you navigate it. I hate seeing you so shaky and unsure."

Phainon hummed.

That was so… unreasonable. It was so *illogical*. To want his problems and his troubles just to try and figure out how he ticked inside so he could help him made no sense. If Mydei said that to anybody else, they'd probably think he was obsessive.

Yet it was comforting nonetheless.

"You're in luck. My master always helps me," he said back, leaving it at that as he tried his best to relax.

It wasn't the end of the world because he and Cyrene fought, right? They'd figure it out like they always did. She wouldn't up and disappear on him because of this, and he'd never let her try if he could help it. No matter how much of a rolling stone she could be, home was with her parents back where they grew up and with him.

She'd be at home, probably cuddling her oversized stuffed toys and writing. Mydei and Hysilens were right. All he needed to do was apologize for making her feel bad about herself, then explain that he liked these new routines. He liked this version of himself, and it wasn't because he wanted to be like Mydei or show off to him. It wasn't because he was being manipulated into changing, either. If this ended now—*not that he wanted it to*—he was sure a lot of these things would stick with him, as they made him feel good about himself.

Because he genuinely liked it, she would then accept it, as Cyrene said she'd love him through anything so long as he stayed the same person on the inside. They could move on after. There wouldn't be any more confusion, and she wouldn't need to snoop and gossip.

Phainon sniffled.

"How are you feeling, my prince?" Mydei asked, and he looked up at him as the hands on his back stilled to touch his neck. "What do you need?"

"You're all dressed up for something," he deflected. "Did I ruin your mood for that, master?"

"I'm only partially dressed." This wasn't *all* of it? It was all he wore last time. "I had this nice, long session planned for you tonight to show you how grateful I am for your patience. But you didn't text me when you got off, and you came to me upset. If you need to raincheck, by all means, I can undress. We can do something else."

"What did you have planned…?"

The palms on his throat cupped either half of it, fingers locking around the back and thumbs gently brushing over the arteries on either side. Either pad rubbed up and down, coaxing him to drop his stiff shoulders and tilt his chin higher.

"I wanted to dress up for you," he answered, keeping his voice low. "I wanted to put on the gear you asked of me once, dress you in the harnesses I bought for you, then get you off until you tap out on me. You're my good boy, and you waited so sweetly for me to be in the right headspace for this. I think you deserve to be taken care of completely tonight. And after, I wanted to run you a nice bath while I make dinner for us."

Phainon's chest kicked over the sincerity in his tone, like this was something he *really* wanted him to have. Pleasure, release, and attention, Mydei wanted him spoiled rotten and pampered completely. It was *romantic* to think about how much he had hoped to take care of his every need tonight.

But as he thought about it, that terrible flame inside of him flickered, hot and daunting because of what Hysilens implied between them earlier.

"You might not like what I look like, but it's an undeniable part of me," Mydei tried to warn him, yet it sounded like begging. It sounded like that day in his room where he was begging him not to think any differently of him. "You might even find it unattractive, or too much to handle, but… this was never about you *loving* it, just *experiencing* it, right? You asked for this the day I showed you my things, and if you still want it from me, please take it."

The hands on Mydei's bare skin lowered, touching his hips and finding the leather belt loops on either side of his body. Wandering fingers inched into them and hooked. They pulled his body closer gently, easing their hips together and coaxing him to take another step closer.

Once glance down helped Mydei not step on his feet with his heavy boots, and a glance back up locked their gazes together.

"You don't deserve to be in the same sentence with the word '*unattractive*'," Phainon reassured him. "Every side of you is romantic and attractive to me."

"Will you sing that same tune when you see me? Or will you take one look at me and think I'm someone scary?"

"It's just you."

He wasn't scary. Intimidating, maybe. But even when drenched in his ignorance at the start, Phainon was never afraid when looking at him. Nerves were not fear, and most of it came from the actions, the uncertainty, and the feeling of being perceived differently, not *him* as a person.

Mydei's lip tilted. He nodded shallowly, a bob more than anything, and brought his hands higher to once again hold his face.

"It's just me," he repeated back to him. "Do you still want that side of me, Phainon? He's yours, if you'll take him."

"Yes, master." His voice was just shy of a whisper as his eyes slowly dragged from that rich amber hue to the pink lips just inches above his. "I want him."

Phainon wanted *all* of him. More than anyone else ever did.

"I need you to answer me this time. How are you feeling?"

He was feeling like he wanted to kiss him. Like he missed the taste and pressure of his mouth on his from that night on his couch. They had felt so good then, so gentle when they knew mostly collars, cuffs, and crying tears of pleasure. Of all the things they did, maybe it was the *one* thing where he was less nervous than Mydei was.

Something in Phainon craved him, and he knew it. He felt it. Hell, even Hysilens clocked it when he confided in her about his feelings.

It crawled and begged on its hands and knees to have as much as Mydei as physically possible. His body. His attention. His time. His efforts. Everything he could give to him, he wanted to monopolize it and keep it for himself.

The thought of Mydei wanting someone else made him feel bitter, and the thought that someone else could be in his spot as his submissive made him sick to the stomach.

Most days he pushed it down, shoved it away, and swallowed the feelings dry. Other days, he acted out just to hear him say there was no one else and take all the energy he could muster.

Regardless of both, it lingered in the depths of his chest, hidden in the tightest crooks of his bones and the darkest corners of his organs.

He *wanted* Mydei. He wanted *this*, more than he's ever wanted anything before.

"I'll be okay," he murmured, having to force himself to look away from his mouth. "Can I clean up before we decide anything, master? I feel dirty and sticky, then if we have fun, I want to watch you cook after."

"You're right. I won't leave you alone after," he promised. "I will get all of our things ready, then reassess when you get out of the shower. Have you got an idea of what you want to do with me, or shall I surprise you?"

"Surprise me."

Mydei lowered, bringing his mouth towards his ear. "Well, I'd like for you to clean up well then," he instructed quietly. "I plan to use that dildo on you, but if you give me a safeword now, I won't."

Phainon's stomach fluttered. His insides tightened. Nerves branched through every inch of him, thinking about how much more exposed and vulnerable he would need to be for that. More than just a casual glance while going down on him, Mydei would be staring at that part of him, prepping him, and fucking him with the toy. The fingers on his cheeks would possibly be inside of him, stretching him open, and that was both nerve-wracking and exhilarating to think of.

No one had ever touched him there before. No one had ever played his ass and ventured inside of it.

But what was he really nervous about when it came to things like that? Being dirty inside even after cleaning up? Being fully exposed to him?

Mydei wouldn't hurt him. He liked his body, and he liked praising him, so much so that everything he did was to take care of him and make him feel good. This was all for him and his pleasure since this was his reward.

If *someone* was going to be the first person to be inside of him, *Mydei* was the only one for that spot.

"Will you say it?" Mydei wondered, and his head shook. "Go shower for me then. Get all soft and sweet for us, okay? I'm going to set up your series of gear and toys, then I'm going to treat you like the spoiled little prince you are."

"Do I get any clothes for when I get out?"

"Mm… I will grab you a pair of boxers to borrow," he decided, and Phainon looked to the bed beside him. "But I want you dressed in only leather if we play, so they won't stay on for long. Is that clear?"

A light nod followed. "Yes, master."

Mydei turned his head, then planted a soft and chaste kiss just in front of his ear. It lasted no longer than a second and a half, yet his body was buzzing the moment the skin connected.

He wanted a kiss lower, right on his neck like when he pulled that filthy trick on him. Over and over. Again and again.

All those feelings of want from that morning in his bed rammed into his chest, begging for more than a tease.

“If at any point you want to stop, you just need to give me a color,” he reminded him. “Don’t wait for me to ask. I don’t care if you think I’m enjoying myself. *Say. It.*”

Phainon nodded again, firmer this time.

If he didn’t know this came from a place of genuine concern, a place still riddled intensely with guilt of going too far with him in the past, he would have teased the man for being so protective.

“I will. I promise.”

Mydei let him go, and he untucked his fingers from his belt loops to let his arms hang by his side.

While backing away, he watched Mydei head towards the closet door. As Phainon stood in the bathroom door frame, he cleared his throat.

“Master?” He called, then heard a muffled ‘*yes*’ in acknowledgment. “When I get out, can you please kiss me a lot tonight? Preferably everywhere you can. I’d really like that.”

Once he managed to force the words out of his mouth, he shut the bathroom door and twisted the lock on it. Both palms rushed to cover his mouth, surprised that he managed to be that bold when he tried to shove the feelings down.

Inside of his chest, a quick and aching beat pounded against his ribs. Each made it harder to breathe until he tilted his head to the door and gasped.

There was a thump from the closet next door, like Mydei accidentally knocked something down when he was usually so careful of his things. That proved he didn’t expect such a request from him either.

Kisses were sweet, innocent, and gentle in nature.

Mydei once said they didn’t need to be made into a habit, that he only wanted a few during that moment on his couch. But he wanted them now. He wanted to be kissed on the mouth and neck, on the chest and hips, on everywhere those lips were willing to go. Knowing his dominant, he’d probably kiss down his legs and calves too if given the chance. And he had it. He had the permission he needed to do as he pleased in that regard.

That meant kisses would be okay between them, right? Especially since Mydei also wanted it in the past.

In the grandest scheme of things, because they both wanted this with each other, then that made it perfectly okay for them to have.

Chapter End Notes

oh my god will they finally fuck im so sick of them dancing around each other.

Chapter 18: Chapter Eighteen

Chapter Notes

17k words of filth and sweetness and a twinge of thinly veiled angst. i love them. i loved writing this. i love everything about this chapter. every word.

i hope you all enjoy it as much as i did writing it. it was truly a process <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

There had to be something in the water inside of Mydei's shower because once he finished, it felt as if the day's stress had been washed away. The hot water raining over his body felt so nice, and the crisp scent of refreshing bergamot was thick in the air and on his skin.

Between scrubbing himself down and lathering his body in an accompanying moisturizer, he felt clean. He felt *good*.

Soft, summer eyes came across his own reflection, and he liked it. He loved it, even. His skin looked nice and felt soft underneath his hands, and his body looked attractive when he flexed to check himself out. The ivory locks of hair fell in a way he liked after just a little bit of styling, and his smile looked pretty when he flashed it to the mirror.

It was just a little bit funny that he dolled himself up just to be taken apart, but he had felt so bad after work that he needed this. He *needed* this confidence hit even if it was superficial at best. *Some* was better than *none* after all.

As Phainon opened the bathroom door, his eyes were immediately drawn to the sight of Mydei casually lounging on his bed. His boots were off the sheets, one planted to the floor and the other crossed to hang over his opposite leg. He had a book in his left hand, the one he grabbed at the store for them, and the right was curled behind his head to rest on.

Upon hearing the door push open, his head turned to him, but his eyes didn't yet follow for a couple of seconds.

"There's my handsome prince," he greeted him smoothly once they did, and butterflies erupted inside of his stomach as a bookmark was tucked into the book.

It was placed by a couple of water bottles, but Phainon was too focused on Mydei's body to really notice much of what was piled on the dresser. As he finally stood up, every inch of his leather clad body became visible to him. With every step forward, they just became more and more clear.

His pants and boots weren't enough for his legs it seemed, as there was a black and silver strap curved around his left thigh. Its '*Y*'-shaped top connected to his belt loops, dropped into

a sizable metal ring, then wrapped around the muscle tightly.

Looking a little bit higher up on his wrists showed that they were cuffed. It wasn't actual handcuffs, but twin bracelets a couple fingers wide in a deep, crimson leather. If he went higher than that, a black band wrapped taut beneath his bicep. The silver buckle was done up tightly to emphasize the sheer size of his strong arm.

But the thing he wanted most, the thing he looked forward to seeing with every fiber of his being, was the red straps lining his chest, shoulders, and torso. Tightened down to the skin, his harness hung on the very edges of his shoulders and collar, coming together in the middle of his chest and between his collarbones with a golden ring. More straps lined around his bust, framing either pec and connecting in the middle again. Belts dropped on either side of his torso, connecting to the front loops of his pants. Metal glistened underneath the bedroom lights, reflecting gorgeously like the jewelry he always wore.

Breathless, Phainon clung to the door beside him as he looked up at him. His heart was already pounding wildly from the sight alone, working into a rush because of how drop dead *sexy* Mydei looked right now.

"I like the back the most," Mydei said quietly while standing in front of him.

"C-Can I see the back then?"

A soft, audible gulp came from the man in front of him. "Address me properly, Phainon, and I'll consider it."

Usually Mydei was more firm when he demanded things of him, but heat burned inside of his stomach from being told what to do anyway. It was as if his body had grown used to accepting instructions and itched to obey them. No matter if asked or ordered, he was always ready to accept a task from him.

"Can I please see the back, master?"

Mydei turned around, hands tucking in front of him to flex the muscles in his back. The top straps over his shoulders met in the middle by his spine with another thick, golden ring. The second layer fanned out lower, meeting two different rings that connected to the front. A diamond pattern was made coming down his shoulder blades from a series of leather bands, rings, and studs, where they then met a belt attached to the back loop of his waistband.

Phainon touched one of the rings, awestruck by the way his leather harness complimented his golden skin. It fit him as if tailored to his exact measurements, and that led him to wonder if he jotted them down himself to get this handcrafted. Even with the buckles to adjust the size, it was clearly made for his body specifically.

"I like it," he whispered, then allowed his hands to touch skin instead. "My master looks really… *really* good like this. I like the design, and the way it highlights all of your muscles. I wish I could see you in this all the time."

Mydei shivered, but whether it was from his words or his touch, he didn't know.

Phainon's hands lowered, touching down his spine before stopping at where the diamond shape is cut off by a ring. He poked at the divot, taking in how Mydei flinched before pulling away from him.

"Is that place sensitive, master?"

"I've never been nervous in this before," Mydei confessed. He then relaxed his body and turned to face him. "I put this on in the past, and I felt strong, confident, and in charge. Yet here I am… none of them."

"You *are* strong, confident, and in charge," he repeated. "You're my master, and I think you should always feel that way. Chin up, shoulders back, and ready to be served by me."

A shaky breath fell from Mydei's lips as he nodded curtly.

One hand reached to cup the back of Phainon's head, and he gasped softly when his back was pushed into the door frame behind him. Mydei's knuckles thumped to the wall from his head tilting back, but he cradled him carefully to protect him from the blow.

"Who am I?" He asked.

The hand not on his head gripped his cheeks, pinching them firmly to force his gaze higher. Phainon smiled, warm in his chest, his stomach, and his groin as he was trapped between his large body and the unmovable wall. There was nowhere to go. There was nowhere to run to. There was only standing there and taking whatever treatment Mydei deemed appropriate for him.

"You're my master."

A tap tingled over his left cheek when thick, swift fingers lifted to snap against his face. Skin hitting skin lightly clapped inside of the room, not at all as loud or intimidating as he thought a slap could ever be.

"Again. Who am I?" Mydei demanded.

"You're my master," he repeated, then whimpered softly when another soft smack followed. His entire body jolted, both alert and aroused from his rough approach. "P-Please… Again…"

"One more time. Who am I?"

Mydei slapped him again, and he moaned quietly over the feeling.

"Mydei's my master," Phainon said one final time, looking up at him as he leaned into the hand that had struck him.

Another pinch sunk his cheeks in, and Mydei's leg pushed in between his to force them open. Thigh to crotch, he was practically forced to sit over it while they stood there.

“How do you feel about continuing like this?” Mydei asked carefully as his palm kneaded his stinging cheek. “You’re awfully receptive right now. Does that mean you’re enjoying this? Do you feel good enough to keep accepting this?”

“I want it.” Phainon carefully brought his hips deeper over his leg. “I want to be here with you, master. I don’t want to think about anything else anymore. Just *this*.”

“Then you’re going to continue to be my good boy tonight. I will think for you,” he instructed him. “No hiding. No attitude. If it hurts, tell me. If it feels good, let me hear it.”

“Yes, master.”

The hand on his face lowered, dragging down his craned neck and collarbones until he met his chest. Fingers danced between, not quite touching either of his pecs but traveling lower than he usually would without explicit consent. They didn’t move once low enough for his liking.

“C’mon,” he breathed out, staring into his expectant eyes. “Please touch me.”

“I am.”

Phainon groaned. “Master, can you please touch my body? Can you please make me feel good?”

A moan climbed from his throat when his large hand groped the left side of his chest, soft and pleased by the gesture. The pads of his fingertips squeezed while pulling, sliding deep before pushing forward to fondle him.

“Do you like touching my body, master?” He asked, shifting his shoulders and pushing his chest out further. “Does it please you?”

“Yes,” he answered honestly. “Since you first allowed me to, I have enjoyed touching every inch of you.”

Mydei pulled his fingers back, then used his thumb to brush over his sensitive nipple.

“Seeing you feel good pleases me. Seeing you in sexual distress pleases me. Simply seeing you half-naked and so willing to serve me pleases me.” He pushed down, Phainon bit his bottom lip. “Ah ah. Don’t hide from me. Let it go.”

He moaned again, back arching off the door frame as his hands clawed out as if to grab his hands. But he didn’t. He didn’t pull him away or grip him for purchase. All he did was take it.

“P-Pinch—*ah—!*”

A sharp pinch clamped down over the sensitive bud, its hold growing hotter and fiercer the longer he held it. When he pulled, his chest pushed closer, hoping to steal back some of the space and ease the tug.

“Be still,” Mydei ordered, eyes narrowing down at him as he came closer to his height. “Does it hurt?”

His head shook carefully, and the grasp let go for a moment before gently rubbing to soothe the ache. Only for him to reach for the right and clamp down around it.

“I want to punish this chest for simply being a sexy distraction,” he told him while coming closer. “I want to see it painted red, and these nipples even puffier and too hot to touch. Would you let me?”

“My m-master does as he pleases,” he whimpered, eyebrows pinching from a pull. “He’ll take care of me after, right?”

Now standing nose to nose, Phainon dropped his gaze towards his lips as they parted for a promise.

“Always.”

They were soft and pink, glossy too. A light scent of pomegranate came from them, of that chapstick tube he vaguely remembered seeing in his medicine cabinet at one point in time.

Without warning, without making him ask for it all over again, Mydei gripped his hair a little tighter and pressed their lips together. Eyes wide, he flicked his attention back at his amber ones, only to find them closed in a bliss. Thick, dark blond lashes tickled the tops of his cheeks, but the relaxed brows above made his own eyelids droop. Within a fraction of a second, they fell completely.

Familiar warmth bled through his nerves, tingling them with life as he kissed him back firmer. It lit up his icy nerves, melting them and him into a puddle around Mydei’s heavy boots.

The hand on his chest groped him again instead, squeezing and massaging in time with their kiss. Slowly. Gently. Like wading him back to the shallow end of his pool for a breath of comfort. A moment to relax from the rough handling.

Phainon caved. His hands reached to grab his harness by the stomach, and he pulled him closer, so close that Mydei kicked the wall beside them.

“Please be careful, master,” he teased him, breaking their kiss. “You’re gonna put a hole in the wall.”

“I’m going to put *you* through the wall,” Mydei growled back, and his heart skipped when he pulled the hand from behind his head back. Instead, he gripped his waist and slid them lower to his thighs. “Hold on tight to me, boy.”

His own arms wrapped around his neck quickly, and wood slid against his back when he was picked off of his feet. A bounce placed his ass in Mydei’s hands, and another helped his legs curl around his hips. As they situated in their new position, in him being carried like he was weightless, those same lips pressed against his with more hunger than before.

"*Master…*"

Phainon kissed him deeper, starving to remember the taste of his tongue. Each push forward was made with eager, parted lips. Each pull back was made with a wet click.

"*Phainon*."

Buckles pressed into his skin like the fingertips dug into his thighs. The scent of leather and warm amber clouded his senses, a mix so distinctly *Mydei* that it made him want to be embedded even deeper with him. He wanted it on his skin, not because he hated the smell there but so he could have it even when his body left.

A tongue brushed over his bottom lip, and he parted his lips further to feel it slip against his own. Muffled moans clawed from the depths of his throat, pleased by the feel of him exploring his mouth from tongue to teeth to cheek.

Phainon released his arms from around his neck, palms choosing to inch over his neck and ears. One cupped the side of his moving jaw, and the other touched his golden earring before thumbing over where gold pierced the lobe.

Their kiss broke to make way for Mydei's quiet exhale, and he pinched gently while his face tucked into his neck.

"You're not too scared to take this further, are you?" He double-checked, and Phainon hid inside of his hair as the tip of his nose pushed the chain of his collar.

"I'm not scared of you, master," he promised, head sliding against the wall to crane his neck for him.

Lips met where his necklace sat over skin, and he took a deep breath while closing his eyes to bask in the gentle gesture. Another was planted a few inches higher, following the links to his shoulder. Closer and closer, he made his way closer to his bare neck until a breath fanned across it. Hot and ticklish, he fought the urge to squirm.

"Please," he begged weakly, fingers traveling from his jaw to his hair. With a pull, he attempted to coax Mydei closer. "Master, kiss—*h-hah*…"

An open mouthed kiss was planted against the side of his throat where his golden tattoo sat. In the midst of his pleasure, he accidentally pulled on Mydei's earring.

A sharp hiss filled his ears, but before he could apologize, the kisses being planted over his skin turned into a bite. Within seconds, his own mirrored sound filled the room, pitched from sensitivity.

Upon hearing the noise, Mydei tried to pull away, only for the hand on his head to hold him there.

"Again," he choked, head dizzy from the creeping arousal engulfing his body and mind. "Master, bite my neck again. Kiss my neck again. J-Just—"

That same mouth kissed him again, and again, and again, mouthing at the skin and feeling every pleased rumble that shook his vocal cords. Teeth nipped at the flesh, pinching and teasing his senses.

“Maybe *I’m* the dog,” Mydei joked, biting over his neck again to feel him cry out. “Maybe you’re my *chew toy*.”

“Yeah… Yeah, my master’s toy,” he repeated distractedly, too choked up on the sensations of being devoured to really think.

It felt so good to be bathed in his attention that there wasn’t much else he wanted but more of it, especially after such an emotional day. His teeth in his skin. His fingers on his body. His lips speaking his name. That was *all* Phainon wanted.

“Mm… not yet. Come on, don’t go yet,” Mydei noticed the spacey tone, then kissed up his neck until he met his ear. “Phainon. I need you here.”

His head turned, and he eased the hold on his hair so they could meet eye to eye again. That deep, golden hue was so beautiful looking at him like that, like he was the only thing that ever mattered.

He was bounced inside of his arms, one hand lifting off of his body. A soft tap then brushed his warm cheek, and he hummed while leaning into the palm and gazing down at him.

“Can you hear me?”

“Mm…”

Mydei’s lip tilted briefly into a soft, tender grin, only to fall and tap his cheek again before using his entire palm to pinch the fat gently.

“Come on,” he urged. “Focus on me, Phainon. Focus on my voice and my touch. Can you hear me?”

“Yes, master,” he whispered.

“Hold on to me.”

His arms immediately wrapped around his neck, and the very moment his back left the safety of the wall, he held on tighter.

“I’ve got you. You’re not going to fall,” Mydei soothed him, carrying him with one arm underneath his bottom. His other hand gave one more tap to his cheek, more gentle than the last. “*Focus*.”

Phainon looked up at him as his back hit the mattress, then around them as Mydei leaned over him. Reason managed to slip in long enough to tell him something was happening, something that needed his attention, and he swallowed thickly while shaking his head.

Mydei wanted him to *focus*.

“Does my prince want to play dress up with me?” He asked, and Phainon turned his head to try and look for the bundle of leather before he answered. “I have your sets on the bench. I will grab them if you want them.”

“Yeah,” he agreed, and one golden eyebrow lifted as if to silently warn him. “I mean, yes, master. I want to dress up with you. Do you think I’ll look good in it?”

“I think you’re sexy in whatever you wear,” he answered. “But my favorite is—”

“—when I’m dressed in black,” he finished, aware.

“And blushing down this gorgeous chest,” Mydei added, dragging one finger down the middle slowly before letting go of him. “Sit up. Be alert for me.”

Phaonon forced himself to move, to push his hands into the mattress and watch as he went to grab a series of black leather straps. How they were meant to fit, he had no clue, but it looked like a lot to sift through. The only thing he recognized was his collar, which brought him comfort to see.

His neck was starting to miss its hold and claim.

“You look sloppy while slouched back like that,” Mydei scolded him.

Immediately, he straightened his back and planted his hands on top of his thighs. His chin lifted, and his shoulders pushed back.

“Good boy.”

Leather soon wrapped around his neck gently, but before it enclosed completely, the buckle was shifted to expose his tattoo. Another kiss was planted against it as if Mydei just *couldn’t* help himself, and he laughed lightly to himself while tilting his head.

Once he pulled away, satisfied with his work, Phainon watched his face while he buckled it tightly behind him. Its ring jingled, making his lips curl into a wider grin.

“Can you please pull it when you kiss me, master?”

Two fingers yanked him by the ring to steal a chaste kiss from his lips. But as he kept pulling and kept backing up, it guided him on to his feet silently.

“You’re so cute,” Mydei praised him. “How can you sound so sweet while asking to be led around by your collar?”

“Maybe I’m just cute all the time,” he joked, earning another quick peck to the mouth because Mydei just *couldn’t* stop. “Mm… Are you gonna dress me up now, master? Will you make me look as sexy as you do?”

Pulling away, Mydei unhooked his fingers and nodded. He gave his body a look over, then reached for the mess of buckles, belts, cuffs, and rings. They were untangled with a couple of good shakes, then brought between them both.

“Here.” He offered him a set, and his hands reached to touch the smooth leather. “They’re very lightweight in case you don’t like the feeling.”

“And if I do?”

“Then we can upgrade to something thicker and heavier like my own,” he said simply. Phainon thumbed across a buckle before handing it back, excited. “Ready?”

“Yes, master.”

Mydei brought the series of straps over his shoulders, allowing both sides to hang for a moment. Another belt situated just beneath his chest, thick and sturdy in width. When closed and tightened, he gasped, taking a step forward over the way it *choked* his body.

“Too tight?”

“Y-Yes, master,” he forced out, and Mydei left it for a moment. “It's digging into my ribs.”

“I think it looks good on you like this,” he insisted, but Phainon shook his head. “No? You don’t think so?”

“Way too tight,” he repeated, then exhaled once it was eased down into something much more comfortable. “You did that on purpose, didn't you?”

Mydei hummed positively. “I wanted to test if you’d stick it to me when you got uncomfortable. Thank you for passing.”

Phainon only shook his head in silent amusement, still watching his hands work to tuck the excess straps away and tighten the ones lining either shoulder. They sat snug over his chest, positioned just outside either nipple. Which Mydei noticed, and maybe he chose it by design, as his fingers then reached to brush either one.

“Are you comfortable?” He wondered, rubbing over the sensitive buds before pinching lightly. “Do you like it?”

A shaky moan left as his hands attempted to grab his wrists for purchase.

“Do not touch me.” Mydei stopped him, then lightly pulled. “I asked you a series of questions. Put your arms down and answer.”

“I-I… I can’t if you’re—”

“I hear speaking, but I don’t hear answering.” Mydei pulled just a little harder. “Focus.”

“*So co-comfortable!*” He forced himself to say, voice raising when he readjusted his grip to pinch deeper. “They’re fine. I like—*p-please*—it. Thank you for buying them f-for me, master.”

Both sets of fingers let go, giving his chest a break so he could instead rub around to his back and pull him closer. Mydei ducked, planting a kiss to his shoulder before lowering. Down the

middle of his chest and over either heated nipple. Down over his belly and the tickle of hair beneath his navel. Down the elastic and cotton prison that cupped his stiff, aching cock. Through each, he bent over lower and lower until situated on one knee. His hands glided further down, and his eyes flicked up to look at him through his lashes and fluffed bangs.

While staring into one another's eyes, he planted his hands on either cheek of his ass, squeezing tightly and briefly.

"I'm taking these off." One finger then snapped the waistband to his hip. "Try not to knee me in the nose."

"I won't," he chuckled. "I like my master's nose."

"Do you?"

"Yeah. It's handsome," he praised thoughtlessly, lifting leg after leg to take his boxers off completely. "All of your body is attractive to me. I like all of it."

"Give me the second set." Phainon swiped it off of the bed within seconds. "Good boy."

Another belt wrapped around his lower stomach and above either hipbone. There was no test this time, just Mydei fastening the buckle before moving on to the dangling leather around his legs. One by one, he tightened them. Two curled higher up on his body, closer to his groin and ass than anything, and the second actually hugged his thighs. The strap that connected the top two to his stomach tightened to secure them.

Mydei's fingers circled them, adjusting both until they rested beneath either cheek.

"Are you okay?"

"Yes, master."

His hands, stretched around the backs of Phainon's thighs, eased him closer. A soft kiss planted just beneath the left strap, and the right was next, ensuring both legs were treated equally.

Mydei stood up straight and tall after that. When he took a step forward, Phainon took one back to compensate until the bed brushed the back of his knees. Once there, he let himself fall into it.

"Ankle," he demanded.

"H-Huh?"

One hand was held out, and he lifted his leg slowly before resting his ankle over it. A pull straightened his leg out, and Mydei kissed the inner bone before grabbing one of the cuffs left on the bed.

"I'm not adding the chain. Don't look so nervous," he reassured him, then fasted the thick leather around. "Second one."

“What’s it for if not bondage, master?”

“To remind you that you’re mine,” he answered, gently squeezing his calf before setting his leg down. Without being told, Phainon lifted his second leg for him. “Your body is mine, Phainon. *All of you.* I *own* you.”

A kiss was planted on his calf this time, then more trailed to his bare ankle.

“Who do I own?”

“Me,” he repeated, watching as leather encased his body again. “My master owns me.”

“I’m going to ask you a series of questions, and you’re going to answer them as honestly as possible,” Mydei instructed him. “You’re going to speak to me with the utmost respect as you do. I am your *master*, not your *friend*.”

“Yes, master.”

“Do I own that pretty face?” He asked. “Those soft lips and sweet eyes, do they belong to me?”

“I only see my master,” Phainon said, looking him right in the eye when he finished buckling the cuff. “And his title is the only one my mouth ever says.”

“What am I allowed to do with them? What have I *done* to them?”

He gulped over the sparkle lit up in Mydei’s eyes, aware that he was enjoying this display of power more than he’d ever admit out loud. But that was the point of tonight, to make him as in control as he wanted so he could then please *him* as much *he* wanted.

“He’s free to keep making these eyes cry,” he allowed. “He’s free to fuck my mouth when it’s bratty and misbehaves.”

“You’re doing good so far,” he encouraged, pleased by his responses. “Do I own those cute, pink nipples?”

Electricity surged through each nerve, pebbling his skin with goosebumps and making said nipples tingle as they stiffened again. His stomach fluttered, tangled with *nerves* from taking part in something so much more intense than they were used to and *excitement* for what’s to come.

“They belong to my master so he can pinch and pull them,” he offered to him, even if that was what he wanted him to do anyways. “This chest is his to paint red and dress in whatever pleases his eye.”

“Do I own that big, leaking cock and those heavy balls?”

Phainon shot a glance down between his legs briefly, then sucked in a deep breath at the sight of its rosy, wet tip. With a nod, he flicked his attention back up.

“My master decides when they can and can’t cum.”

Mydei reached for his second pair of cuffs, slotting himself between his legs and forcing them to part for his thick waist and hips. He didn’t need to ask again. The hand being held out was filled with a wrist immediately, free to buckle the leather around.

“Do I own these strong arms and hands?”

His fingers twitched when a kiss touched the back of his knuckles. It lingered for a moment, gentle in nature despite the weight of what they were in the middle of.

“My master chooses when these hands can and can’t touch me or him,” he recited. “These hands pour his drinks, and these arms hold him when he needs them to.”

Upon finishing his wrists, he touched his thighs again, hoisting them up and coaxing his body on to his back.

“Do I own these gorgeously thick legs?”

The breath was taken from his lungs over his bare ass being on full display for him. One glance between them and he’d be able to see *everything* about him as clearly as he wanted for as long as he wanted.

But he had a task, to answer these questions being dropped onto him, and he couldn’t give in to the nerves of being so exposed so easily.

“M-My master only needs to call and these legs are rushing right to him.” His voice shook when Mydei’s fingers trailed closer to his bottom, swiping beneath where leather met his skin. “They kneel before him whenever and wherever he asks.”

“Do I own what’s in between them?” Mydei asked much, *much* more carefully than the ones before. “Do I own that plump ass and the hole in between?”

Phainon hesitated, heat burning up his chest, neck, and face as he was laid out before him. Either of his hands held his own harness, gripping it tight while staring up at Mydei.

“I can… give them to you if you want them, master,” he said just as carefully, and Mydei smiled before dragging his hands away.

“I’m done asking questions. You can relax now,” he allowed. “Your willingness and eagerness to surrender every inch of your body pleases me.”

“My master’s desire to own and cherish all of me pleases *me*,” Phainon added after, and Mydei planted a hand into the bed. “You’re always taking care of me.”

“And I always will,” he promised.

One hand lifted off of his outfit to reach the tail end of his braid. His fingertips dangled the golden cuff holding it together, caressed it up and down, swung it side to side, then finally lifted to curl around the plaited locks to grip it. But he didn’t pull. That wasn’t his place.

“How do you feel?” Mydei asked, looking down at him. “Dressed up in leather with me between your legs like this, how is it?”

“I’m nervous,” he confessed, trying not to think of his pants sliding against his bare skin and the weight of each unlocked cuff. “I’m *really* nervous.”

“Do you want to stop?”

“I haven’t said a safeword yet,” he hinted, wanting to keep going, to see him in action coming off the week of praise, encouragement, and reassurances.

Mydei’s eyes crinkled in the corners from the width of his grin, excitement and pride shining within them as he leaned in closer.

“You look so good right now, like you’re wrapped up all sexy just for me to rip into,” he complimented him, fingers slipping under his garters to grope his thighs. They dragged deeply against them, indenting the flesh as if he wanted to pull him apart with his own hands.

Phainon felt his nose brush his as he hummed softly, taking in his words. “Yeah?”

“I want to see the parts of you I haven’t gotten to know yet.” His voice was lowered, rolling rich and deep over his senses. “Specifically, I want to see what you look like as you’re fucked open like a *slut* on that toy and overstimulated.”

“Yeah?” He egged him on again.

“But first, you’re going to look at how sexy you are right now,” he instructed him. “Get on the bed. Sit on your knees and face the mirror by the window.”

Phainon rolled with his help, laying flat on his belly before flicking his gaze up to the mirror he hadn't even realized was there. Between finding Mydei in his leather attire, the buzzing excitement for tonight, and being kissed almost stupid, the last thing he was looking for was that mirror from before.

As they were, Mydei stood behind him, straightening himself out from his leaned over state. His eyes weren’t on the mirror, but on him, watching his back and shoulders as he pushed himself up with his arms first. Then came his knees digging into the mattress one by one, leaving him on all fours in front of him.

Soft fingertips touched his back, lining down his skin before pressing down at the deepest curve of his back. It wasn’t hard or suggestive. He didn’t push or guide him in any way. They were simply there, stroking and caressing, as if encouraging him not to feel shy.

Phainon tried not to think about how his ass was bare and pressed to his leather pants, or the way his cock bobbed and swung while moving around. If he thought too much about it, he’d start to spiral into his mess of nerves, but they just weren’t important right now. If they weren't bad enough to safeword over, then it could wait a little while.

Now was meant for them both, for *pleasure*, and he wanted to feel good. He wanted Mydei to feel good with him.

One of Mydei's hands reached to gently cup beneath his jaw, keeping his chin up as he raised himself to his knees. He carried his weight on them, not wanting the leather to bite into his thighs from actually sitting on his legs. Knees spread, his palms met just before either, holding himself bare and open in front of the mirror across from them.

He was still as handsome as he was in the bathroom, maybe even more so with the rose tinting his pale cheeks and chest now. The fingers pinching his chin moved, instead touching his arms to squeeze the muscle.

"Do you like what you see?" Mydei asked, eyeing his body like it was *art*. Like he could stare at him all day, every day and never get tired of it.

"Yes, master."

"When you stare at yourself, what do you like?"

The leather looked nice and felt familiar against his skin as he started borrowing Mydei's leather jackets since starting this. It was shiny underneath his bedroom lights, popping against his rosy complexion the way his daily choker did. Tight straps emphasized his figure, his waist looked slimmer and his chest looked fuller thanks to the belt beneath.

This black harness matched Mydei's lower half, and his red collar was perfectly designed to mirror his upper body. Red, gold, and black, three of his dominant's favorite colors, and both of them were decked out in it. They may as well have had each other's name printed across the chest with how much they looked like *each other's*.

Without Mydei needing to fix his poor posture, he looked much more confident than the last time they did this. Regardless of how much shorter he physically looked in comparison while kneeling, he didn't *look* like someone weak. Likewise, he didn't *feel* weak or small. Not like before.

That felt nice. That felt *really* nice.

"I like how I look beside you, master," Phainon pointed out. "I like how we both look so much more comfortable to play."

"I do too."

Two hands touched over his chest, slipping beneath the leather to grasp and pull. He moaned softly, unable to tear his eyes away from the way Mydei was freely touching his body. Fingers pinched on his nipples. They tugged and pulled, bouncing his chest to watch it jiggle.

Nails scratched into his legs for purchase, wanting to touch him back but refraining.

"Look at you moaning over having your chest toyed with," Mydei mocked him, and his cock throbbed from another pull. "Do you like when your master plays with this handsome chest for his own pleasure?"

"Yeah," Phainon whined, watching his hands work the rosy skin before looking at his own expression. "Master, I-I like it when you play with my chest. Keep going, please."

“Heh. Like a little slut.”

He nodded quickly in agreement. His head pushed back into his body as he clawed at his knees, hungry for more pleasure. Those hands *should* touch his achy, leaking cock until he shot all over his own chest. They *should* fondle his balls and bury inside of his ass, rubbing and playing with his prostate until he dripped a mess into his blankets.

Mydei *should* be touching all of his body after he did such a thorough job to make him look good just for him.

“Are you a slut?”

Mydei *should* want to touch all of his body if he was so adamant that he owned him from head to toe.

“Yes, master. I’m your slut,” he choked out, then jerked when a sharp snap clapped against his chest. “*Master!*”

Shock and surprise followed the slap planted on his chest, and his cock jerked against his lower stomach from the impact. He felt the tingle, the burn of being smacked, then exhaled heavily over its stinging wake.

It felt *so good*.

“Again,” Mydei demanded, groping his chest after. “What are you?”

“I’m your slut,” he repeated, voice breathy and pleased as his chest trembled. “Master, can you please touch more of me? Can you please touch my cock? Can… Can you please touch my…”

When he hesitated, Mydei nodded in encouragement. “Come on. What else, handsome? Speak with your chest when you speak to me in bed.”

Phainon took a slow, deep breath before looking up at him as he glanced down to meet his gaze.

“Can you please touch my ass?”

The hands on his chest left it alone for a moment, then lowered down his torso to thread through the ivory hairs at the base of his cock. Without breaking eye contact, he pinched the length and dragged his fingers higher.

“I will please every part of your body tonight,” Mydei promised him, gripping the slippery head tightly in a fist before slowly rubbing down. That was when those amber eyes looked away, distracted by his lower half. “*Fuck*, Phainon. You’re a mess down here. I bet you’re so pent up it hurts, aren’t you?”

“Yeah,” he whined, bucking his hips. “The closest I get to touching myself is cleaning myself, master. The last time I finished was… I-I can’t even remember. So, please… Can you please let me cum tonight?”

“How many times can you finish in one session?”

“I-I don’t…” His eyebrows furrowed, jaw dropping when he twisted his wrist. “I’ve done it twice in one sitting. I never tried to do more.”

“I will make you cum twice.” The tone of his voice left no room for arguing. “And if you can, a third.”

Oh.

Oh, so Mydei wanted to kill him?

“I’m calling in to work tomorrow,” Phainon joked, and Mydei laughed as his free hand pinched his cheeks.

“I have water on the nightstand if you need it, so you’ll be okay,” he reassured him. “Sit still for a second.”

Mydei’s hands left his body, and he went back over to his bench silently before grabbing the rest of his things. Things Phainon didn’t even think to look over at because he was so captivated by the sight of them together. His vibrator, his dildo, a bottle of lube, and a towel. They made his cock twitch with excitement, his ass clench with nerves, and his insides warm from how *excited* Mydei was to do this with him.

He placed the towel down, and Phainon crawled over it to protect his sheets from a possible mess.

“I said to sit still.”

He pouted, looking over his shoulder to meet his eyes. “But it’s going to get messy. I’m helping you prepare.”

“Yes, but I said to sit still,” he repeated back. “Do as I say. If I wanted you to think, I’d ask. But until I ask, simply await instructions.”

Phainon nodded, then settled back where he was previously. Hands grabbed at his body, pulling his thighs wider open and guiding his hands behind him. Though he wasn’t cuffed, it clearly meant that he wasn’t supposed to move his hands.

He hooked his fingers into the rings on his ankle cuffs. As Mydei then fisted his aching cock, he moaned softly.

“Look at yourself as I touch you.”

The mirror showed his body spread widely for Mydei’s pleasure, pre-cum glistening over the thick head and his balls heavy beneath. Its surface also showed him grabbing the remote to his pink vibrator before clicking the power button. As it hummed to life on the lowest setting, the remote was tucked into the strap by his waist before steady fingers picked it up.

Mydei brought the toy to his jaw, lightly setting it on the curve so he could hear its motor and feel its trembling. Silicone ghosted over his skin, tickling towards his chin and underneath inch by tantalizing inch.

“I felt that,” a voice whispered when his cock twitched. “Where do you want this, hm? Where should I put this?”

Phainon’s back arched, aroused hot and tingling in his blood as the egg trailed over his collarbones and against his right nipple. While touching the sensitive and raw bud, he panted, shifting in his seat.

“Here?”

“No, master,” he pleaded, then it closed in on the opposite side. “Not there either. I-I want it lower. Please put it lower.”

Mydei pressed it to his left nipple anyway, letting it linger while his other fist pumped his cock faster. The consistent buzz made his stomach flex, hips jerking desperately to silently point out where he wanted it.

“Here?”

The vibrator touched his belly, nearing where the remote was so he could click it higher.

“Strange. Does it get you off to have it on your stomach?” He asked innocently, and Phainon wiggled in an attempt to make him lower it. “Can you cum from this? Are you so slutty that your entire body can make you cum if I hold a vibrator to you? How have you survived this long like *that*, Phainon?”

Groaning, he shook his head before glaring up at his mocking expression. “Master, please put it on my cock. Please turn it up and put it on *m-my-y—!*”

A sharp gasp left his lips when it clicked to its highest setting and pressed right on the underside of his cock. Tucked beneath the head, he rolled it around firmly in his fist while jerking him off as well, both hands working diligently.

“M-Master. Wait. *W-Wait, wait, wait.* I can’t,” he choked pathetically, shaking his hips and trying to pull back. “O-Oh my—*master, please!*”

“Shh… you’ve got it. You asked for it,” Mydei encouraged him, resting his lips over his head and meeting his eyes through the mirror. “Look at you. And you mean to tell me I’m supposed to hold back from a face and a body like *that?* There’s no way…”

Jaw slightly agape to make way for his moans, crimson staining his cheeks from the heat in his body, and eyes darkened with need, he looked like someone else. He wasn’t the sweet, smiling guy in silly photos on his phone, but someone that lived in the depths of Mydei’s secret blog. He looked like *sex* wrapped up in a pretty black and red package.

Mechanical whirs filled the room, shifting and muffling as the egg rubbed and rotated around his leaking tip. A flex tightened his stomach from the pleasure, eyes dropping to watch the

hands working him closer and closer to an orgasm. With how sensitive he was from being denied and teased for so long, Phainon wasn't sure how long he was going to last. Especially when it felt so much better than his own two hands.

Vibrations coursed right through the length of his cock, unrelenting. When he squirmed, Mydei clenched his fist tighter as if to silently demand he settle down. When he got louder, his hands worked that same pace and path, toying with him to milk each sound.

The lips on his head lowered, ducking to his shoulder for a kiss.

“Tell me when you get close,” he ordered, and Phainon whimpered while pulling on the cuffs by his ankles.

“Yes, master. I-I will,” he forced himself to say while thrusting his hips forward. “I might… Oh fuck… *O-Oh f—*”

“So soon?” Mydei teased him, yet he looked so pleased by his lack of composure. It *excited* him to wreck this kind of havoc into his body. “You haven’t even lasted more than a minute. Hold out just a little bit longer, okay?”

Phainon bit back his whine. “Can I at least move my h-hands, master?”

They itched to grab him. His fingers wanted to grip his hands and clutch them tightly, to feel them flex and shift as they worked to please him. His nails wanted to dog into flesh, not pull against metal and leather.

There were no chains stopping him…

“Not right now. Keep them there.”

But his dominant said otherwise. Each word shackled his hands to his ankles, forcing him to grip them just as tightly. Metal clicked from his pull, rattling with his trembling hold as his body tightened, released, and repeated the cycle.

“Are you really close?” Mydei asked playfully, and he nodded quickly. “Awh, my poor prince…”

The hand gripping the length of his cock lifted, leaving only the one clutching the vibrator. Instead, it planted against his stomach, feeling each breath push it out and each flex suck it in. He tapped it firmly, following each movement after tucking a few fingers into the belt below his navel.

“Look at me.”

Their eyes met through the glass, and a tighter grip wrapped around him. It shoved the egg even harder into his sensitive body, rattling right through him until even his chest trembled to breathe.

“Please,” he gasped, squirming as his cock twitched pathetically. “Please, master. P-Please, can I… *Oh God*… can I please cum for you? I’m so close. I’m so—I can’t h-hold it. I can’t

—!”

Mydei groaned softly, watching him fight to hold out as long as physically possible with a satisfied glint in his eye. He watched him like that night in bed when he clamped his chest, then again like that afternoon in his bedroom when he touched his bare skin, hungry for more. More twitching from pleasure. More trembling from being overwhelmed. More tears building inside of his wide, hazy eyes without his control. Just… *more*.

They burned in the corners as his lungs ached, working overtime to keep up with his quickening gasps.

“Alright,” Mydei caved, smiling as his amber gaze raked over his body. “Come on, Phainon. Let go for me, handsome.”

Both hands pulled harder on the cuffs. Either knee went to pinch shut, but a quick thinking hand went and pulled the right one back. His body dropped, sitting lower on his knees as he tilted his head further back into Mydei’s body. Leather bit into the expanding muscle of his thighs, and it forced him back upright before he crumbled again anyway.

Tear-filled eyes closed tightly as his orgasm crept closer and closer, faster and faster, and bigger than any he had ever had before.

“Thank you," he barely managed to force out. “Thank y-you, master. Master, tha-ank—!”

His toes curled. His fists closed tightly around the rings he pulled. Breathy, pleased cries fell from his lips as he rambled ‘*master*’ over and over, louder and louder, unable to force another word out.

“That’s it…” Mydei’s low voice whispered into his ear as he opened his fist to let the tip peek through. “You waited so long for this, didn’t you? I know you did.”

Phainon fought against the hand holding his leg involuntarily, wanting nothing more than to have some kind of control when he felt this vulnerable. The toy dragged lower to sit neatly against him, flushed beneath the underside and held down by two firm fingers. That first shot of cum painted over his own stomach, droplets shooting over the skin messily. A second, weaker pump splattered lower by belly button when he fucked his hips forward jerkily.

“Good boy. Let it all out,” he praised him, loosening his grip as more oozed into his palm and over his knuckles. Phainon felt it dripping over himself and squishing between them when he was given a light tug.

“O-Off,” he hiccuped, voice laced with desperation. His braced hips tried to fight the incessant vibrations over his spent cock, but it didn’t help him any. “Master, p-please tu-urn it off. Please take it o-off. *Please!*”

Mydei eased his fist open, taking the toy and letting it buzz away from his twitching, pulsing body.

“You did so well,” he praised him, and a pressure pressed to his waist before the buzzing stopped completely. “And you came so much. My hand’s drenched in it.”

One eye slowly lifted as he looked down rather than at the mirror. His head lolled forward weakly, exhausted from that singular orgasm.

Milky seed streaked over his knuckles and the pink vibrator, and he watched as it was brought closer and towards Mydei’s mouth. Turning his head, he watched him flick his tongue over his fingers, gathering the mess before swallowing with a pleased hum.

“My… My master’s one of the people who likes the taste of cum,” he panted, slumped into his chest. As he spoke, Mydei then used the towel to wipe them both off. Before the messy toy touched his sheets, it was also wiped off.

“Consider the fact it tastes different from person to person,” he reminded him.

“You like *mine*,” he corrected himself, not giving himself the chance to think about someone else. Just the *idea* was enough to alert him from his exhaustion.

“So there’s still a brain inside that pretty head…” Mydei hummed, using his free hand to grasp his chest and give it a tight squeeze. “Use it to tell me how you like to fuck yourself.”

“… Huh?” He asked dumbly, not sure if he heard him right the first time.

“I said, tell me your favorite position to be in when you fuck yourself,” Mydei repeated. “If you leave it up to me, I’ll get creative. I’ll put you on your chest with your legs open in a split. If you don’t like the sound of that, tell me what makes you most comfortable.”

“Not sure I’m *that* flexible anymore anyway.” He tried to laugh, but Mydei didn’t seem particularly interested in playing along.

“Perhaps I should make you stretch more until you can bend the way I’d like you to.”

“My master’s got… uh… extreme fantasies,” Phainon commented as a kiss pressed to the top of his head. “Training me to suck you off better, pushing my body to its limits, making me take yoga to be more flexible…”

The worst part was that *if* he found the time, *if* he had the room to do it, he wouldn’t mind getting into the habit of stretching his body like that. He’d try it out. All he had to lose was not liking it.

Mydei kissed lower, skipping down his play collar to the golden chain around his neck. He kissed the lock. The pressure pushed its pill-shaped body into his skin.

“I’d take the middle one out of those ‘*fantasies*’,” he advised him. “That’s not just something I think about in passing when I’m fired up. Phainon, that’s what I think every day now. I want to see your limits, and that’s what I’m doing.”

He sighed in pleasure, shoulders shifting when his lips touched skin next.

“On your stomach. I’m going to—”

“Master, I… mm… I don’t wanna do it like that.” Mydei nodded, giving him a chance to elaborate. “I don’t think I have a favorite, but I have one that I usually do if I’m not in the shower.”

“Show me, handsome. Teach me how you like it,” he encouraged him, letting his body go so he could move freely. But his lips lingered for one more kiss, this time right where his leather collar touched his shoulder.

Slowly, his thighs eased together.

“Can I move my hands?”

“Yes.”

He let go of himself and the cuffs, shifting in his spot so he could face Mydei instead. Thighs parted and legs bent at the knee, he opened himself up before bringing one cuffed wrist down to block his view of his ass.

“Do you need a pillow?” Mydei offered while folding over the towel before tucking it beneath his body. Before he could even respond, a few were piled up for his head to rest on.

Phainon laid his head down and wiggled stiffly in front of him, shy.

“You look handsome like this, Phainon,” he praised him, touching his thighs and pulling gently on the leather dressing them. They were pulled open wider, allowing Mydei to fit between them when he leaned. “Relax.”

“I am.”

“You’re tense,” he stated, then pressed a kiss to his chest. “I’ve got you.”

Soft moans fell from his lips as a hot tongue traced over his sensitive nipple, swirling and flicking before biting down gently. Just when his back arched and fingers reached to pull on his long hair, Mydei released it to suck instead.

“Your teeth are sharp…”

“Does it hurt?”

“No, bu—*u-uh*—t!” His voice broke when Mydei bit down again, softer than before. “You’re being mean to my body.”

He looked up at him, then pinched his opposite nipple.

“‘*Mean*’…” The word was tasted on his tongue first, said as if he couldn’t believe it, then swallowed. “You love your chest being played with, so don’t give me that lip right now. You *always* like being bathed in attention.”

He brought himself towards the other side of his chest and took his nipple into his mouth, lapping at and sucking just like before. While drenched in spit, his teeth closed around it, causing his breaths to hitch and his legs to squirm.

"*Your* attention," he mumbled, and Mydei's left hand cupped his chest to squeeze. "I like having *my master's* attention."

Mydei didn't respond. All he did was bite down briefly, the sharp pinch just long enough to make him cry out before he let go. After, his body peeled itself back to look into his eyes.

"Do you know what I'm going to do next?" He asked him, dragging his hands down his sides before pulling on the leather connecting his garters together.

"Are you going to get me ready for my toy?" He assumed. "Fingers first, right?"

Mydei nodded, and Phainon glanced at the bottle of lube beside them before meeting his eyes again.

"Okay." He took a deep breath, then reached an arm behind his left knee to pick it up higher. "This… is how I do it."

Mydei grasped his leg for him, bringing it over his shoulder so he could plant a kiss right against his cuffed ankle. With the weight supported, he let go and then looked at his hands unsurely.

"What do I do if you're doing all of this, master?" He wondered, watching him reach for the lube and then drizzle a bit over his hand.

"You lay there and allow me to make you feel good."

That was easier said than down as he awkwardly placed his hands to the sheets. Nails scratched into the fibers, scraping loudly into the quiet of the bedroom.

"You know I'd never think any less of you," Mydei brought up casually, gently, as his glistening fingers lowered.

"I know."

"And you know that it isn't a problem for me to provide you with pleasure in any way you enjoy," he added while rubbing his thigh slowly.

"I-I know, master."

Mydei watched him in return, bringing his slick fingertips right up against dry skin. They made Phainon look away when he felt them slip past either cheek, nervous. With his heart racing wildly against his ribs, his legs spread wide open, and someone else's hands on his body in a place no one has ever touched before, he wanted to run, to laugh, to say something to shift the sudden anxiety in his body.

Heat burned under his face. A wobble trembled his lips before they tightened into a line between his teeth.

Just as he was about to cover his face with one stretched open palm, Mydei reached to grab him by the cuff.

“Don’t do that,” he said, and a flutter filled his stomach. “I *want* to do this, you know.”

“Yeah?”

“Yes,” he reassured him. “I know I wasn’t always honest with what I wanted sexually, and it hurt you to think I didn’t want to do certain things to you, but I… I did.”

His fingers curled into a fist as he processed what he was admitting to.

“I wanted to touch you that night while you were cuffed to my bed. I wanted to see you cry, beg, and scream. I wanted it to hurt just a little bit to see if you could take it,” he confessed. “Right now, I want to watch what you look like getting fucked, Phainon.”

Phainon gulped when he felt his middle finger trace around the rim of his ass, circling slowly.

“I want so badly to feel you clench around my fingers as I play with your prostate,” Mydei added, and a deeper heat burned underneath his cheeks over his unrestrained speech. “I’m looking forward to seeing you cum from having your ass filled.”

And yet he never pushed his finger in, still just slicking the hole while watching, waiting.

“It’s not if you *want* it or not right now, it’s that I’m actually doing it,” he said back. “I can’t believe that I want it too.”

“Then ask.”

“Can you please uh…” The words felt so strange in his head, let alone his mouth. “Mm… Can you please put y-your fingers in, master?”

With that, Mydei slowly eased his middle finger inside of him, pushing into his tight insides. When he tried to move, he was pulled back by his leg. As he attempted to squirm, a look was shot his way as if to demand that he relax.

But it was difficult to try as he took a deep breath.

Mydei’s finger was in his ass.

It was so much different from doing this on his own. His wrist wasn’t twisted to dig in deeper, and he wasn’t in control of how it moved. There was also a minuscule size difference, as his were a little bit more slender while Mydei’s felt thicker while stretching him open.

As if he couldn’t stand to see him still so tense, the hand on his leg moved deeper to grip his cock. In doing so, he pinned his leg between his body and arm, locking it in place.

A tug made Phainon bite his lip, and another forced him into a moan.

“Don’t hide.”

He clenched around him from pleasure, and Mydei groaned quietly.

“You’re tight,” he told him while lightly curling his finger. “But you’re doing such a good job, my prince. If you want me to take it out, just tell me.”

“*Don’t*,” he rushed, and one eyebrow lifted over his demanding tone. “I mean, please don’t take it out, master. Please continue.”

“Continue what?”

He hummed. “Please keep s-stretching me open, master.”

Mydei seemed to accept that answer as he pulled back and pushed in again. It rubbed and massaged against his walls before repeating the notion, coaxing him to relax.

“Have you thought about this before?” Phainon asked, but he couldn’t bring himself to meet his eyes. Instead, he focused on his leather clad torso, eyeing the nice material and shining gold. “Has my master thought about playing with m-my ass?”

“Yes.”

Mydei then brought a second finger to his hole, lightly massaging the rim as a warning. He watched as Phainon’s eyebrows pinched when pushing it in, listened as his breaths hitched from the sudden stretch, felt as his body trembled from the depth they slowly inched towards.

Phainon felt his attention envelope him, washing over him completely as if everything about him in this moment was his to control. If he liked that sound of his stuttered breath, he wrenched another out by hooking his fingers. If he didn’t like the look of his scrunched expression, he slowed down and steadied himself for a moment. His body was Mydei’s, *inside* as much as out, and he was enjoying every second of owning him completely.

Especially when he bumped his fingers upwards, and his body gave a jerk from pleasure.

It seemed Mydei liked that reaction as he then did it again just to feel his cock twitch and hear him moan. And again. And again.

Fuck.

“Master,” he choked out, one hand reaching to hold Mydei’s arm and the other still gripping the sheets. “Please.”

“Please what, handsome? I’m not doing anything special,” he teased him, rubbing firmly just to watch his legs twitch and hips shift. “What are you begging for now, hm? You have it all and you still want more?”

“I-I wanna cum again,” he told him. “Please. If you keep playing with that spot while… while touching me, I’m gonna… *a-ah!*”

Those two fingers continued toying with his prostate, rubbing until his cock ached pathetically all over again. Each thrust was electric, jolting through his body with nothing but pleasure. Every scissor of his fingers and twist to open him up only made him more excited to finally, finally get his toy inside of him. How long has it been since he last did this? Too long if he couldn’t remember it, probably.

“Greedy,” Mydei accused, voice low and thick. “Who’s touching you, Phainon?”

“M-My master is. He’s…” Phainon cried when his fist tightened around his cock. “He’s making me feel so good…”

“Ask for the toy.”

“Can you please fuck me?” He begged, and Mydei’s hands slowed for a moment. Then, they stopped.

“*With the dildo*,” he pressed after, eyes narrowed down at him when they met. “You need to be more specific. Don’t just say things that can be taken out of context.”

Phainon pulled on his arm as he slipped himself free from his ass, allowing his fingers to lower from arm to wrist, then wrist to sticky fingers. He held them, palm to palm, while taking a deep breath to prepare.

“Can you please fuck me with my toy?” He corrected himself, and Mydei nodded.

“There you go.”

Their hands broke apart, and Mydei picked the purple toy beside him up before reaching for the lube. Phainon watched him drizzle it, massage the it around, then bring it towards his sticky, winking hole. The tip was fuller than his two fingers, and he knew the feeling of it well, but to have it in Mydei’s hands made him both nervous and excited.

Would he fuck him slowly? Quickly? Would he be gentle with how hard he pushed it in? Or did he want to be rough?

Phainon was never particularly *rough* or *hard* with his body. Most of the time, just pumping it a few times until he finished in his fist was enough for him. He didn’t need to lay there and just thrust into himself like a mad man, as the goal was to *get off* not really *get fucked*.

Would Mydei *fuck him* or simply *get him off?*

The head popped in slowly, plump and blunt, and his eyes fluttered shut as Mydei carefully pushed it deeper. His head tilted back into the pillows, and his jaw dropped for a silent gasp.

It felt so different without the condom on. The textures were flush against his walls, pushing against them rather than muted behind latex. He used them to keep clean up easy, yet suddenly he was starting to wonder if it was ever worth the hassle.

“You’re so handsome…” Mydei groaned quietly, his voice far away as he watched him react. “Does it feel that good from just putting it in, Phainon?”

He nodded quickly, feeling as the silicone balls soon kissed his skin. It wasn’t necessarily long, not like Mydei himself, but it was enough to knock the breath from his lungs. Even more so while grinding up against his sensitive insides and brushing over his prostate.

“Good job,” he coo’ed, letting him adjust to being filled. “I’ve got it balls deep, and you’re leaking a mess all over yourself like you *need* to be filled up. Did you miss this? Did my poor little prince miss having his ass full?”

Another nod rattled his head.

“Touch yourself.”

Both hands cupped his chest, playing with his own body as Mydei did the same. Fingers tweaked his sore nipples, and they gently rolled them between his thumb and index.

“Just like that,” Mydei praised him. Then, he chuckled. “Mm… That’s my good little slut.”

The degrading name was emphasized with a shallow thrust. As he did, his opposite hand went back to jerking him off slowly and tightly.

“I’ve got a front row seat to your tight ass gripping this toy too…” His voice was so distracted as he began to slowly fuck him. “It’s not even that big, but you’re holding it like you don’t want to let it go or let it in.”

Gentle reels back made his rim feel as if it were being pulled out. Slow eases made it feel as if it were being pushed in on itself. Mydei fucked him carefully, hyper focused on the way his ass swallowed the rubber up to speed up. Not that Phainon minded this pace as each slide in brought him closer and closer to the edge again.

“It *is* big,” he defended his choice in sex toys. “It feels good.”

“It’s not as big as I am,” Mydei pointed out, and, well, he had a point. “Your ass wouldn't be able to take me if *this* is already too much for you.”

Phainon didn’t respond. Instead, he thought about it, about his dominant unbuttoning his pants, pulling himself free, and replacing the dildo with his own cock. Thick, hot, and long, he’d force him open even further than this toy, all while giving him the skin to skin contact he was beginning to enjoy.

Maybe fleshlights were textured inside, or vibrators were fun to mess around with, but Mydei’s fist and mouth felt better than them. Maybe being told he was handsome felt nice inside of his warmed cheeks, but having his body kissed and caressed like it was meant to be worshipped was even better than that. Maybe thinking about Mydei was comforting, sexy, and exciting, but being in his presence, his sight, and his touch was another thing completely.

He wanted him.

Phainon wanted him so badly that just the thought of being opened up on his cock was making his stomach tighten. It made his thighs flex and ass clench.

“More,” he pleaded him, hoping to drown the thought of *Mydei* fucking him instead. “Master, please fuck me faster.”

Maybe he could go back to that nice, floaty place where everything felt blissful and free. Maybe he would get too sensitive from this and reject the possibility of them crossing that line together.

Maybe…

But then Mydei obliged, moving his wrist faster pump by pump. The loud, wet squelches of the toy sinking repeatedly into him filled the room, and the stiff, jelly balls brushed his ass firmly. It was faster than he ever went, and it felt *so good.*

“Do you like having your ass fucked like this?” Mydei taunted him. “Naughty prince has never taken a real cock before, but he moans so prettily and plays so well with his little toys. Come on, be louder for me. What else do you want?”

Him.

Him. Him. Him.

He wanted *Mydei*. He wanted Mydei so badly that it *hurt*.

“*Yeah!*” He cried, pitched from the rush. “Please fuck me. Please fuck me like… like you would if it were *you* inside of me.”

Upon pulling it back, Mydei then *shoved* forward.

His entire body jumped, stomach feeling as if it had been punched right through from the force. It made his thighs and ass ripple, then his hands dropped to the sheets for purchase.

“Do you hear yourself?”

Again. Mydei slammed it into him again, palm holding the toy as deep as physically possible as Phainon panted deeply.

“Begging me like a *whore* to fuck you even though you know that I can’t,” he accused him. “Are you enjoying this? Do you enjoy torturing me?”

“I-I wanna cum.” His cock throbbed pitifully inside of Mydei’s fist, and his balls drew tight with need. “Please make me cum like this, master. I wanna cum while you’re fucking me.”

A quiet and shaky groan followed, one he just barely heard over his own voice.

“You make it so fucking hard, Phainon…” Mydei said underneath his breath. Afterwards, he took a deep breath. “Come on, handsome. Show me how much you love being fucked.”

Phainon's hips lifted off of the bed when he began pumping his cock faster and tighter. His wrist twisted when dragging down, and his other angled to bump the tip right up against his prostate before sliding in deep. There wasn't anywhere to go, or any space to catch his breath between either. Forwards or backwards, up or down, there was only pleasure so good that the colors behind his eyelids were swirling, vibrant, and new.

"Can I please cum, master?" He asked the moment the rush began to build faster and deeper, aware that if he asked too late, he'd finish before he got a response. "Please? I'm… I can't…—"

"Yes, my prince," Mydei allowed. "Give me one more orgasm. Show me how good you can be for me."

Lips pressed to the leg propped over Mydei's chest, kissing just beneath the edge of the cuff when his ankle shifted. His toes curled deep, body shaking in its entirety as his insides repeatedly fluttered around the toy.

"I'm gonna cum," he rushed to say. "I'm gonna cum. *I-I'm gonna—!*"

"Go on, Phainon. Cum for me," he pushed. "Be a good little boy and give your master *all* of your pleasure."

Phainon nodded quickly, senselessly, unable to control his own body. All he knew was that this was a lot. The pace, the power, the steadiness to continue both even as he was pushed over the edge, it was so much to take.

By now, his hands would have slowed down. His brain and body would reject the overstimulation and stop to focus on his release. But Mydei kept going, milking the explosive release by continuing to stuff him full with the toy and jerking his pulsing cock.

Phainon's voice was just shy of a scream as he felt his own cum paint across his stomach again. With his eyes screwed even tighter shut and back arched high off of the bed, he couldn't focus on a thing but the overwhelming pleasure wracking through his body. Tears pinched in the corners of his eyes, rolling down the sides of his face and into his hair without control. Sweat did the same, beading stickily over his skin before dripping down his skin.

Sharp twitches trembled through his figure as Mydei slowed down, easing his pace and grip until there was nothing at all. The hand on his cock stopped, and the toy inside of him stilled for him to squeeze around.

"That was a powerful one." An amused voice chuckled after, muffled slightly from the ringing in his ears. "Can you hear me?"

"Mm…"

Phainon jerked when his dildo inched out of him slowly, carefully. When freed, he missed the feeling of having it inside of him.

His eyes fluttered open as two hands gently held his thighs, thumbs digging in to massage them carefully. They then grasped his calves and squeezed to ease some of the tension left.

“I need you to talk to me. Look at me, then tell me you can hear me,” Mydei instructed him firmly. “Stay with me, Phainon. How do you feel?”

“Mouth… dry…” He admitted, turning his head to try and shake some of the fog away as he still needed to focus.

“Sit up a little bit for me.”

Mydei’s hands lowered, sliding up his sides before gently helping him sit up. One stayed by his back, and the other cupped his head until he had the strength to hold it up.

“Cute,” he murmured to him, and Phainon’s nose scrunched as he looked up at him. “You’re cute when you slip. Phainon, can you say something for me?”

“Thank y-you for making me cum,” he said shakily, eyes half-lidded and lips parted for a heavy pant. “Are you really gonna m-make me do it again, master?”

“Yes, one more time,” he told him, then reached for a bottle of water. It was brought behind him to crack its seal, and Phainon parted his lips for a drink. “I want one more from you, can you do that for me?”

He shrugged while drinking.

“I don’t like that answer. Try again.”

The bottle was pulled away, and he took a deep breath through his nose before nodding. This time, Mydei seemed more pleased with his response.

“I can try, master, but… I’d really like to please you too,” he admitted to him, then watched him cap the drink to put it back. “In fact, I need to ask you something.”

His eyebrow raised. “Yes?”

Before reason could seep in, before his second doubts could kick in, he smiled.

“Can you… C-Can we…” He struggled to get out, but Mydei only nodded in encouragement to continue. “Master, if I make it so hard for you to hold back, if I say it’s okay, can’t we try… *it?*”

“Try what?”

With his body propped up on his elbows, Mydei brought his hand to his collar before pulling him closer. Nose to nose, Phainon tilted closer to him, trapped within his amber gaze.

“I want you,” he said quietly, speaking the damning words that haunted him day in and day out. Tonight, they were the loudest it's ever been. “Not a-a toy. Not your fingers. *You*.”

“I can’t,” Mydei shut him down, then planted a kiss on his lips. “I can’t do that to you. You’d feel so good, but I shouldn’t.”

His eyes widened from the rejection, not having expected it when he was used to getting everything he wanted tonight. His mouth stilled, unable to kiss him back as he tried to fight the chill of his nerves.

“B-But you want it…” He whispered. The sound of Mydei’s voice was clear in his head, and he had said those exact words, right? “I want it too. Why can’t we just give in?”

“I can’t keep giving in to these selfish desires. I’m not learning from my mistakes if I do, Phainon,” Mydei explained gently. “I need to put you first. You didn’t want that before.”

“I do *now*, and you do too,” he repeated, causing the other man to go silent. “Master, *green*.”

“Phainon…”

“Please,” he tried again. “Can you please fuck me, master?”

A shaky breath fanned over his mouth. “I-If I push you too much, it's going to end up like before. I don’t want you to think poorly of us both,” Mydei reasoned.

“If anyone’s going to be the first person to do it, I want it to be my master,” Phainon insisted, and those golden eyes above him widened slightly. “There is no one else I’d ever let touch me like this, so if it’s not you, it’s no one.”

The fingers in his collar pulled harder, and he shifted to push his hands into the bed so he could sit up more. Their chests brushed, buckles clicking with buckles and skin touching skin.

“You’re killing me,” Mydei whispered while glancing down between them. “Do you know that? I made you a promise that we didn’t need to do this, yet here I am about to go back on it.”

He hummed quietly. “It kills you to want me…?”

“Ask me again.” There was a hint of desperation in his voice, as if he both *wanted* him to do it again but was *dreading* to hear it once more. “If you really mean it, say it one more time for me.”

“Can you please fuck me, master?” Phainon repeated.

Lips immediately pressed to his own again, but this time, he kissed him back just as passionately, needing to feel as close as possible to him. The force was enough to make him lean back on his tired arms, smothered in his presence.

“Touch me,” Mydei demanded in between their kisses, and his hands moved.

Back now to the mattress, Phainon grabbed at his skin and his harness, pulling him closer until they were both on the edge of his bed. One hand cupped his chest, and the other

wrapped around his arm to squeeze on the muscle. Fingers pushed in deeply, gripping him for purchase as teeth bit down tightly on his bottom lip to peel it back.

Lips parted, he let Mydei's tongue press against his own, tasting his spit. His hands continued exploring, wrapping around his back to claw at his shoulders and down his spine. They traced along his harness, following the intricate pattern before spinning to touch his hips and stomach. Everywhere he could get his hands on, he tried.

Hums vibrated between their mouths, pleased by the scratch of his nails into skin. A leather clad knee kept his legs spread, and he hoisted both over his thighs comfortably.

When pulling away, spit strung between them.

"Tell me you want me, Phainon."

Phainon cupped his face within his hands finally, thumbs gently caressing his cheeks. "I want you, and I don't want anyone else to ever have this from me. *Please*," he obeyed.

There was no response as Mydei leaned back and unbuttoned his pants, just the rush of him speedily dragging his zipper made his stomach buzz excitedly. Tangled within it were nerves, but they were muted heavily beneath the weight of his desire.

Seeing Mydei like this, with his cock pulled free from his black pants and his body adorned in leather, made his heart skip. To have his amber eyes on him like he was the only thing that mattered, made his skin tingle. Feeling his hot hands glide down his body, pull him by his own get up, and tug on his half-hard cock made him want *more*.

More. More. More.

If Phainon was being vulnerable, and if he was going this far with Mydei, he wanted it *all*. Every ounce he had to give, he wanted for himself no matter how selfish it was.

He wanted to make sure he was the *last* person to ever be beneath Mydei again.

The hands on his body left, and Phainon watched him take himself into his hand before squeezing tightly. Flushed a deep red and leaking, it looked almost painful to be so aroused yet so untouched until now. Not once had Mydei touched himself all night from what he knew, too focused on giving him all the orgasms and attention he could ever want.

"I should probably grab a condom to make cleaning up easier," Mydei mumbled, fisting himself a few times before looking at his messy palm. "I'm a mess now too…"

"Or… you can *not* leave me here," he brought up. "It takes too long to walk all the way over there, unlock your things, put it on, then come back."

"You got me once, but you're not getting me again, brat," Mydei told him while standing up. "If we're doing this, we're doing it *my* way. We can be messy, dirty, and all those other things some other time."

"My master wants to make my first time special?"

“I’ll be back.”

Phainon laughed to himself, half in amusement and half in nervousness. One arm draped over his face, and the other touched his leather collar before pulling on the ring. It clicked and clinked when he jostled it, reminding himself that he was *here*, in *Mydei’s bed*, about to *lose his virginity* all over again.

Why wasn’t it as nerve wracking as he thought it’d be? Where was all the doubt, concern, and confusion that once riddled his thoughts almost incoherent?

Why was he *ever* that scared of this in the first place?

Heavy boots thumped against the wooden floors, signaling Mydei’s return. Upon looking at him, he was rolling it lower before giving himself a quick jerk. Moments after, he grabbed the lube from the bed and rubbed it over himself.

“You’re very… strict with certain things,” he pointed out, and Mydei pressed his knees into the bed.

“First times should be like this—clean, comfortable, and with someone you trust,” Mydei reasoned, and as juvenile as a belief that was, his heart fluttered.

They weren’t sixteen. They weren’t learning or experiencing sex for the very first time after having a sex ed class. Mydei had just finished scrambling his insides with a toy, made him orgasm twice, and has sucked him off plenty of times in the past. There was no need to act as if he was this innocent man that needed to be taken care of like he was made of glass.

But it was sweet how much he cared. It was right from the heart, as he seemed to truly believe this was how his first time with a man should go. How could he be mad?

“You’re romantic without even trying,” he teased, bringing his arms around Mydei’s neck when he leaned over his body. “Thank you for taking care of me, master.”

“It’s not ‘*romantic*’ to care about you,” he protested. “I’m trying to exercise some restraint. I’d love nothing more to slide in raw and fill you up, but I need to be good. That’s the least I could do.”

Phainon shivered over the thought, and Mydei leaned down to kiss beside his ear.

“What? Do you like the sound of that?” He whispered right into his ear. “Do you like the thought of being fucked raw and pumped full with my cum?”

He nodded weakly, then jumped when he felt the thick, lubed head of his cock brush against his ass. Nails scratched down Mydei’s neck and shoulders, pulling him in closer.

“Beg.” The demand was short and sweet, as was the kiss just above his leather collar.

“Please, master.” Phainon opened his legs wider and pushed against him. “Can you please put it inside? Can you please make me cum with your cock? I-I want it so badly. I want to be yours so badly it hurts.”

“I’ll make it better.”

Mydei pulled back, looking down between them as he carefully pressed forward. He touched him carefully, holding his hip as the other guided himself.

Phainon’s hands grabbed his biceps and upper arms, digging into the muscle as his teeth bit hard into the inside of his lips. Instead of watching him slide into his own body, he watched the way Mydei’s jaw dropped and his eyes fixated on his ass stretching to accommodate him.

Slowly, carefully, his sensitive walls gave way his stiff and thick cock, pulled apart by his steady push.

“Oh f-fuck,” Mydei choked, pinching his hip tighter as he sucked in a sharp breath. “Phainon, you’re so damn *tight*.”

Tears brimmed his eyes. The overwhelming sense of being filled with a real cock, especially one as big as Mydei, for the first time made his stomach knot and walls clamp down tighter involuntarily. In turn, that only made both of them gasp.

“*H-Hah*… How are you feeling?”

“Fine. It’s… It’s fine,” he answered stiffly, causing Mydei to look into his eyes. “It doesn’t hurt.”

“Listen when I speak. *How are you feeling?*” He repeated, firmer this time, and Phainon shook his head as his lip trembled. “Do you need a second?”

His head shook again as he pulled his arms closer, wanting to feel his body right over his own.

“Is that all you need? To feel my body on you? Oh… You’re okay, Phainon," Mydei said softly.

He brought an arm flat to the bed so he could slip his palm beneath his head, giving Phainon the closeness that he craved. Curling his fingers, he cradled him gently, thumb to his earlobe and fingers tucked into sweaty hair. There, he rubbed, attempting to soothe his wobbled lips.

“I’ve got you, okay? Just look at me and focus on feeling good.” Soft lips pressed against his heated cheek. “You’re doing so well, and I’m so proud of you, my prince.”

Phainon closed his eyes while listening to his sweet praise, allowing the words to wash over him and quell the tickle of nerves in his gut. Once they did, lips then touched to his clumpy lashes and wet eyelid for a chaste kiss next.

“Master,” he forced himself to say while scratching down Mydei’s arms. “C-Can you kiss me when you move?”

The mouth on his eye lowered to his lips, and he kissed him back quickly. As he did so, Mydei pulled back gently and shallowly thrusted himself forward. It was only a couple of inches, yet it made his whole body jerk anyway.

Even through the sharp, muffled whimper, Mydei kissed him deeper. He kept his fingers deep into his hair to hold his scalp lightly. The other held on to his thigh, thumbing over where the leather garter touched his skin.

Another gentle rock made his stomach jump. A third made his breaths skip as he turned his head.

“You’re okay,” Mydei promised him, and he nodded quickly while repeating it to himself in silence. “There you go. Thank your master for the pleasure if it feels good, Phainon. Remember your manners.”

“Th-Thank you, master. Thank you for fucking me,” he choked out, back arching off the bed from how deep he was being stretched open. “Thank you f-for taking care of me.”

His soft chuckle warmed Phainon’s chest, and a warm kiss to his jaw made his walls clamp down around him.

“Ah ah. Where are you going?” Mydei taunted when he tried to turn his head even further. “How can I kiss you if you’re running away from me, hm? Come back. There’s no running from me.”

He was right.

There was no running from Mydei, or swallowing his feelings down, especially when they were in bed together doing things friends definitely did *not* do. His dominant would always find a way to make everything come back up, to reach inside of him and bring his secrets to light. The things he liked, the things he never knew he could want but did, and the flurry of emotions in his chest were all his. His chest full of warmth, his stomach full of butterflies, and his head full of nothing but desire belonged to him, to *Mydei*.

It wasn’t just his body. It was his thoughts, his feelings, his actions, his *everything*.

When he spoke, pieces of Mydei were in the way he tried to bite his tongue sometimes. When he dressed, glimpses of Mydei were in his black jeans and leather watch. When he was simply existing, Mydei was there encouraging him to keep his head up and his nerves down.

There was never any running. There was no point in hiding.

Eye to eye, Phainon felt his bottom lip tremble at the thought of having to *ever* find someone else to trust this much.

“Please don’t find another guy to do this with,” he whispered, and Mydei’s eyebrows furrowed as he stilled his hips. “Please don’t stop being my master.”

“I don’t want anyone else.”

“Only me?”

“Only my *sweet*…” Mydei thrusted himself forward, ripping a loud moan from his bitten-raw lips. “… *little*…” Another made Phainon's eyes roll back. “… *prince*.”

“M-Mast—”

“Heh… I don't know what you’ve got going on in that pretty head, but if it’s got nothing to do with what we’re doing, it doesn’t matter,” he told him. “You need to focus on *us*, on *pleasure*. Nothing else matters, understand?”

Phainon nodded as lips pressed to his own again. “Mm… Nothing else matters…” He mumbled back.

“Who am I?”

“My master.”

Mydei nodded as he raised one hand to push the back of his bent knee upwards instead.

“What’s your master doing, Phainon?”

“Fucking m-me,” he answered, voice cracking with another push inside of him. “My master’s fucking me.”

“There you go.”

Phainon’s breaths picked up as each thrust became faster, jaw dropped for a moan every time Mydei’s hips connected to his ass. Leather tapped against his skin firmly, the result of him not pulling his pants off all the way.

“You’re so damn pretty when you get all teary eyed like that,” Mydei groaned, eyeing his face for a moment before leaning down. “I… I want to…”

He kissed the trail of tears from the corner of his eyes again gently. The touch was feather light and almost sweet, but when he pulled away, he paused to drag the tip of his tongue over his glistening lips. When tasting the salty tears, he exhaled shakily.

“Mm… That’s not enough. I want more, Phainon,” he told him, breathless. “I want to go faster.”

“*Please*.”

Mydei pulled back. Sitting on his knees, he planted a palm down in the middle of his chest before lifting his leg higher up. With the added space, a deep and slow grind smashed his balls right up against his slick ass.

While completely seated on his cock, Phainon’s sharp and stuttered cry filled the room. The tip of his cock felt as if it was inside of his stomach, and each time he pumped his hips forward, it was like he was forcing his body to make room for him. Mydei was *going* to make him take it all, and he just *needed* to accept that.

It wasn’t *hard*, but it was so much more than he was used to. Being pinned down, being held in this position as Mydei fucked into him, was so much more than just pumping a toy inside

of himself. There was no heat, no stiffness, no hands, no body, no nothing. It didn't have Mydei's scent or size, and it didn't lick his tears while telling him how good he was doing.

Was it *ever* going to be enough again?

"I want to make you cum on my cock," his low and firm voice purred. "Be sure to get nice and close. I'm not stopping until I get that third orgasm out of you, Phainon."

A puff of breath left his lips.

"Yes, master."

Mydei wasn't *rough* either, but he was definitely not as gentle as he had been previously. The bed frame was beginning to rattle from his quicker movements, and Phainon's collar clicked repeatedly from the ripples shooting through his body. Buckles softly clinked as well, shaking from their moving bodies.

One hand smacked over the bracelet on Mydei's wrist, holding the leather tightly for purchase. His ass was sensitive from the last pounding he gave him, and his cock ached from already finishing twice, but he tried. He tried as hard as he could to tighten his gut and will himself to push towards another orgasm.

"Do you like it, handsome? Do you like it when your master fucks you like this?" He goaded him. "Is it everything you've been wanting?"

Phainon nodded, not trusting his voice in between each firm thrust. Even now, without speaking, the most embarrassing cries were leaving his lips, pitched and whiny in a way only Mydei has ever heard him.

"When I ask you a question, answer me," Mydei warned, then reached to pinch his cheeks rather than hold his chest. "Let me hear you loud and clear. Do you like this?"

"*Yea-ah!*" His voice broke over the twinge of pain mixed with the overwhelming pleasure. "Master, I-I like it. I like it when you fuck m-me!"

"You're really growing into becoming my personal slut, aren't you? I can't say I'm upset…" Mydei continued, and he choked on a breath when he tried to swallow one down.

The hand on his face lifted to touch his cock, giving it a squeeze before jerking it slowly.

"Fuck. F-Fuck, master, I-I can't," he begged, pulling back from him weakly. "You can't just… This is too much—"

"Stay," he instructed him. "Take the pleasure as it comes, Phainon. Now answer what I asked you. Show me you can still focus."

"I'm… I'm becoming my master's slut," he told him, and Mydei pumped his cock faster. "P-Please, it's too much. You're g-gonna break me."

Mydei shook his head. “This cock’s all big and hard again, but it’s ‘*too much*’?” He asked him. “You look like you want to cum already.”

Fresh tears dripped down his face, and he reached one hand to Mydei’s chest before hooking the tip of his finger into his leather harness.

“Let go, Phainon. I know you’re close,” he coo’ed, thumbing beneath the head. “Give it to me. Give me one last orgasm, and I promise it’s the last one for tonight. It’s the last one until you ask for another.”

His legs kicked. His hands pulled. That familiar rush from before was engulfing his tired body completely, knotting in his gut and making it even harder to breathe beneath his cries.

Phainon hiccuped, eyes screwing tightly shut as his cock twitched pathetically.

“Do you want to cum with me?” Mydei offered. “Look at me.”

“Yes. *Yes, yes, yes*,” he pleaded, caught up in all of the overwhelming stimulation. Upon lifting his heavy eyelids, he pulled him even harder. “Master. *M-Mydei*.”

A sharp breath filled the room.

“*Mydei, please.*”

One hand slammed down beside his head suddenly, and he leaned over him again while rocking his hips forward faster.

“I’m here, Phainon,” he said back, kissing his parted lips closed even if they fell open again. “Hold on a little bit longer for me. Take it just a-a little bit longer.”

Staring in the blistering, golden irises staring down at him, Phainon felt the heat burn throughout all of his body. His tensed muscles, his sensitive insides, his overstimulated cock, and his sweating face, all of it was warm from his attention.

“Please cum,” he begged him. “Master, please cum for me too.”

“Can I cum inside?” Mydei asked even if he had put a condom on. But Phainon’s hazy head didn’t even care as he nodded quickly.

“Yes, master,” he allowed. “Can you please cum inside of me?”

“Shit.” A breathy pant fanned over his lips, and Mydei’s tilted head broke their eye contact. “Say it again. Louder. Just scream it for me i-if you need to.”

“Master, can you please c-cum inside of me?” He repeated, louder this time. “Can you please fill me up?”

“Oh, you’re such a good boy. Ph-Phainon, you’re *so fucking good*,” he praised him absentmindedly. “You’re *perfect*.”

Never had he finished three times in a single night, yet just his demanding tone was enough to feel his balls draw tight and stomach tremble. With the muscle spasms, his ass clamped tighter, and Mydei hissed in between his heavy breaths.

“Please, can I cum?” Phainon rushed out so fast all the words sounded jumbled together. “*Ple-ease*, can I cum? I’m gonna cum. Master, I-I’m gonna cum!”

“You better,” he warned him. “Come on, I’m waiting for you to feel good first. Let go for me.”

Nails carved past the leather bracelet and into his arm.

“Thank you. Thank you. Thank you.” Phainon wasn’t even thinking, just running his mouth on whatever felt right. “Master, thank you!”

Mydei forced out a dry, humorless laugh. One that shook his shoulders and broke with a choked grunt.

“*I’m so fucked*.”

But Phainon couldn’t even hear him as his head grew completely silent. No noise. No thoughts. Nothing but a blank, exhausted haze.

His body shook, thighs tense and calves taut for the third time in a row, fists balled and arms flexed in a way that threatened the thick leather in his grasp. Heat burned red hot down his straining chest and face from both the physical exertion and emotions coursing through his body, and a raw ache scratched in his throat from the sheer volume of his uncontrollable moans.

He felt *ruined*.

He couldn’t manage a word even if he wanted, and he could barely recall Mydei even getting to finish as he laid there on the bed, boneless, breathless, and still.

The arm that held on to Mydei’s leather harness hung limply off the belt, and the hand on his arm laid on top of him weakly. Both legs slipped off of his thighs, unable to keep against his hips.

Phainon did feel as Mydei slowly, gently, and carefully pulled out though, as his ass was throbbing around nothing but air now. He felt as lips kissed his tears, then as they pressed against his own to give him a taste. He felt the hand beside his head sink to cup his head again, thumbing over his jaw gently.

Everything felt so heavy, so *exhausted*. There wasn’t a thing he wanted to do but lay here and try to catch a breath.

Lips pressed to his burning cheek, then his jaw, then beneath closer towards his neck. The most he could do to help was lightly tilt his head for more room. Which helped, as they kissed just on top of his collar.

Words were being spoken into the silence, but the ringing in his ears made it all sound so muffled and far away. He felt those lips move, heard the faintest whisper of a low voice, but the sounds made no sense. Part of him didn't *want* them to make sense.

Phainon just wanted to lay there. Not thinking. Not speaking. Not reacting. He just wanted to exist as he was with his dominant right there beside him, skin to skin since it was *impossible* to be any closer. But if he could weasel underneath his harness and strap it around them both to glue them together, he'd love that. He'd love to be so close to him that it would be a *nuisance* to separate them.

Lips then kissed his sweaty temple, and he felt the bed shift beneath him. A towel touched over his messy body and sensitive hole, wiping everything up. Gentle hands rearranged his body, rolling him off of the towel before it was used to clean the mess over his stomach and pelvis. Once finished, wherever it went next, he didn't care.

Mydei stood, and just when Phainon had the sinking and devastating fear of him walking away, he watched him tie his condom off, then physically cringed as he set it on the nightstand. Instead of leaving, he sat on the bed, careful of putting his boots on the sheets, and beckoned him closer.

Fingers curled towards him, and his lips wore a tired but kind smile.

"Come to me, my prince," he instructed him sweetly, and Phainon moaned softly as he tried getting his heavy body to move. "I've got you."

He turned, and Mydei planted a pillow on his lap for him to lay down on. Which he did happily, with both hands raised beside his head.

Mydei cringed again when things rolled off of the bed and thumped against his floors, inhaling deeply before exhaling quietly. His heavy hand touched Phainon's head, tucking the sweaty locks from his face.

Sweat, sex, leather, and their own body washes filled the stuffy room, mingling into a scent so uniquely them that it was quickly becoming comforting the longer he breathed it in. It stuck to their skin, to Mydei's bedding, and the air around them.

"Did my sweet boy enjoy his reward?"

Phainon hummed positively, eyes heavy as another hand reached to gently grasp one of his. In doing so, he trapped it within both, clutching on to him and bringing his hand to his face.

"I'm glad," Mydei said gently, brushing his finger to his lips. "Thank you for dressing up with me, Phainon. You looked so good tonight in your own skin and some leather."

His stomach kicked and fluttered as he listened to that kind voice.

"Thank you for trusting me enough to touch you somewhere new," he added as his fingers softly rubbed against his temple. "It makes me very happy that you felt as if you could give that to me."

The grip Phainon held on his hands tightened as he nuzzled closer.

“It also makes me feel very special that you decided I deserved to have your first,” Mydei brought up next, and his heart pounded from the mention. “If you end up feeling taken advantage of, I take full responsibility for overstepping yet again. But for now, thank you, Phainon. You’re always such a good boy for me when we play like this, you know.”

“I won’t,” he said back quietly, moving his lips against his fingers. “My body belongs to my master. No one else.”

“You *are* mine for a little while," he agreed absentmindedly, still playing with his hair.

Phainon closed his eyes as he shook his head weakly.

“*Forever*,” he whispered, unable to feel the weight of his words with how light his head felt. It was simply a *fact* to him.

“Mm… Subspace is truly an interesting place,” Mydei murmured, not giving him so much as a second to sit in silence. “Don’t think too much, handsome. We have all night to ourselves, so if you like it there in your head, you can stay as long as you’d like. I’ll take care of you.”

He liked that.

He liked this floaty, sweet headspace, and he liked the idea that he could live in it for a little while. No inhibitions. No pressure. No nothing. All he needed to do was exist because his dominant would handle whatever he needed. The weights that he carried all day would be in his hands for a little while, and that made his body relax further.

Head to the pillow, skin bare except for the straps and cuffs wrapped taut around his figure, Phainon relaxed enough to feel just a breath away from sleep. It was comforting to feel the leather on his body holding him together, even if it pressed awkwardly into his neck and sides. But he knew that discomfort wouldn’t last long.

Mydei would unbuckle him, clean him up, and wade him through this haze when he felt like it. Until then, he was going to enjoy this sweet surrender for as long as he could.

Chapter End Notes

> my boys. my sweet boys. youd think i control them as the author, but they kind of write themselves sometimes using my hands.
>
> phainons grown so much. mydeis seemingly breaking with every chapter as of recently. oh dear. i love them so much it hurts.
>
> (ps. i dont think im ever topping the “do i own…” segment of this. ever. i cant believe the sweetest and sexiest thing ive ever written is in a myphai bdsm fic…)

Chapter 19: Chapter Nineteen

Chapter Notes

> i feel like i say this a lot but i wrote this chapter maybe ten times. went through five different endings. and have been writing since 2am (its 12:30pm). this is what i settled with.
>
> cw for this:
> • anxiety attack
>
> please enjoy. i wrote 70% of this listening to the greatest by billie eillish and sobbed so hard my teeth hurt and my head hurt behind my eyes and i knocked out. woke up at 2am to finish it. now im here. my heart and soul is in here

See the end of the chapter for more notes

While taking off his gear and wiping down his body with a damp rag, Mydei was sure to gently kiss his indented skin after each unbuckle. Those soft lips dragged down his shoulder blades, over his waist and ribs, the bottom of his stomach, and the width of either thigh. He kissed his wrists and ankles, then kissed his neck where the thick collar once sat because lying on his back so long made it embed the shape into him.

Phainon was sure that he was kissed more times tonight than he was in the entirety of his last relationship, which lasted him *years*. His whole body was acquainted with that mouth, the one that praised him endlessly for being so sweet, so strong, so good. He was *good*. For orgasming three times in a row, for taking his cock so well, for making his dominant so proud, *he was good*.

Mydei helped dress him up after a quick wipe down too, tucking his body in a pair of gray sweatpants and a navy long sleeve. He let him sit on the ottoman in his bathroom, eyes hazy and fingers clutching the cushion, as he cleaned off the sex toys and wiped down the leather harnesses properly. Every so often he turned around to face him, to ruffle his hair and ask if he was okay.

And he was. As long as he was beside him, he was fine.

But Phainon couldn't stay in this daze forever. He knew that. The time he *did* get to simply bask in the ambiance of Mydei's meticulous care was nice. At the end of the day, however, he wanted to be *there*. He wanted to be *present*.

When it came time to put their cleaned belongings away, he took hold of the handcuffs himself. With two in each hand, he carried them to the cabinet to place neatly on Mydei's shelf. While staring at his things, it prompted a thought to cross his mind.

“Master?”

“Yes?”

“I’d like to update our folder soon,” he told him, and Mydei looked over to him curiously. “I… I want you to touch me freely. Not *sexually*, but *normally*. My stomach and hips, my lower back and waist, these regular places you make me ask for, can you please touch them whenever you want from now on?”

It was at the point where he felt a hug or a hand on his waist was a bit *much* to ask for, especially after what they had just done.

Standing beside him, his dominant reached one hand around the narrowest part of his waist to test this resolve of his. A gentle press into skin nudged him to come closer, and Phainon nodded while taking a step towards him. Noticing his comfort with the gesture, he smiled.

“Okay,” Mydei agreed without hesitation as his opposite hand hung up his red harness blindly. “We can do that.”

“I also want you to… um… kiss me more,” he brought up carefully, gauging his reaction by watching his expression. When it didn’t shift, he buckled down on his request. “Can you please kiss me more, master?”

“Did losing your virginity suddenly make you feel big and bold?” He accused, but he ducked down to press a kiss against his heated cheek anyway. “Free kisses. Free touches. Shall I worship you all over again as a reward for having the guts to confront me with these requests? Would you want me to start at your pretty face, then make my way all the way down to your feet?”

Phainon shivered at the memory of having sex with him. He felt the fleeting, phantom brush of those soft lips against his ankles, legs, stomach, and neck. Feather light like he was touching something delicate and dear, then hungry as if he was starved for every inch of skin. It had felt so good to be treated so sweetly and needed so viscerally.

“One more thing,” Phainon murmured, distracted by the thought of being *his*. “I… I want to do *that* more.”

“Worship? Aren’t you full of yourself.”

“No, um… what we just did… You know, when you touched my… ass,” he corrected him shyly. “I want you to use my toy and your fingers… Maybe if I’m not too tired… *more*…”

Mydei turned to face him completely, holding his waist firmly with one hand and using the other to lift his chin. While looking into each other’s eyes, Phainon couldn’t help but feel as if he were made of glass. Not in the sense that he was *fragile*, but in the sense that everything hidden underneath his skin was visible to him.

… Hadn’t it always been like that though?

The night he confronted Mydei about his fetishes and kinks, his hidden curiosity for this life was pulled from the depths of his disgust-riddled confusion. That moment in his kitchen when he was first dubbed '*my good boy*', the darkened, selfish desire to be praised and rewarded for his behavior was brought into the light.

When he was sitting on his lap and handcuffed to his bed, Mydei felt and saw his body respond positively to his touching even if his brain couldn't fathom it. While sitting on his knees for him with his mouth stretched around his cock, that need to be shown just how much Mydei needed him in return was brought to the forefront of things.

The mangled up and electrified mess that he was underneath his skin was *always* visible, and Mydei handled it with his bare-hands every time.

"You want to have sex again already, yet you've just barely done it for the first time," Mydei chided. "Try recovering first before I entertain the thought of fucking you again. I can see you walking a little funny."

"I am a little sore," Phainon admitted, not wanting to hide it. There was no point if he already knew. "I'm not used to *that*."

"Of course. We've never had sex before."

He shrugged weakly. "Yes, but also… being *fucked* is new to me. You handled that toy pretty roughly, master. I've never done it like *that* to my body."

"Maybe I should have prepped you better and for longer, or maybe I could have taken it a little slower," he apologized, but it wasn't as heavy of an apology as it *could've* been. He would have always been a little bit sore after what they did, and they *both* knew that. "I got a little bit carried away by you begging me to fuck you over, and over, and *over* again. I'm not blaming you for my impatience, but… hearing those words gave me a rush."

"Did it?"

It was always a treat for Mydei to be open with his feelings, thoughts, and desires.

"You have no idea."

Warmth bled into his cheeks over the lighthearted chuckle that shook his chest.

Phainon also briefly thought back to Mydei's low voice telling him that he wanted him earlier that night. He wanted to touch him, please him, push him, *fuck him*. There was a desire to see him cry, feel him tremble, and show him just how good it could feel to be dominated completely.

And it did. It felt *so damn good* to be his completely.

"Did you really want to go that far with me?" He double-checked, also remembering that Mydei initially *denied* him and his advances. Quite quickly and adamantly, too. "Or did I kinda beg my way into getting what *I* wanted out of you?"

“I didn’t do anything I didn’t want to do,” Mydei said simply, immediately, not giving him another second to ponder the possibility of *coercion*. “Every touch I gave you, like every word I said to you, was both honest and true.”

Phainin nodded weakly in agreement.

There wasn’t a single lie spoken while with him in his room either, and the ways in which his hands reached to him for purchase and pleasure was innate. Each action was raw and right from the depths of his chest, acted upon before he could even think about the ramifications.

It was at that moment that he remembered one singular word. A hazy, nearly inaudible word that he said to him in the heat of his bliss.

‘*Forever*’.

His heart pounded painfully, threatening both the cage that protected it and the body holding it because Mydei’s hands looked so much more capable of doing that job themselves. Especially when he dragged his thumb over one rosy cheek and cupped his cheek with a pinch of the palm.

“I need to talk to you something while we’re here,” Mydei said softly, and he hummed. “Where is your head now?”

“In your hand.”

A scoff followed, then a gentle hum when he noticed the smile on his lips. Leaning in, Mydei eyed his mouth for a moment before he stopped himself.

“Mm… It’s hard,” he murmured as he gripped his cheek tighter.

“Again?” Phainon asked teasingly, taking in the tired look in his amber eyes. “I can’t take it so soon, master. I’m not built for that.”

“You’re so stupid.” But Mydei leaned in closer anyway. “I want to kiss you until you forget how to crack a joke.”

Taking initiative, he tilted up to meet his lips quickly and smoothly. That soft mouth pressed to his, still except for the pressure as they looked at one another through the mess of their bangs. One arm wrapped around the back of Mydei’s neck, and the other curled just beneath his bicep to grip the muscle.

Upon having that silent permission, Mydei pulled him closer until their teeth pressed through their lips. Phainon closed his eyes first, encouraging him to move by pushing once more.

Mydei then took a step forward. He took one back.

The hand on his waist reached to grab a fistful of his hair, and he moaned over the sharp and sudden sting of having it tugged. Those parted lips opened an invitation for Mydei to do the same, for him to force his mouth closed again and again with open-mouthed kisses.

Rattling sounded from behind him when his back hit the opened cabinet. The sudden thump of items falling beside him made him jump, snapping his attention towards his feet. A thing of lube and box of condoms laid there—both *his* as Mydei's were a different brand.

But Mydei didn't seem to like the thought of sharing his attention. He forced him to look at him again with the hand on his cheek, eyes narrowed to a warning glare.

It made his stomach drop *and* light up with sparks at the same time, guilty for being easily distracted but excited to see what he'd do about it.

"Your master is kissing you. *Don't* look away from him," he ordered.

Breathless, Phainon felt another kiss shut him up before he could think to apologize, and his eyes fluttered shut while returning it just as hungrily.

Their lips met over and over, again and again. Soft, suctioned sounds filled the closet when they pulled apart. Heavy breaths fanned over their combined mouths when pushed as close as physically possible.

Mydei kissed him until his lungs ached deeply. He gripped his face until his fingerprints embedded inside of his skin. Fingers tugged on his hair until a broken, needy whine crawled up his throat.

Phainon tried to catch a breath with a gasp. He tucked his nose to the cheek in front of him, head hazy all over again from simply being kissed.

"Forgive me… I'll be good from now on," Mydei promised him quietly, kissing the corner of his mouth before moving onto his cheek for another. "I won't start anything."

One then touched his jaw.

"I'll… I'll be good…"

Again, a kiss was planted beneath the bone, accessible only because he physically pulled his head back himself to make space.

"*I'll be so fucking good*…"

The tip of his nose trailed down his neck, tickling the bare skin as his leather collar was left in the bathroom to dry after cleaning. He breathed him in deeply through the nose. He exhaled over his tattoo with his mouth. There wasn't another kiss, but it was clear he wanted nothing more than to latch on to his neck with a bite like he had before.

And maybe Phainon wanted it just as badly too.

"I won't start anything," Mydei promised once more, tucking into his neck to hide his eyes. "Phainon, I… I have no excuse for what I just did. I just wanted to kiss you stupid."

Well, he *felt* stupid, like all the words had slipped from his head and all that remained was '*Mydei*' and '*master*'. When trying to think of something witty to say back, all he drew was a

card that said '*more*'. More kisses. More lovebites. More of being held, squeezed, pulled, and doted on by him.

Tingles buzzed underneath his heated skin, prickly and all consuming as he practically hung off of his body by the arm around his neck.

Phainon felt greedy all over again from wanting *more* out of him.

"Are you stupid yet?"

Phainon chuckled over the teasing tone of his question, and Mydei did too as they held on to one another tightly. His hand dragged down the firm bicep in front of him to hold his wrist instead, comforted by the hotter, heavier, deeper press into his tingling cheek.

"Maybe…"

"Well, you can be my stupid prince…" Mydei trailed off after, and as he rolled his eyes, he heard a soft murmur. "… *Just for now…?*"

The lightheartedness of their moment began to drop as their laughter died down, crushed beneath the weight of his added question. It stole the playfulness in the air, thickening it into something heavier and harder to breathe in.

Because that *was* a question. He heard the inquisitive tilt in his tone as if Mydei wasn't sure of the words leaving his mouth, as if they were meant to be *corrected* or *confirmed*.

No, he was not his '*just for now*', or *yes*, this ownership over him was '*just for now*'.

Phainon's grin shook as it fell, attempting to stay up but failing the longer he realized how difficult it was to speak without the rush of pleasure or confidence of alcohol. These feelings that burrowed their way inside of him and made a home out of his chest and stomach, how was he meant to share it with Mydei when the man was so sure there'd be someone else after this?

This was *exploration*. This was *experimental*. Mydei said it himself over and over again—this was *never* about love and *always* about simply experiencing something new.

Phainon was almost certain they were never meant to make it this far.

He was supposed to tap out early. He was supposed to throw in the white towel and cry that this was too intense for him to deal with. Being micromanaged was meant to be both smothering and humiliating as he was a grown man who could make his own decisions. Having someone slap his face as they called him a '*slut*' or a '*whore*' should have been disgusting to him.

The title '*master*' was once a joke. A cruel, degrading joke meant to make fun of Mydei for being this power-obsessed *pervert* in secret. It was coined out of ignorance and disgust in himself, in Mydei's life, and in the entire *BDSM* community.

And yet that title of '*master*' felt the safest on his tongue when he needed comfort.

His master made the world of kink look a little less scary by pushing him to experience things bit by bit, by offering it to him with his own hands and letting him poke, prod, and touch to his heart's content. He didn't let him feel suffocated by the ropes and cuffs in which he tied him up in, and he didn't let him think he was someone *less* for wanting it even if he berated them both in the past. Service didn't feel like a troublesome chore to complete. Pleasing him didn't feel as one-sided as he thought it would.

'*Master*' went from being a title of mockery to one of respect, meant to lift Mydei up into power rather than crush him beneath the desire. It rolled off the tongue so easily now that Phainon could say it for the rest of his life and be happy with its taste in his mouth.

But… did *Mydei* want that too?

"… Phainon?" He swallowed the budding nerves in his stomach while contemplating if it was worth it. "What do you have to say about that?"

"You're my master," he found the courage to say to him. "A-And I don't want you to stop being mine."

Mydei's fingers curled into his head as he stood there, pensive. Without a word to say, Phainon felt like it'd be right to continue speaking before a flicker of uncertainty could wipe his bravery away.

"You always say that this arrangement is only '*for now*' and there'll be '*someone else*' for me after we finish. You call me yours for '*a little bit*', then tell me once I figure out what I want to know about myself, I can '*leave*'."

The words were growing more and more bitter in his mouth, and they left an unpleasant aftertaste over his tongue when he finished. He couldn't see himself with another person in this way, and the thought of Mydei treating another man the way he treated him was an intrusive thought—sudden and violent, then *sickening* to the core. Beneath him was *his* place. They had paved this path together, and there was no way he'd let them split the moment it offered a new route to take.

Who could be more important than each other when they've fought so hard just to make this work between *them? Who* was worth relearning how to trust, love, and want when all he wanted was to be here with *Mydei?*

No one.

"I only remind us of the truth so we don't get blindsided by the possibility," Mydei explained gently. But who was '*we*' when he had been so clear with him? "You should remember that I'm not shackling you to this experience with a ball and chain, and I should be prepared for the moment our curtains draw."

His jaw tightened for a moment over the frustration of his narrow-minded sight, then eased as he tried to let the knee-jerk reaction of arguing go. That wouldn't get them anywhere.

“What if… we *didn’t* treat this like some kinda show or roleplay?” Phainon tried to suggest the idea rather than straight up confessing to his feelings. “Mydei. Master. What if this didn’t have to end at all? If I can decide when we stop, is *never* an option too?”

Mydei’s breathing faltered as he let go of his hair, and he pulled away from him while examining his face. Those eyes raked over his own, dropped to his mouth, then went back to searching through his expression. Alerted. Guarded.

But *why?*

“Think about what that entails,” he warned him. “Do you really want to do this *forever* with me?”

What would be the difference?

It’d be just like how they are now, only they wouldn’t need to be afraid of crossing any boundaries left between them as ‘*friends*’. There wouldn’t be a fear of feelings catching up to them, as he already had them festering in his chest and tainting his judgement. And if Mydei had any of his own that went beyond his usual care, he repressed them deeply and rarely let it show. He wouldn’t need to do that if they were playing for keeps rather than on a whim.

‘*Forever*’ sounded like a breath of fresh air. ‘*For now*’ sounded like suffocating slowly.

There was only *one* choice for him.

Phainon nodded shallowly. “Yeah, I do. Is that possible? Can we just… treat this as if what we have is something *real?*”

He wanted it. He wanted it so badly that it was all he could think about. The cuddles they shared, the kisses they stole, and the pleasure they took part in couldn’t just be a *performance*. The way they behaved couldn’t be watered down to just a *role*.

“But this *hasn’t* been entirely real, Phainon,” Mydei said back to him, speaking slowly.

Those words were like a fist wrapped tightly around his heart. His hand had just slithered into the gaps of his ribs, twisted to crack them open, and used the extra space to carve his nails into the most delicate part of him. The blood filled his lungs, making it hard to grit his teeth and breathe through the pain. Each pump pushed that killer grip deeper. Every pulse brought an ache rather than life.

Ice crystalized inside of his veins, inching through his body and freezing him still.

“Oh… Right… I-It uh… It *felt* a little bit real though,” he forced out through the heavy lump building rapidly in the back of his throat. “I kinda gave a lot for this, you know…”

Time and effort, mental anguish and physical vulnerability, submission and obedience, he stuffed it all into a pretty, leather bound box and handed it to him. Willingly. From the comfort of their homes underneath his watchful gaze to every waking moment when they were apart, he gave it all to him.

“Th-This isn’t just a *role* for me to play anymore…” A choked laugh bubbled up from his throat before he swallowed it down, attempting to hold the hurt back but failing. *Miserably*. “It isn’t just a ‘*trial run*’ of something new, and scary, a-and exciting anymore. Being yours has become a p-pretty big part of my life… *I am yours*, and that’s not… *not* real.”

Mydei’s eyes softened as they watched the tears begin to well up within his eyes, but he didn’t speak. He only watched like he always seemed to do, taking in his expressions, words, and body language.

“I wake up t-to greet you every morning. I go to bed to the thought of you after I text. I even sleep with that… that puppy plushie you got me. For no reason at all, by the way, besides the fact *you* gave it to me.”

Phainon sobbed through the scratchiness in his vocal cords as he hooked his index finger into his day collar to pull. He wanted to breathe, but between the blood in his lungs and the collar he never took off, it was proving difficult to do. The chain wasn’t heavy or tight, but it felt choking when the back pressed into his neck tightly. No amount of pulling threatened the lock that binded it together, not like a flimsy clasp would have.

Because he couldn’t breathe easily, he swallowed thickly to try and gather a second of composure. His eyes darted around the closet he knew like his own, then back to Mydei’s face.

“I dress to impress you,” he added. “I don’t h-have to, but I like to. I like the way you praise me. I like the way the… the leather jackets and harnesses feel and look on my body. I don’t think it's *performing* or *role playing* if I *want* to show myself off i-in your design.”

“Phainon, hey…”

“I got into a fight with ‘rene for this, master,” he stressed, recalling the harsh words he had said to her. Her tears and begging to be understood echoed in his head, and it brought another wrench to his torn-up chest to remember that he essentially told her to go *fuck off*. “Did I hurt her and make her cry for nothing? Did I defend a relationship I don’t e-even have a *chance* at trying to keep no matter how h-hard I try?”

Mydei gently held his arms now, hands hot and firm. They kept him in his place when he tried to take a step towards him, separating them both when they had *just* been kissing each other breathless.

Phainon’s lungs tightened inside of his chest from the distance between them. Tears brimmed his waterline heavily, blurring his vision into nothing but muddled colors of gold and rust.

“Breathe for me,” Mydei instructed him.

“I have a key to y-your house.” His voice cracked terribly, and it drove those hands to grip his arms tighter. “We just had… h-had sex together. Not just handjobs or blowjobs, but *real sex*. Master, I gave you my body because I wanna be yours. I wanna be yours *so fucking badly*, and I… I guess I thought you’d wanna be mine too because you went for it… I guess I thought th-that maybe… you felt the same about me…”

Was he too arrogant? Did he mistake Mydei's ownership of him and lust for him as a hint of something deeper?

Stupid.

Stupid. Stupid. *Fucking stupid.*

"Please breathe," Mydei repeated. "It's not like that, Phainon."

"This was just sex, wasn't it?" He asked anxiously, shrinking into himself. "This… was just hooking up with a couple extra steps."

"Phainon, *stop*."

"At least t-tell me that I wasn't *nothing*. Tell me it *mattered* to you. I'm a brat sometimes, b-but you know it's not to make you feel less in control. You know I just… I can't… *talk* sometimes. I can't *ask* for certain things," he stammered, pulling harder on his collar. "I'm sorry if I made this into a-a mess, but I can cl-clean it for you. I can do anything for you, just… tell me."

"Phainon," he said much more firmly. "I need you to calm down. Listen to me, not whatever you're thinking right now."

But he couldn't. He couldn't calm down because he was in love with someone who clearly only saw this as a way to pass time. The very thing he didn't want, to lose his best friend and be someone's casual hook-up, was *real*.

The worst part was that he played himself by *asking* for it. This was all on him because Mydei was so, *so* insistent on having him *ask* to be here. And he did.

A hiccup filled the small room. "Ple-ease…?" Phainon asked weakly just before his throat closed, hoping this would work. "C-Can I please just… Fuck… Can we please *stop* playing pretend wh-when I… I already gave you everything I have—*including* my heart?"

Mydei didn't respond to that, and in the midst of his hurt, it was impossible to distinguish whether this was a *good* silence or a *bad* one.

"I love you, master. Mydei. Whatever I should call you r-right now," he confessed raspily, certain of his feelings while simultaneously afraid of that revelation. "I love my master, a-and I don't wanna pretend it's *nothing* anymore…"

The hands on his arms raised, cupping his face carefully. Both thumbs swiped underneath his puffy eyes, but it didn't help as his vision blurred even further with fresh tears.

Mydei was still nothing more than a smudged image of crimson and gold, but he was *still* the most important thing in the room. He made his heart quiver behind his aching ribs, rattling with every breath as he tried to compose himself. But no matter how much he tried to breathe, it didn't help.

He breathed in deep, but it was interrupted with a hiccup. So he tried faster, shallower, grasping at what he could in between his sobs.

“Do you love me, Phainon?”

Phainon nodded quickly.

He loved being his. He loved teasing each other while working out, then talking about their days over breakfast. He loved spamming him with text messages throughout the work day, telling him grumpy cats looked like him and ranting about rude customers while hiding inside the bathroom. He loved being held by him when he felt small and praised by him to make him feel strong.

He loved his patience and his reliability to always be there when called. He loved his hands, how gentle they could cradle small animals and handle delicate pastries, but then how firm they could be in pinning him down to the bed or holding him together. He loved his amber eyes and how they noticed little things that others didn’t because he was so focused on listening and watching rather than speaking. He loved how his skin smelled when cleaned and after a long day at work, then how his body looked and felt up against his when touching on him, grinding on him, *fucking on him*. Dressed up or dressed down, stood tall or slumped low, he loved him however he presented himself to him.

That was his best friend, his dominant, and the man he loved all wrapped up into one person. And he loved him.

Phainon loved Mydei, but… Mydei didn’t seem to love him back. Not to the same degree, anyway.

And that hurt. A lot. Like a punch right to the chest, it left him winded and gasping.

“If you love me, breathe nice and deep for me again.” Mydei ordered, speaking sternly yet kindly. “I need you to calm down a little bit before you send yourself into an attack, alright? You can do this for me, I know you can.”

His head shook.

“I wasn’t *asking* you *if* you can, I was *telling* you that I *know* you can. My prince is strong, and I’m right here for him,” he encouraged him. “Come on, copy me.”

He nodded once more, breathing in time with him as he tried to focus on his grounding touch rather than what’s crumbling around him. His hands fisted Mydei’s wrists, clutching them tightly for purchase. His eyes stayed focused on Mydei’s, blurred from the tears when they just kept coming.

“You’re doing so well, Phainon,” Mydei praised him. “Keep it up. Do you need to be held right now? Can I give you a hug?”

Phainon’s sobs broke through once more, and he nodded even harder.

“Come here, my sweet prince,” he coaxed him, bringing his face towards his neck before guiding both arms around him instead. “I’ve got you. There’s no need to be so upset. If I tell you what I’m thinking, do you promise to listen?”

“Mm…” A sniffle made him rethink speaking. “M-Mhm…”

“But you need to calm down a little bit before you do. How can you listen to me if you’re too busy crying?”

Phainon pressed firmly into Mydei’s body. His cheek rested over his shoulder to hide into his neck, and his eyes closed while trying to keep his breathing steady. An occasional hiccup squeaked through the room, and sniffles came every few seconds, but he tried. He tried so hard. *Always*.

Time passed them by as they stood there holding on to one another. Five minutes, ten minutes, maybe even more. However long it took to free him from his crumpled state into something with a little more substance, it didn’t matter. The hands in the clock have never mattered when beside Mydei.

“Can you hear me?” He asked, and Phainon nodded as he sniffled. “Use your words.”

“I hear you, master,” he murmured as he shut his eyes to hide them from the light. “I’m… I’m here.”

“I want to preface this by saying I care so much about you, Phainon. Not a single moment has passed where I thought of you as anything *less* than someone precious to me. You are not *just* your sex appeal, but your sweet smile, lighthearted presence, and kind heart,” Mydei reassured him, sharing his inner thoughts as he had promised.

A pause gave Phainon time to take another slow and deep breath. Even as his chest kicked with an ache, he powered through to try and stay calm.

“Things have changed in both you and me as of recently, and I’ve been trying to figure out what it is on my end.” He rubbed his back gently before gripping his shirt tightly. “Feelings make so little sense to me… I try to rationalize them if I can, to pinpoint the cause and immediately find a way to cut it out if it’s irrational or a burden. I don’t do what I don’t want to do, and I typically need more than a moment to gauge how I'm *meant* to react."

Phainon could have guessed that from watching him interact with others, himself, and the world in a more intimate way. He listened to him in real time as Mydei let his bubbled anger go to instead speak the way he usually did—coolly and casually. He sat with Mydei in complete silence as he tried to make sense of his own insecurities and frustrations. He watched Mydei as he watched *him* to try and make sense of his emotions himself before attempting to comfort him, approach a subject, or speak his mind.

Mydei wasn’t as composed as he appeared or as everyone once believed him to be. He was just so busy dissecting, justifying, and *thinking* that it gave him little time to react or feel sometimes.

That was something he had to learn through observation alone, as Mydei didn't just tell people those things.

"You've always felt so deeply that your body can't contain it even when you try, and it makes you easier to understand than others. I like that about you," Mydei said to him honestly. "As we explored this, I realized the comfort of your presence, mixed with the domesticity of being allowed to exist in my own home, and the intimate nature of the non-sexual things we did together was… *well*, everything I felt I was missing with others."

Phainon exhaled shakily as he listened to his low, *almost* monotonous voice. It was tinted with sincerity, the kind that gave his stoicism a little tilt away from its usual sound. One so small their other friends probably wouldn't be able to discern, but he could.

He learned how to tell *that* about him too.

"You are not the only one who has grown attached to this routine we've created, Phainon. You're just better at expressing yourself than I am."

Hearing that brought him a touch of comfort. It meant this wasn't *entirely* a one sided feeling, but that made it even more confusing to him.

Mydei then continued, giving him little time to let his brain kick its thinking back up. "I don't mean to *hurt you* when I mention an end, but this is *my life*," he reminded him. "You were only supposed to be trying it out, so I couldn't rely on this to be here *forever*. If I let you go at the end, it meant I didn't just mold an innocent man for *my* sick pleasure. If you left me after enjoying your time with me, it was for *your* personal growth. I… I could live with that."

His bottom lip trembled all over again at the mention that this wasn't *official*. Even if it felt serious to him, Mydei viewed it as nothing more than a fleeting experience—a *favor* for a friend rather than a *possibility* for a partner.

"Mm… but you look so good in this life with me." His voice lowered, almost as if he were *ashamed* to see him that way. "You look *so damn good* in this light, Phainon…"

"Do I?" He begged to know. "Better than the others?"

"*No one* has ever worn submission as beautifully as *you do*," he praised him, making his chest flutter and lungs tighten. "It's not what a stricter person would call a '*perfect*' dominant-submissive relationship, but it doesn't need to be. I like that it's a little clumsy, a little playful, and above all else, *comfortable* for us now."

He sniffled. "Do you really?"

"Yes." Mydei wasted not even a *second* to answer. "Sometimes I… I got the idea that we could have this too. In moments when things slowed down or got particularly intense, I considered the fact you were here with me willingly, and I wondered if I could possibly push my way into keeping you for myself. But that's a selfish thing to do. '*Forever*' is too much for me to want."

“Why?” It still didn’t make any sense to him. “Why are you still trying to… to push me away? Why can’t we have it?”

All he wanted was him. All he wanted was Mydei. And if that was reciprocated, why couldn’t they *just fucking have it? Why?*

“Because I’ve never felt this way before with my past submissives. This is… vicious. It’s selfish, and it only gets worse with each passing day.” His cool tone slowly melted into something hotter and less restrained the longer he spoke. “It wants what you give me, and it wants to monopolize that attention completely. It wants to keep you here by my side, shackled by the collar so you *can’t* run because you should be *mine*. You’re so perfect *for me*. But how could I do that to you, Phainon?”

The hands gripping his shirt pulled, dragging it lower as if Mydei wanted to squeeze his body as physically close as possible. He swore he could even feel the other man’s heart pounding against his chest.

“Tell me, how can I think about forever with you when you’ve wanted things in *your* past that I can’t give to you in *our* future?” Mydei pressed. “How could I stand here and satisfy *my* own desire knowing I could never fully give you *yours?* I’d rather let you go than have you resent me for wasting time you can’t ever get back.”

His eyebrows furrowed together. “What ‘*things*’ do you mean?” He asked.

A frustrated ‘tch’ filled the room as Mydei’s jaw clenched, teeth gritted like he was growing more and more angry at himself.

“*Family*, Phainon! *Marriage!*” His eyes then widened at the mention of things he hadn’t even thought of. “You’re a family man! You’re an old-fashioned kind of guy who dates someone to marry them later in life! I… I never *once* thought about having any of that for myself.”

What was he talking about?

Did Mydei really agonize over a future that far ahead? Just how much ‘*reason*’ and ‘*rationalizing*’ did he have to backpack through to come up with that?

“Your family is old-fashioned too… I’ll put everything I own on the line to bet that they… they want grandkids out of you just like Cyrene’s do for her.” Mydei’s voice broke before he inhaled shakily, attempting to calm himself down before he raised his voice again.

Phainon chuckled, not because it was funny but because of how out of depth he felt. Was this *really* a conversation people had so soon?

“Mydei, why… would you think about any of that?” He couldn’t help but wonder.

“You were so ready to marry that girl from school, saving those part-time, minimum wage paychecks in a piggy bank for a big, shiny ring.” Mydei sighed in resignation. “It’s my responsibility to consider your wants and desires, but I don’t know if I want… that. And if I can’t give you that, *realistically*, what’s the point in wasting your time, Phainon? You’re

better off just… toughing out the change in routine for a little while and searching for what you need instead. This didn't last more than a few months anyway, so…”

“*Wh… What?*”

No.

“Letting go should be easy, right?”

No. No. No.

Phainon wanted to say he was wrong so badly about what he wanted before, but spending years dating the same person really *did* make a guy think forever was possible. It made him think he was set for life. All they needed to do was make it past college, and they’d have it all just like his parents did. A cozy little home with a few pets running around and a darling child to dote on while they were still young.

He was older now, though. Nineteen was a while ago, and those fantasies of that pretty house with a vegetable garden and guard dog have long since left his mind. That end wasn’t the goal anymore.

To love and to be loved, to support and be supported, that was all he ever really cared about, and Mydei was right in that regard. So long as he was a good person, kept good people by his side, and was surrounded by people he loved in the future, he could say he lived a good life. All he needed after that was a good person who he loved and who loved him back, someone he could be proud to stand beside until the end.

And Mydei made him proud every day with how beautiful of a person he was inside. He made him feel safe when wading unknown waters and gave him a breath when his lungs didn’t want to work. His casual yet romantic nature and undivided attention on top that gave him all the love he could ever hope to feel even if it wasn't *intentional*.

As of now, he wanted what Mydei would provide for him, and if it didn’t end with picket fences and changing diapers—*oh well*. He didn’t care.

So didn’t *he* get an opinion on this matter? Or did Mydei plan to leave him out of this when he imagined severing him from this dynamic?

How was that *fair?* After all the work he put into this, how was it fair to be tossed out like he didn’t matter? Like a *dog* their owner decided they didn’t want to care about anymore?

“I don’t feel like talking anymore,” Mydei muttered suddenly, but that only made him even more upset. “I’m… not feeling well. I’m going to—”

“I do,” Phainon stated. “If you don’t wanna talk, fine. You can *listen* because I’m not done here. I-I need to talk to you still.”

When he didn’t respond, Phainon fought the urge to roll his eyes because he knew Mydei was probably just overstimulated. It happened. But he couldn’t just stand here and let him believe whatever ‘*rational*’ thought he wanted to—especially when it didn’t make any sense to him.

He knew that once Mydei had his mind set a certain way, it was difficult to sway it. This was clearly something he already put a lot of unspoken thought into, and who knew how close he was to etching it into stone. Maybe it already was, or maybe he still had time.

“You and I put so much effort into making this fun, comfortable, and exciting for us, and you think you can just let it go *for me?* You think I’d let you make that kind of decision *without me?*” Phainon demanded through his aching chest, trying desperately not to yell at him even if he wanted to. “I’m sorry, but that's not your call to make all by yourself. I *let* you have your power, you don’t get to just *take* it from my hands.”

Mydei’s hands loosened over his shirt, barely hanging on to him as if he expected him to push him away. But he didn’t.

“I want what *we* have. I want *this* to be real,” he repeated himself, stronger than it had been when he was choking over his tears. “Being friends who mess around and act like they’re in a relationship when they’re not i-isn’t enough for me. *I want more*.”

“But…—”

His head shook. “I don’t care what Cyrene’s parents want from her and I. And if my parents want kids from me too—*tough*. I could never raise a child by myself, and I'd never want to. It would have *always* been between me and my partner, *never* anyone else—even them.”

One of his own hands grabbed at Mydei’s shirt, fisting it with a shaking, white-knuckled hold to try and calm down. When another second passed, he slowly wrenched fingertip by fingertip off his palm for a grasp a little less threatening.

Breathing deep, he then held his waist instead, not wanting to feel his hands curled into fists like that.

He didn’t want to be angry. He didn’t want to hurt anyone.

He wanted to get through to him.

“What I want is my master, Mydei. I want his control, his companionship, and his life,” he decided, keeping his voice steady. “I’m not ‘*old-fashioned*’. I’m just a simple person who wants to love and be loved back without restrictions.”

A gulp sounded, and he looked between the both of them to where their chests were touching. Then he flicked his gaze up to the two-toned hair that framed Mydei’s face and hid it from view.

“I want the *selfish* kind of love that keeps you from wanting anyone but me to be in your life. The kind that makes you *need* me here in your arms more than anywhere else that might want me. The kind that forces you to be so open and *vulnerable* that it scares you to death how much of you I have,” he listed. “I want the kind of love that makes you *afraid* to let go of me, not… not the kind that pushes me out the goddamn door like I’m not worth fighting for.”

Mydei's arms slipped off of his body to hang limp and alone by his sides, fingertips fiddling with one another. His nails clicked, and they scratched over the skin.

"Stop." Phainon could *hear* the gears in his head turning. "Stop thinking. Stop *rationalizing* everything. I-I don't need you to behave according to something you saw printed on a page or acted out in a movie. Mydei, I need you to *feel something* and then say it to me the way it is!"

His entire body flinched from the sudden loudness of his frustration, and he covered his face with both of his hands before turning away. Either palm lined the sides of his nose, fingertips meeting between his eyes to cup over his nose and mouth. Breathing deeply with his shoulders curled in, Mydei turned his head away from him to hide.

"I *am* afraid," he confessed quietly, voice slightly strained. "I'm confused and afraid because no one taught me wh-what to do when I get this messed up inside from a man like you."

Phainon couldn't help but scoff at that, unable to bite it back. "'*A man like me*'? What does *that* mean?"

"*Yes! A man like you!*"

There was a layer of gloss over his conflicted amber gaze when he whipped around to face him, making them glitter and shine underneath the golden lights above them. Red had begun taking over the whites of his eyes as if he had been holding them back with every ounce of strength inside of him for a while now. He could see it all through the slits of his lengthy bangs.

Both hands fell from his mouth, shaking in their journey to grip his own t-shirt by the collar. In revealing his mouth, it almost shocked him how bloody and raw it was. With an uneven layer of skin torn in the middle, it was clear he was chewing and tearing them apart while listening to him speak.

He looked like the very thing he hated most—a mess. A broken, confused, and hysterical *mess*.

Guilt trickled along his spine for pushing him that far, and he took a step back before realizing there was no space left to take. The cabinet was there, and he rattled the chains and gear enough for metal to slide over wood and click from where they were hung up.

"Mas… Mydei," he whispered. "Hey,—"

"What do I do when my closest, most comfortable friend becomes my dream submissive because he wants to take a little trip into my life? What do I do when he gives me e-everything I've ever wanted because he says it's natural for him to want to be close to me and make me happy? What do I do when he stirs up my chest in a way that makes it hurt so much I feel it *in my teeth* when I think about not being able to keep him as my own?" Mydei cried, speaking fast, loud, and frantic. "Where's my rulebook? Where's my… my guideline? What do I follow, my heart or my head? My selfishness or my reason? My only rule to follow here was being your best friend first and dominant second, but I fucked that up so fast because I'm this needy, selfish, son of a-a—*fuck!*"

Phainon looked away from him as Mydei pulled on his shirt and fanned it over his chest with violent tugs. Then, he began wildly looking around the small, messy closet while speeding his hands up.

“I-I need… I need… O-Oh… I can’t…” He stammered helplessly, taking a step before falling back into place. “I’m sorry. I need air. I need to be alone. *I’m sorry.* I need to think.”

Once those words left his lips, Mydei rushed out of his closet like his life depended on it. Heavy steps smacked against the wooden floor, taking him further and further away from him. They ran out the bedroom door, and it removed the other rooms as an option for salvation when they kept going even further, growing quieter and quieter.

His feet followed, rushing to chase him even if he had asked to be alone. A dull ache climbed up his back, but he powered through to make it in time.

“Mydei!”

Sneakers slapped to the floor loudly to be slipped on, and he watched as his hands fumbled the door to fiddle with the locks on them.

“I’m sorry. I didn’t mean t-to make you freak out like that, and I won’t do it again,” he apologized swiftly. “Please stay. Please just… hold me. Let me hold you. We don’t need to talk at all, just be there for each other.”

When Mydei looked back at him, he pushed the door open despite all that he said

“Ten minutes,” he told him shakily, sounding less stressed than before and more desperate. It was as if he needed this. “I-I’m not leaving you, okay? I’m not running out on you. Just… please. I need ten minutes t-to collect myself right now, Phainon.”

“But…”

Before he could finish, he let the words sit and die on his tongue.

Mydei looked like he needed to go so badly, but something in him knew if he were to beg him once more, he’d probably cave. He’d bite down whatever he was about to confront on his own, rip it off like a tag, and pretend it was never there to begin with. And that was *never* what he wanted him to do.

“Okay,” he caved. “Be easy to spot. I’m going to look for you in a bit, but if I can’t find you because y-you ran out on me, I’m going home.”

Phainon then turned his head when he watched him walk out of the door and close it behind him. The sound of the wood slotting loudly into its frame made him sigh, and he held himself while looking around the open faced kitchen.

The ingredients Mydei had meant to use for a homecooked meal from scratch were left out, and his body moved before he could even register that it was. All he knew was that it was too late to make Mydei adhere to it, made a mess on the nice countertops, and his fingers were itching to do something. Anything to make the silent home not feel so *lonely*.

They reached to tuck some of the dry ingredients back into his pantry before looking at what was left. After gauging what quick and easy meal could be made instead, he opted to get a headstart on it while waiting for Mydei. Even if this was what he wanted to do for him tonight, clearly he was too stressed out to do much tonight. And that was… fine.

Well, it wasn't fine because it hurt to see the person he loved so torn up and broken down, but it was fine because he didn't need to always do this for them.

If he didn't feel well, it was up to *him* to take care of Mydei. No one else could because no one else really knew if he needed it. Phainon wanted to make sure that when he came back inside, the mental load wasn't going to be too heavy. Surely he had enough to think about right now without all these responsibilities and messes to look at.

And Mydei was going to come back. He had to. He *promised*.

Once he put the rice on to cook, he made his way back to the bedroom to plug both of their phones in, pick up what had dropped from his cabinet, and tuck away the last of his gear where it belonged. His fingers made sure they were straightened out neatly, that the straps didn't tangle and the chains didn't knot. Bottles of lube were wiped down a second time to ensure they weren't sticky, and the spilled box of condoms were picked up and dropped back into the cardboard.

The dirty towels from his shower, Mydei's shower, having sex, and disinfecting the bathroom counters after laying the gear all over them were tossed into the wash. His woven basket was placed back under the bodiless sink, lid on and out of the way.

By the time he finished tidying up, it was *definitely* past ten minutes. That meant he could go check on Mydei.

Phainon grabbed a zip up hoodie from a hanger, then shut the lights off in the closet and bedroom. He closed the door, flicked the hallway light off next, and made sure to grab water from the refrigerator just in case. Tennis shoes gently thumped to the floor for him to lace on. Keys jingled when he popped the ring off a hook and locked the door behind him.

It made him want to laugh to think about how he looked right now, especially as elevator doors closed and revealed his lounging clothes. But the sight didn't last long as a sweet and soft ding filled his ears.

If Mydei was anywhere, he was on the roof. At this hour of night, most people were probably having dinner or getting ready for bed, so it should be somewhat quiet. There were a handful of people minding their own businesses, but not enough to really be a nuisance to something like privacy.

Most of the equipment was still empty, but what was being used didn't sport the body he was looking for.

Just as he was about to storm to the lobby and check outside the building, he surveyed the entirety of the space. In doing so, Mydei was off all by his lonesome as he jumped rope so rhythmically that it was almost robotic. The bottom clicked to the floor loudly into the night,

rivaled only by the clank of metal from others and shoes smacking against the floor. Mydei's, someone else's on a treadmill, and soon his own.

He ran up to him, wanting nothing more than to wrap his arms around him and thank him for not just running out the lobby door. The whip of the rope kept him back, however, forcing him to keep his distance and steady his thoughts.

"Mydei," he called, but got nothing in response. "Hey, De."

Still nothing.

Frowning, Phainon waved his arm in front of his stoic expression, and the rope slowed skip after skip before stopping all together. With a final click to the floor, only the steady and hot breaths falling from Mydei's mouth filled between them.

Their eyes met, and a soft smile tugged over his lips to see his eyes dried of tears. Though there was an obvious puffiness beneath them, he looked like he was doing better. Like a little alone time really *did* help him.

"I brought you these," he told him quietly, holding out the water and sweater. "How are you feeling? I-I knew deep down you wouldn't have left me here, but… I still got a little worried you might. I'm sorry for doubting you."

Mydei dropped the rope to the floor. He quietly took the hoodie from his hand, accepting his offering. Left then right, he slid his arms into the sleeves and pulled the hood up, flaring it open. A step put him in front of his body completely, blocking him from the possibility of being seen by others. He took the bottle too, throwing back half of it in a few gulps before shoving it into his pocket with a crinkle.

"Do you not feel like talking?" Phainon assumed his silence was just a side effect of his overwhelmed state. "That's okay. I just want to make sure you're okay. I… uh… I care a lot about you, and seeing you so broken up really hurt. I'm really sorry, De. I won't do it again."

Amber eyes raked over his face, taking in his expression before carefully tucking the hair from his forehead. Finger tips brushed against the skin gingerly, and they curled slowly down his hairline, his cheek, then his jaw. They slipped beneath the bone and tilted his head back, showing off the expanse of his bare neck.

"You're covered in hickies," Mydei said, and warmth tickled into his cheeks at the thought of people possibly seeing him like that. "You don't have your choker on to cover some of them either. Do you want to show off to other people?"

"I was too busy thinking about you to remember they exist," he admitted, feeling as his hand lowered to cup his throat. "Do you need anything?"

"I actually do have something I need." Mydei leaned forward as he spoke, poking just beneath his jaw with his thumb. "I need you."

His heart skipped as he felt the tickle of his hair as it fell, revealing more of his cool, handsome expression. The relaxed state of his brows and pursed lips never looked more comforting than it did now.

"'*Me*'?"

"Yes. I need *you*. It was always enough to just be your friend. Simply being in your orbit allowed me to breathe easier than being with other people, but just *breathing* isn't enough to *live*," he said, not bothering to lower his voice.

"*Really?*"

"I've always been good at letting things go, and I'm good at covering up how I feel. Yet when I'm with you, I become someone pitiful… someone I've never been allowed to be," he confided in him. "You ruin me, Phainon. You make me feel like someone I don't even know half the time, and it's scary how fast and how easily he comes out around you."

That was *not* the confession he was hoping to hear, and his stomach churned slightly over the thought of '*ruining'* him.

"Do you… like him?" He asked hopefully. "The person I make you act like, do you like him?"

"He's the one you love." A steady inhale followed, but it shook lightly as it came back out. "I've never known what it's like to love myself, but I trust your judgment. And I've never known what it's like to love someone else more than my family or a friend, but I think this mess inside of me is love."

"'*Think*'?" Phainon whispered. "Don't p-play with my heart like this. Please…"

If this was a joke, it was sick and cruel. If this was speculation, it was unfair to get his hopes up.

Mydei shook his head lightly. "If you want a love that is selfish, needy, and vulnerable for you, then you've got it right here in me, Phainon. That's exactly how I feel when I'm around you."

His breaths caught in his throat, and as he looked into Mydei's eyes, he felt both his stomach knot and chest flutter. Warmth crawled through each vein, pooling hottest in his face even when a cool breeze brushed over his skin.

Both hands reached to grab his body. They slipped underneath the hoodie and touched his waist freely in their travel around it. Fingers clawed at his t-shirt, peeling it from his lower shoulder blades to squeeze inside of his fists. With it, Phainon pulled, knocking their shoes together.

"I did a lot of thinking about it." Mydei's fingers pinched lightly, stopping him from speaking when his lips parted. "And after I forced myself to sober up so I don't embarrass myself in front of others, I realized that I fucking *hate* the idea of you with someone else."

Phainon gulped, and he must have felt it as his hand loosened immediately. It spun around quickly, cupping the back of his neck tightly instead.

“The thought of another man seeing you the way I do makes me want to punch him in the eye, and I’m not even a violent person,” he said, and as much as that *shouldn’t* make his skin tingle, it did. “The thought of you wanting someone else the way you want me makes me want to slam a bottle back and take a long walk off this rooftop.”

“Don’t do that. Like… don’t do *either* of those things, but specifically the second one,” Phainon mused, smiling back at him when his swollen lips twitched upwards. “I need you here with me, alright? Who else will I get to dress up handsomely for, pour a glass of whiskey for every evening, and look for when the world's too heavy for my hands?”

Mydei leaned forward, and the hand not on his neck reached to grab his waist to pull him closer.

“I’m the *last* person you’re going to be doing any of that for,” he decided, lowering his voice so no one else could potentially hear him. “You are *mine*, Phainon. Your place is by *my* side, and if you think someone else can satisfy your needs better than me—*tough shit*. *I’m* your man, and I’ll sooner chain you down to my bed than watch you leave to fall for another person, do I make myself clear?”

Oh…

Phainon almost wanted to ask if he *promised* for another hit of reassurance, but he refrained in fear of striking a mood he wasn’t ready to handle.

Mydei looked as if he truly meant that, as if he had thought himself into this possessive state and it drowned out anything else he felt. He wasn’t going to keep *moping* that he wasn’t good enough. Instead, he was going to *show him* that he was if the time ever came.

Not that it would, but Mydei seemed to feel better acknowledging the possibility and overcoming it rather than completely ignoring it all together.

“That sounds kinda like a threat,” Phainon teased him, but not a single part of him was afraid of his words. If anything, it gave him a little rush to think about being cuffed to those hooks in his headboard all over again.

“It’s not.”

“Kinky.” He chose to keep the playful mood alive, hoping to ease his intensity down just a bit. “Is that what you wanna do to me next? I thought it's too soon for us to have another round?”

Mydei rolled his eyes, then pulled him closer by the neck until their lips touched. The skin of his mouth was still uneven and puffy from being torn into, but he kissed him like it didn’t hurt. He kissed him like a handshake, a signature at the end of a contract, a promise. Mydei *promised* that he was going to keep him, chase him, and make this work with him no matter what happened.

But his chest faltered. Though he wanted to try and seem unbothered, to put Mydei first, there was a pressure on his chest begging to be acknowledged.

Phainon's mouth shook in the midst of being lip locked, and tears pinched in the corners of his closed eyes from the sheer intensity of Mydei's resolve. Without meaning to, a soft and quiet sob broke their kiss.

"What a crybaby," Mydei murmured. "Why are you crying, handsome? Did I say something wrong?"

Phainon laughed through the tears, then shoved his face into the crook of his neck while pulling him closer. Likewise, Mydei held him there by the neck and waist.

"I'm not s-sad." He tried to swallow back a hiccup, but it broke through anyways. "I just… love you so much, a-and I'm so happy we're not pretending to only be friends anymore. I'm so happy I can keep doing this with you and not worry about the things I did."

A weight was taken off of his chest to not brush off the lingering flickers of love and want. They weren't masked under a thin veil of something else, hiding in fear of being too bold. They weren't foreign, terrifying concepts to swallow down and brush aside.

He could *love* Mydei. He could *want* all of him. He could be selfish with everything about him because he was *his* completely, *officially*.

"Yes, this is *our* life together, Phainon," he chuckled back, resting his cheek to his head.

Nodding, he let his eyes close as a soft gust blew past again. It reminded him that they were outside, in public, and even if they were speaking quietly, they could see Mydei's back and their legs standing here. Two guys not even working out, just holding each other with nothing but a hoodie to hide them.

"The people here can uh… see us…"

"I don't care about strangers." He brushed the concern off. "I'm going to kiss you when I want to, and I'm not when I don't. That's all there is to it. If someone doesn't like it, they can tell their therapist about it."

Phainon hummed curiously. "What about our friends and family?"

"Well…" That seemed to need a second of thought. "I won't purposely try to hide you when you're meant to shine as brightly as the sun, but don't expect me to be overly affectionate like other people."

"That's okay. As long as you don't treat me like a dirty secret, I'm happy," he agreed, aware being with him meant maintaining *some* kind of privacy. "Can we go back inside? I'm sure the rice is done, so can we cook up those vegetables and have a quiet night in?"

Mydei would like that, wouldn't he? Some silence, a hot meal, and a casual conversation to come down from the emotional rollercoaster of tonight?

“One second, being outside of the house is nice sometimes too,” Mydei told him, tilting his head back to look up at the sky. “I’d like you to be here with me for just a little bit longer, breathe in the fresh air and just… exist for a second with me.”

Phainon nodded as he felt himself sway gently to the sound of nothing but their own breaths, gym equipment being used, and cars driving past.

“*Yes, master.*”

Chapter End Notes

i need phainon to get hit on by someone, tease mydei for being jealous, and mydei to chain him to his bed and have his way with him. :3

also, writing mydeis little break down hurt. he did it to himself, but he doesnt realize just how charming and romantic he is as he adamantly refuses being romantic. he just does things that he wants to.

Chapter 20: Chapter Twenty

Chapter Notes

> your honor, i love writing parallels even if i need speech to text to spell the word.
>
> a soft chapter between aedes elysiae siblings because e2 phai and s1 rene came home. im so happy. i love them.
>
> also a lil hint of spice in the beginning because phais trying to get better at being vocal about his wants (because mydei is HIS so he finally can let himself WANT more)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Morning came quickly. The pale gold rays that streamed in through the large windows woke Phainon up before Mydei could, and they only grew both hotter and deeper as the day matured.

Their morning went the way it always did—brushing their teeth, changing into their gym clothes, sharing whatever kind of bagel or toast they felt like, and then working out. Mydei had a little bit less energy than he usually did, but so did he. That didn't feel *wrong* given their long days yesterday and the even longer night they shared together.

After working out, they rinsed the sweat and grime off and washed their faces one by one. Mydei first, as he always began preparations for the rest of their day while he was in the shower, and then himself. Wrapped up in a few ivory towels, one around his hips and the other over his neck, he leaned against the doorframe as watched as Mydei fixed his bed.

The fresh, crisp scent of eucalyptus filled the room. Water dripped quietly from a diffuser machine, creating a peaceful ambiance that had Mydei taking a deep breath.

"Are you okay?"

Mydei nodded, continuing to fluff a pillow before turning to face him. Wordlessly, he approached him, then looked down at his day collar before picking at it. The chain slid around to readjust it, each inch examined closely by his hyper focused eye.

Phainon looked at his hands, then carefully grabbed both wrists into his before lifting them towards his mouth. He kissed them as they stilled, as those amber eyes then raised to him.

"How should I dress today, master?" He asked softly, coaxing him to think about something else. "It'll be hot and sunny today, and I'm going to be running around taking care of some little things today. Preferably, without a jacket."

“*Wait*. Are you going to talk to her today?” Mydei said suddenly, and Phainon bit the inside of his lip.

“If she's home. I might be facing her *and* the girls if she happened to confide in them at one of their places last night." A nervous laugh bubbled up his chest. “Well, considering the evidence on my neck,—*and the fact I don’t own concealer, foundation, or whatever that thing people use is*—I think the topic of our argument isn’t going to last very long.”

“Mm…”

Mydei touched his bare forearms, admiring them for a moment before sliding them towards his biceps.

“If you’ll be out for long, put sunscreen on before you leave. Take care of your skin,” he reminded him. “Be sure to speak carefully if you happen to confront Cyrene too. She’s confused, and she’s trying her best to understand with what little she knows. Think about how *you* once jumped to conclusions with me and bombarded me with accusations.”

Phainon nodded.

“Did you even mean to tell me that back then?” He wondered, curious of how this all started. “When I told you about how *terrible* of a job I did at picking someone up, and you mentioned your last submissive, was that… on purpose?”

Mydei looked at his face for a moment, thinking, and then shook his head.

“All I meant to do was try to relate my experience to yours in the only way I could think of,” he explained, speaking softly. “If I knew I would have caused you so much mental anguish at the start, maybe I would have opened up more rather than let your curiosity run rampant. Maybe I could have saved you from hurting yourself…”

Phainon tilted his head slightly. “You wouldn’t have just shut your mouth?”

Somehow, he anticipated Mydei telling him that he would simply not say anything at all. If he hadn’t, they wouldn’t be here in front of each other. That sacrifice of never having this to begin with sounded like something he would make.

It put a sour taste in his mouth to imagine a world where he didn’t have this, have *him*, at all.

“You know what I want to say,” Mydei told him, confirming his guess.

“But you’re not gonna, are you?” Phainon pressed, hopeful that he’d fight. Even if it started rough, this was *theirs*. Surely, he’d fight himself and take this for himself all over again.

“I wouldn’t take it back.”

Those few words made him smile, proud that he was speaking what he felt rather than what he thought would be ‘*right*’. Especially when it was something he saw as ‘*selfish*’.

The hands on his arms dropped, finding his waist instead. Fingertips curled to indent the softened skin, and they lifted higher until finding the ridges of his ribs.

Phainon swallowed quietly as he straightened himself up off of the wooden frame and tightened a fist around his towel. His elbows were slightly bent, making room for Mydei's wandering hands. Still as stone, he let himself be explored freely.

"Do you want to touch me?" That caused him to stop, holding his ribs. "Mm… Can you please touch my chest a little while you tell me today's schedule, master?"

Mydei stayed still for a second, then brought both hands to either pec for a cup. They seemed to pause, contemplating something he wasn't sure of.

"Am I handsome?"

"*Gorgeous*," he whispered, entranced.

Phainon grinned wider as he took a step closer.

"Are you going to think of me at work all day, master?" He wondered, feigning innocence.

Mydei exhaled, "*I always do.*"

One of Phainon's arms wrapped around his neck, and he leaned in to plant a kiss to his unprepared lips. A surprised hum followed, then the gentlest push back before they pulled away. Before this could turn into more, Mydei pulled himself back and cleared his throat.

"I want to see you show off your arms and chest today," Mydei instructed him, and Phainon swallowed thickly over his command. "Wear a tank-top for me. Nothing else."

"'*Nothing else'?* Scandalous," he teased. "No pants or—*I-I'm sorry!*"

Either hand holding him reached to clamp down on his delicate nipples, silently and suddenly warning him of the words leaving his mouth. They ached deeply, yet he willed himself to stand tall as he took it.

"Yes, master. I'll… I'll wear a tank-top for you, nothing over it," Phainon rushed to say as a jolt of bittersweet arousal bolted through his body. "H-Hey… If you do this for long, e-everyone's going to see them through my shirt when I leave."

The hold loosened bit by bit until two thumbs pressed against them, rubbing around the stiffened buds to tease. Slow drags around the sensitive skin made him squirm, but he tried to take it without fighting. He *had* to.

"You asked for me to touch your chest, so don't cry about it when I do."

Quiet whines crawled into the air from his sealed lips as he allowed himself to be played with, his body serving as nothing but a toy.

“While you’re out, I want you to do two things,” he brought up firmly, giving him more orders to follow. “First, you’re going to treat yourself to something nice—buy a little treat to eat in between running around, grab a nice drink to sip on as you drive, or pick up a little gift at a store you like. It doesn’t need to be expensive, it just needs to be self-indulgent. I want to see it, so I want proof.”

Phainon nodded, then gasped when Mydei stretched his hands open to squeeze the muscle tightly. While pulling on his plush chest, his left eye slightly twitched with the need to shut, but he tried so hard to keep them focused. He needed to be present as he was spoken to, not succumbing under the pleasure of being groped.

“Second, I want to see you. Send me pictures of yourself so I can admire my sweet prince from my desk. Do you understand?”

“I understand, master,” he replied.

“Good.”

Both hands let go of that punishing grasp, but not before gently pushing on the outer sides to watch them bounce. Its recoil and fluidity in moving made him gulp, both embarrassed by its jiggle and turned on by the humiliating gesture.

He was becoming increasingly interested in how *hot* his body got when being sexually *bullied* like that.

“You’re mine.” Mydei continued to bounce his pecs as he looked him in the eye. “I expect you to think of me as often as I think of you. If you call, I always pick up, don’t I? So if I ask for a picture, what will you do?”

It was distracting to be fondled like this, especially when he could feel the weight shift as it rocked back and forth. But that must have been the point. He was meant to focus on his words even as he teased him endlessly, not give in to the pleasure.

"I'll send my master a picture of me,” Phainon answered. “A selfie, right?”

“Yes. As long as your face is in it, I don’t care how or where you take it. Get creative and impress me,” he encouraged him, giving him the illusion of freedom. “If you do a good job, I’ll reward you. If you give me half-assed shots, I will punish you.”

Tingles inched through his veins at the thought of a *reward*. No matter how small, be it a movie night with his favorites on the list or an extra treat after dinner, he liked indulging in his rewards. Especially when Mydei always looked so ready and so pleased to give them to him.

“Yes, master. I’ll be good,” he promised, then felt him squeeze again. Heavy breaths fell from his lips as he stepped closer, pushing his chest deeper into his greedy hands.

Part of him had grown a little bit used to this casual touching and teasing. Mydei liked his body, and he liked touching him in any way he could manage. Even if he was hesitant to

cross the line of being groped freely, places like his neck and face typically sat within his warm palms. Those always felt safe for him, and there was hardly any difference between their safety from then and their safety *now*.

He was loved, admired, and treated well. Whether using his body for his own pleasure or taking the utmost care of them, these hands wouldn't hurt him unless he liked it. That made these one sided touches feel better than he ever could've imagined.

"Mm… I have to start breakfast," Mydei mentioned, then ducked down to press a kiss against his day collar. "I'll get your clothes for the day, then start cooking us both a quick breakfast. Change and join me when you're ready."

"You're just gonna touch me like that and walk away?" Phainon pouted. "Mean…"

Mydei nodded. "I am '*mean*', but you like that."

He did.

As the hot hands left his body, as Mydei turned to walk into the closet and leave him there, a quiet breath left his lips. Shaky, and undeniably aroused, he followed him with silent footsteps, tingling in his stiff nipples and rosy chest. Rose blossomed over either pec from the sheer greed in which he was grabbed with. His cock peeked from behind the towel with a slight bump, ignored completely because sometimes his dominant just *did that*. He touched him enough to make him tremble and squirm, then left him like that—pent up.

While standing in the closet, Phainon kept himself standing upright and tall. Even if he wanted to crumble under the desire to beg for more, he knew it was useless. There wasn't a lot of time to mess around, and Mydei still had so much to do.

But he swallowed, then glanced at a full-bodied mirror briefly. The state of his own body—*Mydei's body*—made another tingle burn through his system. It numbed his insecurities and electrified his guts, coaxing him to crave more.

"Master," he spoke up, aware this was, essentially, *useless*. "Can you please touch me?"

"No."

A hit of arousal pumped into his belly.

"Please?"

Being edged like that was both infuriating and sexy, as it drove him to want to be even better than he already was. That lingering, throbbing feeling inside of him felt like a constant reminder that he wasn't as free as he thought he was. In the same way his collar brought him physical confirmation and comfort to feel owned, being teased by him made his insides remember that he was Mydei's prized possession. He was *his* to take care of and toy with.

"No," Mydei repeated. "I'm done touching you for the morning."

"Y-You're really gonna leave me like this?"

“Yes.”

“Why?”

“Because I can,” he said simply, and there it was. There was the answer he wanted to hear. “Because you asked me to play with your chest, so I played with it until I was satisfied.”

His dominant didn’t need a reason *why* or think up some elaborate excuse to touch him. He *wanted* to do it, so he *did it* because he can. Because this body was his, and he could do whatever he wanted with what was his.

Phainon nodded even if he couldn’t see it, then gripped his towel harder.

“It’s easier now than it was before,” he confessed, and Mydei hummed while holding a sleeveless black top. “I kind of like this feeling. It’s… uh… hot.”

“You didn’t have a choice once you surrendered your pleasure to me, but I’m glad to hear that.”

He couldn't help but chuckle over the response. “Still holding out on that ‘*tough dom*’ mood, huh?”

Mydei hadn’t let it go since declaring he’d punch someone just for looking at him, but he wasn’t necessarily *complaining*. Maybe it was cathartic for him to allow himself to be greedy enough to order him around after what happened. Maybe he decided that he wanted to grasp some of that control back after being so vulnerable.

“Here.”

Clothes were offered to him, and he eyed the all black outfit before taking it.

“Can I ask you something, master? No disrespect or anything, okay?”

“Make it quick,” he allowed.

One arm pressed the clothes to his chest, careful not to wrinkle them with too tight of a hold.

“Did you like the way I was before?” He asked, as that was something Cyrene had seemed particularly worried about. His clothes were changing. His accessories were changing. His ‘*charm*’ was changing. “Before the rules, the outfits, everything. Did you think I had a… ‘*charm*’ to me?”

“Are you worried I only want you because you’ve become my submissive?” Mydei asked him. “I have always had a soft spot for you. You’re my longest relationship and deepest friendship. No matter how you stayed in my life, I’d want you right beside me in my corner.”

Phainon nodded, accepting that as a ‘*yes*’.

“If you don’t like this, tell me. Are these clothes making you feel undesirable? Do my rules make you feel too suffocated to be yourself?”

“No, master. I just needed something to tell Cyrene later,” he answered, offering him a light smile. “I’d like to tell her that you love me for me… the new clothes and obedience just makes your dick harder than it already was.”

Mydei’s expressionless mouth wobbled slightly before he laughed to himself. The sound was sudden yet sweet, comforting in a way that made him proud of himself.

“Ah, Phainon… You really do have quite the mouth.”

One of his hands raised, and Phainon closed the accompanying eye when it slapped down on his cheek lightly. Its heat made him lean into it, and the full-palmed pinch egged the prickly sting on.

“You can tell her that you simply enjoy the way you are, and she may confront me if she has any kind of concerns of my own intentions,” he corrected him, yet the amusement hadn't yet faded completely away. “If you mention my dick to Cyrene in any capacity, you won’t be getting it for a long, *long* time, Phainon. I promise.”

With that, his cheek was let go of so Mydei could begin to walk away from him.

“W-Woah. Master, *wait*. Let’s not be too hasty,” he choked out, turning to look at his back when he paused. “If I can’t have you, how will I be able to make you feel good then? What about… *you know*, blowjobs and stuff? We just had sex for the first time too, are you gonna just… give it up so soon?”

“If *you're* the one who can’t keep his mouth shut about our sex life, maybe you don’t deserve to have one with me.” His shoulders shrugged. “Someone also gave me his fleshlight recently… If I miss getting my dick wet, I’ll lube it up and make you move it for me. Or, you can put ‘*pornstar*’ on your resume with the way you’ll be performing for me.”

Phainon gulped, cursing his cock for twitching at the picture painted inside of his head.

“Do I make myself clear?”

“Yes, master,” he returned, speaking as clearly as possible even if his body was full of butterflies. “Crystal clear.”

Mydei continued to walk towards the kitchen again, leaving him alone with his half-hard cock and a head full of possibilities—ones he never would have thought without his help. That fleshlight in hand as he pumped it over his body to his desired pace. Those hot, amber eyes on him as he touched himself not for pleasure, but for duty to get his dominant off. It was *his* place to please and serve him, even if it didn’t offer him anything other than fulfillment for being helpful.

Would Mydei want to use the blindfold he kept in his cabinet too? Would he also take away his ability to *see* his body if they did that?

A throb made him drop the fold of his towel to instead cup himself, and he groaned quietly to himself in remembrance of his ‘*not touching*’ rule before letting go completely. While nude,

his eyes glanced down.

“I can’t even take a cold shower too…” He muttered, having just got out of the damn thing. “Master’s so mean.”

The last thing he needed to do was think about that when he still had a whole day ahead of him, yet that was proving to be difficult. But as annoying as it could be, a flicker of excitement burned inside of him. Hot, heavy, and just a little bit guilt-inducing.

Being toyed with like this should *not* be arousing to him, but here he was, hard and willing. If Mydei tried to touch him again, if he mocked him and pushed his buttons to see him squirm even more, there was no doubt in his mind that he’d let him. This body was *his*, and so long as he loved him, took care of him, and treated him well, he could continue to have it in any way he liked.

Love and submission was proving to be a *dangerous* combination, wasn’t it?

—

His grievances didn’t last for long, however.

Between listening to fun, upbeat music with the windows down, sending Mydei as many selfies as he asked for, and picking a few things up for himself, Cyrene, and the apartment, it was easy to push aside that clawing desire. Mydei texted him sweetly too. Instead of teasing him even more like he sometimes did, he told him that the sun made his eyes look even prettier when it hit them and the sweet, taro and pudding drink he picked up looked pretty—even if the lavender and gold colors were *atrocious* together. But that was *his* Phainon, a weirdo.

Phainon also grabbed a drink for Cyrene, one that was strawberry and peach flavored. He was tempted to take a sip of it, but ultimately refrained no matter how sweet and delicious it looked. If he could hardly hold himself back, surely his best friend with an even worse sweet tooth than his would love it.

When going home, with his arms full of grocery bags for dinner and both drinks carefully balanced in one hand, the first thing he heard was clicking from a laptop keyboard. The first thing he thought of was that she was here as she usually was and doing what she usually did like nothing was wrong in the world. Each key was pressed in rapid speed, and the scent of toasted blueberry bagels filled his nose meaning she ate already.

As the door shut, he took a deep breath and looked at the woman curled into the couch.

Her too-long hair was clipped up into a balled mess, and her slim glasses dropped to the tip of her nose when she tilted her head down to look up at him. The yellow shirt she had on was

one she had stolen from him at some point in their lifetime, and it was old judging by the crackled, black smiley design on the chest.

One brief look was all it took before she immediately shifted her attention back to the screen of her laptop. It lasted no more than half a second.

“Hey…” Phainon greeted her, but her lips pursed tightly as her clicking grew louder. “I… uh… called into work today. We were running low on some things, and I had to put gas, clean out my car, and… Well, I wanted to talk to you…”

Her eyes stayed focused where they were, on her book.

“My co-worker might be mad. She tells me I’m the highlight of that job.” His chuckle felt more forced than anything, and it died just as quickly as it started. “Hysilens might toss me into the sea at some point. So, if you don’t hear from me… *glub glub*.”

There was no response. Not even a smile.

“How’s auntie and uncle?” He asked suddenly, then heard her spam a button repeatedly. “Have you talked to them recently?”

“They’re fine.”

“Good… That’s good…”

Awkwardness like none other settled between them, and he nodded before walking towards where she sat. Not even his approaching figure made her look away from the screen.

“I bought you this while I was out. You love sweet tea,” Phainon told her as both plastic cups touched the glass coffee table. “Peach with extra strawberry pearls. You like the popping ones, right?”

“You didn’t have to.”

“I wanted to.”

The clicking and clacking continued, making him sigh quietly to himself before walking towards the kitchen with his bags. While setting them down, he began to unpack the items and fold the paper bags away to throw out later. And since he was already there, he also placed the unopened bottle of soda left on the counter in the fridge, as he was sure she probably just forgot to do it herself.

Sometimes she did that. She grabbed things from the pantry, got distracted, and left them on the counter. If they were ever completely cleared off, that meant she was back at home with her parents.

“I’m making dinner tonight too! Are you gonna be here, or did you have plans?” He called out, looking at the ingredients. “If you’re gonna be with the girls, I don’t need to cook as much.”

“Don’t make me anything,” she called back, and he turned his head slightly in the direction of their living room. “I’m not hungry.”

“This is for *dinner*. That’s *hours* from now.”

“I’m not gonna be hungry then either.”

That was wrong. Cyrene was *always* hungry, and she never passed up an opportunity for him to cook her dinner. Especially since they both knew she’d just snack the night away or have a simple sandwich if he didn’t. Because she’d forget to eat, or tell herself she’ll eat later, only for ‘*later*’ to never come.

“You’re lying.”

She didn’t respond after that, and he took a deep breath before covering his face with his hands. They rubbed slowly, lining the sides of his nose before dragging down his cheeks.

If Mydei were here, what would he say to get someone to respond to him? He controlled the room so effortlessly all the time, and while he didn’t want to *control* her, he wanted her to *talk* to him. This cold shoulder treatment was both aching and annoying when he just wanted to fix things.

“Skipping meals is bad for you, ‘rene. You shouldn’t be so neglectful.”

Nothing.

“I’m going to make you food later anyway, and you better eat it. Don't let your stubbornness affect your health.”

Silence.

Frustrated, Phainon left the kitchen to stand by the wall separating them. His arms crossed over his chest, and he bit down on his tongue while watching her type away. Unbothered.

“What are you writing about that’s so interesting right now?” He asked, trying to calm himself down. “Is it the story about the guy lost in time waiting for his lover to come back? Or the one about the lady who seized a king’s crown and fell for her knight?”

Her clicking stopped.

“The first love story is pretty sad. Imagine waiting thousands of years just for your partner to come back…” He trailed off in an attempt to get her to speak. “Or imagine falling in love with someone you can’t have because you’re in the middle of governing a war.”

“What are you doing, Phainon?” She finally said, not even looking at him. “You asked me to mind my business, and I am. I’m leaving you alone like you told me to, yet you’re the one trying to pry now.”

His stomach dropped as she clicked her laptop closed.

“I… didn't mean it like that,” he tried to explain himself, guilty from making her feel as if she needed to ignore him. “Cyrene, I never meant to yell at you or make you feel bad about yourself. And I never meant to compare you and Mydei because that’s just… not possible.”

“I don’t wanna hear this,” she mumbled. “Save it.”

He watched as she tucked the device to her chest and stood up, ignoring the phone that fell, the tea he had bought for her, and the blankets her legs were wrapped up in. All she did was keep her head down and then walk, hoping to make it past him quickly and quietly. But how could he just let her run and leave this unresolved?

“Cyrene, come on.” One hand reached to grab her by the oversized sleeve, and she stopped. “*Please*. I don’t wanna argue with you. I don’t want you to… to ignore me, and I don’t wannna feel like I’m begging for attention. Can’t we just talk like adults?”

But she was just as stubborn as he could be sometimes.

“I’m minding my own business,” she repeated. “I’m not gonna b-be nosy or pretend like I own you anymore. I get it, Phainon, okay? Just… let me do my thing, and you can do your thing, and we don’t have to be in each other’s business like that anymore.”

He groaned loudly. “That’s not what I meant!”

“*That’s what you said.*”

“I was angry! You know I say stupid things when I’m upset, and what you did really pissed me off, Cyrene,” he tried to explain, exasperated. “You went snooping around behind our backs!”

“I really don’t wanna talk about—”

“And you stood here accusing Mydei and I of being people we *aren’t*. It felt like you were rejecting us both when we did nothing wrong," Phainon confessed, cutting her off. “You made it sound so *bad*, like Mydei’s some kind of puppeteer and he’s got me by the strings. *But it’s not like that!* I’m not… weak, Cyrene! I’m not going to roll over and just let someone walk all over me—*even* if I love Mydei.”

At one point, Mydei explained to him that his submission was not to be confused with weakness. Following rules and completing the tasks asked of him didn’t mean he was less than the one who set them up. Kneeling and allowing himself to be small, vulnerable, and powerless didn’t make him any less strong or capable of a man. It was a conversation that stuck with him since the moment they had it, and it changed the way he saw their dynamic completely.

Being told that adhering to these routines made him someone *weak*, someone being *taken advantage of*, felt a lot like a slap in the face to everything he’s learned and tried to let go of. Telling him Mydei was someone he needed to be careful of just reminded him of how *devastated* he was over the idea of actually hurting him. And it hurt. It made him angry.

“Can you say something, ‘rene? I’m *trying* here, okay?”

With her back still to him and head hung low, a light twitch shook her small shoulders. The sound of her sniffling made his heart ache, and he eased the fist wrapped up in her shirt.

“I-I didn’t mean to make you cry…”

“Mydei’s s-so intimidating sometimes… He walks in and all eyes are on him like he controls the room just standing there—no need to even *speak*.” Her voice was small and quiet, like she had felt this way for a while but was never able to tell him that. “He’s so secretive, and he clearly keeps everyone at a certain distance besides *you*. He’s all over *you*, and it's been worse as of lately like he *can’t* be away from you. Now, he’s talking you into changing your life and your style to suit him better. It’s… *scary*, Phainon.”

“… Is it?” He asked gently, not wanting to shoot her feelings down even if he *craved* to just *yell* that she’s got it all wrong. “What can I do to make it less scary for you? I’ll explain it to you if you ask because I *don’t* wanna have to pick between my best friends. Don’t turn this into a-a battle between you and him—”

“*I’m not!*”

“Then why does it feel that way?” Phainon insisted. “How can I get you to drop the suspicions and just… believe in us?”

She shrugged quickly and violently. “I don't know, Phainon! Maybe start with… with… *God*. Why does he even *want* to change you so badly? What does that do for him when he has it all already?”

The fingers on the shirt dropped when he realized she wasn’t going to walk away anymore.

“Mydei’s *not* changing me. I’m *choosing* to do things a little bit differently,” Phainon answered firmly, sick of the idea that he was helpless. “It’s *my* life, and I wanted to experiment with some new, healthier habits. He only gave me some tips from his own life, and they’re not anything someone like… like *Hyacine* wouldn't suggest anyways. If you asked her, or any nurse or doctor for some tips to feel healthier, she’d tell you the same thing Mydei told me—eat well, sleep well, and go outside to exercise. *That’s it.*”

“Why now? You’ve been friends for so long, but this all happened so fast,” she brought up, holding her laptop tighter. “What changed?”

Phainon hummed thoughtfully as he looked at her back, remembering all of their intimate moments from start to finish. From the tomato between his teeth to shut him up and to fact he had been underneath him while dressed in nothing but leather belts and cuffs, then everything in between. His growing comfort in his sexuality. Mydei’s journey into finding comfort in his own feelings. Their knowledge of each other at their most intimate and raw state of being, and their want to be what the other needed so no one else could ever fill it for them.

Everything changed.

Both of them went into it thinking they could come out the same people, but that was never in the cards. They would have always ended up right here with how possessive either of them were.

Last night, they stayed in each other's arms as long as physically possible. From the rooftop hug as they gazed out over the city, to holding hands on top of the table during dinner, and finally cuddling in bed while watching funny videos on his phone until bedtime struck, they were wrapped up together. But he wasn't complaining about being smothered in attention. In fact, he wanted it again, and again, and *again*.

He wanted Mydei *here* in his apartment with them so she could see them as they were. She could see there was no coercion between them, and things weren't as one-sided as they looked.

Them being together shouldn't *scare* her. Nothing felt '*scary*' about being with him.

"*We* changed. *We* aren't friends, 'rene," he shared with her, and she immediately turned around to face him.

"Wh-What are you talking about? Did you have a f…" Her words trailed off into silence as she looked at him, as she *really* looked at him since he walked through the door. Eyes to this throat, she gulped quietly. "You t-two didn't *fight*, did you?"

Phainon shook his head as one of her hands gently touched her own neck, pressing against a spot where his choker opened up on his own. He knew of the reddish-purple lovebite left there. He knew others saw it too when he walked by, the bruise more possessive and straight forward than the collar he wore every day.

He was taken. He was someone's.

He was *Mydei's*, and the people closest to them were going to start figuring that out soon. Why not start right at home?

"I love him, 'rene. I love him… so much more than '*just a friend*'," he said, smiling at the mere thought of his handsome face and low voice. "He's intimidating at first glance, sure, and he speaks pretty flatly and minimally. But he's a good person who does his best for the people he's close to, and he loves me too much to *ever* try and force me into anything I don't wanna do. Trust me."

She didn't answer, too busy watching his face and the heat warming his cheeks.

"I never meant to compare the two of you or make you feel unimportant to me," he repeated himself. "You could never be what Mydei is to me, but Mydei could never be what you are to me."

Wide, misty eyes blinked up at him, and he took a deep breath as she sniffled.

"Really?"

“I was angry because you basically said that we weren’t good for each other, and that the person I’m becoming isn’t ‘*me*’,” Phainon told her, spilling everything he had told Mydei. “But it is. I’m trying to do better for myself, dress up nicer to make him look at me, and visit him more often to be around him. Isn't that *normal* things a guy in love does? You love love stories and romance, so tell me—is seeing me like this *really* something to be scared of?”

Cyrene shook her head, then looked away from him as silence washed over them. Her eyes focused on the wall, face turned but still completely visible.

“Th-That’s all…?”

“That’s all,” he promised. “I like this thing we have, and I’d like for you to be happy for me. My family liking my partner has always been really important to me.”

Her eyes glossed over even more, and he reached to take her laptop from her hands.

“Can I have a—*mmph!*” The impact of her body hitting his chest made him take a step back to stabilize them both. “Yeah, *that*… I wanted *that*.”

Both arms wrapped around his waist, and he curved an arm over Cyrene’s shoulders to hold her closer. The glasses she had on creaked from the pressure of her pushing her face into his chest, and her long nails scratched through the tank-top he was wearing, but he liked this. He liked pushing his nose to the top of her head and feeling her close.

“I’m sorry for what I said,” he apologized quietly. “I’m sorry for worrying you so much. I just wish you would have come to *us* instead of trying to go to our friends and fish for answers on your own. Being confused doesn't mean you should accuse people of being abusive or two-faced.”

“I’m sorry,” her muffled voice said back to him. He could feel her mouth moving against his body, and the heat of her breath through his top from how close she was. “Phainon, I’m so sorry.”

“*I* forgive you, but you should apologize to Mydei sometime too,” he suggested. “I… might have told him of our fight, so he knows.”

Cyrene nodded quickly, and he pulled his arm back briefly.

“Here. Give me your glasses before you break them,” he offered. After she pulled her face back just enough to slip them off, it went right back into his chest.

“I’m sorry,” she sniffled. “I didn’t… I-I know it was too far, but… I guess I thought… I mean… I just…—”

“Take it easy,” he coaxed, holding her tighter. “And try not to get too much snot on this shirt too. I kind of like the feel of this one.”

“Too l-late…”

Yeah. He could feel how damp it was with tears and *more*.

“Awh, come on…” He joked. “Mydei’s gonna kill me, and we just barely made it official. There’s no way I can take both him *and* Hysilens on my tail.”

Cyrene choked on a laugh, then unballed her fists to plant them flat to his shoulders. But she didn’t move.

“I was… a-a little jealous too,” she admitted. “You’ve known him for so long, and I-I know we grew up together as kids, but he was *there*, you know? I missed so many important years of growing up… gossiping about first crushes, high school dances, sports games, learning who we are… I moved here with you as your best friend from *then*, but he was your best friend *now*…”

Phainon stayed quiet, not wanting to interrupt her.

“I can get along with the girls. We’re girls. There’s this… *thing* we just h-have.” A hiccup broke her words up. “But Mydei’s harder. We aren’t close at all even though I've known them all the same amount of time. Lately, I’ve been wondering if I’m just… holding on to the past too hard and holding you back from doing your own thing. I’ve never been good at letting go.”

“You’re not,” he reassured her. “The spot next to me isn’t a competition or a game of tug-o-war, silly. I have my partner, I have my friends, and I have my family. All three co-exist, and all three are important to me.”

“Did uh… M-Mydei call me selfish when you told him?” She wondered quietly, and he shook his head. “Did he say that I’m a terrible friend? That he never wants to see me again?”

“He would never say that to you. He said to talk to him if you have an issue with him,” he shot the assumptions down. “If you know what to ask, you’ll find that he *is* a very honest person. If you don’t ask him the right questions, he’s not going to feel the need to correct you or answer personally… unless you’re *me*. For some reason, he likes being particularly nitpicky with me.”

Cyrene pulled away from him. With the added freedom, he readjusted her things into one arm as she used her own to wipe the mess beneath her nose.

“You’re just r-really e-easy to tease,” she giggled through her raspy voice and sniffling.

“That’s gross. Go find a tissue.” He then pretended to gag, causing her to laugh and push her arm closer to her nose. “What are you doing just leaving it all there? *Shoo!*”

She turned to run towards the bathroom, and he rolled her eyes over her squeal of being ‘*so un-cute*’ when the light turned on. After living together, he wasn’t sure if her face full of snot was the worst thing he had ever seen. But it was, undoubtedly, a little bit funny. The laugh he gave was a little too hard to bite back completely.

He could hear the water run, then the splash of her rinsing her arm off. As she cleaned up, he set her things down on the coffee table.

“Make sure you drink this tea, by the way! Don’t forget about it on the table!”

She probably will, so Phainon made a mental note to remind her again sometime later.

“So, you a-and Mydei are together,” he heard from the hallway, and he hummed positively. “Does that mean I-I should also apologize for insisting that he likes girls?”

His eyes rolled. “You think *everyone* likes girls,” he reasoned.

“Why wouldn’t they? I do,” she sniffled again, making him chuckle quietly. “I feel so bad… I want to hide in m-my room and never come out. I should j-just never see him again.”

“Sucks to suck. I was thinking of inviting him for dinner sometime this week. You two should talk a little more,” he tsk’ed, enjoying her worried groan. “Stop seeing him as this ‘*too cool to talk to*’ person. He’s just a guy.”

“He’s going to think I’m a-a terrible person!”

Phainon wasn't sure how many times he needed to say it to her, but Mydei was *not* going to think of her as anything less than a confused and worried friend. Not *once* did he even blame her for anything that she felt, did, or said. All of it was simply, ‘*she’s doing her best to understand*’. Like he was when he came at him similarly.

“He’s going to come over with some kind of offering, try to make dinner all by himself, then ask about your book,” he said confidently. “He’s going to ask you why you feel how you do, then tell you that you shouldn’t worry so much.”

“Mm…” She shrunk back into herself. “Are you sure he won’t be like… angry at me?”

“Positive. He wasn’t angry when I told him, and he won’t be when you apologize.”

Cyrene rubbed her nose with the tissue, then crossed one of her arms over her chest while looking at him up and down.

“So, you told him about our fight, and Mydei uh… *haha*… Mydei consoled you with sex?”

“Cyrene!” He gasped, and she laughed while holding the tissue over her face. “I’m *not* talking about—”

“Oh, come on! It’s all over your neck! You’re so guilty!” She cut him off, smiling so wide that her glossy eyes crinkled. “I wasn’t around to tease you for your ex-girlfriend, so… I wanna talk about you and him. Does he treat you well, Phainon?”

Phainon sighed, then slowly traced his tongue over his top row of teeth while contemplating the weight of gossiping with her. Their relationship just became official, and Mydei didn’t like too much of his business being aired out. Just the little things, *casual* things, like his interest in baking and cooking.

As long as they didn’t talk about his sex life, it should be okay. Certain things everyone could notice about him and innocent acts people in love did normally should be fine to share.

“He’s very… romantic,” he said carefully, and she nodded in encouragement for him to keep going. “He likes to hold doors open for me, and he always calls me handsome… even if I’m all gross from work.”

Saying that out loud felt so… good. There had been a weight settled on top of his chest since he swore himself to secrecy, then again when she told him something was wrong with them. But she looked at him like she was actually interested in hearing about their relationship, like what they had was something she could now fawn over.

“That’s sweet,” Cyrene coo’ed.

“And… And the lego sets you saw me buy that day, we built one together,” Phainon added. “It’s in his house right now. We glued it together so it never falls apart.”

“Awh! He’s *that* sentimental?”

“And he cooks for me all the time.” He grinned, thinking about the breakfast they shared that morning and dinner from the night before. “Like… De will ask what I feel like having, and sometimes he cooks it just like I ask if I’m extra tired from work. Then we work out every morning, and he’ll make us a big breakfast while I clean up so it’s almost finished when I’m all dressed.”

Cyrene didn’t respond, too busy watching as he reached to touch his neck and hold the pendant closely. His fingers pinched, circling the ring shape slowly with his index while embedding the stone into his thumb.

“He’s so *handsome* too. I mean, he always has been, but it’s just so much more now than it was before. His body, his personality, and the way he carries himself is just so… *attractive*…” He struggled to word as a rush filled into his chest, familiar and warm like sunlight. “Oh, ‘rene… He’s everything someone could want.”

“Mydei better take good care of you,” she warned him despite her softened gaze. “If he doesn’t, I’m going to beat him up.”

All he could do was laugh at the mental image of her battering her smaller fists into his chest. If he somehow *did* hurt him, Phainon had no doubt that Mydei would try to duck just so it was easier to reach his face. It’d be just like him.

“I should shut up now. It’ll get annoying if you let me drone on about him. Do you wanna watch a show, or—”

“I wanna hear you sing more praise about him,” Cyrene egged him on, waving her hand for more emphasis. “Keep going. This is going to be great for the story I’m working on.”

“The *real* storybook lover is Mydei,” he protested. “You should talk to him about it when we have dinner together. He’ll inspire you so much more than me just rambling on about how gorgeous he is.”

“Maybe I will if he accepts my apology,” she agreed, then turned to look at her laptop. “But the look on your face is so much more expressive. Keep talking. Maybe I can get through the chapter I was stuck on.”

Well, if she insisted… He could talk about how much he loved Mydei all day.

Chapter End Notes

i wanna write more smut so the next one will probably have mydei and phainon messing around a bit again.

i really like sexual touches or acts that dont always end in penetration or anything too extensive, yk? i like making out thats just to make out, or groping just to feel because they cant stop themselves. its desire but its not ‘i gotta fuck him rn’. feels more intimate

and phainons got a pretty loose mouth. hes like an excited puppy barking and barking because he just loves mydei and loves letting himself talk about it!! wonder if mydeis gonna bully him for it or not when they get together next

Chapter 21: Chapter Twenty-One

Chapter Notes

> this took me awhile, im sorry. i started writing a diff chapter and decided i wanted something in between so this came to be. not for no reason though, as this shows how comfort they are with each other. i think.
>
> this is also just porn. i needed this.
>
> next chapter will hopefully be up soon. and will have more myph kinky things. so please enjoy

See the end of the chapter for more notes

For sending him such cute pictures while he was out running errands, Mydei decided his reward would be two different things. The first being the home-screen on his personal phone changed to him happily drinking his milk tea, and the second being a photo for him to have. Only this was incredibly *less* innocent than the ones he received that afternoon.

The first thing he did was ask how he was feeling, or if he was interested in seeing him as well. That was the dead giveaway there was *something* up his sleeve.

And when given an answer, that very next text sent to Phainon's phone damn near made him drop it into a bowl of soapy dish water. It shocked him enough for Cyrene to yell from her room that she heard something fall—'*something*' being his phone clacking to the tiled floor, screen side up.

"Fine! I'm fine!" He yelled back then rushed to pick it up quickly. "I dropped my phone!"

"*Butter fingers!*"

While in hand, he did a quick once over to check for any cracks. When none were discovered, his eyes went right back to the photo and audio message with it.

The picture looked to be taken in his home office considering the chair behind him and the peek of a liquor cart by his arm rest. Both halves of his button up shirt were opened, exposing the soft and smooth skin beneath. His tie was loosened, its knot hanging between either pec. Rose-tipped hair tickled his shoulders, falling loosely except for the gold-capped braid on his left.

Oh…

Phainon shakily raised the speaker to his ear, aware that his body was already interested in whatever Mydei was trying to do to him. Especially after being teased so much earlier that

morning, he wanted this. He wanted it *so bad*.

When he pressed play, his opposite hand held on to the counter for balance.

"*You looked so cute today, and I might have thought too hard about those pretty eyes and lips…*" Mydei said into his ear, voice breathy and low. "*My office is so hot right now…*"

He choked on a breath, and he looked down at his phone before shakily dragging his thumb over the keyboard. Click by click, he had to rewrite his text several times because of several typos.

> *[Phainon: You actually take photos like this?!]*

A text bubble appeared. While watching those dots move, he gulped. Nervous. Aroused. Everything in between.

Fuck. His body felt hot inside as he imagined kneeling by his feet and looking up at him in his chair like that. The memory of Mydei stuffing his mouth as full as possible with cock made his own throb, wishing he could give it some attention all on his own.

Mydei had stood up and used his face to get himself off then. One hand on the back of his head and the other on his chin, he fucked into his mouth to take the lear completely.

What would it be like to watch him lay back so comfortably and watch him do it all by himself from start to finish?

> *[Mydei: Only for good boys.]*

> *[Mydei: And you are a good boy, aren't you, handsome?]*

His knees felt like giving out.

"Cyrene, I'm gonna lay down!" He called out to her while rushing to his room, trying to keep his voice under control. "Cooking made me feel a bit sweaty and tired, so I wanna relax a bit before I eat."

"'kay! I'll eat after this chapter!"

The door closed behind him, separating him from anywhere that could potentially lead to him getting caught. Once safe, he immediately began typing one again while falling into his bed.

> *[Phainon: I'm a good boy, master.]*

> *[Phainon: And you're so mean to me. I'm hard all over again…]*

Mydei, believing that to be an invitation to continue, sent another picture. He sent another audio message, longer this time. Much longer. Maybe more explicit.

Phainon's hand reached for the earbud case on top of the nightstand, and he connected them before popping one into his ear. After he pushed play, he took a second to open up the picture

too.

"*You love to call me 'mean', but aren't you the one who likes being bullied? Don't make this one-sided, boy*," he chuckled, the sound heavier than it usually was. "*Your master thought about you so much and for so long that the image of your crying eyes and swollen lips came up at the end. Does it make me 'mean' to spend my day with my cute prince on my mind?*"

It was clear Mydei was thinking about him too, as his unbuckled belt and unzipped pants showed off the bulge behind his navy briefs. Heavy and thick, he could see where it pushed the fabric of his slacks higher. Both halves of his shirt were untucked completely, pushed back behind him to reveal the crimson tattoos on his hips and the dark hairs at the bottom of his navel.

Unable to stop himself, Phainon clicked the call button, then covered his face with his arm.

He missed the scent of his skin and the heat of his body after work. Soaps were nice. Lotions and oils made him turn his head. But his skin, his sweat, was so uniquely *him* that it made him want to tuck into his body just like that—raw and real in a way that felt *intimate*.

As the call picked up, he gulped.

"Hello, handsome."

"Hi, master," he greeted thickly, unable to mask the lust that stained his vocal cords. "You're bullying me again, you know."

A hum followed. "I'm doing no such thing. Are these pictures not a nice reward for you?"

"Yes, but—"

"No. No '*but's*. They *are* a reward." Mydei left no room to argue. "Say it."

Phainon's legs squirmed involuntarily, knees lifting and thighs tightening to try and ignore the craving to touch burning inside of him. He knew he couldn't. He knew that wasn't allowed, but he wanted to so badly.

This was *torture.*

"Seeing my master's body *is* a reward," he repeated quietly, careful not to be too loud. Though, that didn't feel like an issue with the loud ocean waves coming from the bedroom over. "You're so sexy, i-it hurts… This… is making me wanna touch myself, master."

"That's one of the few times you've ever told me that," Mydei admitted, shocking him too. "Did us making this official help you open up to these feelings? There's not as much hesitation now that you know this isn't going to end, is there?"

"I think so…"

Mydei scoffed. "You *think* is not an acceptable answer."

“I mean… I guess… it is easier knowing I’m not doing this just for this to end,” he corrected himself. “But also, I’m *really* turned on right now. Like… *really badly*.”

Back when he and Mydei first started this, he was way too nervous to ever sit and think himself into a pit this deep. Having to ask him to masturbate was nerve-wracking and embarrassing, and he didn’t really find the chances to. Most of the frustration was having to deal with, then brush off, his body’s occasional—‘*hey, you’re gonna be hard now*’. He was rarely ever feeling greedy for more, making it so he could limit just how pathetic it’d make him appear.

But now, his body wanted Mydei. It wanted to be touched and praised by him endlessly, then fondled and fucked by him like it had grown used to. This was nothing but a craving for the pleasure only Mydei could give him, and it made this denial infinitely harder than before.

Was *this* what made Mydei want all of this control? Knowing he was like *this* without even being around each other?

It was so *embarrassing*.

“Should I let you touch?” He brought up thoughtfully, humming slowly. “I’m enjoying your little whines so much.”

“Please, master.”

A soft, breathy moan filled his ear, and Phainon pushed a hand to his mouth to muffle his own breathing. Shivers trembled through his body. Heat burned inside of his belly. He turned his head while dropping his phone to the bed, unable to keep holding on to it when all he wanted to do was focus on Mydei.

“Guess what I’m doing, Phainon.”

“A… Are you touching yourself?” He asked quietly, listening to his heavy breaths over the other line.

“While thinking of how sexy you looked under my desk,” he added, and that made him roll deeper into his bed. “Mouth stuffed full. Eyes red with tears. Mm… *Phainon*…”

Laying on his side, he listened to Mydei feel good while reaching a hand between his thighs. His wrist pressed to the stiffened length of his own cock, putting some pressure on himself before he went crazy.

“Look what you did to me… I’m moaning into my phone like a virgin who can’t control himself…” An agitated grumble broke up his soft breaths. “All I did was think about that gorgeous face, now I want to fuck your throat open.”

“Was work stressful today, master?”

Maybe he needed this. A few drinks in and the frustration of having to sacrifice more time to work after clocking out, maybe Mydei needed to blow this steam off. And if he didn’t get off to anyone but him, then this was the quickest and easier way to go about it.

That gave him a tingle.

Mydei would rather *text him* than go find some random video online, and that made him giddy inside.

"*Don't* talk to me about my damn job right now when you know what mood I'm in," he demanded. "Focus on me."

Phainon did know what to expect… to an extent, and he only made it *deeper* by clicking the call button himself.

"I am focused on you. I'm listening to you as you tell me all these things," Phainon said as he shared the mental image of being face fucked by him. "Would you like me to be under your desk as you continue to work, master? This is *your* mouth and *your* throat, do you need them there?"

"… *Fuck*…"

He was going to take that as a '*yes*'.

His voice lowered, suggestive rather than teasing, to better please him. "Would you like it if I learned to take you all the way down, master? Every inch inside *your* mouth and throat?"

The thought made his throat tighten, imagining the stretch of his jaw as he sunk as deep as possible. Dark blond hair would tickle his nose. Balls would press flush to his chin. Every vein would be imprinted to the sides of his esophagus as he tangled himself in his vocal cords, basking in the vibrations when he moaned and revelling in the clench when he choked.

That would be nice, wouldn't it? Not just for Mydei, but for his own confidence in pleasing him.

"I could swallow your load like I did last time, master," Phainon reminded him. "You could force me to if I try to spit it out."

The unspoken, '*I'll let you*' was there, laced between his words.

"You should be on your knees for me *right now*," Mydei grunted, and goosebumps bubbled over skin from how displeased he sounded by the distance. "I should be training your throat to take me like a real slut should, not fucking my own hand."

"Yeah? You want me there with you that badly?"

"Fuck yes. I want you to make me feel better," he agreed, making a smile pull over his lips. "Phainon… Phainon, put your fingers in your mouth for me."

His eyes widened.

"Two fingers, handsome. Take two fingers, slap them on your tongue, and fuck your mouth as I fuck my hand," Mydei demanded. "Turn your camera on. Show me."

One hand patted around for his phone without a moment to spare, and when he found it beside him, he pushed the back up against a pillow.

This was *embarrassing*. It was *pathetic*. Typing his passcode in, staring at their risque messages between each other, and then flicking his attention up to the camera icon made his stomach knot nervously. Mydei wanted it, and he had been so quick to mindlessly agree, but… was that okay?

Never had he done *that* before. Was he seriously going to follow through with doing something like *that* through the phone with his roommate at home?

"You're taking too long. Give me a color," Mydei then ordered, already aware of his second guesses.

"Green," he answered. "But I need to be quiet. Please don't make me do anything too noisy or crazy."

"I've already thought of that."

Of course he did. Mydei thought of almost everything all the time. Why was he worried that he'd forget about something so important?

"H-How do you want me then, master?" Phainon found the strength to ask, unsure what to do. "What… position… I guess?"

"Kneel. Show me your big, leaky cock and your mouth being fucked," he instructed him. "I like looking at it all wet and red like it's got somewhere to be… If it's not my mouth or hand, where does it belong, handsome?"

"N-Nowhere."

"That's right. Show me."

The pad of his thumb tapped the icon, and he leaned back on his legs while looking at himself. His tank top was a little dirty from cooking, and his sweatpants were crooked on his hips, but two things were very apparent upon first glance. One being the tent pitched from Mydei's rough and needy voice, and the second being his stiffened nipples from the excitement hot in his veins.

Mydei turned his own on after, and he traveled over the heavy cock tucked into his closed fist.

"You make me so fucking selfish," he told him, and Phainon watched him move his hand. "I just had you yet I want you again already. *Dammit, Phainon*."

"Tell me what to do to make it better," he whispered, reaching for the hem of his tank top and raising it to expose his belly. "Tell me *exactly* what to do to please you right now, master."

"Pull your cock out. Show me how hard it is without even touching it."

Phainon used his opposite hand to yank both his pants and briefs down, letting both sit beneath his balls. Stood upright and glistening with precum, he fought the urge to do exactly what Mydei was doing now. Instead, it twitched from neglect and throbbed with need, the sight pleasing to his dominant's watchful eyes.

"That's it. That's my good boy," he praised him, and Phainon bit down on his bottom lip. "Pull your shirt—*there you go*."

One hand pushed his waistband lower. One hand lifted his tank top up to his collar where the tight fabric bunched up. Everything Mydei wanted to see was exposed, lit up under the warm-tinted light of his bedroom. Wandering eyes double checked the lock on his door, but once he was reassured that it was cleared, he looked back to his screen.

"You're wet."

He nodded, watching as a string of precum dripped messily from the tip and down its length. That little picture of himself in the corner was so… *erotic*. His body looked just like the men in that blog he had. Tied up in rope, dressed in leather, and stripped down to just skin, more often than not, he looked like *porn*.

Was he Mydei's *kink?* Was he his *fetish?* Did being his partner mean this was going to become more normalized for them?

Part of him was *proud*. He wanted to be the *only* person to ever get him off, and he *was*.

"Have you been thinking about me too?" Mydei wondered, holding his head with his hand not holding his cock. Those amber eyes were fixated on his body as if dazed by the sight.

"All I've done today is talk about you and think about you, master," he murmured, honest. "You make my body like this from just talking to me and showing me those pictures."

"Have I trained you to make a mess when I give you attention?"

"Y-You make it sound so pitiful," he protested weakly, trying to claim *some* kind of strength as he was ogled at. "I can't help that I'm attracted to everything about you, master."

"It's pathetic, but I *love* it. Oh, I *love* the way you respond to me like your body craves to be dominated," he breathed out. "I'm not even fucking there and you're going to train your throat for me."

"Am I?" He gulped. "Right now, master?"

"*Right now, baby*."

Oh.

His entire body jerked. The way his heart pounded and stomach fluttered needed to be studied, as it felt as if he had been completely winded from the most common of pet names.

Palm to his sheets, he bent over while holding the opposite to his mouth, stifling his surprised moan. And that amused Mydei, as his lip then curled arrogantly.

“Awh, did you like that, *baby?*”

How long has it been since someone that *wasn’t* an older woman called him that?

“Stick your tongue out for me, *baby.*”

“S-Stop,” he choked out, only for his hand to slide down his face until two fingers pressed against his bottom lip. “Master, I can’t handle—”

“—I don’t care. All I care about is watching you play with your gag reflex for me,” he cut him off. “I’ll do it myself the next time I see you, but for now, play with it for me until I cum.”

Slowly, Phainon stuck his tongue out for him to look at, and a quiet groan then followed.

“Sit up. You’re going to hold your wrist, keep your fingers up, and obey. But I shouldn’t have to tell you that.”

He did as he was told, sitting closer on his knees so he could see better while holding three fingers up.

Pleased by the display, Mydei allowed him to continue, to lick along the length of his fingers slowly before swirling around them. Saliva painted the skin, making it easier to slide them on his tongue.

This was *nothing* like Mydei’s cock or the toy when he gave it an experimental taste. This wasn’t even like Mydei’s fingers either, as the powerlessness that came from him handling his body was completely different. It didn’t feel nearly as good, or as satisfying, but they filled his mouth deeply anyway. His fingertips hooked to his tongue, stopping before it became too much.

“Fuck your mouth nice and slow. Follow my fist.”

Mydei wasn’t bringing his fist all the way down on himself. Right now, he was toying with the tip, moving in shallow thrusts.

Sliding his fingers back, he teased his own mouth as if he were currently sucking his cock. When Mydei went lower, he went deeper. When he went higher, he pulled back further.

“Good boy, baby,” he said, and his cock pulsed from the praise. “*Heh*. I saw that.”

“Mm…” Phainon hummed around them, still moving them steadily.

He wanted Mydei instead. It was so… frustrating to see it and hear him feel good, just to be alone during this. Like they were both teasing him until his patience ran thin.

“You’re so damn cute. I want to ruin you.” With that, he lowered his fist down slowly, coaxing his fingers deeper. The tips touched the back of his mouth, settling there for a moment at that limit of almost too far. “I want to see you cry.”

Mydei lowered, and he felt his fingers inch deeper until his knuckles pressed to the sides of his mouth. A quiet gag filled the room, but even while trying to be as secretive as possible, the earbud tucked neatly into his ear still caught it.

“Hold it. Try to breathe anyway.”

His eyes watered as he took a breath through his nose, trying to calm himself down.

“How sexy would it be to feel your collar around me…” Mydei said more to himself than anything judging by his far away tone. “My prince likes it buckled so tight these days. I bet I’d be able to bulge against it.”

Phainon had no doubt in his mind that he could, that if he were to ease every inch of himself into his mouth, he’d feel it. The mere thought made his fingers feel like more than what they were, like they tasted as salty as his skin and were as alive as the veins that throbbed over his cock.

“Hold it.”

A light flinch caved his chest in, breaths slightly ragged from having them buried so deep for so long. Spit pooled in his mouth, threatening to ooze from his sealed lips and soaking his fingers.

“Ease out nice and slow. Follow me, baby.”

He pulled back, guided by Mydei’s pace. With only the tips of his fingers by his lips, he swallowed, breathing heavily while looking at him.

“Do your best to keep up. I can’t keep you long, and I want enough time to talk to you after this.”

Phainon nodded in agreement, then pumped his fingers back in. His glossy eyes stayed focused on Mydei, on the way his dominant eyed him up and down while jerking himself off quickly. Every so often they slowed down, taking it deep and low to flex against his gag reflex, then went back to their steady pace.

The shame and embarrassment had left. His creeping insecurity of looking pathetic was nowhere to be seen. All that lived inside of him was a desire to get Mydei off and do better the next time his cock was stuffed into his mouth.

Mydei was enjoying himself. Low moans and soft grunts filled his ears, as well as quiet rambles of his deeper desires.

He wanted to lay him down on the bed, straddle his face backwards, and fuck himself down into his mouth until he was a mess of spit, tears, and cum. At that same time, he wanted to lick and suck on his own so he could feel him moan around him.

He wanted to pull his head off the edge of the bed, hold his chest down, and use his mouth so he could watch his throat fill with every thrust. The way his legs would kick, body would squirm, and hands would grip the sheets sounded so unbelievably sexy to him as he described it.

Phainon's head was a mess as he imagined them, clouded with nothing but Mydei dominating him.

But then Mydei's breaths picked up, and his hand went lower, which forced Phainon's knuckles to push deeper into the edges of his mouth. Walls constricted around his fingertips as he sputtered around them. Saliva rolled down his chin, and fat tears did the same along his burning cheeks.

"I want you t-to want it too," Mydei said shakily as he pushed the hair from his face to better look at him. "I want to watch you try at your own pace, handsome, like how you woke me up that morning. Fuck, it's so sexy when you push yourself for me without me making you."

He gagged, fresh tears bubbling over his eyes when his fingers flexed.

"Tell me you want—*don't* pull your fingers out," he rushed to instruct him. "Come on… Tell me you want it too, Phainon."

A garbled response left his lips, and his body caved with another flinch as he wiggled them against his throat.

"*Again*."

"Mm… *mmph—!*"

Gagging, Phainon shook his head quickly, nervous of the way his body was trembling. His throat tightened, wanting to swallow but not knowing how around his fingers. He sputtered helplessly as he folded in on himself, waiting to be allowed to stop.

"Try to relax, Phainon. Try to breathe and calm yourself down," a soft, guiding voice advised him. "*Hold it*."

Phainon shook his head quicker, one finger curling downward as his confident position crumbled. All the sexy thoughts he had of being touched by his hands slowly lifted, replaced by the sharpened fear of not wanting to throw up. The longer he kept his fingers so deep, the faster his body was beginning to reject it.

"Let go, baby. Shh…" Mydei hushed him, and he pulled his hand back as thick ropes of spit fell. "Say it for me. You want to take my cock."

"I… I want…" A stuttered and shaking breath interrupted his words, and he gulped down as much of the mess as possible before continuing. "I want t-to take my master's cock…"

"You want to swallow my load."

“I want to swallow my master’s load,” he repeated, watching him fuck his fist faster and harder.

“You… F-Fuck, Phainon… You’re so hard from this. You’re so handsome like this. I’m so obsessed with you,” he choked out. “I’m close. I’m so close. Make me cum, my prince. Talk to me i-in that wrecked voice of yours, and make me finish.”

“Please,” he begged, leaning forward to look closer at his camera with soaked, pouty lips and big, watery eyes. “Master, can… can you please cum for me? I’ll swallow it all, I promise, or… you can try to finish on my face.”

Mydei threw his head back as he groaned deeply from the image, eyebrows furrowed and jaw dropped.

“Is that okay? Would I look handsome covered in my master’s cum?” Phainon wondered as he admired his bouncing chest from each rapid breath. “Could you imagine that a-and tell me?”

“*So fucking handsome*,” he returned, voice strained. “Oh, Phainon… Ph-Phainon… *Baby*.”

“Master,” he returned.

“I’m gonna… I-I’m—!”

Phainon’s eyes followed his fist, watching as the first rope of cum shot over his bare chest and stomach. Thick, milky streaks painted the golden skin, and never had he been more jealous in his life. Especially since he loved the addictive feeling of his cock throbbing as he released. It was his favorite. Yet here he was in his bed, and there Mydei was in his home office.

God. This was *miserable*.

Heavy breaths filtered into his ear, and he smiled while watching him sink back into his desk chair. Seed stained the fist still holding himself and the slacks he pulled open too, making for a mess that needed to be cleaned up.

“You okay, master?” He asked.

Mydei hummed, long and drawn out, as he rolled his head to the side and glanced at his phone. Blood pooled in his face and chest, painting them in the prettiest shade of rose.

“I had… a really shitty day,” he confessed, laying there limply. “I needed this.”

Phainon nodded. “I could tell. Are you feeling better?”

“Is your throat ticklish?” Mydei asked instead, worried about him. “It might f-feel a little bit funny in the back… Not sore, but…—”

“I’m okay. It’ll go away,” he promised him. Upon hearing that, he smiled softly in exhaustion and nodded. “How are you? What happened at work today to make you so…?”

“Same shit…” His voice trailed off as he let himself go to wipe his hands on his pants. “Would you be mad if I said I liked the look of your denied cock?”

The whimper that left his throat made his partner chuckle.

“Master, please. I was good… I-I got you off.”

“I like how sensitive it makes you. I don’t even have to *try* to make it hard—it just is when you see me,” he mused. “How fast will you finish if I allow you to touch?”

His hips shifted. His misty eyes glanced down at his poor, neglected length before biting the inside of his bottom lip. Flushed a red so deep it looked dangerous, he knew if he tried to ignore it, it’d take all night. There would be no way he could leave his room.

“I feel like I can finish in like… less than a few minutes, master.”

“Can you finish faster than I can finish another drink?” He challenged him while slowly sitting up. “I need another, and my prince isn’t here to pour it, sadly. What a pity…”

“I-I can,” he rushed to agree. “Master, can I please touch myself for you? Can I please cum for you?”

Mydei nodded. “Your time starts now, baby. Make me proud, or suffer another night of being edged.”

The spit-soaked hand that had been testing and toying with his gag reflex dropped to his cock. He quickly lathered it with precum and saliva, then pumped his tightened fist down as Mydei slowly rolled his chair back. Within seconds, he was wheeling his cart closer into view.

“What are you thinking about, handsome?”

“M-My master," he whined louder than he meant to. “I’m thinking a-about how good he makes me feel when he plays with me. I love playing with him.”

“Good boy. Now, put your fingers in your mouth to quiet down,” he was instructed. Afterwards, he took a tissue out to wipe up his body. “Cum while gagging for me. I want to see it.”

Phainon did his best. He moved his free hand to his mouth, burying the two middle fingers as deep as possible. His other hand held himself tightly, dragging up and down his pulsing cock desperately. There was no time to tease himself or work himself up, just a race against however long Mydei decided to take.

His partner could rush. He could flick the cap off, shove the bottle down, and fill his glass so quickly that he didn’t have a shot.

Or, he could take the bottle slowly into his hands and carefully take the lid off before gently bringing the rim down to his glass. He could hesitate like he was now, watching him as the last of his bottle rocked back and forth from his teasing.

“Mm… You look so good,” he praised him kindly, voice lowered as he tilted the bottle up to stop himself. “Do you want to cum?”

He nodded quickly, gagging from the movement.

“How badly?”

“*So badly,*” was all Phainon could force himself to say around the intrusion in his mouth. Though it sounded slurred and garbled around his fingers.

Tightening his stomach and focusing on the rush of pleasure, he tried as hard as he could to get as close as possible. His thighs tensed, and his breaths quickened as Mydei began to slowly fill his glass. Its quiet trickle made him buck his hips forward, desperate.

“I wonder if you miss topping…” Mydei murmured casually, looking at his glass and swishing the liquor around. “Do you miss being the one doing the fucking?”

His eyebrows pinched.

“Or have you grown to love being topped?” He continued. “Do you prefer being fucked by me, Phainon?”

A flex made his ass tighten, remembering how big Mydei had felt inside of him and how deep he pushed. It was nothing like he ever experienced before, but it was sexier than anything they’ve ever done. Being beneath his leather-clad figure, pinned by his chest as he repeatedly stuffed him full of cock, was something he wanted again. Soon, maybe.

Oh, it felt so good to be fucked. He was so sensitive, reduced to nothing but mushy limbs and soupy brains.

“Do you want to do it again? Do you want me to fuck you nice and deep again?” Mydei coo’ed, and his fist moved faster. “How would you like it if I filled your mouth with my fingers too? You’d look so good like that, you know… both of your holes filled would be a truly sexy sight.”

Mydei fucking him in his back with two fingers flat on his tongue, flipping him onto his belly and slamming into him as he hooks his fingers into his mouth, seating him on his lap as he pushed his fingers in time with his bouncing body, all of it was making his body feel hot. His blood was boiling, heated from the inside out and making sweat stick to his skin. Some rolled down his forehead and arms, heavy.

Wet squelches from his tireless pumping filled his room, but he tried not to think about it. He tried not to imagine his walls being thin enough to share his heavy breaths and desperate hands.

Phainon thought about Mydei tipping his glass to his mouth, watching him like he was his favorite movie and studying him like an art piece. He thought about how if he finished that drink, he’d have to stop. He had to cum *faster*. He had to get *closer*. So much *closer*. So much *faster*.

A tremble wracked his body. It shook his shoulders as he choked himself deeper, and it forced his head to hang in front of him.

“Five seconds for you to cum before you go to bed, edged and denied like a little slut,” Mydei whispered, voice muffled by the glass held to his lips. “*Five*.”

His head shook quickly as spit dripped down his hand and arm, as pre-cum drooled sloppily from his aching cock.

“*Four*.”

Phainon sucked harder, hiding his own moans as he fucked his hips into his fist.

“*Three*.”

He was close. He was *so fucking close*. It was right there, and he squirmed in his bed from the overstimulation of jerking himself off to this degree.

“*Two*.”

Phainon ripped his fingers from his mouth, aware that he wasn’t told to, and smacked them into the bed as he leaned into his phone. With a jaw dropped, he exhaled heavily.

“C-Can I please cum?” He panted, and Mydei’s lips curled into a proud little grin. “Master, can I—”

“Put your fingers back in that mouth and cum for me,” he ordered him, and Phainon plunged them right back into his throat as his stomach tensed further.

Teeth sunk into his knuckles as he let go, hips stuttering to buck forward and body vibrating from the intensity. Either leg threatened to close, squirming helplessly over the explosive orgasm. Cum painted his own clothes and skin, dripping messily down his rapidly moving chest and belly from the full body breaths he was trying to swallow in from his nose.

Slow drags milked his sensitive cock, pooling more of the milky release into his hand and over his knuckles.

“I could watch you all day.” Mydei hummed after, and the sound of his glass touching the tray made his body twitch. “You’re so fucking sexy, Phainon. Everything about you turns me on, and it makes me want every bit of you that I can put my hands on.

He nodded weakly, slipping his fingers from his mouth and letting his tongue poke out as spit drooled from his lips.

“You’re such a good boy for me, baby. Made such a mess and came so hard,” he praised him. “Next time you come over, I want to play with you in person. I want to hold you and kiss you, and I want to test how much your throat can take.”

“*Nngh*…”

Phainon listened to him speak, slumped into himself and the bliss clouding his head.

“You’re gonna clean up for me, okay? Wipe up the mess, put some clean clothes on, and put those dirty sheets in the wash,” he instructed him. “Wear one of my shirts for me.”

He nodded weakly.

“Did you like doing this with me?”

“*Y-Yes, mas-ster*...” His breathy, tired voice answered.

Mydei picked his phone up, then shut the camera off. Rustling meant he was moving, no longer sitting in his desk chair.

“I’m terribly sorry for springing this on you so suddenly. I never meant to do all of this, just send you some pictures,” he apologized to him, but Phainon wasn’t yet ready to reach over and turn his own off.

“‘s okay,” he promised him. “My… My master needed me, and… that’s what I’m here for. Don’t want anyone else t-to take care of this.”

“My possessive little baby,” he mocked him lovingly, and Phainon smiled before nodding. “Can’t even look at another man or he gets all pouty.”

“Why d’ya wanna? ‘m right here,” he reasoned.

“I don’t want to. You’re right there the moment I need you,” he agreed gently. “You serve me so well. I’m incredibly lucky to have you as my partner, aren’t I? Someone this devoted to me makes me want to be greedier.”

“I love you,” he told him, and Mydei chuckled.

“I love you too, baby.”

Warmth inched through his body, and he grinned while forcing himself to sit upright.

“Can I… call you something too?” He asked suddenly, which earned him a scoff as if he should know that he was allowed to call him pet names if he wished. “In front of our friends and family, when I can’t call you ‘*master*’, can I call you something else?”

“Like what?” He mused.

“Please come up with one you like, master,” he offered him. “I’ll call you by that instead of a nickname like ‘*De*’.”

“Please still use my actual name. Not everyone wants to hear pet names all the time when you speak to them,” he said. “But I will come up with one. Now, clean up for me, handsome. Eat dinner, go do laundry, and please… move the plushie from behind you. That poor puppy saw more than he needed to.”

He laughed loudly, wanting to touch it but refraining as his hands were a sticky mess.

“I love my puppy,” he told him while looking back at it. “I sleep with him when my master’s not here to cuddle me.”

“I’ll get you more if you love him so much,” Mydei offered him sweetly. “If my sweet prince likes legos and teddy bears, I will get you as many toys as you like for being such a good boy.”

Phainon nodded gently. “Only if I’m being rewarded. Nothing else.”

“Of course.”

He clicked the camera button, turning it off before shifting to get off the bed. Shakily. His knees trembled a little bit when putting weight on them, but he held himself up as carefully as possible.

“Text me,” he was instructed. “I’m going to clean myself up as well.”

“I will,” Phainon promised him. “Oh, and have dinner with Cyrene and I sometime. She wants to apologize to you, and maybe we could talk.”

“That can be my excuse for getting out of a trip with my father. Thank you, I’d love to,” he agreed happily, making him roll his eyes. “I’ll talk to you soon, Phainon. Have a good rest of your night.”

“I will. I’ll talk to you later. I love you,” he said back, and Mydei was silent for a moment.

“You can try to call me ‘*my love*’,” he decided, and Phainon’s eyes widened for a second. “I love you too.”

The call ended, and he stared at the device as a wobbled grin stretched across his face.

‘*My love*’.

Mydei wanted him to call him by that cheesy, old-fashioned name like they were a married couple. That was something his parents said to each other, not so much people their age.

But his finger tapped the message bar, and he held the microphone down before watching the sound waves move.

“*Have a good rest of your night too, my love.*”

Once it was sent, within seconds, it was read. But it wasn’t nearly as quickly responded to. Seconds turned to minutes, and it made his stomach knot nervously.

Did he decide that he didn’t like it?

Phainon set his phone down, opting to clean himself up with his already soiled clothes and toss his filthied outfit into the hamper. He stripped his sheets, replaced them with a second

pair, and prayed he wouldn't step out of his room to another confrontation with Cyrene.

His prayers were answered when he peeked out his door and saw hers still cracked, soft ocean noises and clicking followed.

"Cyrene, dinner," he tried to remind her while turning into the bathroom.

"After this chapter!" Her muffled voice called back once he shut the door. "*Wait!* Phainon, I need the word that's like… like… when you… when…"

She screamed into her pillow in sheer agony immediately after, and he laughed as his phone buzzed inside of his hand. There was nothing he could really do to help her until she calmed down, so he gave it a second. She'd sober up soon enough.

> [Mydei: I could listen to you say that all day.]

Oh, so it took him that long to respond because he *liked* it? He liked being referred to as his '*love*'?

That was cute. In fact, that was more than cute. It was so adorable that Phainon couldn't help but grin as he pushed his back to the bathroom door.

> [Phainon: My love really is a hopeless romantic.]

> [Mydei: But on second thought, that name might not be the most appropriate for other people to hear. Not when it makes my chest feel like this.]

That was too bad, wasn't it? He asked for it, and Phainon was always ready to do as he asked. Even if it meant pushing into brat territory and risking a punishment.

> [Phainon: My master told me to say it, so I HAVE to. That's how this works.]

> [Phainon: Sorry, my love. Orders are orders.]

Mydei was surely going to scold him for being so mouthy and toying with his emotions like this. But it was worth it to imagine him red-faced and flustered as he read over their texts, or as he replayed the audio message in his spare time for comfort or reassurance.

He wanted to see it in person already.

Chapter End Notes

> oh mydei. spank this man rn. let him in on ur sadism, i swear he wants to be completely dominated at this point.

Chapter 22: Chapter Twenty-Two

Chapter Notes

> i love them!! i love their oral fixations!! i love mydei being DOMINANT and phainon being SUBMISSIVE!!! i love them enjoying their dynamic so naturally and shamelessly!!!!
>
> i love guided scenes and limit testing and plays without penetration, and that's what this is. phainon safewords, mydei respects him, and they have fun with a rougher kind of play before mellowing out.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Phainon asked what night Mydei would want to come over for dinner, the answer was *none*. He didn't really want to come over this time.

Instead, Mydei wanted *them* to come over to his place. *He* wanted to be the host this time around, and Phainon didn't mind that at all as he really liked being there.

That was what led to Cyrene pacing back and forth inside of her room, hands on her head as she asked him repeatedly, '*is this okay?*'

She opened and closed the door for him, showing him outfit after outfit to see if it was '*nice enough*' for a dinner with his '*boyfriend*'. Because Mydei at *their* place meant *he* was a guest who needed to be on his best behavior. But *they* were going to be guests at *his* place now, and she couldn't just look or act as she pleased in another person's home.

"It's not like you to be so nervous."

"It's intimidating going to his place," she defended herself, making him chuckle softly. "Plus, he's kinda… *high-class*, isn't he? Like… he didn't grow up picking vegetables from the garden, de-scaling fish for dinner, and—"

"That doesn't matter," Phainon cut her off. "Mydei's not like that. He's not going to stick his nose up if you dress comfortably rather than to the nines. All you need to do is dress *clean*. Don't go over with dirty sneakers or paint-stained clothes."

She held herself, looking around her closet as if his words hadn't curbed some of her anxiety.

"I think you see him as someone better than he is," he mused. "Mydei's in a different tax bracket, sure. He was raised with different standards of living than we were, but he's still just a guy. He's not this untouchable entity to hold at a distance, Cyrene."

“He makes himself out to be someone high standard and unapproachable sometimes,” she mumbled. “He’s civil, but it’s also like he’s too good to get close to. You just don’t see it as much because you’ve been friends for over ten years.”

He couldn’t deny that. Mydei *did* hide behind his carefully curated mask in public, letting it slip only when he was indoors with his friends. Even then, sometimes he still allowed everyone else to talk over him or without him, choosing to silently observe from afar or fade into the background to do something else.

‘*Supporting character*’ was what he saw himself as, and it *did* make him seem a little aloof to keep to himself so much.

“Just… wear what’s comfortable for you,” he suggested. “Here. Put a pretty dress on. You look really nice in white.”

“White is a terrible idea! What if I spill something on myself?” She gasped, offended by the choice “He loves his alcohol. What if I get wine on my dress? It’ll be ruined!”

Phainon sighed, staring at her mess of a closet. “Red?” He offered next, seeing a peek of that color.

“That’s way too sexy for a dinner with your man! The only red dress I have is for going out with *the* girls, not showing him *my* girls!” Cyrene shot down, and his nose crinkled.

Oh. It was *that* dress, her *clubbing* dress she swore wasn’t too short even if he swore that it was.

“Cyrene, it’s not a black tie event. Wear something cute! Put a little skirt on or something!” Her eyes squinted while rubbing her chin, staring at the railing packed full of hangers and boxes of shoes. “Just please don’t make us late. You still need to do your makeup.”

“It does *not* take that long.”

It did.

Her hair took even *longer* too considering she had this thing about growing it out as long as possible after having it so short as kids. At this point, the colored tips touched her thighs.

“Please,” he repeated, and she sighed dramatically before pushing him out of her bedroom. “We agreed on a certain time. Mydei values a well kept schedule and punctuality, so let’s keep to it.”

“Yes! Yes, I will! Now get out so I can change!” She huffed.

The door slammed in his face, and he raised one eyebrow before turning back around to his own room. With her dressers ripping open loud enough to thump on their rails, it made him wonder if *he* now needed to put a little bit more thought into his clothes. Originally, he was going to just wear some of the clothes left in his closet from Mydei’s place. Black jeans, a simple shirt, maybe some ankle boots. This wasn’t a dinner that would combust if he didn’t

wear the right pants or put on an ironed out button-up. He didn't *really* care to try any more than he usually did.

Staring at his drawer full of folded jeans, he eyed the blue pair he wore only a couple of times —the *gift* he was given in the past.

Well, *reward*. Mydei had bought these blue ones for *him* as a reward, and the black pair he wore more often as a gift for *himself*. These were meant to be enjoyed on his own, but he found little use for them these days.

One hand reached for them, touching the nice denim before deciding that Mydei would like to see him wear them since he hasn't yet. After all, even if he liked him in dark colors, he liked him being comfortable and confident in himself too. Maybe even more.

Maybe Cyrene wouldn't tease him for trying too hard either, which made it a win-win in his book as he pulled it free.

—

In all the time they've been friends, for the life of him, Phainon couldn't remember if Cyrene had ever been to Mydei's place.

Maybe when Mydei first hosted a housewarming dinner years ago. That night had been special even if he had to be talked into it by Castorice and Hyacine, but was that it? Once? In *years?*

She was tapping her nails to the bottom of the porcelain plate they wrapped up with plastic and ribbon. Cubed brownies were stacked into a neat pyramid, meticulously balanced to keep pretty. Though the edges were messy from being cut with a knife they forgot to keep wiping off, they tasted great. Snacking on what was left caked to said knife proved as much.

Showing up empty handed to dinner was bad manners, and while he knew that, this was *Mydei*. He didn't need to bring anything, but Cyrene insisted this was *standard*. It was *respectful*.

Phainon chose to knock rather than unlock the door on his own, and he stuffed his hands into his pockets while waiting.

"Smells good already," he hummed, and she hummed simply. "You need to calm down. If you cry, you'll ruin the makeup that took you *forty minutes* to do."

"I just couldn't decide what eyeshadow looked best with this! Should I have worn something classier?" Cyrene asked, and his eyes dropped to her pale blue blouse and matching skirt. "Oh… I should've just worn black and white. It's somewhat formal and classy. Watch him come to the door in a *button-up* and *slacks*…"

“Mydei dresses like that casually. He always has,” he reminded her, then heard the lock twist. “It’s kinda hot.”

She scoffed over his attempt to change the topic. “*Well*, *yeah! But—!*”

Mydei, as expected, was in a buttoned, collared shirt with a pair of dark pants. His hair was pulled up into a ponytail with his bangs clipped back with a few bobby pins. Sweat lightly glistened on his forehead, a result of working hard in the kitchen, no doubt.

“Hey, you two actually made it on time for once. Come in,” he greeted them. “You look beautiful, Cyrene. It’s nice to see you again.”

Both men let Cyrene walk in first, and Mydei opened the door wider while stepping to the side.

“Oh, this? I just looked in the closet and threw on what I found!” She laughed nervously, lying right to his face. “But thank you, Mydei. You always look nice.”

He nodded curtly. “Of course.”

“Oh! And we baked these for tonight!” She showed him the dish while he silently held a hand out. “Where do you want me to put them? They’re not that pretty, but Phai ate all the chunks off the knife, so they must be yummy!”

“I’m sure they’re delicious. The counter is fine for now,” he answered. When she didn’t notice him reaching for the plate, he retracted it back to settle on his hip. “How are you?”

“I’m okay,” she returned. “How are *you?* You look like you’ve been working hard in the kitchen.”

“I’m doing fine, thank you. Please help yourself to anything in the refrigerator. If you’d like something, Phainon can get it for you,” he offered, but she shook her head before walking deeper into his home.

Upon hearing her heels click to the wooden floors, Phainon reached an arm out.

“Cy—“

Mydei’s hand rested over his arm gently, and he shook his head to cut him off. Seeing it, Phainon dropped his arm as he lifted an eyebrow.

“It’s a bit irrational to ask your dinner guests to take their shoes off at the door, no?” Mydei reasoned. “I’m sure she tried really hard to put together something nice, so no need. Just come in.”

Phainon allowed the door to close behind his body, and he tilted his head slightly while admiring his face.

“Hi, *De*.”

Mydei glanced towards where their third party disappeared briefly. When he was sure she couldn't see, his curled index finger tilted his chin up and met his eyes.

"Hey, handsome." His voice lowered in both pitch and volume. "You look good tonight too. Let me take your jacket."

Phainon pulled his black jacket off sleeve by sleeve, revealing the fitted sleeves of his white henley shirt.

"I wore this jacket for you. You know, to meet your expectations."

"Then take it off for me too."

He handed it over to his awaiting hand, and Mydei draped it over one arm before leaning in to kiss his cheek. The soft brush made his smile widen, warmed by his chivalrous touch.

"I like the way those sleeves hug your arms and chest," he praised him quietly, and Phainon had hoped he'd say that when he put it on to begin with. "And those jeans always make your ass look good—black or blue. Go on, walk in front of me and show off for me."

Phainon laughed, then set a hand on his chest to gently push him away. In doing so, he made sure to sneak a press against his own chest and feel his body for himself. But it wasn't as unnoticeable as he hoped when the muscles stiffened underneath his fingertips.

"Try not to get too excited," he whispered just for them both, but turned to walk away from him anyway.

"Pour us all some drinks, and let Cyrene snack on the sliced bread if she'd like."

'*Yes, master*,' was on the very top of his tongue just begging to leap free from his lips, but he swallowed it down to nod instead. Harmless flirting was one thing, but *that* was something he didn't want to slip at all around her.

"And show me some more respect," Mydei '*suggested*' from behind him. "Call me something less casual than '*De*'. That's not going to be acceptable tonight."

"Yes, *my love*," he obeyed, listening to his breathing hitch. "Can I go now?"

"Y-You may…"

He made his way over to the kitchen, finding Cyrene there on a barstool with her purse on her lap. To make things less awkward, his elbow brushed her shoulder while passing by. The little bump made her gasp.

"Hey! Watch out, Phainon!"

"Sorry, you were in my way," he teased her, finding the cutting board full of cleanly sliced bread and a shallow dish full of a tomato and garlic filled dipping oil. "Here. Help yourself to this while we get everything ready."

Cyrene looked down at the offering, and when Phainon noticed her hesitation to be the first to ruin the display, he picked a piece right from the middle for himself. The crisp bread scooped some of the chunky dip, and he took a bite right in front of her before turning around.

“Mm… He worked hard for it, so don't let it go to waste, ‘kay?” He said, then finished his slice before wiping his hands on a kitchen towel. “Eat. Talk. Enjoy getting to be here and feel closer to us, that’s what we’re here for.”

That was when he heard her fingers pinch a piece as well, then the crunch of her biting into its crisp crust.

“Mydei’s also got a whole cart full of stuff for a nice cocktail to take the edge off. Would you like a glass?” He offered. “Or do you want some soda? Maybe water?”

“Soda, please,” she answered, then swallowed. “Mydei, this bread is really good. Did you bake it yourself? I know you typically do things like that.”

“I bought it,” he admitted.

“From where?”

Phainon smiled, glad she realized if she wanted *answers* then she had to be prepared to keep *asking questions*.

“It’s a bakery my mother likes to visit. I’ll give you the address,” Mydei explained simply.

“Mm-mm! Please do!”

While grabbing the two of them a pair of glasses, he also brought down three plates to set down neatly besides the finished food. Mydei joined him in the kitchen after their conversation, one hand brushing the small of his back when walking by.

“Behind you,” he warned him gently, and a shiver inched down his spine from the casual touch. “How was your guys’ days? Did anything interesting happen?”

“Couch rotted most of it,” Cyrene answered honestly this time. “Well, *I* did. Phainon’s much more active than I am. I tried to go on a run with him, but he’s too fast and stays out too long for me.”

“She gave up.”

“I strategically acknowledged the extent of my own abilities,” she said stubbornly, and Mydei picked a plate up while he poured two glasses of soda. “In other words, I… gave up…”

“If you start something new by trying to keep up with someone whose made it a regular routine, you’re bound to give up,” Mydei advised. “Everyone moves at their own pace. Start slow, and build your way towards keeping up.”

“I know,” she sighed as Phainon placed a glass closer towards her. “I just wanted to try, but I don’t like it. My hair is so heavy, so it drags on my head when I put it up to start running.

Then my shorts ride up to make my thighs chafe, and people look at you weirdly when you pass by."

A low, unbothered hum followed. "Sounds like excuses," he brushed off. "Those are superficial at best."

"They are," Phainon joked, sticking his tongue back out at Cyrene when she glared at him. "Mydei, water or a refill?"

"Both."

"Greedy," he mused over the immediate response, but his fingers stretched to reach for his empty glass anyway. "Please move so I can get to the cupboard for another glass."

With the added space, he quickly reached for a tall drinking glass like the ones he and Cyrene had. It was filled with ice water. The other carried Mydei's usual whiskey. While closing the bottle to put back on its tray, a hand settled gently over his shoulder.

Phainon turned his head.

"Thank you for being so helpful, handsome," Mydei told him.

Cyrene grinned from her spot in front of them, and his hands gripped the bottle harder.

"Please help me move everything to the table. I'd like us to eat comfortably rather than crowd around the counter," he instructed him. Phainon nodded in understanding. "Cyrene, I'm sorry to interrupt you. Do you mind moving?"

"No! No, that's fine! Anything I can do?" She asked kindly. "I'm not useless. I can do more than let you both do everything."

"I won't let my guest help. It's my job as a host to take care of these things," he shot down. "Phainon helps because he doesn't count as a guest anymore. He half-lives here by now."

"Mydei, but you do this when you visit too," she pointed out. "You take control of things like we can't help you. Please. Let me do something too instead of making you both do it all."

Mydei hummed, letting go of his shoulder while looking at her.

"You'll find I don't like splitting my responsibilities. The things that I feel are my duty, are simply my duty. No one else's," he shared with her, his voice holding an air of firmness. "If I'm a guest, I need to lighten the burden of my presence. If I host, I need to take care of my guests by allowing them to rest comfortably."

"It's a little… um… *how do I put this…?*"

Phainon butted in, speaking carefully while looking at his partner. "Sometimes your desire to do it all by yourself makes it hard for other people to feel close to you. You and I are doing all the work, and Cyrene just… doesn't want to feel left out right now."

His eyes dropped. “That’s not my intention.”

“It’s not, but it’s how it feels sometimes. By doing it all, you close off the opportunity to make a deeper connection with others,” he explained. “So, surely there's something she can do to feel included with her friends…?”

Mydei was silent for a second, then nodded in understanding. “Please help Phainon get the table ready, and I’ll bring our plates.”

Cyrene smiled as she got up from her seat, picking up the cutting board to bring it to the table for them.

“Thank you, my love,” he whispered as he leaned closer to kiss beside his ear. Mydei tucked closer to him as if he craved to be skin to skin. “Please allow us to take care of this, okay? Go sit down. I’ll bring out all of the plates.”

“Are you staying the night?” He asked him hopefully. “Pease tell me you are.”

“I can,” he agreed quietly. Every bone in his body wanted to stay the night too. “Cyrene can drive my car home, and you can drop me off tomorrow.”

“If she’d like the guest bed, she can take it. No need to send her home by herself,” he offered, but deep down, Phainon knew *neither* of them really wanted to dance around extra company later. “I’d feel terrible taking you from her like that. Especially after everything that has happened so far, I fear that’d make her feel more isolated.”

“I’ll bring it up later.”

“Thank you.”

Phainon then set the bottle down, and he picked up both of Mydei’s glasses to bring them to the dinner table.

“Hey, Mydei? Wait a sec’,” Cyrene spoke up, catching him when he passed her. “I… know Phainon told you about what I said before…”

Deciding that was *their* conversation to have, Phainon turned around to head right back into the kitchen to grab three small bowls of salad. Stacking them carefully, he carried the nice dishes to the dinner table, placing one by each seat.

When he finished, his quick feet walked him right back to the kitchen, and he grabbed three full plates to place them by either salad bowl.

“I’m working even on my day off,” he joked to himself while setting them down.

This time, when he was going back to grab the appropriate silverware, a strong hand grasped his arm and pulled him closer. It forced him to stay and listen, standing in between Mydei and Cyrene.

“I want to apologize,” she said, and her eyes glanced between them both before settling on Mydei. “I should have been upfront with you instead of trying to go behind your back, and I shouldn’t have doubted you. You’re *not* a bad person. I know that. I guess… *I don’t know*... I guess I was just…—”

“I forgave you the moment Phainon told me. If there’s something you need me to do to reassure you, tell me,” Mydei said calmly.

As he spoke, he linked their arms together like he needed him there, and Phainon looked down at their touching bodies. He curved his wrist to hold his hand better, and Mydei’s fingers slotted in between his own.

“No! No, it’s… fine. I mean, I don’t know why I even said those things…” She muttered. “It was stupid of me, Mydei..”

Mydei shook his head, not accepting the self-deprecating words. “You didn’t understand, and you shouldn’t punish yourself for that. It isn’t *your* fault *we* didn’t clue you in.”

“You really are so understanding, Mydei… It makes a person feel a bit… immature.”

His eyes shifted to his partner, and Mydei’s lip inched downwards as he shrugged weakly.

“Misunderstandings happen,” he reasoned. “Moving forward, please bring your worries to me directly. Don’t burden someone else if it's *my* motives being questioned or *my* mistake to correct. *I* am Phainon’s partner, and *I* should speak for myself.”

“I… also want to apologize for insisting that you get a girlfriend. I didn’t know you uh… liked guys,” she apologized again as one hand held her arm shyly. “You never corrected me, so I thought it was right to say.”

“I didn’t see the need to correct you because it isn’t anyone’s business who I’m attracted to,” he brushed off. “It doesn’t upset me to hear from you. I don’t care.”

“Still. It’s just as bad as my parents telling me to get a boyfriend, isn’t it?”

Cyrene looked away from them, and Phainon smiled widely to himself before setting a hand on her head. Ruffling her hair, she gasped in betrayal as Mydei immediately batted his arm aside for her. Both looked at him as if he had done something unspeakable.

“I spent so long doing my hair, Phainon!”

“You shouldn’t do that to a woman dressed nicely, Phainon.”

“You’re both being so serious,” he whined, wondering if he was the only one who felt as if anything more than ‘*I’m sorry*’ was unnecessary. “Come on. Let's cut the formalities and just relax a little bit. Why don’t you two just talk and become better friends to put this behind us all?”

Mydei’s lips pursed, and Cyrene carefully patted her hair down while looking up.

“Talk about romance, books, sweets, and flowers,” he listed the similar interests they shared. “The food is getting cold, so let’s not let it go to waste.”

Because Mydei loved him, and he wanted to solidify that their relationship wasn’t something to worry about, Phainon knew his partner would try endlessly to clear his name. The same way he was there to greet her with him when she came back from their hometown, gifted her a plush toy of a character she liked to make up for messing with her things, and baked the cinnamon rolls she enjoyed so much—he knew he’d try. It was the one thing he always did.

And Cyrene was no different. She liked being liked just as much as he did, and she felt just as deeply as him too. There was no need to be redundant when everyone knew that moving forward, they’d *all* try to clear up any misunderstandings before they happened again.

“I’m currently reading a book about a prince and a hero,” Mydei shared. “Perhaps you might like it. When I finish, you’re free to borrow it.”

“Tell me about it,” Cyrene beamed happily, meeting his eyes. “I wanna hear about it. Is it a love story?”

“Like one I’ve never read before.”

“My favorite!”

Phainon unraveled their arms so they could split, and Mydei followed his best friend to the table. While they spoke, he rushed to grab all of their silverware so they could actually eat. No one was going to stick their fingers into the mashed potatoes or salad bowl.

Cyrene thanked him as he handed her a set, and Mydei looked up at him when he handed him both his utensils.

“Thank you, baby.”

“You’re welcome, my love,” he returned, and those amber eyes followed him as he sat down. “This looks good. Thank you so much. Cyrene, say—”

“—*yeah yeah*,” she huffed. “Thank you for dinner tonight, Mydei. We’re always so lucky when you cook for us.”

“Please uh… e-enjoy," was all he said back, rose tinting his cheeks. “Anyway, about that book…”

—

After they had their dinner and dessert, after Phainon was finished washing their dishes and putting them away, Cyrene decided that she wanted to go home. She told him that he could stay if he liked, but she didn’t want to intrude on their alone time or sleep in these

uncomfortable clothes. It'd be too awkward for her, and it'd be even *worse* if she actually accepted Mydei's offer of pajamas to sleep in.

Phainon handed her his keys without hesitation, made her promise to unlock the front door for him tomorrow and not sleep through the whole morning, then gave her a hug goodbye. Mydei too, just before thrusting several containers full of leftovers into her hands.

With the door locked, Phainon gasped as his back thumped against it suddenly, not expecting it.

Mydei's hands took his own, and he threaded their fingers together while lifting them over head. Pinned to the front door, Phainon gulped quietly over their close proximity and the display of power.

"Hi, master," he greeted him while smiling sweetly at him despite the vulnerable position. "Can I do anything for you?"

"I spent the last hour on the couch listening to Cyrene ramble *on and on* about all of the things you said about me," he shared with him. "Someone has a big mouth."

Damn. Cyrene really didn't want him going home tomorrow, did she?

Phainon shrunk back, attempting to make himself look smaller as he flicked his gaze up at him through his lashes. When he did, Mydei's left hand brought both of his into the right. Lowering his hold from his palm to his wrist, he gripped them inside of one stretched fist.

"Do you have a big mouth?" Mydei asked, pinching his jaw.

"Maybe," he played along. "Or maybe I just love you and am proud to brag about you to others. Has my master thought of that?"

"That's not what I asked you. Let's listen when I speak," he chastised, and butterflies filled his stomach as his legs shifted involuntarily. "Do you have a big mouth, Phainon?"

"Yes, master," he answered. After, he dropped his attention to the lips across from him. "I have a big mouth, and I… I told her all about the cute things we do—legos, dinners, movies, stuff like that."

"There you go, that's what I wanted to hear," he told him, lowering his fingers from his jaw to his neck. While there, they stretched to either side.

Phainon gulped quietly. "Am I in trouble for that, master?"

His head shook.

Instead of speaking again, Mydei leaned forward and pressed a kiss against his lips. Soft, sweet, and short, he didn't give him the time to do more than push back. Once he did, he pulled away.

"How are you feeling? Not too full anymore, right?"

Oh.

His body squirmed beneath him when he stepped closer, pinning not just his arms but his restless feet too. Dressy shoes stood between his old boots, forcing his legs apart.

“T-Tingly, and I’m not really full anymore. It’s been awhile since we all ate,” he whispered back, feeling the buckles of their belts click together from how close they were. “Why? What did you wanna do to me, master?”

“Fill that mouth, of course,” he said as if he should have already known. “The kitchen is clean and the living room is organized, we have nothing left to do tonight but get ready for bed. Do you want to play with me for a little bit before we do, handsome?”

He nodded quickly.

“Can I please play with you, master?” He asked, and Mydei’s lip tilted higher. “Do I need to do anything?”

“Undress.”

A short tug attempted to pull his arms free, but Mydei tightened his hold.

“Undress *here*,” he finished.

“H-Huh?”

Here? By the front door? A decent walk away from the comfort of his bedroom?

No one was going to see. No one was here to see—just him, Mydei, and all the empty space in his house. But…

“Y-Your curtains are open.” He couldn’t help but notice the darkened sky behind him. “We usually close them in the room, but the living room ones are usually wide open, master. What if someone happens to peek in?”

“Are you saying ‘*red*’? Or are you saying you’re nervous?” He hummed, eyeing him up and down. “Be specific. We’ve done some pretty intimate things with my curtains opened, Phainon, like making out on my couch and me collaring you in my bedroom. Did you think of someone peeking at us then?”

“But… this is being *naked*, master…” Phainon reasoned. “And… the lights were off when you collared me. It’s harder to see anything then.”

“What are you saying, Phainon?”

His eyes glanced towards the tall, wide windows in the living room behind him. They were beautiful for letting in the morning light or showing off this sky-high view of the city, yet terrifying to consider the lack of privacy with the buildings across from them. Because all the lights were on, he was sure once glance would expose all of him if he were to walk around undressed.

Maybe no one was actively peeking into Mydei's home. Maybe he didn't think of it as a big deal because *someone else* might have been okay with doing that in the past, but the possibility of being seen by anyone other than him was uncomfortable. It made the rosy-hued veil of arousal lift over his senses, freeing them for a moment to feel discomfort and shame.

Phainon would do some embarrassing things if asked, like let himself be fondled for fun or kneel over his shoes, but he was *not* doing *that*.

"I'm saying '*red*', master," he told him, and Mydei nodded. "I won't walk around naked because the curtains are open. You can't convince me to risk other people seeing my body like that."

"I'm proud of you for standing your ground," he said gently. "Will you do this if I close them?"

"I will," he promised.

"Very well. Watch them."

The hand on his jaw moved, reaching instead for something inside of his pocket. Within seconds, the curtains began closing, and Phainon rolled his eyes before looking back at Mydei.

"You knew I'd say it, didn't you? Like when you made my harness too tight," he huffed. "Will you ever stop *testing* me?"

"That wasn't a '*test*'," he said simply, then took his hand out of his pocket. "I wanted to see if you would, but you won't. So in case you said '*no*', I was ready to close them."

Phainon's fingers lowered to the buttons on his shirt next, ready to undress for him.

"Now, take all of it off. I want you completely naked," he instructed him, quick to return to the task at hand. "Show me you're comfortable in just your own skin."

"Yes, master."

The first button slipped free, and Mydei's eyes watched closely as the second followed. Then the third. He watched when his fingers curled over his day collar, readjusting it beneath his shirt just to tease him.

With a pinch, Phainon grasped the collar of his shirt. He pulled it over head slowly, aware of the eyes glued to his bare stomach and chest as they were shown off bit by bit.

"You're being a tease," Mydei pointed out, catching on to his game.

"Can't I show off my body to you in a way that makes me feel sexy?" He pouted back, holding his shirt in one hand. "Where should I put my clothes, master?"

"My hand before I use it to smack you on the mouth."

“Unlucky for us both then, huh?”

Mydei’s eyes narrowed as he began unzipping his boots and slipping his socks off.

“*Phainon*.” That tone of voice made a shiver inch up his spine. “*Your mouth*.”

Boots thumped to the shoe rack beside him. His socks were placed by his shirt, then beside his belt when he unfastened the buckle to hand over. Deciding he should probably *not* push his luck too far, he dropped his jeans and kicked them up to his hand.

Once passed to Mydei’s hands, he took a deep breath. Looking down at his briefs, he steeled himself for a moment.

Right. All of it.

Both thumbs peeled the elastic band down slowly, inch by little inch, until his cock bounced free, until the fabric rolled to his thighs.

“*Fuck*,” Mydei whispered over the sight, and he grinned.

“Should I turn around when I pick them up off the floor, master?” He taunted, earning a shaky breath in return. “Do you want to see the front or the back more?”

“Mm… Turn around.”

Phainon faced the front door, then bent over slowly while pulling his boxers the rest of the way down his ass. Though he couldn’t see his reaction, the skip of breath and the quiet groan didn’t go unnoticed. If anything, not being able to see him made him focus more on the sounds going on behind him.

While pooled around his ankles, he paused. One hand pressed to the surface in front of him, bracing his body so he could stick his ass out. The other hand pushed on his stiffened cock, hanging it lower so Mydei could see the thick tip from behind.

Heat burned under his skin from the embarrassing position. For a moment, he wondered if he was *really* doing this right now, if *this* was the kind of person he was proud to be. Stripped bare and showing off every inch of himself for someone else’s greedy eyes, *who* had he become during this?

“Touch yourself,” Mydei ordered. “Get yourself harder just like that. Let me see it.”

Phainon gave a weak tug downwards with his scissored fingers. His middle finger swiped over the leaking head, massaging pre-cum around so it was easier.

“Is it humiliating?” His cock twitched over the acknowledgment. “Touching yourself somewhere you’re not supposed to, being treated like sexual entertainment, and then having to walk bare ass to my room while I’m fully dressed—*is it humiliating?*”

“Y-Yes, master,” he whimpered. “This is so humiliating…”

“But you like being my slut, don’t you?”

“I do.” The word still brought a tight, knotted feeling of arousal and guilt, but it felt good. “It’s… t-tingly and hot… Feels so… *freeing*.”

Footsteps brought Mydei closer. He heard the soles of his shoes tap against the wooden floors, then felt his presence right up behind his bare and open body. As fingers touched his waist and curled around to his lower belly, the muscles tightened instinctively.

“Can you please touch me, master?” Nails scratched into the door. “Please d-don’t just look at me. Please touch me too.”

“I’ve got you naked and collared around my house… I never meant for this to happen, yet here we are,” Mydei said into his shoulder. “And you *want* it so badly.”

“I do.”

“You *like* being so exposed to me.”

“I do.”

“Heh… Kiss the groom, why don’t you?” He mused, and Phainon turned his head over his shoulder. “What? Does my prince really want a kiss?”

“I do,” he repeated again as the fingers on his stomach lowered. “Can you please kiss me, master?”

Mydei planted his lips to his shoulder, causing his cock to twitch helplessly in his hand from the teasing.

“On my mouth,” he corrected himself before he could be teased again. “Please kiss me on my mouth.”

“Soon.”

He whined quietly at that, just a little upset that it wasn’t *now*.

Facing forward, he hung his head low and looked down at the fingers tickling up and down his navel. They played with the hair around it gently, scratching when moving higher but rubbing when going lower.

“All I had to say was I liked *this*…” Mydei lightly pinched, and he choked over a moan. “… And my good boy keeps it just for me.”

His hand explored lower, fingers stretching to thread through more of the trimmed hairs. Long enough to pull and thick enough to thread through, he grabbed a fistful of where it puffed the longest around the base of his cock. He didn’t *yank*, and it wasn’t *rough* either. All he did was comb through briefly and tug tightly.

“It’s… not any different from how I normally leave it,” he said honestly. “I’m glad it pleases you, master.”

“A lot of the things I ask of you are things you already do. Maybe we were meant to be,” Mydei taunted him. “Stop touching yourself now.”

His hand moved from his stiff cock, and he watched as Mydei lifted it to examine the flushed tip and sticky length. A short and loose pump made his hips jerk closer, but that earned him an immediate drop. Instead, his balls were wrapped up in his palm and squeezed.

“Needy,” that low voice taunted him. “Pick up your underwear and show off that ass—*my* ass.”

The body behind him left, and he bent over further to pick the cotton briefs up. Ass pushed out and body folded as deeply as possible, Phainon did his best to flaunt his body for him.

“I want… *Fuck*.” Mydei’s hand gripped his ass. “Phainon, I want to spank you. This perfect little ass is begging for my handprint across it.”

“Yeah? Right now? Even when I’ve been *so good* for you, master?” He pushed, already knowing his dominant craved this. “You can try it… Just *one* though, please.”

Mydei rubbed for a second, massaging the left side gently to soothe him.

“*Just one*,” he repeated.

Phainon’s eyes watched his legs, staring at what he could of his fully dressed body behind him. The difference between their state of dress, and undress, made his head spin.

“*One*.” He gulped, both nervous and excited for the thing Mydei has wanted to do since… maybe even before they agreed to their rules. For as long as he remembered, Mydei has brought up spanking over, and over, and *over* again. “*Two*.”

The hand holding his boxers tightened, and he took a deep breath when that comforting touch left. How far Mydei lifted his hand, he wasn’t sure. How hard he planned to hit him, he had no clue. The surprise was exciting and nauseating all at once.

“*Three*.”

A swift, sharp clap of a palm hitting his bare cheek echoed throughout Mydei’s home and inside of his own head. Behind it, his own sudden and pitched cry of surprise.

Physically, he lurched from the impact. His insides tightened involuntarily, tightening to gain some kind of control.

Phainon picked himself up quickly, breathing heavily from the lingering sting and ache. *That* was harder than the way Mydei’s hand met his cheek regularly or his chest that one time. He had such heavy hands, such strong arms, and while it didn’t *hurt*, it wasn’t just a slap on the wrist. It was a *spank*, like he was putting every bit of his desire for it into that one smack.

Would it be crazy to say he felt how much Mydei had been wanting to do that?

As the handprint lingered, it burned hot inside of his stomach from the bittersweet ache and ignited the knot of nervousness that had built up. Slowly, it began burning the frayed ropes away.

“Phainon?”

A soft whine fell from his lips when hot fingers touched the warmth of his potential bruise, then he shot a look at his needy, rosy cock. A string of precum dripped from the tip like his body couldn’t help itself, and he pushed his briefs against it so as to not drip onto the floor. The last thing he wanted was to have to clean up the foyer of his own fluids.

“Phainon, face me. Give me a color.”

Turning around, he glanced back at Mydei while biting the inside of his lip. Those amber eyes searched his face, tracing over his wide eyes, wobbling mouth, and the rest of his flushed expression. When he didn’t find what he had been looking for, a tilt brought the edge of his lips up.

Then, Mydei exhaled as if he had been holding a breath that whole time.

The briefs in his hand were shakily handed over and taken into a pile with the rest of them. To make sure nothing fell, Mydei had his arm curled upwards against his chest to pin them together.

“You *liked* that,” he accused him. “Give me a color anyway.”

“*Green*.”

Phainon took a step forward, and he watched as his dominant took one back.

“Naughty prince likes his ass being spanked. Was it hard enough for you?” He pressed, raking his eyes up and down his bare figure.

“Yes, master. It was perfect,” he reassured him. “It didn’t hurt at all. I… I liked it.”

“You look so good following me right now, Phainon. Blushing all cute-like despite being treated like my personal whore,” Mydei praised him as he continued walking backwards. Each step was slow and short, and it gave them both time to admire each other.

Phainon’s hands brushed the counter as they passed it, fingertips tickling the surface he had wiped clean and disinfected. Mydei’s fingers tucked a remote into a slot mounted on the wall, clicking it in place before flicking the switch to shut the lights off.

“Just like this, master?”

“Hands behind your back, handsome.”

The hand not holding his clothes beckoned him closer by curling both middle fingers, and he tucked his hands behind him. One held the opposite wrist, and the other balled into a fist.

Without speaking, he raised his palm to him.

His feet stopped even if Mydei kept walking further and further away from him. But as soon as they wiggled again, he began his steady pace to close the gap between them again.

“I want you,” Mydei said to him, voice low like he was distracted by the thoughts clouding his head. “I want to play with your body until I learn every sound it could make for me, every twitch it could give to me.”

Phainon moaned quietly. “I want you to do that, master.”

“I want to dress you up in a harness, then watch you walk around my house in rope or leather just because we both like it,” he continued, and the memory of tight ropes hugging his upper body made his cock throb.

Could he wear *those* while being fucked in the future too? Like he did with his leather harnesses?

“You should tell me to do that, master,” he insisted. “Tell me when you want it, then order me to do it for you.”

Mydei stopped walking to stare at him, and he stood in front of him both proud and present.

“I want to play with your throat right now,” he told him finally. “I want to blindfold you and play with that big mouth of yours. You looked so good fucking it on your own, now it’s my turn.”

Phainon looked towards the closet, then back at him as he bit down on his bottom lip.

The idea of having his eyes covered was a little bit nerve wracking. Not being able to see if Mydei left the room was terrifying, and it tickled him the wrong way while he was this prepared to submit. Like a little shock of reality from the fantasy of being completely owned. Even if just for a second, he didn’t want to be left alone while bound or restrained in any way. *Especially* if he couldn't speak or see.

“Do you promise not to leave me alone?” He asked, and Mydei tilted his head to the side. “If you blindfold me, please stay right next to me.”

“I won’t leave.”

“Okay… I want to try it then. What should I do first to prepare, master?”

“Grab your collar and take your choker off. I will grab the rest,” he instructed him. “But before any of that…”

Two fingers lifted upwards to curl around his necklace, and he tugged him closer before leaning in. While letting their noses touch, Phainon let his eye-lids droop.

“The kiss my prince deserves.”

Their lips brushed, and as much as he liked their sweet kisses and innocent pecks, it wasn’t enough. Just a touch of their mouths was worse than teasing when he was so ready to drop and give him whatever he wanted.

Phainon kissed him deeper, lips parting to coax Mydei to do the same.

“Mm… If you get me started, I’m not going to stop,” Mydei whispered, then cupped his cheek. “You know I love kissing you. Phainon, I… *mmph*…”

Another kiss broke the sentence up, and when he accidentally let a smile stretch across his face, fingers snapped against his cheek.

“Stop,” he ordered him. Phainon could hear the hunger in his voice anyway. “Go do as I said.”

“One more,” he murmured. “Can you please kiss me one more time, mas—”

A shove forward cut off his words, and Mydei gripped his cheek tightly while kissing him deeper to hold him still. Fingers curled into the plush skin, sliding against it until they closed into a fist. Once his fist balled completely, he dropped it to point at the nightstand.

“*Go*,” he repeated after, turning away from him. “I *won’t* say it again.”

“Yes, master.”

Mydei walked off to the closet while Phainon went to the dresser. He picked the leather collar up and popped the button to his choker so he could put it down. Sliding it back into place, Phainon admired the collar before holding it to his chest.

When Mydei came back, the first thing he did was toss a folded blanket onto the floor. The second was tossing his blindfold and their dildo on to the bed. Third, he took the collar from his hands and nodded to the place designated for him.

“Kneel. I won’t cuff you on top of this all, but I want your hands on the bed as you face me. Don’t move them.”

Eager knees fell on to the floor, and he stretched his arms behind his head to the neatly made bed. Leather brushed over his neck, tightening down enough to feel as he swallowed. Once buckled, Mydei cupped a hand under his chin and lifted his chin, forcing him to look up.

“Does the edge of your collar hurt the back of your head when I hold you this way?”

“No, master,” he answered, admiring his body as he stood over him. “You look good up there, by the way. My master’s so sexy when he’s in the mood to bully me.”

“All the time then?”

Phainon bit back the urge to laugh. “Yeah, all the time.”

The hand not on his chin reached for the blindfold, and he dangled the leather item over his head. It swung left and right, twisting to show off the soft padding meant to protect his eyes.

“Here, touch it with me. Give me one hand.”

He reached for it, holding the gear and squeezing to see just how plush the back was. Buckles clinked quietly on one side, and the belt studded into either corner was thicker than he anticipated it to be.

Curiosity brought it closer, and Mydei allowed him to gently rest it over his eyes.

“Smells like leather.”

“Yes, well…” Mydei didn’t finish the sarcastic remark, and he laughed again despite the nerves in his stomach. “Is it scary to you, Phainon?”

“No, master. I can feel your fingers touching mine and hear how close you are,” he told him, then pulled it back. “Can you please put it on me?”

The blindfold was taken away from his hands, and he brought it back to the bed. Back arched in and weight rested comfortably over his spread knees, firm hands brought his gaze forward. Fingers brushed through his hair, tucking it from his face gently.

“Close your eyes.”

As soon as they closed, the padded blindfold touched the top of his face. With it came the scent of leather and the tight hug of his strap as Mydei tightened its belt.

Taking away his sight completely made his stomach knot, and he squirmed underneath Mydei’s hand when it touched the top of his head. Locks of hair were fanned over the strap, coaxed back into place the way he usually had it.

“How does it make you feel?” He asked, and Phainon’s lips parted as he turned his head. “What do you see?”

“I can’t see anything, obviously,” he retorted, then felt a shoe brush his knee. “What am I supposed to see?”

“Perhaps I worded that wrong.” Mydei’s other hand pinched his jaw before cranking his attention higher and back towards him. “Tell me what you *imagine* awaits behind this blindfold, smart ass.”

He gulped. “I… I think my master is still standing over me, watching me. Maybe he’s smiling because he likes how I look… Do you like how this looks on me?”

Breath fanned over his face, and he jerked away from surprise before being pulled right back.

“Almost.” That voice was so close, like Mydei was bent over right in front of him just inches away. “I *love* how you look right now, Phainon. Even blindfolded, your face is so red and your lips are trembling. I can tell you’re nervous…”

The hand on his chin dropped, and he choked over a moan when fingers cupped over his cock.

“But this right here is leaking a fucking mess because you’re so aroused,” he purred, stroking slowly. “Hold your fingers up for me. If your comfort changes, don’t hesitate to let me know. I’m going to push past these nerves. I’m going to test how far you can go.”

“Y-Yes, master.”

“This mouth loves to run. It loves to drone on and on, and I bet it could run out the hands on the clock if given the chance,” he told him. “I think it’s so cute that you want to sing my praise. The picture of you gushing like a school girl with a crush makes me so incredibly proud of the man I am.”

A twist around the head made his hips jerk, and he moaned shakily over the jolt of pleasure.

“But you know what else makes me so incredibly proud?” His voice lowered, and Phainon nodded quickly. “The sound of your pretty mouth stuffed so full that you’re *gagging*… then the fact that's all *for me.*”

Suddenly, he let go of his aching cock. The hand on his head never left, but because he had no clue where the second would go next, his heart was racing faster. His body itched to move, to search for where it could possibly be if not on his body.

“One more kiss before I make you gag on your toy,” Mydei told him before lips pressed to his briefly. “Tell me how you feel about that.”

“I… *am* nervous,” he stated the obvious, lips moving against his. “But… I still want you to keep going. It’s exciting when you take control like this… so, please help me practice for you, master.”

Phainon chased his mouth weakly when he felt him pull away, just to be held in place by the fingers in his hair. Silicone touched his lips after. Its tip traced over his bottom lip, coaxing them open until he could taste it on his tongue.

“Make it wet,” he was instructed. “Slick this toy up so it can slide down your throat better.”

Saliva pooled in his mouth when he closed it, and his tongue swirled around the head once, twice, then three times. Just for it to shift direction and rub length wise across his mouth.

“If you impress me, I’ll give you the real thing.”

“Please,” he blurted out against the toy rutting along the sides of his lips. “I want it. I-I want my master’s cock the most.”

“Let’s make sure you can handle it first,” Mydei hushed, angling the dildo until its tip touched his tongue. “As impractical as enforced ‘*training*’ when I’m not around sound, it’s really fucking sexy that you even want to *practice* with me like this.”

He eased the toy down, letting it pump shallowly over his tongue and past his lips. Each brought it lower and lower, warming him up to the feeling of having his cheeks hollowed, jaw opened, and mouth fucked.

“If you can take the real thing, you can take a bath with me later," he brought up casually, and Phainon moaned quietly. “Does that excite you? I know how much you love being next to me. I’ll let you share the tub with me, and I’ll cuddle you as we soak. You won’t need to speak if you don’t want to.”

That sounded so *nice*.

Mydei’s tub was so comfortable to sit in and relax inside of. He had all the makings for a beautiful and relaxing bath, and to be held in his arms like that sounded perfect. After all of this, *that* was how he wanted to end the night—cuddled close and held intimately.

He had to be *good*. He had to *impress*.

He had to.

“I’m going to go further. Hold it for me,” he coaxed him while pushing deeper. “Open wider, stick your tongue out, and relax. Let it go down.”

Phainon opened his mouth even more, tongue lolling over his bottom lip even further. With a nudge, he felt the tip touch the back of his mouth.

“You can take it.”

He took a deep breath through his nose, then nodded as Mydei reeled it back slowly. Faux veins slipped against his tongue, and the blunt tip was lightly traced back and forth for a moment. But as it lowered, it didn’t stop. Not like before.

Silicone pushed deeper and deeper, and he twitched while feeling the balls lightly touch his chin.

“My good boy.” He held it there as his body began to curl in on itself. “Shh… Calm down. Breathe through your nose, baby. I’ve got you.”

Phainon tried. He stilled himself as much as possible, trying to breathe slowly around the intrusion. The hand on his head gently played with his hair. Fingers rubbed his scalp to soothe him, silently encouraging him to focus on something other than the toy testing his gag reflex.

Mydei had him. He was going to be both careful and firm, and he wasn’t going to push him too far without warning him.

When thrusting carefully, he gagged quietly.

“You’re so handsome when you try your best. Hold on just a little bit longer for me. I know you can take it. I know it.”

When he gagged again, one of his fingers dropped. Breathing became more difficult as the initial panic of going too far began to rise again, and Mydei slowly inched the dildo back.

Spit spilled over his lips and mouth as he gasped, and the hand on his head lowered. It slipped to the back, cupping him to tilt his head forward.

“Swallow. Spit. Put all of that saliva somewhere, Phainon. Don’t go choking yourself on it,” he instructed him, and he gulped it down. “Are you okay?”

“Y-Yes, master.”

Lips pressed to his forehead sweetly. He leaned closer to them, causing another to touch his temple immediately after. With it, the finger that fell lifted back up.

“Again,” he decided. Phainon dropped his jaw, tongue flat down for the toy. “Good boy. Do you like being shown how to please me?”

He nodded, feeling as his mouth was rocked back into.

“Mm… I could do this all day,” Mydei said quietly, pushing as deep as the toy allowed him. “I don’t even need you to suck me off. Phainon, I could sit down and fuck your mouth like this just for fun, just to hear you choke, gag, and enjoy being played with. Do you enjoy practicing like this?”

Phainon nodded again, folding from the pressure but trying to brave it yet again. For pleasure. For confidence. For himself. For *Mydei*. He wanted it all to make him feel as good as *he* did whenever his partner swallowed him down to the balls.

Again and again, Mydei pushed against his limit and tested it, hoping to make it easier and more comfortable. Even if he whimpered or tried to pull away, his head was forced to stay completely still. No matter how messy he got, or how ragged his breathing grew, he was choked repeatedly.

Balls deep, his bottom lip was starting to feel a little tender from the jelly balls bumped against it repeatedly. Slick flowed down his chin, his neck, and his chest, sticky and thick from his mouth being fucked so firmly. The thrusts weren’t rough, nor were they fast, but it was relentless. Mydei fought to keep going, to push him just shy of too much before giving him a short break. Then he went right back to it.

This time, however, he pushed even deeper. His fingers pushed on the flared base as he no longer felt them cupping the balls, forcing him to take even more even as his head shook and shoulders trembled.

“Settle down,” he demanded, tilting his head back. “Hold it until you physically can’t anymore, Phainon. You can do it. My submissive is strong and brave, and a little bit of deep throating won’t take him down. Breathe through your nose. Listen to my voice. *You’re okay*.”

The instructions and praise made his already hazy head spin, and he tried so hard to keep as steady and stable as possible. But his chest still shook, and his knees still shifted in place.

“You’re okay,” he repeated firmly.

Another gag filled the room, and his three fingers dropped to two as his cheeks puffed. It was getting harder to breathe as he felt his throat tighten, clamping around the tip bent to accommodate the curve downwards. Heat burned inside of his face and chest, creeping and climbing throughout all of his body.

“You’ve got it, baby,” he reminded him gently.

Phainon shook his head weakly, retching another choked noise into the room. This one was rougher, more breathless, and just a little bit scary.

He tried to hide, to pull away and turn his head in an attempt to dislodge the dildo from his body, but Mydei held him firmly in place. His palm pressed flat to the toy, fingers curling to his cheeks so there was nowhere to run or spit it out.

“Come on,” Mydei encouraged him, rotating his palm and grinding it deeper into his throat. It made him jolt uncomfortably. “Keep it in as long as you can. I’ve got you.”

Slowly, his second finger curled, unsure if he was ready to call it or if his dominant wanted *more* from him. Could he go longer? *Should* he try to push himself even further? Would that make him even *better* for Mydei and solidify himself as the *best?*

No.

No, that didn’t sound *right*.

Mydei didn’t care about that. His master didn’t care if he was stiff, leaking, and aching inside of his pants. If he couldn’t take more, he wouldn’t *make* him take more. When he didn’t want to do something, then he didn’t *have* to do it. That was the end of the story every time—his personal pleasure be damned.

He couldn’t *breathe* right with the panic building more and more violently. He couldn’t *see* Mydei’s reassuring presence. He couldn’t *hear* anything but his own racing hard and the retching growing faster with each passing one.

He could *taste* the acid burn on the back of his tongue, vile and uncomfortable.

That second finger dropped quickly, and Mydei shifted his hold as if *he* were the one with his strings being pulled by his hands. His wet fingers clawed at the balls pushed deeply to his mouth, peeling it back for him to cough and spit out the pool of saliva in front of him. Heavy pants dropped from his glistening lips, wracking either lung as they rushed to keep up with the demand.

“I’ve got you, Phainon. Calm down for me.”

Something fell in front of him, and he jerked away from the splatter as a pair of fingers worked the strap of his blindfold. It was lifted off of his eyes slowly to ease him back to the light in the room and pulled off completely after a few moments.

Mydei kneeled in front of him swiftly. One knee slammed between his legs and into the wet mess on the blanket as he gripped his chin gently.

“You are so good for me,” he repeated, then leaned forward. “Kiss me, baby. I need a kiss from you really quickly.”

Phainon pushed forward, bringing his arms around his neck and pulling him closer. Spit smeared over Mydei’s face, slicking his chin and cheeks, but he didn’t seem to bat an eye. All he did was kiss him deeper, harder, like he couldn’t get enough of his lips.

“Did I scare you?” He asked while giving him another chance to gasp for air. “Are you okay?”

He nodded honestly. “Master, I-I wanted to be good—”

“*You are*,” Mydei cut him off, soothing the tickle of fear that told him Mydei might be disappointed in him. He knew otherwise, but it lingered, anxiously weighing his stomach down. “I am so proud of you, and you amaze me every time we play. Thank you for using your safeword, Phainon. I was looking for it.”

He gulped quietly.

“Thank you for being so good for me, for knowing how to recognize your own comfort,” he continued to praise him. “Do you want to end this completely? We don’t need to do anything else tonight.”

“I-I taste… vomit… in the back of my mouth…” Phainon admitted, voice raspy from the fucking. “I’m sorry I stopped. I panicked ‘cause it… it did scare me.”

“Please don’t apologize,” he hushed. “The point was for you to safeword, Phainon. I wanted you to tell me when you reached your limit.”

He nodded weakly, leaning into him as he basked in both reassurance and gentle touches. Eyes closed, his body was pulled even closer to Mydei.

“Did you have enough?”

“I still want you.” The arms on his neck dragged until he held his face. “I wanna m-make my master cum, then I wanna take a bath with him.”

“We can bathe *now* if you’d like.”

His head shook. “I want my master.”

Fingers began to play with his sweaty hair again, and he watched as his partner kissed his cheek and jaw. Lips touched the fresh tears tracks, trailing higher until he touched one closed eye.

“Do you?”

“Please,” he pressed. Mydei kissed his forehead next, causing him to gulp. “Master, can I please suck you off? I’ve been practicing. I’ve been working really hard to take more.”

“You have been,” he agreed, then stood up in front of him. “Here, baby. I’ll let you have it if that’s what you *really* want, but you *have* to take it easy for me, okay?”

The buckle opened quickly and the button on his pants popped open, causing them to pool around his legs. Eager hands tugged his boxers down, exposing the stiffened length of his cock.

"This is all yours,” he promised him, working his shirt off next. “Start nice and slow. Give me your hands and show me your color. I want them up here with me. These are for me right now, and I *need* them.”

One hand was planted on his chest, and the other was cupped within his own to hold. Taking a deep breath, three fingers raised once again, lifted where Mydei could see them with ease.

He held him firmly, looking down with a softly tilted smile. “Are you okay?”

“Mhm…” When he didn’t seem to like that answer, Phainon shook his head briefly. “I’m sorry. I’m okay, master. Just give me a second. Trying to s-swallow it down.”

“You can start whenever you’re ready. There’s no rush and no pressure,” Mydei allowed, and he leaned forward while holding his gaze. Lips to the tip, he planted a soft kiss to it while pooling saliva in his mouth.

Rolling his tongue around him, Phainon hummed softly, pleased by the salty taste of his skin. It washed away that bitter, acid taste that had invaded his mouth quickly.

“I do really like doing this,” he confessed. “I like using my mouth here to make you feel good, master. Pleasing you like this makes me happy.”

“I’m so glad, handsome. Going down on you is *my* favorite thing to do as well.”

It was so nice to feel him over his tongue when he brought himself closer, and even nicer to feel the little pulse of life from the vein beneath. As fun as fingers and toys may be, they could *never* hope to recreate the comfort and pleasure of *him*.

Mydei didn’t push him to take more. He didn’t thrust his hips either to chase more. All he did was stand there steadily, holding his hands and giving him the control to take it as he wished. However slow, however shallow, he was going to simply accept it.

Bobbing slowly, Phainon warmed his jaw up to the stretch, taking more bit by bit. He didn’t try to shove him into his throat after that last push with the toy, but he did try to ease his way down. Gently. *Carefully*. This wasn’t a rush to the finish line. His job wasn’t just to gag on it and make him cum down his throat so they could hurry up and move on.

He wanted to *pleasure* him, yes, but he wanted to indulge in his own need to *feel* him.

“My boy has such gorgeous eyes…” His lashes dropped for a blink, still heavy with past tears. “Keep them on me. Don’t look away from me.”

He never planned to look away now that he could see him again. Mydei was too handsome, and his presence too safe, to focus elsewhere.

Lowering himself, he let those soft moans of encouragement guide him. They brought him to the edge of his limit, to toying with ‘*too much*’ before he ultimately backed away. Over and over, he let himself touch that line with his cheeks hollowed deeply. Soft suction noises left when he pulled back too far or moved too quickly to hold on tight enough.

“Mm… you’re making me feel so good, Phainon. I love your mouth,” he panted. “You’re getting so much better at this, and it makes me so proud.”

His own sense of pride filled his chest, and he moaned around him before fitting more past his lips.

“Someone’s eager even if I told you to take it easy,” Mydei chided, giving his hand a squeeze. “Relax. Don’t push yourself too hard.”

He nudged deeper every time his head bobbed, bringing him closer and closer to taking him completely. The hand being held wiggled lightly, and as much as Mydei pouted over not being able to hold it, he let go. Instead, Phainon lowered it to the base of his cock, rubbing up and down the dark blond hair as he slotted him between his index finger and thumb.

“I like when you do that too.” A puff of breath fell from his lips. “I like when you touch me, Phainon. Does my body please you? Is it attractive to you?”

His hand rubbed again, feeling up on his pelvis before wrapping around his cock to replace his mouth. Slick with spit, he pumped him quickly, faster than he had been sucking him off.

“So much,” he rasped out. “I love y-your body so much, master. No one is sexier than you.”

To prove it, Phainon sat higher on his knees and planted a soft, open mouthed kiss on his belly button. The hair tickled his nose and lips, but he continued lower down. More kisses lined his skin, peppering over every inch he could get. Until he sat right back down on his legs, and he tilted his head back to kiss his balls.

“A-Ah, *wait*,” Mydei hissed softly. “If you focus too much there, I’m going to cum.”

“Please do, master.”

The flat of his tongue ran over the heated skin, tasting it and bathing it in spit. He rolled them around carefully, fondling them with his mouth before leaning closer, so close that he was able to suck both into his mouth.

“Oh sh-shit,” he grunted as he dropped a fist to Phainon’s head. “*Phainon*…”

His hand moved faster. His tongue worked harder.

Egged on by Mydei's moans of pleasure, he continued until those breaths grew faster and his body grew more restless. His hips began to buck now that his throat wasn't in the way, chasing more pleasure. The veins throbbed with need while squeezed tightly in his fist. Fingers pulled on his hair to grip tight, but they *still* didn't push or pull him in any direction. That hand followed him, letting him do as he pleased.

"I-I'm close," he warned him, and Phainon pulled away before dropping his hand down. "How do you want it? Tell me how you w-wanna take this load, handsome."

"However my master wants it."

"On your face. Let me paint that pretty face," he rushed, and Phainon nodded before taking him back into his mouth. "You feel so good, baby, *fuck*. You're gonna look so good wearing my cum… g-gonna look like a *pretty little slut* just for your master."

This time, he pushed himself to take him as deep as possible, bobbing himself down until his jaw was forced open wider, his throat explored even deeper, and his eyes filled with fresh tears. The tip of his nose touched skin, tickled by the dark blond hair, and he closed his eyes as he felt Mydei's body bend forward. He felt him double over in pleasure, gripping his head like he never wanted to let go.

"I'm gonna cum. Oh, your th-throat's *so damn tight*. It's squeezing me so much," he panted, and Phainon gagged as he tried to hold himself there a little bit longer. "Take it out. Come on, d-don't push yourself too much."

He gave it a few more seconds, trying to breathe in through his nose as steadily and carefully as possible. Curious fingers reached for the middle of his collar, and he gave it a firm push upwards on his throat. The sudden pressure pulled another choked noise from his filled lips, then it coaxed a deep groan from above him.

"*Fuck!* Phainon, I-I said *take it out*," he repeated, firmer and more urgent this time, and he pulled back immediately upon hearing the demand. "Head back. Tongue out. Watch your eyes, baby."

Phainon obeyed. He stared up at him as a thick string of saliva still connected them together. The fingers on his collar grasped him instead, pumping quickly and tightly.

All it took was a few seconds for Mydei to shoot right across his face and paint across his nose and forehead. Another landed over his cheek, forcing him to close one eye just before it streaked up to his eyebrow. Breathless, Mydei was thrusting his hips into his fist, milking himself so every drop either painted his skin or oozed into his hand. The mess there was gathered on to his tongue, pooled thick and salty over his tastebuds as the rest dressed his face.

"*Oh my f-fucking…*" Mydei looked down at him, eyeing his messy face, cum-covered tongue, and kneeling figure. He couldn't even finish before he swallowed thickly, panting over him. "*Swallow it.*"

Phainon closed his mouth, working his tired throat and forcing the little bit down. Upon finishing, he stuck his tongue out again for proof.

“You’re my good boy. You’re the *best* boy,” he said, leaning down to his height. To help, his tired legs raised to sit higher on his knees.

“I-I did it,” Phainon stammered. “Master, *I did it.* I was able to… to take it all for a second. I felt it in my throat behind my collar—*did it feel good?*”

“It felt amazing.” He grinned back, then kissed his cum-covered lips quickly. “I’m so proud of you. My prince worked so hard to get that far, and he felt so good squeezing me with his throat.”

Breathless, Phainon pulled back to continue rambling. “Did you feel it when I—”

“—pushed on your collar? Yes, baby. I felt it. It was perfect,” he praised him, and he smiled back as pride flowed through every inch of his body. “Mm… My sweet little boy is a slut for sucking my dick, and I love it so much.”

Phainon kissed him again, hungry for more of his attention and praise. He had tried *so hard* to do it, and he wanted Mydei to talk him up more for all of his efforts.

“My prince is the best,” he said next, and tingles burned inside of his body.

“I can work harder to take it like you can,” he promised. “My master can fuck his own throat deep like that without gagging too much. He can swallow around it too and hold it inside for so long. I can learn how to do that in the future.”

One day, he would be able to fuck his *throat* freely too, not just his mouth. He could take the throat fucking Mydei rambled about before, the one that’d put him on his back and bulge his collar out.

“Ah ah. Let’s take it little by little, there’s no rush for things like this. We have all the time in the world,” Mydei hushed him, not allowing him to focus on the thought for long. “I am beyond proud of you for tonight. You exceeded my expectations completely, and I’m so happy you enjoyed every second of it too. God, you’re incredible.”

“Can I please bathe with you now, master?” Phainon asked while looking up at him. “Can you hold me and pamper me some more?”

“Your wish is my command,” he allowed, then stood upright. “Do you want me to return the favor before we do?”

“Can you get me off tomorrow?” Mydei hummed thoughtfully. “I want to relax with you. My throat feels sore, and my master makes me so loud. It’ll hurt.”

“I can do that.” Phainon let himself get picked up as he agreed, body bouncing into place in Mydei’s arms. “And tomorrow, I have no plans besides cleaning up around here. You and I are free to spend the day together. Ask, and I will get you off at any point in the day.”

He wanted that. Together, cleaning would get done so quickly, and they could do whatever they wanted afterwards.

They could keep playing and exploring with one another's bodies, like experimenting with more shibari ties or toying with the gear in his closet. Mydei wanted him dressed up around the house, and he could do that for him—ropes, leather, *nothing*. He could do it for a little while, so long as he was praised and comforted by him.

They could watch movies in bed or build more lego sets together. There was still one more to put together, and a whole series of superhero movies to get through. If that didn't interest him, they could play board games or video games together, then laugh at each other for being too competitive. Mydei was always better at board games and card games, whereas he had the upper hand in video games against one another.

They could even bake sweets and take them to their friends and family. His mom would love cookies or cake to have with her coffee, and since Mydei's mom couldn't have so much sugar, maybe they could come up with a recipe that wasn't so sweet. Something she could enjoy without making her sick.

Too busy thinking to do much else, Phainon didn't even realize when they were in the bathroom until Mydei set him down on the stool. The bath was full and steaming, wisps of pale bubbles scattered above the rich, blue-tinted water. Lavender filled the room, light and refreshing against the scent of their combined sweat.

A damp rag wiped his face off, delicately swiping over his closed eye. It pulled lightly on the locks of hair caked with cum, rubbing them clean before moving on to his nose, cheeks, and chin.

"My handsome man," he whispered, then kissed his forehead.

Careful fingers then unbuckled his collar to set it aside, and the rag was folded closed to clean beneath where it had sat. Still not done, he gave a once over drag against his collarbones and throat.

"Be good for me now," he instructed him. "Stay still for me."

Nodding, he watched him walk away to pick up the messy, soaked blanket off the floor. His body disappeared, most likely moving to dump it in the wash so the cycle could run as they bathed.

It took Mydei awhile to come back too.

Something told him he had warned him of this, as Mydei didn't just walk off like that, but he had been too busy thinking to respond. That was his own fault entirely.

When he did show up, he had his liquor cart in front of him. There was no liquor on it, however, as the top had bottles of water and a small tumbler with a tea bag hanging from the lip, small bags of snacks from his pantry, two large candles on either side, and a hair clip.

Fresh and dried fruits and chocolates made his smile widen, and the mug of tea looked so inviting for the soreness in his throat. Beneath, a few towels were stacked there for them.

The bathroom lights were shut off, allowing for the candles to warm the room ambiently.

“Come here,” Mydei said, picking his hand up and helping him towards the tub. “It’s been awhile since I last took a bath, so I’d like to enjoy it with you.”

“Stinky,” he teased him, and that earned a roll of the eyes.

Mydei climbed in first, stepping one foot in at a time. He plucked the golden tail holding his braid out, then grasped the locks in either hand to comb them back. With his hair secured in one hand, he grasped the red claw and clipped it into his hair.

“Hair cut soon?”

“Never,” he said simply, and Phainon chuckled over the messy ends sticking and falling every which way. “Come on, baby. Join me.”

Two hands reached out for him, and he took the offerings while following him inside.

Mydei sat down next. His back pushed to the curve of his tub, head resting over the towel draped on the rim. Fingers beckoned him to follow, to sit between his parted legs and rest against his awaiting chest. Judging by where his knees poked from the water, he did his best not to squish anywhere important while following suit.

Hot water washed over them both as his body made the level rise, and light ripples swished around their chests. With the wet arm lifted around his shoulder, a dripping hand pressed to his neck to tilt his head back. Thanks to the proximity, Mydei kissed the side of his head.

The quiet was comfortable, and he closed his eyes while sinking deeper.

“Phainon, thank you for indulging me,” Mydei said suddenly, softly. “Thank you for playing with me on my own whims recently. If it’s ever too much, tell me.”

“You know, I really like when you decide you’re in the mood and offer it to me,” he admitted. “I like when you take control of things like this. It’s so exciting to follow you.”

Mydei sighed. “I don’t want you to feel like a sexual object. I can be a lot sometimes, so I like when *you* confront me with *your* wants.”

“I don’t feel that way at all. When you touch me, all I think about is how good it feels and how sweet you’ll be to me when we finish,” Phainon shot down the insecurity. “The only time I ever feel kind of close to… *that*… is when you touch me and leave me denied. That’s… kinda the point though, isn't it? *Ownership? Possession?*”

“But you *like* it when I do that,” he pointed out. “You told me so.”

“I do,” he reassured him. “Sometimes I’ll ask for things, but I like it more when *you* spring it on me too. Especially now that things aren’t so intimidating anymore.”

“I’ll keep that in mind,” was all he said back, then rested his arm on the rim of the tub. “I should bathe more often. This hot water feels nice.”

Phainon couldn’t help it when he asked, “*with me?*”

A laugh followed, one that shook the chest behind him and made the water ripple around them.

“Yes, I should bathe more with my prince,” he corrected himself, giving into his request. “What’s next? Shall we shower together too?”

“Mhm… Yeah, it saves water… or something…”

“Pervert,” Mydei accused him, and Phainon grinned to himself while shrugging his shoulders. “Settle down. If you keep being cheeky, I’ll spank you.”

“I’ll like it,” he mouthed off, remembering the one he had given him earlier. “Put *that* in our folder later.”

The hand on the rim of the tub lifted, threading through his hair to tilt his head back. Fingers curled and pulled, and his jaw dropped for a quiet gasp.

“You should stop talking before you start getting my thoughts rolling,” he warned him. “Choose your next words very carefully.”

“I’ll be good tonight, master,” he promised, aware that Mydei could read what he was implying. “My throat is a bit sore, so… tonight’s no good for any more loud noises.”

“I’ll hold you to that *tomorrow* then,” he told him, letting go of his hair to instead grab the black tumbler by the rim. “Sit up and come take a drink of your tea if it hurts.”

Both hands reached carefully for the cup, and Phainon sat up before bringing it to his mouth for a sip.

“Mm… there’s a lot of honey in this,” he noticed, glad for the sweetness. “Ginger too.”

“Ginger tea helps sore throats,” Mydei explained as Phainon took another tentative drink. “I’ll put it back for you when you finish.”

“Can you rub my neck too?”

“*Tch*…”

When his mug was put down, a strong arm pinned him back to the chest behind him. Head tilted and chin raised, two fingers gently touched the top of his throat where it connected beneath his chin. Small circles were rubbed back and forth, carefully stimulating the achy spot.

“*Spoiled brat.*”

“You made me like this with your own two hands, my love,” he reminded him, holding his wrist loosely. “Please keep going. The tea mixed with the rubbing is really nice.”

As much as he grumbled, Mydei continued to give it to him because it was true. If Phainon was a ‘*pampered prince*’ or a ‘*spoiled brat*’, it was because his dominant catered to his comfort with his own two hands.

And he liked *him* this way, or else he wouldn’t have gotten him used to being so high maintenance. It was, ultimately, the bed he chose to sleep in.

Chapter End Notes

mydei: if i want a spoiled prince, i’ll cater to one.

yeah, mydei, we know. we see it. you single handedly made this brat even more of a brat, and you give him everything he ever asks for (besides the occasional orgasm) AND THEN SOME. your greed sickens me. im sick. you literally have it all.

AND PHAINON. you are SUCH a good boy. you deserve it all. you deserve to be proud of yourself and be pampered like a prince and given everything in the world. keep asking for things, thats what your dom is there for, baby.

like, if you want dick, just ask him for it. hes literally free use. (and maybe we’ll see him do it next chapter too… hehe.)

Chapter 23: Chapter Twenty-Three

Chapter Notes

> this took forever and im very sorry. i have no excuse. life is life-ing and i have adhd. but im here. im gonna try to be on top of this
>
> please accept some body worship and kisses and praise and soft dom mydei and soft phainon in ropes and men loving men because theyre men.
>
> minor possible homophobia warning.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cleaning was *exhausting*. Phainon thought he knew what '*clean*' meant, but Mydei's sense of the word '*clean*' was completely different.

To Phainon, cleaning the bathroom meant scrubbing the shower's walls, wiping the sliding glass, and probably reorganizing Cyrene's bottles of stuff and things if they had fallen over each other. If it was time to do laundry, then washing and folding all the towels nicely on the racks and opened shelves. He'd also give a quick wipe down around the sink and brush the toilet bowl. Once every blue moon, he'd dust around when it got thick enough to notice while shaving or doing his business.

Mydei said that wasn't '*clean enough*' for him. It'd make him antsy.

Instead, he was on his knees wiping the clean-looking trim by the floors with a wet rag and scrubbing around the bottom of the toilet with a brush before mopping. It meant dragging a duster into the corners of the ceiling to catch invisible cobwebs and pulling his shower heads down to take them apart and clean inside of them. Those got dirty too, apparently.

Well, he guessed they did. *That made sense*. But he never really thought to unscrew the hardware and clean it out, just keeping the outside from being caked in gunk.

Phainon offered to help anyway, taking some of the workload off of his shoulders since this was really important to him. He wiped the glass doors of his standing shower down, cleaning closely by the metal frame and handles as requested. He disinfected the sleek counters and wiped the water stains off the faucets and shower knobs, not that there were many with how diligent Mydei was with keeping his space clean regularly. Whatever tasks his dominant entrusted him with, he did to the best of his abilities.

His bathroom took longer than the guest bathroom as it was used much more often, but Mydei went to clean that one up as well '*just in case*'. He dusted the walls and surfaces, scrubbed the toilet, and made sure the counter and mirror were spotless.

All morning they cleaned, from after their breakfast settled to the time lunch rolled around. The bathrooms, the kitchen, the living room, and the floors between them all, *nothing* was safe from the tickle he got to tidy up.

Mydei swept and mopped the floors while mumbling to himself about fingerprints in the windows and crumbs by the table. It prompted Phainon to go spray his windows down, aware they were probably *his* from pointing out things to Cyrene last night. He had a bad habit of getting too close to them.

Once finished, Mydei lit a candle and placed it on his wooden coffee table. The crisp scent of eucalyptus filled his home, spritzed into every room to freshen it up and clouded through the connected living room, kitchen, and dining area. Music played off of his mounted television quietly, a playlist created from all the songs they've ever liked.

"Bored…" Phainon's lips curled to a pout as he watched Mydei wipe his sweaty forehead with the bottom of his tank-top. When he kept looking around the cleaned space to search for *more* things to touch up, he huffed. "Mydei, *attention*."

"Hm?" His eyes then shifted to him. "Yes, my prince?"

"*Kiss*."

Mydei walked over to him and cupped his collared neck in both hands without another word. Either thumb gently touched under his chin, lifting it to tilt his head back. Once posed, he leaned in to plant a soft kiss to his already puckered lips.

Pleased by the display of affection, Phainon smiled at him. His lips were soft and scented with that familiar pomegranate from the chapstick in his bathroom cabinet, and he wanted more of them. Especially after going through most of the morning in silence and a drought of attention due to how invested Mydei got with his tasks—*he needed this.*

Phainon's own hands touched his waist, pulling his bent figure closer so he could join him on top of the couch. One knee pressed into the cushion beside him, and the other followed suit shortly after. He guided him onto his lap, leaning back so Mydei had more room to come closer.

"Thank you for helping me," his partner whispered to him, and Phainon shrugged casually while chasing his lips again. "*Wait. I'm speaking*. It means a lot to me that you did this with me, Phainon. I know it's boring and tedious, and no one *likes* housework, but I hate feeling like I have a dirty house."

A soft breath fell from his lips as he looked up at him. Beneath that warm gaze, the heat inside of his body only grew hotter.

"If I can do anything for you, I will," he said simply, quietly.

"Your help made it take a lot less time than it usually did," Mydei hinted. He brought his hands to the back of the couch, and the wood creaked when they gripped it tightly. "We have plenty of time left in the day to do *whatever* my prince likes."

Like this, Mydei was sitting on his lap completely and comfortably. Both of his thick arms caged him in place, and his body weight kept him from squirming underneath his gaze. But being pinned by his body was exciting. Getting to have him on top of him like this was turning him on.

Needy hands touched his black tank-top, holding his thick waist and pinching the ribbed fabric to lift it. There wasn't a warning, and he definitely didn't ask, but Mydei's body was his whenever he wanted to touch it, wasn't it? He could ask for whatever he wanted at any point in time, couldn't he? And Mydei would tell him '*no*' or '*later*' if he wasn't ready.

"Did I do a good job for you?" He asked, exposing more and more of his sweaty, golden stomach and back. "Are you proud of me?"

"Yes, baby," he returned. *If* he wasn't in the mood for him to touch his body, he *didn't* make a move to stop him. "I'm always proud of you."

Phainon traced over the divots of muscle, lining up and down while dragging his attention over his body.

Usually Mydei touched *him*. More often than not, Mydei put his hands all over *his* body. He cupped his face and his neck to grab his attention; squeezed his chest and his ass to leave rosy traces of his fingers into them; jerked his cock and fingered his mouth until tears pricked his eyes; took his hands into his while guiding him and kissed his body in places people usually wouldn't, like the *ankles*. Mydei once kissed his ankles again and again simply because he could, because he *wanted* to. And even when he wasn't directly touching him, his partner praised him endlessly for how strong his back looked, how wide his arms and shoulders were, and how thick his thighs have gotten.

Mydei was so *gentle* with his admiration sometimes, as he reminded him often that he wanted every inch of his body to feel wanted and desirable. Which, it did. Phainon *always* felt attractive because of him.

But did *he* ever get a chance to properly touch Mydei in return? Was there ever a moment where *he* was so comfortable in himself and his sexuality that *he* was the one to praise him and his body?

Sure, Phainon told him he was handsome. He told him he was hot and all the words that were similar. And sure, he sat on his knees and kissed his cock or licked his balls. Occasionally he touched his chest or checked him out, but was that enough?

Phainon could say he was attractive, and he could say he was attracted to him. But, again, *was that enough?*

If he were Mydei, it definitely wouldn't be.

Mydei ducked closer, bringing his arms tighter together. It pulled him from his thoughts and sat him right in the palm of his hand, trapped inside of his honeyed eyes.

“You are such a good boy,” he purred, striking him right in the chest with more of that mind-numbing praise. When said in a tone so velvety, it was hard to think of anything other than the tingle it gave him. “You make me so proud, and you did these chores without any complaining. Do you want a little kiss for it?”

He shook his head, breathless, while pulling that tank-top higher up his body. He pushed it past Mydei’s ribs, past his chest, and until his fingers were slotted right under his arms where a tickle of trimmed hair brushed his knuckles. Cerulean eyes focused on the plush muscle right before his eyes, on the soft, brown nipples on either half that begged to be touched. Left then right, he eyed them hungrily, wondering what they would taste like on his tongue.

“I want to kiss your body, master,” he said instead as his thumbs touched either side of his pecs.

“I’m kind of dirty right now, Phainon.”

“Is it rude to say that I don’t really care?” Phainon brushed off, mesmerized by his glistening figure. “I want to taste *you*, not soap and lotion.”

Mydei groaned quietly over his shameless request, pushing his chest closer and closing his arms in further. His hands were side by side behind him and using his forearms to block him from leaning back. His arms bracketed him, strong and unwavering when he turned his head and tested their resolve. There was nowhere to go but *forward*, closer towards his inviting body.

“*Kiss me.*”

Was that a demand? It sounded like a demand.

A few moments passed, and Phainon decided that he was taking it like a demand.

“*Thank you, master*.”

He leaned in and planted a kiss against his chest, feeling the dampness of sweat touch his lips. Both hands dragged down his sides, exploring the bumps of his ribs and dip of his waist.

“I really love your body,” he admitted while cupping beneath his chest. “You told me once that you don’t want to be revered as royalty or worshipped, but every part of you is *so sexy*.”

“Is it?”

“You have to know that,” he insisted, massaging him gently. “There’s no way you don’t when *everyone* praises your looks.”

Mydei hummed quietly. “I take care of myself, and I suppose genetics favored me.”

“Don’t say ‘*genetics*’ as if you don't work out every day and diet all the time,” he argued. “You worked so hard for this, and it shows. Everyone sees it.”

“I do work hard,” he agreed after giving it some thought. “You’re right. I put so much effort into upholding a certain look.”

“Yeah, you do.”

“I… I have all these masks and creams, these vitamins and supplements,” he listed, and Phainon nodded as he kissed his skin. “I’m careful not to eat out too much. My worst habit is drinking a lot, but… I still do everything else right.”

“Mhm…”

His mouth lowered. With a slow lick, he toyed with Mydei’s nipple for a second, swirling around the right bud just to feel him shiver.

“I like the taste of your body as it is,” he admitted, feeling it stiffen under his touch. “When I go down on you after work, it’s… *fuck*… so addicting. The smell and taste is so strong, *so you*, and I crave it all the time.”

“I heard there’s some kind of psychology behind that…”

“Sorry, *doctor*, but I don’t need to be diagnosed as a *pervert*. It’s pretty clear you brought one out of me when I let you fuck me for the first time in full *BDSM* get up,” he mused, feeling a little bit playful.

The arms around his head tightened, pinning him to his chest. There was nowhere to go at all now. Nose to chest, he was pressed into his body as if his face belonged between Mydei’s pecs.

Phainon was right where he wanted to be.

“But you liked being fucked in your little *BDSM* get up,” he shot back, feeling just as teasing. “I should do it again, hm? I should force you to dress you up in leather as you lick the sweat from my body, *slut*. Let’s get you used to that gear so I can put you in leather corsets, pants, and underwear soon. Let’s get you strappier pieces, tighter pieces, so you can *really* embrace your submission to me.”

Phainon choked on a moan over the idea, over the idea of *more* leather dressing his body. Belts and collars were one thing, and cuffs seemed pretty ‘*vanilla*’ in the grand scheme of kink, but a leather corset? Leather underwear? A harness that was more all-encompassing and restricted his body to a higher degree?

Leather felt nice until after they were all sweaty from playing around, but Mydei was always so quick to take care of him. That wasn’t a problem he needed to worry about.

Thinking of the squeeze around his waist and the posture he’d be forced to uphold, then the scent of warmed leather over the intimate parts of his body, and finally the way it’d contrast against his skin or strain around his body—*fuck*. Phainon *wanted* to try it. He *wanted* to be dressed up in it and feel as good as he did the last time they went that far.

"*Oh*… Look at your red face…" Mydei mocked him after, and the action pushed his body closer with each bounce. "I should take this sweaty tank-top off, make you bite into it, then fuck you all over again to get you used to taking dick in your ass too."

Heat trickled into Phainon's gut over the memory of them having sex. It had felt so good to be in his arms like that, held close and intimately as he whispered praise to him. Even if he walked a little bit funny afterwards from how deep and thick Mydei was, he wanted it again. He wanted to be *fucked* by him *again*.

Thinking of that upgraded to imagining taking it right here and right now, bent in half on the couch they just vacuumed inside of and sprayed with disinfectant. Maybe Mydei would prop his legs on his shoulders again, kiss his ankles and hold his hips tightly. Or maybe he'd hold his head and kiss his lips while rocking into him, whisper how good he felt and tell him it was taking him so well.

Phainon looked up at him, eyes wide and doe-y with his mouth pressed in the space between either pec. Both hands shifted to his back, pushing him closer so he was nose deep in his sweaty body. While there, he curled his nails into the sweaty skin, scraping lightly for purchase.

But as much as he wanted to go that far, he was much too shy to ask for so much. To ask to play with him was a warmer idea these days, but to ask to be *fucked* was… *a lot*…

He wasn't high on hormones and post-orgasmic bliss like he was when he originally asked to make anal more common. He was *aroused*, but not yet enough to beg for it.

"Don't give me that look," Mydei warned him, looking down at him from above. A hint of something deeper layered his words, something *promising*. "If I'll take the time to train your throat, don't think I won't bend you over my lap and train your ass too."

"*Y-Yeah…?*"

Was he *promising* to take charge of that decision for him? To *make* him grow more comfortable with it?

"I should order a set of training plugs for you," he pressed, voice lowered to weasel deeper into his head. "You can wear them around my house like your play collar."

Phainon thought of *that* too. He thought of anal plugs like the ones he noticed while ordering his own toys, of walking around with something inside of him while cleaning, cuddling, and cooking with Mydei. During movie nights in bed, as he played video games on the couch, and even when he was simply walking around to fill his glass once more, Mydei wanted him *stretched*. He wanted him *trained* to take his cock easier.

His body shifted beneath him, scratching down his back even lower as he tried to imagine sitting here right now with a toy inside of him. Pressed into his sensitive walls, full and unrelenting, shifting with every movement…

It was a little *intimidating* to think about since he wasn't used to being so sexual, especially *down there*. The things above were one thing. They had worked up to touching his chest, playing with his cock, and working open his throat slowly. But his ass was different. Even on his own, he was never down there *like that.*

But to feel more comfortable in his body, in *pleasure*, was both an exciting and nerve-wracking thought.

"Heh…" Mydei leaned forward after his breath of amusement, then ducked his head down to kiss the top of his forehead. "Those big eyes of yours are so damn cute…"

Phainon closed his eyes as he sat there, smashed between his partner's chest, his arms, and his lips. Steady but deep breaths filled his lungs, trying to keep his composure even if all this talk was making his head feel light.

"I won't make any unnecessary purchases, and I won't push you into anything uncomfortable," he reassured him gently. Phainon already knew that though. "This kind of talk is simply talk until you decide it tickles your interest."

"Plugs seem like a lot…" He murmured, but the idea wasn't turning him off. If anything, it was quite the opposite. "Do you really want that for me, master?"

"They're harmless. It's just to make things easier on your end." Phainon had enough reason in him to come to that conclusion as well. "The more you get used to having something in there, the easier on your body it'll become when we have sex."

Like Mydei pushing fingers and their dildo into his throat to warm it up for deepthroating him better, which *worked*.

"If we want them, I want to pick them," he decided. "Can we look together sometime?"

"Yes, we can. They're going inside of *you*, so you should feel both *comfortable* and *attracted* to them," he agreed. "But for now, enough of that talk. Why don't you wear a harness for me?"

Phainon's body burned underneath his skin.

"Why?"

"Because I *want* you to."

There it was, the most obvious answer he could've possibly given. What other reason did he need?

Butterflies filled his stomach as he nodded weakly, ready to be stripped down and dressed up however he pleased. Whether it was for playing or simply admiring, he didn't care. If Mydei wanted it, then he did too.

"Because I can *make* you."

Lowered hands pulled Mydei's hips closer, allowing his partner to feel the way his body was reacting to these suggestive and promising words. He knew he could too, as he leaned back to look down at him better with a corner of his lip twitched upwards. It was a terribly arrogant look, but one deserved nonetheless.

"Because you want me to make you, don't you?" Mydei mocked him. "My poor, perverted little prince… Always at the mercy of my desires, aren't you? And I can be *so unfair* to you, can't I?"

"Yes, master," he replied shakily, and Mydei made an effort to ease off of his lap. "Anything you want, I want to do too."

One hand held the couch behind him again to leer over him, and Phainon felt the other touch his knee to push it higher and further apart. Spreading them open didn't make those fingers move any higher, but his flick upwards through his lashes made one twitch. The look on his face, whatever it may have been, was enough to make Mydei grip him tighter

Phainon pushed his chest out and inched his hips closer. "Can you please touch me, master?" He pleaded softly.

Immediately, Mydei dragged his touch higher to cup loosely between his legs, and Phainon moaned softly while letting himself push even closer. Bucking into his hands, he chased more of the pleasure even if he knew that was probably it for now. *Teased* and *edged* was his partner's favorite way to have him.

"I'm feeling a bit nice, so tell me if you want a *leather* harness or a *shibari* harness," he offered, palming him slowly. The touch made his legs twitch.

"Shibari, please," he answered, and Mydei's smile widened over his immediate honesty. "I wanna see the rope marks you were talking about before…"

"I want to do a full-body harness this time then." An edge of excitement lined his firm voice. "I know one off the top of my head, so I don't need reference pictures or videos. It's a classic diamond pattern, and it won't take any more than twenty minutes for me to do."

It sounded as if he had been waiting for this moment, like this was a fantasy come true for him.

"*Oh*, red always looks so good on my prince's skin, and the rope marks it'll leave when I take it off… *fuck*, they'll look so nice…"

Phainon smiled in response to the soft, murmured praise and the stars that glittered inside of his golden eyes. To have Mydei be so excited to tie him up made him want to be tied up even more, and he already liked the hug of ropes on his body.

"Mm… I want a kiss first, master. Please," he requested, leaning forward.

The hand on his stiffened cock rubbed lightly, trailing up and down through his borrowed pants. Fingers massaged the head teasingly. Mydei kissed his lips like he always did, hungry

for another before the first even finished.

But Phainon was no better as he pushed closer for more too, hands grasping his back to try and ease their bodies together again.

“I never get tired of that…” His partner murmured, breaking their kiss before stealing another. “Mm… one more.”

“Were you deprived of kisses in the past?” Phainon teased him, and his head shook as their noses brushed over one another’s. “Why do you like them so much?”

“I was deprived of *your* kisses in the past,” he corrected him, causing him to chuckle. Flutters filled his chest from the cute words. “Go on, go to the bedroom and strip down for me. I’ll tie you up nice and pretty, and we can do whatever you like while you are.”

“‘*Whatever I like*’?” He repeated, and Mydei hummed positively. “If I wanna kiss and touch you, can I do it? If I… wanna play with you, can *we* do it?”

Mydei pulled away from his body, straightening himself out in front of him. He pulled his tank-top off completely from where it hugged just below his collarbones and tossed it right into his lap after. Lightly damp with sweat and thick with his scent, Phainon picked it up and held it to his chest before he could stop himself.

“My body’s always open to my *good* boy.” Mydei watched as Phainon held the black fabric closer to his face. “So, won’t you be *good* and go do as I said? Your master gave you an order, but you’re still on your ass… *Go*.”

Phainon, not skipping another beat, jumped up from the couch and rushed towards his bedroom, excited.

—

Mydei was gentle in tying his harness, yet the ropes hugged his body firmly with very little space between his skin and the fibers. There was enough to dig fingers underneath and pull if he wished. According to his partner, that meant they were just right.

Those skilled fingers brought the dual-lined ropes crossed his chest to emphasize the thick muscle of either pec, wrapped around his back to pull his waist in smaller, and lined his between his legs so he felt them around his cock and the cheeks of his ass. He felt *sexy* standing there in them, and he loved the way they felt when he moved. It was better on skin than it was over his shirt, and the fibers were stimulating in a way leather wasn’t.

Leather harnesses were more breathable. They were textured under fingertips but still smooth enough when taut around his muscles. It had a little stretch when testing the buckles, and it could be easily adjusted with just a little fidgeting and unbuckling.

Ropes felt more *absolute*. Once on, they couldn't be so easily adjusted. Because of that, Mydei put extra care into making sure they were right the first time, into making sure they didn't press anywhere too sensitive or uncomfortable.

Phainon could *feel* the care as he moved. With every breath, he felt his body expand into them enough to hug but not suffocate. With every shift, they didn't rub uncomfortably against his moving body.

He felt sexy and secure while standing in front of Mydei, who was looking his *almost* bare figure up and down from the edge of his bed. It seemed his partner loved it just as much as he did.

"You're gorgeous."

"Aren't you lucky?" Phainon teased, and Mydei's hand traced up the diamonds drawn across his torso. "And don't think I didn't see you slip a bottle of lube into the nightstand."

"I wasn't '*slipping*' anything. I'm preparing for the possibility of you getting me hard, then having to deal with the consequences of it," he defended himself while pulling him even closer. "If I want you to get me off, I'm going to make you. You're just so damn addictive."

"Yeah?"

Phainon pushed him onto the bed, watching as he laid back completely on his pillows. Mydei shifted, arms moving to lift above his head as a deep exhale sank his belly. One leg raised, bent at the knee with his foot flat to the bed, and his other rested comfortably and relaxed beside it.

Being so open, so free, made him feel even greedier.

"I want to do it again too, master," he said back to him.

He climbed over his body, straddling his right thigh. Fingers lightly touched where his shorts rode up on the opposite leg, slipping up and down the smooth skin.

"Please tell me where to start first," Phainon requested, unsure where to start kissing and touching first.

Mydei looked so good like that. Messy hair spilled over his pillows, and the rosy color of his bedding made his golden skin look even more inviting. With his hands tucked behind his head, it gave Phainon all the room he could want to play with him. But there was so much of *him*, and he wasn't as… *practiced* in this area of a relationship as Mydei was.

Should he go *up* his body, or should he go *down?*

"You're cute when you're nervous."

"Mm…" Teasing and sweet words weren't going to help him figure out where to start. "Please guide me, master."

Mydei's leg lifted, and he pressed his bare foot against his chest before pushing gently, easing him further down his thigh. Once Phainon was right where he wanted him, it raised to rest his heel comfortably over his shoulder. A little sideways glance made it clear what he wanted before he even opened his mouth.

"Go on."

Phainon's hand held the bottom of his calf gently, feeling as his foot waved left and right leisurely. When grasped, it paused, giving him a chance to kiss his ankle sweetly.

"Higher," Mydei then told him, and Phainon slid his hands towards his knee to plant his lips against his hairy calf next. "Mm… Just like that. Keep going. Do you like my body, Phainon?"

He nodded, feeling up on the muscle of his lower thigh while staring into his eyes.

"I love your body, master."

"Every part?"

"All of it," he promised, kissing the back of his knee when stretching his leg upright. "I like when you wear leggings to work out, and I can see them hug your legs under your gym shorts."

"I'll wear them more," Mydei decided, speaking calmly. Even if he *sounded* unaffected, Phainon watched as his tongue traced over his lips slowly, distractedly.

"I like when you wear my gray running shorts too, the one with the tiny inseam." He kissed lower. His hands slipped the leg of his shorts even further down to expose more soft, golden skin. "Your thighs are so attractive. They make for a good seat."

"And you're going to sit on them here in a minute. Keep going."

Lowering his leg back to the bed, Phainon peeled his hands from his shorts and reached for the waistband of them. With a nod, Mydei lifted his hips to let him pull them down. Then he pulled them off.

"We both know I love this…" Both palms went to touch the bulge behind his boxer briefs, rubbing up and down either side before meeting in the middle. He gave a soft, sensual squeeze.

"'*This*'?"

"My master's *cock*," he clarified, thumbs working together to massage where he could make out the tip. "I love it. The taste, the smell, the feel… It's perfect."

Mydei chuckled at that. "It's the only one you've ever had, Phainon."

"It's the only one I'll ever need."

That made his partner bite down on his bottom lip and squirm lightly, shifting on his back and opening up his legs wider. With more space, his hands lowered, cupping where his balls were.

“And these…” He gave a squeeze while acknowledging them, and Mydei groaned softly. His eyelids drooped slightly while bucking his hips forward, chasing more of the pleasure. “I love these too.”

“Then take my boxers off and touch them properly,” he demanded.

Phainon did. He hooked his fingers under the elastic, dropped them, and then tossed them to the unoccupied side of the bed with his shorts.

Mydei laid there in front of him, legs spread, cock stiff against his belly, and balls hanging beneath just waiting for his hands to meet his body again. And they rushed to make sure they didn’t miss him too much. They cupped them again as if magnetized to him, massaging for a second just to watch Mydei’s leg twitch upwards.

“Is that better, master?”

“Yes,” he exhaled, but Phainon didn’t want to spend too much time teasing him. “Keep going. Keep touching me, baby.”

Flattening his hands, he gently pressed over the plane of his pelvis. Both glided up his body, touching over his hipbones and crimson tattoos. But his eyes lingered on the few veins peeking behind the coarse hairs lining down his navel. They’ve always caught his attention every time he saw him.

“I wanna…—” He trailed off quietly before ducking lower to kiss them.

One hand touched the back of his head, and Phainon looked up at him while kissing his lower stomach. Fingers threaded through his hair and tugged, keeping him from kissing again.

“Stay like this,” Mydei ordered, voice thick from arousal. “Stay close to me as you kiss my body. Don’t go any higher than this.”

He hummed, looking over his bare skin. “Has anyone done something like this for you, master?”

Please say no.

“No.”

Thank god.

Immediately, Phainon kissed him again, lips connecting to his lower stomach and lining up the dark blond hairs. They met again and again hungrily, touching his tattooed hips and the v-line pointed down to his pelvis. His abs were next, each bump of muscle in the middle met his greedy mouth.

“*I love*…” He stopped to kiss his skin. “… *when my master wears tight tank tops*…” Then again. “… *and compression shirts*…”

Mydei moaned, back arching closer.

“… Mm… Your waist is *so wide*…” Both hands curled around where it was thinnest, pinching to feel how thick his body was. “Master, you’re so *strong*. I love how strong you are.”

“I have to be to carry my prince around,” he said back. “I… I’m gonna carry you for the rest of my life.”

“Yeah?”

“If the day comes where I *can’t*, kill me,” Mydei breathed out, and Phainon kissed the middle of his chest next.

“My master has cleavage too, did you know that?” He teased him. “When you unbutton your work shirts, and this part of your chest shows… *mmph*… It’s so distracting…”

Phainon made his way towards a nipple, licking over the bud before taking it into his mouth. He felt it stiffen slowly, pebbled with arousal. To make sure the other didn’t feel left out, one thumb lifted to press into it.

“Keep… Keep going,” Mydei urged him.

Lips touched higher towards his armpit, kissing the edge of his chest before leaning in. Phainon made sure to give attention there too, pecking deep into the side where Mydei had a few pale stretch-marks crackled over his tanned skin. He never really noticed they were there until up close and personal with his underarm. It wasn't as if he just stared at him there.

“My master has these?”

“Mhm… It’s just a side effect of when I gained weight quickly after high school. Skin stretches, and it scars,” he brushed off casually, unbothered by their presence. “Kiss them too if you want.”

He did. He kissed the pale marks again, feeling the textured skin against his lips and hair tickle his cheek. But they didn’t stay for long. Next was the smooth muscles of his upper arms, then his bent elbow from where Mydei was still resting his hands behind his head.

“Neck next.”

Phainon obeyed immediately, leaning down to kiss his stretched throat.

“*That’s it*,” Mydei encouraged him, voice low and drawn out from pleasure. It was then that he moved his hands and gripped the ropes wrapped around his back. “Come on… Give me more.”

Poking his tongue out, he licked against his sweaty skin before moaning quietly, pleased by the salt on his tongue.

"*Bite me*."

He bit, pulling the skin between his teeth just to hear Mydei hiss. He kissed him again right after.

"Master, can I leave more bites on you?" He rushed to ask. "Can I mark you as much as I want?

"Fuck yes," he panted, needy in a way he usually wasn't. "Come on. My collar hides it at work anyway, so don't be scared. Trust me."

And Phainon *did* trust him to know what would be appropriate for his job. So he bit again where he guessed his work-shirt could hide it, painting the golden skin in shades of red. One by one, he wanted him *covered* in his trace for no reason other than Mydei was *his.*

Every day, he wore his day collar. Almost every day, he wore his *play* collar.

Mydei had his matching earring on every day, sure. He had his own necklace that looked similar to his day collar, just longer and thinner. He wore that frequently too, but not every day. And maybe that *should* be enough for him. That *should* be telling enough that Mydei was his partner.

But that wasn't… *enough*. Phainon wanted him to look in the mirror, see the marks on his neck, and feel that he was someone's too. Well, not just '*someone's—his*. *He was his.*

His hands raised, one slid into Mydei's long hair while the other braced himself with an elbow to lean closer. Their chests touched, only scarlet ropes and his own briefs standing between being flushed against one another. Otherwise, he felt Mydei's stomach press on his own, then his thighs shift around his knee.

Slowly, Phainon slid over Mydei's other leg, spreading his thighs wider to encompass the width of his hips. Inches separated his bottom from the bare cock beneath him, giving them both a second to take a breath. Phainon to see if he *really* wanted to potentially go further than some kisses, then allow Mydei a chance to stop him if he had any objections.

When he didn't, Phainon lowered himself to hover over his cock.

"Do you know how to move your hips, baby?"

Phainon brought them forward before sliding down experimentally, grinding over his bare skin loosely.

"No. Don't do it like that," he immediately scolded him. "*Sit on me*. Back straight and ass *suffocating* my dick—*now*."

Mydei gripped him tightly, pulling him down so hard that he almost worried about hurting him. All of his weight was on top of him now, and the pressure ripped a soft groan from his

partner's lips. Fingers dug in ropes lining his ass, not quite guiding but following his movements to let him take it as he pleased.

"There you go. I like when you're on top of me like this…" He praised him. "Keep going back and forth just like that. Move that body like it's yours, baby, because it is. *All of me is yours*."

With his confidence boosted from those encouraging words and grasp, Phainon gripped the headboard in front of him and rocked himself quicker. His body moved with it, waist rolling down to his hips so he could slide smoother, *sexier*. This wasn't something he did often, and maybe he even looked a little bit clumsy to someone with a better eye, but he was *trying*. It felt right, and there were no complaints, so he must be doing well.

Pre-cum seeped through his cotton briefs from both his own arousal and Mydei's. He could feel how wet they were on both sides from how turned on the two of them were from simply kissing, touching, and practicing a little bit of shibari. But it didn't even surprise him how hard he could get from simply being in his partner's dominating *presence*.

"You know, this doesn't require lube," he brought up curiously while peeking down at Mydei's pleased expression. "What did you want it for?"

"Oh, my sweet prince…" Mydei taunted him, eyes glinting with excitement over him asking. "You don't happen to know what '*frotting*' is, do you?"

Phainon tilted his head in confusion. Was he *supposed* to know what that was?

"I'll show you, so don't worry your pretty head over it," he reassured him, then gave his ass a short and sweet little smack. "Just keep grinding on me, baby. Your master will teach you everything you need to know."

His body jumped in surprise from the swat, still not used to the concept of *spanks*. It wasn't that he hated it—quite the opposite, actually. They were just so new that he forgot that was something he *agreed* to do with him.

In an attempt to be even sexier, his hands moved. One palm covered over Mydei's left pec, and the second reached to grab his thigh behind him. With his whole torso exposed and stretched proudly, he rolled himself forward again before dragging his hips down. When that made Mydei moan, he continued.

"You're so sexy," he breathed out, eyeing over his working muscles. "Where did you learn to move like this?"

"I… used to go to the club a lot with Cyrene," he answered honestly. "Um… girls liked to dance on me, and if I was drunk enough, I grabbed them and danced back—*but it never went any further than that!*"

Mydei rolled his eyes at his response. "As long as you only show this to me from now on, I suppose it doesn't matter *where* it came from."

“You look jealous.”

“I’m not really the ‘*jealous*’ type,” he said simply.

Phainon was reminded of the night they confessed their feelings to one another, of Mydei saying he’d take a long walk off the limited rooftop if he ever decided he wanted someone else. Didn’t he also say he’d punch another person if they were ever able to look at him the same way he did? Was that not *jealousy?*

“My master’s a liar,” he teased him.

“You talk too much,” Mydei hushed while pulling him closer. “Speak less with your mouth and more with your body.”

He continued to grind down on him, and the hands touching his body reached to the slit of his briefs. They pulled him free, toying with the slippery head and fondling his balls beneath. A thumb rubbed over the oozing slit, then lowered to press over the underside.

His lips sealed, one eyebrow raising as if to challenge that order. Did he *really* want him to stop talking?

“*Don’t be a smart ass*,” he warned him. “I will deny you *another* orgasm.”

Mydei knew him so well.

A phone rang off on the nightstand beside them, causing them both to turn their attention to the disruption. The red case under the lit up screen made Mydei sigh, and when he looked down at his busy hands, Phainon reached to read the caller ID for him.

“‘*Father*’.”

“Decline.”

Phainon stifled a laugh at the instant decision, swiped the red button, then set it back down to focus on Mydei again. He shifted, angling his hips downward so he could lay over his body better. When the hands moved and held them length to length, he moaned.

“You’re so wet that we might not need lube at all,” Mydei mused, showing off his glistening hands. “Come on, fuck yourself against me.”

The underside was so sensitive, and to feel it brush against Mydei’s made him moan quietly. Tip to tip, he pumped his hips forward, basking in the sticky heat of their skin touching.

“I like how needy you are for pleasure. Your dick’s always so honest with how much you love being toyed with like a whore," his partner coo’ed. “Keep g—”

Another ring filled the air, and Mydei grit his teeth as he shot a glance to his phone.

“Decline.” He said it as if he already knew who it was. “Just decline it.”

Phainon reached to swipe, not even bothering to check the name. It didn't matter if it was Eurypon or not. He was bumping cocks with his partner, and he wanted to finish so badly that they could wait.

"Can I please cum from this, master?" He asked, hoping he still felt generous. "I didn't get to yesterday night, a-and I want to so bad. I've been good."

"That's the plan, baby. I want my good boy to cum for me like this," he promised, bucking his hips. "Give me a kiss."

Leaning down, Phainon propped himself on his hand and planted a kiss against his lips. Lip to lip, he continued rocking into him with purpose, aroused by the throbs pulsing against him and the wetness between them both.

Mydei's hands wrapped around them both suddenly, and they squeezed firmly by the heads to push them even closer together. The pressure made it even better, especially when he began lightly pulling up and down.

"*M-Master…—*"

"You feel so good," Mydei breathed out. "You're making a mess all over me… I should make you clean it up with your tongue when we finish."

Before he could respond, his phone rang again.

"*Oh my fucking—*"

Phainon's head hung as the both of them stopped. With a trace of his tongue over his lips, he sighed in resignation. One hand then reached to swipe Mydei's phone off of the nightstand to stare at the screen with a glare.

"Decline—"

"Just see what he wants so he can stop." He thrusted the device towards Mydei's ear. "I'm going to lose my boner at this point, master. *Seriously*."

"Fine," he grunted, eyebrows furrowing in frustration. "Just answer it then… I guess."

Phainon swiped the green button for it, holding the device because Mydei's hands were covered in their precum. But instead of stopping, he kept his hands there, both tips clutched between his thumbs and index fingers.

"*Father*." His voice was flat, clearly unhappy with being forced to pick up. "What do you want? I'm busy."

An index finger raised, tapping over him once, twice, then three times before tightening around them. It made his breathing hitch.

Was he *crazy?* He wanted to keep playing with each other while his *dad* was on the other line? Did he really not *care?*

"*Yes*. I was busy yesterday, and *yes*, I am busy today." Phainon gulped. "*No*, I'll be busy next weekend too… *Yes*, I'm serious."

Mydei didn't move again, deciding to be still until he gave his own safeword.

So, he did. With the hand not holding his phone, he held one of his wrists and tapped twice, unsure if this was right to do. How could he hate doing things when his mom was around but not his dad? Was the gap between them *that* big?

Tingles filled his gut, but it was difficult to decide if they were *anxiety* or *arousal* as Mydei peeked an eye up at him. He looked as if he *really* wanted to continue.

"Yes, well, I'd rather not do that with you," he said bluntly, then bucked his hips forward. An expectant nod encouraged him to follow suit, testing his limits as he hadn't said '*red*'. "With all due respect, father, I'm not interested in hanging out with your selfish friends and their princess daughters. Please leave my name out of your mouth when you make plans with them."

Phainon's eyes widened.

Mydei continued speaking about not wanting to see him today, sounding more and more annoyed by the second. With it, even his stiffened cock was starting to flag despite them being skin to skin.

Silence followed for a moment, and he leaned down to gently nudge his head into facing his phone. The space gave him a place to kiss the flex of his jaw, then access to his ear for him to kiss his earring. He whispered quietly into his ear, keeping his voice as low as possible so the phone didn't pick it up.

"I love you," Phainon murmured to him, and Mydei nodded lightly in acknowledgment. "Can we make plans with our friends next weekend and get you out of the house, master? Can you dress me up nice and handsome to show me off to other people?"

The hands on him moved again when he bucked his hips into him experimentally, making sure to be slow and careful. His moving coaxed Mydei to grip harder and thrust forward.

"I'll be a good boy for you in front of all our friends, my love," he promised next, rolling his hips down into him. "I'll speak so respectfully to you, let you take care of me in front of everyone, and when we go home, we can do *whatever you want* this time."

Mydei exhaled shakily as he turned his head to face him better. Though he didn't speak, Phainon knew it tickled his interest to hear him say it.

It was so… *bad* to be doing this, to be touching each other while on the phone with his *dad*, but if Mydei didn't care then… *why not?* It wasn't *their* fault he was interrupting them, and there was hardly any noise to pick up on anyway. As long as they were quiet, he would never know.

“Listen, f-father, I… I appreciate your ‘*concern*’ about my future, but stay out of my personal life.” He tried his best to sound unaffected.

Their eyes met, and Phainon smiled at him sweetly despite what he had said.

“I have to go,” Mydei said with more composure. “Have a good rest of your day. Go take mother out on a date night if you’re bored enough to create this mess, and apologize to your friends for lying to them. I won’t be showing up. I’ve got my hands full,—”

Phainon had to *fight* not to laugh at that.

”—and I’m not interested anyway. Goodbye.”

With a nod, his finger clicked the red button on the screen before dropping it on to the nightstand. Despite its clatter, Mydei kept his eyes on him as he began moving his hands over them both.

“‘*Princess*’?”

Jealousy flared up within him at the thought of Mydei’s dad trying to set him up with someone else. Considering it had taken up a majority of the phone call, maybe Eurypon *really* wanted Mydei to join him in whatever he was doing this weekend. To call over and over, to insist even after he declined the first time, he really wanted Mydei to meet this girl.

Did that mean if he ever saw them, they’d have to pretend to be friends all over again? That he didn’t accept Mydei being with a man?

It was one thing not to know while trying to hook them up. Like Cyrene’s parents, they meant it with all the best intentions as she never told them. But it was another thing entirely to reject Mydei’s sexuality and push him to meet people he was clearly not interested in.

Mydei didn’t necessarily tell people he liked men, but surely his parents knew. As a teenager, he didn’t hide it. That enamel pin on his bag was there for anyone and everyone who cared to look at it.

“*Don’t* talk about other people while your dick is in my hand,” Mydei scolded him, and Phainon shook his head quickly to try and erase it from his mind. “I don’t want to think about that.”

“Yes, master.”

“I want to think about *you*, and how *good* you are for me…” He insisted, glancing down at their leaking cocks. “… and how much I only want to be with *you*.”

Phainon leaned down to press a kiss to his lips, breaths fanning into each other’s mouths while grinding together harder.

“Do you like doing this with me, master?” He asked, and Mydei nodded quickly.

“I love playing with you,” he reassured him before tilting his head back into his pillows. “I love touching and pleasing my handsome man… my good boy… *my sweet prince*.”

The pet names tickled his chest and warmed his flexed stomach, and as Mydei continued to murmur out quiet compliments for him, he could feel his chest moving faster against his. He could see his cheeks rosy from heat and arousal.

“I want you to finish first, baby,” he told him, and there was no way he’d ever argue with *that*. “Fuck yourself on my cock. It’s the only way I’ll ever let you get on top of me.”

Phainon humped him faster, desperate to paint his body in his cum and show him that he was *his*. That body he worked so hard to maintain everyday was *his*, and the pleasure he felt when getting off was because of *him*. Those casually romantic moments of shared meals and sweet compliments were for *him* and *only him*. Everything about Mydei, or being with Mydei, was *his*.

Mydei pumped his hands until his thighs shook and cock twitched, and Phainon panted while watching his handsome face contort with pleasure.

“Master, can I… *god*… can I cum?” He whined, aware he could but needing the permission now. No matter what he said before, he needed to hear it again. “Can I make a mess on your body?”

“Let go for me, handsome,” Mydei allowed.

Between his own possessive thoughts of wanting everyone knew Mydei was his and the pleasure of rutting up against him, his orgasm came suddenly and powerfully. Stomach tightened and thighs shaking, he weakly jerked himself forward, stilling his movements. But that didn't mean Mydei stopped, and that didn’t mean he *wanted* him to stop. Those hands kept moving over his pulsing cock, milking rope after rope of cum. And after, he continued.

“Keep going,” he ordered him. “Don’t you dare stop until I finish too. Once I cum, you’re going to lick it all up b-before swallowing it all down.”

Phainon’s voice raised in pitch while moaning, attempting to reel back from the friction. He lost to a firm tug forward instead.

“*Keep. Fucking. Yourself*.”

His hips shakily grinded back into him even if it was too much, unable to deny Mydei the pleasure. Nails scratched into the bedding by Mydei’s head, and his body twitched every time Mydei bumped against him.

“I-It’s too much,” he choked out, but the pleading sound fell on deaf ears. “Master, I-I already… I can’t—”

“I didn't ask *if you can*, I said *you will*,” he hushed. “Don’t be lazy.”

He tried. Phainon tried to rock his hips forward, ignoring the sharp and jolts of pleasure that wracked his shaking body. He focused on Mydei, on his throbbing, his leaking, and his

groans.

This was for *him*. Mydei was using his body to get off the same way he did over the phone and last night. It didn't matter if he was too sensitive to keep going because his job was to *listen*. His job was to please his dominant in any way he could.

It was so *exciting*. It was so overstimulating and a lot on his body, but it was so exciting to be pushed into.

"You look so dirty right now." Mydei's eyes raked over his face. "What a pretty little slut I have. Are you going to lick it up for me?"

"Y-Yes, master," he panted.

"Are you going to swallow?"

"Yes, master. I'll swallow it all—yours a-and mine," he promised him, then felt Mydei's cock pulse. "*Make* me swallow it."

"Fuck, I'm so close," his partner groaned, head turning to the side while fucking into his own hands too. "Phainon… baby, I—"

"Please let go for me, master," Phainon begged, hoping it'd make him finish faster. "And please f-feed me all of your cum. I miss the taste of it already."

That seemed to do it for him. With a low grunt and bucking hips, he fucked himself up into Phainon's softened cock. Each rub helped milk every drop as he slowly eased up on his grasp.

Heavy breaths fell between the both of them, and while looking into Mydei's tired, half lidded eyes, his parted lips curled into a smirk. An exhausted and slightly arrogant smirk.

"G-Get down there and clean me up. You know I h-hate a mess," he demanded him through his panting.

Two hands pushed down on his shoulders, sticky from jerking them off, and Phainon lowered himself while looking at the creamy mess all over his cock, pelvis, and lower stomach. Gulping, he stuck his tongue out and then dragged it over the hot skin. From where his own cum oozed over his length to where it pooled in the dark blond hairs, Phainon licked over it all.

Mydei panted harder, pushing his hands into his hair to hold him still when he tried moving.

"*All of it.*"

He whimpered, then nodded before licking through *all* of the mess left behind on his body. He sucked when his tongue grew too full, drinking up their combined mess until all that lingered on his tastebuds was their release. It coated his mouth, sticky and thick.

When looking up, one of those hands on his head immediately cupped over his lips. Phainon watched him, then held on to his wrist while forcing it down. A loud gulp made Mydei laugh, amber eyes glistening with pride and cheeks rounded from his approving grin.

“Oh, my boy’s so good for me,” he coo’ed, and he nodded quickly while breathing through his nose. “Show me. Come up here and show me you swallowed it all with a nice little kiss.”

His body climbed back on top of him, but rather than just showing off his tongue, Mydei pulled him in for a kiss. It was messy, full of cum-flavored spit, and their tongues touched as if to search for what he could have missed. Whatever he didn’t finish, Mydei wanted for himself.

“We taste so good together,” his partner murmured when pulling away. Strings of saliva connected them before their weight snapped them to his chin. “My prince continues to impress me every day. Come here now, I need to hold you.”

Phainon gasped when he was yanked down into the bed, then closed one eye as Mydei pulled him right into his chest. Forget the ropes. Forget the stickiness of their messy bodies. None of it seemed to matter as he was held skin to skin to his dominant’s body.

“No more playing. I just want to cuddle a little bit, okay? Give me a second,” Mydei said into his hair, and he blinked before holding him closer.

“… *Master?*”

He was being… *clingy*. While Mydei liked holding him after they played and kissing him as much as possible, this felt slightly different. The way he gripped his body and hid into his sweaty hair felt… *off*.

Mydei was usually very talkative, yes. But he typically asked him how he felt about what they did, if he enjoyed himself, and thanked him for their play time. If he had to think, Mydei would’ve asked if he enjoyed this new thing called ‘*frotting*’, and if it was okay that he asked to continue even while on the phone. He’d tell him he was proud of him for holding out while overstimulated, then reassure him that he did a good job.

This time, Mydei just held him. With one arm around his back and the other holding his bare thigh to hike it over his hips, he pulled him close and breathed in the scent of his shampoo and sweat.

Phainon laid there, letting himself be held and holding Mydei in return.

“Are you okay?” He asked tentatively, not wanting him to feel bad about needing this but still wanting to know why.

“You know I love being intimate with you like this, right?” He double-checked. The sound of his voice was slightly muffled, and it brought a patch of heat to his scalp. “I love touching your body and having mine touched by you. I love how *handsome* you are, how *tall* and how *big* you are.”

His eyebrows furrowed in confusion over the sudden compliments.

“I love how *heavy* you feel on top of me, then how *muscular* you are,” he added next. “Your *cock* is so big too, and I love taking it into my hands and my mouth. Then the way you squirm and cry when I touch your *prostate*. I love how your skin *smells* after work too, then how it feels rubbing against mine. I… love your *body hair*, and I love how comfortable you are with it.”

Where was all of that coming from so suddenly? What odd things to praise him for when he already knew Mydei liked these things about him. Again, all he ever did was praise his body to make sure he felt both confident in his skin and wanted by him.

“I love that we can wear each other’s clothes and shoes, then that they *fit* comfortably,” he said next as if he *needed* him to know this. “I love my baby, *my prince*.”

“I love you too, master,” he returned, and Mydei took a deep breath. “Anything you need, I’m here, okay?”

“No. I’m okay. I just… I love *my man*, that’s all…”

Oh. There it was. That was all he needed to say for him to realize what this was about.

‘*My man.*’

Phainon had an inkling that he knew what sprung that series of praise and declaration, but he bit his tongue as Mydei probably didn’t want to talk about it. Especially after they had just finished playing together. Being so high on hormones meant he was more vulnerable, and if there was *anything* Phainon felt he knew the best, it was that this was a delicate moment. One wrong thought, and he could shut down, go nonverbal, and it’d ruin the rest of his day. Maybe his week.

Sub-drops. Dom-drops. Things like that were so *easy* to fall into, and he wanted to prevent it as much as possible. The same way Mydei did all he could for him, he wanted to do the same as well.

“Your man loves you too,” Phainon promised him, and Mydei nuzzled closer to him. “Please hold me, and let’s relax a bit before we rinse off.”

“I want to wash you.”

“Can you please wash my body?” He spun it around, and his dominant nodded while holding him tighter. “Can we turn our phones off and just focus on each other too?”

He nodded again, and Phainon reached for his phone as the grasp on his body tightened. Upon seeing the screen illuminated and the series of text messages and missed calls, he bit his sigh back to simply silent his notifications. Once the display shut off, his arm wrapped tightly around Mydei’s body.

“Thank you for playing with me, master,” he whispered, taking the initiative for him in case it’d help him feel better. “I had a lot of fun with you. I’d like to do this again.”

“I’m glad,” he said quietly back. “I always have fun with you, handsome. Cuddle me, and I’ll carry you to the shower soon.”

Phainon smiled, then kissed his shoulder before closing his eyes, quietly praying it was just a misunderstanding that took place.

Mydei said he loved his dad. He said Eurypon took good care of him and Gorgo, and he gave them a privileged life of comfort and luxury by working hard for his company. Because of him, he never had to worry about a lot of things other people did—*especially* if it was something financial. Even if he was a terrible boss to have or a bad person outside of parenthood, at the very least, he loved his family and looked out for them in the ways he knew best. If he didn’t, Mydei would feel more resentment towards him.

Surely he was just… missing part of the picture. Eurypon wasn’t *rejecting* Mydei. He wasn’t *denying* his partner’s sexuality. He was only… left in the dark about his interest in men, or maybe he was confused by Mydei’s lack of a partner all his life. If he never told *him* about his past relationships, then of course he’d never tell his *dad*.

Phainon’s stomach churned.

Mydei loved his dad, and Eurypon loved him too. It was simply a misunderstanding. *It had to be.*

Chapter End Notes

i feel like mydei has spent this whole fic praising phainon and telling him he loves his masculine body. then he reassures him of his masculinity and strength despite being submissive.

(any body is masc if you want it to be, but like a stereotypical masculine body. body hair, tall, strong, muscular, etc. etc.)

he likes his men. he likes men who likes men too.

sometimes i think about how he was phainons first male partner. he had to ease him into being with a man, unsure if phainon even really wanted to go all the way because he’s only ever been with a woman, and then sit in the fear of not being able to give him a family and all that traditional comfort stuff he could have with a woman. i bet its a lot in the background :<

Chapter 24: Chapter Twenty-Four

Chapter Notes

> i had rewritten this chapter as i edited it in ao3 a few days ago, and it refreshed 3 times so i raged. came back today, tried to edit it ALL MORNING just for it to refresh again and only save half of it.
>
> hohhh boy. i hope this is okay. i got annoyed and decided to just say FUCK IT. i hate the docs to ao3 thing on mobile. its frustrating sometimes

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The thought weighed on the back of his mind. When they kissed, when they cuddled, when they sent their '*good morning*' texts and had a quick '*good night*' call before bed, Phainon thought about how Mydei's father might not approve of their relationship.

They were grown, sure. They paid their own bills, had their own places, and could live their lives however they wanted to. Lord knows they've been doing whatever they felt like with each other, uncaring of what other people might think.

There was no shortage of secrets between them and their families. Phainon didn't even tell his own parents yet as the conversation hasn't come up organically. Neither his mom nor dad has bothered to ask about a potential girlfriend, opting to just chat about work, gardening, dogs, and everything else that mattered *more* to them.

But… it was nice to think Mydei's parents would be okay with them. As his friend, they let him over often and treated him like a second son. Gorgo used to compliment his old country accent when it was at its thickest, and Eurypon was always glad that Mydei had a friend to keep him company growing up. As his boyfriend, he had hoped they'd welcome him back that same way—happily, and with arms wide open.

It was something *everyone* hoped for when romantically involved with someone, right?

Phainon thought about it at work too, where he was forced to watch people who were out on dates. They loved to laugh and giggle with one another—men who insisted they'd let their girlfriends have whatever they wanted and women who joked about eating off of their plate instead. He always smiled at them, coo'ed over how cute they were, and bit back the twist of jealousy in his stomach to be so open and free. It tickled a bit inside of his chest every time he saw the hand holding over table tops and blatant, tunnel visioned heart-eyes.

Part of him wanted that. It wanted *more* than just nights at home sometimes, but Mydei not caring about dates most likely had something to do with him not wanting to be seen out with another man romantically. Which he understood. Not everyone accepted that, and it was fine to be a private, cautious person.

Phainon was sure Eurypon had something to do with those feelings, but he couldn't just prove it. Their father-son relationship was a touchy subject, and he knew it shouldn't matter as much as he was making it out to be. That meant he couldn't just get up and ask.

So, he kept it to himself. If Mydei ever wanted to talk about these things, he could. If he didn't, then that would be a bridge they walked when they got there.

The weekend rolled around soon enough, and they managed to gather their friends for a night out. Mydei had reserved a table at a club he knew Cifera and Cyrene really liked, one Aglaea had introduced them to awhile ago. No matter how Phainon tried to convince him it wasn't necessary to go the extra step, if Mydei was going out, he wanted it to go his way. And since he invited Hysilens and her wife, it was supposedly '*proper*' to go somewhere nicer than usual for first impressions.

Truthfully, Phainon didn't really care where they went, so long as Mydei enjoyed himself. It was meant to be an excuse for him to get out of seeing Eurypon for dinner and to get him out of the house. However it needed to be done—*fine*.

An outfit they both decided on dressed their bodies, two bottles of cologne they picked for each other clouded in the bedroom, and the shoes they planned to wear were taken from their cubby just waiting to be slipped on. All they he had to do now was shut off the lights, double check their pockets for their things, then go.

Only Mydei was distracted while looking at his phone, which was odd. Usually, he kept off of it when they were together. It was only ever checked when using the bathroom, before bed when he remembered it existed, or whenever it happened to ring.

What was so interesting on it now?

"Mm… *attention*," he huffed, leaning on his shoulder and sneaking a peek at the screen. "Master, we promised Cassie and 'rene we would be there first."

"With how long those girls take to get ready, I'm sure we will be even if we hit every red light on the way," he retorted, and Phainon caught a glimpse at the contact name. "Sorry, handsome. My father doesn't believe me when I tell him I'm going out. He wants proof."

"Send him a picture of us."

"No."

One hand slowly slid up the front of his wine-red collared shirt, toying with the golden stud pinned into one fold. After, he lined a thin, golden necklace chain up and around his neck to hold him. The side of his neck filled his palm, and he thumbed over Mydei's adam's apple gently when he swallowed.

"Come on…" Phainon pouted at him slightly. "He doesn't know about us, right? He thinks we're friends, so how could it upset him to just see us carpooling together?"

How many pictures of them were framed in Mydei's place already? How many times were they captured in their high-school yearbooks hanging off of each other? How many posts has he made that had Mydei's user tagged on it right beside him as they worked out or went out with their friends?

What was the difference of one more picture being added to the pile?

Mydei glanced down at him, tongue tracing over his teeth before he hummed quietly. "You know what would make him upset though?"

"What?"

"Seeing another man wearing the designer jacket he bought his son for Christmas last year," he mentioned while turning the screen of his phone off. "Seeing another man touching his son's neck and resting on his shoulder this intimately…"

Phainon's hand curled with more confidence, holding him gingerly as he leaned forward.

"… Seeing his son grab that man by the back of his head and kiss him on his sweet, vanilla scented lips would *really* piss him off…" Mydei added after, and he felt his heart skip over the softened look inside of his eyes. "My prince looks so handsome in my jacket and his choker right now. I know I always say it, and maybe you get tired of hearing it, but I love seeing you like this."

"I really like wearing it." He planted a soft kiss on his lips, unable to help himself. "It makes me feel sexy, then when you compliment me too, it makes me feel even *sexier*."

"You are without even trying."

"You could also lend me one of your black thigh straps for tonight so you can see me in even more," Phainon whispered suggestively against his mouth. "It'll look cool."

Mydei scoffed quietly, pulling away. "Do you *want* people to look at you and realize you're into *bondage?*"

"Trust me." He had a plan in mind and was *ninety-nine* percent sure it would work out in his favor. "Just one. I'll wear it over my jeans, and it'll look… fashionable, not fetish-y."

"You aren't known to have the best fashion sense…"

Phainon pouted while looking up at him, eyes widening for dramatic effect. "Please, master…?"

He wanted it. While Mydei liked the way he looked in leather, it wasn't as if he did it *just* for him. And their friends sometimes wore thigh straps, leather chokers, and chunky boots for fashion too. What would be the difference between Cifera's heart shaped garter and his? An elastic band for stretching rather than a belt to buckle it tight? And if Hysilens was going to be dressed like that too, because she always did when not in uniform, then it wouldn't look weird at all for him to, right?

“Those damn puppy dog eyes…” Mydei grumbled as he stared into them for a moment. “Phainon, what do you think you’re doing right now?”

“Trying to get my master to let me tease him tonight… Is it working?”

“… *One*.” Hearing him give in to the request made his stomach tingle with excitement and pride. “One of the less obvious ones. And if you realize you don’t like it, or you don’t want to keep wearing it, be sure to tell me. I’ll take it off and put it in the car.”

Score.

“Yes, master. I understand.”

They walked into his closet together, and Phainon pressed the passcode into the keypad for him while he took the time to slip his phone into his back pocket. Mechanical beeps followed each button, and when it unlocked, he pulled it open excitedly.

“Do you remember when you were too afraid to look at this?” Mydei brought up casually while reaching inside. “Now you’re asking so freely to come in and out of here.”

“Some of it is still a little bit intimidating,” he admitted. “That metal bar down there looks weird, and the clamps with those weights make me really nervous. But… maybe you can try them again for less time. It’s been awhile, so I’m not sure if it’s just the memory of that night or if I *really* don’t like it.”

“Maybe.” Mydei sounded interested in the thought despite his short response. “We’ll see in the future. You might be riding the high of us doing *this* right now, so we can discuss it *later*.”

That meant he was going to consider it, and that was both exciting *and* nerve wracking. Would they feel any different *now* that he was more comfortable in handling a little bit of aches and pains?

His partner grabbed the hanging belt they were looking for, able to distinguish which was what at first glance. Even after being in here so much, after using these things himself, all of it still looked like a mess of belts, rings, and chains to him.

“Here, give me one of your legs,” he instructed him while getting down on one knee. “Allow me to touch you.”

“Yes, master. You can.”

Phainon stuck his left leg out, watching as Mydei clipped the claws around his front and side belt loops to secure it in place. Those bands met over his front pocket with a silver ring, and a strap connected it to another ring beneath. That stretched into a belt around his thigh, holding his mid-thigh firmly and dipping into the dark denim.

While standing, it didn’t feel particularly tight, but when sitting, he knew it’d dig a little bit deeper into the muscles. His thighs had never been *small*.

“Look how inconspicuous,” he beamed, and Mydei looked him up and down as if he wanted to tear the clothes he had just put on, *off*.

One hand held the back of his thigh, pulling him closer until he was standing right in front of him. Like this, Phainon couldn’t help but admire how *handsome* he looked while gazing up at him right now and how *close* he was to his front zipper.

“My master looks good down there,” he teased him gently. “You should kneel for me more.”

“*Ha. Ha*. Is it too late for you to become a comedian?” Strong fingers curled downwards into his garter, slipping underneath to pull. “Do we *really* have to go tonight?”

“Yeah, we do.”

Mydei took a deep breath. “… *Really?*”

A laugh shook his chest as he pulled his leg back, and Mydei stood up straight while pulling him closer by his hips. Both hands slipped under his jacket to touch his waistband, pinching where his t-shirt was tucked in.

“Really,” Phainon repeated. “We have to meet up with our friends, and I have to get a little bit of liquor in your system to loosen you up. You still look a little tense.”

“I know something that can—”

“*Master*,” he chided playfully, both endeared by his flirting and amused. “We need to leave soon. You’re gonna make us late, and *you’re* the one who’s always a stickler for schedules, you know.”

“Fine… I’ll be good.” Mydei reeled his hands back to set them over his jacket. “If you want to drink tonight, go ahead and enjoy yourself. If I’m going to drive us home, then I won’t be having much.”

His head shook stubbornly. “Nah. Besides, I’d like to pour your drinks for you while we’re there.”

One eyebrow raised skeptically. “In front of all our friends? *Are you sure?*”

“Yes, please. Maybe you can give me like… a tap three times. Or, you can just straight up ask me if I’m not talking to someone,” he suggested, hoping that was inconspicuous enough. “I don’t think they’ll notice, and if they do, I’ll chalk it up to the fact *you* bought the bottle. They’re not exactly *cheap*, you know.”

“That sounds nice. I’d like that a lot, actually,” he agreed without much thinking. “Just make sure you have fun too. If you start getting worried about the prices of food and stuff, if you really want to, I’ll show you the bill after. You can pay me back later… *I guess*…”

The quiet grumbling that left his mouth for having to say such a thing made Phainon laugh again. It was cute how resigned he was to the fact he couldn’t just throw money at him.

Sometimes it felt like he trained Mydei to be his perfect partner. Never would he had said such a thing had they been at the start of this.

“Thank you.”

“Anything for you,” he reassured him. “Where are your keys? Give me them and then text Cifera that we’re on our way to pick her up now. Knowing her, she’s still doing her eyeliner…”

Phainon reached into his jacket pocket and handed him his key ring, unbothered by the fact Mydei wanted to drive him around. If he could be a ‘*passenger princess*’, he wanted to be. It was the one thing he’d never fuss about.

”Can anyone *really* tell if it’s lopsided?”

”Yes, but you don’t ever tell her that unless it’s uncomfortably noticeable,” Mydei explained. “You always tell a woman she’s beautiful and praise her for her effort, especially if she tries *that* hard to feel pretty for herself.”

“Who taught you how to flatter a girl, Mr. Romantic?” Phainon elbowed him lightly.

“Mother.”

Well, he should have guessed that. What else was he going to say? ‘*Ex-girlfriend*’?

”I noticed that it works for men too,” he added after. “Every time I compliment you and your clothes, you get all giddy and excited after. It’s very cute. I like when you’re confident and comfortable with yourself.”

“If you keep being so romantic, we aren’t going to make it to the car,” Phainon warned him, and Mydei shrugged.

”*Oh no… Whatever would we do…*”

—

The club was every bit noisy and crowded when they finally made it there, and Mydei already looked as if he wanted to throw back a drink then walk right out. Crowded spaces that were too loud to think in were never his favorite places to be, and that meant clubs were never his first choice of hangout spots. But their friends liked it, and this was his convenient excuse to get away from Eurypon’s dinner plans. So Mydei kept walking, and Phainon followed behind with Cifera on his tail.

Their table was partially secluded on the upstairs part of the club, separated from the main floor where a sea of people were dancing. It gave Mydei enough privacy to not deal with

strangers approaching him unnecessarily, and it was also easy for the rest of them to walk downstairs and join the crowd.

Had Phainon been single, maybe he would have gone down there to meet new people right away. Talking to others and dancing with them was the appeal of going out, and alcohol was always an afterthought for him past a glass of courage. Unlike Mydei, who always chose to simply sit and drink while sticking around their friends. But as a taken man with a partner who could see him from his seat, he stayed glued to his side until listening to him and Hyacine talk about dieting and supplements got boring.

No matter how low of sugar it was for him to drink straight whiskey, it didn't combat the damage it would do to his liver over time. Hyacine was right—drinking almost everyday *was* bad, no matter what was in his cup and no matter how '*little*' of it he had.

"She continues to worry about me," Mydei sighed when she walked off to use the bathroom with Castorice. "It's not as bad as she thinks. It's one or two glasses… unless I'm particularly upset…"

"Listen to the lady with a medical degree," Phainon insisted, reaching for the empty glass in his hand before he could even set it down. Three clicks to its bottom made it clear what he wanted. "That's why you won't be able to drink as much next week. I'll cut you off if you try."

"Buzzkill," Cifera boo'ed from beside them, giving him a thumbs down as she clicked her glass to the table. "We're still young! Stop being so… boring."

"My bad. Did you want him to become a statistic for alcoholism?" His eyebrow raised as she repeated his words in a mocking voice. "I'll tell Aglaea."

"'*I'll tell Aglaea*'," she mimicked him again. "'*Oh, look at me. I'm snowy, and I get whatever I want with my puppy dog eyes and big tits*'."

Cyrene choked on her shot, half coughing and half laughing from her retort. Beside him, Mydei snorted and turned his head, not quite laughing but also not entirely innocent. Like a *traitor*.

Whose side was he on?

"I don't have… '*tits*'…" Phainon argued, placing the glass in hand on the table. "Just because they're bigger than yours—"

"—*oh*, don't give me that lip!" Cifera hissed while leaning over the table. "I'll have you know, I've had more girls than you've *ever had* with their mouth—"

"That's not hard," he deadpanned, aware all his friends knew he's only ever had *one* sexual partner before. "But what about men?"

"*Please*, I don't even want to deal with you and Mydei sometimes! I'm not about to deal with another *dog* around here," she scoffed. "And does that imply you've slept with a man before,

snowy?"

"I never said that."

Cyrene shook her head while looking at him, and Cifera's eyes widened as she rushed to sit next to him. Batting her eyes with her hands crossed over her lap, she stared innocently as if she wanted him to share every-juicy detail of his intimate life. Not that he *would* after all of that teasing.

"Twenty if he tells us he's this pathetic top that begs for a shot," she told Cyrene, who lifted an eyebrow at her skeptically.

But because his best friend was also a traitor, she grinned along with her. "Twenty says he's not."

It was almost offensive how, after knowing what they were like together, she would rush to bet in him being a *bottom*. Did he really come off that obviously?

"Two-hundred says he doesn't open his mouth about his personal affairs," Mydei joined in with a huff, and Phainon reached for an iced bottle while sealing his lips shut. "That's not *your* business, and I'm not drunk enough for this conversation."

"Oh my—*what's the point?*" Cifera groaned. She slumped into the leather couch, whining over how unfun he was being by cutting them off. "It's not like *you're* fucking him, De. Why does it matter if he tells us? Twenty buys me my next battle pass!"

Cyrene giggled as he began to pour another drink. "Oh, Cifera… How nice of you to turn your video games off to join us here tonight. Did you ever hit that rank you wanted?"

"*Of course not!* I swear that '*999*' person is personally staying in my rank to destroy my hopes and dreams!" She whined, and Phainon turned to his partner. "They always target me too! They see my gamer tag and just know!"

He handed him his glass as Mydei leaned in closer, his voice dropped to a stern whisper. "If you let that happen again, I'm going to punish you. *Watch your mouth*."

A buzz made him jump from his seat, and he set the bottle back down before rushing to reach for his phone. Two sets of curious eyes glanced down on either side of him, and all he needed to see what the name before he moved his clicked the screen off.

"Who's that?" Cifera asked. "Girlfriend? Boyfriend? Mom?"

"She's my *friend*, and she's *married*," he hushed, placing a hand to her shoulder and pushing her away.

"… Girlfriend?" Cifera repeated, and he rolled his eyes before standing up. "I want to go meet your mistress."

Phainon cringed at both the idea of dating Hysilens and having a '*mistress*' in his life. Though he knew she meant it in a different way, both senses of the word felt so wrong to hear

and think about.

Mydei grumbled quietly before taking a drink, upset by it as well.

“That makes me really uncomfortable, actually. Don’t say it like that,” he requested, and she sighed dramatically. “Stay here. I’ll bring them up.”

“Fine! Mydei, you should pour out some shots for them since you bought them. It’s only right.”

“I bought the bottles, but I’m not here to be your play bartender,” he brushed off as he leaned back. “Phainon can pour them their first shots when he comes back up.”

Damn. Mydei said that so casually, yet behind his almost bored tone, Phainon could feel the weight of his silent expectation. This wasn’t to be argued. It wasn’t a suggestion.

Mydei wanted him to do it, so he was going to do it.

“Awh, me?” He tried desperately to mask the immediate rush inside of his gut from the order to be good. “Why do I have to do it?”

This was right in front of their friends too, as if he knew they wouldn’t say anything about it —and they didn’t. All they did was accept that Mydei was telling him what to do, like he typically told everyone what to do.

“Yes, you. Those are your friends you invited, so make them feel welcomed.”

“I guess…” Phainon sulked, brushing off Cifera’s teasing of what a ‘*good dog*’ he was. Cyrene laughed at her, telling her to stop bullying him so much.

For once, he didn't care about saying anything back. Mydei was making him do something, and it wasn’t just for him now. It was for other people. Was he trying to silently show off how good he could be to people who had their own dynamic?

Sure, he could deny him. He could insist that he only wanted to serve him drinks, as it felt like something special between them both, but why was it so exciting to think about? Why was it making his body tingle so much to think that this would please him?

Mydei might even reward him for listening.

“Just one round out of courtesy. Everyone has their own hands,” his partner added after, reassuring him that he wasn’t expected to perform this way all night. “Well? What are you waiting for? Go get them.”

“Yeah! Phainon, you can’t let them just wait!” Cyrene agreed while waving her hands at him. “Go, go, go! Shoo!”

Phainon nodded in agreement. His feet rushed down the stairs and through the crowd, weaving through the bodies carefully. He soon found both women by the bar, and he slowed down while taking in their outfits from afar.

It was one thing to see them online or to see Hysilens in their work uniform, but seeing her dressed up like this was always so surprising. Sometimes he forgot that she liked to look like that—wearing skirts shorter than the length of her straightened hair. From behind, he almost wouldn't have known she had anything on until her hair split to reveal the short hem when she turned.

Granted, he had seen her without clothes on, but he tried very hard not to think about it when together. Especially since he would rather forget the image of her bruised ass completely.

She was standing right beside her wife, who had on an equally short skirt as well. Instead of wearing black, she had on white, and her top covered much more than Hysilens' did despite being backless and sleeveless. One hand was on her hip, short nails tapping against the fabric as she then looked over her shoulder from his staring.

"Can I help you?" *Attitude* was the first thing he noticed about her aside from her height, then a *bored* expression when she faced him fully. Her other hand touched around her wife's hip after, wedding ring flashing under the lights. "You may go. Neither of us are interested."

Hysilens turned around from the exchange, then smiled kindly at him. "Oh, that's not… That's Phainon, not just some random guy."

"Hm… Is it?" She asked, looking him up and down before crossing her arms. "Maybe it is. I don't quite remember his face."

"Nice to meet you." He waved awkwardly. "I promise I wasn't checking you out. It's just so strange seeing Hysilens out of uniform."

"You're telling me. Where's your button up? Why are we showing off our bodies like this?" She mused, then held her cup close. "We looked around and didn't find you, so I got a drink and decided to wait for your reply. Maybe you were caught up somewhere."

"Everyone's up top."

"'*Up top*'?" Cerydra repeated, and he pointed to the loft area above them. Upon looking over there with her, he noticed Cyrene standing there with Mydei to peek at them. While his best friend waved enthusiastically, his partner only stared. "I see."

"My uh… *friend*…" One pale eyebrow raised at him, and Hysilens grinned at him. "… reserved a table for tonight, and they bought a bunch of bottles for everyone to take shots. So, if you feel like it, help yourselves."

"Are they here?" Hysilens asked while following him, and he hummed. "*You-know-who?*"

"Well…"

Would Mydei mind if he came clean? He did say to leave it at just her, and he didn't mind that she knew because of her own relationship. Cerydra being here meant little when they both knew these women told everything to each other.

“Yes, they are,” he answered shyly. “But, please don’t bring it up around the others. No one knows they’re *that* for me, just my best friend and potential partner. We haven’t admitted to anything, but I’m sure they all kind of suspect it.”

Mydei had this thing about him. While he would never lie about them being in a relationship, he also wasn’t going to come out and tell them out of nowhere. If they found out from how he acted, then they did. But if they didn’t ask or point out their behavior, he would never feel the need to announce it to the world.

That was fine. Phainon didn’t need to have a sign over his head that told the world he was Mydei’s, he just didn’t want to outright play pretend.

“I won’t, but I’ll have fun guessing,” she joked. “Hm… Man or woman? Sweet or shy? I’m excited to meet them.”

Phainon only laughed as they climbed the stairs, finding that all his friends were laughing while Castorice had her face scrunched up in distaste. She coughed into her arm, eyes full of water and betrayal.

“*That’s terrible!*”

“*Come on*, princess, you’ve gotta toughen up,” Cifera snickered. “It’s just a shot of tequila.”

“*It tastes so bad!*”

“That’s the difference between a ‘*shot*’ and a ‘*cocktail*’, Cassie,” Hyacine giggled. “*Oh!* Phainon’s back with his friends! Cyrene told us you were down there!”

He turned to face Hysilens and Cerydra, hands clapping together while they stood awkwardly behind him.

“Let me pour your first shots since you’re our guests tonight,” he offered kindly.

Hysilens glanced at her wife, who then nodded curtly. “I’d like that,” she agreed. “She’ll drink whatever you pour. Only one though, as she’s driving.”

“Great! I’m only doing one round, so if you want another, you’ll have to do it yourself,” he mused, earning a gasp of ‘*don’t be rude’* from Cyrene. “I don’t wanna work on my day off.”

“Tell me about it! It’s so nice being on the *other side* of the bar,” she laughed, walking closer towards his friends with Cerydra.

“Guys, this is Hysilens and Cerydra,” he introduced them while swiping a bottle off of the table. “They’re married, so don’t even think about it, Cyrene, *Cifera*.”

“*Hey!*”

Phainon clicked two glasses together before pointing at each person.

“Hysilens and Cerydra, these are my friends—Cyrene, Cifera, Hyacine, Castorice, and Mydei,” he listed them all in the order of how they were sitting. “Sit wherever you want, drink whatever you want, and don’t worry about anything but having a good time.”

“I like those boots,” Cifera commented, staring at Hysilens’ shoes. “Where did you get them from?”

Once full, Phainon slid both glasses towards either woman, then took a seat beside where Mydei’s arm lined the couch. He sat close, leg to leg, aware of the way Mydei pushed up against his own.

“It would be rude not to drink with them,” Mydei brought up as he leaned forward. “Here. Pour everyone else one too—even you.”

“Ah, I have to—”

“One is okay if we’re going to be here for a while,” Cyrene reasoned, and he sighed. “Who’s going to tell?”

“You can’t say that in front of the *nurse* and the *lawyer!*” He hinted, and he looked to where Cerydra was while the others glanced at Hyacine.

“You guys are so…” Hyacine trailed off exasperatedly. “Do you know how many accidents happen?”

Beside him, Cerydra crossed her arms. “*Hmph*.”

When she looked away, Cifera grinned and then slammed her empty shot glass to the table. Cyrene followed. Then Hyacine. Then Castorice.

“I like these ladies! Go on, be a good boy, Phainon,” she taunted him, and he cringed as Hysilens gasped in surprise.

Mydei huffed quietly, nudging his leg again.

“You know, you can go back to calling me a ‘*dog*’ if that’s the alternative,” he mouthed off, then grabbed the bottle again. “I’m only doing this once for you guys! You’re just lucky I feel nice today!”

“I’m sure Mydei will give you a tip later for playing bartender for us.” One eye dropped into a wink, and Mydei choked over his drink before putting his glass down on the table too.

Phainon was no better as he shot her a look.

“I’m kidding!” She waved her hands, though Castorice was giggling quietly over it. “Come on!”

“That’s completely inappropriate in front of new people,” Mydei muttered, wiping his mouth with a paper towel. “Please ignore her. She gets—”

"—*annoying*," Phainon finished, cheeks burning from her comment. "She's annoying."

"—*hyper*," he said instead after he shot him a look. "Cifera is a very eccentric person, and she gets even more bold when drinking. Let's not take her too seriously. She just wants to joke and make others laugh all the time."

Hysilens nodded, setting her cup down before handing a shot to her wife with a nudge.

"Let's all have a good time! It's not often we can come out like this! Especially when Hyacine and Mydei are always so busy," Cyrene beamed happily, changing the subject.

One by one, Phainon gave them back their glasses, then poured himself half of one. When finished, he looked at the shot as Mydei shifted his abandoned jacket over either of their legs.

The hand not holding his own drink touched his thigh, holding it firmly by the leather strap. Though he didn't look his way, it was nice to know Mydei was both thinking about him and wanting to touch him.

"Let's keep making nice memories together, even if we might not remember them all," Castorice added kindly. "And let's hope Mydei doesn't go bankrupt from spoiling us all so much…"

"I'll pay you back on my next paycheck," Hyacine promised.

"Phainon orchestrated this whole thing because he thought we all needed to unwind," he admitted to them, turning to face him. "Thank him. I wouldn't have done this otherwise."

"*Yeah! Snowy!*" Cifera cheered, jumping from her seat. "You know I love you!"

His eyes rolled.

He loved her too, but sometimes he wanted to hide all her favorite things on the top shelves of her house, then not tell her where they were. Then he wanted to laugh as she was forced to climb all the furniture for them.

"Yeah yeah…" Phainon taunted her, raising his glass too. "Just get me drunk and let's all sleep in the bathroom stalls."

"Ew…" Hyacine mumbled as they all raised their shots and clicked it to whoever was closest to them. For her, it was Castorice. For him, it was Mydei.

While looking at him so closely, Phainon could smell the liquor on his breath and feel the slip of his usual restraint. Even just the way he looked at him, eyes softened and focused on his lips, was different. Though he didn't kiss him or say anything, he gave a tight squeeze of his thigh.

Fingers lingered under the belt, teasing him, and he smiled back at him. But it only lasted for a second before they looked back to their friends. With them, he took his drink and Mydei did the same.

“Mm…” Mydei hummed once he set his glass down. “You’ve drank with us now, so tell us more about yourselves. What do you do for a living, Cerydra? How were your days?”

Phainon’s nose scrunched as a burn tickled down his tongue and throat, and he coughed to himself lightly. Even with friends, it was still miserable to swallow down.

“I serve as a district attorney,” she answered, and Mydei nodded. “And you?”

“Your average, cookie-cutter office worker,” he brushed off, only for Hyacine to shake her head.

“He’s being humble,” she corrected him. “His father runs *Kremnos Enterprises*, and he’s climbing the ladder to get experience before taking over the company as *CEO*. How long does that take again, Mydei?”

He shrugged weakly as Cerydra looked at him. “It just takes time, and a lot of it.”

“To think, he used to intern there,” Castorice commented. “Now you’re… what? *Director?*”

“I babysit grown men, play middle man between the staff and the higher-ups, and sit in a chair all day on my computer.” Mydei sounded finished with this conversation already, like he was tired of having to talk about himself already. “Don’t make it sound like I’m more important than I am.”

“You don’t seem to like—”

“Was it hard?” Phainon asked suddenly, and they looked at him as he looked at Cerydra, who looked offended by him cutting her off. “The uh… schooling, tests, and all that. How long have you been an active attorney? You’re still so young, right?”

“Asking a lady about her age should be a crime,” she scoffed, and Cyrene nodded in agreement as Hysilens giggled. “It wasn’t easy, but I’m nothing if not ambitious.”

“I’d like to hear how that went,” Castorice requested, interested in her story. “Where did you go to school?”

With the conversation steered away from Mydei, he felt another squeeze on his thigh as if to thank him. Nails scratched against his jeans, gripping him tightly.

Phainon lowered his hand towards it, slipping beneath the jacket as well in hopes the table covered enough of them to hide. His fingers dragged over the backs of his knuckles and traced along the skin and rings slowly. Once over, they shifted. The slots between Mydei’s were filled with his own, holding the both of them.

“How did you know you wanted to become an attorney?" Mydei added, hoping to keep the conversation there for a while.

“Easy.” Hysilens’ head shook as if she already knew the answer, but she stared lovingly at her wife. “I like to argue with people, and I’m always right. I should get paid for it.”

“Oh, dear… Here we go.”

Phainon laughed, then leaned back into the couch, listening to her talk while holding Mydei’s hand.

—

After the girls had gotten bored of simply talking about each other, Cyrene decided they should go dance. In tow, she took Hyacine and Castorice, not wanting to go alone. With two heads of bright pink hair and Castorice’s glittery, butterfly-shaped hair clips, it was hard not to see them even if it was dark.

Phainon, Hysilens, and Cifera were together, watching from the upstairs railing. Those two were nursing their drinks from the bar rather than shots, and he had a cup of soda in hand as he was dead set on not drinking anymore.

“That looks fun…” Cifera murmured to them, watching with sparkling eyes. “Should I…?”

“You should join them,” he encouraged her, bumping her shoulder gently. “Go on. I bet Cyrene’s hands miss you. You’re the only one confident enough to dance on her, you know.”

She drank from her straw until it had nothing left to pick them, then thrust both her cup and strapless purse into his chest. A soft grunt left his lips on impact, and he rushed to catch them before they fell.

“I’m gonna go join my girls! Watch my stuff, snowy!”

Before he could say anything back, her feet rushed down the steps with loud, thumping steps. Phainon chuckled while watching to make sure she made it there. Only when her smaller body managed to sift through the sea of people to meet up with them did he allow himself to look away.

“Is she always bullying you?”

“Yeah… It’s kinda mutual,” he sighed dramatically. “She calls me a ‘*dog*’. I call her a ‘*cat*’. She likes to scratch me with her too-long nails, and I hold her phone over her head because she can’t reach it.”

Hysilens laughed at that. “Sounds eventful.”

“Mydei hates it,” he joked, and she tilted her head curiously over the mention of his name. “We can go back and forth all day, and we somehow always bring him into our bickering. We give him a headache.”

“Is he not the argumentative type too?” She wondered. “He seems quiet so far.”

“He doesn’t talk much until you get some liquor in him. It helps him open up a bit.” Phainon then looked over his shoulder, finding that Mydei was still listening to Cerydra talk to him. “Those two seem to be hitting it off though…”

“Like me, my wife doesn’t go out often. It’s good she’s making new friends with me.” Hysilens looked so happy watching them together. “She made a few, but she has… quite the personality. Sometimes, she talks too much, speaks too bluntly, and it makes people uncomfortable.”

Well, that must have been nice for Mydei, who also spoke without restraint yet preferred other people to drive the conversation.

“She can be a bit intense,” he confessed to her, focusing on how relaxed his partner looked right now. “But… she’s uh… she’s a cool… person…”

Mydei was leaning back on the leather couch with an arm spanning over the back again. One ankle laid crossed over the other knee comfortably, and he had decided to actually wear the jacket instead of keeping it folded over his lap. All of his attention was on Cerydra, lips pulled into a polite and courteous smile and eyes tired but still aware.

Whatever was being said from both Hysilens right beside him and Cerydra right across from him fell on Phainon’s deaf ears, as the club music was loud and he felt a twinge of something in his chest. It flickered for a moment, hot and demanding attention.

“We should go talk to them again,” he blurted out, and Hysilens’ hand reached to hold his arm. “I wonder what they’re talking about.”

“Absolutely not,” he managed to make out over the music. “My wife doesn’t like stuff like that, *if you get what I mean*. I’ll get in trouble if I disrupt her when she’s talking to someone else.”

Right. He and Hysilens were in the same ocean but not the same boat. As much as he could poke and prod at his partner to get on his nerves, she was probably heavily reprimanded for being a ‘*spoiled brat*’.

Mydei actually liked his neediness and attitude more often than not, as he liked teasing, bullying, and playing around with him back. Though he had his moments when he wanted the games to stop, they weren’t as ‘*normal*’ as the two of them messing around.

From what he remembered, Cerydra didn’t accept such behavior from Hysilens. They had two completely different kinds of dynamics.

“Then I’ll go alone,” he decided, not wanting her to be punished for his bratty behavior. “If you like, you can go dance with them. The girls would love that.”

“Maybe I will,” she agreed. “I must tell my wife, however. So, I guess I’m going over anyway…”

Hysilens followed him back to the table despite her apprehension, and he set Cifera's purse beside Cyrene's. Upon hearing a glass click beside him, Phainon noticed Mydei had set his own down.

"My love, do you—"

One hand raised to signal that he was busy, attention still fixated on Cerydra. But then he brought his palm down to touch the table, and his index finger tapped three times from behind his glass. The gesture was both quiet and discreet to their party, yet because he was looking, it was loud and obvious.

"You really shouldn't interrupt them while they're speaking," Hysilens insisted, taking her seat beside her wife. Rather than asking for her attention like he did, she placed her things down, pulled her phone out, and waited.

Phainon grabbed the bottle in the middle of their table, tingling inside of his belly from Mydei's wordless command, and began to pour him another drink. It was exciting to be told what to do so blatantly. The other two could see them, but it wasn't as if they knew why he was suddenly popping the cap off.

When full, he slid it towards Mydei and watched as he reached for it and brought it towards his mouth.

"This is quite the purchase. I understand things like this are not cheap," Cerydra commented while looking around. That was when Mydei actually took his sip. "How much do I owe you for tonight?"

"Nothing," he brushed off. "I needed something to do tonight, and my friends happened to really like this club. It all aligned."

Her eyebrow raised. "You don't appear to be having fun yourself."

"I am," Mydei reassured her, and Phainon slid closer to his partner despite them still talking. "Are you?"

"I don't do things like this. It's loud and hot," she criticized, a tinge of annoyance in her voice. "But… My wife is making good friends. Seeing her enjoy herself is making this bearable, and it's rude to refuse a gift. So, thank you for tonight. Whatever you feel I owe you, I will give to you on behalf of my wife and I."

Hysilens smiled to herself, keeping her distance while still waiting for her turn to join in.

"You should learn to relax a little bit like Hysilens," his partner advised. "Every now and then, things like this are nice to indulge in."

Cerydra didn't seem to like his unsolicited advice and criticism.

"*Well*. You should tell your submissive to be more considerate of two people having a conversation," she chided, then glanced at him as he sat thigh to thigh with Mydei once

again. “We’re talking, and you’re being rude by attempting to take his attention away from what he’s doing.”

He froze underneath her firm gaze. “Y-You uh… came to that conclusion already?”

She rolled her eyes from his shock. “It’s fairly obvious from how close you’ve been sitting, and how neither of you have left each other’s presence. He was watching you with us downstairs, and he was watching you while beside my wife. This man is your dominant, and yet he doesn’t discipline your poor behaviors at all. You’re awfully mouthy and cut people off when they’re speaking. How disrespectful.”

Phainon leaned back, surprised by the casual scolding from someone he had barely met tonight. Though, he already knew it *was* kind of rude to interrupt, and Hysilens had warned him multiple times that she didn't like that.

They were always with their friends. It had been a long time since he and Mydei were with anyone they hadn’t known for a few years or more. The things they did so casually probably felt a little bit invasive to strangers just getting to know them.

Before he could apologize, Mydei set his glass down and pulled the leg crossed over his knee onto the floor. With them apart and his body sat up straighter than it had been, he looked back at Cerydra.

“I’m sure your wife has told you some aspects of our relationship already,” he started, and Hysilens cringed lightly from the mention of her name. “I’m not shaming you. In fact, I understand. That being said, it only feels appropriate to let you both know he also told me some things about you—as he shares everything with me too.”

Phainon winced next, catching the glance his friend gave him when she realized they were both guilty of over-sharing.

Judging by his approach, he assumed Mydei wasn’t going to let them know that he had followed their secret love life and sexual experiences online for years. This was their first time meeting, and it seemed he wanted to keep it that way to refrain from making anything awkward.

“You clearly know the kind of relationship we have.” Cerydra nodded again as her hand reached to rest under her chin. “While I appreciate you looking out for him that night he and Hysilens went out, it is *not* your place to scold him or question how we treat each other.”

Warmth tickled inside of his face from the firmness of his voice. Very rarely did he ever sound like that unless he was purposely trying to be demanding.

“*Oh?*” Her head tilted as she leaned forward to straighten herself out as well. “Then what will you do? You should be teaching him better.”

“I like him the way he is,” Mydei said simply. “Swing all you want if that’s what you like to do, but do it in another direction. He meets *my* expectations, consents to *my* rules, and

behaves how *I* allow him to. Don't push yourself on to him just because you know a little bit about us. This isn't a *playdate*. *I'm not sharing him*."

Phainon's stomach also fluttered over how protective he was being. That tone mixed with his body language and unfiltered speech was… well, doing inexplicable things to his insides. Never had he heard him sound so quietly pissed before.

There wasn't any sugar-coating or beating around the bush, as he didn't typically care to lighten the weight of his words—especially around new people. Mydei didn't like the way she spoke to him, and he wasn't going to tolerate another word of it. There was no discussion to be had past that.

It was so attractive when he took control of a situation like that.

"I don't '*swing*'," Cerydra said simply, unbothered by his words. "I have no interest in your man other than allowing him to be my wife's friend. You can relax. I was simply letting him know it's disrespectful."

"I also don't talk about these things carelessly." Mydei looked around to see if anyone else could hear them. But with the loud music, secluded table, and their friends all downstairs dancing, the coast was clear. "You may discuss *your* relationship, but separate words like '*submissive*' and '*dominant*' from Phainon and I in public. That's my *best friend* and my *lover*."

"This is getting a little intense…" Phainon mumbled as he shifted in his seat. "I guess… I wanted to be next to him, so I just sat down next to him like I usually do."

Cerydra took a deep breath when Hysilens gently touched her elbow. "Hm… I suppose I should apologize for overstepping. My wife told me about you, so I assumed this was a comfortable topic to approach since we're all alone."

"Phainon?" His partner reached to touch his knee, but he didn't yet look at him. "What do you say to that?"

"That was kind of rude of me," he apologized next, still holding on to her gaze. "But please find another way to tell us next time."

"We accept your apology," Mydei decided after. "Hysilens, please don't look so nervous. No one is mad here."

"Sorry, I just… worry…" She murmured.

"He's right, this was just a misunderstanding," Cerydra added soon after, then looked beside her. "Ground yourself."

Hysilens nodded, taking a deep breath while fidgeting with her rings and nails.

"Yes," she answered, and Mydei looked away from them to focus on him instead. "I'm okay. One second."

It was different from him and his dominant. Had he been in that place, there would be hands holding him, soft hushes to relax, and plenty of kisses. Mydei would tell him to breathe, give him the exact timing on when to inhale and exhale, then reassure him that he'd be okay.

Watching them made him realize Mydei didn't expect Cerydra to do any of that. Maybe he knew them better from watching them from afar, or maybe he simply knew he was much more handsy and gentle of a partner, but he didn't scold her for approaching it in another way. Not like Cerydra did to them.

That worked for *their* relationship.

"Phainon."

His attention shifted to Mydei.

"You aren't in trouble either for wanting to be next to me," he promised him quietly. "Did her scolding you make you uncomfortable?"

"No, my love. It just took me by surprise. I… think she thought you were stricter than you are, so… Does that mean we do it wrong?" He wondered, and Mydei shook his head. "Are you too nice to me?"

"Do you think I'm too nice to you?"

"No…"

"Then no," he hushed, bringing him closer. "We do things the way we like it, and that's all that matters. Don't worry so senselessly about things like that."

Phainon smiled softly to himself, then leaned into his shoulder comfortably. Across from them, he heard Hysilens ask if Cerydra would like to dance with her downstairs. Within seconds, the two stood up out of their seats.

"We will be back." There was no time to respond to Cerydra, just to glance their way and watch them head towards the stairs.

Could he and Mydei also do that? Mydei didn't really dance, and he didn't like the pushiness and lack of personal space from being down there, but… would he agree to it anyway?

As soon as he was going to ask, right behind the couple that left, Hyacine limped up the stairs towards them. It caused them to both pull away, and for Mydei to reach a hand out.

"Here. Come sit with us," he encouraged her, immediately knowing what was wrong. "Don't overdo it."

"Mydei, did you know I really hate wearing these? I miss my sneakers…" She huffed, slumping down next to him and carefully pulling the white shoe off. "Oh, and Phainon, Cassie wants you down there."

But he wanted to ask his partner to go down there.

“Go ahead,” Mydei encouraged him. “I’ll keep Hyacine company up here. No one wants to be alone.”

“But…”

He really wanted to spend some time with him too. Not just with their friends, but with *him*.

Maybe it was uncomfortable to be so close in public, but they didn’t have to grind or hold on to each other. They didn’t need to touch and pull. The same way Castorice and Hyacine swayed side to side with each other, they could do that too, right?

“Please?” Hyacine asked. “Cassie might have had too much, so it looks like I’m staying the night with them both to take care of them. I feel a little tired, so… I was hoping you could help me sober up a bit.”

“Of course.”

Well, how could Phainon be upset that they couldn’t? Mydei was just being his helpful self by taking care of their friends. He knew his partner was like this, so of course expecting him to just up and disregard it all was selfish.

“I’m going to join them if it’s not serious.” Both of them nodded in return. “Take care of her, De.”

Mydei’s lip pursed over the nickname.

“Okay. Have fun.”

Phainon stood up, walking away as Hyacine began to talk to him about how Cyrene and Castorice dressed her up for tonight. Though he loved her, and he wanted to listen to her pout, part of him felt a little… disappointed that Mydei just wanted to sit, drink, and talk all night. They talked all the time, every day, maybe even more than the average couple did.

They talked about their days every day. They discussed new things to try out, the newest movies they watched together, and flirted until it ended up with them kissing and touching each other. Talking wasn’t bad, but… it would have just been nice to do club-like things at a club.

When he found them, Cyrene grinned widely and held his hand in her own, lifting them up high.

“*Phai!* I missed you!” She yelled over the music, and he forced a smile while looking down at her.

“Does it make me look weird to dance around three girls?” He joked.

Cifera stuck her tongue out. “You’re always weird!”

He had set himself up for that one, so he accepted it and laughed. Castorice held on to his sleeve while stumbling, then her other one touched Cifera’s shoulder.

“Careful.” One hand brushed her back to support her. “Cassie, are you okay?”

How much did they make her drink?

“‘*m so good!*” She slurred loudly, and he let her keep holding on to him as they all danced around each other. “Where’s M-Mydei?”

He shrugged, ignoring the prick of disappointment inside of him. “At the table with Hyacine!”

Castorice seemed to accept that answer, and the other two girls looked at each other before agreeing that was fair enough. They continued to dance beside him without pouting over his missing company, giggling and drunkenly yelling along to the music. Because it was *normal*. It was to be *expected*.

He didn’t drink more than a shot, but it was nice to let go for a bit too.

Soon, more people joined them. More girls squeezed in by Castorice and Cifera, and a few guys tried to do the same with Cyrene. Not that Phainon let them stay long. He was quick to push them away, step behind her, and nudge her closer to her friends instead. Watching them walk away in shame and anger made him proud.

It was always a little bit weird when people felt entitled to join. Grabbing someone like that and pulling them close was so uncomfortable when all they wanted to do was just have fun.

While thinking of that, someone’s hand touched his shoulder, and he turned to find a tall but slender man there. Dressed in red with a pair of designer sunglasses perched on his head, he smiled back at him kindly. Rose tinted his cheeks from liquor, and a light flush glistened over his forehead.

Objectively, he was handsome, and he had a nice smile. Not as handsome or nice as Mydei’s, but one that would definitely make *someone else* swoon.

“Mind if I join? Or will you kick me out too?”

Because he asked him, surely it meant he wouldn’t make his friends uncomfortable. This guy had at least a little bit of shame in him, and he could be someone nice. There were good people just looking to hang out and dance, and Phainon knew that.

He shook his head, then turned away to focus his attention elsewhere. But this person didn’t approach the girls like he thought he would. He didn’t talk to them at all.

And that was good… Until that same hand snuck forward, sliding over Phainon's shoulders to pull him closer. Fingers squeezed into his bicep, holding him as that man’s body slipped in front of his own. He looked up at him, shorter by a handful of inches, eyes tracing over his face.

“Are these your friends?” Phainon nodded, silent, because he had no clue what was happening right now. “A man who takes care of others is attractive. I like that.”

… Huh?

“Can I get you a drink?” This stranger wondered, and if his flashy gold chain and wrist watch said anything, then he had more than enough money to blow. “What do you like? I’m a long island kind of guy.”

Was he hitting on him?

“I uh… I don’t,” he answered awkwardly. “Can you actually—”

“Awh, come on. Handsome men like yourself all have a favorite drink,” he cut him off, making it more obvious. “Whiskey on the rocks?”

That was more Mydei’s style. The only time he ever chose to throw back glasses like that was when he was sitting beside him at home. Otherwise, he preferred not to taste the alcohol in his glass.

“No. I don’t drink,” he repeated, pushing on his chest lightly while stepping away. “I’m actually—”

“Surely there’s something I can do for you then…” Phainon felt a twist in his gut from how pushy this person was being. “You know, I really like guys who look like you… A tall and muscular man is always so attractive.”

“I’m not really… interested…” He trailed off while pushing on his chest again. “Please go if that’s what you want. I’m not looking for that.”

Cyrene turned around from where she was holding Castorice, eyebrows pinched while noticing their fifth.

“You can get to know me and become interested,” he hinted. “I think we could be good—”

“*He has a boyfriend!*” Cyrene drunkenly shouted at the man, and both of their friends gasped loudly as they looked at him directly instead. “*He was just being nice to you!*”

“Is it serious?” The stranger had the audacity to ask, and Phainon pushed harder to get in between him and his friends again. “Because I don’t see him here. Why would he let you go out without him when you look this good? Does he care?”

What did not seeing Mydei have to do with anything? That didn’t mean his partner was suddenly nonexistent, and it didn’t mean he didn’t care.

Of course Mydei cared. He cared, so he was keeping Hyacine company while her feet hurt too much to stand on. He cared, so he took everyone out and didn’t expect them to pay him back—even if he knew everyone was going to give him what they could from their next pay checks. He cared, so he dressed him up in a way that was handsome to him, watched him even when he was away, and let him sit as close as possible to him all night

Just because he wasn’t standing right by his side didn’t mean he didn’t care.

“I’ll get Mydei!” Castorice yelled for him, and the stranger’s eyes widened over the name as if he knew it.

“No, don’t get Mydei, I’ll handle it,” Phainon promised her. “He’s taking care of Hyacine, so leave them for now.”

What was that about? Did they think he couldn’t handle himself? That he needed another man to come play hero for him as if he wasn’t just as strong?

“Heh… ‘*Mydei*’?” This stranger asked, speaking the name slowly as if he missed the way it tasted in his mouth. “Tall, blond, rich, and never leaves his damn house?”

Phainon froze over the description.

How did he know who Mydei was? Were they colleagues at work? Was this one of his dad’s friends’ sons—the rich guys who liked to cause trouble for Eurypon?

Or… was this someone more *personal* than that? Was he one of Mydei’s *exes?*

“Oh! That’s why you’re alone!” He laughed, taking his silence as an answer. “That guy’s not even grown enough to be here! He throws his little tantrums, hides in his little office, and thinks he's too good to be around people. He’d probably prefer to watch you with another man than come down to a place like this!”

Phainon looked up to the railing where their table was, where Mydei actually was staring directly at them. Distance and his usual stoic expression made it hard to tell what he was thinking, and it made his blood run even colder.

“You won’t be happy for long. He’s not going to change.” That was confirmation enough to tell *who* this was, and Phainon took a deep breath over the revelation. “He’s going to leave you alone when you want to go out, hide you like a filthy secret, and then try to act like the good guy by sending you on your way for no reason.”

Oh.

The last part hurt because it was *true*.

To an extent, Mydei *did* try to do that to him. If he had any less courage when confessing to him, then they probably would’ve fallen apart right there. No more playing as a dominant and submissive, no more hanging out alone together, and maybe even no more friendship between them. And it would have ended because Mydei decided to kick him right out the door on his own, believing he was right in how he felt and doing the right thing by letting him go.

Phainon couldn’t even be mad as he stared at him, silent.

“Are you still talking?” Cifera groaned, reminding him that his friends were still there. “Unskippable *NPC* dialogues are the worst. I have to deal with them in games and real life now? *This blows!*”

Not seeming to care, Mydei's ex continued. "The most that guy is good for is nice gifts and a good lay. Squeeze what you can out of him, and then go find someone who can actually give you what you need."

What… was that? Did he want him to use Mydei for his money, body, and experience as if he didn't have a heart?

That made him mad.

Thinking about this person potentially wearing the expensive gifts he conned out of Mydei made him want to rip the designer brands off of his body and smash them beneath his boot. How dare he do that to his best friend, his dominant, his *partner?*

So what if sometimes Mydei got in his head? That made it okay to *hurt him?*

"Are you upset that I'm making sense?" He asked while reaching for his arm again, but Phainon jerked away from him. "It feels so good at first, but then you come to realize all he's good at is sex and drinking. He has no hobbies, no interests, and no life outside of his job and his liquor cart."

Phainon's skin crawled.

Everything inside of him wanted to cock his fist back and punch this stranger so badly. He wanted to hit him in his mouth for talking badly about him and for hurting Mydei in the past when they were together, but that would probably get him kicked out. It would cause an even bigger scene for them all, and his friends all deserved better than him ruining their night out.

On top of that, Mydei deserved better than a partner who went around hitting people just because he got a little angry. Being violent wasn't something to be proud of. Being cruel and hurtful weren't traits that made a good person worth showing off.

What did Mydei see in this person besides his handsome face and body? His personality was terrible.

"I can be nicer to you than *daddy* is," he said suggestively, and Phainon glanced back up at the railing to find that Mydei wasn't there. Mydei wasn't watching him.

And if Mydei wasn't watching…

Phainon's arm pulled back, and just as he heard the girls cry that he shouldn't do it, his fist balled tightly.

"*Phai!*"

He wanted to wipe the smug look off of his face. But he also wanted to be good, and he wanted to be nice. He liked to think he was both most days, and that he was getting better at managing his emotions when angry.

"No, Phainon! Come on!" Cifera urged him, pulling on his shirt. "It's not worth it, idiot!"

He hated that she was right.

His arm lowered, and he looked down before shaking his head.

This guy was interrupting his time with his friends, bad-mouthing the man he loved, and airing out business that didn't need to be known. Several times they asked him to leave, but he didn’t. To him, he deserved to be punched in the mouth.

A ringed fist grabbed the stranger’s shoulder, and Phainon looked behind him to find his partner’s heavy glare.

“Get the hell away from him,” Mydei snapped, pulling him back roughly to pry him out of the way. Even Phainon hadn’t thought to shove him like *that*.

Phainon watched him grab him by his shirt next, and he stumbled into him from the sudden force. It was rougher than he ever handled him and shocking in every way.

“One of you go back to Hyacine. Don’t let some creep get close to her while she’s napping,” he ordered them, making his eyebrows furrow over how demanding he was being with them. Never did he speak to them that way either. “I need to… *talk*… to Phainon…”

Mydei then began to pull him away from the crowd. His knuckles were white from his tightened fist and feet slightly stumbling with each step. He took him away from their rushing friends, away from his stunned ex-boyfriend, and away from where anyone could see them completely. The music became quieter as they walked further away from the dance floor, then muffled completely when he brought him into a bathroom.

They looked at the poor guy washing his hands when the door was slammed open, but upon seeing them both staring at him, he rushed to shake them dry. He bolted out the door Mydei was holding open, nothing more than a blur of yellow. After, it was pushed shut.

“H-Hey, are you okay?” Phainon asked, nearly tripping over his feet when he was shoved into the bathroom. “Mydei, how much did you drink?”

“A lot,” he answered bluntly. “Why were you so damn close to that guy?”

His head shook as he backed away from his slowly approaching figure. Each step tapped loudly to the floor, and they were much more careful than when he dragged him away.

Anger was written across his face. Pinched between his golden brows and drawn across his curved lips, Mydei looked as if he wanted to punch someone too.

The only time he ever looked that upset was when criticizing himself and his own flaws.

“No. *Wait*. Did you know him?” Phainon needed to know. “That guy called you ‘*daddy*’ to my face. I should be the angry one for having to deal with your ex.”

“I stopped caring about those guys after it ended. If I knew him or not doesn’t matter,” he brushed off, completely unbothered. “Whichever one that was—*fuck him.* The ones who called me that name were the most entitled men I ever met.”

That was so unlike him too. Mydei rarely ever spoke poorly about someone, always believing that good could be taken out of everyone. Even those who could have hurt him, he simply said that he wasn't what they were looking for and never blamed them for what they could have done. In this case, Phainon assumed it was cheating their way into expensive gifts and using him for sex.

What was it Mydei once said? He was '*naive*'?

Sober Mydei viewed it as his fault for being taken advantage of, yet this drunken version of him was calling them '*entitled*'.

"He told me uh… some things about you."

"*Yeah?*" His voice was low and goading. "Was that the one that said I'm fuckin' boring? Or one of the ones that thought I'm only worth sex and people only wanna be around me because I'm loaded?"

Phainon flinched from the venom. Each of those things made him cringe into himself, feeling hurt for him. And when Mydei exhaled shakily, now close enough to feel, his breath was so full of whiskey that it hurt to breathe in.

"I don't care who that was. I have no feelings for anyone from back then," he bit. "But what did he do to *you?* Did he touch *you?*"

Phainon felt a wall bump against his back, and Mydei slammed his hands down on the tiled surface.

"I think you drank a little too much tonight," he noticed, shifting beneath his intense gaze. "You're being way more aggressive than usual, Mydei."

"Did you feel him grind against you? Did you want to?"

"Of course I didn't want that. You don't need to sound so jealous," Phainon defended himself. "That was *your* ex. Not only do I not want him, but he was being a-a dick."

Mydei scoffed, briefly looking away from him to glance at the mirrors to their right. With a tightened jaw, he glared harder at their reflections.

"I'm not jealous. You keep getting it confused," he accused him while turning back to him. "'*Jealous*' implies that I want to be them. I don't need to be someone else to make you want me, Phainon."

A quiet gulp filled the quiet as his words hung heavy in the air.

"It's possession. You're mine, and they can look all they want, but they don't get to *touch* you and they don't get to *talk* to you the way I do," he hissed. "Do you see this collar?"

One of his fists grabbed the golden chain and pulled his shoulders off of the wall with it. Nose to nose, Mydei looked him in the eyes as he pulled harder, testing its strength.

“Don’t break it because you're upset at someone else!” He rushed to say, immediately grasping his fist in his hands to try and ease his grasp.

“I own you,” he whispered, and Phainon bit on the inside of his bottom lip as a spark tingled inside of his gut. “No other dominant is telling my sub how to behave for me in public. No other man is touching my man like my hands were cut off at the wrist. All night people have been testing my restraint with that, and I’ve had it up to *here* with being nice for the sake of good graces and pleasantries. *You are mine*.”

What was the feeling inside of him right now?

“Y-Yeah?”

“Say it.” Mydei’s voice held little room to protest or deny the command. “Who do you belong to?”

It was so… *hot*. So *overwhelming*.

“I… I belong to you,” he breathed out, tingling inside of his gut from his brutal honesty. “Mydei,—”

“Try again.”

“*Master*,” Phainon corrected himself immediately, eyes flicking to the door behind him before looking back at him. “I’m yours. No one else can have me.”

“There you go.” He let go of his necklace to instead grip around his collar. Fingers wrapped around his neck, holding but not squeezing. “For the rest of the night, you don’t get to leave my sight. If you want to dance, *we* dance. If you want to sit and talk, *we’ll* talk. But you don’t go anywhere without me until I say you can, do you understand?”

This rough and domineering version of Mydei *so… damn… attractive*…

“Yes, master,” he promised as one hand dropped around his wrist to hold him. “You know, I… really actually *did* want to dance with you earlier… Can you please join me before we go?”

“You already know I’ll do anything for you,” he reminded him, and that made him feel silly for being too nervous to ask earlier. “Now, kiss me. I miss your lips.”

Phainon leaned forward, eyes shutting as he felt the warmth of Mydei’s lips touch his. They tasted like whiskey too, and never had he wanted to get more drunk off of it in his life.

Was Mydei even going to remember this when he woke up? Was he taking advantage of him right now?

The last thing he wanted was for him to wake up tomorrow and not remember a thing, but have all these photos of them all laughing, joking, and dancing together. It’d seem as if he completely disregarded his desire to be private and used his drunken state as an excuse to

touch him in public. Then, kissing him and making out with him in the bathroom where anyone could walk in was probably just as bad.

Oh. He hoped the girls didn't remember Mydei's ex saying all those things about him, especially the '*daddy*' part. How embarrassing would it be for them to bring it up while sober and have to explain it all? He'd probably go into hiding. He might even look at him and ask if he happened to let that slip.

As if Phainon would ever call him by *that* name knowing he didn't like it anymore.

Deciding this was probably too much, he turned his head to break their kiss, causing a quiet grumble to leave Mydei's lips.

"When we get back home, I guess…" He caved, letting go of his neck to instead smooth the wrinkles of his shirt out. "You *are* coming home with me, right?"

Phainon chuckled over his hopeful tone. "Yeah, and so is Cifera, remember? We picked her up, so we're responsible for her. She can have the guest bedroom."

"Okay. I-I'll be good. I'll calm down."

"Promise?" Mydei nodded lightly. "Come on, let's dance for a little bit before we head back."

"Can you dance on me like you used to with those other people?" He asked, and heat immediately stretched across his cheeks. "'m not jealous. I just wanna experience it too."

Phainon was almost certain that was the textbook definition of jealousy, but he let it slide because of how cute Mydei looked asking for it.

"You want me behind you?"

"No. Put your ass on my dick then push back on it," Mydei said bluntly. With it, that very cuteness dissipated. "I want to feel it and see it."

"I can't. People are going to see us, and you don't want that," he reasoned. "You don't want people to know that about you, so let's just do it normally like… friends."

Mydei's nose scrunched. "'*Friends*'… Yet I want you to grind on me, *Phai*."

His lip curled downward over the nickname Cyrene and their friends called him, hating the very sound of it in his partner's mouth.

"Stop that. It's not '*Phai*'," he said stubbornly. "It's '*handsome*' or '*baby*' for you, especially if we're alone."

"It's '*my love*' not '*De*'," he shot back, and they looked at one another for a moment. "*Tch*… I don't wanna pretend you're not mine… makes people think you can be *theirs* instead."

"Then don't."

Mydei grabbed him by the shirt and pulled the second those words left his mouth, backing slowly towards the door while dragging him.

“Come dance on me, baby.”

Phainon sighed, aware he might be getting yelled at when they both woke up because of this. But if they didn’t go any further, maybe it’d be okay. It wasn’t as if he was going to have sex with him while he was slurring and stumbling, just a little bit of fun on the dancefloor before they went home. They wouldn’t visit a place like this again for months, so why not indulge just a little bit?

“I’ve been waiting all night for this, my love,” he admitted, catching his tilted and drunken grin as they chased each other out the bathroom.

Chapter End Notes

mydei holding phainons waist, drunk laughing with him as phainon grinds into him…

phainon finding his ex and looking him in the eye as he danced on mydei and gets everything that guy ever wanted, quietly rubbing it in. because hes a damn brat. a spoiled prince. but hes also a sweet and genuine person.

lol. i love easily jealous phainon and extremely possessive mydei a lot

Chapter 25: Chapter Twenty-Five

Chapter Notes

i let my ice cream melt to edit this chapter. im drinking it as i swipe this note

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei was so *handsy* after that.

Belt to belt, his partner slotted himself behind Phainon so closely that his buckle sometimes got in the way with the back of his own belt. Those desperate hands touched his waist and gripped his hips tightly, holding him flush against his body so they were never too far apart. Wandering fingers untucked his shirt to slip over his lower stomach and feel up on his skin, nails dragging through the tickle of hair beneath his navel.

He liked to kiss him where his choker split too. Lips touched the skin in between the leather bands, and his tongue lapped at the sweat before biting. If he left marks, Phainon wouldn't be surprised.

The club was so dark except for the flashing lights, and everyone around them were probably too drunk to really notice them in a sea of people. It was so late at night that the only people sober were the ones driving home, but even then, didn't most people just call a cab or an *Uber* anyways? He had his own fair share of stumbling into random cars with Cyrene when they were younger and freshly legal to drink.

But because of the darkness, he didn't even realize when his friends came back down to join him. Phainon was too engrossed in the way Mydei was rolling his hips into him and practically humping him back.

Too drunk to realize they were about four articles of clothing away from having sex on the dance floor, Mydei only kept going as the girls giggled and joined them. Even a sleepy looking Hyacine with half of a chicken tender in hand and a surprised look in her eyes.

"This is surprising," she teased, looking at him instead of Mydei. "You two are a thing?"

"Uh…" A nervous laugh bubbled from his lips when Mydei pulled him even closer. "Y-Yeah. Kinda?"

"'*Kinda*'?" Her attention dropped to their moving bodies briefly. "*Uh-huh*…"

Mydei grumbled in his ear while clawing at his body. "*We are*," he corrected him.

Phainon gulped nervously over the confession. Part of him knew he should've stopped Mydei from continuing, especially since their friends had found them. He could've pulled himself

away from the situation or pushed Mydei away and saved him from exposing too much about himself. A good partner would've *never* put him in a position like this.

But Cyrene cheered Cifera on as she danced in front of her, both girls laughing loudly. Castorice was swaying side to side, one arm on Hyacine's shoulders and the other raised to move with the beat.

Everyone was having so much fun, and Hyacine was looking at him like she was *happy* for them. All of it egged him to let it happen.

"We are," he agreed, and she nodded simply before offering Castorice the rest of her chicken tender.

Within no time, Hysilens and Cerydra found them too, opting to simply hold each other and encourage them to have fun. Specifically Hysilens, who watched him with a smile, proud that he and Mydei finally had their hands on each other after being so reserved all night. That egged him on too, wanting to show off that Mydei was *his*, he was *Mydei's*, and *no one* should forget that.

Empowered, he turned around and faced Mydei, both arms locking around his neck as he looked at him. Under the neon lights, he could see that he had an almost arrogant grin stretched over his lips.

"Lemme do *that*," he slurred, and Phainon turned around to see Cifera tapping Castorice's ass as Hyacine and Cyrene pushed closer together.

Both hands slipped down his body before he could ask, pulling him buckle to buckle before leaning in closer. Hot breaths fanned over his ear, then his mouth touched just below his earlobe.

"Lemme spank this *fine* ass."

But before his hands could touch any part of his bottom, Phainon grabbed them tightly. Their fingers interlocked over his hips, holding either still.

"*C'mon*…" Mydei pushed. "I wanna…"

"I can't let you do that," he finally put his foot down, aware that would be way too far. "Just hold me, okay? None of that… *kink*… stuff here."

"*Ugh*…" He seemed disappointed by that, but listened nonetheless. "You 'n Cifera dance the s-same, ya'know… You move *these* a lot…"

"If there's a few things she's good at, it's being annoying and moving her body like she's made of water. You learn a little bit of how to dance from just watching her let go," he mused, feeling him squeeze his hips. "But don't look at *her*, look at *me*."

Mydei snorted quietly, amused by his pout. "*She* keeps lookin' at *me*… 's not like *that*."

That made him laugh next, reminded of the silly bet she made with Cyrene. “She might be trying to see who owes who twenty.”

After hearing that, Mydei slipped both of their hands to the back of his jeans, and he gasped loudly when he curled into his left back pocket. Fingers dug into the cheek, holding him tightly before they slid lower and deeper down the middle seam. They pushed, groping him in front of all their friends.

It would have been *somewhat* okay, but Mydei’s middle finger was lining right over his crack and pushing in between. Just that touch alone must have made them realize *who* did *what* between them both.

“*No!*” He vaguely heard, then a series of laughter. Somewhere in the chorus, he even heard a surprised scoff from Cerydra over how childish it was to bet on who was a ‘*top*’ and who was a ‘*bottom*’.

“Mydei!” He scolded sharply, pulling away to find him grinning. It was as if he were proud of himself for having the guts to set the record straight. “You can’t just do *that* in front of everyone!”

“Snowy!” It was Cifera who was crying, and Mydei’s eyes shifted to look behind him. “You let me down!”

“Oops…” Mydei chuckled, moving his hand back to his belt. “I’ll be good now.”

“*Right*…”

Heat tickled over his cheeks, and he puffed them out over the thought that *everyone* had seen him grab his body like that. Realistically, only a few would remember, but for right now, *they knew*.

“You’re never drinking like this again,” he mumbled, and Mydei laughed as he tried to pull away from him. “No more grinding for you until you learn how to control your hands.”

“Tough shit,” he said, still sounding lighthearted. “You’re not leavin’ me ‘til we all take off, so get comfortable. Like *Hell* am I lettin’ someone else put moves on *my man.*”

His eyes widened over the veiled command.

Mydei’s smile never fell, and his eyes stayed locked onto him as he dragged his hands up his body. Some space was put between their bodies, enough to not feel the tent behind his zipper press up against his jeans but still keep their chests brushing.

“If you won’t dance *on* me, dance *for* me.” Phainon could hardly hear it over the music, but the way he gripped his collar made it hard not to focus. “Be a good boy, ‘n don’t try to leave my sight, okay?”

Phainon was pulled in for a kiss, and he exhaled shakily while pulled back into him by the necklace. His own hands hung limply at the wrists, arms crossed above and behind Mydei’s head with his elbows on his shoulders.

“Wha—*Mydei?*” Hyacine gasped loudly as they stumbled backwards and closer to them all. “What are you doing?”

“Get a room,” Cerydra commented, but he could hear that she was more *amused* than anything by their shamelessness. “Everyone can see you two.”

“*Woo! Phainon!*” Cyrene cheered. “*You dogs!*”

He laughed, but that only served for Mydei to force his mouth closed with a harder kiss, effectively muffling the sound. Behind his eyelids, he could see the sudden and bright flashes of a camera, and Phainon pulled away to see Castorice with her phone out. She and Cifera were giggling, pointing at the screen together.

“H-Hey—”

“So cute…” She coo’ed over it, and his stomach plummeted when he felt his phone buzz in his back pocket. “‘s his f-first boyfriend! We should *so* frame it!”

“*Someone’s* not leavin’ a virgin tonight…” Cifera sang, looking at them both with a cheshire grin. He could envision the wiggling tail and little fangs of a mischievous cat. “Ya’ better treat Mydei like he treats us!”

Hyacine shot him a half-amused and half-sympathetic look, most likely aware that he could be getting in trouble come tomorrow morning when the *sober* wave of gossip hit. Especially when Castorice showed him the photo herself, proud of capturing such a moment for them.

Staring at it made his stomach tighten. Thinking about it made him terrified of what Mydei would say when he woke up, sober, to *that* in his phone.

—

When ending the night and driving both Mydei and Cifera back to the safety and comfort of Mydei’s home, their future talk was all he could think about. Between the whir of his car’s engine, the slight rattling from his keys in the ignition, and his friend’s snores, *Mydei* occupied his mind. Every stop sign and every red light had him looking back to his slumped figure, aware his eyes were simply closed. Unlike their friend who passed out on the drive with a water bottle clutched to her chest.

There was no music because he didn’t have it in him to sift through the stations. He couldn’t find it in him to talk either, especially when Mydei was at the point of his drunken stupor where he could hardly even speak. It was a miracle all on its own he didn’t throw up in a sidewalk bush like Cifera and Castorice both did.

His car reeked of booze, and it made his nose crinkle. But he couldn’t roll a window down because before she fell asleep, Cifera told them she was freezing cold. The leather jacket he

and Mydei shared tonight was wrapped up around her, keeping her warm in her short, strapless dress.

Once they got back to Mydei's place, it was easy to get her dressed in pajamas and inside the guest bed, but Mydei was a different story. Instead of staying in his room like he left him, he was swaying in his kitchen with one hand flat to the counter and his phone in the other.

"My love," Phainon greeted him gently while reaching for his body. "Let's get you in bed… *again*."

"*I*… '*yuv you*," Mydei slurred drunkenly. His phone clattered to the counter, abandoned to focus on him instead.

"I love you too," he returned, coaxing one arm over his shoulders to help him steady himself. "Come on, let's get you ready for bed."

"… *don't wan'... sh...eep*…" He grumbled. As he did, he leaned in to hide inside of his neck and dropped his arm from his neck to his back. "… *wan' you*…"

Phainon glanced at his phone, noticing the wall of one-sided texts from Eurypon—as the name on top read '*Father: Personal*'. Carefully, he picked the device up as Mydei mumbled into his skin, the words so broken and drawn out that it made little sense to hear.

But before he could read a word other than '*disappointed*', he decided it wasn't his place to know this without him. Sneaking through his partner's phone was never his style at all, and if Mydei was bothered, he would tell him. It wasn't fair to read his text messages without his consent, and he had racked up enough possible offenses tonight.

One finger clicked the screen off, and he slipped it into his pocket with the passing thought to ask tomorrow.

"Please, my love. Let's just go lay down now."

Phainon was tired, both mentally from having to deal with the weight of his own thoughts and physically from a long night out. It was late already, way later than he's been up in awhile. His eyes were heavy, feet were sore, and the bed was calling his name like a siren to a sailor.

Tomorrow, they had a lot of things to talk about. But for right now, they had some sleep to catch up on.

But Mydei whined quietly, the sound low and raspy. "*No, Phain'... Don't... Don't go*…"

"Shh…" Phainon hushed as he held the back of his head, fingers tracking through his hair slowly to rub his scalp softly. "I'm not going anywhere. I just wanna go to bed with you. Can we do that?"

"'*Bed*'?"

“Yeah, *bed*. Let’s take our shoes off, clothes off, and go lay down.” Hell, he would even sleep in his jeans if it meant going to bed. “Does that sound good to my master?”

“*Mm… ‘Master’…*” He hummed, pleased. “*D’ya sh-till wan’... me...?*”

He sighed, holding him closer to his body. Lips pressed to the slot of his choker where the leather split, bathing his skin in shaky, whiskey-scented breaths. They didn’t kiss, and they didn’t bite. All Mydei did was settle them over his tattoo, touching it with his mouth like he wanted to but forgot how.

“Of course.” His voice lowered, eyes shifting to look down his back. “Why wouldn’t I want you? Sleeping beside you is my favorite way to go to bed.”

“*… Yeah?*”

“Yeah,” he reassured him. “Can I get us ready for bed now, master? Or do you still want to talk?”

Mydei held him tighter as he nodded, and Phainon turned his head to kiss his cheek as best as he could. In doing so, the mouth in his neck put more pressure into it, returning the gesture weakly.

One hand raised to cup beneath his jaw, rings warm against the side of his neck. A thumb touched to bone, an index finger lined up to his cheek, and the rest curled to rest above his choker. They pinched, turning him away to face forward.

At any other point in time, it’d be *so arousing* to be touched by him like that. Had Mydei been any more sober, had Cifera not been in the guest bedroom, had he felt any less tired, then he would have stood there, clung to him, and egged him on to continue maneuvering his body as he pleased. After all, being kissed on the neck and held so firmly by his safe hands were a few of his favorite things.

But Mydei was so drunk he couldn’t hold himself up, Cifera was snoring so loud he could hear it through the hall because of the opened door, and his legs could barely support the both of them. Now was *not* the time to let him kiss on his neck and grip it so tightly.

“No, wait. Please stop,” he requested, reaching to cup his watch and wrist. “I don’t wanna do anything, my love. Please let go.”

That firm hand loosened. Those lips peeled away, replaced by the feeling of his nose bridge and the space between his eyes. He dragged his touch lower, hooking to his choker and dragging it lower down his throat like he didn’t *want* to stop touching him.

“Not tonight.” Phainon stood his ground. “Please don’t touch my neck too much.”

“*Mm… Bu’h…*—”

“We can cuddle, but not with your hand on my neck please.”

He knew Mydei wouldn't hurt him, but something about letting his drunken partner cradle his neck in his sleep felt… unsafe. They could always do it tomorrow night and every night after that, just not tonight.

"'*kay*…"

Phainon brought his hand higher, taking it into his own before guiding it away from his throat. He slotted their fingers together, and Mydei pulled away from him to bring his arm over his shoulders. With a careful step forward, they began making their way to the bedroom.

Boots stumbled repeatedly beside him. Their bodies swayed heavily from Mydei being unable to hold himself up. When passing light switches, Phainon shut them off, and when going through the bedroom door, he left it half-way open so he could hear if Cifera woke up.

They made it to the bathroom, and Mydei sat on the cushioned stool by his counter so Phainon could help him undress a bit. Careful hands pulled his collar's pin and both earrings off, unlatched his watch and unclasped his necklaces, then gently tugged the cuff of his braid and rings away. He smoothed out his sunset hair, endeared by the crinkle curled into the locks by his ear and the rosiness of his cheeks.

Phainon then got on one knee, placed Mydei's boot over the thigh not decorated with leather, and unlaced them one by one. They sat beside the kitchen sink, directly beneath where his discarded jewelry was.

He had half the mind to let him sleep like that in his belt and nice pants, but he decided against it. It'd be uncomfortable for him, and he wanted Mydei to feel a little bit *less* like garbage when he woke up. So, he pulled his shirt off, unbuckled his belt, and popped the button of his pants to pull them off of his legs.

"Come on." Phainon yawned, eyes drooping a bit as he picked his partner back up. "Bed time. 'm so tired…"

Mydei finally made it into his side of the bed, and Phainon emptied all his pockets onto the nightstand. Keys, wallet, phones, everything was dumped hastily down so he could comfortably, at the *very* least, unbuckle his own belt and unzip his own boots.

The toilet room's light was left on so he could see how to take his leather garter off, as he also left the main door to the bathroom wide open in case Mydei needed to run for it. Rather than going all the way to his cabinet, he simply dropped it in the dresser beside his play collar.

Everything was everywhere, and Mydei was going to be a bit annoyed picking it all up, but that was his punishment for getting so drunk he couldn't even stand. Phainon hoped he had fun doing it with his hangover, even if he knew he'd probably cave and help.

Exhausted, he plopped into bed in his jeans and t-shirt, eyes closing immediately. Outside clothes in his clean bed were also typically a no-no, and he knew that, but *oh well*.

Beside him, Mydei turned and draped one arm over his back, weakly pulling him closer by the waist even if he was on his stomach. A slurred and muffled sound suspiciously close to '*goodnight*' left his lips.

Face first in the pillows with both arms above it to hold it close, he mumbled back the same as Mydei threw one leg over his. His nose touched beside his arm, mouth close to his rolled up sleeve and underarm, too drunk to be bothered with spooning the way they usually did.

—

Throughout the night, Phainon was woken up to take care of them as they rushed and stumbled to the bathroom to throw up the liquor in their systems. Cifera was first, and the bathroom door slamming into the mounted door-stop had flinched him from his sleep like a gunshot. Whereas Mydei was snoring in his ear like he could sleep through the end of the world.

Holding her bangs from her face and gently rubbing her back took up a decent chuck of the remaining darkness in the night. Helping her wipe her mouth with a damp rag and getting her water to drink wasn't quite a drag—*as he would never leave his best friend suffer alone*—but he was tired. Undeniably.

Then, just when he thought he could sleep again before the sky shifted too much away from pitch black, Mydei stirred to shift onto his other side. The snoring stopped. The steady, sleeping breaths stopped. Cool, early morning light streamed through the sheer curtains, brightening the room with a gentle hue.

And he felt the bed shift. He heard Mydei rolling out of his place to rush to the toilet, gagging from the liquor he swore up and down he could handle.

Rinse and repeat, Phainon held his hair back in a makeshift ponytail, whispering soothing words while patting his back to help him. Damp towels wiped the bile from his lips, and he cupped water into his mouth so he could wash the taste out. His nightstand was too full of things for a glass of water to rest on, so he fed it to him and left the empty cup in the bathroom before guiding him back to bed.

By then, the sky was pale and bright. The sun wasn't quite up, but it would be soon no doubt. Ten minutes, maybe. Twenty minutes top.

Deciding they were *not* going to work out today, he grabbed Mydei's phone and turned all his alarms off. None at sunrise for working out. None at eight-in-the-morning to have breakfast. They'd wake up whenever they did, eat whenever they could, then go about their days after that.

Oh, he was *so* ready to lay down and pass out after setting the dying device down quietly…

Just for his own to buzz steadily, for Hyacine's contact picture to pop up, and he sighed, resigned to his fate. For today, he was going to just deal with it. It was fine.

They never had time to see each other like that, and they never were able to go out and let go. The last time he could remember everyone in the same room was maybe at a holiday dinner party at Cifera and Aglaea's house. *Maybe*.

Phainon wasn't mad, just tired, as he answered his phone and walked out of the bedroom to not disturb Mydei.

"Hello?"

"Is your morning as rough as mine?" She asked hopefully. In the background, their coffee maker chimed. "Cassie has been whining all night. I've been in your bed with her watching just in case."

"Did any of you try to get food in her stomach?"

"*Tried*." Phainon snorted, flicking the kitchen light on and heading right towards Mydei's espresso machine. Did he know how to use it? Not really. But he could learn. That was what overworked nurses as friends were for.

"Hyacine, do you have an espresso machine at home by chance?" He asked, looking at the machine.

"Huh? Yeah."

"Walk me through making a double. I'm not *that* fancy."

Hyacine laughed, and he began to follow the steps she gave him so he could try to keep himself up. It would probably be easier anyway, especially as he could just nap later. At least like this, he could stay up and be able to make them all a nice breakfast. Something to help cure the hangovers they were going to have.

The scent of coffee filled the kitchen, and he listened to her talk on and on about how she loves a nice, sweet latte before work. She tried to make a new one every night, and it was her favorite part of the day.

He made a mental note to ask Mydei if they could bake a coffee cake or muffins sometime, something she could enjoy with her latte before a long night at the hospital.

"I'm sleepy," Hyacine giggled, and he looked down at his mug. "I'm going to close my eyes for a bit, but I'll text you later. Do you know if Hysilens and Cerydra got home okay?"

"Yeah, she sent me a text sometime last night," he answered. "You get some rest. I'm going to find something to do. Maybe I'll try cooking a nice breakfast on my own… Donuts sound good."

"I believe in you, Phainon."

They said their goodbyes, and he peeked into the pantry and refrigerator. As long as it didn't have yeast, he should be okay.

Back to the counter, mug in hand, he scrolled through the internet until he settled on something called an '*old-fashioned donut bar*'. It sounded easy. He learned to make espresso, and was going to cook breakfast later, so why not also fry some donuts?

And in that sense, why not also turn the television on for some music, push the curtains open to let in the sunlight, and have fun with it?

With his phone hooked up to the T.V. and the bright sunrise now brightening Mydei's home, he grabbed a bag of cake flour from the pantry. His softer playlist lightly filled the silence, accompanied by the occasional tap of pans, soft humming, and the drizzle of the espresso machine working again. Eggs cracked. Vanilla being poured over creamed sugar splashed. A whisk crunched to the bowl beneath when mixing it all, and the bowl clicked to the refrigerator shelf when going to rest.

Time escaped him completely. Reality seemed to have a tear within it, and he was tucked into that space where the sun didn't move from bathing golden light over the room. Phainon kept moving. He kept busy. If he stopped now, the energy rush would leave his bones, and he really wanted to finish this.

Frying donuts, glazing them with a thick maple icing, and starting a large skillet of chopped veggies, potatoes, and breakfast sausage, all of it felt like autopilot. If someone asked him what he did five minutes ago, of course it was rinsing potatoes off, but he didn't really remember that. It had to have happened though, as he was frying them now.

Somewhere between cracking eggs into the skillet and dancing around the kitchen, he heard the heavy, uneven footsteps of Mydei stumbling through the hallway. No way would Cifera's smaller body hit the wall that hard, and no way would she ever be up before noon. If she was, maybe they took the wrong silver-haired girl home.

"…—'*non?*"

Phainon smiled, turning to find Mydei clutching the wall for dear life. His head was hanging low, hair falling over his face and jaw in stringy, messy locks. He still didn't even have clothes on, just his boxer briefs.

"P-Pantry…" Mydei rasped out, then pointed upwards. "*Excedrin*."

A lid was placed over the skillet to steam the eggs, and he walked to the pantry in search of his pain killers. Not that it was a long search. The bottle was next to a few other medicine boxes in a clear container, and he handed them over as Mydei slumped into a barstool.

"Good morning, *master*."

Phainon also gave him a glass of water to help them down.

“Feel like shit,” he grumbled, ripping the cap off before throwing three into his hand. “*Water*.”

“You’re lucky I *like* being bossed around by you.” The glass clicked to the counter rather than waiting to be picked up. “But is my poor master’s hangover *so bad* he forg—”

“G’mornin’, baby,” he muttered, then downed the entire drink at once. Once finished, he raised the glass for him to take. Without being told, it was filled once more to the brim. “I feel like shit.”

“That’s what happens when you drink like… almost a whole bottle to yourself, you know…” Phainon hinted, and he groaned. “You didn’t have to drink *that* much.”

“I… had my reasons…”

His eyebrow lifted. “Oh?”

It was probably the trouble with his dad again as he had been texting him before they left and while at their table, then the series of events that took place after they got into the club. It most likely made him want to drink until he either *forgot* what happened or he simply *didn’t care* how he acted. Phainon couldn’t really fault him for either.

“Well, in other news, I made breakfast,” Phainon reassured him as another pained groan filled the kitchen. “You’ll be able to eat and hopefully feel a little bit better. When you do, we should probably talk.”

Mydei stiffened immediately. “What will we be talking about?”

“Last night.”

There were so many things that happened, and so many different conversations they could have. Him and Cerydra, him and his father, him and his ex-partner, *them as a couple*—the list went on and on.

“Okay,” he repeated, still sounding weary. Then, he noticed the filled cake dish beside him and squinted his eyes at the stack of maple donuts. “I didn’t make these… *Did I…?*”

The stove was clicked off.

“No, I did,” Phainon said proudly. “You had the ingredients, and I had a tickle for sweets this morning. I haven’t eaten one though because I’m waiting to share one with you.”

“Huh? When did you have time to make these?” He pushed the hair from his face while looking at him. “Let’s just… talk about last night now. What happened? My head’s such a mess, ‘n I don’t remember anything.”

Phainon shrugged casually, trying to keep calm even if *he* was the one who wanted to have this conversation. It was better to come clean *now* than have him figure it out from *someone else*, right?

“Why don’t you tell me the last thing you remember? I’ll start from there.”

It took a moment for Mydei to speak. With his eyebrows furrowed and his head in hand, he looked more pensive than ever, wracking his brain for an answer.

“Um… Cerydra scolded you,” he spoke slowly and carefully. “… which *really* upset me, by the way. *I think* I handled it maturely, but I honestly don’t remember what I said. I just remember drinking again.”

There was a lot he missed then. Everything between them was a blacked out mess, it seemed.

“I remember… *Hyacine…?* She fell asleep on me, I think,” Mydei tried to recall, and Phainon nodded. “It was Hyacine? It could’ve been *Cyrene*. I just remember a pink head on my shoulder.”

“Hyacine. She drove the girls home last night,” he reaffirmed. “Not Cifera though. She’s passed out in the guest bedroom right now. I took care of you both.”

“Did Hyacine and I fall asleep together last night?” He asked, and Phainon shook his head. “No? I drank even *more* than that? *Are you serious?*”

There was an air of disbelief in his voice, like he didn’t expect himself to have let go that much. It almost looked like it upset him to know he was wasted enough to wake up with a hangover. That must have never happened before.

“Here. Let me make you a plate, and I’ll explain as you—”

“Wait… Did *you* sleep?” Phainon’s lips sealed immediately as Mydei eyed him up and down. “Why do *you* have clothes on but *I* don’t?”

“Give me a second, okay? One second.”

Silence followed, and he used it as his chance to grab a dish from the cabinet. Mydei stopped asking questions, opting to instead watch and wait for him to make his deep bottomed plate. The breakfast hash was scooped into the center, and he placed a fork off the side before grabbing an avocado from a nearby fruit bowl.

Phainon was screwed.

There was no way he couldn’t tell Mydei everything that happened last night, as there was picture and video evidence of them touching on each other. But he had to find the best way to come clean with it. How could he make it sound like he *wasn’t* taking advantage of him even if he technically *did?*

Sober Mydei often told him his body was his at all times, hinting that he was okay with being approached for sexual favors. If he wanted to touch him, he was free to. Grinding would probably fall underneath ‘*sexual favors’*.

Drunken Mydei wanted him with no objections or apprehension. He didn’t give him a chance to deny them both like he usually did, as he took the initiative with approaching him rather

than waiting for it.

Was it bad of him to give in to his demand? Was it wrong to have indulged in it?

All night and morning he had been worrying over it, but only *one* person could really give him the answers to those questions.

After layering the sliced avocado into the bowl, he placed it in front of his partner and met his eyes. The truth fell from his lips quickly and uncushioned—just the way Mydei liked it.

“Everyone knows about us now,” he shared with him, and Mydei stared at him blankly while taking in the information.

“They know… *what?*” He emphasized, voice terrifyingly calm given the situation at hand. “Be more specific, Phainon. *Who* knows? And *what* do they know about us?”

Phainon sighed to himself. “They know we’re a couple. You demanded that I grind on you last night, and you started touching and kissing on me in front of them. There’s even some… um… evidence… in our group chat too once you look at your personal phone. We’re *almost* making out.”

Mydei didn’t respond, so he continued.

“And I met one of your exes there. He… thought I was like you, I guess. He assumed I was a *top*, or maybe a *dominant*. It’s kinda like the same thing, right?”

“No, but that’s a conversation for….—What did he look like?” He decided to ask instead, confusion thick in his voice. “Unless he told you his name.”

“No. He was kind of thin, and he dressed expensively. Well, not ‘*expensive*’ like you and Aglaea do, but expensive like… *flashy?* He had brands all over him, and he was like *this* tall,” Phainon listed, motioning with his hand to show him his height. “That jerk called you ‘*daddy*’ right to my face too. It seriously pissed me off. I was going to hit him in the mouth, but the girls stopped me.”

A sharp breath filled the silence, and Mydei’s eyes shifted away from him and focused elsewhere. This conversation was uncomfortable for him, clearly, and he knew that. But now it was Phainon’s turn to ask the questions that were bothering him.

“Did it end poorly between you two? I’m assuming it did,” he hinted, hoping Mydei would open up about his unspoken past some more. “What happened to make him sound so bitter?”

Mydei was a homebody, but he wasn’t necessarily *boring* because of that. He wasn’t a social and public person either, but that didn’t mean he would let his submissive go off with whoever they wanted and watch from a distance. All the things that guy said about him were true to an extent, just twisted in a way to put him down.

Why was he so angry? Because they weren’t together anymore? Couples broke up all the time, and it wasn’t as if they knew each other for any significant amount of time… *right?*

“I wasn’t very… *smart*… with some of the people I engaged with,” Mydei said simply, sticking to his usual approach of *self-blame*. “I couldn’t protect myself properly from that relationship, and I ended up hurting us both.”

Phainon frowned at that. He walked around the counter to join him, taking a seat on the stool beside him before holding his bare arm gingerly.

“Why do you say that?”

“I should’ve realized sooner that we weren’t compatible. He didn’t really want to be my full-time submissive, and I didn’t want to be his next boyfriend. I was too stupid to realize the truth at that moment, and it made us both act out *against* each other,” he explained, sounding ashamed of himself.

He hummed, listening to him speak before pointing fingers. Because he didn’t know anything about their relationship, what else was there to do?

“You want to know everything, right? I know you.” A short and light chuckle shook his chest. “My man is too nosy for his own good, but I owe it to him since he got caught in the middle. That’s the *mature* thing to do, isn’t it?”

Mydei’s low and drawn out breath followed as he tilted his head, humming as if trying to think about where to start.

“You don't have to…” Phainon trailed off, already aware that he really, *really* wanted to know. But if Mydei really, *really* didn’t want to talk, then he would understand. It didn’t seem like a pleasant memory.

“It didn’t start bad… We talked over a meal, texted often, and agreed to everything. He didn’t strike me as a ‘*jerk*’ like you called him, just someone eager to meet someone else. We went out sometimes to bars he liked since he loved going out, and we stayed at his place often to have dinner since I didn’t. We had a lot of sex, but that was kind of it. We probably went at it for a couple of months… three at most,” Mydei shared with him, unable to lift his attention off the counter.

His lips pulled into a taut line, already slightly annoyed that this jerk was starting off as someone ‘*not bad*’ who Mydei ‘*had a lot of sex with*’.

Suddenly, Phainon didn’t know if he wanted to hear about him being with another man anymore. Maybe he should have thought this through…

“The rules we had were a bit stricter, and we agreed that if either of us caught feelings then we would talk to each other about it.” Mydei’s voice grew slightly quieter. “He… didn’t ever tell me, but I should have known that he did. He kept expecting me to take him out on all my days off, let him meet all the friends that I told him I was visiting, and he wanted to post about me online for his friends to see. When I denied him anything like that, he liked to get back at me by flat out ignoring me or doing things without my permission."

He could feel his skin crawl at the idea of purposely denying Mydei one of their rules. Maybe he liked to push his buttons or see how far he could stretch their playfulness, but he never thought to outright *ignore* his texts or orders. No matter how pouty or grumpy, the only time he ever *really* broke rules was unintentionally when his emotions became too big to contain.

If Mydei texted or called him, he couldn't imagine looking at it and then swiping away no matter how upset he was.

"I saw him post about his time with other guys online whenever he did—selfies in the bathroom and videos of them drinking or dancing. He told me I had no right to be upset if I wasn't going to go with him every weekend to push the '*nice guys*' away. If I wanted to be home so bad, I should just sit and watch until he was ready to call me over again for sex. And when we had it, it was always rough. That was what he liked, so I'd just get rougher with him even if I wasn't really in the mood to be. He begged for it every time."

Mydei's shoulders curled in on themselves, making him look smaller than he was. His elbow rested on the counter, clutching his head. Not once did he lift his gaze from the counter top.

Phainon wished he punched his ex now. He wished he didn't let the girls stop him from decking him in the mouth.

"He posted a video of him calling someone else '*daddy*' as they kissed on his neck at some point, and it didn't feel bratty anymore. It felt like he was completely shutting me out that time. I just broke it off then and there."

He flinched. "Over… the phone?"

Mydei nodded, voice small. "Over the phone."

Ouch.

It probably wasn't nice to be broken up with over the phone like that, but at the same time, it wasn't nice to entertain other people when seeing someone too.

In the grand scheme of things, being a proud cheater was worse than a break up over call. Because if *Mydei* was kissing *someone else's* neck while calling him *his* personal pet names and titles, that would be cheating to him. *No one* was his prince but him. If someone else could take that title from him so easily, especially a complete stranger at a bar, then he didn't want to have it anymore. It was no longer *special*.

Mydei then exhaled, eyes closing. "I did that to myself… I told myself he wanted what I did, but it wasn't that way at all. I was tying down a man to *my* kind of relationship when he wanted something *more* from me. He's not a bad person for wanting a specific kind of partner. Because I couldn't give it to him, he looked elsewhere, and… I guess I get it."

"That's not… *right*," Phainon protested weakly. "He lied to you, disobeyed your rules, and was letting other guys kiss on him. How is that *your* fault?"

"I should have—"

“—No, Mydei. It’s… It’s not about *you* this time,” he cut him off, hoping he would understand. “You don’t need to keep telling yourself it was just incompatibility or your own naivety. If you’re not happy with someone, *you leave*, you don’t go out and make them feel like garbage. He probably thought you wouldn’t end it. He probably thought you’d beg, and apologize, and do anything to keep him from doing that again. Isn’t that *abusive?*”

Mydei shook his head slowly. “I can’t accept that it wasn’t also my fault. I fell for his goading antics to rough him up and the promises that he wanted what I did.”

Phainon, truthfully, disliked the way he internalized blame sometimes. It irked him to hear the way he talked about himself, like he was the one fingers should be pointed at for everything that went wrong in his life.

Mydei was cheated on, but somehow that was *his fault* for not… *what?* Going out every weekend? Showing someone off to all his friends and family? Things Mydei explicitly tells everyone he meets—that he dislikes big, social events and doesn’t share intimate details of his life, was suddenly a deal breaker to someone who most likely knew that from the start?

“The only thing I could ever agree with that guy on is you have a tendency to do things for other people without consulting them,” he said, and Mydei looked up at him. “You tried to push me out the door without giving me a chance to talk too.”

“He said that?”

“Yeah, so I can guess how he reacted to you telling him to go find what he needs. Especially if you didn’t even give him a warning beforehand,” he added, aware that Mydei could have possibly just broken it off without ever talking about it.

Seeing his submissive looking happier without him, watching him break his rules so freely, and realizing they were incompatible would have given him enough to not even require a talk. Or, to him, maybe the talks came after all the rule breaking. Those punishments *were* the warnings, but to someone who didn’t want to be his submissive all the time, they were probably just kinky little scoldings from ‘*daddy*’.

It wasn't fair. Not to Mydei who wanted a specific kind of relationship. Not to that other guy who craved something more. The whole situation sounded like it could’ve been avoided if they just *talked*.

Their eyes met, and Phainon’s fingers reached to tuck the golden hair from Mydei’s face. Those soft, amber eyes were full of vulnerability, looking up at him like he was ready for him to call him ‘*immature*’ for a break up over the phone or ‘*boring*’ like his ex did. But Phainon would never unless joking with him the way they did as friends.

“You can say you were incompatible, and that can be true too, but it wasn’t just that. No matter how different the two of you are, that doesn’t justify playing with your feelings after agreeing to a certain kind of relationship with you,” he said gently, sick to his stomach at the thought that someone would willingly try to use him.

Even his *worst* mistake couldn’t justify something like being cheated on and blamed for it.

“He could’ve talked to you about his feelings instead of messing around with other people because you didn’t feel the same,” he added. “But I bet he liked free shopping sprees and kinky sex, so he never wanted to risk that talk of feelings.”

“Let’s not talk about it anymore.” Phainon nodded, then leaned forward to press a kiss against Mydei’s exposed forehead. “What happened after him, Phainon?”

“You were angry and dragged me out to the bathroom,” he said quietly, recalling the events for him. “You told me I was yours, and you were sick of people acting like they could boss me around or touch me so freely. That was when you demanded that I grind on you all night. You kissed me, grabbed me, and rubbed up against me in front of everyone—*even our friends*.”

“*Oh*…”

His stomach dropped over the sharp intake of breath that followed.

“I’m… sorry.” Mydei pulled away from him to put some distance between them, both hands holding his own arms instead. “D-Did I… pressure you to do anything else with me?”

Phainon’s eyes widened.

“… Huh?”

‘*Pressure*’? Did he think he didn’t have a choice in anything that happened?

“I bet you didn’t want any of that, right? When you go out, you just want to have fun with everyone, and there I was forcing you to shake your ass on me like some kind of creep. I’m going to be sick…” Mydei mumbled to himself, face pale as he shrunk in on himself again.

That was what he was worried about?

“*No!* No, I-I should be the one apologizing. I didn’t stop you from doing those things to me because I wanted you to,” he rushed to correct him, not wanting him to believe otherwise. “You didn’t ‘*force*’ me into anything, but I should have put my foot down and protected your privacy. I already knew you don’t like everyone knowing your business, yet I did it anyway.”

“Fuck my privacy—Phainon, *did I hurt you?*” He shot back. “Did I make you do anything you didn’t want to do? Was I really *that* demanding with you in a place where you couldn’t say ‘*no*’ without causing a scene?”

“*No!*” He repeated. “No, you didn’t hurt me. All we did was grind and kiss. No one got hurt, really, but… the girls have pictures and videos of us. They know we’re together. They know you’re fucking me. They know our business because I let them.”

This wasn’t how it was supposed to go.

He was the one who was supposed to feel bad. *He* was the sober guy letting his drunken partner get himself into situations he’d never be in while sober. This wasn’t about Mydei

being pushy—he was *always* a but pushy, and *that* was attractive. It was about him being selfish about his own desires and disregarding what Mydei would've wanted.

"Are you trying to cover up for me right now? What if you safeworded, only for me to—"

"I didn't. Not once." Mydei exhaled shakily over the confession, nodding slowly while taking it in. "I didn't even think about it because I wanted so badly to have you all to myself for a bit. Everyone got to hang out with you, and I wanted a turn with you too. I wanted a moment for it to be just us."

"Promise I didn't force you into anything?"

"I promise," he swore. "You know I'll tell you '*no*' if I don't want it. You know I find you attractive when you tell me what you want from me and take it."

They looked at each other, and a smile slowly broke out on both of their faces the longer their silence stretched on. Regardless of what happened, it seemed he was more focused on *Mydei*, but Mydei was focused on *him*.

Together, they sighed in unison.

"Then we made this bed together," Mydei decided as he lowered his arms. "Your selfishness and my recklessness let everyone find out about us, and that's both of our faults."

Phainon couldn't argue with that.

"I'm sorry I put you in a spot for everyone to bombard us with questions and gossip," Phainon apologized. "Our secret didn't last very long, did it? If you want, I can do the talking if they ask. You don't need to tell them anything if you don't wanna."

"No, *I'm* sorry I caused such a commotion in front of everyone last night. I should have been more responsible with my drinking, ate more to soak it up, and saved us both the trouble. Having no recollection of even getting home last night is unacceptable," he said back, rose dusting his cheeks from embarrassment.

"Do you care that they know?"

Mydei hummed thoughtfully, tracing over his expression before shaking his head.

"It's not that I think they'll be unaccepting of us. Our friends are just loud, noisy, and too curious for their own good. They'll pry." Phainon's eyebrow raised. "You should understand that. You're exactly like that too."

"Hey, I'm not just your '*friend*' to talk to like that," he mouthed off, reaching to poke his forehead and push him back. "We've had sex, and I held your hair back as you puked up liquor. Put some respect on my name, okay?"

"Oh, dear, sweet prince of mine, you are *loud*, and *nosy*, and *pry* where you don't belong," he repeated, and they shared a laugh. "It's a hassle to tell people and let them know, then they'll always be curious of how it's going, what we're doing, when are we going to take it to the

next step, and so on and so forth. That's all. You all have the biggest mouths on you, so I didn't foresee us keeping this relationship quiet for long once we told Cyrene."

"Last I checked, you *liked* this mouth of mine," he taunted him.

Mydei's eyebrow raised. "If you have any *oral remedies* for a migraine, I might like it even more."

He gasped over the insinuation, and Mydei smiled back at him when he pushed on his chest. Before his hand could move, however, a firm grasp wrapped around his forearm. It pulled him closer, easing him out of his chair and on to his feet in front of him.

"Nasty," Phainon accused him, voice lowered. "I should put you in time-out."

"You should tell me how it felt to be my *good boy* in front of all our friends," he whispered back. "Sounds to me you did everything I asked of you. What was *that* like for you in public?"

"*Exciting*." Mydei glanced down to his lips. "Have I told you how attractive it is when you're assertive? Especially when defending me?"

He chuckled. "Am I your knight in shining armor?"

Phainon's eyes rolled before dropping to his mouth, watching the way they stretched from their own grin.

"Try tight little *Calvin Kleins*," he mocked, reminded of how bare his body was as his hand slowly slid down his chest. "I can wake up to this every morning though. That's not a complaint."

"Give me a kiss, and I'll give you whatever you want."

The hand not holding his arm cupped his cheek, and Phainon tilted into the touch. Mydei's soft thumb traced over the rounded apple as he smiled softly, pinching to pull him forward by the face.

As their noses brushed, Phainon let his eyelids droop a little. Then, he shut them all together. It was at that moment he realized just how tired his eyes were and how good it felt to close them.

"And… if I want you to hold me while I take a tiny little nap?" He murmured, melting into his warm and gentle touch.

"Then I will put on a movie, lay down in bed, and hold you the way you like while you sleep."

Instead of responding with words, his lips brushed over Mydei's eagerly. They smelled faintly minty from his mouth wash, and he was beyond happy he didn't taste like liquor and bile from last night now that he actually thought about it. But this was also Mydei, who hated feeling gross or dirty in any kind of way.

Of course his first concerns of the morning would be his breath and the missing spot in his bed.

The hand on his chest inched closer to the left side, cupping over his pec to give a cheeky squeeze.

“Phainon!” Mydei chided, and he hummed before kissing him again. “*Mmph—!*”

“Revenge for last night,” he whispered.

But even with the scolding, he didn’t stop him. He let him touch his body, squeeze his body, and kiss him deeper after his tongue swiped over his bottom lip. They touched, brushing over one another’s briefly.

Before Mydei could push even closer, Phainon eased away, saliva stringing their mouths together. Soft breaths clouded between them.

“Let’s be good. None of that.” As much as he *wanted* to keep going, it was probably best to save it for when he wasn’t hungover and they didn’t have someone in the guest bedroom. “Please eat. I cooked a lot for you and Cifera.”

As their eyes met again, Phainon gave his chest another squeeze.

“You’re *still* groping me.”

“It’s *still* revenge for putting a finger over my crack,” he brushed off, leaning into his neck and shoulder as Mydei removed the hand from his face. A clink sounded from his fork tapping the plate. “Is this actually comfortable for you?”

“Very,” he reassured him. “Here. I want you to take a few bites for me.”

His head shook. “Not hungry. ‘m more sleepy.”

“You may sleep *after* you eat a little bit,” Mydei instructed, and he huffed quietly while raising his head. “*Don’t* get an attitude with me right now. Did you get to eat last night? Be honest with me.”

His silence made Mydei scoff.

“That’s unacceptable. You eating is non-negotiable now, Phainon. You *know* how I feel about you skipping meals.”

Phainon shifted, opening his mouth to accept the bite. Potatoes, eggs, sausage, Mydei waited as he chewed and swallowed it all down. By the time he finished, another forkful was waiting for him to take.

“I’m never drinking like that again,” he promised after. “Knowing how neglectful I was to your needs makes me feel terrible, so let me do this for you. Let me tend to you now that I can.”

“Why did you?” He asked before accepting the second bite.

“Father kept blowing up my phone. Usually I mute it, but… he sent more than what he usually did.” Phainon guessed as much. “He was pouring his heart out in my messages, so I didn’t have the heart to mute it. Then our friends were there, and I wanted to be *fun*.”

“Mm… I saw him text you.”

An accusatory grumble followed. “*You went through my*—”

“*No*, I saw the wall of texts when you left your phone open on the counter. I promise I didn’t read any,” he cut him off, and Mydei was silent while mulling over his explanation. “I figured you’d tell me if it mattered enough… I wouldn’t ever pry that far into your business.”

He sighed. “It’s just the same thing he always tells me. Time is money, and I need to hang out with him more so we can talk about my future.”

“Maybe you should,” he gave his two-cents on the topic. “I know he kinda forced this career on you, and maybe he’s not the *best* person, but… that *is* your dad. Him trying so hard has to count for something, right? You love him, and I’m positive he loves you even if it’s… complicated…”

“He won’t like you.” The abrupt statement made his stomach drop. “As my friend? Yes. As my lover? No. He’ll tell you he has nothing against our lifestyle, and he wishes us well for the sake of pleasantries, but he has always secretly held out hope of me ‘*giving it up*’ and finding a woman.”

Oh…

His lips sealed, and he turned away from the next bite of food, too busy digesting the information to eat anymore so soon.

Well, Phainon can’t say he was surprised. He guessed as much from what he heard of their past conversation. Even if most of him had hoped it was a misunderstanding, a small part just… *knew*.

“He wants me to be like him. I should have a sweet, loving wife and a son waiting on me when I get home from work every night.” Mydei lowered the fork. “I should work as much as possible, give my life and wealth to my wife and son, and set him up to have the same life my father did for me. That’s the point of life—*family and success*.”

Phainon scoffed. “You can’t control things like that. You don’t like women, and what would he do if you had a daughter instead?”

“I’d have to keep trying for a son. They got lucky, that’s why I’m an only child,” he answered as if it were that simple.

“I’m sorry,” was all he could think to say.

“Don’t be,” Mydei brushed off. “I’m already taking on this career path for him to honor the hard work we both put into it, but that’s as much as I’m allowing him to take from me. Everything outside of work belongs to me.”

“Like me?” He teased, hoping to lighten the mood, and Mydei nodded.

“Yes, my prince. I won’t let you go for anything. I almost made that mistake before, but never again,” he promised him. “I’ll… call him later, I guess. Maybe we can get lunch with mother next weekend, and he’ll hop off for a while.”

“Maybe it’ll go better with her there…?”

“Maybe. Mother often says we’re alike in many ways, that’s why we clash so much with each other,” Mydei admitted. “You do too, actually. Apparently we both have a habit of thinking we know best, then not asking others before we make decisions for them.”

Phainon looked down, made aware of the fork being brought back up for him. This time, he took a bite to keep from having to respond.

“You know, you make me talk too much.” Amber eyes watched as he chewed, distant as if thinking of something else entirely. “All I do is *complain* around you. Do I ever shut up anymore?”

“Maybe you’re just realizing it’s really not fair,” he pointed out, only for that same fork to poke his bottom lip as a scolding for talking with a full mouth.

“Hush. Eat, then let me put you to sleep for a nap,” he ordered weakly. “I need a moment of silence now, okay?”

He nodded in understanding, then swallowed. “Yes, master. If you need me, talk to me.”

“I love you,” Mydei murmured, kissing his cheek gently. “Thank you for everything.”

Phainon rested on his shoulder again, relaxing against his body as they ate in a comfortable silence. He had taken care of him all night, and he’d do it again in a heartbeat because he loved him. But it was kind of nice to be pampered again, especially as the exhaustion hit him like a truck.

Chapter End Notes

i’d like to preface this note by saying mydeis deadass just chillin in his boxer briefs with the curtains pulled wide. bro is so hungover and so focused on finding his sub that he just doesnt care

also. i wanted them to fuck nasty style while mydei was drunk and wild but i realized this version of phainon would never let him do that. mydeis “free use” is one thing, but

he could never indulge in it like that

oh, but i should make phainon ‘punish’ mydei for groping him like that LOL how funny would it be

Chapter 26: Chapter Twenty-Six

Chapter Notes

> leon ily i hope i made it in time. i paused my bg3 to speedrun this.
>
> also, the long awaited spanking chapter. sorry it took like 200k words to get here. im very bad at pacing things and it didnt really feel organic until now so… sorry again LOL
>
> to make up for it, im gonna make them fuck dirty in one of the next chapters. i think we all deserve it

See the end of the chapter for more notes

In the following days, Mydei wasn't particularly in any kind of sexual or playfully suggestive mood. Phainon noticed that when talking to him on the phone and texting him.

When he tried to hint at things through their calls, they tossed it back and forth between them but no pictures or videos were sent like before. At one point, just before going for a shower, he made a sly remark about Mydei wanting to join. Mydei only told him his shower wasn't big enough for them both. Which, *yeah*, but it was supposed to be *sexy talk* to make him send something a little more risqué.

It didn't feel like outright denial of his advances, but almost like Mydei wasn't comfortable with it. After all, he knew his partner liked being with him, and he knew he was never against any suggestive moves he made. But as the gossip from their friends continued and deepened, he only ever told him he'd '*think about it*' the next time they met up, then left it at that.

Part of him understood. Hyacine had told Cyrene and Castorice what she remembered when they woke up, and Cifera found out from him after screeching over the photo of them kissing in their group chat. It had been almost a week, yet they were still poking fun at how even the *cool* and *composed* Mydei had that side of him—a wild, sexy, and '*exhibitionist*' side of him. All words coined by each of their friends.

Phainon tried so hard to deny it, to blame the alcohol and the vibes of everyone else doing it, but then they'd turn around and say *he* was a pervert. *He* was so into Mydei grabbing him and bossing him around that it was sickening. They could only imagine the things they got into while alone after that.

To Castorice, it was *cute* that Mydei had someone to dote on when he was such a gentle person. She sent a paragraph about how she was so happy he had someone to give flowers to besides his mother. Not that either of them chose to correct her on how Mydei had never given him flowers before.

For Cyrene who already knew, it was absolutely *hilarious* to her that this was how they let everyone find out about them. It didn't even come from *his* mouth, but from the more secretive of them quite literally kissing on him in public. Oh how reckless of them.

In Cifera's eyes, she was *glad* someone else was going to face the brunt end of Mydei's poking and prodding. With him as his lover, he couldn't keep bothering her when all she wanted to do was play games and do her own thing. But Mydei better not bring him over her house all the time, she didn't need three babysitters on her.

And Hyacine congratulated them. She teased him for being a *sucker* for Mydei and letting him do whatever he wanted with him. That was sweet of him to do, though. Allowing him to let loose a bit and then taking such good care of him after was proof of how much he loved him and understood him.

But Mydei was beyond annoyed that it was their hot topic, going as far as to mute the group chat entirely whenever they kicked the conversation back up. Those screenshots were texted to him when he did it, and sometimes he grumbled about it during their calls too, saying he couldn't stand this but didn't want to dull their fun. It wasn't often anyone in their group got involved with someone, as they've all been mostly single all their lives—well, *except Mydei*. But no one else really knew that besides him.

On Friday night, Phainon decided to visit again. The week was long, and he just wanted to be with Mydei to cool off after an even longer day at work. His partner agreed under the premise Cyrene wouldn't giggle about their visit to the other girls in secret.

He slipped his shoes off like he usually did after unlocking the door. A smile tugged on his lips when the warm scent of fresh herbs and sizzling meat filled his nose. Immediately, his shoulders relaxed as if he were coming back to his own home.

"Phainon? Is that you?"

"No, it's an intruder," he called back sarcastically, walking into the kitchen as a scoff followed. "Master, I had the *worst* day at work. It was so miserable."

Mydei turned around from the stove, looking over his shoulder as he approached.

"Hello to you too, *intruder*," he said back, a light tilt to his low voice. "What happened today? Talk to me."

Phainon came up behind him, both arms wrapping around his waist so he could hide inside the nape of his neck. They curled as deep as possible, fists grasping at his cooking apron to lock his partner in place. His forehead pressed into his shoulder, and his eyes closed while taking a deep breath to steel himself.

It took a moment to find the words and the strength to actually talk, but once he did, he started with a frustrated groan.

"Some people just… Earlier, an older lady tried blaming me for a hair in her food. Am I colorblind? Do I *actually* have black hair?" He asked, and Mydei hummed thoughtfully while

listening to him. “Do I have black hair anywhere in my body? Like… *anywhere?*”

“I can confirm that it is, in fact, natural,” he agreed, giving a stir to what he was cooking. “That nice, snowy hair is all over your handsome body. Not a black hair in sight.”

“Yeah, right? Then she said it was the chef’s. Most of the chefs there either have gray hair or are bald! The closest person with black hair is Hysilens, and she’s at the bar,” Phainon ranted, holding him tighter. “Oh, and then this couple brought their kid. First of all, no one ever really brings their kid to a restaurant like this. Second of all, they sat the kid at the end of the booth, perfect for him to knock his plate off the table as he threw a tantrum over his chicken not being the right kind of chicken! Who does that? And what does that even mean? Chicken is chicken, isn’t it? I gave them exactly what they ordered! But it’s *my* fault their kid is picky, messy, and ill-mannered? *As if!* But I had to smile, apologize, and deal with it anyway.”

Mydei clicked the stove off, and the spatula he had in hand clicked to a dish.

“That sounds like a real headache… Come here, handsome. Do you want to be held?”

“Mhm… Yes, please.”

His arms loosened, allowing Mydei to shift within them. He turned around to face him completely rather than keeping that half twisted stance, and Phainon accepted his warm hug while resting over his collar. While tucked into his partner’s neck, he could physically feel his body melting into him as that familiar, worn out cologne filled his lungs.

Mydei was always warm and comforting, but there was something about his strong arms holding him tightly that made things feel as if they’d be okay. Like he was born to protect, support, and take care of the people around him.

Just a few seconds in his embrace and Phainon was already feeling better.

“Sounds like you had an awfully stressful shift. Allow me to help you unwind,” he offered, speaking softly. “How are you feeling tonight? I’ll do whatever my prince wants me to.”

A shiver trickled up his spine over the routine question, and a tickle of interest burned in his belly from the possibilities. When asking that, then following it up with a statement like that, a million things popped into his head at once.

Biting into his lip, he lowered his hands down Mydei’s back to grip the loops of his work pants.

“I’m good. If you’re offering, I’ll bite,” he hinted sheepishly, nervous of his own anticipation. “It’s uh… been awhile since you last… *touched* me, you know… So I’d like that a lot.”

“Would you?” He double-checked. “If you’re too tired, then we don’t have to.”

Phainon nodded his head quickly. “Yeah, please? The last time you did anything to me, I know you don’t really *remember* it because you were wasted, but you went and did *this*…”

One hand lowered, sliding over Mydei's ass to cup the left cheek inside of his palm. The sudden action ripped a surprised gasp from his partner's lips.

"*Wh-What the hell are you doing?*"

"… and you did *this*…"

His middle finger slipped between either cheek, curling with the natural curve of his bottom. It hooked over his crack loosely, not nearly as tight as Mydei had done it to him while drunk, but still reminiscent of the gesture.

"… *then* you pressed your bulge into my ass all night long," Phainon added. His finger didn't move an inch. "You even told me you wanted to spank me in front of everyone, then pouted when I didn't let you."

Part of him kind of *wanted* to be spanked again. The few he had given him in the past were so exciting, and Mydei liked to tell him he would do it.

Could they try it tonight? Should he ask for it, or would Mydei just give it to him if he kept this up?

"Get your finger away from my ass before I bend you over and *actually* spank you," Mydei warned him, his voice low and rich with promise.

There it was.

Phainon still didn't move his finger, curious of if he'd actually commit to it this time.

"Three seconds, Phainon. *One*."

His heart skipped, and excitement pumped through his veins as he slid his finger higher up the back of his pants. But that wasn't *taking it off*. He knew that.

"*Two*," Mydei continued with his countdown, and the lowered number made him giddy. "Don't do this. I have to spend the day with my father tomorrow, so I've got no patience for disobedience right now."

It stayed there, holding him, testing him.

"*O—*"

Phainon lifted it the moment he heard the first letter, but it was too late. Not that he expected Mydei to be lenient with his threat and start counting by halves.

"*—ne*."

A rough hand gripped his chin in hand and pinched it tightly, lifting it from the safety of his partner's collar to meet the amber eyes staring him down. The eyebrows above were pinched together with frustration, and the lips below were pursed tightly to finish the look. Rose tinted his cheeks.

“Here’s what’s going to happen…” Mydei lowered his voice to a firm but quiet tone. Shivers crawled up his spine. “You’re going to take a shower, and you’re going to *clean yourself up*.”

He gulped over the emphasis.

“I’m going to do the things I usually do—make dinner, prepare your pajamas, collar you…” The list went on, Phainon knew it all well by now. “Before we eat, I’m going to *touch* you, and I'm *not* going to ask before I do. I’m going to *punish* you, and you’re going to *take it*. After we finish, you can then enjoy your dinner sitting on a cold compress or standing up at the table. That wholeheartedly depends on how well you can take it.”

Tingles inched throughout his body at the thought of Mydei actually spanking him the way he’s always wanted to. Time and time again he threatened him, and yet he only ever gave him a single swat here or there. Maybe it was to keep from crossing any boundaries, which was sweet. But his curiosity was a dangerous thing.

What would a *proper* spanking from his dominant be like? Was he *really* about to find out tonight?

“Have I made myself clear enough for you, Phainon? *Speak*,” he ordered him, giving another tug to his chin.

Phainon cleared his throat, shaking himself from his thoughts. “Y-Yes, master. Crystal clear.”

“Repeat to me what you're going to do. Verbatim.”

“I-I’m going to take a shower, and I’m going to clean myself up, master,” he repeated for him, earning a nod in response. “After, I’ll eat dinner with you.”

“Any questions?” Mydei asked. “Is there anything I should know about before I send you off? Do any safewords come to mind? Are there any concerns you need to share?”

“Can you please make us ice cream to eat as we cuddle on the couch?” He blurted out, and a flash of confusion crossed his partner’s previously firm gaze. “I want cookies and cream. Can you do that, please?”

“… Excuse me?”

“I want ice cream please,” he said again, innocent despite the hot water he was in.

He was right where he wanted to be, so all he could think of was *after* everything went down. While he was showering, Mydei could make it, and when they finished dinner, it would be ready to share. That made sense to him.

“… If you don’t make a mess on my couch, then I guess it isn’t trouble. I’ll make us some ice cream,” Mydei allowed, sounding a bit confused. “That wasn’t what I meant though.”

“It’s the only concern I have right now,” he admitted to him honestly. “You know I have a sweet tooth, and after a long day, I want sweets.”

“Then go shower, and take your time washing up. But if you take too long to try and escape your punishment, I’ll go get you myself.”

There was a warning in those words, but *that* was one Phainon wasn't ready to test. Being walked in on during *that* kind of shower would be mortifying. It would ruin the mood completely.

“Being kinky is one way to relieve stress after a long day, huh?” He teased him, holding on to an air of playfulness.

The hand on his jaw raised to come down over his cheek. A soft click of skin meeting skin filled the kitchen, and a light tingle burned in its wake as he leaned into his palm. Its warmth and strength was comforting, exciting, and nerve wracking all at once.

“Go, spoiled brat,” Mydei instructed him. “If I have to say it again, I’m going to slap you again.”

“Kiss first, master?”

“No,” he shut down, and another tap nudged his face away from his hand. Phainon’s jaw dropped from the rejection. “And that hurts *me* more than it hurts *you*, you know. So be on your best behavior if you want a kiss at all tonight.”

He pouted, then nodded solemnly.

“My master doesn’t like me, I get it…” He sulked. Amber eyes rolled before giving him another smack on the cheek. “No kisses from my master… I guess I’ll just go be all by myself then…”

“*Phainon*.”

Another tap burned his cheek hotter, and he bit down on his bottom lip while Mydei then cupped the opposite side of his face. Fingers followed the curve of his jaw, bracing him for another impact. A *stronger* impact.

He sighed exaggeratedly anyway, and Mydei gave him a harder slap than before over the dramatic sound. It made him quiet down immediately, head tilting away from the lingering ache. While silent, his eyes darted to the palm hovering over his cheek for another blow.

“Do I need to do it again? I won’t be so nice,” Mydei hissed, and his head shook quickly as arousal burned underneath his skin. “Are you sure? You seem to be awfully mouthy. Maybe another will remind you that when I tell you to do something, *you do it*.”

His hand raised further.

“*No!* No, it’s okay,” he rushed, squirming in his touch. Upon meeting his eyes, the grip on his face loosened. “I-I understand, master. I’ll be good, and I’ll listen to you. I promise.”

Sometimes he forgot that Mydei could be *mean*.

“I *shouldn’t* be giving you prince treatment after this display of disobedience,” Mydei snapped while letting go. “But my heart's all a mess when I think of you having a bad day, and I *want* to do nice things for you. I *want* to give you the things you ask for and take care of you. I *don’t want* you to have to do certain things yourself, and you know that.”

His voice was so soft as he spoke, like he truly wanted nothing more than to keep pampering him and taking all of his worries away. That air of gentleness and mock sweetness made his chest ache with regret for misbehaving.

“Show me you can listen and that you appreciate me taking care of you, Phainon. Prove to me that you can be a good submissive. Otherwise, I can take it all away *like that*.”

Mydei’s fingers snapped for emphasis, and Phainon sensed he might have made a mistake over the fiery look in his eyes.

Maybe he should have just *asked*.

“Yes, master,” he returned, hoping his firm voice proved that he was ready to be good again. “I-I wanna be your prince. I wanna be taken care of.”

Mydei scoffed. “Your words mean nothing to me, so show me you deserve it. *Go*.”

As Phainon pulled away from him, he rubbed his heated cheek with one hand and then rushed to the shower. Pressing into the aching skin made his cock twitch helplessly, so interested in what his dominant had planned for them that he forgot all about his bad day at work.

—

The first thing Phainon noticed when getting out of the shower was that Mydei didn’t leave him any clothes to put on. There was a warm, fresh out of the dryer, towel folded up with his collar right beside it, and that was it. No boxers. No pajamas. Nothing.

That made sense with what they were going to be doing. Why put on clothes just to take them off ten minutes later?

He walked into the room with the towel around his hips, and the second thing he noticed was that Mydei decided to bring out all the toys he wanted to use. They were laid over his bench, and a few towels were folded beside them all. If he had to guess, the bigger one was to lay on the bed or his lap. The smaller one was probably to wipe his body down.

Lube and lidocaine gel were both understandable too, and the leather harness that looked similar to the one he wore around his hips and thighs could be excused. Somehow. But the short chain laying there wasn’t attached to any cuffs, and what did he want with that vibrator when he was meant to be getting spanked?

Curiosity tickled his arousal even further as he picked the bottle of gel up to read the label.

How hard did Mydei plan to spank him that he would need a pain reliever? Was he going to go at it until he safeworded the same way he did with his throat?

Weren't punishments supposed to hurt anyway? Why would he want to numb the lesson he was administering?

He exhaled shakily, setting it down as a knock sounded at the door. It made Phainon jump, and he watched as Mydei approached him. His apron was taken off, leaving him in just his work clothes. One hand beckoned him to hand over the collar beside him.

"Drop your towel. It's not needed," he said, and Phainon let it fall to the floor before he approached him. "My man is so handsome… Look at you."

"You say this everytime…" Phainon trailed off, shifting foot to foot underneath his attention. "My body's the same as before."

"I'll find you attractive no matter how many times I see you," he brushed off as his hands closed the collar around his neck. It buckled swiftly, Mydei's skilled fingers working the belt without even needing to see behind him.

They reached for the harness next, and Phainon took it into his hands when it was held out for him to hold on to. The twin belts meant for his thighs hung off of his wrists, leather cool and stiff over his skin. Silver buckles and D-rings glistened under the bedroom light, capturing his attention.

A chain with no cuffs, and a harness with D-rings…

Two fingers soon lifted to clasp one claw into one leg, then repeated the same to the opposite side. Silently, it confirmed his suspicions.

"Do you want to know what that steel bar in my cabinet is?" He brought up casually while kneeling down in front of him. "It's called a '*spreader bar*'. I can adjust it as long or as short as I want, lock it at that length, and clip it into my cuffs like a chain. Can you guess what that means for the wearer?"

"So it's for bondage, master…?"

"Yes, it *is* for bondage. But what that *means* is, if I were to place it between your thighs, you wouldn't be able to open or close them any further than I've allowed. You're forced to stay in that position completely," Mydei explained. "It's very rigid and unforgiving in that sense. I can grab it, twist you over, and pull you around with it, and you can't do anything but take it."

Phainon looked back to the bench, wondering if he somehow missed this '*spreader bar*' he was talking about. But upon raking his eyes over it, there was no such thing.

"I believe it might be too much for you to be so open and helpless to my advances, so I'm using this chain to mimic the bar while still giving you some freedom," he said carefully,

jingling the metal links. “Your legs will be bound together, and you may close them as much as you want, but they won’t open any more than this, okay? Do you understand that?”

“Yes, master.”

Mydei began to buckle the belts around his lower body, and Phainon stared at the chain curiously. It was the shorter of the two he recalled seeing, which made him realize he was going to be really limited in his movement. Walking would be difficult. Would *waddling* be more appropriate?

Either thigh was dressed in the straps, and he felt his heart pound a little bit harder while trying to separate his legs wider. Every time the chain drew taut and stopped him, he felt his stomach twist with a hint of panic. It only served to make him want to try harder to free himself, like he could rip the rings right from the finely stitched leather.

He was pretty strong. Maybe he could tear through it?

“Close them,” Mydei ordered when he noticed his struggling, and he did. “My bar would not allow you to do that. Tell me, is this freedom more comfortable for you?”

“Yeah,” he breathed out, then raised one knee slowly to see if he could still walk. When it stopped just shy of him taking his normal stride, he pulled harder. “Master, I can’t really walk though. It’s too short.”

“It’s not,” he reassured him. “You don’t need to be walking right now. Knowing that, how does it feel?”

Right. He wasn't *meant* to walk. Mydei was going to put him over his lap and spank him until his ass ached, and that didn’t require him to be able to move his legs.

“Restricting.” Mydei’s deadpan expression made him laugh, both excited and nervous. “It’s… like handcuffs, right? I can’t move, you know? I-I won’t be able to squirm much, but every time I try, I wanna fight it. I wanna pull and pull until I’m free.”

“Go on then. Try again.”

Mydei stood up, and Phainon looked at him as he admired his lower body. Rather than teasing his half hard cock, he was touching his hips and tracing the leather on his thighs. Both hands dipped under the belts, lining beneath before pulling him closer.

As he lifted one leg to try and fight his chain, the hand under his left garter moved. It lifted off for a second, then smacked down on top of his bare ass with a firm clap.

“*Fuck*,” he gasped sharply and suddenly, jumping from the impact and falling into his chest.

“If you pull on them unnecessarily, I’ll spank you more,” Mydei warned him. Fingers dug into the cheek after, gripping it tightly. “What are you *not* going to do, handsome?”

“Fight,” Phainon answered breathily. “I-I’m not gonna fight, master. This is where I’m supposed to be, right?”

“Right. You’re smarter than you let on.” The hand in his ass rubbed gently, soothing out the light burn. “Come on. I’m going to sit on the bed, and I want you over my lap.”

Mydei guided him forward, watching as he struggled to make his accompanying steps. One hand helped him walk while the other held the rest of his prepared toys. The larger towel was set underneath his feet and legs by the edge of the bed. Their lube and vibrator was left on the blankets with the smaller one, all of them ready to be used. Beside them, the gel rested in case it was needed.

Phainon stumbled lightly when leaning over his lap, shifting uncomfortably.

“Wait, my—”

“Yes. I feel it. Let’s put that between my legs,” Mydei hushed, already reaching for his cock to tuck it in the space between his thighs. “Is this better?”

Upon feeling the fabric of his slacks rubbing up against him and the tightening of them closing around him, his stomach twisted deeply. He was trapped here completely. With his body bent in half, ass on full display, and cock being squeezed by Mydei’s thighs, there was nowhere for him to run to. All he could do was lay there and take it.

“U-Um… yeah,” he choked out, looking at the hem of his slacks. “Please don’t s-squeeze it too hard, okay? I know how much you push on leg day, and how strong your thighs are.”

Mydei paused. “Don’t you trust me?”

“I do! I trust you more than anyone,” he promised him, shifting over his lap again. That only served to rub deeper into his thighs and bring a jolt of pleasure through his knotted belly. “Master, I’m just… n-nervous…”

“Were you nervous when testing me earlier?” Mydei brought up suddenly, and he froze. “Were you nervous all those times you talked back and acted like a brat who could do whatever he pleased?”

His heartbeat picked up when a hand gently rubbed over his ass as if to pet the plush cheeks. It moved in loose, circular motions, squeezing gently when completely encompassing either cheek in his fist. When satisfied with the grasp, it began rotating again to soothe him.

“I’ve always told you I would do this to you at some point. Since the very beginning, I told you I would spank you if you allowed me to,” he reminded him. “Tell me, Phainon, you might be nervous, but do you trust me?”

He gulped. “Yes, master.”

“Hands behind your back. Give them to me,” he instructed him, sliding his hand higher towards his tailbone.

Phainon raised his hands one by one to his back for Mydei to grasp. Soft touches trailed down his arm with Mydei’s opposite hand, and they tickled over his wrist until they met his

hand. Fingers stretched to bring both hands on top of one another, then laced between them both to pin them down.

“Hold me back. I’m not angry at you, okay? I’m not going to take my love away from you,” Mydei reassured him as he gave their hands a firm shake. “Do you know why I'm going to spank you?”

“I-I didn’t listen, master.”

“Yes. I asked you to do something, and you refused. I gave you a warning, and you didn’t listen,” he reminded. “Then, instead of obeying me, you went and said ridiculous things like ‘*you don’t like me*’ and ‘*you’re leaving me alone*’.”

Phainon squirmed again, heat building in his face as he realized just how *embarrassing* this position was. His ass was up so high and his head was down by his calves. Both of his hands were in Mydei’s grasp, unable to push him away or pull himself up to get away.

He was helpless. He was completely at Mydei’s mercy.

It was like being handcuffed to his bed as he touched his body, or sitting on his knees as his head was held in his hands and fucked into. It was like being pinned down to the bed beneath his weight as he was fucked for the first time, legs propped up on his shoulders.

“Your cock is hard between my thighs, so I know you want this. I’ve spanked you in the past, and you told me you liked it.” Mydei’s hand went back to rubbing his ass softly as he spoke. “Why are you nervous, Phainon?”

“I-I don’t know… I mean, I *do* kinda know. It’s gonna hurt,” he reasoned, reminded that Mydei didn’t want to hear uncertainty in times like this. He needed to be honest. He needed to be precise. “I’m not really used to being hurt by you, master. You’re so strong, and you like these sadistic things more than me…”

“Yes, but you’ve told me you liked this.”

“I-It’s different. That was *one*. This is… *multiple*.”

Mydei’s hand paused over the middle of his ass. In doing so, he was able to feel just how big his partner’s palm really was. Were his hands always that big?

“I’m going to spank you whether you’re nervous or not. Sit through five of them, then tell me your safeword after,” he said firmly, choosing not to back down. “Count them for me, and thank me for punishing you.”

His stomach eased at the thought. “Only five?”

“A couple for the surprise of it, then a couple more to be sure if you don’t like this. If you enjoy it, I will be giving you more.” That made sense to him. “I’m going to count you down, are you ready?”

Five spanks. One after the other. If he didn't like it, he didn't have to sit through any more. Mydei wouldn't *make* him no matter how poorly he had acted.

"Yes, master." He exhaled. "I'm ready."

"*One*…"

His thumb traced across his cheeks, peeling them apart slowly to admire the jiggle when he pulled it away. More heat burned in his face from the sheer embarrassment of him eyeing his crack.

"*Two*…"

Without the hand on his body, a wave of anxiousness hit him. Was he going to spank him as hard as he usually did? Would it be harder since this was considered a '*punishment*' and not just for fun?

"*Three*."

The impact of his hand clapping down over his ass made his body jolt, and he gasped out from the sharp sting. It wasn't any harder than he had done it when by his front door, but it still took him by surprise. Even with the countdown, he wasn't used to being handled this way.

"What did I ask you to do after?" Mydei asked, holding his hand to the heated skin. "Focus on me. Stop thinking and give your master *all* of your attention. Nothing else matters but you being present for *me*."

"Th-That was one," he forced out. "Thank you f-for punishing me, master."

"Good boy," he coo'ed, pleased by the response. "Brats like you need to be reprimanded, and this was *long* overdue. Come on, *again*."

Another firm smack rippled through his ass, and he grit his teeth while sucking in a breath. Pleasure and pain mingled together, tickling over the skin.

"Two," Phainon breathed out while staring at the floor. "Master, thank you for punishing me."

"*Why* am I punishing you?"

"I was a-a brat. I said things that weren't true, and I didn't listen when you told me to stop touching you," he answered.

"*Why* did you do it?" Mydei groped his ass before reeling his hand back. Within seconds, he brought it back down. "Tell me why you wanted to be bad. What made you think to walk into *my* home, touch *my* body, then refuse *my* instructions?"

Phainon cried out this time, hands tightening around Mydei's as a twitch pulsed through his cock. Jaw dropped, he panted heavily from the series of spankings burning over his ass.

"—*wanted to!* I-I wanted to see what you would do if I was bad. I wanted to see if you'd touch me if I made you mad," he confessed, words rushed and begging to be understood. "Three! Th-Thank you for punishing me, master!"

"My boy was so desperate to be roughed up that he just had to push my hand." Another throb filled his cock over the words. "You're becoming quite the little *pain slut*, aren't you?"

Mydei spanked him again.

"Four!" He heard a chuckle above him from the pitched cry, and it made his stomach tighten. "Thank you for punishing m-me, master!"

"You have no idea just how sexy your ass looks like this," he praised him crudely. "And don't pretend I can't feel how hard your cock is right now. I wonder if it's leaking all over my pants. Should I make you lick it off of me and keep it in your mouth until dinner time?"

Phainon didn't respond, and a second for both of them to calm down followed. He could hear Mydei physically taking a slow and careful breath above him as if to relax.

"Last one, then you're going to tell me your safeword."

Phainon nodded quickly, and when his hand connected to his ass again, he moaned loudly at the impact.

"Mm… there it is," Mydei murmured while rubbing his ass gently. "What number was that? Tell me."

"*Fi-ive*," he panted, then felt the fingers in his fist weasel their way out. "Thank you for… for punishing me, master…"

Laying on his lap, Mydei gave him another second to bask in the lingering sting of his raw skin. Tingles buzzed underneath the warmth, each branching through his body and towards his unbearably stiff cock.

"Tell me how it felt to be spanked by my hand," he demanded gently, and the click of a lid sounded. "Did it hurt?"

"Yeah…" His voice was tinted with a whine. "Master, m-my ass burns a lot, and… and it's a little scary."

Mydei hesitated. "Why is it scary, Phainon? Talk to me."

"What if I… like it too much? What if I like being hurt more and more to the point I-I can't go back?" He worried, then jumped when he felt a hand peel his cheeks apart again. Something hard and wet then rubbed up against his ass, sliding slowly.

"Then you like it, and we can do this more often out of pleasure. There is nothing wrong with enjoying this with me, baby. I have you, *all of you*, and I'm going to take such good care of the person you are and the person you'll become," Mydei swore to him, rolling the object against the puckered rim. It was too hard and too slender to be his finger.

His eyes widened.

The vibrator.

“Shh, trust in me. Trust in your master,” he hushed him, continuing to massage his hole with the small, slender toy even as he squirmed. Sometimes he dipped over the opening, but then he moved right back to circling around it. “*Focus*. Give me a safeword, handsome. Tell me if you want to keep being spanked. I’m going to give you twenty, fifteen more on top of what you’ve taken. Can you do it?”

Twenty sounded like a lot. Could he really handle that? Especially knowing Mydei had somewhere to be tomorrow so he couldn’t take care of him and pamper him when it hurt in the morning?

“Green, master,” he decided, words soft. “But twenty might be too much for the first time… Can we try fifteen? I think I can do that with how hard you’re hitting me.”

A contemplative hum filled the room.

“Fifteen.” There was no room to deny him after that, and Phainon had no more concerns to take up with him. “Take ten more on top of your five, then give me one nice orgasm while your ass is inflamed with my handprints. I won’t take ‘*no*’ for an answer.”

He took a deep breath, steeling his nerves and calming himself down.

Mydei said that, but if he safeworded then he’d stop immediately no matter what. If he could only end up taking ten, or twelve, or even just *fourteen*, a single, three-lettered word would keep Mydei from taking that last one from him.

It was talk. It was all just dominant and selfish talk to get his cock leaking and his heart racing, to reinstate how *powerless* he was in that moment.

Phainon trusted him. He trusted him for the first five, and he trusted him for the next ten.

His fists balled and breaths hitched as Mydei slowly pressed the vibrator against his hole. It pushed gently, not seeming to pull back like it had been before when his body began to open up for it.

“I’m going to put this inside of you,” Mydei told him, confirming his suspicions. “There’s no special reason. I’ve wanted to do this since I saw it in your dresser, so why not use it as a prize for taking your punishment so well?”

Slowly, his ass stretched to accommodate the small toy. Mydei’s finger pushing it deeper was more distracting than the egg, however, especially as he pumped it in and out slowly.

“My prince likes having his ass touched. You asked for it so sweetly before,” he murmured, rubbing up against his walls. “Do you like being fingered by me?”

“Y-Yes, master,” Phainon choked out, eyes screwed shut from the pleasure. “*There!* Master, please keep touching there. Please.”

The pad of his middle finger rubbed against his prostate, rolling it around for a moment.

“Wait. D-Don’t let the vibrator go too—”

“I know,” Mydei cut him off. “I’m almost certain I’ve been touching a man’s ass longer than you’ve been putting toys up your own, Phainon. Trust me, okay? Relax, and let your master do his thing.”

Right. He didn’t need to worry. Mydei had him, and he knew the risks of what he was doing. He was going to make sure he was fine, and he was going to take care of him completely.

Relax.

It was an odd feeling to have a wire dangling out of his ass, then even weirder to feel it wrap around Mydei’s finger. He could feel him tugging it down from where it slipped in deep, then again as he pushed against his insides to plant a finger on top of it. Like this, he was holding it flush to his prostate.

A click turned it on, and Phainon lurched forward while attempting to curl into himself. His knees bent inwards, and his chest pushed forward, yet that only served to make him clench tighter around it.

Never had he put it inside of himself, but maybe he should have with how *good* it felt.

“*Ma-aster!*”

“I bet that feels nice, huh?” Mydei chuckled, then eased his finger out carefully. “To make sure you keep it there, I need to keep this ass clenched tight, don’t I? Come on. Do you remember what you need to do?”

“Hold on. H-Huh?” He stammered, trembling over his lap from the sensations. “Master, i-it’s so much… I can’t.”

The second he lifted his hand, it smacked down over his ass as firmly as it had earlier.

“*Ah!*” His moan echoed through the room with the clap of skin meeting skin. “O-One…— *No! Six!* Master, that was six!”

“Yes it was, and what do we say next?”

Phainon’s legs shook as he squeezed the vibrator tightly, unable to escape the foreign pleasure of it buzzing against his insides.

“Thank you f-for punishing me,” he panted, voice thick with arousal and pitched from the overwhelming sensations.

“Nine more to go,” Mydei said happily, and he nodded quickly. Nine. *Only nine*. “Come on, you can do it. And if you can’t? Then you know not to test my hand again. It will come down on you just… like… *this*.”

Mydei clapped his hand against his ass again.

"*Seven! Th-Thank you for punishing me, master!*"

Each swat on his ass after that held that same firmness and strength, smacking repeatedly into the bruising skin with purpose. He felt his body jiggle. He felt his legs shake and kick, which only made Mydei tsk and scold him even more for being unruly.

The eighth one made Mydei rest his hand over his own again, but he didn't hold him. He let himself be held in return, too busy controlling the remote attached to his toy to lace their fingers together. Nine had him hissing softly from the strength of his grip on his wrist, yet he stayed there to serve as grounding in this helpless state.

At ten, Mydei turned the vibrator up a level, letting it hum on its middle setting. Its intensity coupled with the fire that licked over his skin and his trapped cock being squeezed between firm thighs made Phainon's head feel extra hazy. Counting was getting harder as his muscles tightened and flexed. Thanking him was more difficult as the words began breaking more and more often in his mouth.

Eleven and twelve were a blur. By then, his balls were drawn and his cock was a mess of precum, feeling almost as messy as his face from crying. He felt the stickiness around Mydei's pants engulfing him, then the drip of his tears down the curve of his jaw. It was all so overwhelming, but he wasn't done yet.

Thirteen was forgotten. Did he even say '*thank you*'? Maybe. His dominant would have stopped completely if he didn't, yet the vibrations continued relentlessly. Then fourteen came, proving he had to have been good.

Just before the fifteenth strike, the toy was kicked to its most powerful mode. A wiggle moved Mydei's wrist from his fist, and he laced their fingers together for it. There was a weight on his back that felt suspiciously like the discarded remote, yet he paid little mind to the way its body rocked from his trembling.

"One more," Mydei purred, massaging his throbbing ass and pressing over the forming bruises. "Beg for this one, Phainon. Beg to be spanked."

"Master, can you p-please spank me? Can you please punish me for b-being a bad sub tonight?" Phainon's voice slurred slightly with pleasure, eyes closed from the bliss of getting to let go completely.

There was nothing to worry about at this point. What had he even been concerned over? Work? Risks?

All that mattered was how *close* to an orgasm he was and whatever words left Mydei's mouth. He didn't need to think of anything but being good, and that was so nice.

"Do you really want it?" Mydei jiggled his ass again. "Beg more."

“I want it, master. *Please*,” he continued to beg. “I wanna be put in my place. I wanna be your good boy again.”

As he pleaded for his final spanking, Phainon was unable to keep still like he had before. His hips bucked wildly, half-fucking the thighs holding his cock and half-pushing back into the vibrator. No matter which way he went, there was an unrelenting pleasure awaiting him.

That was when he was shoved back down by their combined hands, forcing him to thrust quickly and deeply into Mydei’s thighs. The legs beneath him closed tighter, edging him closer to his orgasm with their firm grasp.

“Are you going to cum?”

“Yeah… Can I please cum, master?” Phainon whined desperately as he twitched. “I-I *was* bad, but I’ve *been* good. I’ve been doing so good w-with your punishment. Please let me cum.”

“What are you?” Mydei asked him gently, still shaking his ass in his hand.

“I-I’m master’s good boy,” he answered, grinding his hips downwards since he couldn’t keep thrusting. “I’ll be so good, master. I promise. I promise I’ll do whatever you say. I won’t be bad again if you j-just please let me cum.”

“How close are you? You’re humping my lap like a needy slut,” he mocked him. “Look at you grinding into my thighs… I never even allowed you to do that.”

A sob fell from his lips as he flexed his thighs and squeezed his cock again. “*So close*. I-I’m so close, master. *Please!* I’ll be so good f-for you if you j-just let me cum. I need it so badly.”

It was *right there*. His orgasm was *so close*, but he couldn’t let go without permission. He was *always* supposed to ask his master for permission.

“Do you deserve it?” Mydei stalled, then flexed his thighs again. “Or should I leave this disrespectful little brat edged and denied for thinking he runs this house?”

“*No!* No, no, no,” he rushed. “No, please. Master, please don’t edge me. Please d-don’t leave me like this. I’m so, so close! I just need you t-to tell me I can. Please say I can.”

A chuckle followed, the sound slow and taunting. “I guess I’m feeling generous because you beg so pretty. Cum for me then, brat.”

His firm hand clapped down on his ass hard, harder than the rest of them had been, and Phainon threw his head back with a scream. It tore from his throat without warning, surprising them both.

As soon as their skin collided, his ears popped and cock pulsed from the orgasm that tore through his body completely. His ass clenched tighter than ever, and his toes curled deeply while kicking his legs out tightly. Vibrations rumbled all the way down from his thighs, his knees, his crossed ankles, and his curved feet.

That very last spank had him painting Mydei's black pants and the towel between his feet with a mess of cum. Rope after rope was milked from his aching cock thanks to the incessant buzzing and occasional flex, emptying every last drop from his balls.

"Phainon, what do we say?"

"*F-Fif... Fifte-een…!*" His raspy, croaky voice managed to wail despite the haze over his head. "*St-Stop… Sto-op. Master, no m-more! Off! Off!*"

The toy was still going. It continued to abuse his prostate at its strongest even as he kicked and thrashed on Mydei's lap from overstimulation.

"What do we say?"

"Thank y-you! Thank you f-for letting me c-cu-um," he heaved, breaths ragged and heavy in between every. "Thank you… for p-puni-ishing me-e… *nngh, mas-ster…*"

Mydei wiggled his hand free once he managed to get the words out, and he reached for the remote to shut it off. The vibrations died out quickly, but it didn't stop him from twitching and jerking from the aftershocks. He couldn't help it as his body slowly shook the vibrations from his system.

While bent over Mydei's lap, a wave of heaviness settled over his limbs. If not for the involuntary jerking, he couldn't bring himself to lift even a finger.

"You're so good for me," a low, proud voice coo'ed gently while stroking lightly over his beaten cheeks. "I've got you. I've got my baby."

Phainon whined, not wanting to move but also not having the energy to fight back against the hands on his body. They slowly tugged the toy free from his throbbing ass, then dropped it down to the mess beneath them carefully. Next came the chain hooking his legs together, and it was dropped towards the edge of the bed since it wasn't necessarily *dirty* like the lubed-up toy was.

Mydei was talking again, mumbling sweet words he couldn't quite grasp long enough to comprehend. All he knew was they were spoken softly, filling the room with nothing but that softened tone he used for praise and admiration.

It made his eyelids droop. His muscles melted into jelly within the hands attempting to move him.

His ass hurt. Without the stimulation and the edge of an upcoming orgasm, he could truly feel the skin pulsing red hot from the repeated swats. Coming down from his release made it hurt more than it did previously.

The bruising over his skin made it uncomfortable to sit on when he was flipped over to rest on his partner's lap, but he tried to endure. He hid his face inside of his collar, tilting to look down at his own body. But in rubbing the bruises against Mydei's slacks, he hissed sharply.

“I’m so proud of you,” Mydei whispered down to him, bringing his arms to his belly and adjusting his ass over his lap. “You’re so strong, Phainon. Fifteen big spanks, and you took it like a champ for me.”

He stared down at his messy, softening cock while listening to the gentle praise. Cum stained the head and length, and it was slightly annoying since he had *just* showered not that long ago. In fact, sweat was rolling down his skin and lube slicked his crack, and that was even more annoying because *he just showered*. Did he really need to take another one already? When his bottom was *this* achy and his feet *that* tired from being on them?

His frustrations blew into that rosy cloud of subspace, tinging it something less sweet and more bitter.

But then Mydei kissed the top of his head, bringing one hand up to push the hair from his forehead. Lips pressed there too, soft and sweet against the sweat.

“I’m going to clean you up in a second,” he promised as if he could read his mind in that moment. “You’re so gorgeous when you’re in subspace, and I want to hold you a little bit longer while you’re in it.”

Slowly, the agitation dissipated as he closed his eyes and turned deeper into his body.

His dominant was going to take care of it. Why was he even worrying about it? If he was in pain, if he was dirty, if he was anything uncomfortable, his master was going to give him ointment, wipe him down, and give him what he needed. He was going to feed him food and water, dress his naked body up, and make sure he didn’t want anything.

“Thank you for playing with me, Phainon,” he whispered. “Thank you for taking your punishment so well and trusting me.”

Strong arms pulled him in closer, one around his waist and the other holding his dressed thigh.

“And don’t worry about liking things that seem scary,” he reassured him. “You are still my silly, loveable, and kind-hearted prince whether you like being told you’re good or having your ass spanked raw. Nothing changes no matter what we do.”

Tears brimmed his eyes.

“I promise,” Mydei swore without even needing to hear him ask for it. “No matter what you like in bed, it doesn’t change the fact I will always see you as my sweet prince.”

Phainon sniffled, curling up smaller. “Master, my ass hurts a-a lot…”

“I know, baby. It’s supposed to hurt. Bad boys get punished when they act out like that, so tough it out for just a little bit, okay? My boy is so strong, and I know he can do it,” Mydei said back, and he nodded weakly. “Can you do it for your master?”

“I-I can do it.”

“That’s what I like to hear. Now, hold me while we sit here together.” Phainon was pulled closer, and he raised his arms to slip around Mydei’s sides. “I want to make sure you’re okay, and I want to be close to you. Give that to me. Then we’ll have dinner, and I’ll give you your ice cream. Hopefully it’s frozen enough.”

He pressed deeper into him, legs crossing and body turning to face him. And Mydei continued to whisper just how proud he was of him and how he didn’t even need the pain reliever.

“My master won’t put the gel on?” He mumbled.

“No, I won’t,” he shot down. “I’ll put on some aloe and give you some ice, but no drugs to make it go down. That was for if you safeworded out and I needed to calm you down quickly. But you liked your spanking, didn’t you? And you took it so well. You didn’t give me a ‘*red*’ at all.”

Phainon nodded weakly.

“It’s going to hurt for a little bit, but you’re not going to act out again because of that, are you?” Mydei asked, and he shook his head this time.

“‘m sorry, master…”

“I know you are,” he coo’ed. “I know you’re sorry. Give me a kiss, baby.”

Mydei’s fingers left his thighs to lift his chin higher, and Phainon looked up at him as he sniffled again.

“You’re so handsome when you cry,” he praised him, watching as he blinked the tears free.

His head tilted, and he closed his eyes while feeling Mydei’s lips meet his own for the first time since he came back. It was soft, the pressure put into it just enough to make his belly tingle and heart throb. His breaths were ragged and heavy through his stuffy nose, and Mydei pulled back so he could gasp for a real breath.

That was when he kissed his jaw, touching where his tears had fallen.

“Close your eyes, and your master will take care of everything that needs to be done,” he hushed. Even through his fuzzy head, Phainon recognized him licking up the tears from his lips. “We’re done playing tonight.”

“Thank you for t-taking care of me, master.”

Mydei smiled back at him, his grin subtle but the look in his eyes brighter than ever. “That’s what I love to do,” he said back. “Taking care of you is my favorite thing to do.”

Phainon could tell, and he was happy that the rest of the night was going to be full of Mydei doting on him.

Chapter End Notes

god mydei is so lucky getting to spank on his jiggly lil bubble butt and see his rosy teary face like im so jealous of him rn

Chapter 27: Chapter Twenty-Seven

Chapter Notes

> it took me like 6hrs i think to edit this. its 7am. hohh my god.. like 15k words or something like that
>
> im sorry it took so long. writing porn takes more out of me than anything else tbh and i was grinding for robinetto in game.
>
> and im sorry if theyre typos; ill edit when i wake up in a couple of hours cause i gotta be up in 4hrs LOL

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon had been bad the night before, and he knew that. His attitude was everywhere, going as far as to make Mydei not only slap his cheek but spank his ass. And as fun as it was to try something new or get him a little bit worked up, he knew better than to keep walking that same disobedient path. There was a time and a place to push buttons, and he exhausted both already.

When waking up that next morning and starting their day together, he was careful of being overly bratty. If Mydei said something to him, it was already done before he could turn around. After all, Phainon *liked* to be helpful. He *liked* to be good for him and get completely pampered by him in return.

Mydei told him to put the basket full of dirty towels in the wash once he finished rinsing off, so he did. And because Mydei was going to meet his parents for brunch and to spend the day with them, he only had a small meal for breakfast. But he still demanded that *he* eat a full meal, so Phainon *still* had dishes to wash. Those were then taken care of swiftly in the way Mydei liked.

Once finished, he joined his partner in the bedroom. His knuckles tapped to the door even if the mirror in his closet showed him standing there, and Mydei glanced his way briefly.

“Phainon, pick a shirt.”

Since it was a demand, he did that too after looking between the options.

“I like the blue and gold one, master. It matches your jewelry,” he commented. “You look good in red, but you wear red a lot. Let’s retire it for a day.”

“For once, your fashion advice makes sense,” he mused, and Phainon rolled his eyes. “Thank you.”

“Happy to help, master.”

Both hands took the chosen shirt from him as Mydei reached to tuck the hangers back in their spot. He worked the buttons open for him, then silently helped him fit arm after arm into either sleeve.

“Will you be here for dinner tonight, master?” Phainon wondered, eyes locked on to the way his under-shirt hugged his thick waist.

“I don’t intend on staying any longer than necessary. We’re going for a meal, then my father wants to talk to me over golf,” he shared, an edge of annoyance in his usually cool tone. “I plan to be home.”

“Would you like me to be here for you when you do?”

Mydei hesitated, mulling the thought over as Phainon’s fingers worked the buttons of his shirt slowly. “If you have plans, or if plans come up, you don’t need to be here. I’m not going to demand you waste the day all by yourself and wait like a dog by the door. That’s ridiculous.”

Phainon pouted slightly. “But do you wanna see me here, master?”

All he needed to do was say ‘*yes*’. Cyrene knew they were together. She was aware that he needed to be here for some alone time with him, and she promised that she didn’t see it as a way to dodge hanging out with her. Why keep trying to beat around the bush?

If Mydei wanted him somewhere, he would be there. That was all that needed to be said.

“It’s not necessary to wait up.”

Taking a breath, Phainon lightly pulled on his shirt while looking into his eyes.

“Master, please listen. Do you *want* to come home to your sub waiting for you?” He asked one last time, slower than before, and Mydei’s eyes dropped.

Another moment of contemplation passed. He watched as those rosy lips were licked over and chewed on.

“I know myself. I’ll probably be in a bad mood, and you shouldn’t have to deal with my short temper unnecessarily. You’re my *submissive*, not my *therapist*,” he explained himself and his answer.

A smile tugged over Phainon’s lips as he cupped his freshly shaved jaw. Both thumbs touched the corners of his lips, and he pushed them higher.

“Then I just have to try extra hard to make my master feel better, or give him something nice to smile about when he gets home,” he said simply. “Here’s what I’m thinking, but tell me if you wanna change anything, okay?”

“Hm…”

“I can cook us dinner.”

Mydei already had an eyebrow raised, skeptical of his offer because cooking for them was a job *he* liked to do. He cooked their meals, baked their desserts, and pressed their juices. While Phainon was allowed to give suggestions for meals, snacks, or flavors, Mydei did as he pleased in those areas. And it worked for them.

Already, he seemed slightly against the idea.

“I’ll have a delicious meal ready when you get back, dress up nice and handsome for a little eye candy, and be on my *very best* behavior for you. You can have all the control you want from me, and I’ll obey every word even better than I already do,” he offered to him.

Mydei shook the hands on his face off, then raked his eyes over his pleased and proud expression.

"That’s very… *domestic*…” He commented, and Phainon nodded happily.

He really did like the domestic things they did together. Chores were never too boring with Mydei around, and they doubled as a way to be both dominant and submissive for each other. He could boss him around a little bit, Phainon could be praised for a job well done, and everyone was happy with that arrangement.

Even at the start when this was new, he enjoyed getting to take care of the little things for him like dishes and laundry.

“Domestic roleplay," he joked, earning a light chuckle in response. “It’s… relaxing for you, isn’t it? Don’t you wanna come home then *not* have to think about a single thing but *you* and *me?*”

“If that’s the case, may I ask something of you? If it’s a little outrageous, tell me.”

“Yeah, anything you want,” he encouraged him. “I’m just spitballing things. What are you thinking, master?”

Leaning in, Mydei brought his mouth up to his ear. Lips touched the lobe, and a breath fanned across the skin while pulling him chest to chest. The words whispered to him made warmth spread over his face and his breathing to hitch while taking them in. Then, he nodded softly.

“Yeah, o-okay,” he whispered back shakily. “I uh… I can definitely do that.”

“Good boy,” Mydei purred, the sound low, rich, and silky. It enveloped his senses, tingling in his gut and his groin as it wrapped around him and his head. “Do you have any plans today? Or are you going to hang out around here until I get back?”

“I’d like to go out and buy a nice outfit for you. Maybe something you haven’t seen before so it’s more exciting to come back to,” he brought up thoughtfully.

Mydei kissed beneath his ear before pulling back slightly. “I want to buy you a little iced coffee or iced tea while you walk around then.”

Phainon sighed, both in pleasure and in resignation. “Do you really?”

“*Yes*.”

“Fine, but *only* the drink,” he gave in on his own this time. Just that had Mydei grinning with pride. “And that’s because, as my *lover*, I can accept a little ten dollar drink. It’s not that bad, I guess…”

“I also pay for the groceries around here, so how much do you think you’ll need to cook dinner?” He asked, pulling back even further. “You can cook it *if* I can buy it. Otherwise, guess one of us is bringing home take out, or I’m making dinner when I get back.”

“But—”

“No. *My* house, *my* bills. How much?” Mydei pressed firmly, and Phainon pouted slightly over his pushiness.

“I haven’t really thought about what exactly…”

There were so many things he could make for them with all the time he’d have to cook. Did he *really* have to have it planned out this early in the day? Did Mydei *always* know what he was making for dinner this early in the day?

“I’ll give you something, and whatever’s left, *I guess* you can give it back to me.” With that, he turned to approach his jewelry case to end the discussion there. It was clear he had no intent on letting him both buy ingredients *and* cook them for him.

“I guess that sounds fair,” he caved, content with this arrangement. “Can I keep helping you get dressed?”

As much as he liked seeing him in just his boxers, watching him slowly get dressed layer after layer was nice. Picking his shirt, buttoning his clothes, and maybe even brushing his hair and helping him braid it sounded nice.

“Yes, I’d like that,” he agreed. Phainon joined him as he slid the case open to grab a watch. “Put this on me.”

He took it, unlatched the back, and slipped it over Mydei’s wrist as the other man continued to pick out what he wanted to wear. When on, a couple of smaller things like rings, earrings, and his usually braid cuff filled his hand.

“Is this how you feel when you pick my outfits? Fulfilled?”

“Yes, but I also do it so I know other people are going to look at you walking by like I do.” Phainon rolled his eyes as heat tickled through his face. “Not that you give them *too much* attention, right?”

“I mostly ignore the flirting and glancing at this point, master,” he reassured him. “I dress for *you* and *your* arrogance… or whatever I like when you’re not around to pick them.”

“Me and my arrogance indeed,” he murmured, looking down at his body briefly. “I’ll text you an hour before I leave, that should give you plenty of time to prepare yourself for me. I expect you to tell me otherwise if your feelings change throughout the day.”

“I’ll be ready, master,” he promised him, already planning his day out in his head. “I want it.”

He couldn’t wait for later tonight.

—

As Phainon got dressed to go out, he sent pictures to Mydei the way he knew his partner loved. To be just a *little bit* of a tease, he showed him bit by bit in the mirror, from just standing in pants, to putting his shirt on, to the whole outfit at the end.

Mydei warned him once and once only: *do not send him nudes*. He was with his parents, and he did *not* want those kinds of pictures on his phone at that time. Any other time, sure. But not *now*.

After that, he kept them more innocent in nature. He showed him the pretty, fruity lemonade and tea drink he bought with the money he gave him. Mydei told him it was pretty looking too, telling him he liked the pink color from the raspberries.

And while Phainon walked into stores, he gave him a teasing little photo of the clothing rows before tucking it into his pocket. It let Mydei think and imagine what he could be coming home to.

He wasn’t exactly known to be the most fashionable person in his friend group, but that was simply because he didn’t really care. If he liked a color, he wore it. If he liked a style, he put it on. It was as simple as that.

Reason told him Mydei would like him in anything, but he wanted to look *good*. He wanted to do more than wear what he usually did or just strip down completely. Wouldn’t it be a little bit *lazy* to just lounge around in his underwear?

‘*Oh, you had a bad day because of an argument with your dad? Here’s a half-naked guy on your couch*.’

Well…

His head then shook.

As much as Mydei would probably *still* enjoy that, there was no effort or excitement in imagining that. He deserved *effort*. And as comfortable as being naked around him was,

Phainon wanted to be praised for wearing *nice clothes*. Being '*handsome*' in a nice outfit wasn't the same as being '*sexy*' in just his skin.

So he sifted through the racks at stores, picking up a pair of nice, dark navy pants. Those were all he managed to find at the first one, so he moved on to another quickly. But it proved even emptier.

Store after store, he stepped in, searched for anything that called his name, then found himself disappointed while going to the next.

At this one, he managed to find a nice body chain while walking. It wasn't something overly expensive, but it was still pretty. Dainty. Gold glittered under the store lights nicely, and the display model looked nice in them from where the dual-lined jewelry draped down the body, beneath the chest, and finally around the waist.

His body was bigger than the model's though…

Phainon glanced at the packaged chains beside the standee, noticed there were two sizes, and he grasped the bigger one, deciding to try it out. Things like this always had adjustable chains, so hopefully it'd stretch wide enough for him.

Mydei taught him not to be afraid of trying new things, that the absolute worst thing that could happen was he simply didn't like something. There was nothing to be ashamed of with him. He'd never ridicule him for exploring anything, as he'd instead praise him for being brave enough to step out of his comfort zone.

When paying, the girl at the cash register eyed him, but he paid no mind while sipping on the very last of his tea.

"I bet your girlfriend will like it," she commented, fingers brushing his own when taking it from his hand. It didn't even get to touch the counter. "I have one like this too."

"Is it comfortable to wear?"

"Definitely, but this size might be too big. Did you grab the wrong one?" She asked, and his head shook as the charge went through.

"Does it make any noise?" He wondered, completely focused on the idea of Mydei seeing him in it. Maybe he'd think he was handsome in chains like that too instead of just leashes, clamps, and cuffs. "Like, does it rattle? Or is it quiet?"

"Depends how loose it is. If her body fills it out more, there's less room for the chains to move around and dangle," she explained while ringing it up. "I can demonstrate for you if—"

"I don't need a bag or receipt. It's fine," Phainon cut her off as he handed her a couple of bills. "Thank you for your help! Have a nice day!"

He dropped it into the bag with his pants, then walked out the store happily. There was a little pep in his step as he went into the next one, hoping to find a nice shirt to wear with these

things. Maybe a nice button down, one that he can wear like Mydei does with the top few undone. That would be nice to come back to, right? Since Mydei *loved* his chest so much.

Solid colors were so boring though. Mydei saw him in black so often because of work, and white was a simple, boring classic. Then Mydei always wore red himself, and he really didn't think it'd match his blue pants. He wasn't a *complete* fashion disaster, after all.

While searching, he approached a white button down that hung neatly on a hanger. The fabric looked slightly sheer, and when Phainon put his hand behind it, that proved to be true. It wasn't entirely see through, just enough to notice.

Upon touching it, he realized the fabric wasn't itchy either. This shirt was soft, almost silky as he rubbed it between his fingers. Trailing higher, he found the price tag on it and then took a deep breath.

Why was a shirt that covered nothing so expensive?

But he kind of liked it.

This top would probably feel nice over his skin, and it wasn't as boring as a plain dress shirt. If he wanted to wear some basic corporate get-up, then he would have just raided Mydei's closet where he had seven different black button ups and even more in varying shades of red. His partner liked seeing him in his clothes *anyway*.

He also liked seeing him in black, but Phainon kind of liked the white one more… And he *definitely* did not have the money to splurge on both.

Staring at it, he picked up his phone and then snapped a quick photo of both side by side. His thumbs worked quickly to send the next text.

> *[Phainon: Super important. Black or white?]*

> *[Cyrene: White. I don't know why Mydei likes you in all black, but you can't dress for a funeral every day. There's gotta be a limit, Phai.]*

Phainon sifted through the sizes, grabbed one a size bigger than he typically wore since it was all they had, and then walked over to the line by the register without another word. That was all the convincing it took.

Mydei would like it anyway because it was on him. And if he decided he wanted to see it in black, then the next time he had money to spare, he'd just buy it in black too. No problem.

> *[Cyrene: Is this for your top secret date night tonight?]*

> [Cyrene: Wait! No! You can't get that! The garbage needs to go out and if you buy that then you won't be able to walk it out to the dumpster tomorrow.]

> [Phainon: Take it out yourself?]

> [Cyrene: You didn't deny what I just said?]

> [Cyrene: I know what you are…]

He laughed, then rolled his eyes over the text before putting his phone back into his pocket. One look raked over the white shirt, and he smiled before dusting it off. Excitement burned inside of his veins, or maybe it was the sugar rush from the tea, but he wanted to hurry up, grab whatever else he needed to get, then get back to Mydei's place.

—

Mydei did as he said he would. He texted him an hour before he decided to leave, adding that he fully expected him to uphold what he said he'd do. If not, his still-tender ass was going to get more spankings. And he didn't want that, did he?

No. Phainon was *good*. He acted out sometimes for the fun of it and walked Mydei's nerves to see how he'd react when he was too shy to ask, but ultimately, *he was good.* He *wanted* to be good.

Dinner was still in the oven when he went to get cleaned up. The whole house smelled of rich, red wine braised short ribs as they continued cooking and the garlicky potatoes he just finished. Because the food would take longer than his shower would, he left them there as he went about his business.

His dominant wanted him every bit handsome, obedient, and ready to accept whatever he threw at him. Mydei wanted him dolled up until he physically felt like the most attractive person in the world, and that meant soft skin freshly lotioned, cleaned head to toe, and hair done the way he liked.

With his lips scrubbed and chapstick rolled over to make them look more kissable, his new outfit and accessory wrapped over his body, and a nice cologne dusted over his smooth skin, Phainon felt like a man someone would risk traffic tickets for. He felt like Mydei would run a red light or speed down the street just to see him in person if he knew he looked this good. And Mydei was probably the *only* person in the world who had never gotten a ticket before.

This shirt was loose and comfortable, buttons undone at the top to show off both his day collar and the chain he managed to get clasped around him. Both glittered nicely, visible through his top from behind but not enough to warrant taking it off. Part of him worried it was going to be *too* transparent, but he liked the subtle blur of pink from his nipples that let

them be shown but not quite seen. He liked how the outline of his arms was visible but not suffocated within the sleeves or left completely bare like his other shirts.

After he was fully dressed, Phainon buttoned his choker back on and rushed to the kitchen. As carefully as physically possible, going as far as to tie Mydei's apron around himself, he pulled the dutch oven out, left it on a pot holder to rest, and began to make the accompanying sauce.

It was like Mydei knew when to come home too, like he controlled not just him but the traffic he got caught in as well. It almost felt like he *calculated* how long he'd take to get ready and finish dinner despite not knowing a thing about what he bought. Because the moment he clicked the stove off and untied his borrowed apron, the front door unlocked. Phainon heard his shoes in the doorway and the keys in his hand jingling as they swung.

A rush filled his chest—light, tingling, and warm. With it, nerves tangled inside of his stomach.

What if Mydei actually *didn't* like this? What if he was in a mood where he didn't want to talk unnecessarily, play around, or do this anymore? The kind of mood where he wanted to be left alone and not thrown into the middle of this domestic, part-roleplay and part-every day fantasy?

Phainon's feet slowed, and he prepared himself for the possibility of that being the case. Things got *really* sour *really* fast whenever Mydei's relationship with Eurypon came up. If he suddenly didn't want to do this, then as disappointing as it might be, they didn't *have* to. There were other things they could do together instead.

But that lingering fear was immediately washed away when he saw Mydei holding a beautifully wrapped bouquet in his hands. That black and gold paper, the curling red ribbons, and overflowing petals and leaves made his heart skip. For a moment, he even stopped *breathing* to stop and stare at him.

Mydei looked back at him, almost as frozen in place had it not been for the arm tucked behind him. It was hard to mistake that loud click of his lock in the quiet house.

"What is that glittering on your chest?"

"What are you holding in your hand?"

He glanced down to the flowers, and Phainon's hands lightly touched the golden chain dangling down his chest. They lined its delicate links, then dropped to the first button that was *actually* closed.

"I've never bought you flowers because I've been nervous of overstepping the '*money*' thing," he admitted. "But what Cassie said got to me… So, I bought them for you because you did all this for me tonight. You can call it '*spoiling*' all you want, but in my eyes, this is an exchange of gifts."

His lip curled upwards as he stepped closer.

“This whole look is for you,” Phainon shared with him, pulling his shirt open slightly so he could see where the jewelry rested over his bare skin. “I-I thought I’d step a little out of my comfort zone for you—for *my master*. I… kinda like the feeling of stuff like this on my body. Maybe it’s from all the ropes and harnesses we play with, but it’s kinda nice.”

His fingers then gripped his shirt tighter as he averted his gaze. Suddenly, he felt a little bit shy from being so honest, like a large spotlight was beating down over him.

“I thought you’d like it. You said you liked chains if they're attached to a collar or clamps, but… I can’t really give you that without going *way further out* of my comfort zone,” his nervous rambling started up as he second guessed his choice. “Is this okay? Are you happy with this? It’s for a girl, but I guess I thought… *I don’t... know*...—it was pretty on the mannequin. I thought it’d be pretty on me too.”

“Shh…” Mydei hushed him gently. Soon, his hand reached forward to pull him closer by the waist. “Hey, just breathe for me, Phainon. Why are you so nervous?”

Phainon shrugged unsurely. “It’s kinda a girl thing, right? When I got it, the girl asked if I was buying it for my girlfriend. Is it weird that *I’m* wearing it? It’s not like I wanna wear girl clothes or anything… There was like this *haze* over my head while I was out shopping and sipping on the tea you bought me. I just thought of you, what would please you, and what I liked for myself. *Kinda* like subspace, but… *not*. I don’t know… It’s hard to explain.”

His head shook, and Phainon looked back at him shyly as a thumb traced over the dainty chain through his shirt.

“I am attracted to you in whatever you feel attractive in,” he reassured him, speaking softly. “The fact you even felt like putting this kind of time, effort, and attention into me makes me so incredibly happy. My prince did this all to please me, and he even took a step to try something new for me. Do you like it? Do you feel good about yourself?”

“I-I do, master.”

“Then I love it. I love the way the gold color matches your day collar, and I love how it brings so much attention to your chest,” he noticed, eyeing the accessory with a pleased look in his eye. “And this shirt is driving me crazy. I can see everything I want, but it’s not as much as I want. I want *more*.”

Phainon smiled, then nodded in agreement as his insecurities lifted. “Am I being a little tease, master?”

A playful scoff followed. “‘*Little*’?”

He chuckled, closing his shirt before bringing his hands in front of him. For a second, they clasped together politely.

“Please touch me all you want tonight. I did this all for you.”

Mydei's eyes didn't leave. They stared at his body, taking in the exposed skin of his chest and collarbones. The hand on his side continued to lightly caressed him, thumb tracing back and forth rather than gripping him greedily.

"Please accept these in return for all of this, handsome," his partner offered.

Phainon took the bouquet into his hands, eyes shifting to look down at the array of flowers. Though he could only name the roses and baby's breath off the top of his head, there were still a few different kinds of flowers in varying sizes and shapes. Those, with all the added leafy fillers, made for a gift so gorgeous Phainon couldn't help but feel guilty.

His grin fell, and his bottom lip gave a little tremble as he brought his nose to the top. Breathing in the fresh and floral mist brought a little pit to his stomach.

These were *expensive*, and he knew it had to have been.

"Do you like them? Are they to your tastes, or should I have picked different flowers?" Mydei asked when he didn't speak.

"They're so beautiful." Phainon looked up at him while holding them closer. "Master, thank you so much. I love them."

Hearing that made Mydei smile proudly, and he leaned forward to press a chaste kiss against his lips.

"And welcome home. I missed you," he murmured next, wanting to make sure he knew that little detail.

Mydei kissed him even deeper, crunching the bouquet between their chests. With his hand freed from holding them, he cupped the back of Phainon's head to keep him from moving back too much.

"*Mmph…!* H-Hold on. I have to ask you something first." A turn of the head broke their kiss, and a soft, almost disappointed breath fell from Mydei's lips. "Before we get carried away like we always do."

"Yes, baby?" Phainon met his eyes as the hand on his waist lowered to hold his belt, opting not to touch his body. "What do you want to talk about?"

Upon looking at him now, Phainon realized that he had no reason to be worried whether Mydei wanted this or not. With his golden cheeks so red and darkened eyes so hungry, it was clear that no matter how bad his day might have been, he was ready to let it all go and focus on *them*. In fact, maybe the bad day drove him to want it even more than he normally would have.

They could talk about all of that *after*.

"My… uh… butt is still a little bit tender from the spanking," he said, but that only served to make Mydei laugh. "*Don't laugh at me!*"

“Is that all?” A light tilt lifted his words. “Alright. I’ll keep that in mind. But if I give you a little tap, won’t you like it?”

“Yeah, but—”

“No ‘*but’s*.” Mydei then reached to unbutton his own shirt. “Put your flowers in a vase while I prepare the bedroom. Join me when I call you—*only* when I call you. Do you understand?”

Phainon nodded quickly. “Yes, master. I’ll come when you call.”

“You’ll cum when I let you,” he said casually, walking away from him. “… *If* I let you.”

Oh. It was going to be *that* kind of night, the kind where Mydei gets his dominant kick out of bullying him a little bit, he gets pushed to the brink in the best ways possible, and they end up boneless in each other’s arms for a while to cuddle and come down. When Mydei whispered in his ear that he was hoping *sex* could be on the table tonight, he wasn’t particularly sure what to expect with it.

Sometimes ‘*sex*’ was Mydei simply playing with his body, making him finish, then ending it there without getting to do it himself. Other times it was him pushing him to his knees so he could fuck his mouth until he released over his tongue. Handjobs, blowjobs, grinding and groping on each other as they made out—they did things like that often whenever the mood struck. Things could be *sexual*, but never quite *all the way*.

Once did they have actual sex, and while everything else was perfectly fun, a part of him hoped tonight would be the *second*.

Judging by Mydei wanting him *prepared*, he could only assume, but it was exciting to both know and to be left guessing. It left a little tingle in his core, a little pep in his step, and a little breathlessness in his lungs all at once.

Calm. He needed to be *calm*.

Mydei wouldn’t play with him if he was too nervous.

Phainon took a deep breath, exhaled it slowly, then nodded to himself. He pulled a vase out from the very top of Mydei’s pantry, careful not to knock or drop the delicate glass. It was filled with water, then the carefully unraveled bouquet slotted inside. That pretty red ribbon was tied around the middle, its bow big and bright like the flowers above.

Fallen leaves and the discarded paper were tucked into the trash. Even if he had finished, he continued fluffing and arranging the display nicely until called.

“*Phainon!*”

“The next time I see you, I might be carried in his arms because I can’t walk,” he whispered, giving the flowers one last smell before sighing softly. His heart gave a kick, and he knew he’d like to give Mydei flowers too one day, but he never thought *receiving* them would feel this good. “Coming, master!”

Phainon didn't *run*, but he did hurry so as to not keep him waiting. His house slippers tapped to the floor quickly and heavily, and he hid his hands behind his back while stepping into the room. With his eyes on Mydei, he watched him slowly rub and dry one of his hands with a small towel. The ivory cloth rubbed up and down the lengths before circling over the nails.

"Stop," he instructed him before he came too close. "Turn around."

He obeyed.

Spinning to face the opposite direction, he let Mydei eye the way his ass looked in his dark pants—as that was what he expected his partner wanted. The hands behind him moved, resting in front of his hips instead to not obscure the view.

"I'm holding up a number in one hand. If you can guess it, I'll give you a reward." Immediately, Phainon began to think long and hard. "How many times did I get scolded for looking at my phone because of you?"

"Five, master?" He had sent him a lot of pictures throughout the day, some were read instantly and others not. "Was it the full five times?"

"*Ha*." That confidence and amusement didn't seem right. "Do you want to lock that number in?"

"Do I get punished if I get it wrong?"

"No. There will be no punishments tonight. Consider this a game. I'll reward you if you get it right, and if you don't, then maybe *I'll* get to do whatever I want," he brushed off. "Think, baby. How many times did you get your master in trouble by sending him all those cute selfies, hm?"

Phainon gasped softly in surprise when two hands touched his hips and pulled his body backwards.

"I like these pants on you, by the way. They make your hips look bigger," Mydei commented, bringing his hands lower. " And you always look so good in blue. What a nice color you picked out… It kind of matches my shirt today too."

He felt Mydei touch his thighs, gripping them around the outside before guiding his body to bend with his chest. Muscle pushed to his shoulder blades and places their bodies flush together

"Come on…" He goaded him. "Give me a number. You still have the ability to count, right? You did it *so well* last night…"

Oh…

Phainon's head was spinning already, and they had *just* barely started to do anything. The condescending tone and hints towards his spanking were making it difficult to think.

"Mm… I-I don't—*h-hah*—"

A firm palm pushed down on his crotch. It slid the heel along the seam of his zipper, fingers curling beneath to grope. They cupped deep enough for the tips to brush over his ass, then squeezed him within his fist.

"*Focus*."

"Master," he breathed out, grabbing his wrist and holding him gingerly. "What do I win?"

"You may have whatever you want out of me," he allowed. "I will do anything so long as it adheres to our rules. It doesn't have to be tonight either. Any night. Any day. Any time."

Anything?

Phainon thought back even harder to the selfies, the response patterns, the '*read*' receipts. He recalled when he mass replied to a series of texts, responding one by one to be sure everything was seen.

He wanted that '*anything*'. The last time he was given that choice, he orgasmed three times and had Mydei dressed head to toe in thick, sexy leather. Could he get Mydei dressed up like that again? Maybe even *more* since he liked it so much?

"Three, master," he answered, and Mydei hummed. "You got in trouble three times, then let the notifications pile up to check when you went to the bathroom or something. I know you."

"Do you?"

"Yes, master."

A chuckle filled his ear. "Is that your final answer? If you get it wrong, I might get to do whatever I want to you…"

That sounded good too. Mydei taking charge like that was always attractive, and he trusted him so much that he knew whatever it was would be both comfortable and exciting.

"It is."

"Uh-oh… It was *twice*," he *tsk'ed*, placing his lips behind his ear for a kiss. "My father scolded me twice for looking at my phone while with him because I couldn't help myself. The first one was when you sent me that shirtless picture, and the second was when you showed me a picture of your drink. Getting those updates made me so happy, and I couldn't help it.

Phainon smiled, happy that Mydei enjoyed his spam texts throughout the day. Even if he had told him he liked knowing everything about his day, it was always nice to *hear* as it happened. Mydei's enjoyment over *him enjoying himself* was always so cute.

Even if he technically lost, it didn't matter. Regardless of whoever won, technically, they were *both* winners as whatever Mydei wanted to do to him, he'd enjoy.

“I had to silence it.” Another kiss lower made his eyes flutter shut. “I had to sit there and pretend I cared about *golf*. What an exhausting day…”

Mydei’s mouth brushed his neck, and he moaned shakily while tilting his head to give him more space.

“So I’m not going to pretend that I don’t miss you wrapped around me, okay?” He whispered, cutting to the chase. “I’m not going to pretend it didn’t excite me all day to think of you all dolled up and waiting for me to pull you apart. It’s like a pretty present for me to unwrap, and I’m going to be careful with this effort, but not with you.”

Lost within his words, he melted even more against him. The nerves that once floated around the idea lifted, making his legs weak. His hands covered Mydei’s own over his body, following them when they touched his stiffened cock and cupped his chest from beneath his shirt. Two fingers circled around his nipple, teasing him with a slow and gentle trace.

“*Fuck, Phainon*,” Mydei exhaled, breathing in the cologne by his neck. “You’re so good for me. You’re so good *to* me.”

Phainon nodded in agreement. “I have my moments, master.”

“Yeah,” an amused and breathy chuckle followed. “Well, *more often than not*, you are the perfect sub to me.”

The hand on his chest raised, and he dropped his jaw when they tickled up his neck, beneath his chin, and over his lips.

“*Tongue*.”

Phainon licked, tasting his clean fingers and accepting them into his mouth. They pushed over his tongue, splitting and toying with it.

“Good boy…”

He was pulled closer, posture straightening with Mydei’s. As they stood back to chest, the hand that had been palming him through his pants touched his stomach.

“Have you been thinking about tonight too?” He asked, and Phainon nodded honestly. “Have you been wondering what I’d do to you? The possibilities are so endless, aren’t they?”

There really was so many things he could do. His closet was full of toys and gear, and he could do whatever he wanted to him with whatever combination. Because it was *Mydei* doing it to him, he knew it would be fine. Nerve-wracking, but fine.

“I want you bent over this time,” he said to him, giving him his chance to know what was going to happen before it did. “Hands and knees, chest and knees—it doesn't matter to me. I’m getting you on your knees, and I’m having this ass squeezing down on my cock, okay?

Phainon nodded as the fingers in his mouth thrusted lightly.

“Okay?”

The muffed ‘*ofay*’ in his mouth was the result of Mydei pushing deeper into it, and he moaned around him while gripping his wrist.

“Let go of me,” Mydei ordered, speaking gently despite the command. “Do not touch me. Listen and surrender.”

Both hands lifted off of him, twitching with the need to touch but knowing he wasn’t allowed to. They hovered, however, and Mydei didn’t chastise him except for when his fingertips were brought down a little too close.

“You’re going to make me feel good. After I finish, I will make you finish, do you understand?”

Phainon nodded again as another garbled ‘*ofay*’ followed.

“Take care of my needs, and I will take care of yours, okay?”

Again, ‘*ofay*.’ Only this time more spit rolled down his lips and chin, and soft suction sounds followed when he tried to suck it back in and swallow it down.

“Don’t get it confused though. I planned this since this morning,” he hinted. “When I come to collect my own prize of having you *however* I want, I’ll let you know. But until I clue you in, you’re going to get down on your knees and *kneel*.”

A light pressure brought him to his knees slowly, and because there wasn’t any kind of blanket, he knew it wouldn’t be for long. Both fingers in his mouth tilted his chin up and his head back, while his opposite one now pushed his shoulders down. That was when he heard a light jingle, and the familiar click of metal rings made him flick his gaze upwards.

“This is where you want to be, don’t you?” Mydei asked, ghosting his fingers over his folded collar. Once he found his choker, the button popped open. “You want to be with me?”

Phainon nodded quickly and excitedly. He sat higher on his knees, planted his hands on his thighs, and leaned back into the legs behind him as Mydei’s fingers raised free. They caught his choker before it could fall off his shoulder.

“I w-wanna be with you, master,” he promised, feeling as a firmer, thicker leather touched his neck.

Mydei’s lip curled gently, pleased. His hands then closed the collar around his neck, working to buckle it.

“You are so handsome, Phainon.”

“And I’m all yours, master.”

“I know. *Heh*… It’s funny… I grew up being hounded by this… this *eccentric* country kid who couldn't help but start a one-sided competition with me for the top spot in our gym

class," he chuckled lightly while tightening the accessory. "I helped him get his first girlfriend, talked him into trying out for the school football team, and even consoled him through his first breakup…"

Phainon watched him bend over. He felt him squeeze his cheeks once the collar was fastened around his throat.

"Then I got to be his first experiment with a man," he brought up, attention focused on his lips. "I got to be the one who introduced him to kinks and fetishes, who opened him up to accepting my dominance and finding enjoyment in submission, then helped him learn that he could *love it*… Tell me, do you love it, Phainon?"

A firm pound bumped against his ribs.

This sudden praise and reflection reminded him of the moment they were grinding on each other after Mydei got off the phone with his dad. It reminded him of sitting on his couch, kissing for the first time, and hearing him ask if he really wanted this, if he really wanted to be his collared submissive. The subtle tilt of insecurity in his quiet question made it obvious he wanted another hit of reassurance.

He thought of them in his bedroom too as Mydei told him that he wanted him to love *BDSM* with him. That fire in his eyes was hard *not* to be warmed by.

"I love it, master." His voice was firm and proud, promising. When he spoke like this, it was always supposed to be with his chest. And while sometimes he was too shy or nervous, right now, he was going to put his all in it. "I love being your submissive."

"I love you," Mydei said just as firmly. "Be still. Don't move until I allow you."

Lips pressed against his own, and when his own lightly pushed to accept it out of sheer reflex alone, a small slap clicked to his cheek. It stung over the plush skin, tingling in the same way his belly did.

"*Be still*."

"Yes, master. I'm sorry," he apologized. "Force of habit…"

Another kiss was planted on his lips, and it took everything in him not to kiss him back. Even if he was told there would be no punishment tonight, not being able to move right now was driving him crazy. It might as well have been a punishment.

Quiet whines climbed up his throat, and he parted his lips for him under the guise of taking a breath. Mydei then kissed the corner of his mouth.

"*Open*," he ordered next, and Phainon's lips widened even more.

This was torture. Having him kiss his bottom lip, kiss his top lip, bite over them, and lick into his mouth but needing to be still was cruel.

“Ah… please, master,” he begged, and Mydei grinned into his mouth. “Please, can I kiss you?”

“Yes,” he allowed, stopping just long enough to say it.

Phainon licked back, one hand raising to trace through the back of Mydei’s head. But before he could touch, he stopped. His fingers never met. Because he wasn’t yet told he could touch him, he wasn’t going to.

Instead, it lowered. Two fingers hooked into his own play collar, pulling on the rings as his tongue brushed over the one in his mouth. Lip to lip, they kissed each other’s mouths closed over and over again.

The hand on his chin lowered, touching down his chest to follow his bodychain. He pulled on it, wiggled it against his day collar, and then let go to instead palm his chest.

“Such a perfect chest,” he mumbled, breaking away to eye his body as he gave it a jiggle. “Flex for me.”

Upon feeling it harden, he moaned softly, rubbing up and down the firm muscle. He peeled his shirt lower down one shoulder, exposed more of the skin, then tapped. As he relaxed, a sudden slap made him gasp.

“Come on, get up before you hurt yourself,” he urged, then pulled away.

Phainon could’ve gotten up on his own, and there wasn't any kind of pain besides a hint of discomfort in his knees, but he took his hands anyway. He let Mydei lead him towards the bed, following eagerly.

It was then he noticed the towels laid out neatly by the clean bed and lube left out on the dresser. Besides both the bottle and his charging phone, a couple of condoms were placed neatly for use.

“Master, are we really going to do it twice?” He asked, eyeing both foil packets.

“*Precaution*.”

In the back of his head, he remembered the way Mydei was so adamant that they do it a specific way for the first time. Later, that same low, breathy voice had asked if he could finish *inside* of him to help get him off. And Phainon *did* want him to finish inside of him.

The thought made him look back at Mydei, eyes wide and doe-y the way he knew his dominant couldn’t resist. As busied hands began unbuckling his belt for him, his own fisted the blankets beside him to lean back.

“Master?”

“Yes, handsome?”

Phainon watched him take his belt off, set it on the floor, then held his hips out so he could undo his pants next.

“Do we have to use it?” Mydei blinked at him, one eyebrow raising silently to remind him of being specific. “Sorry. Um… a condom. Do we have to use a condom when we do this, master?”

Mydei slowly dragged his tongue over his lips, then looked down at his lap as if contemplating it. The hands unzipping his pants also paused, hovering over his bulge.

“Say it. If you can tell me *explicitly* what you want, I will grant it to you.”

It was nerve-wracking and a little embarrassing, but he gulped quietly. He tried to speak as clear, honest, and confident as possible.

“Master, can you please cum *inside* of me?” Phainon asked, and Mydei pushed him onto the bed. “*H-Hey—!*”

A heavy pant followed. “You have *no idea* what you do to me.”

Phainon laughed as a mix of emotions filled his chest. Arousal, excitement, nervousness, and amusement all bundled up with one another. Each was a rope, and they twisted and turned into a knot over how new this was and how much Mydei seemed to crave this.

Had Mydei been even the slightest bit less patient, this new shirt’s buttons would’ve been scattered all over the place. He moved so quickly and pulled so desperately on his body. While his clothes were safe, Phainon knew that *if* he could, Mydei would’ve torn them off and just paid for replacements. *He knew*.

The top was left unbuttoned, and amber staring at the way its sheer fabric hung off of one shoulder and opened up half of his torso. Gold glittered over his body. It sat around his neck on both of his collars, draped down his middle and around his waist in a body chain, and then embedded itself into his tattoos. Ivory hair beneath his navel and around his pelvis had been cleaned up and trimmed down just for him. Either nipple, pink and pebbled from interest, poked upwards to be seen.

Phainon dropped onto his elbows while showing himself off better, stomach lightly pulled in and shoulders back.

“Would you like me to help you here, master?” He asked, voice lowered as his leg lifted in between Mydei’s legs. The side of his calf rubbed up his thighs, then the top of his shin brushed against the obvious tent behind his pants. “It’s my responsibility to serve you. *May I, master?*”

Mydei grabbed his knee and hiked it upwards, bending and pulling it away so he could look between his legs.

“Turn around,” he demanded, pushing his leg to the bed. “Hands and knees.”

He flipped over, adjusting himself over the laid out towel.

“Mm… Open wider for me, ba—*there you go*. Look at these heavy balls and this big, hanging cock,” Mydei noticed, sliding his touch down both while his knees lowered. “This cute little hole is winking back at me too. It wants to be filled so badly, doesn’t it, *slut?*”

Heat burned in his face, head hanging down as his crack was opened up with a hand pulling one cheek back. *Everything* was open to him. *Everything* was so visible underneath the bedroom lights.

“Master, okay… okay, *wait*,” he panted, pulling himself back slightly. “Don’t look so close —”

There was no sound as he felt a glob of something hot suddenly touch his ass. The thick, wet trickle slowly dripped down his crack, down his hole, and toward his balls. Two fingers then picked it up and rubbed it over the puckered rim, massaging it slowly.

Was that *spit?* Did Mydei just *spit on him?*

“This is *mine*. I’m going to *look* at you," he protested, and Phainon gripped the sheets tightly. “I’m going to *touch* you. I’m going to pump you so full of cum my prince is dripping it as we sit and eat dinner later.”

Tingles erupted in his belly and groin, and his hole fluttered from the deep massage over it.

“Do you want that?”

“A-Ah, yeah… I mean, *yes, master.* Yes please,” he answered properly. “I… um… You can put one in. While I showered, I stretched myself a bit for you. One should be easy to… *t-to... —!*”

Another glob of spit sank over his ass, catching over the fingertips pushing beneath. One touched the middle of his ass and rubbed the spit around, slicking the hole.

“Let me be the judge of that,” he hushed, and Phainon’s eyebrows pinched as he eased his middle finger into him. “Are you *really* stretched, baby? Did you prepare yourself for me to slip in right away? Were you *that* desperate to have sex tonight?”

Mydei was too! He was the one who suggested it originally…

But as inch after inch of his finger slid deeper, the words grew caught in his throat. And as Mydei let go of his cock to grab their lube, squeeze some over his reeling finger, then push it back in, Phainon moaned.

“Still tight,” Mydei groaned quietly, pumping back and forth. “I don’t want to hurt you, so relax, baby. I’ve got you.”

He moved slowly despite his own neediness to feel him, and Phainon felt it. The tip of his finger rubbed up against his walls, pushing and circling to ease his body open. Sometimes it bumped to his prostate, nudging it weakly just to make him gasp before ignoring it again.

Lube dripped down his rim and taint, and the mess only grew bigger as more lube and a second finger slowly joined. Their stretch made his back shift as he whined softly, gripping the beddings tightly.

“Shh…”

Another hand touched his lower back, sliding over the subtle curve of his spine to ease it down. Gentle rubs coaxed him to arch it instead, and he pushed his ass out more while looking down.

“*Easy*,” Mydei purred. His hand guided higher, maneuvering Phainon’s body into whichever way he wanted to see it. “Relax, handsome. Keep your back in like this, and keep your ass out for me. You’re so sexy like this.”

“It’s… embarrassing, master,” Phainon whined through the pleasure, and Mydei chuckled. He kept his hand on his shoulders, rubbing them lightly to keep him soothed.

“That’s okay. You can be a little embarrassed or nervous, but I’m still not going to stop.” His ass tightened from that firm tone, clenching around the fingers buried inside. “I’m going to keep you on your hands and knees because it pleases me, and *you’re* going to keep *yourself* on your hands and knees because *you* want to please me too.”

“Yeah… Yeah, I-I wanna—” A moan broke his sentence up. “—please you, master. You always m-make me feel so good.”

“Spread your legs wider. How far can you stretch for me?”

Phainon pushed his legs lower, knees parting deeper. Once his cock kissed the towel beneath him and a dull pull ached in his inner thighs, he hissed quietly and pulled himself just a little bit higher.

“Good boy,” Mydei praised him, bringing his hand lower. “Hold yourself like this.”

“I can’t… do it all the way… I’m sorry.”

“I didn’t ask if you could. I said to go as low as you can, and this is enough.” His touch trailed over the thick, bare muscle. “Don’t over complicate things, Phainon. *Listen*.”

He moaned as his fingers wiggled, rubbing and curling into his sensitive walls. They massaged his prostate until he was shaking from the intense pleasure. They pushed as deep as possible and scissored apart to stretch him thoroughly for his lengthy cock.

“Are you listening?”

“Yes, master. I’m… I’m lis-sten—*a-ah!*”

Phainon’s words were broken up with a sharp and pitched moan when he began to wiggle his fingers inside of him against his prostate. Repetitive curls made his hips jerks and legs twitch, but Mydei held him still with a tight grasp on his thigh. Fingers dug deep in the muscle,

maybe tighter than necessary, but he didn't care. All that mattered was how *good* it felt to have him toy with his body.

"Move your hips," Mydei instructed him. "Back and forth. Fuck yourself on my—*that's it*."

He moved for him, pulling himself forward before rolling back. As he did so, those fingers continued to push him open and get his cock leaking.

"One more," he was told, and more lube drizzled over his filled ass. A third finger touched his hole, pushing in as he lowered himself. "Take it slow. Ease it in."

Phainon's jaw dropped from the stretch, and he panted softly as knuckles brushed his cheeks.

The way Mydei was preparing felt different than before. Granted, he had the added pleasure of multiple orgasms and dildo to open him up, but this felt so *sweet*. He was taking so much time to prepare him, to not slam against his lightly tender ass and reawaken the ache.

Mydei was so precise. He was so full of authority. It was the sexiest thing about him, and Phainon wanted *more*. He *needed* more.

"Master, can you please touch my cock?" He begged, but his thigh was caressed instead.

"No. I don't want you to cum until I do," he shot down. "You don't need to touch your dick yet, baby. Let it hang there all messy and stiff."

He whimpered pitifully, but accepted the cruel answer.

"Your ass is the star of the show tonight, and *if* you have the pleasure of orgasming from just your prostate alone—*take it*. But *if* you need to jerk off to feel good—*too bad*. I'll touch it after I finish," Mydei brushed off without any hint of mercy.

"Please keep f-fucking me with your fingers," he said instead, encouraging him to keep going.

"Does it feel good?"

Phainon nodded. "*So good*, master. Your fingers are *so big*."

"You take them so well, slut."

His eyes fluttered shut in bliss as a rush flooded into his body. Dropping from his hands to his elbows, he lowered himself down and pushed back against Mydei's fingers harder, faster, and more excitedly.

"This body was made to be fucked." Mydei's crude words made his cock twitch. "I wonder how much this little hole could take…"

"M-My master's cock is all I can take," he insisted over the wet squelch of him bouncing on Mydei's hand. "It's so big."

“Is it?”

“Yeah! Yeah yeah yeah,” he rambled, rolling his hips as three fingers seated knuckles deep inside of him. “I want it… Please, master. Can you please fuck me already?”

“I will. Give me a second.” Mydei’s wrist twisted, spinning his fingers before he pushed them apart. “You’re loosening up so well. Do you enjoy having me stretch this tight hole out?”

“Yeah,” he repeated, pitchy and lost in the pleasure of him continuously bumping his prostate. “I love it…”

With his fingers still inside of him, Phainon heard Mydei’s belt jingle lightly. The metal ticked. Its zipper ripped. Heavy fabric hit the wooden floor. Even if he didn’t see it fall, he heard its light thump. He heard the way they were kicked away.

Slowly, he pulled back, and Phainon leaned forward. A rush of lube followed, and an embarrassingly slick sound filled the room.

“*Don’t…!*” Mydei was holding him open, gazing at his gaped ass by pulling on the puffed rim. “*Don’t look at it!*”

“That’s *my* ass, baby,” he reminded him, still watching even as Phainon tried to tighten it. “I’m going to look, touch, and enjoy myself with it. Relax.”

Clicks of caps, a wet sounding glide, then hot skin touched that same hole. Mydei’s cock was thick, the head spongy and round, and his eyes fluttered shut over the teasing slap he gave it.

“Beg for me.”

“*Please*.” His hips twitched, jerking from the next tap of his heavy dick over his ass. “Master, please fuck me. I need it so badly. You need it too, right?”

More wet slaps made his balls tighten and cock twitch. Precum drooled from the tip steadily, the result of how desperate he was to finish while stretched full of him again. Just like before, he wanted Mydei to grip his body, hold him down to the bed, and fuck into him like he needed it.

“Are you my little slut?” Mydei asked, rubbing up and down his still stretched ass. “Are you going to take this cock until I tell you it’s enough?”

“Yes, master, *please*,” he stressed again. “I’m your… your slut, okay? I want you to… *fuck, master*… I wanna be used by you for a little bit. I’ve been thinking about you taking out your frustrations on me all day. Any bad mood you have, please use it to fuck me the way you need.”

“Spread yourself for me. Get on your chest,” he demanded, and Phainon dropped onto the bed before reaching behind him. Either hand held his ass, keeping himself open so Mydei could pump his cock slowly. The wet sounds and fingers bumping his skin made him shiver.

Phainon felt so dirty in this position. Being face down and ass up with his asshole gaped and crack spread by his own hands was more embarrassing than ever. Having Mydei stand behind him to watch and stare as he jerked himself off made his knees shift and heart pound. It brought a sense of powerlessness and vulnerability to him that he wasn't yet used to, and it was *a lot.*

But he took it. Phainon laid there obediently, aware that even if it was humiliating, Mydei was going to take care of him. He was going to watch the pulse of his walls attempting to hide himself, and he was going to listen to the breathy, humiliating things he said, but he wasn't going to ridicule him in any way he *didn't* like.

Mydei was *lucky* to do this with him, and he treated him like his body was the most precious gift. There was no reason to be embarrassed.

The hand not holding his cock rested over his hip, touching the bare skin and rubbing his thumb around slowly. Gentle pressure pulled him back, and he followed Mydei's silent guidance as much as possible in this position.

His cock was so much thicker than his hands, and Phainon was still slightly new to putting his body in all these positions. Pushing back, he felt his chest and jewelry slide on the bed and his back bend deeper. Both hands dug into his own ass, fingers embedded in the plush cheeks as it was being filled up all over again.

"You can take it," Mydei encouraged him when his breaths skipped and his body tensed. "You needed this, baby, and I needed this too. Take it for me."

Phainon's eyes screwed shut as he focused on the wet, hot stretch.

"There you go…" Mydei's voice was so hot, so smooth that he melted underneath it. "You've got it. Come on."

Deeper and deeper. Wider and wider. Those fingers did little to prepare him for the sheer depth, but he wanted it anyway.

"Oh fuck," Phainon gasped. "*O-Oh fuck…*"

Mydei kept pushing in slowly, stilling once his ass touched

"Mm… You're swallowing up my cock so well," he praised him. When a second hand finally touched his body, it was tacky but not quite soaked in lube like it had been before. "You can let go now, baby. Let me see this nice, plump ass. Grip the blankets if you need to."

Phainon did. He slammed his hands over his head, scratched his nails onto the comforter, and moaned brokenly as Mydei grinded in as deep as possible.

"*Master…*"

"Keep going," his strained voice followed. "You feel so good around me, Phainon. I can't believe how tight you are even after three fingers."

Phainon's walls tightened even more, muscles clamping harder, and Mydei hissed while squeezing his hips. Fingertips dug in deep, so deep the bones beneath ached.

"If you keep doing that, I'm going to cum early," Mydei warned him. "Do you want that, baby? Do you want my load so bad you'll make me cum before we even get to have any fun?"

Shaking his head, he laid his face down on the bed as shallow, gentle thrusts pushed in and out. His eyes crossed the mirror that usually sat by the edge of his bed in the corner of his room. It wasn't positioned for them as Phainon knew it was always there, but it did happen to show him exactly what he wanted. Now that he thought about it, was it always meant to be used for this? The angle was hard to explain otherwise.

He could see Mydei standing over him from behind, his arms straining from where navy sleeves squeezed his thick forearms. The buttons were undone, and his undershirt was raised half-way up his stomach to expose his tattooed hips. His golden necklace glistened. His heavy earring swung when he turned to the mirror, feeling his gaze.

Mydei's lip curled, and he straightened his back before meeting his eyes.

"Watch how I turn a spoiled prince into a dirty little slut," he instructed him, then rolled his hips forward. "Don't close those eyes. *Watch*."

Phainon watched him move. The scrunch of his eyebrows, the drop of his jaw, everything. Sweat glistened over his skin already, shining under the bedroom lights.

He was fucked faster, skin slapping to skin quickly and firmly. Each pump made his ass jiggle from the friction, and every bump left his cock bobbing uselessly between his legs.

"Do you see this ass? This is *my* ass." A spank clapped over his cheek, and Phainon cried out from the sudden impact. "*Fuck*. You sound so good like that, give it to me again."

He mimicked the pitchy cry again as he felt the tip of Mydei's cock dig in as deep as possible.

"*Again*."

Another one came as he reeled himself back and then shoved his hips forward into him, jerking him forward.

"*Master!*"

"Come on. Keep going. Show me you like having my dick inside of you. Show me how much you missed it," Mydei demanded, tearing his eyes away from the mirror to look down at where he was balls deep in his ass.

Phainon watched him with glazed eyes and a foggy head, focused on the way he was pounding into him like he couldn't help himself. The pleasure was mind-numbing, and it left a rush in his gut every time Mydei slid in deep and pulled himself out. Unabashed cries and

moans fell from his lips, echoing through the bedroom as their moving bodies shook the bedframe.

One of Mydei's hands soon left his hips and raised to his mouth quickly. Teeth then bit into the dark blond hair tie around it. He pulled it over his hand and stretched it with his fingers for use.

"Heh, don't look at me with *that* look in your eyes, boy," he mused, lifting the other hand to quickly tie the hair sticking to the sides of his face back.

"Me too," he blurted out. "Bite me too, master. Fuck me h-harder."

A deep and playful chuckle vibrated up his chest as he dropped his arms to his sides. Mydei fucked him without holding him, attention focused on his face.

"Do you remember your safeword, baby? Give me a color."

"*Green*, master," he answered, exactly where he wanted to be. "I want it. I want it so badly."

That navy button up was torn off his back the very moment he said his color, and his undershirt was ripped over head right after. While undressing, he was still moving his hips as if going a second without the friction would kill him. Not that Phainon was complaining at all about the repetitive smack of his hips against his ass.

"You have no idea how badly I've wanted to do this."

Mydei propped a leg on the bed for leverage, then reached for the back of his play collar with two fingers curled beneath. A tug had Phainon using his arms to help sit up, easing the pressure on his throat. But then he moved to yank when he was close enough, slamming his back into the firm chest behind him.

The white shirt he still had on fell down his arms and shoulders, held on only by the sleeves around his elbows and forearms. It left the skin beneath bare and ready to be both kissed and bitten, which Mydei did quickly. *Hungrily*.

He felt soft lips touch his shoulder, a tongue lick over his salted skin to taste it, then teeth as they sank in. Breaths fanned over him from the proximity, and muffled groans vibrated through his bite as he continued fucking him.

"*Ma-a-aster!*"

"I love hearing you call me that," he grunted, pounding deeply and quickly. "That's right, baby. I'm your master. I taught you everything you know about this, and there's still so much more to learn."

Phainon nodded quickly in agreement, unable to speak past his repetitive '*ah ah ah's* with every thrust.

"Like how it feels to be flooded full of cum," he said into his ear. "Tell me you want it."

"*W-Wa-ant it*," he forced himself to say, but the nearly incoherent sound made a flare of embarrassment hit.

Maybe he should audition to be a *pornstar* the way he sounded so damn pathetic as he was being fucked. Sharp and breathy, maybe even a little dazed, Mydei was forcing sounds out of him that he had never heard himself let out before.

"I'll give it to you. Every drop."

The hand not on his collar reached for his stomach, and Mydei pressed down on it to push him back with a bounce.

"This is where I'll fill you up," he promised, and Phainon moaned louder at the vulgarity of it all. These words, the roughness of his pace, and the way he bit into his body again, all of it was just *so much*. "If you like it, maybe I'll do it *twice* before I'm done with you."

Fuck.

Taking Mydei's load not just once, but *twice* sounded like too much. It'd be impossible to hang on that long when his cock was already leaking an uncontrollable mess. Did he want him to be bedridden completely tomorrow?

A pair of strong jaws bit down again on his shoulder to keep himself muffled, and the sudden pinch made him cry out. All of his senses were filled with Mydei—with *his master*. His body was engulfed in his touch and breaths clouded by the mix of worn cologne and musk. His head was full of how handsome Mydei had looked behind him and how pleased he looked to get his hands on him like this.

So in control, so quick to make his heart race, and so unbelievably *his*. It was *perfect*.

—

Mydei fucked him like an animal. He bit the places no one else would be able to see on his body, and he fucked him until his legs felt like jelly beneath him. His hands gripped and squeezed wherever he could, desperate to have all of him before they both got too tired to continue.

And Phainon was completely out of it after. With his head up in the clouds and words scrambled, there was no talking from his end for a good ten minutes. Even if questions were asked and reassurances were given, all he could do was croak and hum, thoughts emptied and body exhausted. Not that Mydei seemed bothered as he accepted his responses with a smile and a kiss to the sweaty forehead.

Being filled with his cum was a new experience, but he didn't really mind it. In fact, he kind of *liked* it. The mess was sticky, wet, and felt like it was going to rush from between his thighs when gravity pulled it down, but having it inside of him felt a little bit like a *prize*.

Having proof that he had made Mydei feel good was rewarding, just like the way it was when he flooded his mouth after fucking it.

Warm rags wiped his sweaty skin when they finished, and Mydei had him push the load out into the toilet after so he didn't need to deal with it at dinner. *That* was an experience he felt so utterly embarrassed by that the crushing weight of post-nut clarity made him *never* want to be finished inside of again.

But knowing him, he'd probably cave again if they had the time or energy to clean up. And knowing Mydei, he'd probably never turn the opportunity down if presented with it.

When they were ready for dinner, Mydei chose to reheat it for them both while Phainon sat on a plush cushion at the bar. It was always so heartwarming seeing Mydei rush to take care of him. And Mydei *always* rushed to take care of him.

"Master, how was your day?" He asked, resting his head on his hand. "You know, before you came home."

"Father always stresses me out," he shared monotonously. "He made me think of things I didn't want to, so I'm sorry if I was a little rough on you."

Phainon hummed, still a little bit dozed out of his previous subspace. "Don't apologize. I might have begged for it a little bit."

"'*A little bit*'?"

"… *A lot of bit*, but *who* was the one who kept asking me to beg?" He mouthed off.

"You are free to tell me '*no*'," he shot back, and Phainon shrugged at that.

He knew. He was always able to say '*no*' or give him a safeword regardless of how kinky or vanilla things were. He just didn't feel the need to.

"*That's what I thought*. You wanted it, so don't raise an attitude with me."

They shared a laugh together, and Phainon took that time to glance at the flowers beside him. One finger picked up a leaf drooping lower than the rest, and he gently traced along its spine as a silence fell over them.

"So what did the two of you end up talking about anyway?" He asked next, curious if it was something Mydei would like to get off his chest. "Work? Golf? Feelings?"

"Houses, kids, and potential spouses. I'm only getting older, so I should be more concerned than I am about those things," he admitted to him honestly, but he didn't quite sound *upset*. It was more so *resigned*, like he couldn't change it, therefore felt no need to be angry over it. "He wants me to start setting up the next chapter of my life. Before I get my next promotion, I should start setting some more money aside, look to rent this place out, then go look for a real house."

That was a bummer to hear. Phainon really liked this place, and Mydei had been living in it for the last handful of years. His condo had a nice view of the city, was in a good area, and had all the things someone might want included like an outdoor, rooftop gym that anyone could access whenever they wanted.

Sure, it was tedious to get groceries up the elevator sometimes and moving furniture up here was *horrible*, but actually being *inside* made it worth the hassle. The countertops and sinks were all pretty. The soft floors were scratch free without any creaking when walked on top of. The windows let in such beautiful light.

Mydei liked it too. He took such good care of this place. Moving out after being here for so long sounded bittersweet to Phainon, and it wasn't even *his* place.

"An entire house to yourself would be lonely," Phainon commented, not wanting to shoot the idea down even if it saddened him. "What would you do with all that extra space?"

"That's where kids come in, I suppose." Mydei's voice was tighter, but still not quite frustrated. "Not that I *want* any, but… why should *that* matter? I'm supposed to be the second coming of *him*. My achievements are *his*. My career is *his*. *I'm his*."

Phainon frowned, watching him set a whisk down. Both hands gripped the counter on either side of the stove, and his nails drummed over the stone.

"You know, you could turn one of the spare rooms into a home gym," he commented, trying to lift his spirits and get his mind off of it. "Then you won't have to worry about continuously wiping stuff down, and you could work out however you like without other people around. And maybe you could get a place with a pool for when it gets hot here, since you don't really like the one here."

Mydei inhaled deeply, exhaled slowly, and then nodded in agreement. "Would *you* use it if I get one?" He asked after.

"Master, I'm *not* skinny dipping at your house, if that's what you're thinking right now."

"Hm… What's the point of a pool then?" He joked, and Phainon rolled his eyes. "I will admit, the idea of a house is nice. I could have a room specifically for my *BDSM* things."

His eyebrow then raised. "Yeah?"

"I've always wanted to get specific furniture pieces for kink, but I feared someone would happen to see them and recognize them," he confessed. "Like a swing."

"Mm…"

Upon recognizing his quiet confusion, Mydei finally turned around to face him.

"You bolt it into the joists in the ceiling, and it comes down to a leather seat with four heavy duty chains…"

Mydei's hands moved as he continued to explain what a '*swing*' meant in this scenario, and Phainon watched intently to try and envision it. He listened to him say that it was meant for him to sit in and possibly be restrained in, that it was supposedly more *exhilarating* to have sex in it rather than just laying on a bed or sitting on a couch. The position would be different, the height would be adjustable, and there was the added bonus of just being exciting because it was somewhere different.

He seemed to be *really* into the idea of having one.

"I'd also like a more open area for things like my boots and my harnesses. A small closet with just my kink clothing sounds nice," he added thoughtfully. Phainon could get behind something like that. "Hiding it in a locked cabinet feels a bit… shameful. I'm not ashamed of it, and expanding my collection is something I've always wanted to do. That small cabinet would be too small soon."

Phainon smiled softly, endeared by the rambling. Despite the nature of his subject, it was cute to listen to him.

Mydei could display his books and guides on a nice shelf, then add more that he happened to find over time. As of now, he usually forgot they existed not only *behind* a sealed door, but at the *bottom* of the cabinet. There'd be more room for him to get more leather clothing for both of them, like vests, underwear, and more pants. Maybe boots too. The toys he kept could have their own respective spaces, separating things like dildos and ball gags better in case they decide to get more of either in the future. Specific towels, blankets, and other things could be kept there, not to be confused with the things they use for their own bodies and guests might borrow when staying over.

There was a little bit of a sparkle in his eye. His hands shifted quickly as if he could vividly imagine it all, drawing horizontal lines in the air to mimic clothing racks and vertical strikes when talking about hanging up his gear. A bed didn't need to be in there, but maybe it would be nice so he could stop worrying about the place he slept getting filthied from sex. It didn't need to be top notch or big, just big enough for them with hooks for bondage.

"Oh, wait…" Mydei backtracked, lowering his hands and balling his fists. "*You* are my partner. I should ask how you would feel about these things too, as my things are yours as well. Maybe this is too far…"

He suddenly looked like a kicked puppy, and Phainon pouted for a moment.

"No. I like it when you're fired up like that," he reassured him. "Master, if you want to put me in a kinky swing some day, I'll try it… But *you* need to sit in it first to make sure it doesn't come crashing from the ceiling, *then* I'll trust it to carry me."

It wasn't that he didn't trust Mydei in finding and drilling into the wood, as he knew how to do it himself from putting up a floating chair for his mother to read in at one point. However, something about how fast they move and how fragile some houses were just… made him nervous. The last thing he wanted was to fall and break something while having sex.

How humiliating of a trip…

“What about seeing things like that out in the open? Are you okay with that?” He clarified, and Phainon shrugged.

“If it’s in another room behind a locked door, I don’t see why you can’t have shelves, racks, and things on display. It’ll be hard going to bed at night with a *BDSM* swing staring at me, so please don’t install it in your bedroom,” he suggested, then slowly stood up off of his seat.

Despite the wobble in his legs, he walked up to Mydei and wrapped himself into his body. Both arms held him tightly, and Mydei did the same back while hiding in his shoulder. Nose to his shoulder, Phainon took a deep breath and leaned into the side of his head.

“I love you,” Mydei said gently, and Phainon returned it as they stood in each other’s embrace. “Is this really okay with you? Or am I being a pervert by imagining a room dedicated to my kinks and fetishes?”

It was a lot to think about for himself. Phainon would’ve *never* considered such a thing in a place of his own, but he understood the desire that drove it.

Artists wanted art studios for their canvases, pastels, and paints. Musicians wanted sound booths to record their guitars, loop their beats, and block the noise from others. Dominants wanted their own spaces for all their toys, clothes, and gear as well—especially someone like Mydei who always wanted to have his things organized in a certain way.

This was a big part of their relationship and his life, and it was something important to him. If Mydei wanted to display his things proudly in a house he would be paying the bills for, then he should. That was his right.

And Phainon knew how much he liked these things when he declared that he wanted to be his submissive forever anyway. It wouldn’t be fair of him to pick and choose when Mydei could show off this side of him in his own home.

“Are you gonna put that cool little electronic lock on the door too? Or is a simple key good enough?” Phainon played with the idea, and Mydei held him tighter. “Is it gonna be just for sex and sexual things?”

“We can go in there whenever we feel like it,” he brushed off. “Oh. And I’d like a big mirrored closet door too.”

“Oh my—*Master!*”

“I like seeing you from all angles,” Mydei said simply, bringing warmth to Phainon’s cheeks. “Maybe a house doesn’t sound so bad… What a shame that if I bought one, I’d be pushed even harder to find a girlfriend.”

“*Yeah*…” Phainon hated that. “*That’s frustrating*…”

Mydei shrugged weakly as his head turned. “I’ll… think about it… I can drive him off a little longer, and we can keep doing our thing. I wonder, if I do get that house, can I actually get you to go skinny dipping with me…?”

“The satellites in orbit take pictures of us *all the time* when we’re outside, you know,” Phainon reminded him, but his partner only laughed at his serious tone. “Someone’s going to search your address and see us naked in your pool. How would you feel if everyone could see us?”

“*NASA* would be very lucky to see your handsome body,” he brushed off.

“*Master! Have some decency!*”

Both hands rubbed up and down his back, then raised to touch his collar. They curled around the leather, cupping over its surface as he pulled back to look him in the eyes.

“I’m kidding,” Mydei hushed, then kissed his heated cheek. “Go sit down, and let's have dinner now, baby. Thank you for cooking tonight’s meal. It smells amazing.”

Pride flooded his chest as he smiled from the praise.

“I did work really hard, and I saved us a little bit of the red wine to share,” he brought up, and Mydei gave a short glance to the bottle on his counter. “Can I have a glass of it with you, master?”

“Sex, wine, and dinner with my handsome man… I could get used to this…”

“It’s like a date night at home,” Phainon added, amused by his suggestive tone. “But, to be honest with you, every time you cook something elaborate for us, it *always* feels like a dinner date.”

“Would you like to go on one then?”

“*Huh?*”

“A date,” he clarified, not that Phainon needed it. He just couldn’t believe what he was hearing right now. “You’re always so quick to always indulge me—to talk dynamics, rules, punishments, and kink. Phainon, I should meet you in the middle so you don’t lose what *you* value in a relationship too, right?”

His head tilted slightly in both surprise and confusion. “You… wanna go on one? I thought you were happy with just this?”

At his big age, was Phainon *supposed* to be getting butterflies at the thought of a date with the man he was having sex with and spending all his free time around? They’ve done so much together already as a couple, was it *supposed* to make him tingle inside to think of something as cheesy as a date?

When was the last time he even went on a date?

“Before starting this with me, that was what you wanted from a partner,” Mydei recalled, which was true. Phainon *did* like to go on dates—if the ‘*talking stage*’ ever got far enough for one. “Speaking to my father today made me realize that I can’t accept you sacrificing those old values. Even if I trust you when you say you’re happy with this, it’s unfair that our

relationship fulfills all of *my* wants but not all of *yours*, just as it's unfair for him to push *his* life on me when *I* want something else for myself."

"It's okay, my love. Our friends call us boyfriends already, and what's really a '*date*' in this day and age?" He tried to lighten the mood again with a chuckle, not wanting to end their days with the suffocating feelings of inadequacy.

They were having a good night so far too. They exchanged their gifts, had incredible sex, and he felt closer to him than ever after spending so long being cuddled and pampered by him. He really didn't want Mydei to get too caught up in not feeling good enough for him like before.

"Besides," Phainon quickly continued. "It feels like every time we get together, we're doing things other people would consider a date *anyway*. Just because there's not an explicit title on it, it doesn't mean the same thoughts and feelings aren't there. Talking over dinner is the same whether it's at a restaurant or at home."

"It's not good enough," he protested immediately. "I want to be the '*boyfriend*' you tell your parents about when they ask about your love life. You're close with them, and I know you've always wanted your parents to like your partner… *My* strained relationship with my father doesn't mean I have to keep *you* from confiding with *your* own."

Phainon swallowed. "I… I can tell them about us then?"

He wasn't sure how they'd react, but he trusted them. His mom and dad did everything to make sure he was happy and healthy, and they supported him through all of his choices in life.

When he said he wanted to go to a big school and learn a lot of things as a kid, they packed their bags and moved to the city to try and make more money than just growing vegetables and fishing. They helped him go to college and let him live at home as long as he needed. *If* he didn't have a place and Cyrene decided she wanted to move out, he was sure they'd *still* let him have his old room back in a heartbeat.

They loved Mydei as his friend, and they'd love him as his partner for how well he treated him. Now that really thought about it, he trusted them with that.

"You can tell them after I take you out on a real date," he answered, and Phainon felt his lip twitch upwards into a smile. "What is your dream date, baby? I'll make it happen for you."

Could his heart be anymore full?

"Anything with you is my idea of a '*perfect*' date," he said honestly, not really picky with what they would do together. "Dinner at home could be a date. Playing board games with each other could be one too."

But Mydei shook his head, uninterested in those suggestions. "No. A date should be romantic and special, something different from what we do every day. We eat dinner and lounge around at home all the time, so it doesn't sound right inside of my head to make that our first date."

Ah. How could he have forgotten? Mydei's never been on a date, and his idea of '*romance*' included grand gestures, a lot of money, and a lot of gifts. Floral arrangements, imported chocolates, aged wine, and Michelin-star restaurants were Mydei's vision of '*romance*'. His casual, everyday romantic gestures of holding doors open, cooking for him, and praising him weren't '*romantic*' in his own eyes. They were a '*given*', an '*expectation*'.

Chivalry was expected of him. Respect and consideration were the bare minimum to him. No matter how Phainon saw him, Mydei cooked for others and behaved that way so often that they began to feel *mundane*.

So, he sighed, then nodded in resignation.

"My one request is to keep the expenses low," Phainon brought up immediately. "Don't try to spend hundreds on a fancy dinner for us. I don't care for an expensive steak dinner."

"Then… what am I supposed to…?" Mydei trailed off, and Phainon couldn't believe he clocked his plans *that* quickly. "Dating is confusing…"

Two hands cupped his cheeks, and lips pressed to the tip of his nose.

"But I'll figure this whole '*dating*' thing out for you, baby. I'll watch movies, read books, and research things to do that might suit both of our tastes." His voice was soft and genuine, speaking as if reassuring him that he'd do anything to make sure *all* of his wants and needs were met.

And… *yeah*. Maybe a part of him really *did* want to be able to go out on a date, a *real* date, with Mydei asking and everything. Which was why he didn't try to fight so hard to deny him.

"But your dad," Phainon said quietly. "You're not worried about someone seeing you and telling him?"

"No. I'll come up with something for us, so trust me. Let me prove that it's not just *talk* when I tell you I've got it," he soothed his worries.

"I do. I trust you with everything."

"Thank you. Knowing you feel that way brings me more confidence in myself." Mydei gave him a kiss on the cheek after. "Come. Let me make your plate and pour our glasses."

A pout tugged on his lips. "But I wanna do that…"

"Then *you* pour our glasses, *I* will make our plates, and *we* will spend the rest of our night talking, cuddling, and being close to one another," he said finally, leaving no room to protest. "Is that better?"

"Yes, it is," he agreed happily.

There were so many things they could do together. There were so many places they could go that wasn't some overpriced restaurant where four bites of food cost an arm and a leg.

Maybe Mydei would want to go to a museum or aquarium, then take a walk around the park as he liked art and history. They could go see a local band perform, and they could have a casual meal after. Or maybe he hated golfing with his father, but he'd enjoy a little bit of competitive mini-golfing with him. There was also bowling if he didn't want to golf.

Mydei was an active person too. He liked being outside and constantly moving his body. Maybe they could take a drive and go for a hike together, then a picnic at the top of wherever they went. Maybe they could pick Khas and Reaver up from his parents, then go for a run with them at the park and get some ice cream after.

There were so many options, and each one of them made him more giddy than the last to think about.

Chapter End Notes

house husband roleplay. mydei. just admit ur whipped like some cream and ask him to move into ur new house smh.

and this mydei would definitely have his own bdsm room and a bunch of machines/furniture for it.

phainon would have his own rack of clothes for playtime too, ranging from harnesses to sexy lingerie once he get more comfortable in his skin. u heard it here from me, sleep deprived author.

Chapter 28: Chapter Twenty-Eight

Chapter Notes

> this is kinda all over the place, i think. i had a lot of ideas but i wanted to fit it into one chapter because i have specific cute and kinky plans for the next few.
>
> ive been up since 2am working, editing, and cleaning this up. 10am now. hhh, my brain is fried

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei really did study up on how '*proper*' dates were meant to go in the next week of hanging out. The movies they watched in bed after dinner were mostly old rom-coms Mydei never bothered to watch, and the videos that played too loudly on his phone when he was in the bathroom were on what was considered '*romantic*'.

Phainon had to stop himself from laughing every time he was in bed waiting for him to come back.

Most people played games on their phone. He had his own little selection of phone games to play. Yet his partner was studying up on learning that he was casually doing '*dating*' things without ever officially dating anyone. It was so dorky that he couldn't help but fall even more for his oblivious lover.

Truthfully, Phainon never thought he would be the one being asked out on a date before either. When it came to talking to girls, he never expected them to do more than possibly try to talk to him. After that, it was *his* job to be Prince Charming and make their plans, and it was *their* job to be his princess and possibly accept his advances.

So to watch Mydei's gears spinning was amusing and charming all at once. He was usually someone who knew what he wanted and went after it. This unprepared side of him was hardly ever let out unless it was a short-lived accident.

Phainon enjoyed watching the movies with him even if they were cheesy, chatted about the videos when he had questions about dating etiquette, and clarified any kind of personal questions he had. Like *no*, he didn't mind if people saw them out together. Phainon was never particularly secretive about liking men, and it just so happened Mydei was his first actual male partner. Then *yes*, he would prefer to keep things on the more casual side of things. Nothing expensive. Nothing overly flamboyant.

While lounging around at home with Cyrene later that week, he felt his phone buzz from between his thighs. It was Friday night, they had '*Mean Girls*' on in the background to laugh at every so often when she needed a break from writing, and a bowl of fruity rings to share between them both—a treat he had to ask Mydei permission to have.

Asking permission for things when they were apart had become second nature at this point, and he liked it. If it were up to him, he'd snack and snack all day and all night. Why not? They only lived once, and it wasn't as if he didn't regularly exercise. If it wasn't visible, then was it really that bad for his health?

But Mydei cared enough about it for him, and Phainon cared about both his opinions and his decisions. He didn't need him to play doctor without a degree, but it gave him a little rush to know his lover would tell him when he felt he was indulging too much. That was better than him not caring at all about his health.

While looking down at his phone, at the photo of Mydei sleeping with his Cinnamoroll plushie, Cyrene giggled. One of her fingers lowered her glasses to admire it better.

"Uh-oh, the hubby needs you," she teased, and his eyes rolled as she swiped a watermelon ring from the bowl. Without asking, it slipped over his fourth finger on his right hand. "I now pronounce you husband and husband, you may kiss the groom!"

Phainon laughed, then raised the ring to his mouth for a bite while holding his phone to his ear.

"Hey, my love. 's up?" He asked in between chewing, then hummed. "Mm… Wait. 'm sorry. Lemme' finish."

Mydei didn't like him speaking with a full mouth because it was disrespectful, so he swallowed. His tongue then licked at the sugar coating his finger to clean it up.

"Okay, I finished. Hey, my love," Phainon repeated. "What's up? Are you getting ready for bed already?"

"Tomorrow…" Mydei said, then gulped. There was a hint of nervousness in his hesitation, one he didn't usually exude. "Tomorrow at exactly three in the afternoon, I'm going to pick you up. We're going on a date."

Cyrene leaned in closer to sneak a listen, and he pushed her shoulder gently before looking up at the television. Not that it stopped her from trying to eavesdrop.

"Three?"

"Yes. Wear something casual—shorts, preferably, but anything you feel good in," he instructed him firmly as Phainon pushed Cyrene away again before she could hear something she didn't need to. "Bring a jacket though, or don't if you want to borrow mine. You know I'll give it to you if you ask politely."

His lips curled into a smile at how his partner even had something like that mapped out in his plans. The cliche '*take my jacket if you're cold*' was the sweetest, cheesiest, and oldest move in the book, and Mydei just told him not to bring a jacket if he wanted his.

He was crossing a jacket off of tomorrow's outfit. Mydei's would be his by the end of the night.

“Do I get to know what we’re doing?” Phainon wondered, and Cyrene set her laptop while leaning back in.

Mydei hummed curiously. “We’re going on a date. Wasn’t that already clear?”

“*Where* on this date, my love? What are we doing?” He specified, causing Cyrene to wave her hand frantically while looking at him. “Can’t you tell me? Or is it a huge surprise?”

“Oh. I’m going to make it a surprise.” Phainon mentally groaned, disappointed he didn’t get to know. “You’ll know when we get there. There’s only so much we can do, and my man’s not that dumb.”

“Anything with you is perfect.”

They could go sit at the park to feed ducks, count clouds, eat hot dogs from the corner vendor, and crunch on ice pops from the ice cream truck for all he cared. As long as Mydei was the one he did it with, nothing would be boring.

But Mydei didn’t share that sentiment.

“That makes me feel like all this effort I’m putting in isn’t worth it,” he commented, and his eyes widened over the brutal honesty. “If anything will be perfect, then why try so hard to get it right? What’s the use if you’re satisfied with the bare minimum?”

Phainon couldn't help but realize he was right. Mydei was putting so much effort in because that was the kind of guy his lover was. He put his all into the things he did, and he liked to know his efforts were both well received and worth the attention to detail.

Instead of brushing it off as unnecessary, he should be grateful for how much he cared to get it right.

“You’re right. I’m sorry,” he apologized gently. “What I meant to say is that I’m *excited* to see what you have planned for us, and I *trust* you for whatever it is. I’m sure you came up with an amazing plan.”

“I hope it isn’t too boring or simple. It feels… like I could be doing more.”

“I’m sure it’s going to be everything we want it to be and more,” he insisted, already mulling over possible date ideas in his head. “Is there anything I can do to help? Should I bring anything?”

“I’ve got it. You just need to be ready on time and tell Cyrene you’ll be back on Sunday,” he brushed off, and Phainon flicked his gaze up to his best friend who was still cheesing over the word ‘*date*’. “Understand?”

“Yes, my love.”

Mydei hummed quietly. “I love you, handsome. I’ll see you tomorrow.”

“I love you too. I’ll see you tomorrow,” he returned, listening as Mydei hung up. Once he pulled the phone away, Cyrene bounced up and down on their couch hard enough to creak its wooden frame.

“*Phainon’s got a date! Phainon’s got a date!*”

“Shut up,” he laughed, and Cyrene poked his red hot and rounded cheek with her long nail. “C’mon… He and I have been seeing each other for so long, why are you making a big deal about it?”

“Because you’re as red as a strawberry right now!” She pointed out, and he lifted his shirt collar over his face while rolling his eyes. “It’s so cute! Phainon, I’ve never seen you blush this badly before!”

“*Stop!*”

But he knew she was right. He even felt hot in his face right now, like his skin was melting off of his bones.

“Where are you going? What are you doing?” She pressed, and he glanced away from her. “I bet you Mydei’s going to go all out if he’s making it a big deal to call you beforehand. He seems like the type to do all these grand gestures for the person he loves. You know, roses, chocolates, candles, everything!”

Oh, he was. Even if he didn’t plan dates like that, Mydei was still the kind of guy to worry if he had enough lit candles or if a patch on the floor had too little flower petals on them. Phainon could imagine him contemplating heavily over what time would be appropriate for them to go out, or whether it was too soon to buy him another bouquet of flowers when the ones he had were currently sitting pretty on his coffee table. Maybe he’d even pace a store aisle trying to decide what sweets to get him as a gift for simply showing up to open the door —as if things like that even mattered to him.

Mydei was an idiot. He was a confident yet nervous, proud yet shy, handsome and bumbling *idiot* who wanted him not to worry about a single thing. In turn, that then met he had to do the worrying and planning.

Phainon loved him. He loved him so much that this could be the worst date he ever went on and it’d still be better than any one he’s ever been on because Mydei was trying so hard. They could blow a tire, get caught in the worst traffic imaginable, trip and fall and end up in the hospital, but it’d still be worth every moment.

Even an injured Mydei would still look at him and ask if he was okay first. He would still do all he could to keep him calm first and foremost.

Phainon really loved him so much.

“What do I even wear? I don’t know where I’m going,” he mumbled. Immediately, the eyes beside him lit up as Cyrene jumped onto her feet. “No! That’s not an invitation to—!”

Their bowl of peach rings was picked up and set on the table, and he cringed from the loud clang of porcelain meeting glass. But before he could scold her for being so reckless, she hit the power button on the television. One thumb jabbed into her own chest.

“And this is what totally awesome best friends like me are for!”

He was pulled off of his couch and rushed to his bedroom before he could even laugh. The lights were flipped on with a harder thump than necessary. His bottom bounced over the bed from the force in which he was pushed, and Cyrene threw the closet door open with an excited ‘*bang*’.

“Why is your closet cleaner than mine?” She demanded immediately, both hands on her hips. “Mydei did this when he was over, didn’t he?”

“No, I’m just not as messy as you are,” he corrected her. “I also know how to donate clothes to make room for ones that *actually* fit—”

“I’m not listening!” Her hand waved at him dismissively. “I’ll lose weight, and those dresses are going to be super cute again.”

“Uh-huh…” He didn’t believe that one bit. “We aren’t twenty-one anymore. Put them to rest, ‘rene.”

An offended scoff follower. “*You’re* not twenty-one anymore.”

Phainon rolled his eyes, watching as she sifted through the hangers, examined different clothing items, then tossed things his way. They collected beside him, filling his bed with smaller options to choose from.

“I’m not trying all these on. I’m not a Ken doll.”

A look was thrown over her shoulder, one that read, ‘*are you testing me?’*

“Dress up, and I’ll bake that cake my mother always did when we were growing up,” she bribed him. “The one with all the hidden veggies, and nuts, and chocolate—”

“Deal,” he said instantly, not needing any more incentive. “But you have to make it the way auntie did where the edges got a little burned to the paper—”

“—so we can pick it off—”

“—and eat the crunchy parts.”

Cyrene laughed with him at the memory, and she threw a flannel at his face while smiling sweetly.

“Go on. Shoo,” she waved him off, and he looked down at the blue and black shirt in his arms. “I expect pictures for the future wedding montage. I want to see it all—including you two being sickeningly in love.”

“He likes when I wear black, so let’s respect that.”

“*Ugh*.” That groan came from the depths of her chest. “*Fine! I guess!*”

She was so stupid sometimes, but it was so nice of her to chill the thrumming anticipation and nerves he had for tomorrow.

—

That next morning, Phainon did his little stretches, ate his pre-run snack with a cup of tea to wash it down, then went on his usual morning run. With his earbuds turned up and his mind focused on later tonight, he was more pumped than usual. He even went for another mile just because he felt great.

The sun felt brighter overhead, but not overbearingly so. The park looked more green and full of life as squirrels skittered about, ducks swam in a line down the large fountain honking at each other, and birds chirped happily. Some people were doing the same as him with their dogs on leashes, and they waved kindly or chatted at the street lights before moving on.

Everything suddenly felt more *alive*, as if today was meant to be wonderful for everyone around.

When he was coming back, he shared the experience with Mydei. His fingers typed quickly over his screen, telling him all about the kind girl he met with her adorable pet, the squirrel with fat cheeks that looked at him when he paused to skip a song, and how good he felt both physically and mentally.

Like Mydei always did, he told him he was happy to hear him having such a good day. He mentioned that he was proud he ran longer than usual, but to take it easy and not push himself too hard.

Phainon noticed three little redheaded girls standing around the mailbox once he got past the gates, then texted Mydei to give him a second. They all looked worried, and he had plenty of time to help someone out before needing to prepare for his date. Maybe they needed assistance in mailing a little letter, or they lost a toy somewhere in a bush or down the street.

It wasn’t as if he didn’t know these girls. He saw them every now and then on his runs as their family was the ones who helped him take care of the stray cats around.

“Oh! Mr. Snowy’s back!”

He nodded, watching as one with a little braid in her hair ran up to him with a familiar looking orange cat. The poor then was being held by the ribs, arms up and belly wobbling side to side with her rushed steps.

“M-Mama said they’re gonna get rid of them!” She cried loudly, and he tilted his head curiously. “‘cause they have no home, they’re taking them all away! They’re stealing them!”

… Huh?

“They’re going to a ‘*shelter*’,” another one wearing a flower crown corrected her, holding the smallest one like a baby in her arms. “They started collecting the stray kitties and putting them in a big truck.”

Phainon frowned, bending over to give the cat Mydei had taken a liking to a pet. His ‘*meow*’ sounded low and slightly annoyed as he squirmed.

“Are they?”

There were a lot of stray cats around. All of them hid in bushes, under cars, and even on the balcony of the first floor tenants. He could see how it’d be annoying after a while, especially since he started hearing cats crying outside of his window most nights. No doubt, they just kept having kittens too.

“We stayed next to them so they didn’t pick them up! These are ours! They can’t just do that!” The last triplet insisted, her little fist on her hip as the mother cat stood by her side proudly. “So we need your help!”

“Me?” Phainon asked, pointing to himself. “What can I do?”

How much more a month was it to add a pet to his lease again? Would Cyrene even *want* a cat around?

“Mama said we can only have two of them because *Trinnon* already has a puppy!” One said accusingly.

“Yeah, and you’re the only one who helps us take care of them! No one else feeds them or even cares!” Another insisted, stomping her little shoe to the pavement. “You have to help us, Mr. Snowy! We even told mama that we’d wait until after your run!”

“Please take one! That way we can keep them together forever and ever! If not, they’re gonna steal them and we’ll never see them again!”

All three of them couldn’t be any older than seven or eight years old, and they looked so cute staring up at him side by side. Their big, doe-y eyes as blue as the sky and rosy cheeks made them look like little dolls in the flesh, and the determination to save the little feline family made his heart swell.

When he looked up, there was a woman staring outside the nearest apartment windows. She held a steaming coffee mug in her hands, and there was a fond yet tired smile on her lips. Yesterday’s makeup was smeared around her sleepy eyes.

How could he crush her daughters’ attempt at taking care of the animals? How could he send them crying back to her when she looked as if she needed a little break?

Caving, he looked back at the girls in front of him.

“Okay. Let me see this one… Come here, little guy.”

Phainon reached for the male one, carefully holding him up and looking into his eyes. He was chubby, smelled like both freshly cut grass and wet cat food, and stared back at him dumbly with its bright green eyes. Somehow, the way it looked at him reminded him of Mydei.

Mydei liked to look at him like that, as if he said something in a different language and was trying to decipher it. Or he did something that made so little sense that his partner needed to take a second to rationalize it in his head.

“Tribbie and Trianne really want the girls, so do you want the boy?”

“Awh man,” he mumbled, deciding he was now going to have to buy all the things a cat would need before he started getting ready. “We can’t let the bad guys split them up, right? So we need to keep them together.”

“*Yeah!*” The three girls cheered, bouncing up and down as their mother giggled off to the side from the sight. “We can have playdates out here in the grass so papa cat can see mama cat and the baby kitten! They don’t have to be away too long!”

“*Girls, breakfast!*”

“Coming, mama!”

“Thank you, Mr. Snowy! You’re the best!”

“Yeah! Thanks, Mr. Snowy! You’re awesome!”

They ran back into the apartment right next to them, and Phainon looked down at the cat in his hands before holding him to his chest with one hand. The other reached for his phone.

“Master is going to be so happy,” he murmured, then took a picture of them together while walking back to his own place. “*Guess who just… became responsible… for this guy…*”

The text was sent, and he watched as the ‘*delivered*’ receipt turned into ‘*read*’ quickly. There wasn’t a text back though, just an immediate notification hanging at the top of his screen. While dragging it down, he smiled.

“He’s yours?”

“The family that takes care of them with me said the property owner is going around collecting the stray cats to take to the shelter,” he explained casually as a series of ‘meow’s filled his opposite ear. “They can only take two, so they took the girls and offered me the boy because I’m the one that helps look after them.”

“… So, when I pick you up…”

“Yes, my love, he will be in my apartment probably hiding under the couch,” he hinted. “You’ll be able to see him.”

Mydei hummed negatively. “He’s way too fat to fit under there. Maybe the coffee table.”

“Cats are weirdly liquid-y and fit in the tightest places. I’m not sure how, but I bet he’d fit,” he mused, pushing the front door open. “‘rene! Kitty!”

“You did not just call me—*kitty!*” She gasped, running up to him to take the cat from his hands. “Oh my gosh, Phainon! Where did you find him?”

“If you ever went outside, you’d know,” he mocked her, only for her to roll her eyes. Inside of his ear, a scolding of ‘*be nice to her*’ sounded.

Her head shook as she gently petted the chubby animal’s head. “No thank you. What’s his name?”

“… Kitty?” He offered unsurely, and even Mydei grumbled that wasn’t a good enough name. “What? I don’t know! I didn’t know I was homing a cat today either, but three little girls kinda cornered me and begged with these big ol’ puppy eyes! And the cat looked like it wanted to come home with me too! And their mom looked so hopeful! Now I have a cat! We have a cat!”

“You’re such a bad dad!” Cyrene huffed, causing him to grasp in offense. “Here, mama ‘rene will give you a name, little one. What do you like? Fish? Chicken? Oh, we need to get you a litter box and take you to the vet. Can you walk-in for a vet? Or do we need an appointment?”

“Do I look like the internet, ‘rene?”

“You have Khas and Reaver!” She reminded him as if he were stupid. “Don’t you take them to the vet?”

“We were given them from our neighbor with too many puppies. We didn’t pick a couple of Samoyed puppies up from a bush,” he corrected, then shrugged. “My mom did all of that stuff when I was like… *I don’t know*... fifteen years old? All I had to do was feed them and take them out on runs.”

Again, Mydei scolded him to ‘*be nice to her*’.

“If you want, I can go—”

“I’ll do it,” she cut him off, turning around from her place in the hallway. “Go prepare for your little date! I’ll call Cassie, and she’ll help me get this guy situated in his new home. Won’t we, Mr. Kitty-Cat? Mrow… Hehe, that’s how Cifera always says it.”

Phainon didn’t even get a chance to deny her. He could only watch as she disappeared into her room and left him there.

“You’re mean to her.”

“She’s mean to me!”

Mydei laughed at that, and Phainon couldn’t help but chuckle with him as he relaxed against the door. With his head leaned back and eyes closed, a deep breath then filled his lungs.

“I’m really excited for later, by the way. I’ll see you soon,” he told him. “Try not to miss me too much.”

“You’re silly… I’ll see you all very soon, my prince,” Mydei returned as a clank of metal rang out on his end of the call. It was definitely the sound of a baking sheet hitting his counter top.

“Don’t hurt yourself.”

“I’m smarter than you give me credit for,” he scoffed playfully. After he hung up, Phainon pulled his earbuds off and pried his body off the door.

“I’m taking a shower now! If you have to use the bathroom, find a bush outside!”

“I will kick the door down,” she promised from her bedroom, and he stuck his tongue out at her when passing by. “Go wash your butt, stinky! Mydei isn’t going to want it if you smell like gym socks.”

He shut the bathroom door, locked it, then debated sending Mydei a pre-shower photo of him in the mirror all sweaty from his run. Or should he send one when he was soaking wet and in nothing but a towel?

Something like that would make him happy because his lover always wanted to see him, and getting to read his flustered messages was always nice. The best were the audio messages from when he was busy or particularly frustrated by them so he could listen to them again and again, but was it worth the possibility of being punished for being naughty?

“Mm… he’ll definitely punish me if I do that,” he murmured to himself, thinking of how he was currently cooking and baking. “Maybe another time.”

Phainon decided he should be good. There would be plenty of other times to tease him in the future, but how many ‘*first dates*’ were they going to have?

No doubt Mydei had a plan, and he didn’t really like to deviate from his plans. Cooking, baking, preparing for their date, and being sexually frustrated might be overstimulating all at once.

Yeah, Phainon would be good today.

—

Getting dressed for his date made him anxious, but not in a sense that he was worried whether Mydei would find his outfit attractive or not. His partner always did. But in the way that made him wish Cyrene were there so he could laugh and joke his way through the minutes.

Realistically, it would be very, *very* difficult for their evening to go bad. With the exception of crashing the car and *dying*, or choking on food and *dying*, the only way he could not enjoy himself would be Mydei going behind his back and picking out some luxurious, overpriced activity to go do. It'd be as if he told him he didn't like fish, then was taken to a sushi restaurant anyway to try and convince him. There could be other things to order there, but it'd still feel like a punch to the chest that he simply *didn't care* about his feelings.

Mydei wasn't really that kind of guy, thankfully, but he was still a little anxious about where they would go and what they would do. Was he dressed appropriately? Should he have bought something for when he came to the door like a flower or chocolates?

Phainon was never on *this* side of a date. Every date he had ever gone on in the past, *he* was picking the other person up. *He* was bringing flowers to the door, making sure his car was completely cleaned, and making all the plans so the other person could enjoy themselves. That was always *his* job.

But it was *Mydei's* now, and being on the receiving end was both nerve-wracking and exciting. His leg couldn't stop shaking. His tongue didn't stop tracing over his teeth to make sure the chicken salad he ate three hours ago wasn't still in between despite checking nearly four times.

He never expected a girl to give him anything at the door when he picked her up, but did that account for him being a guy and Mydei not being a stranger? Should he have got something for him because of that? Was it too late to run to the store?

When Cyrene came home with an entire store in the backseat, it just so happened that Mydei was right behind her too. His partner watched as he carried a sack of cat litter and a few boxes up the stairs, following behind with a bag that matched the one Cyrene had.

"Look at how his big belly hangs," she teased after setting the cat down, and Phainon watched as he began to explore their apartment. "Oh! I left something in the car! Be right back."

She pushed him into Mydei while zooming past. Thankfully, they didn't topple over, but he still grumbled despite enjoying his partner's swift catch.

"You look so handsome today." Mydei took the moment to praise him, and Phainon met his eyes. "Such a pretty face."

Lips pressed to his cheek next, causing him to grin widely before curling an arm around his neck.

"Only my face?" Phainon pouted. "I tried to look good for you, you know. Don't you like my clothes?"

“I’m trying not to stare at your ass in those shorts too long. That’s not very respectful of me, is it?” Mydei asked, yet shot a glance over his shoulder and down his back.

“Oh? My master doesn’t have sex on the first date then?” He joked, then looked down between them. “You look good too. I really like this…”

Mydei skipped his button-ups and his henleys today. He skipped his sweaters and his turtlenecks for tonight. This white t-shirt was crisp and bright, and it hugged his waist nicely. His black jeans weren’t too tight, but they weren’t loose either, hugging his legs and showing off the thickness of his thighs. They were different from his usual slacks and dress pants, more reminiscent of how he used to dress back when they went out while still in school.

The leather jacket he had on was red rather than black, matching the dark sunglasses perched on top of his head and the tips of his sunset hair. It wasn’t overtly edgy or punk-ish. There were no unnecessary belts, buckles, and studs. There was only sleek red leather and the bronze looking zipper in the middle, a casual kind of edge to his usually clean attire.

Mydei looked so *casual*, like he wasn’t trying too hard to look professional or done up. It was so effortlessly *attractive*.

“This red leather reminds me of something,” he hinted, grabbing either half and looking up at him. “You know?”

“Don’t be naughty now,” Mydei whispered to him, and Phainon leaned forward. “Cyrene could come up any second. The last thing she needs to hear is you talking about our leather kink.”

It wasn’t his fault Mydei was dressed to kill. He looked so good that he didn’t want to stop admiring him, but it didn’t seem like Mydei was any better when his attention dropped to look him up and down.

A soft ‘*meow*’ then filled the room, and Mydei turned his head before tilting his lip up slightly. Bending over, he picked the cat up under its front legs and then looked at the stretched out animal.

“You really are so fat.”

“You and Cyrene need to stop calling him that,” Phainon scolded him, watching as the cat just allowed itself to hang there while looking around dumbly. “Leave him be.”

“*He* approached *me*…”

When he began to fuss at the sound of the door opening, Mydei let him go. Though, there was an almost saddened look from being left. His eyes even tailed him for a second before standing up straight and then pointing to the hallway.

“Let me wash my hands, and then we’ll go.”

Phainon nodded, then watched as Cyrene brought up two bags full of treats.

“People food. Cat food.” She bounced either bag in either hand.

“*Please* don’t eat a chicken flavored lollipop, Cyene. You’re going to get sick,” he pointed out, causing her to switch them around. “Better.”

Cyrene pushed him to the door while grumbling about him being a ‘*smart ass*’. And once Mydei left the bathroom, he too was ushered to hurry.

“Have fun on your date! Make sure he’s got some strength in him because there’s all these new boxes to take out tomorrow!” She winked at Mydei, who only tilted his head curiously.

“Why wouldn’t he?”

Phainon sighed at the response, pushing a hand to his own face. Heat burned in his cheeks, embarrassed by her shameless attitude now that the two had gotten closer.

“You know what I mean, Mydei.”

“Our date isn’t going to be particularly exertive, so he’ll be fine,” he reassured her, and Cyrene lifted an eyebrow. “I’ll get him home safely tomorrow.”

“You know what, forget I said anything,” she brushed off, sticking a leg out to keep their newest friend inside. “Have fun. Be safe.”

The door shut, and Mydei hummed while holding out a hand. He motioned him to walk forward, so Phainon did.

“You know what she meant.”

“I was contemplating going for a hike actually,” Mydei said thoughtfully, following behind him. “I spoke with Cerydra, and she mentioned there’s a nice mountain trail that leads to some pretty waterfalls a few hours up north.”

“Oh?”

So he took Cerydra’s number from when they all met up for drinks. How often did the two of them talk now? Did she help him come up with tonight?

“She sent me a video, but I think I'd get overstimulated being there too long. Do you know how loud waterfalls are? Or how many bugs there are?” He asked, and Phainon chuckled at the thought. “If we ever went, I’d only be able to handle it for a little bit. I’m not a fan of insects or having to speak loudly for casual conversations.”

“City boy,” he teased, stopping to then poke at Mydei’s arms and stomach. “Are you scared of a few bugs?”

“*You* are a bug.”

“*Ha!* But *you* are the one who bites like one.”

Mydei reached to poke him back on his side, and Phainon gasped before rushing to put a few extra steps in between them.

"*You know I'm—!*"

"Looks like *you're* the one scared of a bug," Mydei mocked him. He grabbed his wrist next, guiding him towards his car as the other dropped his sunglasses to his nose. "Come on."

Grinning, he followed him towards the vehicle, eyeing the way the top was retracted back. As they got closer, Mydei pulled the door open and nodded towards the seat.

"Doesn't it bother you when your hair gets crazy from the wind?"

"It's going to be a long drive, and I think it'd be nice to drop it down for a bit," he answered as he shut the door for him. "Here's the plan."

Phainon perked up as he looked at him, sitting up in his seat as Mydei crossed his arms to keep from touching the door. It was like he just got it cleaned earlier today. The paint was vibrant as if freshly shined, there wasn't a hint of dust on the dash, and a faint citrus scent lingered around the air.

"The drive is going to take roughly two hours," he told him. "Before we get on the road, you and I are going to stop to grab some snacks and drinks. Whatever you want, I'm buying."

Mydei was letting him eat in his car too? Who was he and where was the real Mydei?

"What if I don't want you to buy them for me?"

"What if you save that for a day where I'm *not* making all the plans?" Mydei shot back, and a tingle thrummed beneath his veins from his firm tone. "I have a set vision, and we're going to follow it, okay? That's it. End of discussion."

Oh…

"Yes, my love," he said sweetly, watching as his partner visibly shivered from the pet name. Not that his insides were any better after that firm tone of his. "Is that our date? A little road trip out?"

"No, it's part of it."

What was there around here that took a few hours to get to?

An amusement part? But Mydei didn't like loud, crowded spaces. And getting him on a rollercoaster would probably involve a lot of begging, pleading, and bribing.

A concert? There was a big stadium a few hours out that always had sold-out shows, but with traffic, it might be even longer of a drive. Then again, Mydei wasn't really a fan of those environments.

He said they weren't hiking, so the mountains were impossible as well. There wasn't much to do up there besides hiking and camping, but who was going camping for one night with their expensive car freshly detailed and an outfit like *that* on?

Maybe the aquarium by the bay as it wasn't too far out. That sounded like something nice, and no doubt Cerydra and Hysilens would've recommended it. He knew his friend loved her little sea critters.

"Did you hear me?" Mydei asked, snapping him from his thoughts.

"Huh?"

Mydei uncrossed his arms, then grabbed the zipper of his jacket before leaning in.

"I said…" His voice was lowered both in volume and pitch. "You're going to be a *good little boy* and wait patiently until the destination reveals itself to you, do you understand me?"

The hand not holding his zipper brushed under his chin, and Phainon flicked his gaze up to his.

"Yes, master," he whispered for just them to hear. "No more questions about it."

"If you want me to put the top back on, ask," he was instructed. "Otherwise, sit back, enjoy this nice, sunny day we're having, and try not to make an unnecessary mess in my car."

"Can I please have a kiss before we take off?" Phainon asked before he could pull away.

Mydei leaned closer, and their lips lightly touched for a soft peck before he pulled away. It was just enough to smell his pomegranate chapstick, to feel his soft lips, and to miss them both before he could even close his eyes. But even his pout didn't get him another.

"There's an extra pair of sunglasses and a small bottle of sunscreen in the glove department for you. Put them on," he ordered him instead. "I don't want your pretty face getting burned or your eyes hurting."

"Yes, master," he said again, just a little bit louder this time.

That made Mydei to glance around them to survey their surroundings, hoping no one else felt like heading to their cars at that exact moment. And upon seeing the parking spaces completely void of anyone else, the fingers on his chin lifted to instead pinch his cheeks. They dug in deep, tilted his head back further, and kissed him again like he meant it this time.

Phainon grinned, already dubbing this the best date he's ever been on without it even starting yet.

—

After picking up bottles of their preferred drinks, a packet of beef jerky, and a bag of chips to share, they took to the freeway to start their trip. Mydei had pinned his hair back into a ponytail during a minor traffic jam, and Phainon had to take a picture of him with his hair tie dangling from his mouth as he pulled it all together. Then another as he drove with one arm hanging out of the window and the other holding the steering wheel.

The music playing between them was a mix of Mydei's favorites and his own, and he was told the playlist was made specifically for this trip. Each upbeat and catchy song was selected purposefully to keep him singing along and from growing bored. And Mydei always snuck a little glance as they cruised down the free way.

Phainon fed him beef jerky, teased him by pulling it away too soon, and earned himself several smacks on the back of his hand. But it was worth it. Seeing Mydei shoot him a warning glance always made his stomach tingle.

He watched from his place in the passenger seat as the big, bustling city they lived in shifted to the more rural outskirts, then as it all faded away completely. The air felt cleaner. The wind smelled nicer. Even if his hair was probably a mess from the wind, he enjoyed the rush of freshness from having the top down.

Half-way through the drive, Mydei's arms shifted. He put his opposite hand in the wheel, leaned back in his seat, then rested his elbow on the center console. With his palm up and fingers light spread, Phainon already knew he was asking to hold hands. So he laced their fingers together and leaned back in his seat for a while to bask in how happy he was to get a version of Mydei that no one else ever had.

When he broke their hands apart to eat, Mydei stretched his arm out to wrap it around his thigh. The strong grip made him crush his chip in between his fingers, and the immediate smack against it made him press the back of his hand to his mouth. It was meant to be a warning about making a mess, but the spanking only served to kickstart a jolt of arousal out of him.

What movie or book had *that* move in it? Where did he learn to pull *that?*

Mydei held his thigh for a good chunk of the ride after, trusting him when he placed the larger chips in his mouth. Phainon snacked on the smaller ones, as those were harder to feed him without shoving a finger in his mouth and teeth from the bumps in the road.

The air grew crisper. The scent shifted from warm roads and dirt to a refreshing, salty breeze. Throughout the trip, he noticed as the temperature dropped degree by degree on the touchscreen, but he felt it most now. It was completely cooler here than it was at home.

Phainon had been driving for a while now. He got his license pretty early on, and when he did, he went exploring with his minimum wage checks. He knew where these freeways took him, what cities and towns were on the signs, and what that scent in the air was.

His eyes immediately shot to Mydei, to the scarily convincing poker face he wore. If he noticed him staring, he didn't react at all.

"… Where are we going?" Phainon asked.

"I thought I told you to sit there and wait?" He called back, watching the road closely. "Be patient. You'll get to see it soon."

But Phainon had a tickle. He had an inkling of a thought that became more and more apparent as the moments passed.

"*Mydei*…"

"*Ah ah.*" That earned him another spank on the inner thigh, then the hand leaving all together to grab the wheel. His opposite rested on the car door, and he attempted to hide his mouth by placing a curled finger over his top lip. "I said to be patient. Don't distract me while I'm driving."

"*Mydei!*" He repeated with a bit more excitement, and the expressionless look cracked into one of blooming happiness. "Mydei, are we—"

Sure enough, driving around the hills for just a few more minutes revealed a glistening, endless sea of crystal blue in his peripheral vision, and he snapped his attention back towards the window. Staring at it, he felt a well of emotions flood inside of his chest.

He was reminded of his hometown, of growing up with Cyrene with dirt covered boots on, of chasing each other by the seaside when they were so bored they could die. The memory of being little, rolling up his baggy jeans, and casting a fishing pole out by the pier with his father made him wish he had a one-day license, a tackle box, and some poles. His mother liked to collect the pretty seashells he would find, and that jar of sand and shells was still on a shelf in their home.

Oh, he remembered his childhood home, the one his parents paid off and let Cyrene's folks look after. They often told him they'd like to go back when they retired, and they were saving all the money they could put towards enjoying the small town they missed so much.

How long had it been since he last thought to come even close to the beach? It was such a long drive, and he wasn't like Cyrene who could disappear for random weeks since his job was more demanding.

Phainon's bottom lip gave a little shake, and he looked back at Mydei, who was juggling between him and the road in front of him.

"Pull over," he demanded, turning the music down completely. "Pull over so I can give you a hug and kiss right now!"

"The only place this car can go right now is off the highway!" Mydei warned him, and '*off the highway*' meant tumbling over the edge of the hill they were on. "Sit down, and don't do anything funny."

He sat, pulled his phone out, then snapped as many pictures and videos as possible. His finger didn't stop until Mydei physically grabbed it from him, tucked it between his thighs,

and took his hand into his own.

“Stay off of that for a bit,” he decided, and Phainon held him tighter. “Enjoy being here with me, not draining your phone battery.”

There were probably twenty more minutes of driving left before Mydei was able to pay for entry to this specific part of the beach. Because it was later in the day, there weren’t many people there as most of them were already preparing to go home. Parking was easy to find.

Once parked, Phainon rushed to unbuckle his seatbelt. The bags of snacks on his lap crunched as he shoved them aside, and his hand reached for the door handle before pausing.

“Hey. Look at me.”

Phainon obeyed just to find himself facing Mydei’s own phone as the shutter went off.

“You could have told me!”

“You haven’t stopped smiling since you saw the water. Don’t your cheeks hurt yet?” He teased him, eyes on the screen for a few more moments before dropping it into his jacket pocket. “You’re precious, you know.”

While looking eye to eye, Phainon couldn’t help but keep his grin up. “And you’re the best.”

“I’m so glad you think so,” he said gently, then reached for his face. “Come on, give this a little rest. You’re going to hurt yourself.”

He tried to calm his grin, but his heart was racing so quickly. His chest was so full and warm, stomach close to bursting with fluttering butterflies. They coaxed his lips to wobble from their pursed state, stretch upon seeing Mydei’s lifted eyebrow, then finish his grin with a laugh. All while Mydei’s thumb rubbed his heated skin.

“Come here.”

Phainon leaned forward, and Mydei pressed a kiss against his mouth to force him to draw the corners down. Closing his eyes, he kissed him back just as deeply, parting his lips briefly so they could be forced closed again. In focusing on the warmth of his partner’s lips and the feel of him cradling his cheek, the urge to grin slipped. All that stayed was a desire to keep kissing.

But then Mydei pulled back, and he pouted while meeting his gaze.

“Are you going to apologize for making a mess with all these crumbs when I took a lot of time to get my car cleaned for tonight?” He brought up suddenly, and Phainon nodded. “Go on.”

“I’m sorry for making a mess when you specifically told me not to, master.”

Wasn’t he just going to get sand all over the seats anyway?

“Thank you. Now be still.”

Mydei closed the top of his car, shut the engine off, then stepped out while dunking both the keys and their phones into his jacket pocket. The little jog he gave around the hood as he picked the bobby pins from his hair made him chuckle, and seeing his door open as he placed them between his lips made him reach for them. They filled an empty cup holder soon after.

Hand in hand, Mydei helped him out of his seat. Phainon took that as an opportunity to stretch both his arms and legs as the door closed behind him.

“The sun will set soon,” he commented, breathing in deep the scent of the ocean. “My love, aren’t you a romantic?”

“… *For you*,” he caved, then popped open his trunk as they walked towards it. “I came prepared.”

Phainon’s hand wrapped around his elbow, holding him while peeking at the items tucked inside the small space. A large black bag was pulled out to rest over Mydei’s opposite shoulder, the thing as big as an athlete’s gym bag, and a thick, woven blanket folded over that same arm. Beach towels followed.

All of it together looked like a hefty load to carry, but Mydei wrenched his arm back when he tried to help. Instead, he held his empty arm out expectantly, and Phainon took that as his command to put both of his arms on him. One held his elbow, and the other laced their fingers together.

“Are we going in the water?” He asked.

“I don’t plan to swim, no. But should you, I have clothes in the car.” Mydei dragged a pair of blue swimming shorts out. “I can roll my jeans up and walk in.”

“Is this why you wanted me in shorts? Not just to stare at my legs and thighs?” Phainon asked, and he nodded. “You should’ve too.”

“Not necessary. Do you want these?” His head shook. “Very well. If you change your mind, let me know.”

The trunk closed, and the things on his arm bounced to readjust one last time before they set out to find a comfortable spot—preferably one where the sand was packed tighter without being too close to the water. He knew Mydei wouldn’t like the possibility of loose grains blowing into his food or drinks. And Mydei’s own comfort was one thing he wouldn’t sacrifice for this night out.

They walked for a few minutes, surveying the beach together. Phainon pointed out nice places to settle down, but Mydei shot them down because people were already there. The beach was so big, why should they be close enough to hear other people’s intimate conversations? Or worse, for *them* to hear *theirs?*

When a nice spot they both agreed to came, they laid the blanket down with the towels folded on one corner. The bag was set on its opposite side.

“Did you make all of this?” Phainon marveled, eyes wide as Mydei began to lay containers out for them. There was a bag inside of the bag, insulated with a thick ice pack beneath, and everything was still cold despite the drive.

“Yes.”

One had neatly cut vegetable sticks lined by each other with a little divider between them. Another was full of raw berries and other small fruit. The smallest one with a screw lid had a creamy looking dip, something definitely made by him rather than store-bought as was. The largest looked as if some kind of pasta salad was inside of it, and the next on top was full with some kind of syrupy, orange-colored cake decorated with actual orange slices on top.

And there were still things wrapped up in foil, which he assumed might be sandwiches or wraps.

“Mydei…”

“Hm?” Upon noticing his stare, he paused. “Are these things okay?”

“This is so much,” he said, speaking lightly. While admiring it all, he even looked into the bag and found he had packed a little lantern, cans of sparkling water, and more.

Everything that they might need, he had. Everything that they might *want*, he had. There was even a battery pack for their phones in case they needed to charge them before they could get to the car.

“… Huh?” Mydei seemed confused by his amazement. “It’s not a lot though.”

“It is. It’s so much,” he gushed. “Everything you’ve done for me today is just so…”

What were the words to describe it besides for simply ‘*romantic*’?

‘*Perfect*’? ‘*Wonderful*’? ‘*Dreamy*’? A love-story that had come to life*?* A cheesy rom-com that escaped the television?

“I love you,” Phainon told him, unsure how to convey his feelings in any other way. “I love you so much. Master, really. L-Like… really. I’m so… *fuck*…”

His chest felt so full. His stomach ached with butterflies and tingles. Being here with him now with the sun closing in on the far edge of the sea and no one else around felt surreal. Like if he blinked, they’d be back at his condo just laying around together.

Not that it wasn’t nice to, but it sure wasn’t being on a picnic date at the beach.

Mydei’s eyes softened over his lightly choked up words. Their already glistening amber hue was brightened by the tangerine rays of the sky around them, complimenting his equally as golden hair. Rose bloomed in his cheeks, deepening their sun-kissed flush even more.

“You like it then?”

“I love it.”

A light squint made those eyes glitter. Smiling, Mydei let out a breathy chuckle as if he were relieved to hear that.

“I’m so happy to hear that,” he said through his laugh. “I was stress-baking last night while thinking about how you’ve probably had so many dates that were more exciting. There ended up being so many things for us to share. Please eat.”

Phainon leaned in closer, crossing his arm with Mydei. The ones they were leaning on touched at the elbow, cool leather touching his skin from where his plaid sleeve was rolled up. Their fingers overlapped, slipping in the spaces between one another’s.

“I labeled them,” Mydei told him, then grabbed one of the foil wrapped foods. “These are some garden pastries I baked with your favorite vegetables and some basil. These ones are spinach and artichoke. I also baked bread—”

“*—you baked a whole loaf of bread for today too?*”

Mydei nodded, then held something up while looking for the label. “Garlic and herb focaccia. It was easier than I expected.”

“Bragging much?”

“No. I’ve always wanted to bake fresh bread, but it’s very time consuming and requires yeast. A lot of the things I bake don’t have yeast in it,” he explained, and Phainon leaned against his shoulder as he listened to him ramble on about the science included in baking.

His free hand did the thing he usually did when explaining, moving as if his physical gestures could convey his words better than his mouth. Apparently yeast could die. Apparently the sourdough bread he loved was delicious but much more complicated because of the yeast.

Phainon knew these things, of course, but he listened anyway. He asked questions to keep Mydei going, shifting from the topic of focaccia to sourdough, then from sourdough to 7-grain bread that he could hopefully get his mother to eat to help with her blood sugar. The series of shifts made more sense as they were talking rather than taking them one by one without context.

“If I can get more comfortable baking bread, I can experiment in baking her something better for her body,” Mydei brought up, open in a way he usually didn’t allow himself to be. He couldn’t help but smile over his caring nature. “She doesn’t take her health seriously enough. That’s why I learned how to bake sweets in the first place—so she can have delicious treats that aren’t too full of sugar or fat.”

“I know,” he hummed. “You’re a good person and a good son, master.”

Mydei didn’t respond to that. He stayed silent as if mulling the response over, then leaned over to rest his head against his own. Temple to temple, they watched over the water as it

climbed the shore and sparkled from the sun. Their hands slid further, reaching behind one another instead.

“I would’ve loved to take you back to your hometown, but that’s a pretty far drive,” he changed the subject instead. Phainon understood why, as that talk of his mom and being a good son was getting dangerously close to *other* topics. “I’d make it for you if we planned at least a whole weekend there.”

“It’s definitely better to fly than drive,” he agreed. “But this is perfect. There’s no need to think you could’ve done more when I’m so grateful you even did this much.”

“Let me take you someday,” Mydei insisted anyway. His heart skipped over the fact he wanted this. “Let me take you back home, then let’s take your parents back too.”

“You’ll even take my parents?”

Phainon wouldn’t agree so quickly, but Mydei seriously wanted that? He wanted to give his parents a short trip back to their hometown too?

“They left what they knew so you could come here and live in a big city. Without that sacrifice, we never would have met,” he reasoned, speaking softly. “They gave me my best friend and the man I love. I should thank them for it sometime. It’s courtesy.”

Water rippled, and in the faint distance, children giggling as parents called for them filled the silence beneath.

“Maybe I’ll let you one day,” he settled on, and Mydei nodded. “I’d really like for you to visit too. Maybe I can teach you how to catch the fish you cook.”

“Maybe I’ll be better than you at it,” he joked.

“No,” he denied immediately. “If you ever get better at fishing than me, I’m going into hiding and practicing my technique.”

“Is that a promise?”

“*Are you trying to get rid of me?!*”

Mydei laughed, and he grinned while leaning into him as well. “Tell me how fishing works. Is it really as easy as baiting a hook and flinging it into the water?

“No way! You have to know what you’re fishing for!” He started, and Mydei turned to watch him explain. “If your line or rod isn’t the right kind, they’ll snap!”

“Will they?”

“Mhm! So, you should research what kind of fish are where you’re going to be fishing first. Then understand you have to catch within certain weights. Too big? You’ll have to let it go. Too small? You have to let it go,” he explained to him. “Some fish are really well protected, so you can pull them up for a picture, but you have to let them go.”

“Tell me more,” Mydei said, giving him the chance to ramble as well. And because he seemed interested, Phainon was ready to talk his ear off about it.

—

Having got there so late, the sun was down quickly. Chills rolled in over the sea, and Mydei had given him his jacket to wear since he was in shorts and a flannel. The leather was warm inside, scented thickly with his cologne and deodorant, and more comfortable than ever.

And Mydei had his blue flannel on, having denied it originally but caved after seeing his puppy dog pout.

Their picnic set up was illuminated by the lantern, therefore easy to spot as they walked along the shore. With their shoes left by their belongings, cold waves tickled their ankles while they rolled in. Though Mydei chose to wear pants, he had them folded up the calf to keep them from getting wet.

Stopping, they stood in front of one another, lit up by the pale moon above.

“Phainon?”

“Yeah?”

“I want to remake our folder tomorrow,” he said suddenly, and his eyes widened in surprise. “It’s full of these ugly sticky notes and tabs, and it’s severely outdated with the things *I* wanted from this. Let us take some time, create new papers *together*, and detail everything our future should hold to better the *both* of us. Our future deserves some better thoughts.”

His eyebrows furrowed together. “Like what?”

“*Romance*,” he answered. “Let’s make a rule where I need to take you out on a date a certain amount of times in a month. You and I can make a list from game nights of your choosing to weekend trips out.”

“You know, that reminds me a lot of Hysilens and Cerydra,” he teased, but warmth bled into his cheeks anyways. “Is that what you’d like to have with me?”

“Is that what *you’d* like as well?”

‘*Mandatory dates*’, huh? It’d probably help Mydei a lot to be able to pencil them in on his calendar. Knowing he needed to plan one, two, three, or more dates in a month meant he’d never have to guess if he was doing it enough to keep him happy. It’d bring him the comfort he needed to know he was meeting his mark.

Phainon could deal with the uncertainties. He could handle the possibility so long as it did, eventually, come. Mydei was never that kind of person.

“I think a rule like that would be a good idea,” he agreed, watching as the man in front of him smiled. “Let’s also make a rule where we leave the house for a certain amount of time too. It can even be by ourselves like this, but let’s get out more. This is nice, isn't it?”

“If it’s like this, then I can do that,” Mydei promised. “Just us, no one else.”

“Who said this *BDSM* stuff can’t be romantic?” He joked.

“*You* did.” Phainon’s eyes rolled over his genuine response. “*You* are the person who said that.”

That was true.

Maybe he used to wonder how someone could smack their partner across the face and then have the audacity to say they loved them. But he kind of liked the little taps Mydei gave him so long as they stayed beneath a certain strength. And maybe he used to feel uncomfortable at the thought of needing to ask permission for things and behaving a certain way, not liking the idea of punishment. But the punishments Mydei dished out weren’t always bad. They could be fun, teasing, and even a little bit enjoyable.

It was kind of romantic how even if Mydei liked to rough him up, take his control, and tell him what to do, it was always done to make him feel good, give him better habits, and take care of him completely too. He was pampered like royalty, and he couldn’t imagine a relationship where someone didn’t give him as much as Mydei did.

For all he gave up, Mydei always gave back. And even if the version of him from *before* didn’t understand that, the one *now* did.

Mydei pulled him closer, and Phainon stepped towards him as water washed over them once more.

“I take it all back,” he murmured. “My master is the most romantic person in the world, and there’s no one I’d rather be with than him.”

“You know, my mother always told me there’s certain expectations for a man like me,” Mydei shared, taking his hands and holding them. “I should hold doors open for others. I should always pick up the bill because I can. I should always appear both clean and professional—no one wants to look at a slob.”

Phainon felt him rub over his knuckles.

“Certain things I do, I know you don’t like, like my daily drinking habits. Certain ways I feel, I know you don’t reciprocate, like my itch to spend money on others,” he listed, and he was right about that. “But the one thing I never want you to have to second-guess or worry about again, is the way I see you. You are everything to me, Phainon.”

A smile stretched across his lips, and he pulled their hands to his cool cheeks. The knuckles were cold, and Mydei gripped his hands tighter as he kissed them gently.

“If you want dates, I will take you wherever you want to go and do whatever activity you want to do,” he promised him. “If you want me to dress a certain way for you, I will fill my closet with whatever will keep you looking at me and only me.”

Mydei pulled him chest to chest next, moving their hands so he could hold his face and Phainon could grip his wrists.

“I never thought I’d ever be interested in going out, introducing myself as someone’s boyfriend, or planning trips with someone else’s family, but here I am.” Shaky breaths fell from his lips, orange scented like the cake they shared previously. “I’m so in love with you that I need to thank your parents for giving me you. I’ve never felt so strongly about anyone before.”

“You’re cheesy,” he accused, but it was definitely working on softening him up. “Would the Mydei from before have guessed that he’d be here?”

“No. The Mydei from before would have snuffed any feelings out until he forgot about them if you never admitted you loved him,” he admitted quietly. “Had you let me cut you off that night, I would have bit my tongue until it fell off. I would have moved on in my own quiet misery.”

“I know. Aren’t you glad you have a man like me with a little bit of *attitude* in him to talk back to you, master?” Phainon teased, and Mydei rolled his eyes. “Even if you gotta spank him a little bit for that?”

“I’d never want to change a thing about you.”

Phainon leaned in, pressing a kiss to his lips softly and wishing the night never had to end.

Chapter End Notes

im so sad this story is closing in on its end. i love them so much, and im gonna miss them even more when it ends…

Chapter 29: Chapter Twenty-Nine

Chapter Notes

cw: choking. boot riding.

this is the bdsm chapter i have been FIENDING for, if im being honest. the negotiations, the exploration, the sex, everything is what i wanted this fic to be about. its my best one if i say so myself.

also, i am NOT a kink instructor. i am not medically certified. i am just a kinky girl who knows some stuff and things. please dont go into kink without research or a trusted and informed partner

remember RACK. risk-aware consensual kink. remember PRICK. personal responsibility, informed, consensual kink. be safe and smart.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

That Sunday morning after, as Phainon was washing dishes from their breakfast and the tupperwares from their picnic date, Mydei approached him. With his arms crossed and his hips pressed against the counter, he supervised his chores for a moment before speaking.

“When you're finished, come to my office.”

That was it. There was no added explanation, just his command.

“Yes, master.”

And Phainon followed it once he dried the dishes and tucked them away where they belonged. He didn’t need to know anything else because he could figure it out on his own.

Mydei mentioned that he wanted to work on their rules, omit some, create some, and most importantly, cater the folder completely to *them* rather than the generic things he had before. Now that he had his own grasp on what he liked, what he disliked, what he might enjoy, and what he wouldn’t ever want, it was time to put these findings together into a better, more coherent set of expectations, limits, and more. This was *their* folder, not a rinse and repeat process carried from person to person that belonged only to *Mydei*. It had been overdue.

Wiping his hands on his pants and fisting the hem of his borrowed t-shirt, Phainon walked towards Mydei’s office curiously. Immediately, he was greeted with a folded up blanket on the floor beside his rolling desk chair. Inside of the leather seat, his partner was holding up a familiar red folder full of sticky notes with different highlighter colors, colored tabs on various pages, and pen scratches.

“Kneel.”

His knees touched the pillowy blanket, and Mydei looked down at him once he was situated.

Back straight with his chin up confidently, legs folded beneath his bottom with his hands on his thighs, Phainon assumed the position Mydei liked him in when sitting like this. Confident. Attentive. He was ready for orders, and he was ready for whatever Mydei wanted to do with him.

“Aren’t you a good boy?”

A hand pinched his cheek, and he smiled while tilting into the touch.

“Thank you, master,” he said, still watching him. “What do you need me to do?”

“I’m going to ask you questions, and you’re going to answer me. We’ll discuss our views, our expectations, our necessities, and our limits,” he explained to him. As his hand pulled back, Phainon watched him bring it to his keyboard and begin to type. “Then, we sign it for appearance’s sake again. It makes our agreement feel a little bit more official, don’t you think?”

“It does,” he agreed, then looked up at the computer screen. “I can’t see much from down here though.”

“Do you trust me?”

“Of course.”

“Then sit there and be pretty.”

Phainon rolled his eyes playfully, and Mydei set a hand on his head when he was able to stop typing. The mouse clicked a few times, and a few keys were pressed, all done with one hand so he could keep petting his head.

“Who am I?” Mydei asked next, getting straight to the point. “Who are you?”

“You’re my master, and I’m your spoiled prince,” he said, mourning the weight of his hand when it left yet again.

“Why do you want a master? What does submission give you?” He wondered, and that wasn’t something Phainon was quite ready to hear this soon—*or at all*, really. That wasn’t something they discussed when opening the folder before, was it?

Why did he like it?

Phainon kind of just… *did*. But that wasn’t an acceptable answer, was it? Mydei wasn’t satisfied with anything other than the utmost clarity, and ‘*I don’t know*’ wasn’t something he accepted from him in moments where their dynamic shined the brightest.

He liked the tingle that shot through his stomach when Mydei's voice lowered to be more stern and demanding. He liked the warmth that pumped from his racing heart when being told he was '*good*' or '*doing good*'. It was exhilarating to give in to him sexually, as giving up control meant he could focus more on feeling good because he knew Mydei would take care of him. Being able to rely on him for the things he didn't know or understand felt so safe, and he could explore as much as he wanted with someone who not only knew better than he did, but someone who truly cared about his comfort, enjoyment, and growth.

The satisfaction of Mydei being *proud* of him for completing his tasks or submitting to him made Phainon want to accept more and more. Pleasing him made him happy because to him, Mydei deserved to smile more and be taken care of in return. Being spoken of highly, held to a certain standard of self-care, and encouraged to embrace his sexuality made him feel more confident in himself, both mentally and physically. It pushed him to step out of his comfort zone more, and that made him try new things, befriend new people, and confront what he'd usually run away from.

Phainon liked to know his efforts were acknowledged, accepted, and rewarded. He liked to blanket himself under his guidance when the world felt too much, aware that he was safe from cruel judgment within his embrace. There was only moving forward with Mydei, never lingering in complacency and wallowing in the past.

How was he supposed to put those thoughts into words that made sense in a document? In his head, they were perfectly clear, yet his tongue was twisted over how to speak them into existence.

"Would it help if I told you why *I* want my prince?" Mydei asked gently, and he nodded as his chair turned to face him completely. "Are you ready?"

"I am."

"I want a man who will accept my desire to have control by entrusting it to me in return for the safety, care, and comfort I provide," he started, opening himself completely. "I take care of myself, my friends, my parents, and I will happily take care of my partner too. *That's the man I am.* I may complain about my job, and I may sound ungrateful for this life at times, but I'm blessed with the opportunity to look after others completely. So, I will always choose to do so."

Phainon's lips curled into a smile, watching as his partner placed a hand over his heart. Hearing that made his own beat harder for him.

"I have rough kinks that demand careful consideration and patience to warm up to. I have intimidating fetishes that I can't live without even if I tried. But being dominant, to me, is more than just rough sex with someone. Dominance, to me, is a space where I can be myself, and '*myself*' is someone who thrives with direct communication, clear expectations, structure. My relationship and dynamic, in a perfect world, would be the most comfortable place for me to let go of my daily life. I'm uninterested in the guessing games and unspoken rules of an average, vanilla dating experience, and a dom-sub relationship is where I feel most understood," he explained thoroughly. "There are things I'm forced to do almost every day, and it exhausts me. I want to let that stress go, put my energy in a place where someone else

is going to meet me, and have that feeling of closeness, investment, and effort reciprocated. You give me that, Phainon. What we have is everything I've ever wanted and more."

The way he was looking at him now made him feel as if Mydei were thinking back to all the nights and mornings they shared together. There have been so many now. Months and months have passed since they started this, and each day made it easier than the last. This submissive '*role*' stopped being '*role*' to him, and it upgraded to be a part of him now. It was second nature now.

Mydei was being so honest and vulnerable in his reaponse. That meant he had to meet him there too, didn't it?

He had to come up with an elaborate answer, nothing half-assed. He had to try to sort through the rambles in his head to find the clearest, most honest answer he could muster. What was a *power exchange* such as their own *without* complete transparency and communication between both sides?

Phainon took a deep breath, then exhaled slowly.

"I want my master because there's still so much I want to experience. He's the one I feel safest with because of his desire to keep learning, his drive to always talk things through, and his heart that only ever wants to help," he did his best to explain the mess of words in his head. "Being your submissive has been the most freeing feeling. Even with our rules and expectations in place, I don't feel suffocated to be someone new, but a better version of the person I am. I feel taken care of and looked after even when you're not there physically. I feel encouraged to grow and learn, even through failure and anxiety."

Mydei's hand, the one that was previously holding his heart, reached to touch his cheek and chin. Fingers curled under bone, and his thumb lightly swiped over plush skin. It was gentle yet reaffirming, light yet guiding.

Phainon followed, obedient. He waited and watched, anticipating his next question.

"Tell me, what do you want from your master?"

Phainon smiled, leaning into his touch as he stared at his lover's, *his dominant's*, amber eyes. They glittered so beautifully as they watched him, delighted by the depth of his response.

"I plan to be your lover and your submissive until the end," he answered, keeping his voice strong. "If things go wrong, I expect us to talk it out like a couple rather than you deciding on your own what's best for us. No more '*rationalizing*' without me. I'd like for us to be '*boyfriends*' to our friends and families, yet to us and our friends who know, I'm happy to only refer to you as my '*dominant*' or be referred to as your '*submissive*'. Those titles are true too, and maybe even more accurate. I want to be taken out on dates like vanilla couples do, and I want to explore more on the kinky things we like already. We should look more into more shibari harnesses and ties for you to wrap me in, leather clothing and accessories for us to wear for each other, and we should play more with our casual kinks."

“And how do you imagine we would practice more casual kink?” Mydei asked to pick his brain.

“I want to wear harnesses around the house more, and I want to see you in leather more often. Maybe I can try to do my chores while in gear of your choosing sometimes, or you can make me ask permission for more things than I do,” he told him honestly, doing his best to sound both assertive and confident. “It doesn’t need to be sexual. Though, being more sexual wouldn’t be a *bad* thing either… I’d enjoy it. So, if you’re up for it, we can also be more sexual than we are.”

The last time they did it was so much fun. It was so exciting to have Mydei fuck him senseless, and if they did it more often, then he wouldn’t be upset as the strain wasn’t too bad.

Stress was a big factor in libido, sure, but Mydei didn’t have to stand over him and bark orders to be dominant. He didn’t need to plan these intricate scenes and plays where they take all the toys from their closet and use them one by one. Things could be simple. They could be subtle.

Mydei could have him suck his cock, and then switch since he knew his partner loved to do the same. They could jerk each other off or frot against one another, and both would be quick to do and stress-relieving. Toys weren’t necessary. Dressing up all the time wasn’t necessary.

And Phainon didn’t need to wear sex toys when eating dinner, or be rubbed up on at all moments of the day. But he was open to doing more than they did if Mydei found himself wanting it too. *BDSM* wasn’t inherently sexual, but it was still a decently sized chunk of what they enjoyed about it too.

“Now, what should your master do for you to continue making you feel taken care of as a person and submissive?” He wondered, but it didn’t ever take a second to think of an answer.

“Continue to be a safe, trustworthy person for me to rely on. Hold me accountable when I do bad. Reassure me when I’m nervous. Praise me when I’m good. Remember I’m not just your sub, but your best friend and your lover. Joke with me, laugh with me, go out with me, and never stop being there for me. If there’s one thing I don’t like, it’s being left alone,” he said firmly, earning a gentle rub against the cheek. “I’ll obey your rules, uphold your expectations, and give you the control you want, but only if you keep being someone who I can rely on without even needing to think.”

“Now, what will you do if your master doesn’t meet these standards and expectations?” He pressed.

“If you stop being safe for me or unable to handle the weight of our rules, I’ll take back my submission until you gain my trust back,” he promised him. “Trust is easier broken than gained, master.”

But Mydei wouldn’t do that. There were only three times he could think about when he ever got close to ripping through that lining—that night they played with nipple clamps and he both lied to comfort him *and* left him alone, the argument they had when he was going to end

this arrangement on his own for '*his best interest*', and when he touched him at the club in front of everyone and left him anxious the whole night. The misunderstandings and hurt, the confusion and anxiety, all of it had made him question himself, but they talked everything out relatively quick each time. Things weren't left broken or painful. As soon as Mydei realized he was wrong or had done something wrong, he did his best to clear it up and make sure it didn't happen again.

He was safe despite the happenings because he acknowledged his mistakes, took responsibility for the aftermath, and let his actions prove that he wouldn't repeat them. If either happened again, then that'd mean he didn't care, and if he didn't care, then Phainon couldn't keep doing this dynamic—this '*power exchange*' where the power was actually being *abused*.

"What would make your master '*unsafe*'?" Mydei was quick to say next. It was as if he could recall everything he was too. "Give me an example."

"If you watched me freak out over not being tended to properly, then didn't change a thing the next time, you'd be unsafe," he answered, and Mydei lowered his hand from his cheek. "If I came to you anxiously, but you still tried to act like nothing was wrong with me, you'd be unsafe."

"Think smaller now."

"If you told me you'd take care of something but you didn't, repeatedly, then it'd make me think you didn't deserve to ask for so much control over me," he brought up. "If you started dressing me in ways you know I really don't like, it'd make something meant to be fun and exciting into something more forceful and one-sided."

"And you would stop?"

"We would have to put a pause to this and talk about it because we can't have an '*exchange*' if you're *stealing* from me," Phainon reasoned, and that was when Mydei stood up out of his seat.

His head tilted back to look up at him, and as he got down on one knee, Phainon's attention followed. He kept his eye contact. Even as two hands held his cheeks and pinched them with his palms, he didn't stop looking at him.

"You make me so proud," he said gently, and Phainon smiled. A light throb filled his chest. "The way you're articulating yourself so rationally, precisely, and confidently tells me you know what you're talking about. You're well aware of what you want from me, how you deserve to be treated by me, and if that standard isn't met, then you know exactly how to confront it."

He nodded. "I have a good master to teach me."

"Give credit where credit is due. You can lead a horse to water, but you can't make it drink," he reminded him, causing Phainon to pout.

“Master, are you calling me a horse?”

Mydei laughed, then kissed the top of his head. “Maybe.”

“*Master!*”

Another kiss touched his nose, and Phainon closed his eyes while chuckling with him.

“Are you ready to keep going?” Mydei double-checked. “Keep being honest with me. Keep being open with your responses. I will meet your vulnerability with my own, and when we finish, you and I are going to have some fun.”

“Master, can I say one more thing?” A nod made him gulp. “I’ll… also let you buy me small things like a sweet treat every now and then, and flowers a certain amount of times a month.”

Mydei pulled back. “Are you sure?”

“My *BDSM* gear, my groceries here, and all my bathroom stuff, I’ll let you keep buying them without saying anything,” he caved. “When we go out *specifically* on dates, if a meal is beneath a certain price, I’ll let you take the bill. But if it’s above, we have to split it half-and-half. If it’s even more than that, you better have a good reason for taking me there… like it’s your birthday and you want me to go with you and your mom, or something…”

Mydei looked excited for the opportunity anyways. There was a sparkle in his eye like he had been hoping for him to relent on such a limit.

“I understand. But still no shopping sprees or jewelry, right?”

“*No*.”

“Yes, my prince,” he agreed, and Phainon hummed softly to himself when another kiss pecked over his lips. "I'll respect that.”

“Then, can we please continue before we get too caught up in kissing, master?” He asked, which caused Mydei to stand and then nod. “We have a lot of pages to work on, right? You still need to answer those same questions for me.”

“Yes, but this will go by quickly.”

—

For the most part, it did.

Mydei told him he expected him to always be a kind, respectful, and loving person no matter how spoiled he could be. He expected him to always be available, or to be available as soon as possible if he was busy, in the same way Mydei made himself out to be for him. He was

supposed to submit freely at all times, to accept his guidance and enjoy his place beside him. They had their bad days and stress, so he didn't need to put on his extra polished behavior every day, but he still needed to uphold his side of their dynamic unless they agreed a little leniency was needed.

Phainon took care of him by simply being there to give him a place to channel his efforts. Mydei didn't need much to feel safe besides his honesty, understanding, and reassurance of his efforts. It helped to be told his efforts were appreciated and his attention to detail wasn't '*too much*' to deal with. He wanted to be accepted with all his little quirks, then have them embraced—like how Phainon learned how to keep his home organized and allowed him to ramble freely. Sometimes he might need more control to feel better, and Phainon was more than willing to uphold these desires as much as possible.

'*Unsafe*' for Mydei was dismissing or mocking the person he was. If Phainon told him he was '*abusive*' for liking what he did, if he said he was '*too complicated*' to understand because of his structure, and if he purposely disregarded his wishes by pushing him to do things he wasn't comfortable with, it'd make him feel taken advantage of or not good enough. He was sensitive about his over-explaining, intense sexual desires, need for cleanliness and organization, shutdowns, and hobbies. If Phainon pushed him to keep going out to places that overstimulated him, refused to indulge in things he enjoyed too, and kept disrespecting his way of living, Mydei wouldn't feel comfortable in his own relationship. He'd be forcing himself to be someone he wasn't. If he called him '*childish*' for needing certain things done in a certain way, or for shutting down for a little bit when he was overstimulated, then he'd rather just be alone with his ways. It'd be better than feeling alone in his own relationship.

Phainon would never do those things anyway. Mydei had his quirks, and he was going to be there to help manage and take care of them too. That was what he wanted to do.

Mydei wasn't just his dominant—that was his best friend for years and the love of his life who he wanted until the grave. If he needed quiet nights without talking to calm down, if he needed activities to focus his overactive mind on, and if he couldn't handle going out to certain places because of how loud or crowded they were, then they could work through it together. There was always a compromise to be made. Give and take, meeting in the middle, alternative options, things like that were always possible.

A lot of their rules didn't change from what they were though, and a lot of the things they talked about were the same as before. Honesty and transparency was still required between them. Respect was non-negotiable, not just between them as a couple but the spaces they owned and the people in their lives. And infidelity, *still*, was an immediate termination.

At eight in the morning, they were meant to share their '*good morning*' text or call if they weren't together in bed, and every night at eight would include a '*good night*' variant even if not yet preparing to sleep. Mydei still wanted to pick out his clothes when he could as he liked the idea of showing him off, and Phainon wanted to help him get dressed when possible. They were both going to uphold their own healthy lifestyles, but if he wanted extra treats or to skip working out, then he needed to ask permission and leave it up to Mydei. It was *his* decision, after all. Cooking was Mydei's job, as was driving them around. Washing

dishes was his, as was the laundry. If at any point they couldn't uphold these responsibilities by themselves, the other was free to step in and help.

Their safewords and safety signals didn't change either, but the list now included their repetitive phrase of '*how are you feeling?*'. When asked exactly that way, not as '*how are you*' or '*are you alright*', it would symbolize wanting a shift from their everyday lives to a heavier, more intense kind of exchange. Mydei was still holding on to his '*free-use*' title, but Phainon liked being asked the question. Sometimes they didn't pre-plan to do anything more demanding together, and the tickle could come randomly without warning, which was when the question mattered most. It was a nice little warning without being too crude or blunt with it.

Mydei also updated their rule about knowing where he went to always having his location shared with him since they did that already, and the newest addition to their previous financial limits included everything Phainon agreed to. He still needed to tell him where he was going if he had errands to run. He was required to ask permission to go out places where alcohol or drugs could be, then tell him when he was leaving, who he would be with, and when he got home. On that note, he wanted Mydei to share with him when he was going to be with his parents, at meetings for work, or if Eurypon was trying to set him up with anyone again.

Phainon decided, at that moment too, he didn't feel comfortable with Mydei getting off to porn too. Not that he thought he did, but the idea of his lover watching *someone else* to feel good made him uneasy, and he could keep whatever pictures or videos he wanted for references, ideas, or admiration for the craft of *BDSM*, but he didn't want him *masturbating* to it. Mydei then promised not to use anything like that for his own pleasure. He didn't anyways, as he just called or texted him for relief. Phone sex with him was much, *much* better anyway.

His orgasms were still not his own. His pleasure still belonged to Mydei, and he was to ask permission to touch himself if he needed it and to ask permission to finish when close. Mydei was free to deny him as much as his heart desired and keep him pent up as long as he wanted, or until he safeworded. And with consideration, he decided as long as Mydei didn't surprise him with anything inside of him, he could touch his body freely. Occasional gropes or touches were fine. He had grown to like them even if they never led up to full-blown sex.

After they got past those, they moved on to their newest addition—*dates*.

The minimum amount of dates they needed to go on was three a month. If four was possible, then four. But if it wasn't, three was mandatory at the least. Two had to be outside of the house, and one was free to have a more relaxed night in doing something they didn't usually do—a puzzle, another lego set, video games, board games, or whatever wasn't just movies, silly online videos, and dinner together.

Their punishments weren't much different either. Apologies in person, no movies or games, kneeling while leashed, face slaps, spankings, even being denied orgasms or play—all were things they had done before in the past. Mydei chose to accept punishments of his own too, including giving up minor control over things like cooking dinner or not getting to pay a bill. But Phainon wasn't exactly *keen* on the idea of punishing him. Apologies and his own

internal guilt felt like more than enough as it felt like Mydei internalized things more than the average person.

As they finished up with most of their rules, expectations, punishments, rewards, and rituals, that was when Mydei allowed him to stand and read the documents he created. They looked over the text, revised the wording on some to clarify better, and created a new page to move on.

“Now that you have basic understanding of some kinks and plays,” Mydei murmured just loud enough to hear, creating a new page. “I’m going to copy and paste my old lists from before for us both, and this time, we’re going to fill them out. No guessing games. If you don’t know what it means, ask. I think we’re at a spot where kink doesn’t scare you off, so let’s talk *sex*.”

“Master, what does this one mean then?” He asked, pointing to a word as he began to add more boxes, more columns, and more decorative texts. This one was labeled ‘*sexual acts’* and had a list of different things from ‘*anal: bareback*’ and ‘*blowjob: receiving*’. Most he somewhat understood from first glance. “‘*Ana…lingus…*’?”

Mydei didn’t show him these things before, probably because he was afraid of scaring him off or overloading his plate. Back then, he had been so timid and uncomfortable just *thinking* about sex. Being touched that day was so… different. It was the furthest he was willing to imagine going.

Things like blowjobs and fingering, even sex itself, was completely off the table. Seeing this kind of chart would have probably sent him into another nervous spiral and made him back out.

“It means putting your mouth and tongue on someone’s asshole,” he answered calmly, and Phainon’s breathing hitched as he thought about it. “For the record, I have no personal qualms about giving it, but certain requirements must be met.”

‘*That was a given*,’ he wanted to say, but refrained.

Phainon shifted his weight foot to foot while trying to imagine Mydei’s hot, wet, and skilled mouth against his asshole. It was one thing to have a toy in there on his lonesome, then another to have Mydei moving it for him. His fingers and cock were another thing he had warmed up to if he didn’t outright stare too long at his hole, but his *mouth?* His *tongue?*

“I don’t think I’m… ready for that,” he admitted, and Mydei nodded. “That sounds too uncomfortable.”

“No matter. If you ever feel like you want to try it, I don’t mind indulging you,” he brushed off. “Sit on my lap facing me and allow me to read these to you.”

He turned to look at him, then looked down at his lap before pressing a knee down on his chair.

“Will this support our weight?”

“Yes.”

Situating himself over his lap, Phainon took his seat and then looked down at Mydei. His eyes were on the screen as they were sitting at an angle for him to keep reading.

“Can I touch you, master?” He asked, and when his partner nodded, his hands settled over his collarbones and shoulders. A wiggle made the fit more comfortable, and Mydei set one hand on his lower back to both scoot him higher and give him some support.

“Shall I fill out the ones we’ve already done for us?”

“Yes please.”

Mydei clicked, clacked, and hummed quietly to himself. As he did, Phainon eyed his handsome face. But upon recognizing a pop of color in his peripheral vision, he turned towards the wall to their left.

Hanging there was the lego set they had built and glued together, bright, beautiful, and childish. It sat in an area beside some hung up frames, easy to turn and find when he got stressed.

“When I get a house, I plan to have a nice shelf to display all of the different flower sets they have to offer. That one will be in my new office, but the rest will be kept for everyone to see in the main room,” Mydei brought up, flicking between him, the wall art, and then his computer. “Be a doll and build more for me.”

“Yes, master.”

“Good boy,” he coo’ed, then looked up at him. “Now, tell me. Does this good boy like to be called a ‘*slut*’ and a ‘*whore*’?”

Phainon gulped as tightened his grip over his shirt. “Sometimes, but not casually. Please don’t just walk in a room and say that to me.”

“Never, baby. I’m only curious about how far you’re willing to take degrading talk—abstaining from anything ‘*pet*’ related because you are my *man*, not my *pet*.” The hand on his mouse beckoned him closer, and Phainon leaned in. “What if I were to call you a doll? A *fuck doll?*”

“Um…” His stomach tingled. “I…—”

Lips brushed his ear as Mydei sat up, kissing the lobe before humming softly. "What if I asked you to be a *good little fuck doll* for your master, hm? To take his cock like you’re meant to?”

Phainon’s skin bubbled with goosebumps, and he closed his eyes as a mix of emotions flooded into his stomach.

“I-I like the ‘*good little*’ part of that the most,” he confessed. “If you add that in front of degrading things, it’s like having sugar with medicine. Just saying it without the praise

feels… weird…”

“My pretty boy does like his praise, doesn’t he?” Mydei continued to coo at him, and a soft whine crawled up his throat. “You’re doing so well for me. Let’s keep going.”

“Y-Yes, master…”

“What if I said I *owned* you?” He asked next, and Phainon shivered as the word echoed inside of his head. “Is that a sweet one, hm? Does your master *own* you, baby? Can he make you do whatever he wants because you’re *his slut?*”

“M-Master,” he choked out.

“Shh… Tell me how that makes you feel. Do you like being *property*, my good little boy?” He asked, and Phainon turned his head to try and escape the breath fanning over his ear. “Are you my *property?*”

“Wait… W-Wait, I can’t… think,” he stammered, caught up in the low voice wrapped around his senses. “When you say it like that, you can call me *anything*.”

“*Ah ah*… We don’t use that word. You don’t mean that,” Mydei hushed, sliding his hand higher up his back. “Answer me. Are you my property? You dress for me. You have my collar on your neck. *Do I own you?*”

Phainon nodded quickly. “I’m… I’m owned by my master.”

“Do you *like* being owned by me?”

“Yes,” he breathed out, and Mydei pulled back to lean against his chair again. “I like it, master.”

“Let’s check ‘*verbal humiliation*’ then,” Mydei mused, speaking normally again. “Then I’ll add a tag for this that says, ‘*must have praise… Phainon is still my good boy*.’”

Glancing at the screen, Phainon read through a list named ‘*objectification*’, which had been broken down into more minor segments. The checked ones included verbal humiliation, begging and pleading, crying, orgasm control, orgasm control, and forced obedience. Things they had done in the past that Mydei knew he enjoyed.

Reading it made his stomach feel fuzzy, warm from Mydei’s teasing yet slightly squeamish from how dirty it looked to see his name next to it all.

“Is that how your brain categorizes this stuff?” Mydei nodded. “‘*Impact play*’? What’s…”

“Hitting.” When he cringed over the blunt response, Mydei nodded in understanding while taking a breath. “Okay. It's the type of play that involves impact to the body, baby. Like when I give you little taps on the cheek or spanks on the ass—that’s us taking part in ‘*impact play*’. I’m not going to punch you, okay? Relax for me.”

Phainon grumbled. “I’ll punch you back…”

“I’d never,” he promised. “Look, I have it down exactly as we’ve done it. Spanking and mid-to-light slaps with my hand on the cheek. That’s what we do, and that’s all we need.”

He turned away from the screen, and Mydei cupped his cheek.

“Are you okay?”

“Yes, master,” he said softly, and those same fingers trailed lower. “And if we find more things we like?”

“I’m leaving a bunch of boxes blank beneath each type of play, and we can write them in with a pen. Once this folder gets too messy again, we can make a new one. It’ll give us this chance to check in with one another on a deeper level again, and we can make sure our goals and desires are still aligned," he explained. “Hold in there a little bit longer, okay?”

Phainon nodded, and the fingers on his cheek lowered.

“How are you? Are you feeling okay?” He asked again.

“I’m okay.” The reassurance made Mydei nod, happy to hear him say it. “Are you?”

“I’m right where I want to be,” he returned, then lowered his gaze. “Phainon, have you ever given much thought to being choked?”

“Like… on your cock? Or *strangled?*”

Mydei paused, probably trying to think of another way to word it. But it took him longer than it did when recovering from the word ‘*hitting*’ to explain ‘*impact play*’.

“When I go down on you and you choke me from going too far, that’s about the only time I ever really think about you taking away my ability to breathe. It’s gotten easier each time we do it, but it's still a lot of pressure and soreness. I don’t mind it if I’m in the mood,” he admitted, assuming that was what he meant. But when he didn’t add it to the list, something told him he already did and was mentioning something else.

Mydei was strong. His hands were large and his grip was tight. The throat was a delicate place, and he held him there so many times while whispering that he wouldn’t squeeze. All this time, did he want to? Was he trying to warm him up to the feeling of a hand in his neck to one day ask this question?

They cuddled back to chest with his hand clasped around his throat. It was always safe there in his palm. Did he want to ruin that?

“Do you want t-to strangle me with your hands?” His voice shook a little as the fingertips touching his skin suddenly felt more daunting. “Or a-a rope? Or something… like that? You want my face a-all purple?”

How red did his face get that night he choked him with deepthroating until he found his limit? How did he look at him from the other side of the blindfold as his body caved from not being able to breathe?

“No. Please don’t think like that, okay? Don’t assume things about me,” Mydei shot down calmly, lifting his hand off his body. “Breathe. Have I ever given you a reason to believe I’d want to push you that far?”

His head shook. The collar on his neck—*thick, padded, and protective*—jingled with the movement.

“Okay. So, you understand the man that I am, and you know that I don’t want to do that,” he denounced, and Phainon nodded next, unable to speak. “I was only asking if you’ve thought of it. I won’t do it.”

“D-Do you want to?”

“I want to know if you’ve considered the possibility.”

He hesitated, staring at the hand between them and how its fingers were curled into the palm to keep from touching him. His thumb was poking at his index finger, scratching along the side of his nail.

“In the beginning, whenever you touched my throat, I thought a few times of you squeezing it. But you never did.” Phainon reached to touch him, wrapping his fist around his thumb to stop him. “Master, I know you won’t hurt me. I'm sorry that was my initial reaction. It just… surprised me.”

“You’re okay,” he hushed. “Forget I asked. “I’ll mark it as a hard limit.”

“How do you safely choke someone, master?” He asked, holding his thumb tighter. “How does it work? Do you just… push down on their windpipe?”

“No! Of course not! That’s how you put someone in the hospital and cause serious damage to them,” he immediately answered, rushing to correct him. “I mean, there’s a big risk in breath play no matter how you go about it, but there’s risks in *everything* we do. Some just have higher stakes than others, and it takes understanding the body and the dangers that come with it. Like if you leave clamps on nipples, you could damage the skin. If you tie the wrong part of the body too tight or in a bad position, you could damage the nerves.”

“Right. You mentioned that before, and… you have those acronyms in our folder about understanding the risks in kinks and keeping things consensual," Phainon hinted. "But you know how to be *careful*.”

“I know the widely accepted way to do it,” he reworded his statement. That told Phainon there was no careful way to choke someone. “We don’t have to.”

“Show me, master?” He whispered, and Mydei raised their combined hands to guide his gaze higher.

“I can show you, but I’m still marking it as a hard limit,” he told him. Phainon didn’t disagree with that. “I’ll use my neck. I understand the risk more than you do.”

Their hands raised, and Mydei created a claw-like shape with his hand before looking him in the eye.

“See this? Don’t push on this.” He pointed up and down his throat, following from the base, up his Adam's apple, and beneath his chin. “We are very strong men, and this is one of the most vulnerable parts of our bodies. This gets crushed like *that*.”

A snap came from behind him, and he jumped, having been so focused that he forgot Mydei was still supporting his back.

“Did Hyacine teach you that?”

“No. This is the very first thing I ever learned because I thought it was *kinky* and *fun*, and my first submissive told me to go in a corner and suck on my thumb. That’s a childish way to look at things that could hurt someone,” he admitted to him. “I don’t get to call myself a dominant if I don’t understand the risks involved in my kinks, and I don’t get to put my hands on someone if I don’t understand the weight of my touch. So, I studied. I learned. I’m teaching this to you so you understand as well.”

Phainon watched their hands slide down, fingers touching his neck on either side of his windpipe. They held on gently, allowing him to get used to the feeling for a moment.

“You push here. Can you feel that?” A light pulse bumped against his fingers. “Lightly close them. You don’t want to *hurt* the other person. You just want a second.”

Mydei pinched their hands, and Phainon stared at their fingers for a moment before shooting his eyes to Mydei’s neutral expression. No heat pooled in his cheeks to fill them up so red they turned purple. No panic lit up in his steadied eyes. He was being *strangled*, yet he didn’t look afraid at all from it.

“C-Can you breathe?”

“Yes. My lungs are fine. It’s all blood,” he explained, pulling their hands away. “These arteries carry blood to the brain. Holding them restricts the flow and causes the brain to receive less.”

Phainon watched him lift his hand to kiss his knuckles.

“That’s scary to think about.”

“Yes. It can be,” he agreed. “We don’t need to do it. I was simply checking all of our bases.”

Another kiss touched his hand, and Mydei pushed his knuckles to his cheek while exhaling.

“Forgive me. I just wanted to ask because you like when I hold your neck or have you practice how to deepthroat. I thought maybe you might have thought about it, and if you did, I would have offered to let you try it. But if you have no interest in it, we don’t need to,” he promised him. “Breath play is very dangerous.”

“I know. Choking on you when I go down on you means possibly suffocating, that’s why you always tell me to take it easy and go slow,” he added, having been completely aware of that. “Yet I do it anyway because I want to get better at it and make you feel good.”

Phainon pulled their hands to him, and he scooted closer until he was as high up as possible on his lap.

“One time,” he offered to him. “I’ll be calm, and I’ll be understanding. You’ll be as gentle as possible, and you’ll be as safe as can be. Right, master?”

“You understand—”

“Yes, the same way I understand you slapping me isn’t really safe either,” he cut him off. “You could hit my eye. You could hurt my ears. Doing this is risky too, and I understand that, master. But I trust you not to hurt me, and I trust you know what you’re doing.”

“Give me a color then,” Mydei instructed him as he raised his hands to reach for his collar. “Right now. Be honest.”

Taking a deep breath, he dropped his shoulders while lifting his chin upwards. The added space gave him all the room he could want to eye every inch of his delicate throat.

“Yellow.”

“Look at me. Don’t look away.”

Phainon met his eyes, and he felt the buckle of his collar come undone. The leather loosened, either half slipping and falling between their bodies with a light clank from the rings. It left the skin naked, ready to accept his fist.

“Hold me,” he ordered gently, and both of his hands wrapped around Mydei’s wrist to follow him. “Show me your fingers.”

Two of them lifted up high.

Mydei’s opposite hand cupped the back of his head, supporting him as he leaned back into it. His hold also served to keep him steady, giving him little room to look away.

“Breathe in nice and slow, and whatever you do, *don’t panic*. Panicking will make you squirm, and it’ll make it harder to breathe. The very moment you get scared, I will stop,” Mydei promised.

“Yes, master.”

His thumb swiped over his cheek. It caressed along his jaw, around his chin, over his Adam’s apple, and then down to the dip at the column of his throat. Gentle rubs followed his breaths, rising with each inhale and falling with every exhale.

The claw shape from before formed, and Phainon felt his touch slide into place around him. Heat from Mydei’s palm rested over his skin. Its weight rested over his collarbones.

“One… Two…” Mydei counted down, examining his expression one last time. “*Three*.”

He pinched, and at first, it wasn’t noticeable. The pressure was odd. The danger felt almost laughable with how he was still able to take a breath and let it go freely. Having a throat full of his cock felt more intimidating as he couldn’t breathe when Mydei was over several inches deep inside of him.

Then the seconds ticked, and he felt the creeping heat climb up the top of his throat and towards his head. It was in his ears first, then his cheeks, and his head entirely. A pulse from his veins pounded, and a weight fogged over his head. Tingling heat pooled in his cheeks, hid behind his nose and eyes, and throbbed in his temples.

“You’re breathing heavier,” Mydei noticed, hyper focused on his expression. “It’s not going to help. This isn’t your *lungs*. This is *blood flow*.”

Phainon stared at him as he choked, breathing but not doing much with the oxygen. They didn’t appease the throbs. They didn’t reach his hot head as the blood was restricted from reaching. That left him unable to do anything but stare at the love and concern in his partner’s shining eyes as he squeezed his throat inside his fist.

All at once, a flood of emotions crashed into him. Reality struck.

Both fingers dropped at once, and Mydei let go immediately to flatten down against his collarbones again. The hand holding his head pulled him closer, allowing him to kiss his cheek, nose, and jaw. Mydei kissed everywhere but his parted lips as he breathed faster.

“Are you okay, baby?” He asked, and Phainon sat there for a moment as the blood began to pump back into his head. “Does anything feel… wrong?”

His nodded. “Throbbing. M-My head feels heavy. Please don’t touch my neck right now. Please just hold me, master. Can we take five?”

“I’ve got you, my prince. Relax, and let your master take care of you,” he hushed quietly.

Closing his eyes, he let himself come down from his rush with Mydei’s reassuring presence. His partner agreed softly, kissing his cheek again and pulling him in so he could hold him as closely as possible.

“You’re okay, baby.”

Phainon closed his eyes as he nodded again, panting softly as he came down from the feeling.

—

Once the shock factor slipped away, being choked with his hand like that wasn’t really… *bad*. It didn’t feel as dangerous as Mydei made it out to be, even if he knew it was definitely

something risky. It was just intense to stare him in the eyes as he felt him holding his throat like that, but he didn't *hate* it. That being said, he didn't *like* it either.

If Mydei warned him beforehand, he could probably do it in micro-doses. Being surprised with a squeezing fist on his neck would probably end up in a fight—a physical one before an emotional one. But Mydei told him '*no*'. Firmly. Absolutely. Even if he wanted it, that kind of play wasn't in his skill set yet. They could try again in the future, but for now, he would only ever hold his neck, never squeeze it.

They filled out the rest of their pages, printed them to fit into their folder, and then gave their signatures at the bottom where '*master*' and '*prince*' were labeled beside dotted lines. Once tucked into sleeves, they were organized and tucked away. Their old papers were shredded and discarded.

After finishing, Phainon was a little bit pent up from all the teasing and testing Mydei did on him. Underneath his skin, there was a rolling hunger to be touched, called a '*good boy*', and be close to him.

"Master, how are you feeling?" He dared to ask as the other man brought a folded blanket to the room with him.

"Good. I'm happy we got to do that together. How are you feeling, baby?" Mydei returned, setting it on the floor. "Did I put you in a more submissive headspace with this?"

"Yes, master…"

Mydei approached him, lightly grabbing him by the waist and kissing his shoulder from behind. He held him tightly as a jolt of anticipation shot through his belly.

"Do you want to be a good boy for your master? Would you like to play with him?" He whispered. Phainon nodded quickly as his hands touched the ones holding him. "Do you want your master to dress up for you?"

"Oh, *please*," he breathed out, already imagining it. "Can you please wear leather? Can you please wear your boots?"

"I can."

Excitement burned inside of him, fueling him.

"Be a good boy and kneel as your wait." A finger pointed to the blanket by his bed. "When I come back, you will dress me and show me how much you like seeing me in those clothes."

"Yes, master," he rushed, walking towards the blanket before turning around. He faced the closet, then sank to his knees on top of it. With his eyes on Mydei, he watched him disappear into his closet.

The faint beeps of his keypad, and the sound of clicking chains followed. He stared at the opened door, waiting patiently.

And when Mydei came back, an arm full of leather clothes, straps, and his boots in hand, he grinned. His imagination already saw him standing over him while looking down at him, eyes firm with power radiating off of him. In the opposite hand, his partner held a bottle of lube, their dildo, and a pair of cuffs. Their short chains hung off of an outstretched finger, allowing them to dangle.

Talking rules, rituals, and roles for as long as they did made him crave to be dominated. Being told how to be good and that he was an owned submissive made him want to prove that he deserved to be Mydei's most prized possession, his most important responsibility.

Mydei set their things down, then reached behind his head to pull his shirt. Golden skin stared back at him, smooth and relaxed.

"I'm in a specific mood too," he told him, then freeing up the knotted drawstring that held his pants up. "You tell me you like certain things, but you're going to show me how much servitude turns you on. I want to see it, not hear it."

Kicking his pants away, they joined together in a pile by his dresser, nudged out of the way and somewhere they could be picked up with ease. He stood there in just socks and briefs. His half-hard cock hung between his legs when pulled from the slit, only for his hand reached to cup over it.

"You like these right here, baby? You like your master's cock and balls?"

"Yes, master," he breathed out, focused on how his hand couldn't hide the entirety of his crotch. "I love them."

Mydei walked up to him until he stood right in front of him, and he lifted his cupped hand as Phainon leaned in closer.

"Open your mouth, but don't suck and don't lick."

Eyes half-lidded and lips parting, he accepted Mydei's balls into his mouth. He accepted his cock hanging over his face, tip touching between his eyes. The tip of his nose was poking by the base, filling his senses with the scent, taste, and heat of Mydei's skin.

"Good boy," Mydei praised him, threading his fingers through his hair to push it back from his face. "Do you like it there?"

Phainon hummed, and Mydei's breaths shook.

"Is this where you belong?" He asked, holding his head gently. "Do you belong beneath your master—pleasing him, taking care of him, *servicing him?*"

He nodded, lips moving around his sack but not enough to pull it even deeper. Spit filled his mouth, and his tongue fought not to move or flick against him. Every inch in him wanted to be good, to fall deeper and deeper into the firm and steady voice washing over him. It warmed his belly and coiled between his hips.

“Do you want to taste this cock before I tuck it away?” A hand picked the length up, stroking it right in front of his eyes slowly. When he nodded again, it paused. “Do you want to feel it get harder in your mouth?”

Phainon nodded once more, and Mydei picked his balls out of his mouth before guiding the tip of his cock towards his lips. Spit dragged over his chin, the result of him soaking them with saliva. But all he cared about was taking inch after inch, holding him in the heat and wetness of his mouth before he filled out even more.

“Don’t move,” Mydei said, speaking camly. “Close your eyes, open yourself to guidance.”

His eyes fluttered shut, and he relaxed as he felt a throb pulse over his tongue. Second by second, he felt the semi-soft, spongy length grow harder, thicker, longer.

“You want to be here for me.” Fingers massaged his scalp, rubbing his temples as he continued to speak. “I want you to be here for me too, my prince.”

Fog rolled over his head, thicker and sweeter, as he felt the cock in his mouth inch deeper. It closed in on the start of his throat, triggering his gag reflex. But as he gagged, soft shushes followed.

“Shh…” Another nudge made him try to breathe slowly from his nose. “Don’t think about your body’s limits. Don’t worry about a single thing. Think about your master’s words. Think about how proud you’re making your master.”

He relaxed, breathing heavier as Mydei slid further.

“Good boy. That’s it.”

His shoulders loosened and his lips eased from where they tightened around him, allowing even the spit pooling in his mouth to seep free. Nails scratched to his scalp lightly, coaxing him further to melt into him.

Nudging again, he felt more of Mydei’s cock push into him, and hair tickled his nose from the depth. Even if his chest jumped inside of his body, if tears pinched in his eyes, if his throat tightened around him, he knelt there for him. He didn’t need to suck. He didn’t need to move. He didn’t need to be anything but a hot, wet place to help get him hard.

“Take your master’s cock all the way. Hold it.”

Skin touched his nose. Spit spilled down his chin.

Veins throbbed against the walls of his throat, and they pumped flush to his tongue. Aches bled into the very corner of his jaw from being opened so wide for so long, but he welcomed them. He braved through them as Mydei sighed happily in pleasure, pleased by his display of submission.

No hands. No fighting. Phainon sat there on his knees with his palms against his thighs, with his chin tilted up and his eyes closed in bliss. It was so safe in Mydei’s hold, and it was so rewarding to have felt Mydei’s growing arousal from him simply being obedient.

Slowly, as he gave another gag, the length of his cock eased out. Slowly, he was given his mouth back, and he used it to hang open after a few coughs.

“Open your eyes.”

Phainon looked up at him, tears burning the corners of his eyes and lips messy with spit. Mydei’s cock was fully hard, glistening and rosy right in front of his eyes. The balls beneath were no better, hanging with a glob of spit right down the middle.

“Stand, take off your clothes,” he said, holding his hands out to help him off his knees. “Is my good boy’s cock as hard as mine? Show me. Let me inspect you.”

While on his feet, he reached for his shirt to wipe his mouth, but a hand stopped him. Upon seeing Mydei shake his head, he then pulled his shirt off without touching the mess on his face. His bottoms followed, pullled down and set aside where Mydei’s own went.

“Hands behind your back. Allow me to check.” Mydei waited for him to grasp his arms behind his back, then reached for his stiffened cock. “Hm…”

Fingers lightly trailed from the bottom of his balls to the very tip, ghosting over the heated skin before twirling around the tip. Stringy, clear pre-cum stuck them together, and he flipped his hand to show him the messy pads. As the light caught it, Phainon’s heart skipped.

“Just the way your master likes it,” he said, voice low with pleased approval. “Big, leaking, and denied. Is this your place?”

“Yes, master,” he answered, twitching when those fingers pinched the head to milk a few more droplets out.

“Clean my fingers.”

They raised, and Phainon’s tongue reached to lick his own release off of them. Forget the sticky texture. Forget the salty tang. As he stared into Mydei’s eyes, feeling small beneath their gaze, he lapped at his fingers as if they were dripping something like honey.

Mydei wiped them on his chest. Their wetness dragged down the dry skin until they were left dried themselves, then looked at the bed. One hand grabbed a pair of pants, and they were handed directly to him.

“Dress your master.”

Phainon picked them up, opened the zipper and button, then knelt to the ground on one knee. Mydei stepped into them, and together, they pulled the leather up his hips. Careful hands tucked him back into into his briefs, then into his pants so he could zip them, buckle them, and admire the way they clung to his hips.

The only talking that followed was Mydei’s short and precise instructions. He told him how to wrap a belt around his thigh and how to clip a leather cuff around his wrist. Both were self explanatory, but the guidance left him no room to think. All he could do was act. All he was *meant* to do was obey.

His fingers marveled over the girth of Mydei's arms as he slid a cuff in place, then again as he buckled a belt around his firm bicep. They slid slowly over the warm skin, admiring the shape and how his muscles were grown from years of discipline. Then again as he touched Mydei's chest to slide the halves of his leather vest, wanting so badly to be face first in his pecs with his mouth closed around the perky, brown nipples on either side. Both looked so inviting.

"Ask." Mydei watched him, eyeing him as if he could read his mind. Had they done this enough to grant him such an ability? "Closed mouths don't get fed."

Phainon gulped. "Can I please suck on your chest, master?"

"Go on."

Leaning in, he pushed the leather aside and then ducked down to kiss over the right one. Mydei's body and the sleeveless vest he wore made for a scent so warm his head spun even more while beneath it, familiar and encouraging in every way possible. His tongue dragged over, circled around, and slicked the bud with saliva before curling his lips around it. He sucked gently in between each kiss, eyes fluttering shut in bliss.

Mydei moaned softly, one hand holding the back of his collar.

Phainon might as well have been making out with his chest, and he was so invested being pulled away made him whine softly. Looking up at Mydei, he practically pouted over being unable to continue milking the soft, pleased noises from his dominant's lips. Especially since he didn't even get to make the second feel good.

It was so unfair of him to leave just one side of his chest pleased, wasn't it?

But his thoughts didn't matter. If Mydei wanted him to be done, then he was done.

"Kneel." His deep voice was still soft, not needing to put any aggression or force behind the word. Just speaking it was enough.

Knees to the blanket, Phainon lowered himself with his hands on his thighs.

Bottom to the bed, Mydei rested and then pressed his foot just in front of his fingers.

"Put my boots on next. No, no… Not that one." Phainon stilled his hand. "The other one. There you go."

Heat burned inside of cheeks from getting his left and right mixed up. Embarrassment shocked his movements, churning in his gut as Mydei watched him closely. The spotlight was suddenly, unbearably, *humiliating*.

"I'm sorry, master. M-My head's… a mess…" He stammered, pulling the heavy shoe closer. His shoulders closed in on themselves with shame to make himself smaller.

"Look at me," Mydei said, and he looked up at him. "Do I sound upset? Do I look upset?"

His head shook. “No, master…”

“There’s no reason to apologize. There’s no reason to believe you’ve done anything wrong. You are here to listen to my voice, to obey my orders, and to take the pleasure I allow you,” he reassured him. “Don’t think. If I don’t say it, it must not be true, do you understand?”

“Yes, master,” Phainon breathed out, trying to relax the tingle of shame.

“My sweet prince is doing so well. Now help me lace my boots. Can you do that? If you can’t, let me know. I’ll help you,” he offered, watching him unzip the inside, unbuckle the closed belts, and pull the laces free from the top.

“I can do it, master.”

Together, they fixed his right boot on, then moved on to the left. His fingers worked the laces into a knot, fit the belt into its buckle, then lingered around Mydei’s ankle as he looked up at him.

“Do you like them?”

He nodded, touching over the leather sides and tall, chunky soles against his thigh. The stitches bumped over his fingers. The leather was cool but smooth, not a single scuff over them.

“I love when you wear them, master.”’

“Do you like them against your bare skin?” He asked, motioning to the shoe sitting in his leg.

Phainon looked at it, rolled his leg left to right, right to left, then gulped.

“Yes, master.”

“Move it higher,” he suggested, and the hands holding it pulled it higher up his thigh. “Look at me. Look at how I’m dressed and you’re completely nude.”

He eyed his bare leg and then the stiff cock between his legs, then the heavy boot on his body and the leather pants tucked into the tongue. Arousal burned under his skin, red hot and coursing. It made his breaths shake, then his hands grip him tighter.

“What are you, my prince?”

“I belong to you, master,” he answered, meeting his eyes next. “I’m… whatever my master wants me to be.”

“A good little slut.” His heart skipped. “You are your master’s good little slut, and you’re going to serve him however he asks. Say it. Verbatim.”

“I’m my master’s good little slut,” Phainon repeated as they looked each other in the eyes. “And I am going to serve him however he asks.”

Tingles thrummed through his body as Mydei's boot moved to then step between his legs. It didn't touch him, not yet, but he knew if Mydei wanted to, it would.

"This right here is so excited…" Mydei pointed out, easing his foot closer. The very tip of his boot nudged between his legs, lifting his cock. "Does this hurt?"

"N-No, master."

"Lift your balls. Put them on top so they don't pinch."

Phainon readjusted himself, and Mydei tilted his boot up to watch his aching, leaking cock bounce once, twice, then three times. Each one made him whine, fists balling but never touching his boot to pull it back.

"I love your dick," Mydei commented casually, and it throbbed. "I like the way it drools for attention when I don't relieve it. Should I give it any? Is your pleasure more important than your master's?"

"I get pleasure from pleasing you, master," he said, voice shaking from the mix of sensations mingling inside of his body.

Arousal from being dominated so completely, humiliation from not being able to think clearly, and guilt from enjoying his boot touching his bare cock and balls all twisted inside of him. They tangled. They knotted. They were all dyed the same rosy color, making it hard to tell what was being pulled when.

But Mydei looked so pleased. He felt larger than life. Looking at him and listening to him felt so… *good*.

Mydei then reeled his foot back, placed it on his thigh, and handed him another belt. This one was significantly shorter with a thick ring in the middle, and he took it before waiting for instruction on where to put it.

But then their purple toy came into his vision. Phainon watched as he took the silicone, slipped it through the silver ring, and held the tip. Leather dangled around the suction cup base, bouncing when Mydei jiggled it.

"Lift my boot."

Phainon lifted it, and Mydei reached to strap it around the middle. Another pull proved it wouldn't slip through.

"You're going to ride my boot," he instructed him. "This is what I want from you, so this is what you'll do for me. Not only do you owe me whatever I'd like, but we've established that you are my property. And I may do whatever I wish with my property."

"Yes, master. I'm your property," he said again, causing him to smile lightly.

"Stand," Mydei ordered, helping him to his feet. "Sit on my leg. That's it."

He sat on his thigh comfortably, maneuvered so he was leaning forward into Mydei's chest with his bottom sticking out, and Mydei reached to uncap the lube. He heard it ooze on to his fingers, then felt it touch against his bare crack.

"Put your arms around me. Hold me."

Phainon did. He clutched on to him as a finger rubbed around his rim, lathering it with lube. His hands held on to one another around Mydei's thick waist, slipped beneath his vest to embed himself within his warmth.

"Do you like having this hole played with?" Mydei asked, touching the middle before pulling back. "Is it more pleasurable to be penetrated than it is to penetrate?"

"Y-Yeah," he gasped, eyes rolling when it pushed closer, stretching him open. "Yeah, I-I like when you fuck me, master."

"What do you like about it? Do you like when it's deep inside of you? Do you like that it's thick and pulls you apart?"

His finger rocked back and forth, taking it slow even when inching deeper and deeper.

"*You*. I like that it belongs to my master," he promised him, not really caring about any of that. "I like when it… it twitches as he cums because that means I pleased him well. I like the way it tastes and smells when he puts it in my mouth…"

"Do you?"

"Yes, master." A pant then left his lips as Mydei's opposite hand pulled his back in, stuck his ass out, and moved to fist his aching cock.

"Isn't it big though?" Mydei asked, stroking him slowly. "Just like this, huh? Though, mine might be a little bigger."

Phainon choked, eyes rolling back from being both jerked off and fingered at the same time.

"But you like that. You like having a big, thick cock inside of your mouth and your ass." The words spun around inside of his head, making a home inside of his skull. "You've practiced for it. You've begged for it. You'd do anything for it."

Lips brushed his ear, kissing beneath.

"My good… little… *cock slut*."

Mydei pushed his finger down to the last knuckle, dropped his fist tightly over his cock, and then wiggled one while pulsing the other. Pleasure bled through both sides of his body, jolting inside of his belly enough to make it ache. His walls clenched. His cock throbbed.

Breathy and broken moans fell from his lips unabashedly, filling the room and fanning over the leather-clad chest in front of him.

“Don’t cum,” he was told, and his head turned deeper into his chest. “Do you remember what you need to do in order to orgasm?”

“Yes… Y-Yes, master,” he forced out. “I need to ask. I need to ask my master f-for permission to cum.”

“Why?”

“Because my master likes when I’m needy. H-He likes when my cock is… is leaky and hard,” Phainon answered, then bucked his hips back into his hands. “Please, master. Please, more.”

“None of that,” Mydei chided. “You take what is given to you for now, and you enjoy it, do you understand? If I offer, you may ask. But until then, you accept as little or as much pleasure as I allow.”

“I’m sorry, master. I’m so sorry,” he rushed, wiggling as his opening and closing fist began to slip up and down his cock. Upon tightening around the tip, he cried out. “*Master!*”

Mydei only continued, toying with his body however he felt like. Two fingers soon replaced his one, stretching him more for the toy still attached to his boot. They scissored around the rim, rubbed up on his prostate, and flexed as deeply as possible inside of him. The fist on his cock was no better, especially since it always released him once his voice grew too loud and too broken.

Leather stuck to the side of his face. It was slippery from his hot breaths fanning over it repeatedly and his sweat gliding over. All he smelled was the peppery vest and Mydei’s own musk.

“M-Master… Master, I’m close—”

His hand left. His fingers stilled. They waited for him to catch a breath, for him to twitch helplessly, then continued. Pleasure surged as if it had never rolled away, stronger than before.

“*Master, stop! Stop, s-stop, stop!*”

Mydei stopped again, and he cried helplessly into his chest as the rush eased away. That heightened sensitivity was so close, the very peak of pleasure was right there, and yet the distance stretched. Those crashing waves mellowed, leaving him hot, pent up, and on the brink.

“Shh… Calm down,” Mydei soothed, taking the hand that was on his cock. “You’re okay.”

Two fingers wet with his own pre-cum touched his lips, and he accepted them as the ones inside of him began to move slowly. He sucked on them, muffling his own cries despite the tears leaking down his cheeks. Each thrust made him moan, the sound vibrating through the air.

“My boy is doing so good,” Mydei whispered, beginning to pump the hand in his mouth next. “Are you my boy, baby?”

He nodded quickly, vision blurry and head dizzy.

“Yes you are,” he agreed. “You are my handsome, strong, and slutty little boy. That means you can take it, right?”

Phainon nodded once more.

“I know you can. You’ve got it,” he encouraged him, pushing both hands deeper. “Give me a signal. Tap on my back.”

His fists unballed, and he tapped his back three times. On the third, his nails scratched deep into his back from Mydei pushing as deep as possible.

Gags crawled up his throat, and Mydei chuckled as spit rolled down the sides of his mouth. When one hand pushed in, the other did as well. They moved together, quick and deep, scrambling what was left of his coherency.

When another loud gag wretched from his filled mouth, Mydei pulled back. He kept his fingers on his lips, leaving them there to give him space to pant, swallow, and cry from him fucking down into his prostate. Each bump made his cock jerk and belly tighten.

“No, no, n-no,” he rasped, trying to wiggle away from the onslaught of pleasure. “I’m g-gonna cum. Master, stop. Master, I-I can’t—!”

Mydei pulled back, leaving him there as the stirred up pleasure froze in place. Then, it melted away second by second.

“Good job denying your own orgasms. What a good boy for your master,” he coo’ed. “Straighten up. Give me your attention.”

His heavy body twitched, and he pulled himself back. Wet hands steadied his wobbling frame, holding him firmly as his hazy, blurry eyes looked up at Mydei.

“So fucked out,” Mydei murmured, pushing the damp hair from his face. “Oh, my sweet prince. You’re most beautiful like this. I love when you have that look in your eyes. Do you need to be filled with a cock yet?”

“Yes, master,” he breathed out. “I-I need it. Please. Can I please have a cock, master?”

“Get on your knees, baby. Straddle my boot.”

Phainon moved to position himself on the blanket again, both knees spreading around the one with his toy. Mydei eased them as far as possible with his opposite foot, blocking him from closing them anymore than necessary.

“Cup your hands.”

His opened palms were given a dribble of lube, and upon being told to, he grasped the toy. Slick was lathered up and down its length, and Phainon wished so, *so* much he was lubing Mydei up to slip inside of him. This cold, lifeless rubber had nothing on his dominant, and even if he was meant to accept what he was being given, part of him just wanted more. It wanted *him*.

“Position yourself.”

One hand gripped the toy, poking its head against his stretched hole. It pushed weakly, preparing to slip inside of him.

“Now, bring your hands to me. Clasp them together around my leg, and show me.”

He did. His arms closed around Mydei’s leg, sticky fingers interlocking, and then lifted to the side. Once seen, he watched as Mydei picked his hand cuffs up. Cool leather encompassed his wrists one by one, keeping his body bound to Mydei.

His ass was going to be on the toy. His hands were cuffed behind his calf. His leg was being held back by his heavy boot.

“Give me a color,” Mydei double-checked, allowing him to rest his hands against the heel of his shoe.

“Green, master.”

“Tell me how you’re feeling,” he said, bringing his knuckles to his cheek to wipe one of his tears. “Where is your head?”

“I… I don’t… know,” he admitted, aware he didn’t like that but unable to really think of a proper response. “My head’s so fuzzy, master. I just wanna be good… *Please*. I wanna be your good boy.”

“And you are. You are my good boy,” he promised him. “Sit down nice and slow, baby. Fill yourself up with cock for me, for your master.”

Phainon’s body lowered, pushing down on the toy until the tip popped in. A sharp and sudden gasp fell from his lips, and Mydei licked over his lips as he watched him.

“Lower.”

He eased himself down more, taking it inch by inch. Though it wasn’t as long as Mydei, it still wasn’t small. It reached deep enough to make his walls tighten, and it was thick enough to need a moment.

“Stay.”

Leather touched his ass and balls as he settled down over it. His cock pressed up against the laces as he whimpered quietly, overwhelmed from the unfamiliar feeling. His chest pushed to the leather pant leg in front of him, sticking from the sweat.

Mydei pushed his hair back, tilted his chin up, and smiled kindly while admiring him.

“Is it good?” He checked, and Phainon nodded. “Do you like having a cock balls deep in you?”

“I l-love it, master.”

“Up.” His body raised, picking himself up until just the head was tucked inside of him. “Down.”

Dropping back down ripped a loud, unabashed moan from his lips. But the moment was short-lived as Mydei grinned wider.

“Up,” he ordered again, watching him lift his ass higher. “Down.”

Another jolt of pleasure from taking every inch bolted through his body. Another moan fell. As he sat there, twitching, his head felt as if it had floated off to another plane of existence entirely.

“That’s all you need to do. Up and down. Up and down.” Phainon’s body moved as he spoke. “Don’t cum without permission, and don’t stop. Can you do that?”

“Yes, master. Yes,” he rushed. “I can be your good boy.”

Mydei continued to guide him. He continued to watch him. Every movement Phainon made was taken only after given to him, and every thought that passed his mind was centered around Mydei. If it didn’t please him, then it wasn’t worth thinking about.

Between his breathy ‘*ah ah ah’s* and the wet squelch of the toy sliding in and out of his slick ass, the only other sound was Mydei’s two words—‘*up*’ and ‘*down*’.

Phainon’s cock bobbed uselessly with his movements, rutting up against the bumpy laces and smooth belts of Mydei’s shoe. Precum oozed over the leather, smearing over the tip and glossing the black fabric.

Then Mydei bounced his foot, pushed it deeper as he was dropping down on the toy, and he hiccuped sharply.

“Keep going, baby. I didn’t say stop,” he scolded him. “Up. Down. Up. Down. Follow that rhythm now. Don’t let up.”

He bounced it again, and again, and again.

“M-Master, can I please cum?” He begged. “Can I please cum for you?”

“*No*.”

His lips shook. “Master, please? I’ll do anything. *Anything*.”

Phainon watched him stand. He watched as Mydei suddenly became over twice his height, towering over him like an impenetrable wall. Those eyes staring down at him made him feel a lot like a small animal caught by a predator waiting to hunt. But where was he supposed to go when handcuffed to him?

“Keep riding, boy. You’ve got it,” Mydei instructed him. “Don’t stop. Don’t cum.”

Both hands reached for his belt, unbuckling the leather before popping the button on his pants open. Its zipper followed.

“Open your mouth for your master.”

His jaw fell, and Mydei pulled his rock hard cock free. Stiff and full of life, it was slick with pre-cum and rosy from neglect. A few pumps made it twitch. A tug on his balls beneath made it throb.

The wet head soon touched his bottom lip, and he curled his lips around it when Mydei pushed deeper.

“Perfect,” he sighed happily, pleased by his hollowing cheeks. “Close your eyes. Enjoy the feeling of both your holes being filled for me. Enjoy being the center of your master’s attention.”

Phainon basked in it. He reveled in it.

Mydei touched his hair, slid down to his shoulders, and squeezed his arms. He filled his mouth, sat over his tongue, oozed over his tastebuds. One boot kept his legs apart, and the other kept his dildo still. Amber eyes watched every tear, each blush, and the occasional slip of drool. All of him was monitored, guided, and taken care of.

He moaned softly, melting beneath the heat of his spotlight. His hips rolled to impress, and his head bobbed to please, working to give Mydei the show he wanted.

“My handsome boy,” he praised him. “Your body’s so beautiful. I could watch you all day. Perhaps one day I might make a personal entertainer out of you.”

A positive hum vibrated in response.

“I could tie you up in your favorite ropes, lay you down somewhere soft, and watch you as you squirm from being used by toys,” Mydei commented, feeding his empty head with images so crystal clear they were hard to ignore. “We could use a bigger collection of toys.”

Phainon could see it. He could imagine being tied in a diamond-patterned harness with his hands bound, back on the couch or bed, as a toy pumped into him. He saw Mydei there, watching his body like every twitch and shake, each moan and cry, was fine art worth admiring. In this scenario, his dominant would never stop looking at him as he was fucked open.

That sounded fun. That sounded like it’d make Mydei so happy. It’d then make *him* happy.

“I’d like to buy bigger dildos for you, ones that could stretch you out nice and deep like my cock does,” Mydei then added, and the image in his head shifted. “Maybe even bigger than mine if you'd like. I’m not insecure.”

His ass tightened. His cock twitched.

The toy Mydei would make him use would fill him up even more than his cock, pushing him to his limits. His cruel master *did* like to see just how far his body could go for him.

“I’ve always wanted to buy a nice machine too. There’s no room here, but in a new place, maybe,” he thought out loud. “One I could turn on and sit back to watch as my handsome submissive is taken apart, supervising even if I’m not in the mood to fuck you myself.”

A ‘*machine*’?

Phainon thought he saw one of those while scouring the internet in the past. If Mydei wanted one of those expensive looking things, he should buy one.

He should lay him down on the bench by his bed, stick his ass out, and then turn it on to watch as he was fucked as slowly or as quickly as he’d like. He should sip his whiskey after a long day of work and enjoy himself however he’d like—including watching free *porn* of him if he didn’t want to step up and take one of his holes himself.

Phainon would be like the pornstars online for him, and if that was what Mydei would like, then he trusted him. He wanted that for him. What was the difference between *that* and between *now?*

“*Earth to my handsome boy*.”

Mydei snapped his fingers, and his eyes shifted to look up at him.

“There you go. Look at me,” he said gently, cradling the back of his head next. “Don’t stop looking at me with those beautiful, teary eyes. Don’t stop focusing on me.”

A thumb swiped one of his tears away, and Mydei brought it to his lips before moaning softly.

“Mm… do you want to cum?” Mydei asked next, and he shook his head. “No? Tell me why, Phainon.”

Together, they pulled him away from his cock, and Phainon panted softly. “My master s-said not to cum, and he likes my… my leaky and denied dick, so I don’t wanna. I wanna be good.”

Mydei chuckled. “But what if I want you to cum, baby? Won’t you want that too?”

“I want whatever my master wants.”

“Sit higher on your knees for me,” he ordered, then looked down at the way his thighs trembled as they rose slowly.

Phainon's legs were tired. Between kneeling for long periods of time and riding the toy, he had slowed down a lot. There was a kink inside of his thighs from being stretched so wide for so long, and the act made him even more breathless than riding should.

But he was ready to keep going. He was ready to keep being good. Nothing would stop him.

"Come here," he told him. "Come here one last time. After this, you don't need to do anything."

Mydei helped him stand on his shaking legs. He waited for him to get off of the dildo, then very, *very* carefully lifted his boot out from his cuffed hands. When free to move, he then caught his stumble from how exhausted his body was and guided him on to lap once he sat down. Knees on the bed, thighs around his hips, Mydei held him closely as they looked at one another. Nose to nose, breath to breath, he watched him as he lined his cock up to the lubed up, stretched hole above it.

"Just sit, baby. That's all you have to do. Sit on your master's cock, keep it warm inside that tight hole, and let him make you cum," he promised. "That's it. You're doing so good. Mm… my sweet baby boy."

Phainon tingled over the new pet name, then whimpered over the stretch of being entered once again. Mydei's cock was hotter, significantly harder than the toy, thicker, and longer all at once. As it filled him inch by inch, he couldn't help but both feel at peace with finally getting to have it and tired from all the overwhelming sensations.

"There you go," Mydei coo'ed, speaking softly despite the pleased strain. "Balls deep in my boy's perfect hole. Just keep it warm for your master, okay?"

"Yes, master."

"And allow me to make my good boy cum."

A hot hand wrapped around his stiff and aching cock, spreading the pre-cum around. His thumb rubbed against the tip, rolling it around before twisting and lowering.

"*M-Master*,—"

"Let it out," he encouraged him. "Don't hide a thing from me. And when you get close, make sure you ask even if I'm allowing you to."

Phainon moaned loudly as he was jerked off with a firm fist. His legs twitched. His hands scratched into Mydei's bare waist for purchase. There was no stopping the loud moans and stuttered breaths falling from his lips, nor the continuous clench and unclench of his ass wrapped around Mydei's cock.

He didn't stop a single reaction, not the buck of his hips or the way he threw his head back so hard that Mydei had to then cradle him to keep him from doing it again.

"Please," he begged, looking down at his sparkling yet darkened eyes. "Master, please. I-I'm gonna… *h-hah*... I'm gonna cum. Please, can I h-have your permission to cum? Please?

Please, please, please?"

Mydei looked so pleased as he took his time to respond.

"No, s-stop. Master, you're gonna make me cum. I can't. Stop," he sobbed, squirming as he tried desperately to hold back his orgasm. "Master, please. Can I…? B-Before you make me…—!"

But Mydei kept jerking him off. He kept swiping over the head, squeezing down by the base, and twisting his fist.

"*Please!*"

"Yes, baby. Cum for your master," he allowed, finally deciding to give him the permission he was begging for. "Cum all over his chest."

"Thank you, master," he cried, relaxing his flexed stomach and grinding down to his stiff cock. "O-Oh, thank you. Thank you. *Th-Thank you!*"

Mydei watched. He raked his eyes over his glazed over expression and stared at his messy and dropped open mouth. He didn't stop for even a second.

"Keep your eyes open for me. Keep looking back at me, Phainon," he said, and even if his eyelids drooped, Phainon didn't close them at all.

Back arched, face scrunched, and nails dug deep into muscle, the orgasm that hit his body was violent and sudden. The moan that left his lips was nearly a breathless scream, one that ached in his throat and could've possibly permeated the cement floors of the building. But Phainon didn't care. Mydei didn't care, so why should he?

It felt so good. Finally being allowed an orgasm after nonstop stimulation and a sea of teasing felt so good that he could scream and cry out of joy.

His insides clamped down so hard that Mydei groaned out of pleasure himself, and streaky ropes of cum painted his dominant's chest, leather vest, hand, and wrist. Its milky color stood out starkly against the black leather, looking obscene against its clean surface.

Phainon's chest rose and fell quickly, fighting to catch his breath through his exhaustion. Tears continued to leak down his cheeks, and a little bit of drool too considering he felt the light trickle.

Mydei smiled, raising his hand towards his lips to lick around his thumb and index finger. A pool of cum laid there, lapped up happily like it was something delicious.

Still hazy, Phainon reached for his bare forearm and then pulled his arm closer. The chain between his cuffs jingled, shifting and swinging lightly. With a drag of his tongue, he licked the streak of seed that painted his wrist cuff. Mingled with the salty release was leather, hot and slightly earthy.

Inside of him, Mydei's cock twitched.

“I… I just learned something about myself,” Mydei whispered, watching him then pull his tongue away from the leather cuff. “I love you. I love every kinky and vanilla part about you. *Fuck, Phainon*…”

Smiling, he tilted his head as exhaust inched through his body. “I love you too, master.”

Mydei brought him closer with the hand on his head, then leaned in to kiss his lips gently. He tasted like cum and spit, but Phainon welcomed it anyway. He lapped at it hungrily.

“Keep your master’s cock warm inside of you,” Mydei whispered as they pulled away. “I won’t move an inch. You won’t move an inch. Just keep it there, let me hold you, and I’ll give you my load when you come down a bit.”

“Yes, master.”

“Kiss me again, baby. I miss your lips already,” Mydei demanded, and Phainon leaned back in to kiss him. “Mm… Good boy.”

—

Phainon wasn’t sure how long Mydei kept his cock inside of him. Time slipped by fast, and he was so comfortable in his arms as he whispered how much he loved him, how proud he was of him, and how gorgeous he looked. His head was elsewhere, floating up where they could live like this forever.

But it couldn’t last all day.

Mydei soon lifted one leg to his knee, jostling him from his comfortable spot of listening to his heartbeat, and unstrapped the toy from his boot. After, he uncuffed his wrists and set them aside to be forgotten.

“Master?”

“I’m going to do all the work,” he reassured him, grabbing the lube beside them to crack it open. “You can take just a couple minutes of me, baby. I won’t be long.”

He was guided higher, and cold lube was reapplied around his stretched ass. The temperature shock made him twitch, as everything down there was so hot from use. But Mydei only continued, slicking them both up to make sure he wouldn’t hurt him. Then, he picked him up as he stood.

When was he able to do *that* so effortlessly? It wasn’t as if his body was light when he was over six-foot and full of muscle.

“Don’t look so surprised,” Mydei mused, carrying him towards what felt like the bathroom. “I’ve increased my max in our time together. Did you think I’d ever settle for being unable to

carry my prince around with ease? No way."

Phainon's back hit a wall, and he grabbed onto his partner's neck as his legs were held beneath the knees. He spread him open, grinded into his ass, and then eyed his bare body hungrily.

"You're all here, right?"

"Huh? Yeah… I mean, my head's clear again," he answered, and Mydei nodded while reeling his hips back. "*Oh f-fuck!*"

"I was patient," Mydei told him, voice strained from pleasure. "I got you off first. I gave you your time to play, focused all my attention on making you feel good, and when I noticed you were too far gone, I gave you all the time you needed to come back down to me."

Phainon moaned as another thrust rocked into his body.

"And you don't owe me for doing what I'm responsible for, but *if you don't mind*, then I'd like to finish as well."

"Faster," Phainon urged, and Mydei pumped his hips faster for him. "My master's cock f-feels so much better than a toy or his fingers. Oh, I love it. Master, fuck me more."

"You bet I am. I wonder if your tight ass will gape the size of my cock after this. *Fuck*… A perfect hole just for me to fit inside of, huh?" Mydei panted. His head tilted back as he screwed his eyes shut, too choked up on the pleasure to respond right away. "Baby, I want to keep you so full of cock. You're so pretty when you're being fucked that it's not fair sometimes."

"Yeah," he whined in agreement. "Yeah, master. Th-The machine you said—"

"*Oh*. You'd make such a gorgeous centerpiece in my new house, all bare and fucked out until you're just as brainless as you were earlier," his partner breathed out, voice rich with lust as he continued moving his hips. "You make me into be such a greedy person now."

Hot breaths fanned over his jaw as Mydei came in closer, kissing his sweaty skin.

"I can keep you… *ah*… leaky a-and denied all day with a leather cock ring," he panted. "I bet you'd cry big, fat tears for me to let you take it off. *Mmph*… You're so beautiful when y-you cry. Gorgeous, glittery, fucking *puppy dog eyes*."

Mydei sounded so far gone already, like he was knee deep in his fantasies of pushing their sexualities even further than they've gone. Whether he meant it seriously or meant it just to babble out whatever his head conjured up. Phainon wasn't sure. But what he did know was every time Mydei rambled about something sexual, somehow, they ended up trying it out.

Throat training. Spanking. Things like that they've done and enjoyed. And, truthfully, Phainon would probably enjoy being fucked like that so long as Mydei never left him alone with his machine.

“What’s a-a cock ring?”

“Wraps around your cock and balls, makes you l-last longer,” he answered, breathing heavily as he pounded his hips forward. “I want one for myself so I can fuck you longer, so I can make you cry better.”

“You’re gonna b-break me, master,” he said weakly, but something told him that was the point.

“Mm… it’s okay. I’ll put you back together even stronger.” Phainon couldn’t help but grin. “My baby boy… My handsome prince… You’re so strong.”

“Yeah?”

“*Yes*. I love how strong you are. It makes breaking you down even more rewarding… *Oh shit*...” Mydei grunted after. “I’m so close. Baby, beg for your master’s load. Let me hear how much you need it.”

Moaning loudly, he willed his ass to clench around him tightly, milking his twitching cock. “Please, master. Can you please cum inside of me? Always f-feels so good…”

Mydei panted louder as his hips grew less rhythmic and more desperate. He chased his release like it was the only thing that mattered now.

“I was such a good boy, right? A-And a good boy deserves his master’s load, doesn’t he?” Phainon pressed, trying to hold his own composure. “Can you please give your good boy his reward? *Please?*”

He nodded, pushing closer to his body and gripping the back of his knees harder. The force rubbed his back up and down the wall, and a loud clapping noise echoed inside of his empty bathroom. It was then he realized how nice the acoustics were inside of there.

Mydei sounded *so good*, and he looked even better when Phainon tilted his head to the side and admired him.

“Close,” he groaned, and Phainon threaded his fingers through his long hair. “*Ah*, *baby*… You’re so good to me. Take this load, okay? Keep it warm f-for me.”

“Yes, master, I’ll do anything for you,” he promised him, pulling him forehead to forehead. “Come on. You’ve been holding back for so long. Can you cum for me? For your spoiled prince?”

Mydei laughed breathlessly as he nodded, grin wide and amused. “Spoiled brat. Gets every ounce of attention all the time, h-huh?”

“Can you please kiss me, master?”

He nodded, then pressed their lips together gently. Heavy breaths and soft groans broke their kiss up, but Phainon only kissed his mouth closed again and again.

When he finished, it was with one particularly rough pound that had his entire body jerking. Pleased hisses and shaky breaths washed over Phainon's mouth and filled the bathroom, just as rope after rope of cum spilled into his ass.

"Thank you," he gasped, feeling the heat and the rush. "Oh, m-master… Thank you for cumming inside of me."

"So good…" Mydei slurred, humping into him and using his body to milk every last drop out. "Feels so good… *You're so good*…"

Phainon kissed him again, smiling to himself as Mydei's hips slowed to a stop. He rolled into him, grinding deep and lowering his body to seat him on his lap.

Being suspended in the air like this would have been a bit scary if he wasn't already used to being carried around by him. For a second, he wondered if sex in a swing like Mydei wanted in the future would be like that, just less work for them both as they didn't have to hold on and risk dropping him. It made the thought less scary. It made it almost inviting.

Mydei made everything a little bit more inviting when he treated him so well.

"Are you there, master?" He asked, and Mydei nodded as he then ducked to bury himself into his play collar. "Yeah?"

"Mhm… I'm here, baby. I'm right where I wanna be," he promised.

Phainon kissed his head, darting his attention to the mirror to look at both of them together. Mydei's skin was glistening under the lights, wet and slick with sweat from being dressed in leather. His pants were barely pulled down, leaving just enough room for his dick and balls to pop free. It must have been hot inside of those tight pants and heavy boots.

Speaking of his boots…

"Master, I rode your boot earlier," he brought up, staring at the heavy leather shoe.

"Yes, you did," he confirmed. "How did that feel?"

Heat pooled into his face the more he thought of how he must have looked doing that. He had been kneeling over Mydei's shoe, then rode a dildo strapped to it both shamelessly and without much coercion. How *pathetic* of a sight was that?

It was so embarrassing to imagine now that he wasn't lost in his own submission.

"I enjoyed it, but it's embarrassing, isn't it?" Phainon asked sheepishly.

"No," he answered, kissing his shoulder softly after. "You always look so beautiful when you let yourself go. I love the way your skin blushes down your chest, your eyes glaze over with those pretty tears, and you trust me enough to obey my every word without thought."

Phainon hummed, closing his eyes as he listened to him. "I didn't look pathetic?"

“I like when you are,” he reassured him, silently answering his question. “There is no shame here, baby. The only time I’ll ever shame you is if you decide you have a kink for it.”

“‘*Slut*’.”

“Yes, like when I call you my good little slut.”

His ass tightened, and Mydei laughed as he looked up at him. One eyebrow lifted, having felt it, and Phainon smiled innocently.

“Round two in the shower?” Mydei asked hopefully, and Phainon glanced at his large, luxurious, standing shower before looking back at him.

“Are you asking me or telling me, *master?*” He hinted, and Mydei’s cock gave a twitch out of interest.

“Undress me,” he ordered him. “And don’t you spill a drop of my cum on the bathroom floor, or I’ll make you lick it up with your tongue.”

Phainon let out a puff of breath as his legs were lowered, ass tightening to try and keep his load from spilling. He could already feel gravity pulling the mess down.

“And if you feel a little freaky, you can give my dick a nice little once over with your mouth to clean it off,” he hinted, but Mydei’s cock was just balls deep in his ass. Did he really want to lick it when it was *there?*

“My master, who hates messes by the way, sure does like sex to be dirty,” Phainon commented while helping him shred his vest off.

“It’s so much easier to relax about things like messes and filth when I’m completely focused on our play,” Mydei told him. “You have your subspace to melt into. I have my domspace to create that space for you. Now, don’t you have a job to be doing, boy? I’m still wearing these sweaty clothes.”

“Right away, master,” he teased, and Mydei clipped his wristband off as Phainon unbuckled the armband.

Phainon was definitely not going to be walking right when he went home later tonight, but that was okay. He didn’t mind the teasing if it meant he could take not just one, but two of Mydei’s loads inside of him and then get pampered like royalty after.

Chapter End Notes

mydei calling phainon ‘boy’ and ‘baby boy’ and ‘little boy’ as if phainon isnt like x months older than him HAHAHA

(also. this is my favorite version of mydei that ive ever written. i love him so much. thats our kinky and autistic lover boy.)

(also also. their growth really hit for me. idk. i cried a little writing this. i dont even remember half of it. i was so in my element.)

Chapter 30: Chapter Thirty

Chapter Notes

this is kinda short but i think its super cute. also a tiny bit sad. but mostly cute.

sorry it took so long again. i know you guys dont mind but i still feel a lil bad when i take more than a week to update

See the end of the chapter for more notes

In the following days, Phainon had grown more used to Mydei expecting a little bit more from him.

On Monday morning, he asked him to touch his chest a little bit to '*warm him up*' for the day. While sleepy and in bed, his phone propped up by his ear and his eyes closed, both hands rubbed either nipple teasingly. Mydei would tell him he was handsome, smart, and hardworking, but he was *still* his cute little submissive. No matter what '*big boy*' things he did—working long hours, paying his bills, and taking care of himself on his own, he was Mydei's baby boy. And he liked that, didn't he? He liked waking up and getting to toy with his chest and be reminded of his place, right?

… Unfortunately, Phainon *did*. He liked the tickle of arousal from being pent up, then the command of not being allowed to get off. It was like that day Mydei groped his chest as long and as much as he wanted before leaving him like that to go about their days, and it was *sexy*.

Starting that same day, Mydei began to choose what color boxers he would wear when getting ready throughout the week, and Phainon proved his obedience with a picture of the fabric on his thigh. Even when away from him, he was going to remember that he was *Mydei's*. Not that he could ever forget.

And Phainon liked that too. He looked forward to the tingling sensation that filled his body from being good to such a minuscule degree. He liked that Mydei was both confident with his commands for more sexual acts—*as he had explicitly asked him for*—and pleased by his compliance. He liked that, as a reward, he was given audio clips of Mydei praising him or speaking sweetly to him. They were so nice to listen to when away from him.

Fuck. Phainon liked everything about how Mydei took a little bit of time to remind him that he was *owned*. Each instance of picking out his underwear, instructing him to get water, and demanding to know about his dreams was no more than five minutes of their morning, yet it did *so much* for him every morning.

And at night, when he was too tired to think of what to make for dinner, he asked Mydei. Then he listened every time. If his dominant said to make rice, chicken, and veggies—he made two servings of one-pot rice, chicken, and veggies. If his dominant said he was good

and should order Chinese take out, he asked Cyrene if she wanted shrimp fried rice or chicken fried rice more. On the night Cyrene cooked fish for them, he asked permission to have a slice of cake after, knowing it was fulfilling for him to give up the control and for Mydei to take it.

Mydei also wanted to hear him say '*yes, master*' and '*thank you, master*' in audio messages too, which he said softly while in the comfort of his bedroom or hiding out in the bathroom.

Besides just pleasure and satisfaction from his obedience, Phainon was given choices in things Mydei was buying for them to indulge in together too. His dominant sent him photos of different kinds of leather boots, asking which he would rather sit on more. He showed him leather jackets, wondering if he liked studs and belts or if he preferred a cleaner, less flashy coat for when going out in public. Then, Mydei warned him beforehand that he bought gear and clothes without him too, but he'd enjoy it because he knew his prince. That was his executive decision as his master.

Phainon trusted him. If his partner said he'd like them, then he was sure he would.

When ordering toys for them, Mydei also showed him options, asked which he would prefer to add to their '*collection*' as he worded it. Phainon always chose the rubber options over glass or metal. They felt more comfortable in his experience, which Mydei then praised him for knowing what he liked in that regard. If he preferred silicone, then he would buy silicone training plugs and things alike for him.

It was like Mydei heard him say '*let's try more things*' and ran with it, but he found it cute how excited he was.

After work that Friday, he fully planned to go over. Weekends with Mydei were always so nice, and it felt as if they recharged him for the following work week ahead. Not having to worry about driving home for work the next morning was a bonus too, as it was draining having to drive so much.

But then his mother asked that he visit after work, and Phainon had to tell him that instead of stopping by, he was going to his parents' house for dinner. If he wasn't too tired, maybe he would stop by late so they can at least have the morning together. To which Mydei agreed, telling him to have fun, be safe, and to text him if he was going to come over.

It wasn't rare that his mother asked him to visit. Sometimes she just wanted to talk about how Khas gets into her tomatoes sometimes or have him brush Reaver's coat since he squirms too much with her. Sometimes his father liked to check in, ask how his job was going and if ever wanted to join him in getting his pretty hands dirty. A couple of callouses did a man good, supposedly.

Phainon was confused by the extra cars parked outside their home when he got there, by Cyrene's parked in front of the mailbox and an older model of pick-up sitting in the driveway. His mom parked her little sedan in the garage and his father's work truck was parked in front of the gate to the backyard. Whose car was that? And why was Cyrene here without telling him? She *always* told him if she was visiting his parents.

As he walked up to the door, hearing multiple voices before it finally opened, it became a little bit more clear.

“Cyrene, what are you doing at my mom and dad’s house?" He asked slowly, noticing she was slightly dressed up.

When she visited, she’d leave in leggings, messy hair, and a sweater. They were *family*. She didn’t need to *impress* anyone. Yet she had a plaid dress on, make-up to match the baby blue color, and her hair pulled back neatly.

“Phai,” she laughed fakely, then shot a look over her shoulder. “So, um… guess who came down for a night…”

His eyes widened over her nerves.

“And guess who thinks we’re…” Her fake smile widened even further as she opened the door for him even more. Then, her voice raised. “Hey! How was work!”

“Surprise!” His mom beamed, hands up and cheeks rosy from the glass of wine in her hand. “Oh, Phainon! Look who came down for the night!”

“Yeah…” He chuckled awkwardly while stepping inside. “Hey, auntie… uncle…”

Great.

“*Oh my*—you’re so big!” Cyrene’s mother beamed, and he watched as she climbed off of the couch and then rushed over to him. Her hands then flattened out her own dress. “What a man you’ve grown to be! Look at you, Phainon!”

“Gets it from his father, eh?” Her father teased, elbowing the man sitting beside him.

“You bet’cha,” his dad chucked back. One hand raised to greet him. “The apple doesn’t fall far from the tree around here, huh, son?”

Phainon was not ready for this. He wasn’t prepared to put on an act for the sake of pleasantries.

“Look at you two,” she coo’ed, glancing between him and Cyrene as they stood side by side. Either of her slender, freckled hands held his and her wrists. “Where are the rings? Where are my grand babies, huh? You should be all over my daughter, young man. She’s the most beautiful girl in the world, and you’re so lucky to have her.”

“*Oh*.” His eyes darted aside for a second, then looked back down at her. “No, it’s… not like that. We’re not…—”

“Huh?”

“Mom, please,” Cyrene sighed, then turned her around gently. “You had too much wine… Don’t bother Phainon when he just got off work.”

“But you two have been living together for so long! You were begging for years to go live with auntie Audata from the second they left! You clearly had a crush on him!” She reasoned. “It doesn’t take this long to get together and decide you want to have a baby.”

“Stop it,” his mom cut in, pushing her shoulder playfully while giggling. “These two might not even want kids right now! They’re still in that apartment, you know. You don’t have kids until you can take care of them!”

“Oh, go back and fix up your old home!”

“That’s *my* house!” His dad called back, eyes on the television before he titled a beer bottle back. With a loud sigh of pleasure, he then glanced their way. “While I don’t mind a-a little baby or two crawling around, a man needs his own place to grow his future family! That’s our job as men, son.”

This was so *awkward*.

Was this what Cyrene faced every time she went back home to see her parents? Constant jokes and pressure to come back, to bring home a child, and give up on her writing dreams to be a wife and mother?

Not just any wife and mother—*his* wife and *his* baby’s mother. Because boys and girls *couldn’t* just be friends or roommates with one another, it seemed. Because boys *had* to jump the girls they were around like dogs, and girls *had* to deal with it, right?

He felt a little sick at the thought of having *that* kind of life when he loved his own so much.

“My son is smart. He’ll know when the right time to start a family is,” Audata insisted, then looked back at them both to wink. “Cyrene, darling, don’t let him get you pregnant until he can give you a nice big ring and a good home. Hold him accountable.”

“*Right*...” she dragged on uncomfortably. “Phai, don’t worry about it, ‘kay? It’s no rush. Take all the time you need.”

Mydei would not be happy to hear the things that were being said tonight. Just one second of this conversation would probably have him walking right out the door or on the edge of his seat, biting back his tongue for the sake of being kind.

“You guys are… what? Twenty-five? Twenty-six?” Cyrene’s mom asked them curiously. “You guys need to get on it. The older you get, the less fun you can have with your little one. Your bodies aren’t getting any younger.”

“Look at them! They can be on a magazine cover!” Cyrene’s dad waved his hand dismissively. “They’re fine! They have some time before they start feeling the age creep in. *Oh!* And Phainon, your dad says you haven’t left that fancy ol’ restaurant yet. What’s with that?”

“Um… No, sir,” he confirmed, walking into the kitchen before glancing at them through the window above the sink. He wanted to be as far away from them all as possible. “Why? Do

you wanna make a reservation for a special occasion?"

Please say 'no'.

"When are you going to be like your old man and get a man's job? Or are the muscles just for looks?"

Phainon glanced away while reaching for a glass from the cabinet, not wanting to let his expression be seen.

There was another big reason why he didn't go back home sometimes, and it was *this*. Cyrene's parents were terribly and unapologetically *old-fashioned*. It was a side effect of having generations after generations of family that lived in a small farming town all their lives. The men worked hard with little breaks. The women stayed home to watch the kids. Everyone started families before they were twenty-five, and no one ever ventured too far away from the nest.

It was too much to listen to sometimes.

What if he didn't want to do hard labor all his life? What if lifting sacks of wheat and shooting nails into rooftops in the middle of summer wasn't something that appealed to him?

There was nothing wrong with it, but why did he have to do work like that to be considered a '*man*'? Why did he have to have rough, calloused hands and an aching back to be considered '*hard working*'?

Phainon grabbed some ice, hoping their chatter amongst themselves could push the question back far enough to where he didn't need to answer it. But while filling his cup with tea from the refrigerator pitcher, Cyrene's dad's voice came back.

"*Well?*"

Damn.

"It pays decently, and it's not too much trouble," he answered back simply. "I like it there. I have a close friend who works there too, and she makes it even more rewarding."

"What about that degree you made your folks come all the way down here for?" He asked casually, like he didn't see how rude it could be considered. "It doin' anything for ya'?"

"Mm…"

Phainon deflated, not wanting to answer that.

"He has his bachelor's in art," his mom said proudly, swishing her wine around in her glass when he glanced her way. "*Humanities*. He's such a good person, and he just loves to help others and be there for them. He's been that way since he was a boy, but you guys know that!"

His lip curled upwards over her praise, warm from the idea that she was proud of him for it even if it didn't really help him in life yet. Maybe one day he could figure out what good it could be used for, but until then, it just sat in his closet.

"Does it pay? What can you do with a degree for something like that?" Cyrene's mom asked curiously.

Cyrene, herself, tried desperately to talk about how yummy the chocolate cake she took a bite of was. She was moaning while chewing, begging to know what made it so moist, what chocolate his mom used, and if she could give her the recipe sometime. Not that anyone but him seemed to notice, as they were too busy discussing *him* and *his* degree.

She went to college too. She had her degree in art as well, choosing to study all things literature. Why wasn't *her* degree as important as *his?*

"Whatever my son wants," Hieronymus brushed off. "Phainon, you can *do whatever* and *be whoever* you want. You're still so young. Don't mind this old fart. He never even went to college."

"I didn't need college to have a nice home, a beautiful family, and a decent job," he bragged. "Did you, Hieronymus? Audata?"

That wasn't fair to ask. He knew his parents were in the same boat as him—born and raised in a small town where most people went right to work and families after high school.

"Oh, don't be like that… The kids these days wanna keep going to school and meet new people! They wanna learn all they can when they're young so they can relax when they're old like us!" His mom stood up for them. "When the time is right, he'll have his family. I trust him."

"This cake is really good, auntie!"

He stifled a laugh.

"Oh, 'rene, be a dear and get Phainon a slice," her mom said to her, but Phainon shook his head.

"I'm not really—"

"My son can get his own slice. Look how grown he is, and his limbs aren't broken," his dad mocked them. "Girl, sit back down and enjoy yourself. He can cut a piece of—actually, his mom already pre-cut it! He just needs to pick it up! If he can drive a car and go to work, he can get a slice of cake. C'mon now."

At least his parents weren't going to force her to keep up the '*good future wife*' act.

"I… I wanna say '*hi*' to Reaver and Khas," Phainon spoke up, then set his tea down. "Excuse me."

"You're excused, baby," his mom said back.

“Me too!” Cyrene rushed, and the both of them made their way to the sliding door. They couldn’t flip the lock fast enough.

Phainon held it open for her, ignoring the way her mom coo’ed over what a gentleman he grew up to be, then slid it shut to separate them. Once sealed, their voices were no more than severely muffled laughs, he sighed happily. He paid the laughter little mind.

Immediately, Cyrene walked away from the glass and smacked her hands over her forehead. The sound of skin hitting skin made him jump suddenly.

“This is so embarrassing,” she whimpered. “Phai, I want to disappear. I love them, but they’re so…”

“I know.”

“I’m so sorry you have to deal with it.”

He shrugged, getting down on one knee as a large, overactive ball of white fur ran up to him from his dedicated dog house. “It’s not your fault, ‘rene. It’s okay.”

“They told me not to tell you so it could be a surprise.”

“Well, I’m definitely surprised,” he laughed, rubbing Khas’ face before kissing his dark nose. “Oh, you’re so handsome. Look at you. My handsome boy.”

“I bet it’s so disgusting being told all that while you have a boyfriend. God, this blows so badly,” Cyrene continued to ramble. “And the worst part is it won’t stop. No matter what, they’re going to tell us to get married and have kids! They want me to be a pretty little housewife with all these babies! But I can’t break their hearts and tell them I wanna write, travel, and find a pretty girl! Th-They’re gonna be so sad…”

Phainon hummed in understanding as another dog walked up to him, and he smiled while looking at the moon-shaped charm on his collar.

“Hi, Reaver,” he greeted him softly. “You’re so big. Look how handsome you are too…”

They nudged him, licking at his face and pushing him back to get as close as possible. Phainon brought his hands to their collars, grabbing them as their sun and moon shaped charms jingled and clicked.

It really *did* sound like his own.

“I should tell them I have a boyfriend, huh?” He thought out loud, watching as she then looked over at him. “That way they stop pestering you about me.”

“Do you know how traditional they are?” She whispered. “I mean, they’re going to be…—”

That was true. The last thing he wanted was to hear a spiel about how he and Cyrene would make a better couple than him and *the love of his life.*

“I guess I’ll have to keep it in until they go to bed,” he sulked. “I planned on telling my parents when they asked me to come over.”

“Please don’t do it in front of mine. I don’t want to know how they’ll react until it’s my turn. It’s way too nerve-wracking,” she begged, and he nodded in understanding. “Thank you.”

“Anything for you.” He then ruffled Reaver’s fur. “Wanna say ‘*hi*’ to auntie ‘rene? Go! Go say ‘*hi*’!”

Cyrene gasped when he ran towards her, giggling when Reaver nuzzled into her stomach. Watching Phainon smile softly, glad that she could let go for her lingering discomfort and nerves for a second.

“Also, my mom’s chocolate cake recipe comes from a box. She added milk instead of water, butter instead of oil, and chopped up semi-sweet dark chocolate into it,” he spilled. “A little bit of coffee too. It brings out the chocolate.”

“Does it?”

“Mhm. Mydei told me that trick one night, so I told her, now it’s her little secret,” he mused, holding on to Khas. “The more you know.”

“Mydei would make a really good housewife,” she teased and Phainon raised an eyebrow. “But don’t tell him I said that!”

He could laugh.

Mydei may like cooking, baking, and cleaning, but it was *him* who enjoyed dressing handsomely for his boyfriend and being there for him to come home to. While Phainon would never want to give up working to live in Mydei’s home as a spoiled partner, their little domestic roleplay was fun. Cooking for him, cleaning up for him, and waiting around for him didn’t hurt if it was every once in a while.

“I should buy him a little dress,” he played along.

“He might hit you on the head.”

“Maybe,” he brushed off, aware that Mydei would probably give him a confused little look before laughing that he would *never* wear that. “I think I’ll stick to seeing him in leather then.”

“Kinky.” His eyes widened, and she laughed over his flushed expression. “I’m kidding! I bet he’s too sweet to be like that.”

Phainon laughed awkwardly, reaching to pull on his choker lightly. “Mm… Yeah. Mydei’s a real sweetheart…” He agreed.

This was getting dangerous…

“Let’s go back inside before the mosquitos get to you. They always liked your blood more,” he changed the subject, and Cyrene smacked her arm. “Or before you make them extinct…”

She only smiled back at him, then bid Reaver a goodbye before following him to the sliding took. They both took a deep breath before joining their parents again.

It was going to be a long night…

—

Once Cyrene’s parents went to the guest bedroom to rest, Cyrene took off to go home. But Phainon decided to stay a little bit longer to help clean up. He dusted the table cloth off, pulled all of the chairs back to sweep the floor, and picked up the empty bottles of beer and wine. The clean dishes left in the rack were tucked neatly away, and he folded foil over the containers without lids before placing them into the refrigerator.

“I should buy you guys new tupperware,” he commented, and his mother wrapped her arms around his before leaning into him. “Where are all of your lids?”

“It’s fine. They all have clear bottoms, so we can see what it is,” she pointed out as if that made it any better.

“Mom, this is stained orange.”

“Tomato sauce will do that,” she brushed off nonchalantly, making him roll his eyes. “The lids are… somewhere. They didn’t just grow legs, ya’know.”

His next paycheck, he was buying them some new sets. Their refusal mattered little when it pained him to see such an unorganized kitchen.

“Son, who were you on the phone with earlier?” She asked, and he hummed curiously. “At eight. You went to our room and made a call.”

”Well…”

“First, what time is it, Phainon?” His father asked next as he took the garbage bag out from the can and tied the handles together.

He reached for his pocket, then clicked the screen on. While he read the time, his mother gasped quietly. His father hummed as if he had seen it but just wanted to confirm his suspicions.

“What is that?” She asked, taking his phone. “Phainon, who is… *oh my*… Is that Mydei?”

He felt a presence behind him, then a hand rested on his shoulder as they stared at his phone screen. When it faded, Audata clicked it back on to stare at Mydei’s sleeping body. It was

impossible not to notice the two-toned hair spilling over his pillows as he had it since they first met.

“Son?”

His heart pounded, and Phainon took a deep breath while trying to steel himself to confess that Mydei was his boyfriend, he loved him deeply, and he would not be giving them grandchildren in the foreseeable future.

“That’s Mydei,” he confirmed, and his mom clicked the screen back on. “That day, we baked, packaged, and drove around to give cinnamon rolls to all of our friends. We got back to my apartment, watched movies, had dinner, and fell asleep together. I took this when I woke up.”

“O-Oh…”

“See that little guy? He bought me and Cyrene matching teddy bears when she came back from her trip to her parents’,” he chuckled, pointing to the puppy plush with his thumb. “He said it was ‘*courtesy*’.”

“You’re… not into girls anymore?” Hieronymus asked slowly as if trying to make sense of it.

“I am, but… I’m into Mydei the most. I only look at my partner that way,” Phainon answered, and the word, ‘*boyfriend*’, made him take a deep breath. “Um, being with him makes me happy. He and I want to be together for a long time, so… I’m sorry. I won’t be marrying Cyrene, and I never planned on it. She’s just my best friend, nothing more.”

They were silent, and as the screen shut off again, all three pairs of eyes were on the reflections staring back.

“How long?” Audata wondered quietly.

“*Months*.”

“Are you happy with that boy?” His dad added soon after, and Phainon nodded. “You see yourself marrying him one day?”

“I see us being together for a long time,” Phainon settled on, knowing marriage wasn’t something they wanted now. Maybe it’d change over the years. Maybe it wouldn’t. But regardless of what happened, he only wanted Mydei. “He makes me really happy, and he treats me so well that I couldn’t imagine being with someone else.”

His mom didn’t respond. She just held his hand and his phone, taking in the information that was just unloaded onto her. No pretty wife. No darling kids. No traditional little family with a few dogs scurrying around.

Maybe Mydei would open up to having a pet around once he got a house, maybe his own cat as he seemed to love them. But big, messy dogs who loved to roll in dirt? Most likely not.

“How does it work? Do you treat him well? Or does he treat you well? Are *you* the gentleman, or is *Mydei?*” She wondered, and he laughed quietly over her confusion.

“Both of us are, mom. We both treat each other well,” Phainon settled on. “That’s the point. We’re *both* gentlemen.”

“What she’s asking is if you’re the one who gives—”

“*Love!*” Audata scolded her husband immediately, and Phainon rolled his eyes as a hearty chuckle came from behind him. “I don’t need to know all of that! Stop it!”

He definitely didn’t want to tell them that either.

“Mydei is very sweet, you know. Just last week, we went on a date to the beach. He set up a beautiful picnic,” he told them, switching the topic from whether he was a bottom or not to something more family-friendly. “Want to see the pictures we took there?”

“Oh, he drove all the way out there? Of course,” she said sweetly, holding his arm again so he could look through his gallery on his own. Her head leaned into the muscle, using him to rest on.

It was a good thing he made a habit out of deleting the sexy pictures he sent to Mydei. Once in their messages, they were removed from his camera roll completely just in case moments like this happened. Family and friends would always want to see pictures or videos, but no one needed to see their private texts.

“Oh, and he bought me the most beautiful flowers one night,” he brought up, swiping to show them the bouquet. “Look. Aren’t they pretty?”

Both of them nodded and hummed in agreement, and Phainon went back to show them the photos he took on their date. From the candids he took of Mydei driving them, to the ocean over the edge of the highway, to their picnic set up once fully spread out, then the distant horizon as the sun began to set—he didn’t skip out on a moment of letting them into his life. Some photos had them kissing in them. A few hand their handprints in the sand with a heart drawn into it. One or two involved just him or just Mydei, and as the pictures shifted through the day, so did the clothes they wore as they switched outer layers.

He took so many, and he saved the ones Mydei took too. How could he not? It was their first date.

“What about this?” She asked, squinting her eyes as she clicked on one he saved from Mydei’s phone.

It was him. His blue eyes were glittering with fresh tears, and his face lit up a bright shade of rose as he smiled uncontrollably. The sun was behind him, casting a golden glow over his body since the roof of his car was dropped.

“Mydei took that.”

“Look how happy our son is,” Hieronymus commented, zooming in. “My boy looks just like he did when he was a kid, only ya’ have more teeth now. I remember when you were just up to my hip, asking if you could go to a big school with a lot of books and people to meet—like

in those little teenage movies and shows. When we said we'd do our best to take you, you looked at us all smiley and teary too."

Phainon felt a pair of lips touch his arm from where his mom was still holding him.

"If he treats you right and makes you happy, I have no problem with you seeing that boy. I always liked that kid and his mother," she admitted to him.

His heart skipped, and he exhaled shakily as he realized they were *happy* for him. They were going to *accept* this part of him.

Warmth bled into his chest, and he reached to touch the chain around his neck before nodding. His thumb rubbed over the circular ring, pushed against the stone, and made him smile gently.

He always wanted his parents to love his partner. The idea that he'd ever have a relationship where he had it hide it from them or have holidays apart made him uneasy. He wanted his mom to be excited to see them, and his dad to be proud of the person he chose.

To hear they were happy for him being with the man he loved so much made tears prick in the corners of his eyes. While he didn't think they'd *hate* him, he didn't expect them to come around so fast or so easily. And he didn't expect this weight off his chest to make him feel so light.

A finger shut his phone off, then reached to swipe the moisture away before anything could fall. The gesture made Audata look up, Hieronymus look down, and he sniffled as he looked away.

"Are you crying?" His mom asked gently, shifting to stand in front of him instead of wrapping herself on his arm. "Phainon, why are you crying?"

A choked laugh left his lips.

"Oh, you didn't think we'd stand here and tell ya' something like '*you're not our son anymore*', did'ja?" His dad scoffed. "We spent too long being your parents to suddenly stop. You're gonna be our little boy until the end no matter who you bring back home to us."

"The rules these days are always changin'," Audata agreed, waving her hand dismissively. "Boys love boys. Girls love girls. Boys are becomin' girls. Girls look like boys but are still girls. It's all so much! It's hard to keep up with! I just go, '*yeah yeah yeah, whatever you want. Whatever makes you happy. It doesn't change my life any'*."

He nodded, then felt her hand hold his cheek.

"But you tell that boy he better greet us properly as your boyfriend," she scolded, and he laughed again. "He better come over and not be a stranger if he's gonna be kissing and cuddling on my son. I wanna know what he does these days and what he plans to do with you."

“Mydei’s old man is that big-shot company guy, dear, remember? That’s what his mom used to say, always too busy to ever come meet anybody,” he dad reminded her. “No doubt that kid’s got a job there too. What I wanna know is how he spends that money and treats the people around him. No spoiled brat who only thinks of himself is gonna be good enough for you.”

“Mydei does everything for everyone all the time,” he told them. “Just recently, Cyrene and I adopted this cat he used to feed at my apartment complex. He came over with food, toys, and treats for him.”

“Yeah?”

He nodded before sniffling again.

“He’s a really good guy. He’s spoiled, but he’s not a brat at all,” he promised. “I’ll bring him over sometime, or we can all go out to dinner.”

“I’d like that,” his mom agreed, dropping her hand from his cheek. “I’m guessing the reason you told us now and not when auntie and uncle were awake is because they’re a little more closed minded?”

“Little bit, so… if they drone on about Cyrene and I, just laugh along,” he requested, and she rolled her eyes. “I don’t wanna put Cyrene in a spot where they have to tell her bad things about me.”

“Alright, son. That’s your business, and we won’t tell it,” she promised. “But you tell that boy to be good to you.”

“He knows.”

“I gotta take that trash out,” his dad sighed. “If only I had a son with a better back to—”

“I got it.” His eyes then rolled. “I’ll take it out. You two go lay down and get ready for bed.”

Audata sighed. “You leavin’?”

“Yeah, I should check on Cyrene and head to bed myself. It’s late,” he answered, and she nodded despite pouting. “Awh, don’t do that…”

“Come back soon. I miss you.”

“I will,” he promised, then leaned down to kiss her cheek. “I’ll see you later, dad.”

“Just know, we are proud of you every day,” he swore, spinning him around to grip his shoulders. “You are smart, kind, and loved. That’s what matters most in this world.”

He nodded, then leaned into him when he pulled his body in for a hug.

“I love you, boy.”

“I love you and mom too,” he said back, eyes closing for a moment to melt into his touch. “So much…”

He couldn’t wait to tell Mydei the news.

—

Because Cyrene admitted that she stole Cifera from her bed to stay over at theirs for a night, Phainon decided that he could, safely, go visit Mydei’s. As much as he loved both girls, and as much as he wanted to be there for Cyrene, he didn’t want to listen to their giggling all night. He didn’t want to hear their gossip through the walls over celebrities Aglaea has bad mouthed in their phone calls together.

So he texted his boyfriend that he was coming over, walked through the silent lobby with a foiled plate of leftover chocolate cake, rode the empty elevator up to his floor, and unlocked his door as quietly as possible. His shoes were set on the rack. He double checked the door to make sure he locked it, then tucked the cake in the refrigerator for Mydei to taste tomorrow.

And because he knew Mydei would want him to, he also took a bottle of water, drank it quickly, and tossed it into the recycling. There was hardly any noise as he didn’t want to alert him.

Not a single light was turned on. He used his phone screen to navigate through the hallway, to the bedroom, and towards the closet.

Mydei was in bed on his side, back facing him when he walked past. He snored away as if an invisible body was taking up the other half, as if he had left it open for him to come back to. And Phainon planned to take it.

He changed into some pajamas, folded his work clothes neatly to carry them to the bathroom, and he set them in the dirty laundry since they were not only sweaty, but full of invisible grass stains, dog hair, and a little bit stinky from the dogs rubbing against him. With the door closed to block the bathroom light, he began to wash his face, brush his teeth, floss, and prepare for bed. It didn’t take him too long.

By the time he was shutting the lights off and making his way to the bed, Mydei had turned over to face the door since he last saw him. One arm was beneath his pillow to rest his head, and his other arm was curled tightly around a body pillow. Even his leg was thrown over it, pulling it close to his body.

Phainon wished he was that pillow.

He set his phone and choker down on Mydei’s dresser, then tucked his messy hair back from his face. Gently, he brushed over his warm cheek patterned with the indents of his hair.

“Master?” He whispered, admiring his sleeping expression. “I wanna let you know it’s me. I’m not any kind of intruder for you to start wailing on.”

Mydei hummed, low and rumbling, turning deeper into his pillow.

“And can you cuddle me instead? I feel a little left out.”

How dare a pillow get cuddled when he was right here? He should brat about it tomorrow, huff and puff that Mydei didn’t want to hold him, and see where it got him.

“… Mm?”

Phainon chuckled at both the thought and Mydei’s confusion, watching as his eyebrows pinched and his breaths kicked up for a second. He inhaled deeply until his lungs couldn’t hold anymore oxygen. Once it paused, he cracked an eye open to peek. Upon seeing him there, he exhaled slowly.

“Mm… Welcome back, sweet prince,” he rasped, pulling his pillow away almost instantly. “C’mere… What are you doin’ just standing over me like a little creep, huh?”

“Watching you sleep, duh.”

”Stop that. Sleep with me.”

Grinning, he climbed into bed on his side and then turned his back to Mydei happily. They shifted, and a warm blanket wrapped around him when his partner’s heavy, heated arm did. Mydei’s nose touched his neck. His legs tangled with his own.

Immediately, his body relaxed.

“Mas—”

The hand tucked under him lifted, sliding up his body, under his arm, and towards his neck before he could even finish the word. There, fingers stretched to wrap around it, resting beneath his jaw and tucking under his weight. With them in place, Phainon tilted his head and closed his eyes comfortably when he gently pulled back.

Lips touched the top of his spine, kissing him lightly before just lingering there. Warm. Gentle.

This was how he liked to sleep. This was how he wanted to fall asleep *every night*.

“That’s better…” He sighed happily. But before he could relax enough to join him in falling asleep, Phainon hummed softly. “I told them, by the way.”

“Mm… Told who what, baby?” Mydei mumbled, too sleepy to remember that he had spent the evening at his parents’ house. “What’s wrong?”

His head shook. “Nothing. Nothing’s wrong. They’re really happy for us, master.”

Mydei was quiet, swallowing back the spit that would've turned into drool in the middle of the night, then pulled away from his body. The fingers on his neck gave a twitch, but they didn't squeeze.

"… Huh?"

"I told my parents that you're my boyfriend, and they're very happy for us," he repeated. "They're completely fine with me being with you, and they want to meet you as my boyfriend, not just my best friend. That's why I got back so late. We were up for a while talking about you… about *my love*."

"That's… very relieving," Mydei whispered, and Phainon nodded in agreement. "I'd love to meet them as your boyfriend, prince. Let me check my calendar, and let's make it a date to take your parents out somewhere nice."

He smiled at the thought, imagining taking them out and getting to share this part of his life with them. It was one thing to show them pictures or videos, but another entirely to see them together in person.

"They like seafood the most."

"I will find a nice restaurant to take them to," he promised him.

"I can pay for them, and… you can pay for me if you'd like," Phainon offered, feeling the mouth in his skin tilt for a grin.

"I'd like that."

"It's a date then!" Now that he got it off of his chest, he nuzzled deeper into his pillow. "I love you so much, master."

Lips touched his neck, lingering as Mydei whispered softly. "I love you too."

"You can go back to sleep now. I just needed to tell you about it before I could go to bed," he sighed happily. "I'm so happy. It's like… everything is going to work out, and nothing's going to be in the way for us."

Mydei moved, pushing himself up on the arm beneath his pillow before guiding him on to his back. As Phainon looked up at him, he smiled sweetly.

"Goodnight kiss?" He asked hopefully. "Please, master?"

Ducking down, Phainon fluttered his eyes shut while feeling a kiss pressed to his lips. Hair tickled his face as it fell around them. A nose brushed against his own while pushing closer, fanning warm breaths over him.

But when he bit down on his bottom lip, Mydei pulled back with a raised eyebrow.

"You wake me up in the middle of the night, then try to make out while you smell like a wet dog?" He asked, and Phainon pouted.

“I might have been around Khas and Reaver…”

“I can smell that,” he mocked him, making Phainon laugh. “I’m still tired. Let’s go to bed, then when we wake up, we can have all the makeout sessions and sexy time you want… *after* a shower.”

“Yes, master,” he agreed. “I’m sorry I woke you up. I didn’t wanna get in your bed, then have you hit me or something because you weren’t prepared to see me.”

That made him chuckle. “Good thinking.”

They settled back into bed, into Mydei resting behind him comfortably and him laying on his side.

“Wait. Can we have honeyed pancakes for breakfast?” He asked suddenly, thinking of tomorrow and what they could do. “Oh, and can you tie me up? I wanna be tied up in shibari. That sounds fun.”

“Baby, go to bed,” Mydei said firmly, and he hummed. “Stop thinking about tomorrow, and close your eyes.”

“But I’m so excited. I wanna spend every day with my master,” he pouted. “Master, can we also—”

The hand on his neck raised to cover his mouth.

“*Go to bed*.”

Phainon hummed, then shook his head free before grinning to himself. “If you want me to be quiet…”

He kissed his middle fingers, letting his lips stick for a moment before nudging them. Filled with confidence from having the strength to come out to his parents and coming over to Mydei’s place whenever he felt like it, he decided to push a little more by licking them. With a flick of the tongue, Phainon tasted his heated skin.

And when Mydei pushed them into his mouth, he moaned softly.

“I said, *go to bed*,” Mydei repeated, and he nodded quickly as a tingle inched through his body from the command. “Be a good boy, settle down, and sleep. If you don’t want to, then you can go take a hot shower and come back, but you *won’t* get your cuddles. If you wake me up again for them, I’m going to punish you. Make your decision now.”

“Mm-mm…”

“Are you staying here? Do you want to be held and take your shower in the morning?” He asked.

“Mhm…”

“Then be quiet.”

Phainon closed his eyes, relaxing as Mydei slowly peeled his hand back and wiped his fingers on his shirt. They found his neck once more, weaseled around the width, then held him. Their bodies pressed together, and Mydei took a deep breath while settling into place behind him. So as to not disturb him, Phainon gave a little wiggle to wipe his mouth on the pillow beneath his head.

Sealing his lips and closing his eyes, he tried to be good. He tried to lay down, to relax himself and come down from the rush.

He was good. He was going to sleep, waking up with him to work out, then asking him sweetly, cutely, and as convincingly as possible if he could *pretty please* tie him up.

… But how was he supposed to go to sleep while thinking about *that?*

Chapter End Notes

phainon is such a BRAT. never change, baby

Chapter 31: Chapter Thirty-One

Chapter Notes

> kinky kinda spicy but also just a work out chapter i always wanted to write but never got around to.
>
> cw: phainon as a foot rest. because thats a kink we both discovered he had.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Most days, they woke up early, got changed, had a morning snack, stretched a bit, and went to start their day with a workout. In fact, nearly every day together started that way.

But this time, Mydei woke him up by kissing him. With a hand around his neck and lips peppering across his ear and jaw, Phainon woke up smothered in his affection with the sun a little brighter than he was used to. Though he wasn't complaining, it sure was a little bit *different* considering he still smelled like dogs, gave him some unwarranted attitude last night, and woke him up around midnight knowing he always got up around dawn. If anything, he half-expected to be punished for his behavior, not kissed awake like a princess in some fairytale story.

Well, he *was* his '*sweet prince*' and his '*spoiled prince*'…

The innocence in it must have been his imagination, though. Once he was fully conscious and aware of what was happening around him, Mydei's mouth pressed to his ear as his hand lowered to the middle of his chest.

"Good morning, baby."

"G'mornin', master," he rasped out, blinking away the sleep from his vision. "Mm… you're… being clingy…"

"Did you sleep well? How are you feeling?" He asked, and Phainon hummed slowly.

"I slept so good." His answer made Mydei smile. "Um… 'm okay t-to touch, if you wanna…"

"Spoiled little prince," he whispered the *exact* pet name he just thought of. His voice was low and raspy from just waking up, and it sent a shiver up his spine to hear such a sultry tone drift through his morning voice. "You came into my house acting like you owned the place last night. *Tsk. Tsk*."

Phainon touched his hand weakly, subtly trying to coax it lower down his body since he wasn't helping his *problem* by being so mocking.

“Now look at you, acting like I *have* to touch you because you woke up with a little morning wood…” Mydei chastised, then pulled his hand back to instead hold his arm. “Get up. You wanted to be tied up *so badly* that you just *had* to keep me up late being a needy little brat, huh?”

His head turned, and Mydei grinned over him. A sparkle lit up his eyes as their bodies shifted until his back was flat to the bed.

“‘*Master, I’m jealous of your pillow. Cuddle me instead*’,” he mocked him with a whiny tone, reaching to grip his cheeks and force their eyes to stay locked together. “‘*Master, don’t go to sleep yet. I want to eat pancakes for breakfast*’.”

Phainon laughed at it. “*Master*,” he mimicked the pouty sound himself, equally as high and mocking as his partner’s voice. “*You’re being so mean to me!*”

“Am I?” Mydei asked as his lip curled into a lopsided grin. “Am I being mean, baby? Do you want to know what would *really* be mean of me to do?”

“What, master?”

“Making you work out in bondage,” he told him, and Phainon’s eyes widened slightly in surprise. “You wanted it *so badly*, baby. You kept me up to *beg for it*.”

His fingers lowered, lining down his cheeks and towards his neck.

“So, *beg for it*.” Phainon shivered again over his firmer tone. “If you want it so badly, your master will happily tie his little *rope bunny* up in a harness and watch him squirm under his clothes.”

It was all so much.

The idea of having ropes under his gym clothes was already a lot, but being goaded endlessly and called a ‘*rope bunny*’ for the first time was even *more*. Mydei was being so condescending, and coupled with his morning wood and slightly groggy state, his brain was a mess. An aroused, nervous, and confused mess.

Why did he like that?

Why did he like the idea of that when one little slip up could possibly expose him as the filthy *pervert* he was? Why did being called ‘*bunny*’ make him tingle like that in his groin when he disliked the idea of being referred to as an animal? Why was that look in Mydei’s eye making him want to agree so badly?

But then Mydei paused, dropped his grin a little bit, and furrowed his eyebrows together. He took a moment to collect himself and think of what he had said.

“No. I didn’t mean to say that,” he backtracked. “I didn’t mean to call you a ‘*bunny*’, baby. You’re not any kind of animal or ‘*pet*’ to me, and you know that.”

And yet Phainon didn't really want the apology because it didn't feel bad to hear it, just confusing.

"A '*rope bunny*' is someone who likes being tied up. I remember seeing it in our chart under the '*bondage*' category," Phainon recalled while giving a little squirm. "Master, if I like being tied up, doesn't that make me *your* '*rope bunny*'? Are you going to keep tying me up in harnesses and pushing me deeper into it?"

"You're okay with being called a '*bunny*'?"

"Am I a bunny with puppy dog eyes, master?" He asked, looking up at him with a light pout.

Mydei was silent as he stared at him, a rosy hue slowly blossoming over his cheeks. His lack of response made Phainon's stomach buzz with excitement.

To this day, he still didn't want to be referred to as Mydei's *pet*. He didn't want to be forced to crawl around on the floor or make animal noises either. But he also couldn't help it if he had '*puppy dog*' eyes or if he would be considered a '*rope bunny*' for liking shibari and rope bondage. Both were just undeniable parts of him at this point.

"I just learned something about myself," he mumbled, and Phainon chuckled as Mydei turned his head. "I can't believe how sexy that was…"

"Me too," he said back. "I trust you, master. If you promise me that it's safe to wear in public, I want you to tie me up and make me work out with you. Please use your ropes and make me a pretty bunny, master."

"*Oh… m-my*…" Mydei breathed out. "*Yes*. Yes, I will protect your modesty. One word from you, and we will drop everything to come back and untie you."

"I'm nervous even if I trust you," he admitted, not quite hesitant but also not jumping too quickly into such a thing. "Won't they get dirty with sweat too?"

"I can wash them and hang them up to dry," he brushed off. "Come on, go do your business then strip down to your briefs. I'm giving you a full body harness this time."

That sounded fun. They never did one of those before.

"You're tying my legs too? Won't that mess with my movement when I squat or run?"

Mydei settled over him, legs spreading around his hips. With his hands on his body, he began to draw crosses and lines over his clothes to help him visualize it beforehand.

"I'm going to make you a corset I saw online," he answered, dragging down fingers from the base of his neck to his collarbones. "It'll come from your neck and hug your chest the way you're used to with the half-harnesses, but be much fuller here on your stomach. Your ass is going to be flossed, and your bulge will be framed. But, I won't tie your legs so you may walk, jump, stretch, and lift them normally."

"Wow. Wedgie much?"

“You can deal with it,” Mydei decided, and Phainon squirmed beneath him over how *little* of a say he had in it. “This might be a little exciting, but it’s still punishment for thinking you run this place.”

Mydei’s hands pushed his shirt up, revealing his bare skin.

“You know, I wonder if I can get you doing push-ups while I lay my boots on your back one of these days…”

Was Mydei trying to kill him? First, it was straddling his boot to look up at him as he was degraded, then it was riding his boot while sucking his cock to have both holes filled, and now he wanted to use him as some kind of human foot rest?

“You’ve gotten more into the boot stuff than you originally warned me about,” he noticed, and Mydei nodded. “Is it new?”

“You’re learning about you, and I'm learning about myself. I always told myself that I *could* do it if someone asked, but I’m realizing I might *want* to do it myself because it’s with you,” he explained himself. “You respond well when I dress up, so it makes me want to keep trying new things.”

He nodded, then reached to hold his arms.

“Do you wanna do a little bit of a home workout instead?” Phainon offered cheekily, toying with the idea. “I’ll go outside with you, stretch and warm up while you work out, and then I’ll do mine here with you…”

“*Pervert*,” Mydei accused, but his lit up eyes proved he liked the sound of that. “Do you really want to do push-ups, planks, and bridges with my boots on your back? Do you want to expose yourself and perform for your master like a good submissive does?”

His stomach fluttered, and a tingle bled through his body as he thought of incorporating their *BDSM*-play into more of their mundane lives. Morning workouts could now be *kinky*, and he… wasn’t as opposed to the idea now as he might’ve been in the past. Especially since he liked being tied up, cuffed, and looking at Mydei as he wore his chunky boots.

Where was the harm in trying?

“If I say I want it, does that still make it a punishment?”

“If I say I want your nipples clamped too, it just might,” he returned, and Phainon felt even hotter beneath his clothes.

“But—”

Mydei was going to bring *those* out too?

“*Ah ah*. Be a good boy and strip down, and prepare to be tied up for our play,” he ordered him. “I wasn’t *asking* you if you wanted them. I was *warning* you to prepare you for them, not start a negotiation.”

He bit down on his bottom lip, even more nervous now that he knew they were going to use them again. The first time was so scary and overwhelming, and they were finally going to bring them back out. Were they going to hurt as badly as they did then? Would he be feeling the tenderness and ache for the next few days?

Mydei watched him, eyeing his face for a moment before doubling down. “We’ve wasted enough time in bed. It’s time to get up,” he ordered, then swung his leg off of his hip.

Phainon followed, scooting towards Mydei’s side of the bed while taking his shirt off slowly. Sitting there made him feel a little bit vulnerable, more than usual, as his bare nipples were there and waiting like clamps would magically manifest to bite into them. Even if he knew, realistically, he wasn’t wearing them outside, it was still nerve-wracking to think about.

Damn, his bratty mouth *really* got him into other questionable places, didn’t it? It got him choked on fingers and cock, spanked red and raw, and now tied up outside where other people could potentially see.

Mydei came back with his bundle of ropes soon after, and Phainon had since kicked his clothes off to the side. He stood up in just his boxers, hands balled by his side.

“Am I going to be able to pee?”

“Sure,” he answered. “Just take it out. I’m not tying your cock. As sexy as that’d be, I don’t think you’re ready for rope wrapped around your dick in public.”

“And… *other things?*” He asked, unsure how he was meant to use the bathroom if he was going to have a rope shoved up his crack *over* his boxers.

“Let me know. I’ll untie you the very moment you feel it,” Mydei promised, already unraveling the crimson ropes. “Give me a second. This is a bit higher difficulty from my usual diamond pattern.”

Phainon nodded, watching as he brought and leveled the rope around the back of his neck.

“You’re going to wear this until it’s time to shower, okay?” Mydei’s lowered voice warned him. “I’m going to give you one of my hoodies, a t-shirt, and a pair of sweatpants. The bulkiness of them will hide the ropes from view.”

“Yes, master.”

Phainon felt him pull his body closer, using the rope in his neck to force them chest to chest. As they looked at one another, Mydei eyed his expression.

“I’m going to make you work out in the living room in just your sweats. I’ll leave the thinner lining closed, but the heavier curtains will be pulled open. No one will see in,” he explained, continuing to detail his plans for him. “When we get back, you’ll take your tops off. Your collar and my boots will be put on, and you’re going to do your work out in front of me.”

“What if I don’t like your feet on me?”

Something told him he probably would. After all, he had his boots on his skin already when he was lacing them up and had them touching his thighs and cock. Why wouldn't he mind if they were on his back as he did a plank? It was less intimate than having them bounce his balls up and down.

"You already did once, so I don't see why you wouldn't now," he mused. "What I understand is you're not as comfortable with the clamps, but we're going to use them. This body is mine, is it not?"

"Yes, master, it is," Phainon said back, reaching to touch his wrists. "I'm yours."

"And that means I can do what I want with it. If I want to watch you work out in bondage, I'm going to make you. If I want to punish you with clamps to remind you who you belong to, that's my right, correct?" Mydei double-checked, bringing his hands down the length of the rope until he met his nipples. "Because you are my boy, I am your master, and you obey what I tell you to."

"Yes, master."

"Good. Drop your hands." Phainon let them hang by his sides again. "I understand how you feel about them, and you can tell me '*no*', or '*stop*', or even '*take them off*', but I'm not going to listen."

Thumbs brushed over his nipples, and he nodded as Mydei rubbed the skin around them slowly. The gentle circles were barely more than a caress, causing the skin to pebble and his nerves to tingle.

"If it's not your safeword, I'm not going to stop. I'm going to push you."

"I understand," he promised, and Mydei leaned in to plant a soft kiss on his lips.

"Good boy."

—

Leaving the house wasn't so bad, but a lingering itch of *filth* stained his insides. It knotted itself, heavy and anchored.

The ropes were difficult to see beneath Mydei's clothes. His hoodie was puffy yet heavy, fabric able to pinch and hold its shape rather than lightweight and confirming to the shape of his body. His sweats were the same, tight on his lower belly where he hiked them a little higher than usual but loose around the crotch and back. No one could see the frictions bulge from his outfit, nor the knot where leftover rope was wrapped around his back.

There was slightly more people than usual, but they were also a little bit later than usual. It wasn't quite sunrise anymore, as talking, tying, and having their snack before working out all

took time. And that time meant more people were waking up at more acceptable hours to go to the gym, which was most likely the point.

There was a woman on a bike talking to someone in an ear piece, then a couple of men off jumping rope and doing weighted pushups. They were all preoccupied in their own world, and yet it felt like at any moment, they could snap their necks towards him and see right through his clothes. Reason told him that was impossible. He looked like any other guy, just a bit more covered up. But the fear remained.

Phainon was simply taking up space there to talk, yet after stretching with Mydei and warming up his body a bit, he stood by him to spot his lifts. Sometimes he shoved his hands into the pocket of his hoodie just to feel the ropes lining down his torso and remind himself that he was outside in a shibari harness. This daily thing they did, they introduced kink to it, and he liked it.

It was one thing to implement '*master*' into his language, then another to ask permission for things like treats before he indulged. But to implement *bondage* into their workouts was different because if they liked it, then this could become their normal too. Maybe not every day, but something normal.

Casual kink. It wouldn't be a punishment or a play session, just a part of their every day lives. That was what he asked for, and it was exciting to watch new ideas for their future blossom to life.

They talked about their plans, about Mydei telling him they were going to have veggie omelettes and sausage for breakfast—*not* honeycakes. Mydei was taking him to the store to buy ingredients to bake a dessert for the next week and meal prep lunches and breakfasts for the next few days. He wanted to go out, pick up a nice puzzle to do together after dinner, then a nice frame to hang it up as wall art. It was one of their date nights, and Phainon liked the idea a lot.

When Mydei finished, his hand settled over his back, pushing the ropes closer to his skin. The touch made him bite the inside of his bottom lip, sensitive to the fibers rubbing against him. In touching him like that, it also flattened his sweater down to the harness, possibly defining the shapes better for someone to glance their way and ask themselves, '*hey, why does his back look so weird?'*

Inside of the elevator, Mydei's fingers peeled his shirt and sweater higher. He traced the rope slowly, pushing down firmly, and Phainon glanced at him.

"P-Please…"

"I'm not doing anything," he brushed off, watching the floors change. "How are you holding up?"

A simmering pot of arousal bubbled in his belly. When he twisted, he felt the harness shift stiffly around him. As his back touched the wall, he felt the bundle dig into his body firmly.

It was so *dirty*. It was so *exhilarating*.

”’m okay, master…”

Mydei guided him forward when the doors opened, allowing him to walk first. He unlocked the front door for him too, eyes glued to his body every step of the way.

“Grab a few bottles of water and put them in the living room,” Mydei demanded while they placed their shoes on the rack beside them. “Take your clothes off, move the coffee table, and wait for me by the couch.”

Phainon did. He carefully moved his coffee table out of the way, cautious of scratching his floor with its feet. The shirt and sweater he wore were folded neatly and left on a cushion away from where he figured Mydei would be sitting. And as he waited, hearing the faint beep of their cabinet full of toys to unlock it, he began warming up again.

Crossing his arms and raising them overhead, bending over to touch his toes and stretching his leg out while leaning down, he took his time making sure he was ready. By the time he finished, he felt a pair of hands touch the ropes by his waist, fingers stretching to follow them before pulling him back gently.

Crisp and cool leather covered Mydei’s wrists and hands, only his fingers left bare. The golden skin looked more inviting when framed by the daunting, shining fabric.

“Wh-When did you get those?” Phainon found the strength to ask. His cuffs were old, but the fingerless gloves strapped on his knuckles were new.

“I told you, I bought some things I figured you’d like.” Mydei chuckled into his ear after, still touching the ropes but not his skin. “Don’t my hands look good?”

“Yes, master,” he answered, unable to look away.

They raised, climbing the crosses of rope higher up his torso. He could imagine his soft touch on his skin, feather light and teasing. *Always* teasing. Mydei was *nothing* if not a filthy *tease*.

His cock twitched inside of his briefs, throbbing with life as his left hand came closer. Fingertips raised to his neck. They dragged over his Adam’s apple then curled to trace the artery on the left side, nail lightly scratching the surface of his skin. Not once did he actually let him feel his glove.

It was there that his other hand raised a collar to his neck, pushing the padded accessory to his throat. Hardware clinked and jingled. The collar lightly moved when he swallowed and followed the shape of his throat.

“Are you going to give your master a show?” His collar gave another jingle before it was fitted around his throat. “Show me what you do to stay fit for me, boy.”

Oh… Oh fuck…

Arousal, deep and boiling, pooled in his gut and groin. Deep inside, his ass gave a little clench around nothing as if it craved to end this with sweaty, sticky sex.

“Yes, master. I will,” he promised, turning his head in the direction of Mydei’s mouth to feel it against his skin.

Phainon knew that he didn’t exercise to ‘*stay fit for him*’, diet to ‘*stay healthy for him*’, and dress to ‘*stay handsome for him*’. He did these things because exercise and diets kept his body healthy *for himself* and dressing up nicely made him feel good *about himself*. These were things most people did on their own volition. If he wanted to stop being so strict with his body, Mydei would love him even if he skipped a day at the gym. If he gained weight, if he lost weight, if anything happened at all, Mydei only wished for him to be healthy and happy at the end of the day.

‘*Healthy*’ didn’t entail a six-pack or a figure packed with muscle, they both knew that. Someone could look like him and be considered ‘*unhealthy*’ too.

But when Mydei phrased these average actions of self-care to be *for him*, it ticked a greedy part of Phainon’s brain. It was the part that desperately wanted to be *praised* for upholding this lifestyle even if he were meant to be doing it anyway for himself.

“Stand in front of the couch,” Mydei instructed him, tightening his collar. “Face the cushions.”

Phainon took a few steps forward, looking at his couch as heavy footsteps trailed behind him. Plastic soon crinkled, a seal cracked open, and his head tilted back when a plastic rim touched his lips.

“Drink.”

He did, closing his eyes and gulping down as much as Mydei wanted. After he finished, the couch gave a creak. His attention was immediately in front of him again.

Mydei looked good lounging back on the couch like that, his hair tied back in a ponytail and sweat glistening over his skin. A towel was behind him, stopping his damp tank-top from directly touching his cushions. Another was wrapped around the back of his neck. His top was darkened both underneath and between his pectorals, then even more under his arms.

He didn’t dress up extensively. There was a leather belt around his arm, bulging around the muscle, his gloves and cuffs, and the chunky boots they both loved. He still wore his black gym shorts, but he took his leggings off, leaving his hairy, bare legs and thick thighs completely visible. In that same regard, having them spread so wide made the tent *that* much more visible.

“Where are you looking?” Mydei asked, dropping a hand to the hem of his way too loose shorts. He peeled both sides higher one by one, revealing his upper thighs and the very tip of his bulge from behind his briefs.

Phainon tore his eyes away, and while Mydei moved his hands to pick up one of the four cuffs he gathered, he didn’t fix his shorts. He left them just like that—pulled up to show off all of his legs and peeks of his burgundy briefs.

“Come.”

Wrist after wrist, Mydei tightened the handcuffs higher and tighter than he usually did. Ankle after ankle, he did the very same thing. Mydei had him roll each, testing his movement. He had him jump, making sure they wouldn’t slide too much and end up hurting him.

When content with the display, he leaned back again. His arms folded behind his head, relaxing comfortably to just admire the sight of his cuffed and tied up body. Eyes to calves then back up again, he gave him multiple full body looks like he simply couldn’t stop.

Phainon shifted, unable to look away from his flushed cheeks.

Mydei looked so pleased and so relaxed. It was as if he were enjoying every second of this kinky, sexually charged yet completely sex-free play.

Both of them were hard, one look said all that needed to be said about that. But Mydei hadn’t even touched his body, and he never said he would either.

“You may get on your hands and knees now,” Mydei allowed him, meeting his eyes as he lifted his legs.

Lowering to the floor, Phainon positioned himself accordingly. The weight of Mydei’s calf touched his back, and he stared down at the rug while wondering if he liked that. As the second lowered, hovering over his body without yet settling, he took a deep breath.

This was like those videos he saw before… Only, the men were completely naked with violet bruises embedded into their asses, and the books on their backs were caked in filth to rub it over their skin. He watched the submissives get whipped with a long stick, listened to them scream and cry, then roll over to have their balls stepped on until they nearly popped. It was all so dark and horrifying.

But being here with Mydei felt… okay. Having him shift to settle his clean boots over his back and kneeling for him like this wasn’t gross or anything.

Phainon couldn’t imagine being whipped, used as a floor mat to rub mud and grime against his clean skin, or rolling onto his back and letting Mydei’s heavy boot crush his balls like a bug beneath it. None of that side of *BDSM* appealed to him whatsoever.

Mydei wasn’t interested in anything more than using his hand for impact play anyway, and he’d never allow mud in his house to begin with. And if he wanted to crush his balls, that’d definitely would’ve came up already like face slapping and spanking. Clearly, those things didn’t appeal to his dominant either.

But they liked leather. He liked kneeling to show his submission, and Mydei liked watching him do it. He liked tying his boots as the soles touched his thigh, and Mydei liked pointing with his toes to bump his cock around. Together, they liked the position they were in now.

Mydei liked it because Phainon knew the kind of person he was, and he liked everything this represented. It was right up his alley.

Phainon liked it because it wasn't as humiliating or scary as he thought it'd be, and it was another way to make his lover happy. In making him happy, he made himself happy, and this wasn't so bad. He could do this.

Maybe it felt a little bit *degrading* to be reduced to a footrest. Maybe it felt a little bit *uncomfortable* to have his lover looking down on him like this. But it wasn't necessarily the kind that turned him *off*.

"Do you like it there underneath my boots?" Mydei asked, beginning to lightly shake one foot side to side.

"I… do, master," he admitted, unable to look back at him. "I like it here."

"Heh… Then what are you waiting for? Start your workout." One foot lifted, then dropped down over his back. The force made his arms lightly buckle. "Give me three sets of fifteen push-ups, boy."

Phainon lifted his knees, straightened his back, then took a deep breath before bending his elbows down.

"*One*," Mydei counted for him, voice full of authority. "Again."

He repeated the process.

"*Two*. Again."

"Master, isn't this a-a little…" Phainon paused, thinking of a word to say. Between his scrambled brain and the warmth in his veins, it proved difficult to continue. "This feels like some kind of *soldier-sergeant* roleplay… Am I in boot camp or something?"

"Mm… Phainon, I could talk your ear off about the history of gay army men, kink, and the leather they wore that makes *this* kind of feel like *that*, but I'll save you the ear full," he brushed off. "For now, just keep that body moving. Give me another."

Phainon obeyed, listening to him count.

"Can you please tell me the story some time, master?" He asked hopefully, curious to know what he did. It was always so nice listening to him ramble and picking his brain to see how *he* saw things.

"Do you really care that much about it?" Mydei asked, continuing to count in between their conversation. "It's just information I learned while researching my way around. You can just have a kink and think men in leather is sexy, or you can find the clothes themselves to have a rebellious; bad-boy appeal. You don't need to know all of the extra stuff."

"If we both practice this, then we should both know how it started, right?" He reasoned. Phainon hoped to coax him open when he was trying to clam up, to let him know he wanted to learn more than just the sex appeal part of his kinks. "If this i-is gonna be the rest of my life, I should know where the stuff I practice comes from."

“Okay,” he agreed without any more convincing. “Let’s read about it tonight. It’s… pretty interesting, actually.”

“Is it?”

“I guess if you’re like me, it is.” That sounded a little bit double-edged to him. “I always get… *excessive*… when I start to like something. I like to know it all. To me, it’s more interesting than anything.”

“It’s so cool that you know so much about all of this. You’re very passionate,” he praised him, then turned his head to look at him while lifting himself higher. Mydei was already doing the same back. “Thank you for teaching me all that you know, master.”

His pink lips raised for a light smile, and his eyes followed him as Phainon gave him another push-up.

“Thank you for always p-pushing me out of my comfort zone, master."

And another.

“Thank you for tying me up even if I was a brat last night, master. I planned to be a-an even bigger brat to you today,” he confessed to him, then set his knees down to rest as he had finished his set. “Because I like when you’re a little mean and teasing to me.”

“I can tell. I have to think up more punishments because you’re starting to like them all,” he accused, lifting one leg to set the sole of his shoe to his side. The ropes took most of the rough, bumpy feeling from his skin. “Later, I want to fuck your mouth. You’re going to swallow my load.”

“Thank you for allowing me to have your cum for breakfast, master,” he said, and Mydei groaned softly. “Do I start my second set now?”

“Go. Give me fifteen more, boy,” he ordered him, and Phainon settled on his hands and toes as Mydei adjusted his legs over his back. “Keep yourself sexy for me. Don’t stop now.”

“For you,” Phainon repeated softly, then gave him a push-up.

“*One*. Again.”

He could get used to this if Mydei wanted him to. Really. So far, this was comfortable for him.

—

Push-ups, planks, crunches, squats, and more, anything that could be done under his boots was done with the added weight in his back. Anything that couldn’t be was spent looking at

Mydei, reminding himself that he was doing this for him. Every time he wanted to call it, he pushed a little bit further just to hear his praise. With it, he was given a little bit more time to rest and have water in between.

Continuing his workout, Mydei didn't bring out the nipple clamps until Phainon had his back to the wall. At this point, all of his muscles were slightly sore from the different exercises he had done. While preparing to do a wall-sit, he pushed his head back too for support. Tired, half-lidded eyes watched as his dominant came closer and closer with the silicone tipped clamps in hand.

He had taken the chain off of them, saving him the weight of having them tugged down even more. Rubber rolled around his nipple, brushing the bud but not yet taking a bite from it. The cool tip sliding over his skin felt nice, and he panted softly while watching it. Anticipation burned in his blood, waiting for the painful pinch he remembered.

"Do you know why I'm doing this?"

"Because I-I'm a brat who needs to remember my body belongs to you, master," he answered, sucking in a breath when the tip settled over his nipple directly.

"That's right. And you don't like these clamps very much, do you?" Mydei asked next. "But that doesn't matter. Why?"

"Because I'm owned by you, so *you* decide what I get and don't get. *You're* my master," he recited, once again reminding himself this was *for Mydei.*

It benefited his body to work out, but doing it in front of him like this was for *Mydei's* viewing pleasure. His shaking, bound body against Mydei's relaxed, leather clad one was to reinstate the power imbalance between them both. They both liked this, and maybe he suggested it, but Mydei agreed because *Mydei wanted this*.

"Good boy," he coo'ed, opening the clamp but not yet closing it. Instead, they rubbed up and down on each side, letting him grow more accustomed to it. "Hold it. Squeeze it. Feel how strong they are."

Phainon took one into his hand, pinching to ensure it didn't accidentally close on him. He felt the weighty handles, toyed with the dial on the side curiously, and neared it to clamp down on him just to feel how much force was needed to open them back up. While in his hand, they weren't as big and intimidating.

"Give it back now."

Mydei took it from him, then turned them so they'd pinch top to bottom. One more rub made Phainon shiver.

"Look at these big and beautiful nipples," he praised him, toying with his body a little bit longer. "Look how puffy and pink. I love your chest, do you know that?"

"I do, master."

“And because I love it, I want to hurt it, do you know *that?*” He mused, closing the clap a little bit more. “Because I love them, I want to clamp, bite, and pinch these guys until you have tears in your pretty eyes. Do you think that’s fair?”

“Yes, master,” he said back, then flicked his gaze upwards. His wide eyes locked with Mydei’s slightly narrowed ones, taking in their sadistic glint and excitement. “Please punish my nipples. Please make me cry.”

“Don’t look down. Look at me as I put this right… here…”

The clamp closed, touching either side of the left bud. It didn’t clamp, not yet, but Mydei watched his tickle of nerves and fear from the wait. He watched him swallow and take in a deep breath, attempting to steel himself.

”*One… Two…*”

Phainon nodded weakly upon his little glance to his chest.

”*Three*.”

Then Mydei let go, and Phainon whimpered as a dull pressure enclosed around his nipple. His second followed soon after, biting down on the sensitive skin.

“Do they hurt?”

“Yeah,” he whispered honestly. Upon seeing his raised eyebrow, his head shook. “I-I mean, yes, master. It hurts. It pinches so much h-harder than your fingers…”

One hand inched to touch, wanting to take it off, but Mydei stopped him by gripping his wrist and pinning it back. Leather stuck to his sweaty skin, rubbing to his wrist.

“You look so sexy like this.” The compliment over his pain made his cock throb. “Those nipples were made to be tortured for my pleasure. One day, I’ll take the ropes and tie them around your nipples so they’re constantly being stimulated.”

Phainon moaned, head tilting back into the wall.

“And if they get itchy from the friction, I’ll use my mouth and tongue to soothe them because *I’m so nice to you*,” he offered. “But that’s *for you*. *This* is *for me*, so take these clamps like the good boy I know you are. Next time you want to forget your place, remember their bite. Remember I own chains and weights to make it even worse than it is. This is *merciful*, understand?”

Mydei pulled away, leaving him there to take in his entire body.

“Thank you f-for your mercy, master,” he choked out, feeling his cock ache from the pain. “Thank you for punishing my poor behavior.”

It hurt, but it hurt in the way a *spanking* did. It hurt in the way a *slap to the face* did. Sweet yet sharp, deepening the more he sat through them.

“Now, give me three sets of wall-sits,” Mydei instructed him. “Remember your safe word. Maintain proper form.”

Phainon tapped his head to the wall, brought his legs out, tightened his sore stomach, and lowered into a sitting position. For extra measure, a gloved hand wrapped around his face and kept him back.

Leather filled his senses. He smelled the peppery edge so vividly he could taste it and felt the texture press into his skin. It was so reminiscent of Mydei that his head spun as he closed his eyes. Everything in him tried to brave not just his tired legs, but his aching chest from the clamps.

“*Lick*.”

His tongue darted out, tasting his glove and moaning softly from it. It slid down his face slowly, allowing him to lick at skin next.

“Good boy. Keep it up. I’ll tell you when it’s time to yield, so just focus on my voice,” Mydei said gently. “You’re taking it so well.”

Phainon nodded, lost in a mix of both arousal and pain as his chest caved slightly. Another hand then touched his shoulder, thumbing the sweaty skin to try and soothe him. But clamps were heavy on their own. They lightly weighed down his chest and nipples, shaking and wiggling when he felt his body twitch or his breaths come too fast.

More seconds passed as he basked in his attention. Five. Ten. Fifteen. His legs were starting to ache after all the exercising.

“Rest.”

He relaxed, sliding up the wall to stand. As he did so, the fingers by his mouth pushed aside, cradling his sweaty cheek.

“Breathe, baby,” Mydei said, and he took a long drag through his nose before exhaling with his mouth. “Do you want some water?”

“Please, master.” He felt his hands leave. Before he could miss them, they were back. A water bottle touched his lips. “Mm… thank you, master…”

“Drink for me,” he encouraged him, and Phainon gulped it down. “You’re so close to being done. When you finish these sets, I will remove the clamps.”

Phainon felt him pull them away.

“Give me another.”

His legs stretched out, thighs tense and aching from previously doing lunges and squats. But he assumed the position anyway, holding himself up as Mydei silently counted the seconds.

The ache in his muscles were almost more distracting than his chest, making his nipples hurt significantly less than before. He could chalk it up to mercy, that Mydei was well aware his workout would mask the brunt edge of his clamped nipples, but he liked to also think he had grown since the last time they brought them out. While they hurt, it wasn't scary like before. It wasn't something brand new and uncomfortable, sprung on him in a moment of pleasure where he felt too nervous to deny them.

"Come on," Mydei encouraged him, rubbing his thumb under his cheek. "Hold it, boy."

Phainon shook his head. "Master, I'm *so tired*…"

"Hold it," he repeated as he walked closer. His left leg slotted between his shaking ones, and both hands held his cheeks. "Look at me."

His torso came closer, and Phainon eyed his body before looking up through his lashes and his bangs.

"You're going to do it. I don't care if you're tired. I don't care if your legs shake. You're going to finish these sets," he ordered, voice firm and tight. "Don't make me punish you more. Do you want to make me happy, boy? Do you want to make me proud?"

"Y-Yeah… *Yes, master*," he corrected himself. "I wanna make you happy. *Please*. I wanna make you proud."

"That's what I like to hear," he coo'ed almost mockingly. "Come on. A couple more seconds, then you may rest."

Phainon's lip trembled next, forcing himself to hold the position until Mydei let his cheeks go. He reached down to cup his ass gently. His fingers gave a little tap to signal him to stand up and rest.

"One more set, and I'll take these off." Mydei's ghosting over the clamp as to not jostle it anymore. "Can you do that?"

"Yes, master."

A water bottle met his lips again, and he finished down the last of it this time around. Mydei set it on the floor beside them, tucking it out of the way. Then, those same fingers began to brush the hair from his face.

"You are so handsome," he praised him, admiring his expression. "Are you going to be my good boy and finish this for me?"

Phainon nodded.

"Are you proud of yourself for making it this far?"

He nodded again, reaching for Mydei's arms to grasp the muscle firmly and pull him closer. The desire to hold him, be close to him, and feel him against his body was too much to try and deny. After being looked at and used, it felt nice to be touched again.

“You should be.” Mydei smiled, allowing him that moment of reprieve. “Come on. Get ready to give me one more set, baby. Just one, then we’re done.”

“Yes, master.”

Phainon slid his feet down, groaning to himself as he lowered down to his seated position. His hands let go of Mydei, and his head thumped to the wall again. Immediately, his legs trembled and his form crumbled.

“*Ah ah*. Stick it,” Mydei chastised, forcing him to bring his feet in rather than stretching out. “Don’t get lazy on me.”

Each heavy breath rattled his chest, and as his hand reached to touch the bobbing clamps, Mydei took his cuff and pinning it to the wall. The second joined voluntarily, knowing that if it wasn’t held, he was definitely going to try and grab the other side. To cut the loss early, he simply handed his freedom away.

“Steady,” he soothed him. “If you keep breathing like that, you’re going to keep wiggling them. If you keep wiggling them, they’re going to pull. You know how to breathe when you’re working out, baby.”

Tears pinched in his eyes as his chest gave another cave, another bounce, and therefore, another tug on his sensitive nipples. It then made him curl again, which made them bounce again, tug again, cave again. The cycle was *vicious*. Mydei was right, but he was so tired. His head was so messy.

Phainon sniffled, shifting his feet to slide higher up the wall.

Mydei touched the base of his neck and around his collarbones upon noticing, lightly pressing down to keep him steady. That one touch stopped him from climbing any higher.

“Ten more seconds, baby. *Nine*.”

The end was close, yet his legs wanted nothing more than to sink to the floor and give in to gravity.

“*Eight*.”

“Master, please,” he begged, exhausted. “My chest hurts.”

“Seven seconds, prince, okay?” Mydei hushed, lowering his hand to touch the ropes in the middle of his chest. “*Six*… *Five*…”

So close. How were seconds so long?

“*Four. Three*. You’re doing so well,” he rushed to say as he reached towards his left nipple. “*Two*…”

The left clamp was pinched off.

"*One*."

The right clamp followed immediately, and Phainon lowered himself to the floor. His wrists were released, and he wiped his eyes while slumping down on the floor.

"Good job, baby. Those strong legs of yours lasted so long, and these pretty nipples took their punishment well."

With the clamps gone, he could feel the lingering tenderness of them as the cool air blew over his hit skin. Just that little brush had him whimpering, body wincing.

"Shh…"

Mydei squatted down in front of him, both hands cupping his chest to lightly massage close to his nipple but not quite on it. The touch felt nice, soothing even, and he sighed softly while trying to calm himself down.

"Did I do good, master?" He asked quietly. Shaky hands gripped his tank-top, easing him closer until he was as close as his bent body could be. "Are you happy with me?"

"I am so happy with you, Phainon," he reassured him. "Thank you for taking your clamps so well for me, prince. I am so, *so* proud of my boy."

Phainon nodded, resting on his collarbone and closing his eyes in comfort. Rather than touching his chest, he curled them to rub his back instead. Despite how sticky and gross, or how sore and tired, his body felt at that moment, he just wanted to be *held*. All he needed was a minute or so of Mydei holding him just like this, then however long it'd take to untie him from these ropes, then a quick rinse before a big breakfast.

Ah, but… Mydei wanted a blow job, right?

Maybe he should blow him first, then get his hugs and everything else second. Because this was *for Mydei*, and he wanted to both entertain him *and* pleasure him.

One hand dragged lower, following his stomach and stopping at his crotch. He cupped him, holding his balls and thumbing at his stiffened cock while trying to find the strength to open his mouth and let him fuck it.

Did he *really* want to right now? Would it be unfair if he said he was too tired?

"Not right now." Mydei stopped him by lightly batting his hand away. "Right now, I want to hold you for a second, get you out of these sweaty ropes, and put some food on your plate. Later, we can talk about blow jobs and orgasms."

"But… you wanted to feed me your cum for breakfast."

"No, Phainon. I'm feeding you a nice, big omelette full of veggies and cheese, then some breakfast sausage for more protein," he mused. "*You* said you wanted cum for breakfast. The last time I checked, my load wasn't part of the food pyramid, so it's not significant enough to be part of any meal."

His hand dropped, and he nuzzled closer to him upon realizing Mydei wasn't going to make him take it right now. Not that he figured he would, but… maybe he owed it to him for saying he wanted to before he got too tired.

No. That didn't sound right.

His head felt like such a mess after all of their exercising and playing…

"Let me put some food in your belly, my prince." Mydei kissed his forehead next. "Let's take a breather, and before we shower, you and I could give each other a blowjob if you're up for it."

"Yeah?"

He'd like that. Right now, he didn't want to do anything but sit down and relax. But *later* would be fine.

"Yes. You don't need to worry about a thing right now but coming down, breathing, and being held," he murmured, allowing him to melt into his body. "Do you like being held, baby?"

"Yeah," he whispered. "And… I liked having your boots on me."

"That's good to know because I enjoyed the power it gave it. How did those clamps make you feel?" He wondered, rubbing his shoulder blades slowly. "Still bad?"

"No. They're okay," he answered honestly, wincing because of his throbbing nipples rubbing against Mydei's ribbed tank-top. "For you, o-or for punishment, I'll wear them. But not too long, please. I think my chest is just too sensitive, so… it needs to get more used to it."

Mydei nodded lightly, kissing his head again as he held him closely to his body for another moment. For all Phainon cared, they could stay like this all day.

But they made plans. Mydei had things to do and things he wanted to do. Until that time came, however, he just wanted to be hugged and doted on for as long as possible.

Chapter End Notes

i am both into bdsm and a part of lgbt. that being said, ive always known about 'leather' pride and the minor links between both when it comes to the gay community. its hard not to see it, you know?

but since writing this, ive done a lot more in depth research on it, the history, the correlations, the epidemics, the raids, and more in the post-war era. its truly fascinating stuff. if you have time, maybe pop a look into it if you get curious of it too or wanna write yourself/explore more on it on your own. im no educator, so im nervous of

speaking too much on it in the story, but know mydei knows about this all. mydei LOVES his history.

i might touch on it before this ends, but like i said, im no educator. i just love bdsm a lot. (i say that too much i think)

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